

# Ā'īna-e-Kamālāt-e-Islām

*(The Mirror of the Excellences of Islam)*

**Also named: Dāfi'ul-Wasāwis**

*(Remover of Misgivings)*



## **The Mirror of the Excellences of Islam**

English translation of *Ā'īna-e-Kamālāt-e-Islām*

Written by Ḥaḍrat Mirza Ghulam Ahmad  
The Promised Messiah and Mahdi, peace be on him,  
Founder of the Ahmadiyya Muslim Community

First published in Qadian, India, 1893  
First English translation published in the UK, 2025

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Published by  
Islam International Publications Ltd.  
Unit 3, Bourne Mill Business Park  
Guildford Road  
Farnham, Surrey GU9 9PS, UK

For further information, please visit [www.alislam.org](http://www.alislam.org)

Cover design: Salman Muhammad Sajid

ISBN: 978-1-83596-202-2

10 9 8 7 6 5 4 3 2 1

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*by*

**Ḥaḍrat Mirza Ghulam Ahmad**

*The Promised Messiah and Mahdi<sup>as</sup>,  
Founder of the Ahmadiyya Muslim Community*





# CONTENTS

## FRONT MATTER

|                               |             |
|-------------------------------|-------------|
| <i>About the Author</i> ..... | <i>xi</i>   |
| <i>Publisher's Note</i> ..... | <i>xiii</i> |
| <i>Foreword</i> .....         | <i>xvii</i> |
| <i>Introduction</i> .....     | <i>xix</i>  |

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*Ā'īna-e-Kamālāt-e-Islām*  
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## INTRODUCTION

|                                                                                                                                                                           |    |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----|
| A Few Couplets for My Community as Advice & a Call to Islam<br>(بکوشید اسے جو انسان تابہ دین قوت شود پیدا) .....                                                          | 1  |
| Address .....                                                                                                                                                             | 5  |
| Persian Poem (محبت تو دوائے ہزار بیماری است) .....                                                                                                                        | 5  |
| In the Praise & Glory of Our Blessed Master—Sovereign Lord<br>of Both Realms—Muhammad Muṣṭafā & Ahmad Muḥtabā <sup>ṣas</sup><br>(چون زمین آید ثنائے سرور عالی تبار) ..... | 31 |
| Preface .....                                                                                                                                                             | 47 |
| Persian Poem (بدہ از چشم خود آبلے در خمان محبت را) .....                                                                                                                  | 71 |

|                                                                                                                                               |     |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----|
| Essence of Islam .....                                                                                                                        | 77  |
| <i>Footnote</i> .....                                                                                                                         | 165 |
| <i>Sub-Footnote</i> .....                                                                                                                     | 221 |
| Admonition—Misconception in the <i>Nūr Afshān</i> .....                                                                                       | 243 |
| <i>Note about a Vision</i> .....                                                                                                              | 251 |
| <i>Urdu Poem—Blessings of Islam (ہر طرف فکر کو دوڑا کے تھکایا ہم نے)</i> .....                                                                | 260 |
| <i>Fruits of Islam</i> .....                                                                                                                  | 264 |
| <i>Footnote—An Essential Conclusive Argument for</i><br><i>Sayyed Ahmad Khan C.S.I.</i> .....                                                 | 279 |
| Announcement for the Mubāhalah .....                                                                                                          | 307 |
| Announcement for Religious & Other Leaders .....                                                                                              | 313 |
| <i>Addressed to All Clergymen, Hindus, Aryas, Brahmus, Sikhs,</i><br><i>Atheists, Naturalists, &amp; Other Gentlemen</i> .....                | 313 |
| Blessed are the Truthful, for They Shall Triumph in the End....                                                                               | 319 |
| Announcement of a Prophecy prior to its Fulfilment .....                                                                                      | 321 |
| Correspondence with Shaikh Muhammad Ḥusain Batālawī .....                                                                                     | 331 |
| A Letter to Shaikh Muhammad Ḥusain Batālawī .....                                                                                             | 331 |
| <i>Witnesses</i> .....                                                                                                                        | 333 |
| Batālawī Statements & Their Responses .....                                                                                                   | 334 |
| A Letter from Muhammad Ḥusain Batālawī .....                                                                                                  | 354 |
| Rebuttal to Shaikh Batālawī .....                                                                                                             | 365 |
| Correspondence with Nawwab Muhammad Ali Khan .....                                                                                            | 373 |
| Letter from Nawwab Muhammad Ali Khan .....                                                                                                    | 373 |
| Letter to Nawwab Muhammad Ali Khan .....                                                                                                      | 379 |
| Persian Poem (چون مرا نوری پئی قومی مسجدی دادہ اند) .....                                                                                     | 422 |
| <i>At-Tablīgh</i> —Conveying the Message .....                                                                                                | 423 |
| To the Descendants of Pīrs, Devotees, Faqīrs, Ascetics, & Ṣūfis in<br>India, Punjab, Arabia, Persia, Egypt, Iran, Turkey, and Beyond<br>..... | 423 |

|                                                                                                                        |     |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----|
| Letter—To the Eminent Leaders and Scholars of India &<br>Mystics of Afghanistan and Egypt & Other Nations.....         | 429 |
| Letter—To the Noble and Pious of the Arabs .....                                                                       | 459 |
| Addendum—A Brief Account of My Life and Blessings of the<br>Gracious God .....                                         | 497 |
| An Account of the British Empire and the Empress of India.....                                                         | 505 |
| An Addendum—Further Details about My Life, My Ancestors, and<br>My Brethren in Faith .....                             | 517 |
| An Account of Some of My Helpers.....                                                                                  | 563 |
| <i>Qaṣīdah</i> —An Ode in Praise of the Holy Prophet <sup>ṣas</sup><br>(يَا عَيْنَ فَيْضِ اللَّهِ وَالْعُوفَانِ) ..... | 575 |
| Guidance for Those Who Reflect (بُطْطَلَعٌ عَلَى أَشْرَارِ بَالِي).....                                                | 585 |
| <i>Qaṣīdah</i> —Pearls of Guidance for Seekers of Truth<br>(أُمِرْتُ مِنَ اللَّهِ الْكَرِيمِ الْمُمَجِّدِ).....        | 591 |
| Reply to Shaikh Muhammad Ḥusain Batālawī's Paper .....                                                                 | 597 |
| A Spiritual Sign to Recognize the Truthful.....                                                                        | 605 |
| Sign of the Day of Judgment .....                                                                                      | 611 |
| Proceedings of the <i>Jalsa</i> of 27 December 1892.....                                                               | 629 |
| Names of Those Who Participated in the <i>Jalsa Salana</i> .....                                                       | 632 |
| Worthy of the Attention of the Readers .....                                                                           | 645 |
| An Important Announcement—Regarding Printing Press.....                                                                | 647 |
| List of Contributors— <i>Jalsa</i> Qadian 1892.....                                                                    | 648 |
| For the Attention of Friends.....                                                                                      | 655 |
| <i>Jalsa Salana</i> Qadian—Proceedings and Personal Reflection .....                                                   | 657 |
| Couplets Written by Maulawī Muḥammad ‘Abdullāh Khān<br><i>Arabic Teacher, Mahinder College, Patiala</i> .....          | 667 |

|                                                                                                       |     |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----|
| Supplement of the Newspaper Riyāḍ Hind Amritsar .....                                                 | 669 |
| About the Treatise <i>Sirāj-e-Munīr</i> —Consisting of the Signs<br>of the All-Powerful Lord .....    | 670 |
| Magnificent Light of Muhammad—Persian Poem (عجب نورست در جان محمد) .....                              | 679 |
| A Prophecy regarding Lekh Rām of Peshawar .....                                                       | 683 |
| Announcement about the Book— <i>Ā'īna-e-Kamālāt-e-Islām</i> .....                                     | 687 |
| Shaikh Mehr Ali—Chief of Hoshiarpur .....                                                             | 689 |
| <i>Verdict</i> .....                                                                                  | 689 |
| Announcement—About <i>Barāhīn-e-Aḥmadiyya</i> .....                                                   | 697 |
| Original Translation of the Announcement .....                                                        | 701 |
| Concluding Persian Couplets in Gratitude<br>to the Glorious Lord (قربان تست جان من ای یار محسن) ..... | 703 |

## BACK MATTER

|                                                          |     |
|----------------------------------------------------------|-----|
| <i>Books of References</i> .....                         | 703 |
| <i>Commentaries of the Quran</i> .....                   | 707 |
| <i>Works of the Promised Messiah</i> <sup>as</sup> ..... | 708 |
| <i>Names of Prophets in the Book</i> .....               | 711 |
| <i>List of Places</i> .....                              | 713 |
| <i>Glossary</i> .....                                    | 715 |
| <i>Index</i> .....                                       | 723 |





Hadrat Mirza Ghulam Ahmad of Qadian  
*The Promised Messiah & Mahdi<sup>as</sup>*

## ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Ḥaḍrat Mirza Ghulam Ahmad<sup>as</sup> was born in 1835 in Qadian, India. From his early life, he dedicated himself to prayer and the study of the Holy Quran and other scriptures. He was deeply pained to observe the plight of Islam, which was being attacked from all directions. In order to defend Islam and present its teachings in their pristine purity, he wrote more than ninety books, thousands of letters, and participated in many religious debates. He argued that Islam is a living faith which can lead man to establish communion with God to achieve moral and spiritual perfection.

Ḥaḍrat Mirza Ghulam Ahmad<sup>as</sup> started experiencing Divine dreams, visions, and revelations at a young age. In 1889, under Divine command, he started accepting initiation into the Ahmadiyya Muslim Community. Divine revelations continued to increase and God commanded him to announce that He had appointed him to be that very Reformer of the Latter Days as prophesied by various religions under different titles. He claimed to be that very Prophet who the Holy Prophet Muhammad<sup>sas</sup> said would be raised as the Promised Messiah and Mahdi. The Ahmadiyya Muslim Community is now established in more than 200 countries.

After his demise in 1908, the second manifestation of Divine power was demonstrated, and the institution of *Khilāfat* (Successorship) was established to succeed him in fulfilment of the prophecies made in the Holy Quran, presented by the Holy Prophet Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>, and in the book of the Promised Messiah<sup>as</sup>, *al-Waṣiyyat*. Ḥaḍrat Mirza Masroor Ahmad<sup>aba</sup> is the Fifth Successor to the Promised Messiah<sup>as</sup> and the present Head of the Ahmadiyya Muslim Community.





## PUBLISHER'S NOTE

This current edition is the English translation of the original Urdu and Arabic composition. For the Arabic portions, we have additionally provided a reference to the page numbers for the source Arabic text in Rūḥānī Khazā'in. However, for poetry we have retained the original source language text along with its translation below it.

The translators' primary objective was to adhere to the original text of the Promised Messiah<sup>as</sup> as strictly as possible. Contemporary nineteenth century lexicons were utilized to precisely define Urdu, Arabic, and Persian words and phrases. To preserve the author's writing style, and particularly his points of emphasis, where possible we have retained his original underlined, varying font sizes, and bold text styling. However, to facilitate readability for an English speaking audience, punctuation and pauses were inserted as considered necessary, and lengthy paragraphs and sentences were broken into smaller ones. Grammatical rules, literary conventions, and presentation were generally applied in conformity to the *Oxford Guide to Style*.

Please note that, in the translation that follows, words given in parentheses ( ) are the words of the Promised Messiah<sup>as</sup>. If any explanatory words, translations of Arabic or Persian text, or phrases are added by the translators for the purpose of clarification, they are put in square brackets [ ]. Footnotes given by the publisher are marked [Publisher].

The Promised Messiah<sup>as</sup> has reproduced numerous pieces of correspondence by others in this book. To ensure that readers can easily distinguish between the Promised Messiah's words and these documents, we have inserted grey sidebars and side notes alongside the latter, and in some cases, separated out the text or footnote.

References to the Holy Quran contain the name of the *sūrah* [i.e. chapter] followed by a chapter:verse citation, e.g. *Sūrah al-Jumu'ah*, 62:4, and count *Bismillāhir-Raḥmānir-Raḥīm* ['In the name of Allah, the Gracious, the Merciful'] as the first verse in every chapter that begins with it. Throughout the book, the Promised Messiah<sup>as</sup> cites his earlier works, such as *Barāhīn-e-Aḥmadiyya*. In those places, we have given the corresponding page number to the 2008 edition of *Rūḥānī Khazā'in*, as the first editions are rare and not easily accessible. Where an English translation of such a book has already been published, we have also tried to give its citation. In places where we have cited the applicable verses from the Bible, all references are taken from the King James Version (KJV).

The following abbreviations have been used for salutations:

ṣas *ṣallallāhu 'alaihi wa sallam*, meaning 'may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him', is written after the name of the Holy Prophet Muhammad<sup>ṣas</sup>.

as *'alaihis-salām*, meaning 'may peace be on him', is written after the names of Prophets other than the Holy Prophet Muhammad<sup>ṣas</sup>.

ra *raḍiyallāhu 'anhu/'anhā/'anhum*, meaning 'may Allah be pleased with him/her/them', is written after the names of the Companions of the Holy Prophet Muhammad<sup>ṣas</sup> or of the Promised Messiah<sup>as</sup>.

rta *raḥmatullāhi 'alaihi/'alaihā/'alaihim*, meaning 'may Allah shower His mercy upon him/her/them', is written after the names of those deceased, pious Muslims who are not Companions of the Holy Prophet Muhammad<sup>ṣas</sup> or of the Promised Messiah<sup>as</sup>.

aba *ayyadahullāhu Ta'āla binaṣrihil-'Azīz*, meaning 'may Allah the Almighty help him with His powerful support', is written after the name of the present head of the Ahmadiyya Muslim Community, Ḥaḍrat Mirza Masroor Ahmad<sup>aba</sup>, Khalīfatul-Masīḥ V.

Readers are urged to recite the full salutations when reading the book. In general, we have adopted the following system established by the Royal Asiatic Society for our transliteration.

- ا at the beginning of a word, pronounced as *a*, *i*, *u* preceded by a very slight aspiration, like *h* in the English word *honour*.
- ث *th* – pronounced like *th* in the English word *thing*.
- ح *h* – a guttural aspirate, stronger than *h*.
- خ *kh* – pronounced like the Scottish *ch* in *loch*.
- ذ *dh* – pronounced like the English *th* in *that*.
- ص *s* – strongly articulated *s*.
- ض *ḍ* – similar to the English *th* in *this*.
- ط *t* – strongly articulated palatal *t*.
- ظ *ẓ* – strongly articulated *z*.
- ع ' – a strong guttural, the pronunciation of which must be learnt by the ear.
- غ *gh* – a sound similar to the French *r* in *grasseye*, and to the German *r*. It requires the muscles of the throat to be in the 'gargling' position to pronounce it.
- ق *q* – a deep guttural *k* sound.
- ء ' – a sort of catch in the voice.

Short vowels are represented by:

- a* for  (like *u* in *bud*).
- i* for  (like *i* in *bid*).
- u* for  (like *oo* in *wood*).

Long vowels by:

- $\bar{a}$  for ———<sup>ˆ</sup> or ٱ (like *a* in *father*).  
 $\bar{i}$  for ى ——— or ———<sup>ˆ</sup> (like *ee* in *deep*).  
 $\bar{u}$  for ُو ———<sup>ˆ</sup> (like *oo* in *root*).

Other vowels by:

- $ai$  for ى ———<sup>ˆ</sup> (like *i* in *site*).  
 $au$  for ُو ———<sup>ˆ</sup> (resembling *ou* in *sound*).

The consonants not included in the above list have the same phonetic value as in the principal languages of Europe. While the Arabic ٱ is represented by *n*, we have indicated the Urdu ٺ as *ñ*. As noted above, the single quotation mark ' is used for transliterating ع which is distinct from the apostrophe ' used for ء.

We have not transliterated some Arabic words which have become part of English language, e.g. Islam, Quran, Hadith, Mahdi, jihad, Ramadan, and ummah. The Royal Asiatic Society's rules of transliteration for names of persons, places, and other terms, are not followed throughout the book as many of the names contain non-Arabic characters and carry a local transliteration and pronunciation style.

## FOREWORD

*Ā'ina-e-Kamālāt-e-Islām* ('The Mirror of the Excellences of Islam') was written by Ḥaḍrat Mirza Ghulam Ahmad, the Promised Messiah<sup>as</sup> at a time when the beautiful face of Islam was being misrepresented and maligned on virtually every front. Ever so novel attacks were being contrived by the Christian missionaries, the Arya Samaj, and the proponents of various rational and scientific lines of thought. To make matters worse, the Muslim ulema were inadvertently harming it from within as they tried to reconcile Islamic teachings with the rational thoughts of the day. In this book, the Promised Messiah<sup>as</sup> refutes their assertions on the authority of his personal spiritual experiences, Divine revelations, and deeply insightful knowledge of the Qur'an and Hadith.

This book is also named *Dāfi'ul-Wasāwis* ('Remover of Misgivings') and is comprised of an Urdu section which was written in 1892 and another Arabic section written in 1893, which is entitled *At-Tablīgh*. This particular section represents the first time the Promised Messiah<sup>as</sup> had written a book in Arabic. During the composition of the book, the Promised Messiah<sup>as</sup> had twice experienced visions in which the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> had expressed his great pleasure upon the writing of a work of such lofty calibre. In another vision, the Promised Messiah<sup>as</sup> saw an angel calling upon the people to stand in reverence of such a noble book.

This is the English translation of the book, the review of which was guided closely by Ḥaḍrat Khalīfatul-Masīḥ V<sup>aba</sup>. My humble self was blessed with the opportunity to seek his guidance, obtain approval of the final translation of various passages, and convey his directives to the reviewers and other departments as necessary. As directed by Ḥuḍūr<sup>aba</sup>, I personally visited the United States of America to meet with the team members, guide them throughout the review process, and assist with the finalization of the book.

Publishing a book of this magnitude and calibre demands a tremendous effort and I would personally like to extend my sincere and heartfelt gratitude to all those who contributed towards its success. An initial translation of a significant portion of the Urdu section was carried out by Qāḍī 'Abdul-Ḥamīd and published serially in *The Sunrise* magazine. It was then revised by Wakālat-e-Taṣnīf. The Arabic parts were translated by Wakālat-e-Ishā'at and reviewed by Ibrahim Ikhlaḥ and Umar Nasser. The translation was finalized by Munawar Ahmed Saeed with valuable support from Dr. Waseem Ahmad Sayed, Naser-ud-Din Shams, Bushra Shahid, and Mirza Abdul-Wahab. The team that contributed to this immense task in Additional Wakālat-e-Taṣnīf consisted of Hassan Faiyaz Khan, Luqman Tahir Mahmood, Naveed Malik Qureshi, Jaleel Ahmad Akbar, Fouzan Mansoor Pal, Tariq Amjed, Sardar Anees Ahmad, Rawan Malas, Nasira Naseem, Amjad Mahmood Khan, Naemuddin Tahir, Salman Muhammad Sajid, Sabahat Ahmad Cheema, Asifah Wahab Mirza, and several others. I am also grateful to the various departments who were consulted for research and finalization—particularly the Taṣnīf and Ishā'at Departments, the Arabic and Persian Desks, and the Research Cell.

May Almighty Allah reward them and their families for their selfless services in this regard, *Āmīn*.

**al-Ḥāj Munīr-ud-Dīn Shams**

Additional Wakīlut-Taṣnīf, London

July 2025

## INTRODUCTION

*Ā'īna-e-Kamālāt-e-Islām* ('The Mirror of the Excellences of Islam') was written at a time when Islam was being defaced and disfigured by a host of enemies on every front. Penned by the Promised Messiah, Ḥaḍrat Mirza Ghulam Ahmad<sup>as</sup>, the book seeks to repel these attacks by holding a mirror to the beautiful face of Islam and showcases its charm, excellences, and perfection for all the world to see.

In the Preface of the book, the Promised Messiah<sup>as</sup> describes the painful state of affairs afflicting Islam at the time. Millions of books had been printed against Islam and the Holy Founder of Islam<sup>sas</sup>. Meanwhile, the ulema, who bore the lofty burden of defending the Faith, were too busy fighting each other over petty issues. Their insincerity and incompetence culminated in the apostasy of tens of thousands of Muslims, who joined ranks with the enemies of Islam. The naturalists and philosophers, on the other hand, had created yet another calamity by compromising the essentials of the Faith to harmonize it with modern science and rationality in a misguided manner.

The Promised Messiah<sup>as</sup> then elaborates upon the true essence of Islam, which entails a complete surrender to the will of God through the *fanā* (annihilation) of the ego and its selfish desires. This 'death' of one's ego and carnal passions is then followed by a new life which is termed *baqā* (revival) in which the Holy Spirit is completely bestowed and a spiritual life is breathed into the soul, ultimately culminating in the perfect bliss of *liqā* (union).

## Mission of the Promised Messiah

The Promised Messiah summarizes his purpose and mission as follows:

Almighty God, finding this age immersed in darkness, neglect, *kufr* [disbelief] and *shirk* [polytheism]; and seeing the decline of faith, sincerity, truth, and righteousness, has sent me so that He may re-establish the truth in the world—in knowledge, practice, morals, and creed. And so that He may safeguard Islam from the attacks of people who—under the cloaks of philosophy, naturalism, heresy, *shirk* and atheism—wish to inflict some harm upon this Divine garden. (*See* p. 273)

Accordingly, the Promised Messiah<sup>as</sup> challenges all seekers of truth—be they Christian, Hindu, Jew or Muslim—to show any Sign of the unseen, the reward for which he would present all his immovable property valued at approximately 10,000 rupees. (*See* p. 316)

## The Challenge of Science

The Promised Messiah<sup>as</sup> also addresses Muslims who are overly influenced by Western philosophy and modern science. In particular, Sir Sayyed Ahmad Khan, despite his passion to serve the interests of Islam, denied fundamental aspects of Islam to harmonize the Faith with contemporary science and philosophy. The Promised Messiah<sup>as</sup> calls him out, saying:

The egregious error which Sayyed Şāhib has committed is that he accepts modern philosophy to be so irrefutable and certain as if it is beyond any error, whereas this new philosophy and science is just as vulnerable as the errors which are being exposed of the former philosophy or science. ... He accredited the new



philosophy with an honour which solely belongs to the pure and certain Word of God. (*See* p. 282)

### **Mubāhalah against the Ulema**

The Promised Messiah<sup>as</sup> addresses all *maulawīs* and muftis who have declared him a disbeliever and challenges them to a *mubāhalah*. He cites that disagreements have been prevalent amongst Muslims since the inception of Islam, but it never justified declaring anyone a disbeliever.

### **Arabic Section Entitled At-Tabligh**

In the Arabic section, *at-Tabligh*, the Promised Messiah<sup>as</sup> writes about his love for the land of Arabia and its people, and counsels them to heed his call. He proceeds to refute the Christian critique of Islam, and he addresses the *faqīrs* [mendicants], the *zāhids* [ascetics], and the respectable people of Arabia, India and other countries, informing them of his Divine mission. He proves through the Holy Quran and Hadith that Jesus<sup>as</sup> had died, and exclaims that it is simply impossible that the Holy Prophet Muhammad, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, should be buried underground while Jesus<sup>as</sup> thrives up in the heavens.

He also calls upon the Queen of England to accept Islam for it is now the only religion acceptable to God. He advises her to repent and to hearken to his words.

### **Love and Defence of the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>**

The most prominent hallmark consistently displayed throughout the Promised Messiah's career is his unwavering and relentless love and

defence of the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>. The Promised Messiah devotes a considerable portion of *Ā'īna-e-Kamālāt-e-Islām* to eradicating the misconceptions of the Muslim ulema', which were inadvertently helping the Christians prove their false belief in the superiority of Jesus<sup>as</sup> over Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>. By adopting the view that Jesus the Messiah did not die, the ulema' had granted superiority and distinction to the Messiah. Also refuted are their misconceptions surrounding the Holy Spirit and the false exclusivity they give to Jesus the Messiah<sup>as</sup>.

The Promised Messiah<sup>as</sup> goes on to express his profound love for the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> as follows:

That high degree of light which was granted to man—that is to say, upon the perfect man—was not within the angels, the stars, the moon, or the sun; neither was it in the oceans and the rivers of the earth, nor was it in rubies, emeralds, sapphires, diamonds, or pearls. In short, it was not in any earthly or heavenly object. It was only in man; that is, the perfect man, whose most complete, highest and loftiest, and most perfect example was our **Lord and Master, the Chief of the Prophets, the Chief of all living ones, Muhammad, the Chosen One, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him.** (*See* p. 142)

While composing the book, the Promised Messiah<sup>as</sup> experienced powerful spiritual corroboration in the form of dreams, visions, and revelations. He writes that he was honoured by a blessed vision of the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>, who expressed his great pleasure of the book, at one point saying, 'This is in my praise and this is in praise of my Companions.' This was followed by the revelation from God Almighty, 'This is My praise.' In addition, the Promised Messiah had seen an angel who was calling people towards the book with a loud voice, proclaiming, 'This is a blessed book, so arise in deference to its glory and grandeur.' (*See* p. 543, 688)

The book *Āīna-e-Kamālāt-e-Islām* stands as a towering testimony to the immense scope of the Promised Messiah's mission. It serves as evidence that he was, in fact, that solitary soul who would rise up in the Latter Days and defend the Faith against all odds, proving that God's glory would ultimately reign supreme.

**Mirza Masroor Ahmad**

Khalīfatul-Masīḥ V

United Kingdom

June 12, 2025

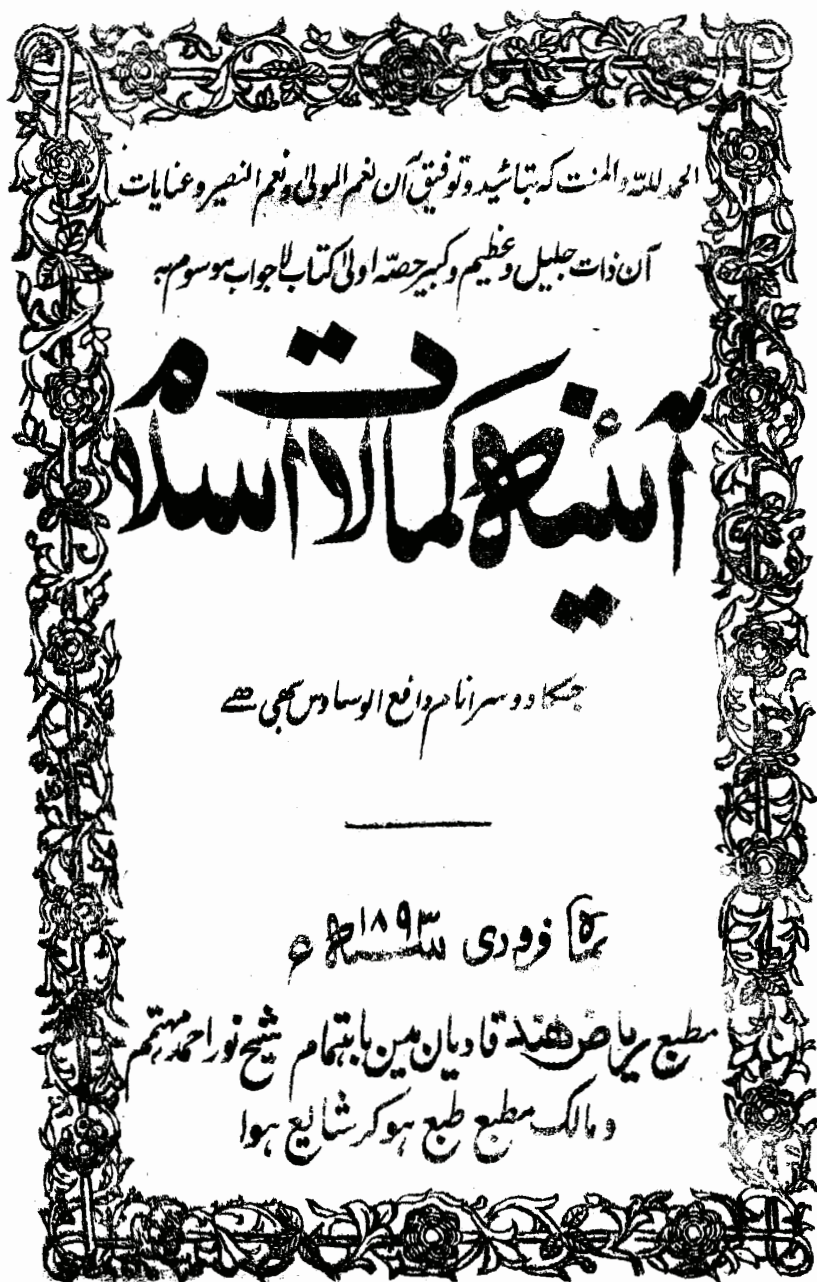


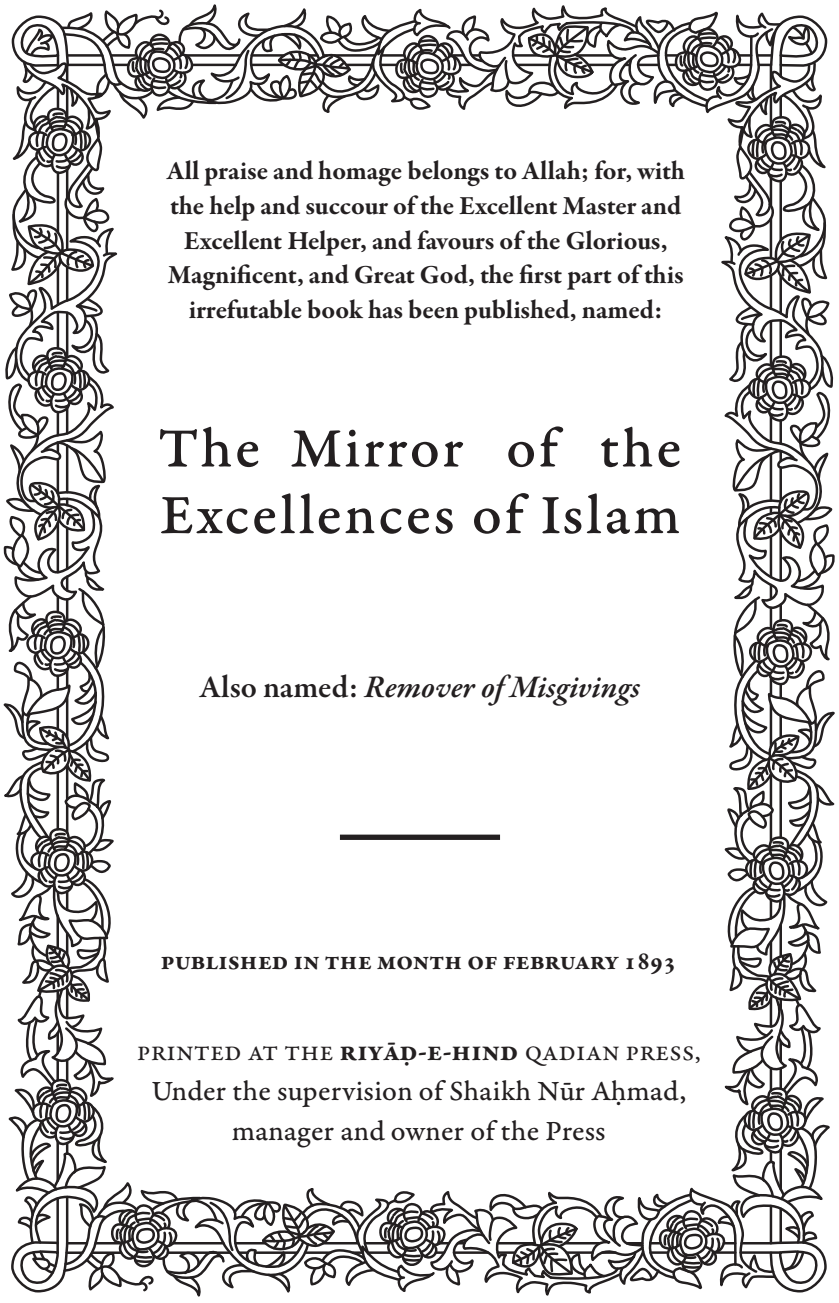
# Ā'īna-e-Kamālāt-e-Islām

*(The Mirror of the Excellences of Islam)*

**Also named: Dāfi'ul-Wasāwis**

*(Remover of Misgivings)*



A decorative border of stylized flowers and vines surrounds the text.

All praise and homage belongs to Allah; for, with  
the help and succour of the Excellent Master and  
Excellent Helper, and favours of the Glorious,  
Magnificent, and Great God, the first part of this  
irrefutable book has been published, named:

# The Mirror of the Excellences of Islam

Also named: *Remover of Misgivings*

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PUBLISHED IN THE MONTH OF FEBRUARY 1893

PRINTED AT THE RIYĀD-E-HIND QADIAN PRESS,  
Under the supervision of Shaikh Nūr Aḥmad,  
manager and owner of the Press





## A FEW COUPLETS FOR MY COMMUNITY AS ADVICE & A CALL TO ISLAM

بکوشید اے جوانانِ تابہ دین قوت شود پیدا      بہار و رونق اندر روضہٴ مِلّت شود پیدا  
*Strive hard—O valiant ones!—so that the Faith may gain strength,  
And freshness and elegance may flourish in the garden of Islam.*

اگر یارانِ کنون بر غُرَبِ اسلامِ رحم آرید      باصحابِ نبی نزد خدا نسبت شود پیدا  
*Friends! Should you have compassion for the plight of Islam,  
You will be—in the eyes of God—akin to the Companions of the Prophet.*

نفاق و اختلافِ ناشائسان از میان خیزد      کمالِ اتفاق و عُلّت و اُلفت شود پیدا  
*Hypocrisy and discord will be removed from the ignorant;  
Perfect harmony, brotherhood, and friendship will be cultivated.*

بجَنبِ اِز پے کوشش کہ از درِ گاؤِ ربّانی      ز بہرِ ناصرانِ دینِ حقِ نصرت شود پیدا  
*So rise up to strive, for surely from God's court,  
Assistance will appear for the helpers of Islam.*

اگر امروز فکرِ عِزّتِ دین در شما جو شد      شما را نیز و اللہ رتبت و عِزّت شود پیدا  
*Should any sympathy for the honour of the Faith burn in you this day—  
I swear by Allah—ye shall likewise attain dignity and honour.*

اگر دستِ عطا در نصرتِ اسلام بکشائید      ہم از بہر شما ناگہ یدِ قدرت شود پید  
*Should ye extend forth the hand of generosity for the victory of Islam,  
 Likewise shall ye behold the sudden manifestation of the Hand of  
 Power.*

ز بذلِ مال در راہش کسے مفلس نہی گردد      خدا خود میثود ناصر اگر ہمت شود پیدا  
*Lavish spending in His way left no one a pauper;  
 God Himself is the Helper if you cultivate the resolve.*

دو روز عمر خود در کارِ دین کوشید اے یاران      کہ آخر ساعتِ رحلتِ بصدِ حسرت شود پیدا  
*O Friends! Spend the fleeting days of your life in serving the Faith;  
 For, in the final hour, death comes with a hundred regrets.*

امیدِ دین روا گردان امید تو روا گردد      ز صد نومیدی و یاسِ عالمِ رحمت شود پیدا  
*Fulfil the needs of the Faith, so that your needs be fulfilled—  
 In the face of hundreds of disappointments, pains, and sufferings, you  
 will experience Divine mercy.*

در انصارِ نبیؐ بنگر کہ چون شد کار تادانی      کہ از تائیدِ دین سرچشمہ دولت شود پیدا  
*Look at how the Anṣār [Helpers] of the Prophet<sup>sa</sup> worked  
 To realize that serving the Faith generates a fountain of wealth.*

بجو از جان و دل تا خدمتے از دست تو آید      بقائے جاودانِ یابی گر لہنِ شربت شود پیدا  
*Strive with your heart and soul that some service be rendered by you;  
 If you produce this sweet sherbet, you will attain everlasting life.*

بمفتِ لہنِ اجرِ نصرتِ راہِ ہندت اے افی ورنہ      قضاے آسمانِ ستِ لہنِ بہر حالت شود پیدا  
*The reward of the service will be conferred upon you freely—O  
 brother!—otherwise,  
 This is the heavenly decree that will certainly be fulfilled.*

ہی بینم کہ دادار قدیر و پاک می خواهد کہ باز آن قوت اسلام و آن شوکت شود پیدا  
*I see that it is the will of God—the Almighty and Holy—  
 That Islam arise, once again, to its power and glory.*

کریم احد کرم کن بر کسے کو ناصر دین است بلائے او بگردان گر گئے آفت شود پیدا  
*O my Benevolent God! Shower abundant graces upon the one who is a  
 helper of the Faith,  
 And if a calamity befalls, do avert it.*

چنان خوش دار اور اے خدائے قادر مطلق کہ در ہر کار و بار و حال او جنت شود پیدا  
*O God, the All-Powerful! Keep him so content,  
 That his every situation and circumstance manifest into Paradise.*

دریغ و درد قوم من ندائے من نے شنود زہر درمے دہم پندش مگر عبرت شود پیدا  
*Alas! My people pay no heed to my wailing and crying;  
 I admonish them in every way—would they but take heed!*

مرا باور نمی آید کہ چشم خویش بکشاند مگر و قتیکہ خوف و عفت و خشیت شود پیدا  
*I do not believe that they will open their eyes,  
 Until they cultivate righteousness, piety, and fear of God.*

مراد بجال و کذاب و تراز کافران فہمند نمی دانم چرا از نور حق نفرت شود پیدا  
*They deem me to be a deceiver, liar, and worse than disbelievers.  
 I cannot understand why they hate the light of God.*

عجب دارید اے نا آشیایان غافلان از دین کہ از حق چشمہ حیوان درین ظلمت شود پیدا  
*Are you amazed—O ye heedless and careless of the Faith!—  
 That amidst this darkness, a fountain of life sprung forth from God?*

چرا انسان تعجب با کند در فکر این معنی      که خواب آلودگان را رافع غفلت شود پیدا

*Why should anyone be surprised that*

*A remover of heedlessness has been raised for those intoxicated with slumber?*

فراموش شد اے قوم احادیث نبی اللہ      کہ نزد ہر صدی یک مصلح اُمت شود پیدا

*O my people! Have you forgotten the aḥādīth of the Prophet of Allah,*

*That a Reformer of the Ummah would be raised at the head of every century?*

رَبِّ يَسِّرْ وَلَا تَعْسِرْ وَتَكْم بِالْخَيْرِ  
O my Lord, make it  
easy and not difficult  
and bring it to  
completion in a goodly  
manner.

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

In the name of Allah, the Gracious, the Merciful

رَبِّ يَسِّرْ وَلَا تَعْسِرْ وَتَكْم بِالْخَيْرِ  
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نَحْمَدُهُ وَنُصَلِّى  
عَلَى رَسُولِهِ الْكَرِيمِ

We praise Him and  
invoke blessings  
upon His Noble  
Messenger.

يَا قَيُّوْمُ اسْتَعِذْ بِكَ

O the Ever-Living! O the Self-  
Subsisting and All-Sustaining!  
In Thy mercy I seek relief.

نَحْمَدُهُ وَنُصَلِّى  
عَلَى رَسُولِهِ الْكَرِيمِ

We praise Him and  
invoke blessings  
upon His Noble  
Messenger.

محبت تو دوائے ہزار بیماری است بروئے تو کہ رہائی دین گرفتاری است  
Love for You is a panacea for a thousand ailments.

By Your face! To be captivated by You is indeed freedom.

پناہ رُوئے تو جہنم نہ طورِ متان است کہ آمدن بہ پناہت کمالِ بخشاری است  
To seek refuge in You is not the way of the mad;

For, to find refuge in You is consummate wisdom.

متاعِ مہرِ رُخِ تو نہان نخواہم داشت کہ خفیہ داشتنِ عشقِ تو زِ غداری است  
I shall not conceal the wealth of the love of Your countenance;

For, keeping Your love secret is also an act of infidelity.

بر آن سرم کہ سرو جان فدائے تو بلنم کہ جان بیاہ سپردنِ حقیقتِ یاری است  
I am ready to shed my honour and life for You;

For, true friendship lies in surrendering one's life to the Beloved.

[Translated from Arabic Section] All praise belongs to Allah, who illumined the eyes of the believers with the lamps of faith and helped the minds of men of knowledge ascertain the deep verities of Divine knowledge. He revealed to them such subtleties, secrets, and sciences as none is granted save those who are the recipients of *wahy* [revelation] from the *Rahmān* [Gracious Lord]. He made them the luminaries of the earth and conclusive

proofs for the Faith and a refuge of safety. He rekindled the fire in the east and the west and carried their fame with honour across the horizon and to the corners of the earth. He made them such a spring that does not dry up and a provision that does not perish; He made their enemies like broken straw eaten up, or like a dry and barren branch that falls from a tree. He made them the happiest of peoples—those who are never subject to humiliation—neither overcome by the smoke of evil nor harmed by the slander of the slanderers. Indeed, they emigrated from their lands and devoted themselves wholly to Allah the *Raḥmān* [Gracious]. Their moon shone full and their fruits became abundant; their enmity was but a presage of calamity, and harming them is but the garb of the indigent and mark of the foolish scoundrel.

We praise Allah for His favours who sent His men of Divine cognizance, His *Khulafā'* [Vicegerents], and His *Auliya'* [Friends] to save people from the slumber of heedlessness and to deliver them from the hands of Satan, thereby purifying souls from the filth of idols and cutting off the trees of evil and rebellion with an axe. The *Mālik* [Sovereign], the *Ḥakīm* [Wise], and the *Wadūd* [Loving], is He who created the sun and the moon in order to illumine the outer world, and He raised the Prophets, Messengers, and *Muḥaddathīn* [recipients of Divine revelation] to illuminate the spiritual realm of humanity. He established the Shariah, allowing the valiant of the age and the valorous of the time to penetrate its narrow and subtle ways.

Holy is He! How exalted is His majesty! He is the Sender of the Messengers, the Facilitator of (narrow, fine, and complex) paths, the Originator of religions, and the Establisher of conclusive proof. He, in every age and day, manifests in a different state; He concealed mysteries to the fullest capacity in the very essence of all entities. Then, which of His secrets can be fathomed by man? Do not be left alone stranded in the tent of reason while its central beam has collapsed. Rather, strive towards Allah with complete submission, purging your heart of everything outside of Him. Woe to every stubborn and arrogant heedless one, who has slaughtered his soul and brought about its death!

وَطُوبَى لِمَنْ سَنَّ وَسَارَ *Revealed*

**And glad tidings to he who adopts this way and follows it** and earnestly strives in the ways of the Gracious God.

Peace and blessings of Allah be upon the Chief of His Messengers, *Khātām-ul-Anbiyā’* [the Seal of the Prophets], the Leader of His *Auliyyā’* [Friends], the purest form of His light, and the essence of His brilliance—the blessed immaculate Messenger and Prophet—who guided the common people to the right path and cured those who had become like cattle due to the disease afflicting their hearts; he who most eloquently and explicitly elucidated the injunctions of the *Furqān* [Discrimination, i.e. Holy Quran] for his followers; he caused the spring of his affirmations to gush forth like torrential rain and he brought the Book wherein lies nourishment for the hungry and pure sweet water for the thirsty. He delivered the embryos out of a threefold darkness: 1) the idolatry that casts one out of Paradise; 2) those deeds that cause one to burn in the Fire; 3) those vices that deteriorate human nature into the animal nature of beasts and serpents.

He was the admonisher, the awakener who showed extreme compassion towards mankind, and he removed drowsiness from their eyes and gave these weak fledglings the strength to flutter and fly. He guided the people to the straightest path and made their souls walk with steadiness—their pace being neither too slow nor their stride being too wide. He made the Ummah an exalted people who excelled all other nations in brilliance as if they were the two shining luminaries—the sun and the moon. He drew them with his spiritual power so much so that they became more obedient to him than the shoes on his feet, irrespective of the land or arena of war. He perfected their souls and nourished them like trees to the point their fruit grew abundant and heavy, weighing down their branches.

Thus, they entered the religion of Allah, striving and selling their selves to seek the pleasure of Allah, *ar-Rahmān* [the Gracious]. They were shaken with a violent shaking until the matter became straitened and their calamities became unbearable for them. Despite their lack of strength, they set out at night, pleased with the decree of Allah until the sun of Divine help dawned upon them, and they alighted in jubilation amidst comfort and redolence. They entered into the Presence of Allah with full force and shattered all the fetters and idols that hindered them from entering this palace. They placed themselves as an obstacle in the way of all troubles befalling Islam and forgot all their past afflictions before these sorrows. They spent their nights before their Lord—prostrating and standing—never tasting sleep but briefly.

They lost themselves in following the Messenger of Allah. They did not deviate nor depart from the Word of the Loving God in following any school of thought. They stood up in every place of danger for the rejuvenating faith of Allah. They severed all ties with every companion and bosom friend for the sake of Allah and His Messenger till they drew swords out of sheaths. They preferred rags to luxurious and lavish garments, deprived themselves of bodily pleasures and worldly comforts, and remained content with [drinking] hot water while eschewing water that was cold and sweet. The world was nothing more than a coffin in their eyes.

They feared Allah as He should be feared in all their deeds and words. They feared the trials of the tongue and demeaning remarks to the extent they became akin to a shy virgin, preferring to remain silent and restraining their speech. They followed the example of the Messenger of Allah<sup>sas</sup> in their words, deeds, activity, inactivity, morality and conduct, and in the cultivation of their inner selves and the acquisition of virtue. Hence, Allah granted them a heart that inclined towards truth, a tongue adorned with veracity, and a soul liberated from ill-will, rancour, and enmity. Allah the Exalted was well pleased with them, and He caused them to alight into His Gardens of Pleasure.

Their good account has been conveyed to us. Certainly, they were



palpable proof of the message of our Lord, the undeniable evidence for the truthfulness of our Master, the stars of guidance, and the avenue to conviction. Every one of them was made to suffer in the cause of Allah, to endure hardships in what he was entrusted with, and was threatened with both sword and spearhead. Nevertheless, they slackened not, nor did they suffer humiliation—instead fulfilling their vow and preferring their Master over their mortal selves. They were such a spiritual ummah and nation who suffered afflictions for the sake of the most beloved friend of all friends.

O ye people! Invoke blessings and peace on the Prophet, in whose footsteps mankind would be resurrected and drawn to the Benevolent, Ever-Merciful Lord. He delivered a great number of people from an arid, perilous, and tormenting desert to the gardens of peace and security. He emboldened the frightened souls, strengthened passionate resolutions, and rekindled those lights that had been lost. He produced the most splendid pearls, rubies, and coral, and he established the fundamental principles and refined reasoning. He delivered many a people from the shackles of *kufr* [disbelief], error, and rebellion. He made the obedient and desirous believers drink from the goblet of certainty, peace, and tranquillity and protected them from the paths of evil, disorder, and loss, while guiding them towards all the paths of goodness, bliss, and beneficence. Among his many favours is that he apprised us of the tribulations of the Latter Days and then he gave us the glad tidings from the Beneficent Lord of security and His succour.

O Allah! Send blessings and peace upon this chosen intercessor, the saviour of mankind, and help us to seek nourishment and draw benefit from the presence of this King. Through him save us from the evil of every hand outstretched with cruelty and from such ulema who strive to seek out the faults of their brethren while forgetting their own vices. Their tongues remain unchecked from abuse, cursing, spewing vile accusations, and uttering calumnies, but are restrained from bearing true witness, giving voice to truth, and establishing real proof. They exhort others but they themselves fail to benefit from good advice; they

repel but do not welcome; they preach to others what they themselves do not practice; they create disorder but do not promote peace; they divide but fail to reconcile; they declare others as disbelievers without any knowledge nor any fear; they urge the laity to do good but they themselves persist in evil; they say to a believer, 'You are not a believer', while caring not the least for the punishment of Allah the Exalted, and they refuse to reflect.

**O Allah!** Save us from their mischief and exonerate us from their allegations and distinguish us exclusively by Your protection, Your selection, and Your beneficence. Do not entrust us to the protection of anyone besides You; enable us to do good deeds that please You. We seek Your mercy, Your bounty, and Your pleasure, for You are the Best of those who show mercy.

O my Lord, by Your grace, be my strength and illumine my sight and what is in my heart and be the purpose of my life and my death. Fill me with Your love and grant me such love that it is surpassed by none after me.

O my Lord, accept my prayers, grant me my wishes, cleanse me, protect me, draw me close to Yourself; guide me, help me and enable me to do good, purify me, illumine my soul, make me entirely Yours and become entirely mine.

O my Lord, come to me from every door, deliver me from every veil, make me drink deep from Your every beverage and help me against the rising passions of the self and its enticements, and protect me from the pitfalls of separation and its manifold darkness; leave me not to my self even for the blink of an eye and guard me against its evils; make me ascend and rise towards You and permeate Yourself into every particle of my being; make me among those who swim freely in Your seas, and roam freely in the gardens of Your light and who are pleased with the issuance of Your decrees; and create distance between myself and all those besides You.

**O my Lord,** by Your grace and by the light of Your countenance, show me Your beauty and make me drink Your pure water and deliver me from every kind of veil and haze; make me not among those who revert

to darkness and obscurity and who refrain from attaining blessings, illumination, and light; and who, due to their defective reason and perverse effort, return from the abode of bliss to the place of destruction; grant me sincere submission for the sake of Your countenance and everlasting prostration in Your presence; bestow upon me such a resolve on which descends Your kind glance and grant me such favour that You grant only to Your exclusively chosen ones, and send down upon me such mercy as You cause to descend only upon Your loved ones.

**O my Lord! Revive Islam through my strenuous efforts, my resolve, my prayers, and my words, and restore its beauty, splendour and depth through me, and destroy every headstrong opponent and his arrogance.**

O my Lord, show me how You give life to the dead. Show me such faces that manifest the beauty of the Faith, such souls that possess a blessed wisdom, such eyes that shed tears in fear of You, such hearts that tremble with Your remembrance, and that pure posterity who follow the truth and the right course, and who take refuge under the shade of those lost in God and His elect. Show me the ones who hasten towards repentance and who prepare for the final abode.

O my Lord, disorder has appeared in land and sea, dwellings and deserts; I see Your servants in misery, Your gardens turned to deserts, Your religion in calamity and affliction; I find Islam like a needy person fallen into poverty after [previous] affluence or like a trembling old man far advanced from youth or like a traveller in a far-off land, or like a foreigner parted from friends, or like a free man trapped in slavery or like an orphan who was fallen from grace.

Falsehood struts about in the cloak of arrogance while the truth is being struck by the hands of the malevolent. They strive hard like devils to extinguish its light, but Allah is the Best Protector. Who else is there for us besides that Perfect Guide? Religion has suffered the greatest loss, and the measles of dissension and the leprosy of apostasy have broken out among the youth, they having renounced the prohibitions of the luminous Shariah. They threw themselves into the desert and

abandoned the Excellent Exemplar, making the misguided philosophers their leaders and esteeming their discourse as sweet, their errors as excellence; their hearts have been imbued with the love of the lifeless calf of European philosophy, whereas it is nothing but a corpse producing a lowing sound, and they have not even smelled the fragrance of the Divinely cognizant.

I swear by Allah! I have been raised by Allah to revive the Faith by His command and to utterly humiliate and disgrace falsehood. I was commanded for this by Allah the Omnipotent, the Originator. So, I promptly responded to His call as an obedient servant and explicitly delivered His commands and strove very arduously for it. However, the people doubted my allegiance and refused to accept my message. Consequently, the depth of their intellect and the claim of their scriptural knowledge were severely tested, so the deniers rose up and harboured many misgivings about me, pouncing upon me with the edict of disbelief even though they were entirely ignorant of the facts of the matter. They dared to enter the realm of which they had no knowledge. They took recourse to cursing and never bothered to examine the truth deeply. This was all out of the blazing fire of rancour that afflicted them like tuberculosis.

Well, as far as I am concerned, I have never been such as to disobey the command of my Lord, or to fabricate a lie against Him from myself. He is my Benefactor and the Bountiful Bestower. He has poured down favour upon me and bequeathed every kind of bounty upon me. He guided me towards the right path, with wisdom that holds fast to the truth, and He bestowed upon me what has not been granted to any of my contemporaries. This is but a grateful remembrance of all these blessings of the Gracious Lord. He became my Guardian and Friend and He alone granted that which He granted, and He gave me the glad tidings of prosperity in the Hereafter and in this life. He drew close to me and drew me close; He praised me from His throne and walked to me and exalted me to the lofty heavens. All these favours were due to the blessings of Muṣṭafā [the Chosen One; i.e. Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>]. The

shadow (1) followed its original (2); thus, one (1) witnessed what the other (2) witnessed. Now, I do not fear the slander of any detractor or the disgrace from any defamer. I entrust my cause to Allah. If I were a liar, upon me will be the lie; but if I am truthful, then, be sure, Allah suffers not the cause of the truthful to perish.

The real calamity is that the enemies of Islam have robbed us of our peace by insulting our Leader, the Messenger of the Final Epoch, while the labour of our ulema is all lost in declaring Muslims disbelievers and banishing our brethren in faith from the pale of religion and true belief. Thus, this is the calamity that struck Islam and the catastrophe that befell the religion of the Best of Mankind. The suns of knowledge have set, pure trees have become scarce, and the tree of *Zaqqūm*<sup>1</sup> abounds; nothing survived but the remains of the ulema and the remnants of the eminent ones in accordance with Allah's will.

When they lost the essence, they became like stillborn children. Alas for the ulema! In front of the enemy they are like a lame and blind camel on the slippery battlefield of the wilderness, but for Islam and the Muslims they become like a beast of prey, or a heaven-sent calamity. They become absolutely devoid of knowledge, forbearance, deep understanding, and reflection. They are nothing but names, devoid of wisdom and replete with arrogance and conceit. The exception are those whom the benevolence of the Glorious God has saved and who have been covered by the mercy of the Most Merciful God; thus, they are saved from this disease. Indeed, they serve as a remedy for this epidemic and are the proof of Allah against the wicked. They are the first and the foremost of the blessed, noble, and honourable people. In their hearts burns such a fire for Islam that the frigidity of winter touches them not. They are the chiefs of Islam and the pillars of the religion of

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1. *Zaqqūm* denotes the evil tree of faithlessness in the Hereafter. Quran has compared true belief to a good tree which brings forth its fruit at all times and disbelief to an evil tree. See *Sūrah aṣ-Ṣāffāt*, 37:63–66, *Sūrah ad-Dukhān*, 44:44–47, and *Sūrah Ibrāhīm*, 14:25–27. [Publisher]

the Best of Mankind<sup>sas</sup>. They are the kings of religion as good deeds are disseminated from their household, and every desire is granted through their kindness. They are the repository of the utmost subtleties of the Shariah and are well versed in its fundamental and subsidiary principles. May Allah the Almighty keep them safe, grant them long lives and become the Enemy of their enemies and the Friend of their friends.

O ulema who slander my faith with the calumny of atheism and curse me with the charge of apostasy! Do you know why I put your account amidst a eulogy of the Noble Prophet<sup>sas</sup>? I do not think that you would ever know without being apprized of it. Therefore, know that my purpose for this is that I had girded my loins for these twin matters and had beseeched the Lord of earth and heaven to grant me both these twin objectives.

**THE FIRST OBJECTIVE**—To draw you close to the remembrance of the Chosen Messenger and the Accepted Intercessor whose glory is far beyond comprehension by reason and whose closeness cures the wickedness of the forsaken. Thus, I put your account in the midst of that of Muṣṭafā [the Chosen One], so that I may find a cure for your hearts from this refuge and so that you might remember *Khātamul-Anbiyā'* [the Seal of the Prophets], his lofty status, and his might which emanates from the power of the Self-Sufficient God. Thus, that you may display decency, reverence, fear, and *taqwā* [righteousness], and that you may be granted sound intuition, remorseful souls and fearful hearts so that with his remembrance you may be saved from the flood that has come close and draws nearer still; that your skins may soften, your hearts may tremble, and you may listen to what I say to you, and that you follow not, therefore, any defiant disposition.

O my friends, fear Allah and be respectful when the name of the Messenger<sup>sas</sup> of Allah is mentioned; lower your wings in his presence and be not boastful; enter into submission and be not divided; obey and break not apart; become brothers and harbour not enmity with

each other; keep relationships strong and sever not ties; seek the ways of Allah's pleasure and do not despair; O servants of God, hold your tongues and transgress not.

Do you expel your brethren in faith from your religion without fear? And you forsake your brothers and invite them not with compassion, holding grudges against your own people while feeling no sympathy for them? You declare Muslims—who pray and fast, believe in *Tauḥīd* [Oneness of God], and restrain themselves from crossing the boundaries set by Allah—as disbelievers

and you do not care? Are those who believe in the same *Kalimah* as you, disbelievers? What is wrong with you? How judge ye? Are those who worship facing Makkah like you, strangers? Do you hear what you are saying? Do we run away from the Messenger of Allah, may peace and blessings of Allah be on him? Fear Allah, O transgressors! Do we disbelieve in Allah and His Messenger?

Fear Allah, O liars! You dare to revile your brethren when Allah has forbidden you to revile even the idols. You afflict<sup>1</sup> the believing and obedient women when Allah has forbidden you from killing even the idolatrous women of the warring disbelievers? Is declaring believers to be disbelievers a good deed while declaring the death of the Messiah<sup>as</sup> a sin? What is the matter with you? Where is your righteousness? What has blinded you? Where have your insight and wisdom gone? Where have your knowledge and understanding disappeared to? Have you studied in the [wayward] Jewish academies and been trained in the art of piling up falsehood, layer upon layer? You became pleased with filth while you were advised to be mindful of it. You forgot the Day of

#### AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE

Do you drive away the People of the *Qiblah* [fellow Muslims] from your religion, and you do not fear [God]? You neglect to show kindness to your own brothers and fail to feel compassion for them. You become angry with your loved ones and feel no sorrow for them. [Author]

1. This is in reference to the announcement that states that it is no sin at all for anyone who wishes to take and seize their women. [Author]



Judgment and you, in relation to the honey of Islam, became like an oyster [i.e. closed off and hoarding what was meant to be shared].

O people of falsehood! Be mindful of the Day of Reckoning. You comprehend nothing except the outer meanings of the Quran, and then deny those possessed of its inner meanings. You are content with merely the husk of the Book and your intellect has not touched its essence. You have followed the apparent meanings of the Quran and its periphery, and you presume to have completely exhausted its well-spring. Among you are those who have embellished calumnies, parroted mad ravings, and manifested the beastliness of an untamed she-camel. They degraded human reason with errors and misleading meanderings, inciting every ill-meaning firebrand to pounce on me. They perverted my words and they bit them apart like rats. They hastened towards me with contempt and invective and intended to tear apart my honour like lunatics. They attacked the fortified firmaments of the outer city, as well as its valleys, to destroy them via internal dissension over fundamental and secondary principles. They persisted in their erroneous opinions and so their feet stumbled. They stretched forth their tongues and behaved in a contemptible manner. They frowningly refused to accept the truth and they indulged in their own falsehoods. Every insolent one cursed and abused me; every hyena howled at me, every blind she-camel tried to trample me, and every fighter threw his spears without holding back. Thus, we were rained hard upon until the earth turned into a mire and the strong and the weak alike revolted against us, never ceasing from cursing and condemning us, declaring us disbelievers and disparaging us. They tore apart my honour as rats eat away the pages of the Quran and they attacked me like the attack of the Ethiopian [Abraha] on the House of the Gracious Lord.

When I saw that their pot was boiling over for provoking disorder, along with their tendency for falsehood, strife, and excommunication, I betook myself to the Gracious God to seek protection from this attack of theirs that was battering against me like the waves of a typhoon. Then God heard my prayers, humble entreaties, and supplications and



He gave me the glad tidings of triumphs from Him and the support of His hosts. He said:

لَا تَخَفْ إِنِّي مَعَكَ. وَمَا مَعَ مَشِيكَ. أَنْتَ مِنِّي بِمَنْزِلَةٍ لَا يَعْلَمُ الْخَلْقُ. وَجَدْتُكَ مَا  
وَجَدْتُكَ. إِنِّي مُهَيِّئُ مَنْ أَرَادَ إِهَانَتَكَ. وَإِنِّي مُعِينُ مَنْ أَرَادَ إِعَانَتَكَ. أَنْتَ مِنِّي وَسِرُّكَ سِرِّي  
وَأَنْتَ مُرَادِي وَمَعِيَ وَجْهِي فِي حَضْرَتِي. اخْتَرْتُكَ لِنَفْسِي.

[Be not afraid, I am with you and walk along with you. You have a standing with Me of which people have no notion. I have found you that which I have found you. I shall humiliate him who designs to humiliate you, and I shall help him who designs to help you. You are from Me, your secret is My secret, you are My purpose and are with Me. You have a high standing in My presence. I have chosen you for Myself.]

These are the glad tidings which my Lord and my Refuge gave me at the time of my need. By God! Even if all the kings of the world were to obey me and all the treasures of the world were to be granted to me, it would not have gladdened me to the extent that this has.

O my Lord! I have been filled with your blessings and have been made to drink from the oceans of Your favours. O my Lord! Take my gratefulness to the entire expanse of Your heaven; come and enter in my heart with all Your splendour. I have chosen You and Your Messenger over everyone besides You. I have been detached from my own self and have come to You seeking Your pleasure. Here are my verses for You. You alone are my Beloved, my inner and outer Attire.

نگ و نام و عزت دنیا ز دامن رختیم یار آمیزد مگر با ما بنجاک آ میختیم

*We have shunned all honour and glory from our threshold,*

*And we have reduced ourselves to dust should our Friend meet us.*

دل بدادیم از کف و جان در ره انداختیم و از پنی وصل نگاری حیلہ ہا انگشتیم

*We happily gave away our heart and threw our soul in His path,*

*And to meet that Beloved we strove in every way.*

Now I revert to my initial story and the great agony it brings. Indeed, the ulema did not spare any arrow to shoot at me, nor did they spare me any torment. They rained down baseless and false allegations upon me. Neither poetry nor prose was spared in my denunciation.<sup>1</sup> When I saw their deviation from the right path and their increase in suspicion, I did not find any recourse but to write this book, so I wrote it with tears of prayer and bitter grief. I strove hard to dispel their misgivings and to expose their errors. I beg Allah the Exalted to put abounding blessings herein and to instil its meanings even into their narrow minds. Here I am, absolved of what they say. Allah knows whereas they know not. I am not a disbeliever, a heretic, or an apostate. I am but a Joseph among the prisoners. In fact, I have been sent to remove their chains and shackles. Then how could I fear their labelling me a disbeliever while I am cognizant of their condition? The one who stands firm on the top of a mountain is never scared of ravines and the one who drinks from the goblet of communion cares nothing for any misguided denier. Verily, I know from my Lord what I have brought from the stars. Hence, the howling of a fox does little to annoy me. Fear Allah, and do not strut around relying on your worthless armour, and rally not the people to wail over the dead. What is the matter with you that you do not rein in your mouths nor restrain yourselves? You do not abstain from conceit and arrogance and exult in your attacks. You declare people infidels without any knowledge, and thereby exceed all limits. If there are any differences between you and me, then remember, differences did occur before this as well and many a disagreement turns out to be a blessing in disguise, if only you knew. Allah will judge between you and us in this world and on the Day of Resurrection, and will inform you about those matters on which you used to differ.

O my people! Refrain from these suspicions, for suspicion in some cases is a sin. What is the matter with you that you do not understand? I have not come to you with a lie or a fabrication nor with anything that

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1. This refers to the poetry of Munshī Sa'dullāh and his ilk about their invectives and diatribes and the prose of Batālawī Şāhib and of some other *maulawīs* of the kind. [Author]

is against the paths of guidance, but this matter remained obscure to you. Thus, how can I cause you to accept that which you avoid to even touch? Soon you shall remember what I have been telling you; and I entrust my affair to Allah—my Lord—who looks at my heart and finds therein what you find not.

O my people! Why have you exceeded all limits in your affairs, throwing the Quran behind your backs? Do you intentionally follow something other than the *Furqān* [Discrimination—the Holy Quran]? Those who address themselves wholly towards God fear not the separation of anyone and remain serene by His promise. They find comfort in Allah, their Master, and in Him do they place their trust. They hear and speak through Him and through His light do they see. They are apprized of His subtle knowledge and His secrets are laid bare for them. If you were in any doubt about my claim, then read my book and ponder over my response, and ask Allah what there is in my mantle, if you seek the Truth that the truthful always seek. Keep praying and become not weary. Purify your motives and do not besmirch them. Pray in the hours of your nights and tire not. Wait for the hour of mercy and be watchful. Strive as it behoves you to strive; it will be disclosed to you and you will be guided.

Glad tidings for him who comes with a heart that is penitent and sound. Glad tidings for him who comes with upright and clear understanding. Glad tidings for the soul that retreats at the sight of doubts and asks Allah for understanding of the complexities. Glad tidings for the feet that impel the legs to flee from the temptation to backbite against your brethren and to declare them disbelievers. Glad tidings for to the eyes that have been guided by Truth to what is right and safeguarded from paths of corruption and ruin. Glad tidings for the footsteps that move toward good deeds and turn away from the schemes of sin. Glad tidings for the self that has purged itself from its surging carnal passion and Glad tidings for the souls that have been granted from the burning thirst of the truth and its intensity. Glad tidings for the intellect that knows no weariness, nor yields until it beholds the desired objective.

Glad tidings for every humble and meek one. Glad tidings for the one whose heart has been adorned with love for the Noble Lord.

O my people! The enemies from among the human worshippers and the priests have landed in our courtyard and have rained stones of satanic mud upon us. They deemed pure gold as dirt, life as death, light as fire, and good as evil. Their trickery dispersed and their propaganda proliferated. They created tumult against Islam and brought about great disorders. Their sorcery pervaded every stone and tree, and every town was made rotten by their breath. They present their bitter and curdled milk as being fresh. They pounce on the truthful with their misguided hearts. So, a legion of anguish anticipated their assault and a battalion of our sorrow faced it, and we became tired of absorbing the multitude of their attacks. Finally, our sufferings began to be published in the press like tales. This state of fear extinguished the comfort of our lives. We became saddened when we felt the fire of these days. The night grew dark over us on account of our sorrow and anxiety, and we found ourselves stuck in an inescapable predicament, with our circumstances taking an evil turn.

O my people! These are a people who gave the lie to our religion, led astray our youth, and accused our Messenger of fabrication. We entered dire straits with their arrival, we were afflicted with incapacity during their ascent, and we were utterly humiliated with their insults and ridicule. Now the time has come for us to beseech before the Gracious Lord, to cry before Him like a mother who lost her child, to knock at His door like a person afflicted with pain, and to beg Him to remove this affliction and deliver us from punishment; so that Allah's shining mercy may be stirred, this clamour may subside, and—after severe travails—a day of comfort may arrive; that the fragrance of happiness may emanate from the Most Merciful God; and that the heart's comfort and the eye's delight may descend after we have suffered extreme exhaustion, which has brought us to the brink of death.

O my people! Muster your courage before it departs and please your Lord before He becomes displeased and wroth. Do not be the

first to be aggressive towards His Faith and to attack His Signs and proofs. Why do you hasten towards evil at the time of mutual beneficence and toward division at the time of union? Do you not see the disorder created by the offspring of the whisperers? The friends of falsehood pierced us with injurious words, wounded us by the denigration of the Chief of the nobles and with their rejection of the Book of Allah, which comprises all blessings. They trampled us under their tongues and their feet, and beguiled our youth through the power of their greed and subtle trickery. They appeared as a fatal disease to Islam and like a wolf to the Muslims. Thus, we fell into a severe famine with its consequential calamities multiplying, while its uprooting and obliteration lie exclusively within the power of Allah. They pelt stones at our religion and assault the honour of our Prophet and beloved friend.

Strange is your Islam! You fail to wake up from your slumber. Do you not see that the end time has arrived and the hordes of enemies have poured in and the earth has become straitened for us with poverty and adversity? Know, therefore, that for Islam this age is a difficult time, and its verdant garden has turned barren. Had Allah's mercy not come to save it, it would have perished.

The disbelievers have decorated falsehood while disparaging the musk and perfume of flowers. The Quran is viewed as defective and considered worthless; its clothing torn apart at the bosom and its miracles rejected. Urine is mixed with water, and darkness is preferred over light. They exalted 'Īsā<sup>as</sup> [Jesus] with excessive praise and attributed to Allah, the One, of having daughters and sons. They made His servant equal to Allah and pushed people into the deepest darkness of the night. They carved out slander against the Noble Prophet and led astray a multitude of people through these fabrications.

Nothing hurts my heart more than their mockery of the majesty of Muṣṭafā [the Chosen One] and their wounding the honour of the Best of Creation. By God, if all my young ones, my children and my grandchildren were murdered right before my eyes, and my hands and feet were cut off and my eyeballs were pierced and I were deprived of all my

wishes, peace, and exuberance—even then nothing would be harder on me than this.

O my Lord! Look compassionately to us and our sufferings and forgive us our sins and overlook our transgressions. Nothing changes unless You let it change and no calamity befalls us or is removed from us without Your decree.

O company of ulema! You have gladly grown accustomed to this world, its slumber, and the delights of its intoxication. Among you are those whose feet sank into the mire of Christianity, who—distancing themselves from the disheveled, dust-covered masses—moved towards those steeped in ornament and embellishment, so that they may take a ripe share of the comfort of this world and its carrion, and to reap the fruits of their lust and adorn themselves in its fine velvet. And among you are those who fell on each other like dogs, exposing their evil and ugly natures to the enemies. Some of them wounded others, smashed their heads and struck them with rods—becoming arrogant and casting aside the robes of peace—created disorder, every group of them tearing into their companions as a wolf tears into sheep. They intended to uproot their enemies by shooting arrows and raining down stones [of abusive language] upon them. Thus, they devoured each other like vermin and left the matter [of objections] open for the enemies of the Faith and the transgressors. They abandoned *taqwā* [righteousness] and took pride in each other's filth. They gladdened themselves but utterly displeased the Gracious God.

Thus, Islam was hit hard by internal and universal disorder, and every hypocritical heart turned away from its sympathy. I was beholding all this, and I made myself drink the bitter draught of sorrow; my tears continued to fall from my eyes, and my sighs were rising up to the collarbones. Indeed, I put all my trust in the Everlasting Allah. When the breeze of *ilhām* [revelation] blew over my heart and brought the fragrance of glad tidings, He elevated my status. Then was I appointed and sent forth in order to reform this chaos and eliminate this slumber. Surely, there is fertility after barrenness. Yea, surely there is fertility

after barrenness. So, fear Allah and abandon arrogance and conceit. My coming was not untimely; rather, it was at the time of people's turning towards darkness and their abandonment of the lamp of Allah and the light of His religion. I came at a time when the Muslim Ummah was deeply mired in the centre of the burning fire of debate, and caught in currents that cause the heart to tremble.

The people began to tread the paths of heresy, licentiousness, and disorder, and abandoned the path of true guidance, righteousness, and truth. The ulema would not behold the freshness and delicacy of the Quran and would not see its elegance nor its drapery in cloaks of light. They threw away rubies into the dust with disdain and deemed the Book of Allah to be devoid of insights and hidden verities. They adjudged the one cognizant of the depths of its knowledge with contempt, and left him abandoned in distress, severing all brotherly ties with a frown. However, the debates between the religions were to be conducted by way of argument and reason; not by knights riding on horseback. The people of this age set this practice and it was established to examine grace and beauty, and to observe good traits and various excellences. Islam was in such a state that its cheeks and forehead were burnt, its form and shape were changed, its power and excellence were left hidden, and its sweetness and elegance concealed. This was the reason that emboldened the opponents in their denial. So, they turned away with suspicion and scorn.

Hence, Allah raised a man to elevate the majesty of His Word, disclose its secrets, reveal its deep verities, manifest the fragrance of its musk and to break open its sealed meanings. However, the people rejected him and accepted him not, expelled him, and did not shelter him; they abused him, and did not become grateful to him, insulted him and did not honour him and did not look up to him as the eminent and beloved are looked upon for guidance in brotherhood. They went far beyond the limits of righteousness in their scurrilities. They said, 'Assuredly, you have perpetrated an egregious enormity! And you have strayed far away from the Ummah.' They had not tarried long before a

pathological liar emerged from them to declare me a disbeliever. How could the light of Allah be extinguished by the mouth of a liar, devoid of righteousness [i.e. Batalawī]? However, he tried the utmost to eliminate the rays of truth, to extinguish its lights, and to disperse its supporters and helpers. He spared neither young nor old when turning the hasty so-called jurists into slanderers and excommunicators, except a few whom Allah, the *Rabbul-'ālamīn* [Lord of all the worlds], saved.

Consequently, every tiny bird not accustomed to hunting prey turned into a falcon that pursues its target, and every blind one issued a declaration of disbelief and rejection. They targeted me with increasing hostility and every one of them exposed their true nature without slackening. They targeted my honour with their spears and deemed it a virtue that would bring them closer to God. They hatched plots against me and fired up the oven to consume me. They were eager to destroy, annihilate, and make me drink the cup of death and calamity.

Nevertheless, Allah willed to crush their designs and to manifest some Signs to them. He is my Lord and His mercy is sufficient for me. For Him alone is my life and death—my preparation and my enshrouding. He alone is my love; extremely forgiving is He. He comes to me and makes me drink the goblets of bliss. His remembrance is a drink that eliminates all worries and His love is a thing that captivates the righteous. We will never sever the bonds we have established with Him even if we were to be cut into pieces with swords and spears. Behold the effects of His mercy and the Signs of His acceptance. Indeed, the people are toiling to bring about my destruction but He is the One who is nourishing me. The people are devising schemes to uproot my foundation and demolish my edifice while He is nurturing my limbs and branches. The people wish for my destruction, my contempt, and my humiliation while He honours me and gives me glad tidings of exalted stations, and draws me close to Him.

Among His favours is that He has revived the hearts that passionately come to me and the servants who stay in my presence and the friends who invoke blessings on me. He has stirred winds to blow all



around the world that they may pull the people towards me as if they were an enlightened army that lead the hearts towards the lasting faith. That is,

أَوْعَبَّقْرِي بِهَيْرِي نُورُ الدِّينِ

یعنی اخویم مولوی حکیم نور دین بھیروی کہ ہمدردی اسلام پر ایشان  
غالب ست ازین وجہ بانشار نورانیت سماوی مشابہت دارند و هذا فضل اللہ

# THE GENIUS *from Bhera,* NOOR-UD-DEEN

*That is, our brother, Maulawī Hakeem Noor-ud-Deen of Bhera who is overwhelmed with the passion of serving Islam. By this quality he resembles the spreading of heavenly light. This is purely the grace of Allah.*

*This is a mercy of Allah and a manifest and plain truth that neither Batālawī nor his cohorts can deny even if he kills himself in his grief and his soul departs from his body. By God, Batālawī left no stone unturned in his mischievous designs; rather, he supplemented his falsehood with his vulgar and demeaning language.*

Were it not for the fear of the drawn sword of the British Government's justice, he would have incited people to shed my blood and would have assembled his foot soldiers and cavalry for my annihilation and destruction, but he was held back by the majesty of this Government and the spark of its power. Thus, I am extremely grateful to Allah for how He sheltered me from every fear under the shadow of this blessed British Government that supports the weak, being the shelter of Allah for the poor and indigent, and the whip of Allah against every rebellious and arrogant one. Moreover, it is incumbent upon us to be grateful for the favours from the just Queen whose grip the heart of every transgressor fears. Why should we not be grateful to her as Allah has protected us through this Government from various kinds of calamities and it has eliminated all the traces of injustice, sending down blessings and provisions upon us?

O Allah, reward this Queen for our sake with the best of Your rewards, help her against her and Your enemies, bring her into Your protection from every evil, grant her from Your bounties, lead her heart and the hearts of her descendants to Your faith—the religion of Islam—and deliver them from the grief

**of polytheism, from deifying a man, and save them thereby from all kinds of torment.**

**O my Lord! Be kind to them as they have been kind to us and turn some of their hearts into accepting Your religion in my lifetime.**

**O my Lord! Send down a table full of Your blessings upon them and grant my prayers.**

*Āmīn, then again, āmīn.*

Wonder upon wonders! A case of great wonder! These are the people who are called *al-kuffār* [the disbelievers] while there are other people who are called ‘brothers and helpers’.

O community of brothers—more wicked than enemies! Come to what will (save) you on the Day of Mutual Calling and Wailing and do not continue to be suspicious about your brethren; fear your Lord, who turns the day into night. Is there no right-minded man among you, who, fearing the end, abandons this violent quarrel and dispute? Do you know what you are facing and who you are targeting? Do you excommunicate sects of Islam on account of differences in secondary principles while you refuse to comply with well-established binding principles?

Here I am! I bear witness to the Great Lord and swear by the Munificent Lord that I am surely a Muslim believer, having firm faith in the Oneness of God; a follower of the Divine commandments and the practices of His Messenger; and I am clear of what you suspect, distant from the poison of disbelief and its manifestations. Indeed, I see no honour in anything that runs contrary to the Shariah nor do I see any standing for a scholar indulged in such a practice. I believe in the Book of Allah and bear witness that everything against it is

nothing but disbelief. Anyone who utters a word that has no real basis in the Shariah—whether he is a recipient of revelation or a leading scholar—is playing into the hands of satanic beings. I also believe that our Prophet, Muhammad, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, is *Khātamul-Anbiyā'* [the Seal of the Prophets] and that our Book, the Noble Quran, is a means of guidance. There is no prophet for us that we follow except Muṣṭafā [the Chosen One—the Holy Prophet], and no book for us that we follow except the *Furqān* [Discrimination—the Holy Quran], the guardian over earlier scriptures. Furthermore, I believe that our Messenger is the Master of all the children of Adam and the Chief of all the Messengers, and that Allah sealed through him all the Prophets. I also believe that, after the Messenger of Allah, the Holy Quran has been safeguarded against any corruption by interpolators, and any errors of the misguided. Nothing can be abrogated from or added to, or subtracted from it after the Messenger of Allah, and no *ilhām* [revelation] of the true recipients of revelations can ever oppose it.

Everything that I understood of the 'difficult to comprehend' verses of the Quran, or that which was revealed to me by the Gracious Allah, I accepted on the condition that it was authentic, right, and clear, it being disclosed to me that it was absolutely true and in line with Islamic Law, free from doubt, ambiguity, misgiving, or obscurity. If, supposedly, the matter was determined otherwise, we would throw it away as a useless entity and mere spittle. We believe in all the meanings that Allah and the Noble Messenger had meant, even if we did not know them, or even if their true essence was not disclosed to us by the All-Knowing Allah. We have many Quranic texts, Signs, and clear arguments as a proof of their correctness, which we shall present at their appropriate time and place. We will rebut those whose hearts have become habitual in lying and whose pens have hurled complete fabrications. They do not peruse my books and do not ponder over my reply, nor do they reflect. Woe to them for what their hands have written, and woe to them for what they earn!

In this book, we did not desire for the opponents anything but to rebut their suspicions and crush their allegations. But as far as the way of responding to abuse with abuse, of curse with curse, and force with force, this book is absolutely free of that and the matter is entrusted to Allah, the Lord of Heaven.

O company of ulema! Do not interfere in the matters of Allah's knowledge and His mysteries, and dare not to say anything about which you have not been granted even an iota of knowledge. May the worldly life and its glamour not deceive you, and may the cry of a howler and its clamour not draw you into tribulations. I invite you in the name of the Gracious Allah to leave me alone for fighting against the enemies of Muṣṭafā and the *Furqān* and to help me by the restraint of your tongues. If I am truthful, Allah will show you my truth and my steadfastness. However, if I am an impostor, then Allah is sufficient for my elimination and destruction. So, make not the enemies rejoice over me and do not transgress, nor prolong this torture. Allah's knowledge is much more vast than your knowledge. He knows what is in my heart while you know not. If you do not refrain, then indeed you shall return to Allah where you shall be held accountable.

**AS FOR THE SECOND REASON** that compelled me to put your mention together with that of the Imam of the Far and Near, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, is that—O ye youthful Muslims and older believers!—know that with this arrangement I intended for the mercy of Allah and His compassion to descend upon you through the *Khātamul-Anbiyā'*, the Purest of the Chosen Ones. Therefore, bear witness that I am extending my praying hand to Allah for your sake and begging Him for your guidance.

My Lord—O my Lord!—hear my prayers for my people and my entreaties for my brothers. I plead to You through Your Prophet, *Khātamun-Nabiyyīn* [the Seal of the Prophets]—the intercessor whose intercession has already been granted for sinners.

O my Lord, bring them out of darkness into Your light and from the wilderness of estrangement to Your presence.

O my Lord, have mercy on those who curse me and save the people who desire to cut off my hands from Your grinding punishment; fill the deep recesses of their hearts with Your guidance; pardon their mistakes and their sins; forgive them and keep them safe and sound and make peace with them; purify them and grant them eyes with which they can see and ears with which they can hear and hearts with which they can understand and lights with which they can recognize; have mercy on them and overlook what they say for they are a people who do not know.

My Lord, by the countenance of Muṣṭafā and his high station and by those who stay up in the small hours of the night worshipping, and by those who go out to fight in the daylight, and by Your horsemen that ride by night and by the saddles that are fixed on the animals for the Mother of Towns [Makkah], make reconciliation between us and our brothers, open their eyes, enlighten their hearts, make them understand what You have made me understand, teach them the ways of *taqwā* [righteousness] and forgive what has passed. The conclusion of our prayer is, 'All praise be to Allah, the Lord of the High Heavens.'

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*In the Praise & Glory of Our Blessed  
Master—Sovereign Lord of Both Realms—  
Muḥammad Muṣṭafā & Aḥmad Muṭtabā,  
may Peace and Blessings of Allah be upon Him*

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چون زمن آید ثنائے سرورِ عالی تبار      عاجز از مدحش زمین و آسمان و هر دو دار  
*How can I possibly succeed in praising the sovereign of supreme rank,  
Whom the heavens and the earth and both realms cannot laud  
enough?*

آن مقامِ قرب کو دارد بدلدارِ قدیم      کس نداند شان آن از واصلانِ کردگار  
*The station of nearness he achieved with the Eternal Beloved  
Transcends beyond the ken of all who ever enjoyed communion with  
God.*

آن عنایتِ با که محبوبِ ازل دارد بدو      کس بخوابے هم ندیده مثل آن اندر دیار  
*The gifts with which the Eternal Beloved continues to visit him—  
None throughout the world can even dream of their similitude.*

سرورِ خاصانِ حق شاهِ گروهِ عاشقان      آنکه روحش کرد طے هر منزل وصل نگار  
*He is the chief of the chosen of God and the king of the squadron of lovers,  
Whose soul has traversed every stage of communion with the Beloved.*

آن مبارک پے که آمد ذاتِ با آیاتِ او      رحمتِ زان ذاتِ عالم پرور و پروردگار  
*That blessed one who is the manifestation of Divine Signs,  
And who came as a mercy from the Lord and Nourisher of all the  
worlds,*

آنکه دارد قرب خاص اندر جناب پاک حق      آنکه شان او نه فهمد کس ز خاصان و کبار  
*Who holds a special place of proximity with the Holy and True God,  
 Whose station is not comprehended even by the elect and great,*

آحمد آخر زمان کو اذیلین را جائے فخر      آخرین را مقتدا و ملجا و کھفت و حصار  
may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him  
*Ahmad of the Last Age is the source of honour for the Awwalīn [Earlier  
 Ones],  
 And is the leader—a haven of refuge, security, and strength—for the  
 Ākhirīn [Latter Ones].*

هست درگاه بزرگش کشتی عالم پناه      کس نگرود روز محشر جز پناہش رستگار  
*His magnificent threshold is the ark of protection for the entire creation;  
 No one will attain salvation on the Day of Judgment save through  
 his protection.*

از همه چیزے فرون تر در همه نوع کمال      آسمانها پیش اوج ہمت او ذرہ وار  
*He surpasses all and every kind of excellence—  
 The heavens being but a mere speck of dust before his immense resolve.*

مظہر نورے کہ پنهان بود از عہد ازل      مطلع شمسے کہ بود از ابتدا در استتار  
*He unleashes the light that had been concealed since eternity;  
 He is the rising of the sun that had remained veiled since the  
 beginning.*

صدر بزم آسمان و حجتہ اللہ بر زمین      ذات خالق رانسانے بس بزرگ و استوار  
*The head of the heavenly assembly and evidence of God upon the earth—  
 A great and powerful Sign of the existence of the Creator.*

ہر رگ و تار وجودش خانہ یارِ ازل      ہر دم و ہر ذرہ اش پُر از جمالِ دوستدار  
*Every vein and particle of his being is the abode of the Eternal Beloved;  
 Every breath and particle of his is imbued with the beauty of the  
 Friend.*



حسنِ روئے او بہ از صد آفتاب و مہتاب      خاکِ کوئے او بہ از صد نافہ مشکِ تبار  
*The beauty of his countenance far exceeds hundreds of suns and moons;  
 The dust of his street is more fragrant than a hundred pouches of  
 Tatar musk.*

ہست او از عقل و فکر و وہمِ مردم دور تر      کئی مجالِ فکر تا آن بحرِ پائیدا کنار  
*He lies well beyond the intellect, conception, and imagination of mere  
 mortals.*

*How can the confines of conception dare to encompass an endless  
 ocean?*

روح او در گفتنِ قولِ بلیٰ اولِ کسے      آدمِ توحید و پیشِ از آدَمِش پیوندِ یار  
 اشاره سوسے السُّبُّ بِرَبِّکُمْ قَالُوا بَلٰی      یعنی پیدا کنندہ توحید بعد از گمشدنِ آن

*His soul is the first to proclaim: 'بَلٰی' [Balā—'Yes, indeed']!<sup>1</sup>  
 The reference is to the verse: اَلَسْتُ بِرَبِّکُمْ قَالُوا بَلٰی*

*He is the Adam of Tauhīd [the Oneness of God]; and He enjoyed the  
 bond with the Beloved even before the creation of Adam.*

*He brought to life the concept of Tauhīd after it had been forgotten.*

جانِ خود دادنِ پیے خلقِ خدا در فطرتش      جانِ ثنایِ خستہ جانانِ بیدلانِ راغمدگار  
*Laying down his life for God's creation is ingrained in his nature.*

*He is ever ready to sacrifice himself for the downtrodden—he is a  
 dear friend of the helpless.*

اندر آن وقتے کہ دنیا پر ز شرک و کفر بود      بیچکسِ را خونِ نشد دلِ جز دلِ آن شہریار  
*At a time when the world was filled with idolatry and disbelief,*

*No heart wept blood but the heart of that emperor.*

1. Sūrah al-A'rāf, 7:173 [Publisher]

مہیچکس از جہت شرک و جس بت آگہ نہ شد  
 این خبر شد جان احمد را کہ بود از عشق زار  
*Unknown to all was the evil of shirk [polytheism] and the filth of the idol;*

*may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him*  
 Only the soul of Ahmad was cognizant of it, for his heart was lost in the love of God.

کس چہ مے داند کرازان نالہ با باشد خبر  
 کان شفیع کرداز بہر جہان در کُنج غار  
*Who knows and who is aware of the cries and pleas*  
 That the Holy Prophet made for the world in the Cave of Hira?

من نمیدانم چہ دردے بود و اندوہ و غمے  
 کاندان غارے در آوردش حزین و دلفگار  
*I cannot fathom the pain, the agony, and the distress,*  
 Which drove him to the cave—so troubled and overcome with grief.

نَے ز تالہکی تو حش نَے ز تہائی براس  
 نَے ز مردن غم نہ خوف کژدے نَے بیم مار  
*He feared neither darkness nor loneliness;*  
 He did not fear death, nor was he intimidated by scorpions or snakes.

کشتہ قوم و فدائے خلق و قربان جہان  
 نَے بجم خویش میلش نَے بہ نفس خویش کار  
*Loving his people deeply, devoted to mankind and a sacrifice for the world,*  
 He cared little for his bodily comfort and personal needs.

نعرہ ہا پڑ درد میزد از سپے خلق خدا  
 شد تضرع کار او پیش خدا لیل و نہار  
*He raised cries of pain for the good of humanity;*  
 Engaged in supplication to God day and night.

سخت شورے بر فلک افتاد زان عجز و دعا  
 قدسیاں رانیز شد چشم از غم آل اشکبار  
*His humility and prayers stirred a tumultuous uproar across the heavens—*

*Even the angels being moved to tears on account of his pain.*

آخر از عجز و مناجات و تضرع کردنش      شد نگاهِ لطفِ حق بر عالم تاریک و تار  
*Ultimately—owing to his humility, prayers, and supplications—*  
*The Lord turned to the dark and dreary world with compassion.*

در جهان از معصیت با بود طوفانِ عظیم      بود خلق از شرک و عصیان کور و کرد هر دیار  
*The world had been rocked by a massive tumult of sin;*  
*People everywhere had been rendered blind and deaf in consequence of disbelief and sin.*

بهمو وقتِ نوح دنیا بود پُر از هر فساد      هیچ دل خالی نبود از ظلمت و گرد و غبار  
*As in the time of Noah, the world was filled with every mischief;*  
*No heart was free from darkness and dust.*

مر شیاطین را تسلط بود بر هر رُوح و نفس      پس تجلی کرد بر رُوح محمد <sup>صلی اللہ علیہ وسلم</sup> کردگار  
*Devils reigned supreme over every body and soul;*  
*Then, the All-Powerful Lord appeared in glory to the soul of*  
***Muhammad.*** may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him

منتِ او بر همه سرخ و سیاهی ثابت است      آنکه بهر نوع انسان کرد جانِ خود نثار  
*His grace surely encompasses the black and the white alike;*  
*He it is who sacrificed his own life for the sake of mankind.*

یا نبی اللہ توئی خورشیدِ ره بایستی هدی      بے تو نآرد رُوحِ براهی عارف پر هیزگار  
*O Prophet of Allah! You alone are the Sun of the path of righteousness;*  
*Without you, no pious or righteous one can find his way to the right path.*

یا نبی اللہ لب تو چشمهٔ جان پرور است      یا نبی اللہ توئی در راهِ حق آموزگار  
*O Prophet of Allah! Your lips are a life-sustaining fountain.*  
*O Prophet of Allah! You alone are the guide to the path of the True Lord.*

آن کی جو نہ حدیث پاک تو از زید و عمرو و آن دگر خود از دہانت بشنود بے انتظار  
*There is one who yearns to hear your sacred sayings, from Zaid and Umar;*

*There is another who hears directly from your own lips without waiting.*

زندہ آن شخصے کہ نوشد بزم از چشمہ ات زیرک آن مردیکہ کراست اتباع اختیار  
*He indeed is alive who drinks from your fountain;*

*Wise is he who adopts your obedience.*

عارفان را منتہائے معرفت علم رخت صادقان را منتہائے صدق بر عشقت قرار  
*The ultimate point of knowledge, for those who know, is the knowledge of your countenance;*

*For the truthful, steadfastness and loyalty to you is the height of truth.*

بے تو ہرگز دولت عرفان نمی یابد کسے گرچہ میرد در ریاضت ہائے و جہد بے شمار  
*Without you, no one can ever acquire the wealth of true knowledge,*

*Even if one dies in the exertion of unlimited devotion and worship.*

تکیہ بر اعمال خود بے عشق رویت الہی است غافل از رویت نہ بیند روئے نیکی زینہار  
*To rely on one's own efforts without the love of your countenance is naivety;*

*For he who is unaware of your face can never see the face of virtue.*

دردمے حاصل شود نورے ز عشق روئے تو کان نباشد سالکان را حاصل اندر روزگار  
*Through the love of your countenance, a light is attained in a single instant,*

*Which the seeker cannot attain otherwise in an entire lifetime.*

از عجائب ہائے عالم ہرچہ محبوب و خوش است شان آن ہر چیز بینیم در وجودت آشکار  
*In the wonders of the universe—all that is beautiful and sublime—*

*I clearly behold the grandeur of them all in your person.*

خوشتر از دورانِ عشقِ تو نباشد هیچ دور      خوتر از وصف و مدح تو نباشد هیچ کار

*No time is better than the time consumed in your love,*

*Nor is any endeavour more pleasant than devotion to your praise and glorification.*

منکہ رہ بردم بخوبی ہائے بے پایانِ تو      جان گدازم بہر تو گر دیگرے خدمت گزار

*As I have experienced your unlimited virtues,*

*I am eager to sacrifice my life for you, whereas others only offer their services.*

ہر کسے اندر نمازِ خود دعائے می کند      من دعا ہائے برو بارِ تو اے باغِ بہار

*Everyone supplicates for himself in his prayers, but—*

*O my Garden of eternal spring!—I supplicate only for your progeny.*

یا نبی اللہ فدائے ہر سرِ موئے تو ام      وقتِ راہِ تو کنم گرجاں دہندم صد ہزار

*O Prophet of Allah! I am devoted to every particle of your holy person.*

*Were I to have a hundred thousand lives, I would sacrifice them all in your path.*

اتباع و عشقِ رؤیتِ از رہِ تحقیقِ چیت      کیمیائے ہر دے اکسیر ہر جانِ فگار

*What is the proven truth about submission to you, and love for your countenance?*

*It is a panacea for every heart—an elixir for every lacerated soul.*

دل اگر خوں نیست از بہرت چہ چیراست آن دے      در ثنارِ تو نگر دد جان کجا آید بکار

*How worthless is the heart that does not bleed for you!*

*How useless is the life that is not sacrificed for you!*

(صلیب)

دل نے ترسہ بہر تو مرا از موت ہم      پائنداری با بین خوش میروم تپائے دار

*Because of your love, my heart does not fear death; but instead*

*Behold my steadfastness: I happily go to the gallows! (the cross)*

راغب اندر رحمتت یا رحمتہ اللہ آمدیم      ایکہ چون ما بردر تو صد ہزار امید وار  
*O mercy of God! We have come to you seeking your mercy;  
 Like me, there are hundreds of thousands of hopefuls waiting upon  
 your threshold.*

یا نبی اللہ ثنار روئے محبوب توام      وقفِ راہت کردہ ام لیں سرکہ بردوش ست بار  
*O Prophet of Allah! I offer my being for your lovely countenance;  
 This head of mine, lying heavy on my shoulders, is but an offering in  
 your service.*

تا بمن نورِ رسول پاک را بنمودہ اند      عشقِ او در دل ہی جوشد چو آب از آبشار  
*Ever since I have been allowed to witness the light of the Holy Messenger,  
 His love has been gushing forth from my heart as water gushes from  
 a waterfall!*

آتشِ عشق از دم من بچو برقی می بہد      یکطرف اے ہمدمان غام از گرد و جوار  
*The fire of devotion emanates from my breath like lightning.  
 O weak-hearted companions! Move away from my proximity.*

بر سرِ وجد است دل تا دید رویِ او بہ خواب      ای بران روی و سرش جان و سرور و دم ثنار  
*Ever since I saw his countenance in a dream, my heart is in ecstasy;  
 My very being, my body, and my soul, are but an offering at the altar  
 of his body and countenance.*

صد ہزاران یوسفِ ینیم درین چاہِ ذقن      و آن مسیحِ ناصری شد از دمِ او بے شمار  
*I see hundreds of thousands of Josephs in the dimple of his chin;  
 I see countless Messiahs of Nazareth given birth by his breath.*

تاجدارِ ہفت کُشورِ آفتابِ شرق و غرب      بادشاہِ ملک و ملتِ ملجاءِ ہر خاکسار  
*He is the sovereign of the seven continents; he is the Sun of the East and  
 the West;*

*He is king of both the worlds—he is a haven for all the humble.*

کامران آن دل که زد در راه او از صدق گام      نیک بخت آن سر که میدارد سر آن شه سوار  
*Successful is the heart that treads faithfully in his path;  
 Lucky is the head that is sacrificed for that valiant champion.*

یا نبی اللہ جہاں تاریک شد از شرک و کفر      وقت آن آمد که بنمائی رخ خورشید وار  
*O Prophet of Allah! The world is dark with polytheism and disbelief;  
 It is time for you to reveal your face, which is radiant like the sun.*

بینم انوارِ خدا در روئے تو اے دلبرم      مست عشقِ روئے تو بینم دلِ هر هوشیار  
*O my beloved! I see the light of God reflected in your countenance;  
 I see the heart of every wise person intoxicated with your love.*

ایل دل فہمند قدرتِ عارفان دانند حال      از دو چشمِ شیران پنهان خورِ نصفِ النہار  
*Lovers recognize your status and the enlightened know your unsurpassable rank,  
 But the eyes of bats cannot behold the bright, midday sun.*

ہر کسے دارد سرے بادِ لبرے اندر جہان      من فدائے روئے تو اے دلتانِ گلزار  
*Everyone in this world has a beloved, but—  
 O beloved of rosy countenance!—I am devoted to you alone.*

از ہمہ عالم دل اندر روئے خوبتِ برہ ام      برو جودِ خویشتن کردم وجودت اختیار  
*Out of the entire world, I have fallen in love with your lovely face;  
 I have forsaken my own self for you, and adopted yours.*

زندگانی چیست جان کردنِ براہِ تو فدا      رستگاری چیست در بندِ تو بودنِ صید وار  
*What is life? It is to be sacrificed in your path.  
 What is freedom? It is to be like prey in your captivity.*

تا وجودم هست خواهد بود عشقت در دلم      تادلم دوران خون دارد بتو دار و مدار  
*As long as I live, your love will always dwell within my heart;*  
*As long as blood flows in my heart, it will always be sustained by my*  
*love for you.*

یا رسول اللہ برویت عہد دارم استوار      عشق تو دارم ازان روزیکہ بودم شیرخوار  
 یعنی عشق تو در وجود من فطرتی است  
*O Messenger of Allah! My ties with you are very strong, indeed;*  
*I have been devoted to you ever since I was a suckling infant.*  
*Meaning that love for you is my natural instinct*<sup>12\*</sup>

ہر قدم کاندر جناب حضرت بے چون زدم      دیدمت پنهان معین و حامی و نصرت شعار  
*At every step I have taken towards the Peerless Lord,*  
*I have seen you guiding me secretly as a helper, supporter, and guide.*

در دو عالم نسبتے دارم بتواز بس بزرگ      پرورش دادی مرا خود ہیچو طفلی در کنار  
*In both realms, I hold an endless affiliation with you;*  
*You have nourished me like a baby in your lap.*

یاد کن وقتیکہ در کشتم نمودی شکل خویش      یاد کن ہم وقت دیگر کامدی مشاق وار  
*Recall the time when you revealed your countenance to me in a vision;*  
*Recall the time when you visited me with great longing and eagerness.*

یاد کن آن لطف و رحمتہا کہ بامن داشتی      و آن بشارت ہا کہ میدادی مرا از کردگار  
*Call to mind the kindness and favours you showered upon me;*  
*And also the glad tidings you conveyed to me from the Lord.*

\* The number 12 is used here in the sense of the word *ḥadd*, which means 'limit' or 'end point'. In the Abjad system, the letter ح (*ḥā*) is numerically an 8, and the د (*dāl*) is a 4, the combination of which is 12. Thus, the number 12 here indicates that the comment being made ends at this point. [Publisher]



یاد کن وقتی چو بنمودی بر بیداری مرا      آن جمالے آن رخے آن صورتے رشک بہار  
*Recall the time when—in full wakefulness—you granted me a glimpse  
 Of the loveliness, the charming face, and the beauty that is the envy  
 of spring.*

آنچہ مارا از دو شیخ شوخ آزارے رسید      یارِ رسول اللہ پیرس از عالم ذو الاقتدار  
*The pain that I have suffered from the two wicked shaikhs—  
 O Messenger of Allah!—Ask Allah the All-Knowing, the Almighty,  
 about it.*

حال ما و شوخی لاین ہر دو شیخ بد زبان      جملہ میدانند خدائے حال دان و بردبار  
*My plight and the wickedness of the two foul-mouthed shaikhs  
 Is well known to Allah the All Knowing, the Forbearing.*

نام من دجال و ضال و کافرے بہادہ اند      نیست اندر زعم شان چون من پلید و زشت و خوار  
*They have called me a deceiver, a misguided one, and a disbeliever—  
 There being none more evil and despicable than me in their  
 estimation.*

ہیچکس را بر من مظلوم و غمگین دل نہ سوخت      جز تو کاندہ خواہا رحمت نمودی بار بار  
*No one felt the pain of my afflicted and painful heart except you,  
 Who consoled me with compassion again and again in my dreams;*

ہاں خداوند کریم و دلبر و محبوب من      داد و ہر دم میدہد تسکین مرا چون غمگسار  
*Except, of course, the Benevolent God, who is my Darling and Beloved,  
 And always comforts me like a sincere sympathizer.*

صبر کردیم از عنایتش برین صدمہ و کوفت      سرمہ در چشمے نیاید تانے گردد غبار  
*By Allah's favours, I showed patience in the face of hundreds of sufferings;  
 For, collyrium is not fit for the eye until it is grounded down.*

ایکہ تکفیر مسلمانان کئی از بخل و کین      شرم از خدائے عادل و ذی اختیار  
*O ye who gives lies and infidelity to Muslims out of jealousy and enmity!*  
*Feel ashamed in the presence of Allah, the Just and All-Powerful!*

سہل باشد از زبانِ خویش تکفیر کسے      مشکل افتد آن زمان چون پُر سدا وے کردگار  
*It is easy to brand someone else a disbeliever,*  
*You will suffer hardship at the time you are called to account by*  
*Almighty Allah!*

کلمہ گویان را چرا کافر نہی نام اے انی      گر تو داری خوف حق رو بیخ کفر خود برار  
*O my brother! Why do you label reciters of the Kalimah [the declara-*  
*tion of faith in Islam] as disbelievers?*  
*If you fear God, rid yourself of your own kufr [disbelief].*

بیر گشتی خلقِ پیران را نے دانی ہنوز      ایزد بخشد چو پیران صدق و سوز و اصطبار  
*You have grown old, yet you fail to conduct yourself as the elderly;*  
*May Allah grant you the sincerity, anguish, and patience of the*  
*elderly.*

گر کئی تکفیر قوم خود پہ کارے کردہ      نہ کہے      روا اگر مردی جہودے را باسلام اندر آ  
*What have you accomplished by calling your own people disbelievers?*  
*If you are courageous enough, go and convert a Jew (or an atheist)*  
*into a Muslim.*

چون نسیم صبح محشر پردہ بردارد ز کار      کیست کافر کیست مومن خود بگردد آشکار  
*On the morning of the Day of Judgment, the veil will be lifted—*  
*It will be openly manifest who the disbeliever is and who the*  
*believer is.*

گر خردمندی برو کن فکر نفس خود نخت      لاف ایمان خود پہ چیزے نور ایمان را بیار  
*If you are wise, go and worry about yourself;*  
*Claims of faith are of no avail. Bring forth the real light of faith.*

چند بر تکفیر نازی چند استهرا کنی    رو بایمان خود و ما را بکفر ما گذار  
*How long will you take pride in calling us disbelievers? How long will  
 you keep mocking?*

*Look at the condition of your own faith and leave us to our 'disbelief'.*

نَه ز فرد و سم حکایت کن نه از آلام نار    کز غم دین محمدؐ میرزیم شوریده دار  
*Lecture me not about the story of Paradise nor the torment of Hell;*

*I am at the brink of madness out of pain for the religion of  
 Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>.*

اندر آن وقتیکه یاد آید مسم دین مرا    بس فراموشم شود هر عیش و رنج هر دو دار  
*Whenever I recall the immense struggle that the Faith demands,*

*I am altogether oblivious to the pleasures and pains of both realms.*



*Now following is this book, one title of which is*

*The Mirror*  
*of*  
*the Excellences of Islam*

*[Āīna-e-Kamālāt-e-Islām]*

And *Remover of Misgivings* [*Dāfi‘ul-Wasāwis*] is another title as well, consisting of a preface, three chapters, and an epilogue. May God Almighty bless it and make it a source of guidance for the world.

*Āmīn—and again—Āmīn.*





By the means provided by God Almighty, my humble self had recently published three treatises in support of Islam—the title of the first is *Fath-e-Islām* [Victory of Islam], the title of the second is *Tauḍīḥ-e-Marām* [Elucidation of Objectives], and the title of the third is *Izāla-e-Auhām* [*The Removal of Misconceptions*]. In conformity with the indications, revelation, and inspirations granted by God, these treatises also mentioned the dignity of being the **likeness of the Messiah**, which has been conferred upon my humble self. Similarly, there was an explanation of the subtleties, verities, and profound spiritual insights which constitute the sublime truths of Islam and the Noble Quran, and serve as a source of honour for the Muslims in confrontations with the enemies. Furthermore, the beauty and purity of the unsurpassable supremacy of Islamic *Tauḥīd* [Oneness of God] were revealed through these verities. Likewise, all those spiritual insights were abundant and satisfying replies to the extraneous charges that the people of the current day and age heap upon the teachings of Islam entirely out of their bigotry and blurred vision. All of this had been taken from the Noble Quran and the authentic *aḥādīth*; and testimonies to these truths were borne by the pious sages of the past.

It was hoped that the wise would look upon these books with a sense of gratitude and would fall upon the threshold of God Almighty in prostrations of thankfulness for conferring these spiritual favours at the precise moment of need. But alas! The situation turned quite to the contrary due to the dissension spewed by some ulema. Instead

of people being grateful to God Almighty, a hue and cry of intense ingratitude was so fiercely raised that all those verities, fine points, illuminating subtleties, and divine spiritual insights were deemed statements of heresy. My humble self was branded a *kāfir* [disbeliever], a *mulhid* [atheist], a *zindīq* [heretic], and a *dajjāl* [deceiver]; rather, I was declared to be the worst of all the *kāfirs* and *dajjāls* of the world.

The primary instigator of this mischievous propaganda is a *shaikh* by the name of Muhammad Ḥusain who resides in Batala, in the District of Gurdaspur. Like the majority of today's mullahs who are quick to pronounce edicts of disbelief, and prior to fathoming the substance of any statement, they declare its speaker to be a *kāfir*, this trait appears grossly inflated in the aforementioned *shaikh* in comparison to the others. And from what has been proven to me thus far, it seems certain that the share of understanding, deliberation and goodwill allotted to the *shaikh's* persona from *Qassām-e-Azal* [the Eternal Dispenser (of all things); i.e. God] is very scant. This is the reason that this particular gentleman was the first to run around in every direction carrying the **proclamation of his *fatwa*** in hand [accusing me of disbelief].

Consequently, Miyān Nadhīr Ḥusain Dehlawī was the first to lift the pen in declaring me a *disbeliever* and *apostate*, signing and sealing his attestation of disbelief upon Baṭālāwī's *fatwa*. Miyān Nadhīr Ḥusain declared my humble self to be a *kāfir* [disbeliever] without any delay or deliberation, even though I had clearly written to him earlier that I do not deviate from any of the agreed-upon tenets of Islam. Among the many reasons that he did so, one reason is that the said Miyān suffers from senility. With his unbridled wrath, rage, and fury, he holds no remarkable ability for deep reflection and research. Moreover, if I am not mistaken, his senses are now somewhat close to being lost on account of becoming old and decrepit. Apart from this, it seems to me that, from the very beginning, he has been a man of shallow thinking and by its very nature, his mind is not at all agreeable to sublime verities and profound spiritual insights.

In short, the instigator of the petition [labelling me a disbeliever]



is Baṭālawī and the first to issue the declaration of disbelief is Miyān Nadhīr Ḥusain; all others are their followers who generally walk in their footsteps to appease Baṭālawī and show respect to Dehlawī's right as a teacher.

It is nothing new for these ulema to declare someone a disbeliever; indeed, this habit has deeply obsessed this group during this age in particular—with each sect declaring the other to be outside of the Faith. Nevertheless, if there is regret, it is only to the extent that these edicts merit condemnation not only on account of their errors of judgement, but also because they can be clearly seen as contrary to trust and *taqwā* [righteousness]. Personal jealousies are concealed from view and are publicly expressed in the garb of religious issues.

Is it not surprising that in this critical matter, such a degree of audacity is shown in declaring someone a disbeliever that an individual repeatedly affirms his [faith in] Islam, and exonerates himself from the false accusations of disbelief, and yet he is branded a disbeliever? Moreover, people are told that in spite of declaring the *Kalimah*—**لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ مُحَمَّدٌ رَّسُولُ اللَّهِ** [There is no one worthy of worship except Allah; Muhammad is the Messenger of Allah]—and despite believing in *Tauḥīd* [Oneness of God] and obeying the obligatory tenets of Islam, observing *Ṣaum* [the Fast] and *Salāt* [Prayer], and being among the People of the *Qiblah* [i.e. the Muslims], he is still a *kāfir* [disbeliever] and like other polytheists and disbelievers, he will abide eternally in Hell and will never get out of it!

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ایکہ دجالم بچشت نیز ضال چوں نترسی از خدائے ذوالجلال

*O ye who vieweth me a deceiver and astray!*

*Why do you not fear the Lord of Glory?*

مومنے را نام کافر ے نبی کافر مگر مومن با ایں خیال

*You give the name kāfir [disbeliever] to a believer;*

*I would indeed be a kāfir if you—with this belief of yours—remain a believer.*

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In general, it is a pity that all of the ulema alleging disbelief affixed their seals on Baṭālawī's edict of disbelief without any inquiry or investigation. They did not read my books from beginning to end, or enquire anything from me by letter or correspondence. Had they affixed their seals with good intention, the light of their heart would have inevitably perturbed them to ask me first, and to seek the unravelling of the meaning of my words directly from myself. If after due inquiry, those words were proven to be truly the words of heresy, then with a heavy heart, they might have proceeded to document their testimony regarding the disbelief of a brother. Had they done so and not been hasty, they would have been acquitted of the charges that can be made by God against a hasty heretic-hunter. But alas! They did not do so. On the contrary, as a sheep follows another sheep and nibbles whatever the other is eating, some of our ulema have embraced this very approach in accusing others of disbelief. *فَمَا أَشْكُوا إِلَّا إِلَى اللَّهِ* [However, I do not complain to anyone but Allah].

Who does not know that it is a very serious issue to declare someone a *kāfir* even though he is a Muslim believing in the One True God and facing the Qiblah, particularly when he repeatedly affirms in his speeches and writings that he is a Muslim and believes in Allah and the Messenger; the Angels of Allah, the Lord of all Glory; His Books; His Messengers; and the Resurrection—precisely in the way that Allah, glorified be His eminence, and the Messenger of Allah, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, have declared in their teaching? Moreover, he proclaims to abide by all the commandments, *Saum* [the Fast] and *Salāt* [Prayer] that have been ordained by Allah and His Messenger<sup>sas</sup>. Is it the work of people who are righteous, God-fearing, good-natured, and bearers of goodwill to declare such a Muslim to be a *kāfir* and to call him a great disbeliever and *dajjāl*?

Although, as I have just described, it is undeniably true that it has been the case of the ulema since the earliest of times that, when they failed to comprehend the various diverse truths, spiritual insights, subtleties, and sublime intricacies in the books of the holy elders, the pious

guides, and the imams of the time, and in their vain presumption they found them in conflict with the Book of Allah and the Prophetic traditions, then some of the ulema expelled these pious guides and imams from the pale of Islam, while others, employing leniency, did not declare them *kāfir* but excluded them from *Ahl-e-Sunnah wal-Jamā'ah*. Thereafter, when that era passed and another generation of ulema appeared, God Almighty opened up the hearts and minds of the later ulema and granted them the understanding of those profound subtleties that the former [ulema] had failed to grasp. Hence, they acquitted those previous pious guides and imams from any edicts declaring them *kāfirs*. And not only that, they also came to believe that they were *Qutabs*, *Ghauthes*, and exalted *Walīs*.<sup>1</sup> The conduct of the ulema remained in this very pattern, with very few fortunate ones who came forward to accept those chosen in the court of Allah at the appropriate time. This is precisely the character and conduct of these superficial boasters of knowledge who have carried on since the time of Husain, the Perfect Imam, may Allah be pleased with him, to this time of ours, that they have never accepted any man of God in his time.

Allah the Exalted had said in the Holy Quran about the Jews:

اَفَكُمَا جَاءَكُمْ رَسُولٌ بِمَا لَا تَهْوَىٰ اَنْفُسُكُمْ...<sup>2</sup>

Meaning: O Children of Israel! Has it become your habit that of every Messenger that came to you, you rejected some of them and killed some others?

The ulema of Islam have adopted the same characteristic and have thus established a full and complete resemblance with the Jews. In copying them, they have spared nothing; it was necessary that this should

1. *Qutb* (pl. *Aqtāb*—Guiding Stars), *Ghauth* (Saint), and *Walī* (Friend [of Allah]) are various designations used for *Auliya'ullāh* (Friends of Allah). [Publisher]

2. *Sūrah al-Baqarah*, 2:88 [Publisher]

come to pass so that all those things that the Noble Messenger<sup>sas</sup> had foretold in the very beginning about this likeness might be fulfilled.

Granted, the ulema eventually recognize the honoured ones of God, showing them great reverence to the point that they even joined their communities; but they did so only at the time when they had passed away from this transitory world and their acceptance [by God] had been made manifest to millions. وَلِلّٰهِ ذُرُّ الْقَائِلِ [i.e. How well has someone described this situation]:

جب مر گئے تو آئے ہمارے مزار پر  
پتھر پڑیں صنم تیرے ایسے پیار پر

*Only after my death did you come to my grave—  
Cursed be this love of yours, O my lover!*

As for me, the Benevolent God is well aware of my condition. He has bestowed His blessings upon me perfectly and has sent me endowed with a burning passion to obey the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> so that I may teach people the ways of true obedience and deliver them out of this theoretical and practical darkness, which is engulfing them on account of their carelessness.

I do not claim that my soul possesses an excessive wealth of acquired knowledge. On the contrary, I am the first of all and greater than all in confessing my utter ignorance and unworthiness. At the same time, however, I cannot keep it a hidden secret that the Benevolent Lord Himself admitted a humble, unimportant, and unlettered person like me into His tutelage and made me aware of the perfect verities and sublime insights that I could have never fathomed even if I were to have remained ever occupied in deliberating and pondering more than all others, and had also been granted a long life. I am also thankful to the Benevolent Lord because He has granted me so much faith-inspired zeal for the propagation of Islam that even if I am called

upon to sacrifice my life in this path, it would be no burden upon me by the grace of the Almighty. Though I have cut off all expectations from the people of this world, my hopes from God Almighty are very strong. Hence, I know that even though I am alone, I am not alone. The Benevolent Lord is with me, and no one is closer to me than Him. Through His grace alone, I have been conferred this passionately loving spirit in order to serve His Faith even while suffering pain, and to carry out Islamic endeavours to their utmost completion with zeal and sincerity. God has appointed me to this task Himself. Now I cannot stop because of anyone's demand nor can I—God forbid—view the directives revealed to me with disdain; nay, I highly revere these sacred directives and desire that my whole life be consumed in this very service. In reality, a happy and blessed life is that life alone which is spent in the service and propagation of God's religion. Otherwise, even if a man becomes the master of the entire world and amasses such vast means of livelihood that all the provisions possible for a king of kings be available for his pleasure, they would not amount to a pleasant life but would, in fact, be a kind of punishment whose bitterness unfolds sometimes simultaneously and sometimes subsequently.

I regret that the attention of most of our ulema is largely drawn towards superficial, base, and crude ideas. They do not understand the fine verities which have been placed by the Benevolent Lord in the Mighty Book and which have been set forth by our Master and Guide, peace be upon him. Moreover, they declare an enlightened person who is blessed by God Almighty with insights of Divine wisdom and lays bare those fine truths—the manifestation of which was the essential need of the time—to be a heretic, atheist, interpolator, and apostate. I am observing that they are generally unacquainted with spiritual verities and are contented merely with the shallow and superficial. Their natures have no inclination towards the true bliss which is experienced by the elect of God upon receiving intimation of profoundly intricate mysteries, nor do they possess any capacity for it. Even though they have not been affected by the usual idolatrous practices of the East,

their hearts nevertheless conceal such idols of superstition that are hindering their path from accessing the true Qiblah [direction and focus of worship].

I am absolutely certain that it is the will of God Almighty to break these idols. No argument can make me doubt that the time has come that these idols be completely shattered, and for the worshippers of God to rediscover lost verities [of spirituality]. Almighty God, who is aware of all secrets, is well aware that people have strayed far away from the essence of Islam, and they have abandoned the blessed light of truthfulness.

Such is the internal calamity, as I have briefly described above. But the condition of our [non-Muslim] opponents is beyond description—they are laden with criticisms and misgivings the way a tree may be laden with fruit. Their rancour towards Islam has increased greatly in our time and everyone has started criticising Islam in accordance with their ability and capacity. If, from among our opponents, someone has some knowledge of the physical sciences, he raises objections in the context of these same physical sciences and wishes to prove that Islam sets forth things opposed to the proven facts of physical science. If an opponent has acquired something of the knowledge of medicine and the work of a physician, he presents the investigative studies of the same discipline in a wholly deceitful manner to raise objections against Islam, alleging that Islam sets forth matters opposed to those evident and ascertained experiments that have been proven to a perfect degree by means of modern research. Similarly, someone who has a passing knowledge of modern astronomy is engaged in finding fault with the teachings of Islam from that perspective. In short, as far as I have been able to ascertain, about 3,000 objections have been raised by short-sighted people against Islam, the teachings of the Holy Quran, and our Leader and Master [the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>].

At first thought, one becomes restless and grieved at such a storm of opposition; however, upon closer examination, these objections are not truly harmful to Islam. Nay, if we ourselves are not negligent, they

constitute an opportunity afforded to us through Divine wisdom to disclose the hidden subtleties and verities of Islam. Thus, in the light of these new insights, which shall be made manifest and are being manifested upon those who ponder as a result of the opportunity thus afforded them, the seekers of truth may be saved from the many forms of terrible darkness prevalent in the world today. However, in case we do not attend to them, these objections are cause for great apprehension and appear such as could raise a storm of misguidance. Mere knowledge of Islamic beliefs, or familiarity with ancient texts, will not be a sufficient protection against them. People of perceptive wisdom realize that these objections constitute a serious trial for the Muslims, and if the Muslims show negligence towards this calamity, this poisonous material will continue to gradually affect them and their descendants until it carries them to destruction.

The [certainty of] faith which can prevail against evil thoughts and misguidance can never come into being without the intervention of heavenly knowledge. So how can such people—who are ignorant of the beauties of the Holy Quran, are powerless to refute external objections, and deny verities and lofty insights of the Word of God—remain protected from the dangers of stumbling? On the contrary, in this day and age, that barren faith of theirs is at risk of being in grave danger and is incapable of enduring the most trivial trial.

The firm establishment of an individual's faith in God Almighty is possible only for the one whose faith in His Book is firmly established, and the firm establishment of the faith in His Book is possible only when the Holy Word of God Almighty is itself seen as an unsurpassable miracle and an infinite ocean of insights and verities without the need of *manqūli* miracles<sup>1</sup> that are not even visible today. Yet, these are the people who believe that a fly reflects innumerable such wonders of the might of the Omnipotent God that no man can make the like of it, no

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1. *Manqūli miracles* refer to miraculous events that have been narrated and handed down over generations through traditions. [Publisher]

matter how great a scientist or philosopher he may be, and who believe that if all the scientists of the world were to study the wonders and hidden qualities of a grain of barley till the Day of Judgment, they would still not be able to say with certainty that they had discovered all its qualities. These very people—who are called Muslims and the progeny of Muslims—believe that apart from some coarse words and superficial meanings, the Noble Quran contains no other sublime truth within it. They have come to limit the fine points, the concealed mysteries, and the meanings of the Divine Word to the mere extent which the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, had set forth in keeping with the need of his time and the intellectual capacity of the people who were present before him. They know that all the sayings of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, were not fully recorded nor completely preserved as they should have been. In spite of all this, they are absolutely uninterested and unconcerned with exploring the fresh subtleties of the Holy Quran.

Bear in mind that by '**fresh subtleties**', I do not mean that insights that are in conflict with its ordained and explicit Shariah can be extracted from the Noble Quran from time to time. Rather, they are the insights implied from the secrets, fine points, and profound subtleties which—while keeping the whole Shariah intact—reveal its true and complete picture and manifest its true perfection for all to see, up to the point that they demonstrate the *manqūl* as being the *ma'qūl*.<sup>1</sup> Hence, there was a need to bring out these insights in this age of rationality.

Look wherever your sight stretches to, you will find this to be the inevitable practice of Allah—that God Almighty always helps His Faith in accordance with the needs of the time. Whatever kind of light was demanded by the nature and circumstances of the time was shown

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1. *Manqūl* refers to knowledge transmitted through religious texts and traditions, while *ma'qūl* refers to knowledge based on reason and rational thought. *Ma'qūl* refers to knowledge grounded in reason, logic, and rational thought. [Publisher]



by Him in His Word and Work through some of the elect to provide proof of the point that His Word and Work are neither deficient nor frail and feeble. In the time of Ḥaḍrat **Mūsā [Moses]**, there was a need for a serpent to confront the serpents, and in the time of the Messiah, medicine men and sorcerers needed to be opposed by the power of spiritual healing. Thus, God Almighty helped His Prophets according to the demands of the time. The fact is, the needs of the time of our Leader and Guide, the Seal of the Messengers, were not limited to any one particular category. In point of time, too, his age was not limited but, rather, is so expansive that it extends to the Day of Judgment. Therefore, the All-Powerful and All-Wise Lord placed endless excellences in the Noble Quran. The Noble Quran has been perfectly remedying the mischief of every age on account of these excellences wherein the slightest good has not been omitted.

Accordingly, during the time of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, the monumental feat of the Noble Quran was to reform the fundamental teachings for all mankind. Hence, it conferred clear and straightforward principles for the cognition of God and for respecting the rights of human beings upon the entire world, and re-established the lost doctrine of *Tauḥīd*. In contrast to the totally misguided thinking of the world, it presented a Book filled with wisdom and light, couched in lofty, eloquent, and lucid words, which shattered all prevailing notions and manifested a wondrous miracle of wisdom, cognizance, eloquence, lucidity, and forceful appeal.

Thereafter, in this very fashion throughout every era, whenever any kind of darkness raised its head, the light of this Holy Word continued dispelling that darkness because that Sacred Text—an eternal miracle—had brought within it the consummate light for obliterating the various kinds of darknesses of different ages. Accordingly, it has been removing and repelling every kind of darkness through the power of its light up to the point that this era emerged wherein we find ourselves. And just as the Noble Quran had prophesied, the earth unleashed in our time all the darknesses that lay concealed beneath it, and a turbulent

uproar of immorality, disbelief, and abuse of intellect erupted. This is that very feverish impetuosity of crooked minds which has otherwise been called by the name of *Dajjāl*. God Almighty had given the news in the Noble Quran that the Glorious and Perfect Word would also overcome this turmoil. It was, therefore, essential that the Word of God be laden with the true philosophy that would prevail upon the beguiling philosophy of the time; for, it has come for the purpose of [carrying out] reformations eternally. It will not be wearied nor weakened until it establishes its authority in each and every sound mind. Those devouring the poison of [ungodly] philosophy were in need of this antidote. Hence, God Almighty manifested it and—in order to shatter the prevalence of impious rationality—He emphatically willed to manifest the supremacy of Quranic rationality and to pulverize the vain rationality of the opponents.

But pity be upon those who fail to recognize the time! They do not even have the slightest idea of the unbearable difficulties being faced every day by the children of Muslims through external attacks and afflictions, nor how much injury has been inflicted upon Islam by [evil] philosophic innuendos, to the extent that a large portion of newly educated Muslims have been so far removed from Islam as if they have left it altogether. Similarly, many ignorant and foolish people, abandoning the light of Islam, have entered into the darkness of Christian beliefs and embraced a shameful creed which is a source of disgrace and ignominy. The reason for this is that the absurd objections of the present age, which were filled with deception and sophistry, appeared to possess merit in their defective judgement.

An immense enormity is that today's ulema are themselves aiding the Christians and others in various aspects for their polytheistic teachings. For instance, according to the false creeds of present-day Christians, the **tenet** regarding Ḥaḍrat Masīḥ, peace be on him, **being alive**, is a tenet that is —so to speak —the one and only pillar of the Christian faith for making Ḥaḍrat 'Īsā<sup>as</sup> [Jesus] into God. Nonetheless, when today's Muslims affirm on the one hand, the death and earthly

burial of our Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, yet also affirm the belief that the Messiah is still alive, they surrender their own written confession into the hands of the Christians that the Messiah<sup>as</sup> is distinct and unique in his attributes from the attributes of all common men—nay, even from the attributes of all Prophets!

Since *Afdalul-Bashar* [the Best of Mankind]—who appeared 600 years after the Messiah—died after a brief life, yet even upon the lapse of 1300 years beyond the death of this Noble Prophet<sup>sas</sup>, the Messiah has still not died, then does it prove anything other than the Messiah's nature being superior to the inherent requisites of humanity? Assuredly, although the ulema of this age formally express their **abhorrence** for every apparent form of *shirk* [association of partners with God], they have left no stone unturned in **supporting** the polytheists. What an outrage it is that Allah the Glorious declares the death of the Messiah<sup>as</sup> throughout His Holy Word, yet these people—by supposing that he is still alive—give rise to thousands and countless calamities for Islam. They deem the Messiah as the 'Living and Self-Subsisting' of the heavens but pronounce the Chief of the Prophets, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, to have died in the earth, despite the testimony of the Messiah recorded in the Noble Quran as follows:

مُبَشِّرًا بِرَسُولٍ يَأْتِي مِنْ بَعْدِي اسْمُهُ أَحْمَدُ<sup>1</sup>

Meaning that I give glad tidings of a Messenger who will come after me—that is, after my **death**—whose name will be **Ahmad**<sup>sas</sup>.

Therefore, if the Messiah has not yet passed away from this physical realm, it follows necessarily that our Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, has also not yet come into **this world** since an **explicit dictum of the Holy Quran** is telling us that the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, would come into this **physical world** after the Messiah would have left this physical world.

1. *Sūrah aṣ-Ṣaff*, 61:7 [Publisher]

The reason is that in the verse, 'coming' has been expressed in juxtaposition with 'going', which makes it essential that 'coming' and 'going' should both be applied in the very same context. In other words, one went to that world, and one came from that world.

Thereafter, the second **testimony** of Ḥaḍrat Masīḥ [the Messiah] regarding his death is a clear and plain reference in the verse: فَلَمَّا تَوَفَّيْتَنِي<sup>1</sup> [Since You did cause me to die.]

Whosoever has eyes, look and see! Bear in mind that the verse: فَلَمَّا تَوَفَّيْتَنِي gives an indication of the fulfilment of the very promise which was made in the verse:

يَعِيسَى ابْنِ مَرْيَمَ قُلْ إِنِّي مُتَوَفِّيْكُمْ وَرَافِعُكُمْ إِلَيَّ<sup>2</sup>

In order to understand these meanings of تَوَفَّى [*tawaffi*—cause to die], which reflect the purpose and intent of Allah the Glorious, it is necessary to evaluate these two verses—the promise and the realization of the promise—collectively with a consistent view. But sadly, our ulema have no interest in this research. This very word تَوَفَّى [*tawaffi*], which is employed in two places of the Noble Quran with reference to the Messiah, is precisely the same that is also applied in the **Noble Quran** for our Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, as Allah the Glorious says:

وَإِنْ مِّنْ مَّا نُرِيكَ بَعْضَ الَّذِي نَعِدُهُمْ أَوْ تَتَوَفَّيْكَ<sup>3</sup>

Here, too, if our ulema had taken the meaning of تَوَفَّى [*tawaffi*] to be

1. *Sūrah al-Mā'idah*, 5:118 [Publisher]

2. O Jesus, I will cause you to die *a natural death* and will exalt you to Myself (*Sūrah Āl-e-Imrān*, 3:56). [Publisher]

3. And whether We make you see *the fulfilment of* some of the things with which We threaten them or *whether* We make you die, *it makes little difference* (*Sūrah ar-Ra'd*, 13:41). [Publisher]

the same—that the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, had also been raised alive to the heavens—then I would not have any regret about them. But look at their insolence and impertinence, that wherever the word تَوَفَّى [*tawaffi*] occurs in the Noble Quran with reference to our Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, they take it to mean **death**, but then, when the same word is used with respect to the Messiah, they say it means to be raised **alive**. None of them notices that the word is exactly the same. They go on believing the account of one another like the blind. By mentioning this word **twenty-five times** in His Book—the Noble Quran—God Almighty has made it manifestly clear that its meaning is ‘seizing the soul’ and nothing else.

Up till now, these people have continued to interpret this word in an altogether different sense when applied to the Messiah<sup>as</sup>, as if to say that the meaning of تَوَفَّى for the entire world is simply ‘to seize the soul’, but for the Son of Mary its meaning is ‘to be raised alive’. If this course is not an endorsement of *shirk*, then what else is it!

On the one hand, the unworthy and bigoted Christians abuse our Chief and Master overtly and openly and deem the Messiah to belong to the heavens, and our Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, to belong to the earth; while on the other hand, these ulema are helping them in these precarious times by accepting their polytheistic notions of the Christians.

I wish that these people would set aside their prejudices for a minute and simply reflect on what *shirk* [associating partners with God] is: what its essence is, and what are its origins and prerequisites. It would then quickly dawn upon them that allowing the association of anyone in God Almighty’s person, attributes, words or works, or in His right to be worshipped—be it equally or to a somewhat lesser degree—is **precisely the *shirk*** that will never be forgiven. The prerequisites which give rise to *shirk* consist of any individual being ascribed any such quality regarding his person, attributes, or works which are never found in his kind—neither in his own right nor by way of reflection.

Now, if we suppose that a particular person is, so to speak, unique

and exceptional among all humanity in his nature and the inherent essentials of life, and possesses some such quality over and above all others in which no one else has any share, then we shall be placing a huge mound of *shirk* in Islam's way by holding such an unjustified belief. The clear teaching of the Noble Quran is that Lord God, who is Unique and Praiseworthy, demands Oneness by virtue of His very nature. He has imposed shared qualities upon His creation and has ordained some to be the likeness and **resemblance** of others, so that any quality that a person possesses in his being, actions, words, or attributes may not result in the deception that the person concerned is invested with a quality that is not shared with anyone else, so that, like God Almighty, he might be considered to be one without a partner in any of his attributes. *Sūrah al-Ikhlās* in the Noble Quran affirms this very distinction—that Uniqueness in being and attributes are the sole possession of God Almighty.

Behold! Allah, His eminence be glorified, commands:

قُلْ هُوَ اللَّهُ أَحَدٌ<sup>1</sup>

Since the fact of the matter is that the primary indicator of having been created is that there is commonality and resemblance of some with others, and no individual possesses any personal quality or trait that is not shared by any other individual—neither by way of reflection nor in his own right. Under these circumstances, if we suppose that an individual human being is entirely distinct from others and transcends the requisites of humanity in his various attributes or works and, like God Almighty, is unique in this act or attribute, then we would be admitting a partner, so to speak, in God Almighty's attribute of Oneness. This is a very deep point of wisdom. Thoroughly reflect upon it.

God Almighty has articulated the death of the Messiah several times in His Book to the extent that his mother, Maryam Ṣiddīqah

1. Say, 'He is Allah, the One' (*Sūrah al-Ikhlās*, 112:2). [Publisher]

[Mary the Truthful], who, as all agree, is dead, has been mentioned together with him as:

كَانَا يَأْكُلِينَ الطَّعَامَ<sup>1</sup>

Meaning that they both used to eat food when they were alive.

The reason for this emphasis was that in His eternal knowledge, He knew very well that a grave tribulation would befall mankind during the Latter Days because of the belief that the Messiah is alive, and that tribulation would be very harmful to Islam. Therefore, He decided from the very beginning and clearly disclosed that the Messiah had died. Some naive people surmise that the verse:

إِنِّي مُتَوَقِّعٌ<sup>2</sup>

merely contains the promise of the Messiah's death, which only indicates that God Almighty will cause him to die at any given time, but not that He has already caused him to die. Such people do not consider that God Almighty had already conveyed the news of the fulfilment of this promise when He mentioned the words فَلَمَّا تَوَفَّيْتَنِي<sup>3</sup> [‘When You caused me to die’] spoken through the mouth of the Messiah himself. Moreover, it is also worth considering that a promise of God Almighty in the words that ‘I am about to do such and such a thing’ indicates that the promise is about to be fulfilled soon without delay—not that the promise of *rafā‘* [exaltation] should be fulfilled immediately but the promise of causing death has yet to be fulfilled despite the lapse of nearly 2,000 years!

O readers! By making the aforementioned statements at this time,

1. *Sūrah al-Mā'idah*, 5:76 [Publisher]

2. *Sūrah Āl-e-Imrān*, 3:56. [Publisher]

3. *Sūrah al-Mā'idah*, 5:118 [Publisher]

it is not my intent to expose the errors of the present-day ulema to the public because whatever has dawned upon me of their sorry state of poor judgement, evil inner selves, suspicious temperaments, and foul talk, shall soon be discussed by me in reply to their own questions. In this **Preface**, I only wish to point out that our ulema have failed to recognize the crisis which has befallen Islam. Instead of supporting Islam, they themselves have supported the Christians by providing them with a partial argument through their very own statements. **The Noble Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, had made it clear to us, not by one, but by twelve strong arguments and conclusive criteria that Jesus, son of Mary, peace be on him, is dead, and the Promised Messiah who is to come shall appear from this very Ummah.** But the present-day ulema paid no attention at all towards it. They conceded many complications for Islam, and strengthened the external threats through internal fabrications. Because of the blowing of these poisonous winds, the religion of Islam is facing a perpetual and never-ending threat. No wise man's intellect can now agree that the eradication of all these evils is within human capacity. On the contrary, the rectification of this corruption upon land and sea is exclusively the work of that God who can sink the sea beneath the land or the land beneath the sea through His [extraordinary] powers of omnipotence.

Brothers! Understand it well that the Muslims today are in a more precarious situation than the Jews during the time of Jesus, peace be on him, and they are surrounded by a chain of adversities akin to a land surrounded by impenetrable mountains. The fact that the pathways to success have become difficult and innumerable complications surround Islam like a circle is not difficult to understand for a sensible person who surveys the prevailing ailments of this age.

But, alas! Most of our ulema, whose ignorance and stupidity are pitiable, are completely oblivious to this violent tempest. And I grieve all the more when I see that in addition to the lack of concern, heedlessness, and indifference that this group holds regarding Islam, there is a serious decline in their true righteousness and integrity, whereas



goodwill, courtesy, perseverance, high resolve, expanse of virtue, and sympathy for Islam, Muslims, and humanity seem to have completely disappeared from their hearts. Commendable moral qualities, such as forgiveness, benevolence, sincerity, and reconciliation, have been, as it were, obliterated from within their bosoms. The minds of most of them seem to have thousands of doors open to stirring mischief, but none for exiting discord and entering reconciliation. I see that their spirituality has seriously declined on account of excessive arrogance and extensive negligence. They have a zeal for this material world and its pomp and glory, and a reluctance towards God Almighty. The reason is that they have strayed far from the purpose of that *wahy* [revelation], which purifies hearts and cleanses internal impurities. They preach, but do not practice; they show the path but do not tread upon it themselves. God Almighty has therefore placed seals upon their hearts and has made their intellect and understanding dull because it is the practice of Allah that until someone performs acts of virtue with the subtlest of care, the subtlest of mysteries are not conferred upon his heart.

Such is the plight of the ulema. But, alas! The condition of our ascetics appears to be even worse than this. *إِلَّا مَا شَاءَ اللَّهُ* [Except as Allah wills]. Only such ascetics are generally seen among our people who have maligned Islam by inventing thousands of innovations for which no valid basis can be found in the Holy Shariah. They are involved in such perverse rituals and notions as are shameful to describe. Some of them have adopted a special manner of dress, like Hindu Yogis, and live in a style very much approaching theirs. They waste their lives in extremely inappropriate and savage forms of bodily penance, which are far removed from the practice of the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>. Their faces display extraordinary marks of the wrath of God and portray such a perverse image that perhaps no other face upon earth evidences a greater misery.

Most mendicants indulge in diverse practices which they deem to be a mark of excellence, and they prop this up as evidence that they have traversed a great distance in the [spiritual] path. However, in reality,

those practices are simply based on ignorance and barbaric gestures that are so far removed from true cognition as a cloud is from the earth on a bright sunny day. These people cannot carry out any service at all to the Faith. It is apparent that a life of laziness, wasting of time, lack of self-discipline, indolence, lethargy, and boastfulness has made a powerful impact upon them and they squander away their entire life and find themselves utterly weak and helpless to change any of their habits which runs contrary to the Holy Shariah—indeed, against humanity itself.

Some people who go about in the garb of mendicants have abandoned the pure paths of Islam under the influence of their evil inclinations and are involved in extremely filthy and shameful practices to the degree that I doubt whether or not Satan—notwithstanding his great notoriety—is their equal.

In reality, however, [the burden of] all this sin rests upon the shoulders of the ulema, who waste their time in futile disputes and pay no heed to serving God's creation [i.e. people] with true sympathy. Are they any less than the Jews in their ostentation, materialism, hypocrisy, lasciviousness, sedition and manipulative argumentation? No, certainly not. Rather, they are somewhat worse than Jews in all these qualities, which they conceal from others with great cunning. They hate the truth and love falsehood. Moreover, they also want to push others into the same pit into which they themselves have fallen. On account of their inherent misfortune, they remain embroiled in the superficial aspects of the Faith and the petty minutiae of the Shariah and have no inclination to touch the sublime truths and deep spiritual insights of Islam, nor do they hold any aptitude for such [Divine] mysteries and finer points. Just as a spring erupts due to the rising up of the air trapped within its channels, moment by moment, similar is the case of the spring of their intrinsic state; for this filthy fountain of theirs is being exposed with great force these days due to the rising gas and fumes of bigotry which they had been concealing for ages. رَبِّ اَرْحَمْ رَبِّ اَرْحَمْ [My Lord have mercy! My Lord have mercy!]

In short—O brethren!—in this age, such a toxic wind has spread

out internally and externally, as cannot be eradicated by the power of man; rather, its eradication rests in the hand of that All-Powerful God who is *حَيٌّ وَقَيُّومٌ* [*Hayyun wa Qayyūmun*—Living, Self-Subsisting and All-Sustaining], the One who changes the seasons and alternates the times, and showers rains of mercy following a drought. And, as you can see, the intensity of heat ultimately draws the rain. In a way that, when the heat reaches its extreme and arrives close to the point of exterminating humans, then, by the perfect wisdom of the Eternal Maker, this heat triggers a powerful effect upon the seas and, owing to the intensity of that heat, vapours arise from the seas. Then, the air from the seas—which is cold and heavy and possesses the capacity for retention—absorbs the vapours and, like a pregnant woman, is filled by them; and it is pushed by the winds of the surrounding vicinity, which are moved naturally, and stir it into motion—thus becoming the impetus behind the phenomenon of that air moving naturally in the shape of clouds towards the land where the air is hotter, thinner, lighter, and offers less resistance. Then it rains to the same degree as warranted by the intensity of the heat.

The same is the case with spiritual rain, which—like physical rain—has been descending since time immemorial in its due seasons; in other words, just as during the days of drought when the drought reaches its ultimate extreme, the heat and desire of the eager souls are at once activated fervently. Then that heat conveys its burning intensity and pain to the Sea of Mercy, which is an endless ocean. Thereupon, the Sea of Mercy ordains its remedy and the luminous vapours of gratuitous [divine] grace begin to emanate. Then the nearby angels—who remain cold to the movement and passion of their selves, are extremely light and are the embodiment of *يَفْعَلُونَ مَا يُؤْمَرُونَ* [they do what they are commanded]—imbibe those graces. Then, the people who have the spiritual temperaments connected with those angels, who are Prophets, Messengers, and *Muḥaddathin* [recipients of Divine revelation], stir those graces into motion through their consummate zeal for the Divine and, themselves becoming the impetus, rain down at the opportune moment to those

who possess the warmth of capacity and desire. This situation continues to recur in the world during times of need.

Indeed, after the torrential downpour [of spiritual blessings] took place during the time of the **Holy Prophet**, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, no further downpour is needed and that pure water has not been wasted even up to this day; however, lesser rains are still needed, lest the general fertility of the soil should suffer. Therefore, whenever the All-Wise and All-Powerful God witnesses that aridity has overtaken the world and the plants of His garden are withering away, He definitely creates circumstances for rain. This is the eternal law of nature in which you will never find a variation. Accordingly, it was necessary that God Almighty should have shown mercy for His humble servants in these days.

Look at the condition of the present age and bear witness truthfully: Is this not the time when the religion of Islam needs Divine help? Can you find an example of the extent to which Islam and the Noble Messenger, may peace and blessings of Allah be on him, have been vilified in this age, and the degree to which attacks have been made upon the Shariah revealed by God, and the manner in which the door of apostasy and heresy has been flung open? Is it not true that in a very short time, about **100,000** people have adopted Christianity in India alone and **60 million** or more **books** have been published in opposition to Islam, and people belonging to very noble families have been deprived of their holy religion, to the extent that those called the descendants of the Messenger, have become his enemies and donned the robe of Christianity?

So many books filled with slander, disrespect, and vile abuse of the Noble Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be on him, have been printed and published, the hearing of which makes the body tremble and the heart cries out to bear witness that even if these people had murdered my children before my eyes, had cut to pieces my sincere and loving friends of this world, had killed me with great humiliation, and

seized all my property, I swear by Allah—again, I swear by Allah—that I would not have been so pained and my heart would not have been so hurt as it has been pained and hurt by these abuses and this slander that has been inflicted upon our Noble Messenger<sup>sas</sup>. So has the time of that ultimate calamity, which was destined for Islam in the Latter Days of the world, not yet arrived? Can anyone prove, on the basis of the Noble Quran and the Hadith, that a time worse than this is yet to come—one that will bring greater trials than those that are present today?

So, brethren, do not wrong your souls. Carefully consider that the time has arrived, and external and internal afflictions have reached their extreme. If you place all these trials and afflictions on one side of a scale, and for the other side, search through the Noble Quran and all *ahādīth*, you will not be able to find their equal—nay, not even a thousandth part of the present-day tribulations will be proved by the Quran and the Hadith. So, which age of trials and which **time of an even greater *Dajjāl*** that would be worse in trials and tribulations than the present time is yet to come after this period of time? Can you prove that tribulations are found mentioned in the Noble Quran and the sayings of the Prophet that are greater than these afflictions and of which there is currently no sign today? Keep in mind that if you were to strive so hard to find mention of such tribulations that you even died in this effort, even then it would definitely not be proved through the Noble Quran and the Hadith that there will ever be a time of greater tribulations than those present today.

**Gentlemen! Such *Dajjāl*-like behaviour is spreading here, the like of which even the father of your supposed *Dajjāl* could not have conceived.** Mankind is being led astray in a thousand ways, the documenting of which would require a large volume. Our opponents have been so successful in their efforts to misguide people as to make hearts tremble, and their schemes have generally had an acute effect upon hearts. Their science and philosophy have spread the seeds of such temerity and audacity as though every person from among

their philosophers claims: **أَنَا الرَّبُّ** ['I am the Lord']. Awaken and arise, therefore, and see what kind of age has set in and reflect on how the prevalent thinking is opposed to the concept of absolute *Tauḥīd* [Oneness of God], so much so that the very concept of the power of God is considered to be a great naivety, and he who speaks of the Divine decree is accounted a great fool. People with a philosophical bent of mind go on spreading atheism and remain preoccupied with somehow trying to take possession of the whole **machinery** of Godhead so that it might come into their hands. They want to be able to eradicate epidemics whenever they wish, avert death, cause rain, cultivate crops at will, and allow nothing to remain outside their power. Think about it. In this age, is there any end to this misguidance? **These calamities have put a hatchet to both arms of Islam.**

O you who are asleep! Awaken! O you who are heedless! Arise! For, the time of a great revolution has come. This is the time for weeping and not sleeping; it is the time for earnest supplication and not for mockery, ridicule, and charging people with heresy and apostasy. **Pray** that the Benevolent God may grant you the insight to perceive the present darkness fully and perfectly and that you may also see the light that the mercy of Allah has prepared in order to dispel it. Arise in the later part of the night and seek guidance from God Almighty by weeping and crying and do not unjustly pray for the destruction of the Movement established by God nor contrive designs against it. Almighty God will not follow your heedless and misguided designs. He will make manifest to you the follies of your minds and hearts and will help His servant. He will never cut down the tree that He has planted with His own hand. Is there anyone among you who will cut down the tree which he expects to bear fruit? Then why would He, who is All-Wise and All-Seeing and the Most Merciful of those who show mercy, cut down the tree, the blessed season of whose fruitful harvest He is awaiting? When you, being human, would not want to do such a thing, why would He, who is the Knower of the unseen and reaches the depth of every heart, do such a thing? Hence, remember it well that in this confrontation, you are striking your swords

against your own limbs. So do not thrust your hand into the fire wrongly lest the fire flare up and consume it.

Bear in mind that if this had been man's doing, many would have emerged to destroy it. Moreover, it would definitely not have survived for twelve years, which is the age of maturity. Do you recall seeing any impostor who, having claimed falsely to receive converse from God, survived and remained secure for such a long time? It is a pity that you neither reflect upon nor recall the verses of the Noble Quran where Allah, glorified be His eminence, Himself says with reference to the Noble Prophet, that had he falsely attributed the smallest thing to God, He would have severed his jugular vein. Who is dearer to God than the Holy Prophet, that he should not only survive such a great imposture, but should be enriched by the bounties of God Almighty? Brothers! Refrain from self-deception and do not exceed the bounds of your obstinacy regarding matters which are specifically in the realm of God's knowledge. Break the chains of your habits, and, becoming a new person, tread along the paths of *taqwā* [righteousness] so that you may receive mercy and God Almighty may forgive your sins. Fear God and restrain yourselves. Is there not a single one of you who is rightly guided? *وَإِنْ لَّمْ تَنْتَهُوا فَسَوْفَ يَأْتِيَ اللَّهُ بِضُرَّةٍ مِنْ عِنْدِهِ وَيُضْضِرَّ عَبْدَهُ وَيُزَيِّقَ أَعْدَاءَهُ وَلَا تَصْرُوهُ شَيْئًا*. [If you do not desist, God will soon bring help to His servant from Himself and will smash his enemies and you will not be able to do him any harm whatsoever].

بدہ از چشم خود آبے درختانِ محبت را مگر روزے دہندت میوبائے پر علاوت را

*Water the trees of love with the tears of your eyes,*

*So that someday they may give you their sweet fruit.*

مہِ اسلام در باطنِ حقیقت ہائے دارد کجا باشد خبر زان مہ گرفتارانِ صورت را

*The Moon of Islam has many verities within it;*

*How can people who are captivated by superficial looks know of [the qualities of] this Moon?*

من از یار آمدم تا غلق را این ماه بنمائم      گرام روزم نمی بینی به بینی روز حسرت را  
*I have come from the Lord to show this Moon to the people;*  
*If you recognize me not today, you shall surely see a mournful day.*

گراز چشم تو پنہانت شام دم زن بارے      کہ بد پر ہمیز بیمارے نہ میند روئے صحت را  
*If my exalted station is hidden from your eyes, do not be impatient;*  
*For the sick man who is careless does not regain his health.*

چو چشم حق شناس و نور عرفانت نہ بخشیدند      نہادی نام کافر لاجرم عشاقِ مِلّت را  
*Since you have not been granted the eye to recognize the truth and the*  
*light of cognition,*  
*That is surely why you label those who are the lovers of the faith as*  
*disbelievers.*

کجا از آستانِ مصطفیٰ اے ابلہ بگریزیم      نمی یابیم در جائے دگر ایں جاہ و دولت را  
*O fool, where can we run away to, from the court of the Chosen Prophet*  
*of God?*  
*For we can find no other place to attain such honour and riches.*

بحمد اللہ کہ خود قطعِ تعلق کرد ایں قوے      خدا از رحمت و احسانِ میسر کرد غلوت را  
*Praise be to God that the people themselves separated from me;*  
*God, in His mercy and kindness, vouchsafed me privacy.*

چہ دوزخِ ہما کہ میدیدیم بیدارِ چنین رُوبا      بنامِ دلبرِ خود را کہ بازم داد جنت را  
*What a hellish sight did I see in those faces!*  
*I glorify my Beloved who has restored my paradise to me.*

چہ مہ سوزی ازالِ قربے کہ بادلدارِ میدارم      اگر زودست در دستت بگردانِ رزقِ قیمت را  
*Why do you burn with envy if I enjoy nearness to my Beloved?*  
*If you have the power, deprive me of my appointed sustenance.*



به نخوت هائی آید بدست آل دامن پاکش      کسے عورت ازویابد که سوزد رخت عورت را  
*Pride will not let you catch hold of His holy garment;  
 Only he is honoured in God's sight who has burnt up the symbols of  
 worldly honour.*

اگر خواهی ره مولی ز لاف علم خالی شو      که ره ندهند در کوشش اسیر کبر و نخوت را  
*If you desire the way of God, free yourself from the pride of your learning;  
 For, a slave of pride and haughtiness cannot find his way to His  
 Presence.*

منه دل در تنعم هائے دنیا گر خدا خواهی      که میخواند نگار من تهیدستان عشرت را<sup>الهای</sup>  
*If you are seeking God, do not commit your heart to the luxuries of the  
 world;*

*revealed line      For my Beloved loves only those who stay away from all luxury.*

مصفا قطره باید که تا گوهر شود پیدا<sup>الهای</sup>      کجا بیند دل ناپاک روئے پاک حضرت را  
*revealed line      A pure drop is needed so that it may become a pearl;  
 How can an impure heart be honoured with a sight of the counte-  
 nance of the Holy One.*

نمے باید مرا یک ذره عورت هائے لیس دنیا      منه از بهر ما کر سی که ما موریم خدمت را  
*I do not seek even the smallest title of honour in this world;  
 Do not place a chair for me, for I am appointed to serve.*

همه خلق و جهان خواهد برائے نفس خود عورت      خلاف من که میخواهم براو یار ذلت را  
*All the people and the whole world desire honour for themselves,  
 Unlike me, who will bear disgrace for the sake of my Beloved.*

همه در دور این عالم امان و عافیت خواهند      چه افتاد این سرمارا که میخواهد مصیبت را  
*Everyone in today's world seeks ease and comfort;  
 What has happened to my head that it bids for sufferings?*

مراہر جا کہ می بینم رخ جانان نظر آید در خشد در خور و در ماه بنماند ملاحظت را  
*Wherever I look, I see the face of the Beloved;*

*He shines in the sun and shows Himself in the beauty of the moon.*

حریص غربت و عجزم ازال روزیکہ دانستم کہ جادر خاطرش باشد دل مجروح غربت را  
*I have loved poverty and humility from the day I learned*

*That the wounded heart of the humble is honoured in His presence.*

من آن شاخ خودی و خودروی از بیخ برکندم کہ می آرد ز ناپاکی بر نفیرین و لعنت را  
*I have pulled out from its roots, the tree of ego and haughtiness,*

*That bears the unholy fruit of hatred and curses.*

اگر از روضہ جان و دل من پردہ بردارند بہ بینی اندران آل دلبر پاکیزہ طلعت را  
*If the curtain were drawn from the garden of my innermost being,*

*You would glimpse therein the radiant trace of the Pure-Faced Beloved.*

فروغ نور عشق او ز بام و قصر ماروشن مگر بیند کسے آن را کہ میدارد بصیرت را  
*The radiating light of His love shines forth from my entire house,*

*But it is visible only to those who possess the vision of understanding.*

نگاہ رحمت جانان عنایتها بمن کرد دست و گرنہ چوں منی کے یابد آن رُشد و سعادت را  
*The glances of the mercy of my Beloved have bestowed countless favours*

*on me;*

*Otherwise, how could someone like me enjoy such good fortune and blessings?*

نظر بازان علم ظاہر اندر علم خود نازند ز دست خود گلندہ معنی و مغز و حقیقت را  
*The learned ones in mundane knowledge are proud of their learning,*

*But they have cast aside the reality and true essence with their own hands.*

ہمہ فہم و نظر در پردہ ہائے کبر پوشیدند چنان خواهند لیس خمرے کہ پاکال جام قربت را  
*They have buried their understanding and vision behind the veil of pride;*

*They are fond of this drink, just as the drink of nearness to God is loved by the holy ones.*

خدا خود قصہ شیطان بیاں کردست تا دانند کہ این نخوت کند ابلیس ہر اہل عبادت را  
*God has Himself related the story of Satan, so that*

*People might know that arrogance turns even a devout worshipper into Iblīs.*

بلفاظی بسر کردند عمر خود بلا حاصل دے از بہر معنی ہانمی یا بند فرصت را  
*They wasted their lives insisting upon the letter of the text,*

*But they did not devote even a moment to finding its real meaning.*

گزار و لاف شان در ظاہر شرعت ہم باطل کہ غافل از حقائق کے نکوداند شریعت را  
*Their bragging about the outward knowledge of the Shariah is also wrong;*

*For, how can he know the Shariah who is ignorant of the true facts.*

مسیحؑ ناصری را تا قیامت زندہ می فہمند مگر مدفون یثرب راندا ند لیس فضیلت را  
*They believe that the Messiah<sup>as</sup> of Nazareth will live till the Day of Judgment,*

*But they did not accord this honour to the one buried in Yathrib [Madinah].*

ز بوئے نافہ عرفاں چو محروم ازل بودند پندیدند در شان شہ خلق لیس مذلت را  
*Being eternally deprived of the fragrance of the musk of knowledge,*

*They were content with this disgrace upon the Sovereign of all mankind. may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him.*

ہمہ دُربائے قرآن را چو خاشاکے بیگلندند      ز علم ناتمام شان چہاگم گشت ملت را  
*All the pearls of the Quran, they threw away like rubbish;  
 How much has the Muslim ummah suffered from their imperfect  
 knowledge.*

ہمہ عیانیان را از مقال خود مدد دادند      دلیری با پدید آمد پرستاران میت را  
*They helped all the Christians by their utterances,  
 And thus emboldened the worshippers of a dead body.*

دین ہنگام پُر آتش بخواب خوش چہاں تُسبم      زماں فریاد میدارد کہ بشتابید نصرت را  
*How can I enjoy a peaceful sleep at a time when this fire is raging?  
 The age cries out: Hasten to help me!*

شب تاریک و بیم دزد و قوم ماچنین غافل      کجا زیں غم روم یارب نما خود دست قدرت را  
*A dark night; burglars all round; and my nation so careless;  
 Where shall I go, my Lord, with this grief of mine! Manifest the  
 Hand of Your glorious power!*

بجاک انگیزی شان بر ضیائے خود نمی ترسم      نہان کے مانند آن نورے کہ حق بخشید فطرت را  
*I am not afraid of their throwing dust on my light;  
 How can the light that God bestowed upon my nature remain  
 hidden?*

کجا غوغائے شان بر خاطر من و حشمتی آرد      کہ صادق بزدلے نبود و گر بیند قیامت را  
*How can their noise be disconcerting to my heart?  
 For, the truthful does not show cowardice, even if he were facing  
 Doomsday.*

## [ESSENCE OF ISLAM]

Now, before I turn my attention to other issues, it is imperative to put in writing the true essence of the **Religion of Islam**, the ways and means of arriving at this truth, and the fruits of adhering to this reality. This is essential because the understanding of many profound verities depends upon first fully understanding the truth of Islam, the means of its attainment, and then the fruits of adhering to it. It would be of great benefit for my opponents from within [Islam] that they should thoroughly study the discussion relating to the **truth of Islam** and its related matters, because many of the doubts and suspicions that assail their minds arise in the hearts only due to their failure to reflect upon the complete and perfect truth of Islam, the ways and means of its attainment, and its fruits. There is no doubt that after reflecting upon all these realities, if the internal [i.e. Muslim] opponents of my humble self study my responses vis-à-vis their objections, they would be relieved of many doubts and misgivings. The condition is that they study diligently and at appropriate occasions reflect upon the **responses** that I have written to dispel their doubts. Those who oppose our religion would likewise benefit greatly from the statement of these verities. They would thereby understand what **religion** is and what the signs of its truthfulness are.

Now, bear in mind that in the Arabic lexicon, '**Islam**' means to pay the purchase price in advance, or to commit some affair to someone, or to seek reconciliation, or to surrender an assertion or dispute.

The idiomatic meaning of '**Islam**' is set out in the following noble verse:

بَلَىٰ مَنْ أَسْلَمَ وَجْهَهُ لِلَّهِ وَهُوَ مُحْسِنٌ فَلَهُ أَجْرُهُ عِنْدَ رَبِّهِ وَلَا خَوْفٌ عَلَيْهِمْ وَلَا هُمْ يَحْزَنُونَ<sup>1</sup>

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1. *Sūrah al-Baqarah*, 2:113 [Publisher]

Meaning that: A Muslim is the one who commits his entire being to the cause of God Almighty; that is to say, who devotes his being entirely to Allah the Exalted, and to following His will, and to attaining His pleasure, and then remaining steadfast in doing good deeds for the sake of God Almighty and devoting all his faculties of action to that cause. In other words, one should belong solely to God Almighty, both doctrinally and practically. 'Doctrinally' means that one should truly regard one's entire being as something which has been created for the recognition, obedience, adoration, and love of God Almighty and for seeking His pleasure. And 'practically' means the doing of all real acts of goodness that are related to each of one's abilities and God-given faculties, solely for the sake of Allah, but with such eagerness, zeal, and attention as if beholding the countenance of the True Beloved in the mirror of one's obedience.

The remaining translation of the verse is that whosoever has doctrinal and practical purity based on such personal love, and performs good deeds with such natural zeal, it is only such a one who deserves reward in the sight of Allah; such people have no fear, nor do they grieve. In other words, for such people, salvation is immediately available because when one truly believes in the Being and attributes of Allah and achieves perfect affinity with Him, and his desires align with the will of God Almighty, and his pleasure lies entirely in His obedience, and all good deeds are performed with relish and spiritual delight—and not by way of carrying a burden—then that is indeed the state of being which can be called success, salvation, and deliverance. And whatever shall be witnessed and felt in the Hereafter due to salvation, shall really be a reflection and consequence of this very state of being, which will be felt bodily in the world of the Hereafter. In other words, heavenly life begins in this very world and the root of the punishment of Hell also is the filthy and blind life on this earth.

By reflecting upon the noble verses mentioned above, every right-minded person will be able to realize that the essence of Islam can truly become established in someone when his whole being—together with

all its physical and spiritual faculties—becomes devoted solely to God Almighty and the trusts that are committed to him by God Almighty are rendered back to the True Bestower. He should demonstrate his Islam and the entire picture of its perfect reality, not only doctrinally but also in the mirror of his actions. In other words, a person claiming to be a Muslim should prove that his hands and feet, heart and mind, intellect and understanding, anger and compassion, meekness and knowledge, all his physical and spiritual faculties, honour and wealth, comfort and delight, and whatever pertains to him from the top of his head to the tips of his toes—whether it be apparent or hidden—so much so that even his motives, the fears lurking in his heart, and the passions of his soul, all have become fully subordinated to Almighty God, just as a person's limbs are under his full control. In short, it should be proved that his sincerity has reached a stage in which whatever is his, does not belong to him but now belongs to God Almighty, and that all his limbs and faculties have become so engaged in the divine service of God that they seem to have become the **very limbs of God**.

Reflection on these verses also shows clearly and manifestly that devoting one's life to the cause of God Almighty, which is the essence of Islam, has two aspects. **FIRST**, that Only God Almighty alone should be regarded as your deity, objective, and beloved, and no other should remain a partner in His worship, love, fear, and hope. All matters relating to His holiness, glorification, worship, etiquettes of servitude, ordinances and commandments, all the limits set by Him, as well as the heavenly decrees and determinations, should be accepted with utmost sincerity of heart and soul. All these commandments, limits, laws, and decrees should be fully accepted and undertaken with the utmost self-effacement and humility. Moreover, a full understanding should be acquired of all those holy verities and points of wisdom, which are a means of appreciating His vast powers and a reason for discovering the greatness of His kingdom and sovereignty and a powerful guide for recognizing His favours and bounties.

The **SECOND** aspect of devoting one's life to the cause of Allah the Exalted is to devote one's life to the service of His creatures, sympathising with them, alleviating their sufferings, sharing their burdens and truly assuaging their sorrows. One should be prepared to suffer pain to bring comfort to others and be ready to bear grief to bestow contentment to others.

This above discussion demonstrates that **the essence of Islam** is supremely sublime indeed and no human being can truly deserve the noble title of 'belonging to Islam' till he surrenders the whole of his being to God, together with all its faculties, desires, and designs and till he begins to tread along His path by withdrawing altogether from his ego and all that accompanies it. Thus, a person will be truly called a Muslim only when his heedless life undergoes a total **revolution** and all traces of the existence of his *nafs-e-ammārah* [the self that incites to evil], together with all its passions, are wiped out altogether and then—after this death—he is invested with a new life for the purpose of doing good, for the sake of Allah, and this pure life should consist of nothing except obedience to the Creator and sympathy for His creatures.

Submission to the Creator should be such that—in order to make manifest His Honour, Glory, and Uniqueness—one should be ready to accept every dishonour and humiliation and should be eager to undergo a thousand deaths in order to uphold His Oneness. One hand should be ready to cut off the other with pleasure in obedience to Him, and love for the grandeur of His commandments and the thirst for seeking His pleasure should render sin to be so hateful as if it were an all-consuming fire or a fatal poison, or an obliterating bolt of lightning, from which one must flee with all their ability. In short, to follow His will, one must abandon all desires of the ego; and to establish a relationship with Him, one should be ready to endure life-threatening injuries; and to provide proof of this relationship, one must break off all carnal relationships.

The service of one's fellow beings should be such as to strive for



their benefit purely for the sake of Allah in all their needs and to strive to provide benefit to them out of true and selfless sympathy, in all the relationships of mutual dependence that God has established from the very beginning. All those in need of help should be helped out of one's God-given capacity and all efforts should be exerted for their betterment, both in this world and in the Hereafter.

However, this devotion will be true to its name only when all of one's limbs become so subservient to the will of God as to become instruments of the Divine, through which the actions willed by Allah are implemented from time to time, or are a clear mirror in which the will of the Divine is reflected with the utmost clarity. When submission and service reach this perfect stage, then—by the blessings of his being visibly coloured in the colour of Allah—it can truly be said regarding the limbs and powers of a man possessing such qualities, by way of *wahdat-e-shuhūdī*,<sup>1</sup> that his eyes, for example, and his tongue, hands, ears, and feet, are the eyes, tongue, hands, ears, and feet of God Almighty because all those limbs and powers having become perfectly imbued with [the desire to carry out] the will of God Almighty and, having become the embodiments of His wishes, become deserving of being said to bear the appearance of God Himself. The reason for this is that just as a man's limbs are entirely under the control of his will and pleasure, so does a perfect man, upon reaching this stage, develop within himself a concordance with the desires and wishes of God Almighty, and he comes to love God's Greatness, Oneness, Lordship, His being worthy of worship, and His every wish and desire, as much as God loves these things Himself. Hence, it is this magnificent submission and service for the sake of Allah, admixed with love and affection, and filled with sincerity and utter devotion, which is Islam, the true nature of Islam, and the very essence of Islam—and it is attained

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1. Lit. 'Unity of Perception'. A Sufi concept holding that everything seen in nature is a reflection of God. [Publisher]

after bringing about death upon the ego, physical existence and its desires, and by extinguishing the personal will.

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**  
Stages of perfect bliss in  
Islam

At this juncture, it should also be borne in mind that the verse mentioned above, namely:

بَلَىٰ مَنْ أَسْلَمَ وَجْهَهُ لِلَّهِ وَهُوَ مُحْسِنٌ فَلَهُ أَجْرُهُ عِنْدَ رَبِّهِ وَلَا خَوْفٌ عَلَيْهِمْ وَلَا هُمْ يَحْزَنُونَ<sup>1</sup>

alludes to all the three essential grades of perfect bliss—namely: *fanā*, *baqā*, and *liqā*—because, as I have just mentioned, the phrase *أَسْلَمَ وَجْهَهُ لِلَّهِ* [submits himself completely to Allah] teaches that all faculties and organs and whatever belongs to oneself should be surrendered to God Almighty and dedicated to His cause. This is the condition which is described in other words as *fanā* [*self-annihilation*]. The reason is that when a person, conforming to the meaning of this noble verse, submits the whole of his being and his faculties to God Almighty and dedicates himself to His cause, and completely abandons his carnal drives and desires, then, undoubtedly, a kind of death overtakes him, and this is the very ‘death’ that the Sufis designate as *fanā*.

Then, after this, the expression, *وَهُوَ مُحْسِنٌ* [and he is the doer of good] points to the stage of *baqā* [revival]. When a person, after complete and perfect annihilation of the self and abandonment of all lustful passions, is prompted by Divinely inspired passion and urging, and after the cessation of all lustful activities, he is filled with Divine inspiration and begins to move again, then, that is the **second life**, which should be called *baqā*.

1. Nay, whoever submits himself completely to Allah, and is the doer of good, shall have his reward with his Lord. No fear *shall come* upon such, neither shall they grieve (*Sūrah al-Baqarah*, 2:113). [Publisher]

Thereafter are the following phrases:

فَلَا أَجْرَ عِنْدَ رَبِّهِ وَلَا خَوْفٌ عَلَيْهِمْ وَلَا هُمْ يَحْزَنُونَ<sup>1</sup>

These words—which attest to the affirmation and acceptance of reward and negation and removal of fear and grief—point to the condition of *liqā* [communion]. For, when a man develops such a high grade of cognition, certainty, trust, and love as to remove from his mind all unease, apprehension, and doubt concerning the reward of his sincerity, faith, and loyalty; and instead it becomes so certain, absolute, visible, palpable, and perceptible as if he has already received it; and his belief in the Being of God Almighty becomes so certain, as though he is beholding Him; and all fear concerning the future disappears from his sight, and no trace is left of any grief, past or present; and every spiritual bounty is seen as manifestly present before him; then that is the condition—free from all constraint and imperfection, secure against every doubt and apprehension, exempt from all pangs of waiting—that is known by the name *liqā*.

It is this rank of *liqā* that the word *muhsin* [doer of good], which is present in the verse, affirms with great clarity because, according to the explanation given by the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, *ihsān* [doing of good] is the name given to the perfect condition in which a human being establishes such a relationship with God Almighty during his worship as if he is beholding Him.

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**  
Stages of perfect bliss in Islam [continued]

This rank of *liqā* is established perfectly only when the colour of the Divine completely and perfectly covers and conceals the colour and characteristics of humanity in the seeker, just as fire hides the colour of

1. He shall have his reward with his Lord. No fear *shall* come upon such, neither shall they grieve (*Sūrah al-Baqarah*, 2:113). [Publisher]

iron beneath itself, such that the physical eye perceives nothing but the fire. This is the stage at which some seekers stumbled and misunderstood the symbolic union as being an actual, physical union.

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**  
Children of Allah

Some Sufis have designated the *'Auliya'ullāh* [Friends of Allah] who reached the stage of *liqā*, or who partook even a sip of it, as the **Children of Allah** on account of the fact that such people are completely immersed in the protective lap of the attributes of Allah. Just as a son has some resemblance to his father in his form and features, in the same way, they, too, in consequence of having adorned themselves reflectively with certain attributes of Allah, acquire some resemblance to the beautiful attributes of God Almighty.

Such titles are not used explicitly in the idiom of the Shariah, but those invested with the quality of spiritual cognition have derived them from the Holy Quran, as Allah, glorified be His eminence, has said:

فَاذْكُرُوا اللَّهَ كَمَا ذُكِّرْتُمْ ۚ أَوْ أَشَدَّ ذِكْرًا<sup>1</sup>

Meaning that: Remember Allah the Exalted as you remember your fathers. It is obvious that if the metaphorical use of these expressions had been forbidden by the Shariah, God Almighty would have kept His Word entirely free from such expressions as might have provided a justification for others to use them.

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**  
Miraculous Signs of the  
Messenger<sup>sas</sup> of Allah

At this stage of *liqā*, a person sometimes performs certain actions which appear to be beyond **human capacity** and possess the nature of Divine power. For instance, our **Chief and Master, the Chief of the Prophets, Ḥaḍrat Khātamul-Anbiyā' [the Seal of the Prophets],**

1. *Sūrah al-Baqarah*, 2:201 [Publisher]

may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, threw a handful of pebbles at the enemy during the Battle of Badr, not with any prayer but only with his **spiritual power**. But that handful of pebbles manifested the **power of God** and affected the opposing army in such an extraordinary manner that not a single one of them was left whose eye was not affected. They were rendered like the blind and were overpowered by such alarm and fright that they fled like the bewildered. Allah, glorified be His eminence, alludes to this miracle in the following verse:

وَمَا رَمَيْتَ إِذْ رَمَيْتَ وَلَكِنَّ اللَّهَ رَمَىٰ<sup>1</sup>

Meaning that: When you threw that handful, it was not you who threw it, but it was God Almighty who threw it. That is to say, Divine power came into play behind the veil; this task was not possible for any human power.

In the same way, a second **miracle** of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him—namely, *Shaqul-Qamar* [**Splitting of the Moon**—was shown by the same power of the Divine. It was not accompanied by any prayer because it was manifested by the mere pointing of his finger, which was charged with the **power of Allah**. There are many other such miracles that the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**  
[Cont.] Miraculous Signs of  
the Messenger<sup>sas</sup> of Allah

be upon him, showed, which were manifested only through the power bestowed upon his own being, unaccompanied by any prayer. On many occasions, the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, by merely placing his fingers in a cup of water, increased the quantity of water to satisfy the thirst of the whole Muslim army, camels, and horses, and the quantity of water was still the same as before. Many a

1. *Sūrah al-Anfāl*, 8:18 [Publisher]

time, he blessed two or four pieces of bread by the touch of his hands to satisfy the hunger of thousands of people, and on other occasions, he blessed a small quantity of milk with his lips to make it fill the stomachs of an entire group of people. And on some occasions, he turned the salty water of a well into fresh water merely by putting some saliva from his mouth into it. He healed the critically injured by placing his hands on their wounds; and with the blessing of his hand, he made the eyes whole of those who had been deprived of their eyesight in war. Similarly, he performed many other miracles which were the result of personal powers that were accompanied by a hidden **power of Allah**.

The **Brahmūs**, **philosophers**, and **naturalists** of today may be excused if they deny such miracles, for they cannot visualize a state of spiritual eminence in which a man is vouchsafed powers of Divinity by way of reflection. Thus, if they laugh upon hearing such things, they are helpless because they have not attained any stage of **spiritual maturity** beyond an immature, childish level. They are not only in a defective condition, but would also be happy to die in the same state of **spiritual imperfection**.

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**  
Sad state of the Christians

Yet even more pitiable is the case of those **Christians** who, by recounting some similar miracles—albeit inferior to these—have presented them as an argument for the ‘Divinity’ of Jesus. They claim that the Messiah’s raising the dead to life and curing the paralyzed and the lepers was through his personal authority—not through any prayer—and this is evidence of the fact that he was truly the Son of God; nay, even God Himself!

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**  
Our Prophet<sup>sas</sup> was granted the greatest number of miraculous Signs

What a pity! These hapless people do not realize that if a man can transform into God through these means, then our Chief and Master, the Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, has a far greater claim upon this

‘divinity’ since the Messiah, peace be on him, could never achieve the extent to which this type of miraculous ability was shown by the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him. And our Guide and Exemplar, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, not only demonstrated this miraculous ability on his very own, but he also left a long legacy of such miracles to remain in his Ummah until the Day of Resurrection, which has been manifesting without fail in every age in accordance with the needs of the time, and will continue being manifested in this very fashion until the last days of this world. The likeness of the extent to which the splendour of **Divine power** has been showered upon the holy souls of this Ummah is difficult to find among other ummahs. How great a folly is it, then, to declare someone to be God or the Son of God on account of these extraordinary occurrences? If a man can become God solely through these extraordinary events, would there ever be an end to such ‘Gods’?

**Nevertheless**, it is worth remembering in this connection that while these types of miraculous Signs truly emanate from God Almighty, even then, they can in no way

**AUTHOR’S MARGIN NOTE**  
Powerful miracles remain inferior in rank to the direct powers of God Almighty (without intermediaries).

equal those exclusive manifestations of His power, which are independent of the will or intention of any other being, nor is it appropriate that they should be equal. That is why, when a Prophet or a *Wali* [Friend (of Allah)] manifests an extraordinary feat—through his personal spiritual power and not through prayer—and exhibits a result that is beyond the contriving, planning, or capability of a human being, that act of the Prophet will remain inferior to those acts of God Almighty which He brings about in a manifest and patent manner through His perfect power. That is to say, such a miracle of someone’s personal spiritual power must inevitably have some defect and weakness within it when compared with other Divine works that are manifested directly by Allah, glorified be His eminence, so that in the eyes

of those with superficial insight, there may not appear to be a **similarity in creation**. It was for this very reason that the **rod** of

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**

Powerful miracles remain inferior in rank to the direct works of God Almighty (without intermediaries).

Ḥaḍrat Mūsā [Moses], peace be on him, despite the fact that it became a serpent many times, remained just a rod in the end, and the **birds** of Ḥaḍrat 'Īsā [Jesus], despite the fact that their miraculous flight is proved from the Noble Quran, were, after all, only clay and earth and nowhere does God Almighty say that they also became alive. Yet **the miraculous Signs of our Holy Prophet, may peace and the blessings of Allah be upon him**, were infused with more Divine power than all others because the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, was the perfect and greatest and loftiest and most complete example of the glorious manifestations of God. This is why we are unable to measure the miracles of Divine power of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, with the help of any human scale. Nevertheless, we believe that here, too, something must necessarily be concealed that differentiates between the work of Allah, glorified be His eminence, and the actions of His Messenger, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him.

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**

Miracles are manifested by the men of God at the stage of *liqā*.

My point by all these statements is that when someone has been granted the stage of *liqā* [**communion**], he inevitably manifests Divine acts when an **upsurge** of this stage [of *liqā*] takes place. Anyone who spends some part of his life in the close company of such a person unavoidably witnesses something of these Signs of Divine power. This is because, during the upsurge of this condition, such a one reflectively manifests the attributes of God, so much so that his mercy becomes the mercy of God Almighty, and his wrath becomes the wrath of God Almighty. Many a time he says, even without a prayer, that such a thing should come into being and it does come into being. If he looks upon someone with anger, such a



person is afflicted with some calamity, and if he looks upon someone with compassion, that person becomes the object of the mercy of God Almighty.

Just as the Divine command كُن [Kun—‘Be!'] always brings into being the desired result without delay, in the same way, when such a person says, ‘Be!’ in the state of the

**AUTHOR’S MARGIN NOTE**

Everything associated with the men of God is blessed

**upsurge** and **rising tide** of *liqā*, it too does not fail. As I stated earlier, the real reason for these miraculous Signs is that such a person, on account of his intense union with God, becomes the metaphorical reflection of God’s glory and greatness, and Divine manifestations take perpetual hold over him, and the True Beloved takes him into His embrace and removes all intervening veils on account of his extreme closeness to Him. And as He Himself is **Blessed**, He confers blessings upon his words and works, activity and ease, food and clothing, space and time, and all his essential characteristics. Thus, every single thing that comes into contact with him, even without him resorting to prayer, receives **blessings**. There is blessing in his home, and the threshold of its doors are filled with blessings. Blessings rain down upon the doors of his home, which he experiences continuously and whose fragrance he perceives. When he travels, God Almighty keeps him company with all His blessings, and when he returns home, he brings an ocean of light with him. In short, he is a wonderful person whose true condition is not known to anyone except God Almighty.

In this context, it should be clearly understood that upon the establishment of the condition of *fanā fillāh* [**self-annihilation in Allah**]  
—that is, the stage experienced after fully establishing the

**AUTHOR’S MARGIN NOTE**

Characteristics of the stages of *liqā* and *baqā*

import of the verse, <sup>1</sup> **أَسْلَمَ وَجْهَهُ لِلَّهِ**, which the Sufis designate as *fanā* [self-annihilation] and which the Holy Quran describes as **steadfastness**—the grades of *baqā* [revival] and *liqā* [communion] follow immediately. In other words, when a person empties himself completely of his condition as a created being, altogether discards desire and design, and reaches the point of perfect surrender, the stage of *baqā* commences immediately upon the firm establishment of his condition[of *fanā*]. But the stage of *baqā* cannot manifest until this condition of *fanā* is firmly established and the complete inclination towards God Almighty becomes a natural affair.

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**

Characteristics of the stages of *liqā* and *baqā*

That stage of *baqā* will manifest only when every aspect of artificiality in obedience is removed, and just like a natural blossoming, the swaying, verdant branches of obedience sprout forth from the heart, and all that is considered one's own, truly becomes God Almighty's, and just as other people find pleasure in indulgence, such a person's whole delight lies in worship and remembrance of God, and the desires of God Almighty take the place of his personal desires.

Then, when this condition of *baqā* becomes firmly established and permeates every nerve and fibre of the seeker, and becomes an essential part of his being; and **a light is seen to be descending from heaven** and all veils are immediately lifted upon its descent, and a fine, sweet, and pleasant feeling of love, which had not been perceived before, is kindled within the heart; and the heart feels such a freshness, contentment, peace, and delight the like of which one experiences upon suddenly meeting and embracing a long-separated dear friend; and the bright, pleasant, blessed, comforting, eloquent, fragrant, and glad tidings of Almighty God begin to descend

1. Whoever submits himself completely to Allah (*Sūrah al-Baqarah*, 2:113) [Publisher]

continuously—whether sitting, standing, asleep, or awake—like a cool, pleasant, and fragrant breeze that wafts across a garden of flowers and begins to blow in the morning, bringing with it a delight and joy; and the man is so drawn towards God Almighty that he finds it impossible to live without His love and an ardent, enraptured contemplation of Him and he is not only ready to sacrifice his wealth, life, honour, progeny, and all that belongs to him, but has already sacrificed all of it in his heart; and he is pulled by a powerful attraction the nature of which he is unable to fathom; and he perceives a brilliant light illuminating his inner self, like the dawning of the day; and he observes streams of devotion, love, and loyalty flowing vigorously through him; and feels moment by moment **as if God Almighty has descended upon his heart**; when you experience this condition with all its Signs, then rejoice and express gratitude to the True Beloved, for this is indeed that ultimate stage which has been named *liqā*.

At this ultimate stage, the seeker feels as if he has been washed in many holy waters and has been created anew by casting out every trace of his ego, and then, the throne of *Rabbul-*

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**

The journey of a righteous person extends only as far as the stage of *fanā*

*‘ālamīn* [the Lord of all the worlds] has been placed within him and the shining countenance of the Holy and Blessed and Holy Lord, with all its winning charm and beauty, remains ever-present before him. However, it should also be remembered here that both of these last two stages—*baqā* [revival] and *liqā* [communion]—are not achieved through one's own efforts but are Divine bounties. Effort and struggle terminates at the stage of *fanā* [self-annihilation], and the journey of all righteous seekers ends at that stage, and the circle of human excellences arrives at its full completion. And when the pure-natured seekers have passed through the stage of *fanā*, as required, it is the practice of God Almighty that, all at once, the breeze of Divine bounty blows and conveys them to the stages of *baqā* and *liqā*.

It is now clear from these facts that all the travails and labours of this

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**

The luminous and perfect shadow of the Holy Spirit arises with the meeting of two loves at the stage of *liqā*.

journey are up to the stage of *fanā*. In advancing further, there is no involvement of human effort, labour, toiling, and striving. Rather, the pure love for God, the Noble and Glorious, which develops in the

stage of *fanā*, is blessed automatically by a bright flame of God's love. This is designated as the stages of *baqā* and *liqā*.

And when God's love descends upon the love of His servant, then, through the union of these two loves, a bright and perfect shadow of **the Holy Spirit** manifests in the human heart. At the stage of *liqā*, the light of this Holy Spirit is very bright and the miracles of Divine power that I have just mentioned proceed from such people for this very reason, because this **light of the Holy Spirit** attends upon them under all circumstances and at all times and dwells within them.

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**

The reason why miracles and Signs of Divine power are manifested

They never separate from that light under any condition, nor does that light ever depart from them. That light issues forth from them with every breath and falls upon

everything due to their glance, and displays its brilliance to the people with their words. This very light is called the Holy Spirit. But this is not the real Holy Spirit. The real Holy Spirit is that which is in the heavens. This Holy Spirit is its reflection, which dwells permanently in pure bosoms, hearts, and minds and does not leave them even for a moment.

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**

Those people are false who hold the belief that the Holy Spirit departs sometimes from the *Auliya'* [Friends of Allah] and Prophets.

The person who suggests that sometimes this **Holy Spirit**, with all its effects, departs from them, is altogether in the wrong and disparages the holy elect of God Almighty through his utterly misguided thinking.

Granted, it is true that the real **Holy Spirit** remains at his station; however, his reflection, which is also metaphorically called the Holy

Spirit, enters into the breasts and hearts and brains and limbs of those who, after attaining the station of *baqā* and *liqā*, are considered worthy of the perfect love of God Almighty, with all its blessings descending upon their absolutely pure and radiant love.

When that Holy Spirit descends, it develops a bond with the being of that person, which is akin to the relationship of the soul with the body. It becomes the power of vision functioning in the eyes and—donning the

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**

The light of the Holy Spirit remains constantly with perfect men and permeates throughout all their faculties.

garment of the faculty of hearing—bestows spiritual sense upon the ears. It becomes the speech of the tongue, the righteousness of the heart, and the alertness of the mind. It flows through the hands and also exerts an influence over the feet. In short, it lifts all darkness from their being and illumines them from the hair on their head down to the toenails on their feet. Were it to depart even for a moment, darkness would immediately take its place. However, the perfect people have been granted such a **good companion** that he does not depart from them even for a moment, and to imagine that he can depart from them would amount to a confession that, after entering into light, they fall again into darkness and that, after having been made pure and safe, their *nafs-e-ammārah* [self that incites to evil] reverts to them and that the spiritual senses that were bestowed upon them are all rendered useless and suspended.

So—O people who reject this **verity** and deny **this point of wisdom!**—make no hasty demands of me. Seek testimony from the light of your own heart, whether it is really true that the light of the elect sometimes leaves them entirely and completely. Is this true that, even in a state of perfect faith, all the marks of enlightenment are sometimes lost by the perfect believers?

**If you reply**, ‘Where and when did we say that sometimes the spiritual light of the elect leaves them altogether and they are completely surrounded by darkness?’, my reply is that this is indeed the

conclusion to be drawn from your own **beliefs**. You do accept and follow the verses of the Word of God [which teach] that every light, comfort, satisfaction, blessing, steadfastness, and every spiritual bounty is indeed bestowed upon the **elect through the Holy Spirit**. And **just as** Satan has been appointed as an **evil companion** for the disbelievers and the wicked for all time—so that he might spread darkness over them at every moment and should not leave them alone in their standing and sitting, moving and resting, and sleeping and waking—**similarly**, for those who are the elect of God, **the Holy Spirit has been appointed as a good companion** for all time, so that it should constantly rain down light upon them and should support them every moment and should not depart from them at any time.

#### AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE

Refutation of the belief that the Holy Spirit does not abide permanently with the Elect of God and sometimes severs his blessed connection with them, ascending to heaven and leaving them devoid and empty

Now, it is obvious that—in contrast to **the evil companion** who is always the servant and friend of the extremely wicked—it is highly essential that the **good companion** should always be the friend and companion of those who are **close to God**, and the Holy Quran confirms this. Thus, if separation from that good companion is contemplated—as our opponents from among the Muslim brethren believe, who say that the Holy Spirit is the name of **Jibrā'il [Gabriel]**, who at times descends from heaven and establishes a very close relationship with the elect to the extent that he penetrates into their very hearts; yet, at other times, he leaves them alone and separates himself from them and **ascends to heaven** at an immeasurable distance and conceals himself in his station, thereby completely cutting off from the elect, who are then entirely deprived of the light and blessing which, at the time of his descent, pervades their hearts, brains, and every fibre—if such should be the case, **would it not follow from this belief** that, after

the departure of the **Holy Spirit**, such elect are again surrounded by darkness and—God forbid—because of the departure of the **good companion**, they begin to be subjected to the influence of the **evil companion**?

Now, you should reflect giving just a little space in your heart for the fear of God—is *this* respect and is *this* faith and divine cognition!

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**

To hold the belief that the Holy Spirit would often part from the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> is an insult of the highest degree

**And is *this* love for the Messenger of Allah, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him,**

that such a state of defect and deficiency be attributed to the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, as if to say that **the Holy Spirit** would be separated from His Holiness, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, for long periods of time and during these periods—God forbid—the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, would be deprived of the holy light which is a reflection of **the Holy Spirit**!

It is outrageous that the **Christian people** should firmly and categorically believe<sup>1☆</sup> that from the moment the **Holy Spirit** descended upon the Messiah, peace be on him, it never departed from him and that he was strengthened by the Holy Spirit at all times and

1. ☆ **Note:** Many Muslims also hold this same belief about the Messiah [Jesus]. See commentaries of Ibn Jarīr, Ibn Kathīr, *Ma'ālim*, *Faṭḥul-Bayān*, and *Kashshāf*, and also *Tafṣīr Kabīr* and *Ḥusainī* etc. with reference to the verse: \*وَإِنَّا لَنُؤَيِّدُكُم بِالرُّوحِ الْقُدُسِ [and strengthened him with the Spirit of holiness]. Alas! Alas! Alas! (Author)

\**Sūrah al-Baqarah*, 2:88 [Publisher]

every moment to the extent that it did not depart from him even in his dreams; and that his **Holy Spirit** never ascended to heaven to leave him alone and abandoned; and that the light of the Holy Spirit never departed from him even for a moment; **yet the Muslims should believe** that the Holy Spirit of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, at times separated himself from the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him; and that the Muslims should admit before the **opponents** that the permanent companionship of **the Holy Spirit** was not granted to the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, as it was to Ḥaḍrat 'Īsā [Jesus]!

Now imagine what greater disrespect and insolence there could be than that the Holy Prophet, peace and blessings be upon him, is brazenly insulted and the Christians are provided an opportunity to raise objections. Who does not understand the fact that the descent of the Holy Spirit brings about the dissemination of light, whereas its departure breeds misguidance, darkness, evil thoughts, and dissension of faith? May God Almighty protect **Islam** from the mischief of such Muslims, who—being the so-called reciters of the *Kalimah*—are launching an assault upon the **Messenger of Allah, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him.**

Even with respect to the Disciples, the Christians do not believe that the Holy Spirit had ever departed from them; on the contrary, their belief is that they even conferred bounties of the Holy Spirit upon others. However, these people—calling themselves Muslims and donning the titles *maulawī*, *muḥaddith* [a scholar of Hadith], and *Shaikhul-Kull* [the Ultimate Scholar]—hold such misgivings about the glorious rank of His Holiness the *Khatmul-Mursalīn* [Seal of the Messengers], and the *Khairul-Awwalīn wal Ākharīn* [Best of all past and present]! Spewing such disrespectful language, they still deem themselves to have remained Muslims, yet others are disbelievers in their view.



**And should the question arise** where in the Noble Quran is an explicit statement or an implicit indication that the Holy Spirit perpetually dwells within the elect of God and does not depart from them, then its reply is that the entire Noble

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**  
Evidence from verses and *ahādīth* that the Holy Spirit always resides in those close to Him

Quran is replete with such clear statements and indications; indeed, it gives every believer the promise of meeting the Holy Spirit. Accordingly, from among these verses, which are decisive in this regard through clear and explicit pronouncement, are the first two verses of *Sūrah at-Ṭāriq* and they are as follows:

وَالسَّمَاءِ وَالطَّارِقِ ۝ وَمَا أَدْرَاكَ مَا الطَّارِقُ ۝ النَّجْمُ النَّاقِطُ ۝ إِنَّ كُلَّ نَفْسٍ لَّيَّا عَلَيْهَا حَافِظٌ ۝<sup>2,1</sup>

The last verse—namely, إِنَّ كُلَّ نَفْسٍ لَّيَّا عَلَيْهَا حَافِظٌ—means that an angel is appointed to keep watch over every soul.

This clearly indicates that just as an angel is appointed for man's physical being and does not part from him, so is one appointed for the protection of his inner [spiritual] being, who withholds the inner self from Satan and safeguards against the darkness of going astray.

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**  
Every star has an angel appointed over it for its survival and for the carrying out of its functions

That being is the **Holy Spirit** who protects the chosen servants of God Almighty from the dominance of Satan, and the following verse also gives an indication of the same:

1. *Sūrah at-Ṭāriq*, 86:2–5 [Publisher]

2. ☆ Please see **Footnote** on pages 165–220. In the original Urdu edition of *Ā'ina-e-Kamālāt-e-Islām*, the Promised Messiah<sup>as</sup> presented this footnote along with the main text. For the ease of English readers, it is being presented as its own section after this section. [Publisher]

إِنَّ عِبَادِي لَيْسَ لَكَ عَلَيْهِمْ سُلْطَانٌ<sup>1</sup>

Observe how clearly this verse tells that the angel of God Almighty is always present for the protection of man and remains with him for every moment, not being separated from him for so much as a single moment. At this juncture, can it be imagined that an angel is appointed for the perpetual protection of man's physical body, but no angel is appointed for the perpetual protection of his spiritual existence? Rather, even the most bigoted of bigots can understand that the protection of the inner being, and the safeguarding of the soul is even more vital than the protection of the body since an affliction of the body is a suffering in this world alone, whereas an affliction of the soul and the spirit is capable of condemning one into everlasting Hell. How can we presume about the Merciful and Munificent God, who has mercy even upon this human body which exists today and will be dust tomorrow, that He does not have mercy upon the human **soul**? Thus, it is proven from this definitive and unequivocal text that the **Holy Spirit**—or, you could say, the angel of internal safeguarding—always remains with a righteous person in the very same fashion as he remains with him for his external protection.

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**

Reply to the question that since the Holy Spirit is granted especially to the elect of God, then why is it conferred upon common people.

Many other verses in the Noble Quran with a similar meaning prove that angels who permanently stay with man are appointed over him for his physical and spiritual training and protection and to record his deeds. Some of these verses are the following:

1. Surely, you [Satan] shall have no power over My servants (*Sūrah al-Ḥijr*, 15:43). [Publisher]

وَأَنَّ عَلَيْكُمْ لَٰحِظِينَ ۝<sup>1</sup> يُرْسِلُ عَلَيْكُمْ حَفَظَةً ۚ<sup>2</sup> لَهُ مَعْقِبَاتٌ مِّنْ بَيْنِ يَدَيْهِ وَمِنْ خَلْفِهِ يَحْفَظُونَهُ مِّنْ أَمْرِ اللَّهِ ۝<sup>3</sup>

The translation of these verses is as follows: There are appointed over you, for your protection, those whom God Almighty sends. They are guardians appointed by God Almighty who watch over His servants from every side; meaning, they safeguard them both physically and spiritually.

In this context, the **author of Ma‘ālim** documents a hadith stating that for every servant of Allah, an angel is appointed as a guardian, remaining with him and protecting him from satans and other evil enticements during his sleep and wakefulness.<sup>4</sup> He has also quoted another hadith with the same meaning from Ka‘b al-Ahbār. **Ibn Jarīr** quotes the following hadith in support of the aforementioned Quranic verse:

إِنَّ مَعَكُمْ مَنْ لَا يَفَارِقُكُمْ إِلَّا عِنْدَ الْخَلَاءِ وَعِنْدَ الْجَمَاعِ فَاسْتَخِيئُوهُمْ وَأَكْرِمُوهُمْ.

Meaning that there are angels who never leave you except when you attend to the call of nature or are engaged in intimacy. Therefore, feel bashful in their presence and give them due respect.

In the same context is the following hadith narrated by ‘Ikrimah that angels accompany man to protect him from every type of evil, but leave him when an irrevocable decree befalls him.<sup>5</sup> Similarly, it is narrated

#### AUTHOR’S MARGIN NOTE

Evidence from the Prophetic *Āḥādīth* of the fact that angels who inspire virtue and satans who incite vice undoubtedly remain with man

1. *Sūrah al-Infīṭār*, 82:11 [Publisher]

2. *Sūrah al-An‘ām*, 6:62 [Publisher]

3. *Sūrah ar-Ra‘d*, 13:12 [Publisher]

4. *Tafsīrul-Baghawī*, al-Juzw 3, p. 9, *Sūrah ar-Ra‘d*, published by Idārah Ta’līfāt Ashrafiyyah, Multan, Pakistan. [Publisher]

5. *Tafsīrut-Ṭabarī*, Juzw 13, p. 139, *Sūrah ar-Ra‘d*, published by Dār Iḥyā’ at-Turāth al-‘Arabī, Beirut, Lebanon. [Publisher]

by **Mujāhid** that there is no such individual for whose protection an angel has not been permanently assigned.<sup>1</sup> Then there is another hadith recorded from '**Uthmān bin 'Affān**, the summary of which is that twenty angels accompany man to serve him in various ways; and lying in wait for every opportune moment are Iblīs during the day and Iblīs' children during the night with the intent of inflicting harm.<sup>2</sup> Moreover, there is a hadith narrated by Imam **Ahmad**, may the mercy of Allah be upon him, as written below:

حَدَّثَنَا أَسْوَدُ بْنُ عَامِرٍ حَدَّثَنَا سُفْيَانُ حَدَّثَنِي مَنْصُورٌ عَنْ سَالِمِ بْنِ أَبِي الْجَعْدِ عَنْ أَبِيهِ عَنْ  
عَبْدِ اللَّهِ قَالَ قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ مَا مِنْكُمْ مِنْ أَحَدٍ إِلَّا وَقَدْ وَكَّلَ بِهِ قَرِينُهُ  
مِنْ الْجِنِّ وَقَرِينُهُ مِنَ الْمَلَائِكَةِ قَالُوا وَإِنَّا يَا رَسُولَ اللَّهِ قَالَ وَإِنِّي وَلَكِنَّ اللَّهَ أَعَانَنِي عَلَيْهِ  
فَلَا يَأْمُرُنِي إِلَّا بِخَيْرٍ.

The narration from Abdullah is reported through Aswad and others that the Messenger of Allah, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, said: 'There is no one from among you who is not **accompanied by a companion of the nature of the *jinn* and a companion from among the angels.**' A Companion asked, 'And you, too, O Messenger of Allah<sup>sas</sup>?' He replied, 'Yes, I too, but God has placed my *jinn* under my control so that he does not urge me to anything but goodness and virtue.' This hadith is found exclusive to [*Ṣaḥīḥ*] *Muslim*, page 244 [from among the *Ṣiḥāḥ Sittah*].

#### AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE

It is established from authentic *aḥādīth* that man has been conferred two companions—a caller to good and a caller to evil

This hadith clearly and manifestly proves that just as there is a داعي إِلَى الشَّرِّ [caller to evil] appointed for man who always stays with him, so too is there a داعي إِلَى الْخَيْرِ

1. *Tafsīruṭ-Ṭabarī*, Juzw 13, p. 138–139, *Sūrah ar-Ra'd*, published by Dār Iḥyā' at-Turāth al-'Arabī, Beirut, Lebanon [Publisher]
2. *Tafsīruṭ-Ṭabarī*, Juzw 13, p. 138–139, *Sūrah ar-Ra'd*, published by Dār Iḥyā' at-Turāth al-'Arabī, Beirut, Lebanon [Publisher]

[caller to good] appointed for every man who never separates from him and is always his friend and companion. Had God Almighty only appointed a caller to evil for man and had He not appointed a caller to good, a blemish would have tarnished the justice and mercy of God Almighty that the weak human, who is already burdened with *nafs-e-ammārah* [the self that incites to evil], had been vested with evil inclinations and temptations. Had God Almighty established Satan as man's **eternal friend** and companion who even creeps into his blood and, entering into the heart, sets the impurity of darkness loose within it, yet for the calling towards virtue, He had failed to appoint any such companion that he might also penetrate the heart and circulate within the blood, balancing both sides of the scale equally. Nevertheless, it has now been proven from Quranic verses and authentic *ahādīth* that just as God Almighty has appointed Satan as the eternal companion of man for inviting him to evil, so has that Merciful and Munificent One appointed the **Holy Spirit** as the eternal companion of man for inviting him towards virtue. Moreover, in the state of *baqā* [revival] and *liqā* [communion], the evil influence of Satan virtually disappears as if he embraces Islam, and the light of the Holy Spirit ascends to its ultimate degree of brilliance **at that time**. Who, then, would dare say anything against this lofty and holy teaching other than that blind and foolish person who lives the life of an animal and has no share of the light of pure teachings?

**Nevertheless, the truth and substance of the issue** is that this teaching of the Noble Quran is also a miracle from among its miracles, insofar as the beauty, justice, and dignified sagacity with which this teaching has resolved the issue of why man is endowed with exceptionally strong passions for virtue or vice, to the extent that even in the realm of dreams, their light

#### AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE

This teaching of the Holy Quran that there are appointed both a caller unto good and a caller unto evil is in reality a miraculous teaching because it is based on a very fine, exalted and wise system.

or darkness is felt clearly and palpably. No other scripture has presented it with such firm clarity and truth. The miraculous nature is made even more manifest by considering that no other acceptable method comes to mind answering this question. Any other answer would invite a host of objections that would be impossible to escape; for God Almighty's universal law of nature clearly proves to us that all the benefit that our souls, faculties, and bodies receive from His Being—the Source of Grace—are received through the agency of various other things. For example, although He indeed bestows vision upon our eyes, that vision is granted to us through the agency of sunlight. Similarly, the darkness of the night, which provides our souls comfort and in which we can satisfy the needs of ourselves, is also in reality from God, for He is the Cause of causes for all creation.

Thus, we see that there is an **eternally appointed law** for our benefit that we receive every bounty of Almighty God through the agency of some other thing. It is true, of course, that we possess the faculties to imbibe those bounties; for instance, in order for our eye to receive light, it maintains a kind of sight perception within itself, and in order for our ears to receive the sounds which are transmitted through the air, they maintain a kind of sensory perception within their nerves. However, it is certainly not the case that our faculties maintain their structure in a manner so perfect and independent that they do not need and require any external aid or assistance.

We never observe that any physical faculty of ours can function solely by its inherent capability without the need for outside help or a helper. For example, even though our eyes may possess exceptional sharpness of vision, we still need the light of the sun, and no matter how good the hearing of our ears may be, even then we are in need of air, which envelops the sound within it and carries it to our ears. This proves that our faculties alone **are not sufficient to make the machinery of our humanity function**. We certainly need external helpers and assistants. Nevertheless, the law of nature is telling us that although God Almighty Himself, being the Cause of all causes, is that Outside

Helper and Assistant, it is certainly not His rule that He should influence our faculties and bodies without intermediary agents.

Moreover, no matter how far we take our attentive consideration, and howsoever much we employ our reflection, intellect, and imagination, we see clearly, conspicuously, and evidently that for every grace there are **mediating causes** between our Benevolent Lord and ourselves, through whose mediation every faculty receives grace according to its need. **Thus, it is this very argument which also establishes the existence of angels and jinn** because we need only prove that, for the performance of good or evil, our faculties on their own are insufficient and that we need external helpers and assistants which possess extraordinary effectiveness. However, God Almighty is not Himself that helper or assistant directly without any mediation, but it is [the work of] God through some intermediary means. Thus, observing the **law of nature** has made it clear to us, conclusively and certainly, that those helpers and assistants exist outside of us. Although we may or may not be aware of their true essence and nature, we know this for certain: they are neither God Almighty Himself operating directly, nor are they simply our own faculties and capacities. Rather, they are a species of creation apart from both of these and have their own, independent existence. **And should we label any of them as داعى الى الخير [a caller unto good], we would describe the same as the Holy Spirit or Jibrā'il [Gabriel], and should we name any of them as داعى الى الشر [a caller to evil], we would also describe that very one as Satan or Iblis.** It is not necessary to show the Holy Spirit or Satan to every dark-hearted person, though the spiritually enlightened can indeed see them and both of them also become visible through visions. However, this proof should suffice for the *mahjūb*<sup>1</sup> who cannot as yet see Satan

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**  
Proof of the existence of angels and *jinn*

1. *Mahjūb* literally means 'covered, hidden, or veiled'. Spiritually, it refers to someone unable to perceive divine truths due to obstacles or worldly distractions. [Publisher]

or the Holy Spirit; for, the existence of an effect proves the existence of a cause. If this rule is not correct, then how could one even learn about the existence of God Almighty? Can anyone show where God Almighty is? It is only by seeing the effects that are a specimen of His power that the necessity of the existence of that Real Cause is acknowledged. The spiritually enlightened do, however, in the highest stage of their spiritual development, see Him with their spiritual eyes and can also hear His discourses. However, for the *mahjūb*, outside of seeing His effects, what other means of evidence is there for believing in the existence of the Real Cause? Accordingly, it is through this very manner that the existence of the Holy Spirit and of satans is proven—and not only proven but also seen with the utmost clarity.

#### AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE

The evidence of the existence of angels and satans is among those rare insights with which this humble one has been uniquely and specially endowed through the overflowing inspirations of the Quran.

Pity be upon the sorry state of those people who, being impressed by the obscurity of futile philosophy, **have come to deny the existence of angels and satans** and rejected the clear texts and proofs of the Noble Quran, and fell into the pit of heresy brimming with ignorance. Bear in mind, in this context, that **this [Islamic] tenet is among those tenets for whose corroboration God Almighty has singled out this humble one to deduce the verities of the Noble Quran. فَالْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ عَلَى ذَلِكَ** [So Allah be praised for all this].

#### AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE

Shaikhs Batālawī and Dehlawī do indeed believe that Satan alone has been appointed the constant companion of man and, let alone ordinary people, even the Prophets, God forbid, are bereft of the constant companionship of the Holy Spirit, except for Ḥaḍrat 'Īsā [Jesus]

An Ārya or a Christian may object here that most present-day mullahs, like **Shaikh Batālawī Muhammad Ḥusain and Shaikh Dehlawī Nadhīr Ḥusain**, are opposed to this belief; that they certainly do not believe that every man has been provided with two companions—one, the caller unto good, who is the Holy Spirit, and the other, the caller unto evil, who is Satan; and that they



actually state that there is only one companion, who is a caller unto evil, who keeps company with man at all times to ruin his faith; and that God Almighty found it very pleasing that by making Satan the constant companion of man and by allowing him to infiltrate into the very flesh and blood of man, the latter should be quickly led to his ruin; and that Gabriel, whose other name is ‘the Holy Spirit’, has most certainly not been appointed as a caller unto good for the ordinary people, nay, not even for the saintly; that all these people have been left entangled in the clutches of Satan; however, the Holy Spirit does descend upon the Prophets, but even that is only for a moment or for a very short time, after which he ascends to the heavens, leaving them all alone; that sometimes the Prophets remain deprived of the company of the Holy Spirit, or Gabriel, even for forty days or more; but that the other companion—who is Satan—does not, God forbid, leave them even for a single moment, though ultimately he may turn into a Muslim.

The **reply to** this is that these people are *mahjūb* and heedless and deprived of the verities of the Noble Quran. Nor, in reality, is this their actual belief. They have fallen into this difficulty through their own folly and lack of reflection and because of their meanness and malice toward this humble one. The paths these people took in opposition to this humble one were fraught with these difficulties, so they unknowingly got trapped in them, just as a bird, lured by a grain, gets caught in a net.

#### AUTHOR’S MARGIN NOTE

The belief of Batālawī and Dehlawī is that even the Prophets are frequently deprived of the companionship of the Holy Spirit, but the other companion (i.e. satan) remains with them at all times—just like other people—although he does not gain control over them. In spite of this, they say that there was no satan with Jesus, and the Holy Spirit verily came with him and verily ascended upon the heavens with him.

The **fact** is that when these people insisted that Gabriel, the Angel of Death, and other angels descend upon the earth with their actual bodies, and then return to the heavens after a brief stay and thus, when they descend from the heavens, it becomes devoid of their presence, and afterwards, when they fly back from the earth to the heavens, the earth becomes devoid of their presence; this led to **hundreds of objections**

against them based on the Quran, Hadith, and reason. Of the many evil consequences that inevitably arose from their creed, one evil is that such a belief renders the Divine spiritual order unjust and devoid of mercy.

#### AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE

Baṭalawī and Naḍḥīr Ḥusain gave Christians and others the opportunity to raise objections against Islam, but they imposed the flaws of their own understanding upon Islam

The disbelievers and all opponents [of Islam] were **given an opportunity to raise the objection against Islam** of how callous and contrary to the quality of mercy it is for God Almighty to appoint Satan and his spawn as a constant companion and attendant of man to lead him astray, so that they remain preoccupied with undermining his faith, and at all times infiltrate his blood, heart, mind, veins, eyes, and ears, sowing all manner of doubts, **whereas man is not given even a single such companion who should constantly stay with him and guide him!**

This objection does indeed arise inevitably from these people's above-mentioned creed, for they believe on the one hand that the angels Gabriel [Jibrā'il] and Azrael ['Izra'il], the Angel of Death, have their abode fixed in heaven—they cannot move even one arm's length below or above their appointed place—according to the verse: وَمَا مِثْقَالُ ذَرَّةٍ إِلَّا أَعْلَمُ ۚ لَهُمْ مَقَامٌ مَّعْلُومٌ<sup>1</sup> On the other [hand], they also firmly believe in the physical descent [of the angels] upon the earth; and again, they imagine that they return to heaven in the same manner with their actual bodies. If anyone should contradict their belief of physical descent and ascent, **he is, according to them, a *kāfir* [disbeliever].**

#### AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE

The belief of Baṭalawī and Dehlawī that the perpetual companion of man is only Satan—and nothing more—destroys and disrupts the balanced system of God Almighty which pertains to the moral training of man

The creed of these strange Muslims faces the dilemma that it **completely destroys the balanced spiritual order** of which I have spoken—namely, the existence, side by side, of an evil and a good companion

1. And the angels say: 'And there is not one of us but has an appointed station' (*Sūrah aṣ-Ṣāffāt*, 37:165). [Publisher]

of man—and it leaves only Satan as the constant companion of man. For, these people believe that if the Holy Spirit at all descends like a traveller upon any man, it stays with him for only an instant or for a very short period and returns to its native abode in heaven, leaving the man, however virtuous he may be, in the company of Satan. Is this not such a creed that leaves a **serious blot on Islam**? Is it permissible to suggest about the Benevolent and Merciful Lord that He desires the destruction of man more than his guidance? No, never, God forbid.

The **blind man** does not understand the teachings of the Noble Quran and lays the blame of his own ignorance upon it. All these difficulties, from which it is impossible for these ulema to extricate themselves, arose because they believe that angels descend upon earth with their actual bodies. Then, there is also the requisite and accompanying belief that they ascend to the heavens immediately. Owing to these two erroneous beliefs, these people were caught in this terrible predicament of having to fabricate a third belief, that, as against the ‘evil companion’, man has not been provided with a ‘good companion’ to always stay with him.

#### AUTHOR’S MARGIN NOTE

Baṭalawī and Dehlawī first erred in believing that angels descend and ascend physically—and as a consequence of this error, they were led to the further error that the Holy Spirit does not always accompany the recipients of revelation

By fabricating this belief, they egregiously slandered the Quranic teaching and **furnished** malicious opponents **with an opportunity to attack**. If these individuals were to accept the fact that no angel ever descends in his own body, but descends through his reflective body whose resemblance he is empowered to assume—just as Ḥaḍrat Jibrā’īl [Gabriel] would appear in the guise of Diḥyah Kalbī [a Companion of the Holy Prophet] and as the angel appeared [in the form of a man] for Ḥaḍrat Maryam [Mary]—then no objection would arise and no one could find fault with the **constancy of a good companion**. What is truly surprising is that, in holding these beliefs, these people are absolutely opposed to the Noble Quran and authentic *aḥādīth*. On the

one hand, the Noble Quran declares the heavens as the halting place of the angels, and on the other, it is also emphatic in stating that the Holy Spirit is given to the perfect believers, to assist them, for all times, and he does not separate from them at any time. Every single person possesses the light of the Holy Spirit to some degree due to the light bestowed upon him innately; however, in the case of ordinary people, that light becomes overwhelmed by satanic darkness and gets so smothered as to become virtually non-existent.

It must be remembered that there are three groups of people, as Allah, His eminence be glorified, says:

فَمِنْهُمْ ظَالِمٌ لِّنَفْسِهِ وَمِنْهُمْ مُّقْتَصِدٌ وَمِنْهُمْ سَابِقٌ بِالْخَيْرَاتِ<sup>1</sup>

Meaning that: There is a group upon whom satanic darkness prevails and the Holy Spirit shines only a little. The second group consists of those in whom the light of the Holy Spirit and satanic darkness are about equal. The third group consists of those upon whom the light of the Holy Spirit prevails and who have become goodness personified.

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**

There are many verses in the Noble Quran which prove that the perfect believers are bestowed the Holy Spirit permanently

From among the verses of the Noble Quran that show that the Holy Spirit is given to the perfect believers for all time, one is:

يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا إِن تَتَّقُوا اللَّهَ يَجْعَلْ لَّكُمْ فُرْقَانًا<sup>2</sup>

[And]

وَيَجْعَلْ لَّكُمْ نُورًا تَمْشُونَ بِهِ<sup>3</sup>

1. *Sūrah Fāṭir*, 35:33 [Publisher]

2. *Sūrah al-Anfāl*, 8:30 [Publisher]

3. *Sūrah al-Ḥadīd*, 57:29 [Publisher]

Meaning that: O ye people who have believed! If you adopt righteousness and keep fearing Allah, glorified be His eminence, then God Almighty will give you that thing (namely, the Holy Spirit) through whom you will acquire a complete distinction from others and He will assign for you a Light (namely, the Holy Spirit) that will walk side by side with you. In the Noble Quran, the Holy Spirit is called 'Light'.

Then, at another place, it states:

إِنَّ الَّذِينَ قَالُوا رَبُّنَا اللَّهُ ثُمَّ اسْتَقَامُوا تَتَنَزَّلُ عَلَيْهِمُ الْمَلَائِكَةُ أَلَّا تَخَافُوا وَلَا تَحْزَنُوا وَأَبْشِرُوا  
بِالْجَنَّةِ الَّتِي كُنتُمْ تُوعَدُونَ ۝ نَحْنُ أَوْلِيُّكُمْ فِي الْحَيَاةِ الدُّنْيَا وَفِي الْآخِرَةِ<sup>1</sup>

Meaning that: Those people who say, 'Allah, His eminence be glorified, is our Lord', and who then demonstrate resolute steadfastness—so much so that they do not waver the least in their sincerity during times of tribulation, catastrophe, unforeseen calamity, or trial—angels descend upon them, saying, 'Have no fear at all nor grieve, and be happy and rejoice in contemplating the Paradise that you have been promised. We are your guardians and are always close to you in this world and the Hereafter.'

#### AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE

Affirmation that when man attains perfect faith and perfect steadfastness, angels descend upon him for permanent companionship and become his helpers from God Almighty in all his affairs

Again, it is said elsewhere:

أَوْ مَنْ كَانَ مَيِّتًا فَأَحْيَيْنَاهُ وَجَعَلْنَا لَهُ نُورًا يَمْشِي بِهِ فِي النَّاسِ كَمَنْ مَثَلُهُ فِي الظُّلُمَاتِ لَيْسَ بِخَارِجٍ  
مِنْهَا<sup>2</sup> وَمَا يَسْتَوِي الْأَحْيَاءُ وَلَا الْأَمْوَاتُ<sup>3</sup>

Meaning that: Can someone who was dead and We brought him back to life and We gave him a Light with which he walks among the

1. *Sūrah Ḥā Mīm as-Sajdah*, 41:31–32 [Publisher]

2. *Sūrah al-An'ām*, 6:123 [Publisher]

3. *Sūrah Fāṭir*, 35:23 [Publisher]

people—meaning that people become aware of the blessings of that Light—can such a person be like the one who is entirely a prisoner of darkness and cannot escape from it?

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**

*Rūḥul-Qudus* [the Holy Spirit] imparts spiritual life and light into hearts; thus, it is called *Nūr* [Light] and *Rūḥ* [Spirit]

‘Light’ and ‘life’ refer to the Holy Spirit because it dispels darkness and resurrects hearts. This is why it is called the ‘Holy Spirit’; that is, the spirit of holiness, whose entry imparts a life of holiness.

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**

**Commentary on the verse:**  
وَأَيَّدَهُم بِرُوحٍ مِنْهُ [and helped them with a Spirit from Himself]

This noble verse is **one of the** verses of the Holy Quran that proves that the Holy Spirit constantly accompanies these servants of God Almighty who are recipients of divine revelations and instructs them in knowledge, wisdom, and purity.

*Sūrah al-Mujādalah*—<sup>1</sup>أُولَئِكَ كَتَبَ فِي قُلُوبِهِمُ الْإِيمَانَ وَأَيَّدَهُم بِرُوحٍ مِنْهُ

Meaning that: God Almighty imprinted faith into the hearts of those believers and helped them with the Holy Spirit.

Imprinting faith into the hearts means that faith permeated their innate and physical desires and became a part of their dispositions, without any intervening formality or artificiality. This stage, whereby faith enters the very veins and sinews of the heart, is attained by man when, having been strengthened by the Holy Spirit, he receives a new life. Just as life always resides within the physical body for its protection and keeps shining its light upon it, so should the Holy Spirit of this new life make its abode within and shed its light, at every moment and at all times, upon the heart. Just as the physical body is alive every moment through the breath of life, the heart and all spiritual faculties remain alive with the Holy Spirit.

1. *Sūrah al-Mujādalah*, 58:23 [Publisher]

It is for this reason that God Almighty, after stating that faith has been imprinted upon the hearts of such people, also states, We helped them with the Holy Spirit; for, when faith becomes inscribed upon the heart of man, and when it penetrates the very borders of his nature, he undergoes a process of rebirth which can never be accomplished without the help of the Holy Spirit. This indeed is why the Holy Spirit is called the Holy Spirit, because one acquires a pure spirit upon its entry.

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**  
Description of the functions of the Holy Spirit

**The Holy Quran is replete with the references of spiritual life** and refers to the perfect believers again and again as 'alive' and refers to the disbelievers as 'dead'. This also indicates that perfect believers are granted a life upon the entry of the Holy Spirit into them, but the disbelievers, even though physically alive, are deprived of the life that bestows a life of faith upon the heart and mind.

Bear in mind here that a great deal is mentioned again and again in support of this noble verse in the *ahādīth* of the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>. In [*Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī*], there is a hadith related on the authority of Ḥaḍrat 'Āyeshah, may Allah be pleased with her, as follows:

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**  
Hadith in *Bukhārī* attesting to the Holy Spirit's permanent companionship with believers

أَنَّ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ وَصَعَ لِحَسَّانِ ابْنِ ثَابِتٍ مَنبِرًا فِي الْمَسْجِدِ فَكَانَ يُنَافِخُ عَنْ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ فَقَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ اللَّهُمَّ أَيْدِ حَسَّانَ بِرُوحِ الْقُدُسِ كَمَا نَافِخَ عَنْ نَبِيِّكَ.

Meaning that: The Messenger of Allah, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, placed a pulpit in the mosque for Ḥassān bin Thābit, who would contest with the disbelievers on behalf of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, responding to their calumnies with praise [for the Holy Prophet]. So, the Holy Prophet, may peace and

blessings of Allah be upon him, prayed for Ḥassān, saying: 'O Allah! Strengthen Ḥassān with the Holy Spirit'—that is, Gabriel.

Abū Dāwūd has also related this tradition from Ibn Sīrīn, and Tirmidhi has also narrated this hadith and labelled it authentic and reliable. There is also a longer tradition in [*Ṣaḥīḥ al-*] *Bukhārī* and [*Ṣaḥīḥ*] *Muslim* that the Messenger of Allah, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, said to Ḥassān: أَجِبْ عَنِّي اللَّهُمَّ أَيُّدُهُ بِرُوحِ الْقُدُسِ (O Ḥassān!) Respond to the disbelievers on my behalf. O Allah! Strengthen him with the Holy Spirit.<sup>1</sup>

Similarly, there is also this hadith about Ḥassān:<sup>2</sup> هَاجَهُمْ وَجِبْرَائِيلُ مَعَكَ meaning, 'O Ḥassān, return the disbelievers' sarcasm<sup>3</sup> with sarcasm, and Gabriel is with you.'

#### AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE

The very same words have been used in relation to the support of the Holy Spirit for Ḥassān bin Thābit [mentioned in the *aḥādīth*] that have been used in the Noble Quran in relation to Jesus. And it has been acknowledged that in this place these words mean that the Holy Spirit was granted to Jesus on a permanent basis and would never part from him for so much as the blink of an eye. Therefore, due to the identical wording, that very meaning should apply here as well

These *aḥādīth* prove that Gabriel stayed with Ḥassān and was his constant companion. Similarly, the following noble verse of the Holy Quran—**أَيُّدُهُمْ بِرُوحٍ مِنْهُ**<sup>4</sup> [He strengthened them with a Spirit from Himself]—also clearly and very manifestly demonstrates that the Holy Spirit always kept company with the believers because the exact same type of verse, which

1. *Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī*, Kitāb Bad'ul-Khalq, Bāb Dhikrul-Malā'ikah, Hadith 3212; see also *Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim*, Kitāb Faḍā'iluṣ-Ṣaḥābah, Bāb Faḍā'il Ḥassān bin Thābit<sup>ra</sup>, Hadith 2385, published by Mu'assasatur-Risālah Nāshirūn [Publisher]

2. *Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī*, Kitāb Bad'ul-Khalq, Bāb Dhikrul-Malā'ikah Ṣalātullāhi 'alaihim, Hadith 3213 [Publisher]

3. This is an Arabic expression meaning to respond to the slander in a befitting manner. [Publisher]

4. *Sūrah al-Mujādalah*, (58:23) [Publisher]



appears in regard to Jesus [Ḥaḍrat ‘Īsā]—namely, <sup>1</sup>وَأَيَّدْنَاهُ بِرُوحِ الْقُدُسِ [And We strengthened him with the Holy Spirit]—is explained by all commentators unanimously to mean that the Holy Spirit was a constant companion of Jesus, not leaving him even for a single moment. See *Tafsīr Ḥusainī*, *Tafsīr Maẓharī*, *Tafsīr ‘Azīzī*, *Ma‘ālim Ibn-e-Kathīr*, etc.

Commenting upon the same verse Maulawī Siddīq Ḥasan writes in *Fathul-Bayān*:

**AUTHOR’S MARGIN NOTE**

The belief of Muslim ulema that the Holy Spirit remained with Jesus at every moment and at all times

وَكَانَ جِبْرِائِيلُ يَسِيرُ مَعَ عِيسَى حَيْثُ سَارَ فَلَمْ يُفَارِقْهُ حَتَّى صَعَدَ بِهِ إِلَى السَّمَاءِ.

Meaning that: Gabriel always remained with the Messiah, peace be upon him, not leaving him even for the blink of an eye, up to the point that he went to the heavens with him.

**Here, there are two extremely regrettable aspects** which are worthy of the readers’ attention:

(1) FIRST: These *maulawīs* used to believe that Gabriel descended upon the Prophets from time to time with *wahy* [revelation] from the heavens and, after conveying the *wahy*, he would immediately ascend to the heavens.

**AUTHOR’S MARGIN NOTE**

The belief of present-day *maulawīs* is that Gabriel remained continuously—day and night—with Jesus for 33 years and never separated from him during that entire period and that this is a lofty and unique distinction granted to Jesus, and that no other Prophet shares in it—not even, God forbid, our Holy Prophet <sup>ṣaṣ</sup>

Now, in the case of Jesus, however, they have invented a new and contrary belief; namely, that Gabriel did not ascend to the heavens to fetch revelation for Jesus. Revelation simply fell from the heavens while Gabriel did

1. *Sūrah al-Baqarah*, 2:88 [Publisher]

not separate from Jesus even for the blink of an eye, and Gabriel ascended

#### AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE

The belief of present-day *maulawīs* is that the manner in which revelation descends on the Messiah is unique among all Prophets.

only when Jesus ascended to the heavens, and he stayed on earth, day and night, for thirty-three years, not leaving him even for a single moment, and for thirty-three consecutive years, he left his heavenly abode—which is not less than a thousand miles in

length and breadth—desolate and abandoned, whereas, the authentic *aḥādīth* say that not a foot of heaven remains without angels even for a single moment<sup>1</sup>—and the manner in which he conveyed revelation to Jesus for thirty-three years also turns out to be unique among all Prophets!

#### AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE

How does revelation descend upon the Prophets

*Bukhārī, Abū Dāwūd, Tirmidhī, Ibn*

*Mājah, and Muslim* are all unanimous in their reports that the descent of Gabriel

(that is, his manifestation, as I explained earlier) from the heavens with revelation takes place upon the Prophets from time to time. In support of this, **Ibn Jarīr and Ibn Kathīr** have also recorded the following hadith:

عَنِ النَّوَاسِ بْنِ سَمْعَانَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ تَعَالَى عَنْهُ قَالَ قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ إِذَا أَرَادَ اللَّهُ تَبَارَكَ وَتَعَالَى أَنْ يُوحِيَ بِأَمْرٍ تَكَلَّمَ بِالْوَحْيِ، فَإِذَا تَكَلَّمَ أَخَذَتْ السَّمَوَاتُ مِنْهُ رَجْفَةً أَوْ قَالَ رَعْدَةً شَدِيدَةً مِنْ خَوْفِ اللَّهِ تَعَالَى، فَإِذَا سَمِعَ بِذَلِكَ أَهْلُ السَّمَوَاتِ صَبَعُوا وَخَرُّوا لِلَّهِ سُجَّدًا فَيَكُونُ أَوَّلُ مَنْ يَرْفَعُ رَأْسَهُ جِبْرَائِيلُ عَلَيْهِ الصَّلَاةُ وَالسَّلَامُ، فَيَكَلِّمُهُ اللَّهُ مِنْ وَحْيِهِ بِمَا أَرَادَ فَيَمْنُضِي بِهِ جِبْرَائِيلُ عَلَيْهِ الصَّلَاةُ وَالسَّلَامُ عَلَى الْمَلَائِكَةِ كُلِّهَا مِنْ سَمَاءٍ إِلَى سَمَاءٍ يَسْأَلُهُ مَلَائِكَتُهَا مَاذَا قَالَ رَبُّنَا يَا جِبْرَائِيلُ فَيَقُولُ عَلَيْهِ السَّلَامُ: قَالَ الْحَقُّ وَهُوَ الْعَلِيُّ الْكَبِيرُ. فَيَقُولُونَ كُلُّهُمْ مِثْلَ مَا قَالَ جِبْرَائِيلُ فَيَنْتَهِي جِبْرَائِيلُ بِالْوَحْيِ إِلَى حَيْثُ أَمَرَهُ اللَّهُ تَعَالَى مِنَ السَّمَاءِ وَالْأَرْضِ.

1. *Sunan at-Tirmidhī, Kitābuz-Zuhd, Bābu fī Qaulin-Nabī<sup>ṣas</sup>*: Lau-Ta'lamūna Mā A'lam Laḍāhiktum Qalīlan, Hadith 2312 [Publisher]

Meaning that: Nawās bin Sam‘ān, may Allah be pleased with him, relates that the Messenger of Allah, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, stated that when God Almighty desires to send down a revelation from Himself, He speaks out the same, the revelation being yet of a general nature and covered by a veil. This speech, whose meaning is still concealed, causes the heavens to shudder and its awe-inspiring words travel throughout the heavens. No one comprehends their meaning and every angel is atremble in fear of Almighty God. They expect something terrible to happen. They are stunned by the mighty voice and fall into prostration. The first angel to raise his head from prostration is Gabriel, peace and blessings be upon him. God Almighty explains to him all the details of the *wahy* [revelation] and informs him of His will and purpose. Then Gabriel takes the *wahy* to all the angels who are in different heavens, and each angel asks him what that dreadful sound was and what it meant. Gabriel answers them that this is a matter of truth, and that God Almighty is Exalted and most High. That is, this *wahy* is among those truths that the **Exalted and Great God** has deemed appropriate to manifest. Then all the angels begin saying what Gabriel has said. Gabriel then conveys the *wahy* to where he has been commanded to convey it, whether in heaven or on earth.

**AUTHOR’S MARGIN NOTE**

How does revelation originate, and how does it then descend upon the Prophets?

Now, from this hadith, it is learned that at the time of the descent of *wahy*, Gabriel remains in the heavens. Then, as God Almighty has endowed his voice with strength and power, he delivers the *wahy* to

**AUTHOR’S MARGIN NOTE**

Refutation of the belief that Gabriel abandoned his heavenly abode to reside physically and permanently with the Messiah

its destined place. In this context, believing that Gabriel migrated from the heavens in his original form to stay with Ḥaḍrat ‘Īsā [Jesus] for thirty-three years, and that all the duties assigned to him in the heavens, which I have already mentioned, were left pending for those thirty-three years, is manifestly a false belief! Moreover, it necessarily

follows from this belief that *wahy* used to descend from heaven on its own, without the mediation of Gabriel, and that Gabriel used to receive it on earth itself.

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**

Statement on the manner and form in which the present-day *maulawis* are slandering the Holy Prophet<sup>345</sup>

The second point, **worthy of note** for readers, is that these *maulawis* have exalted Jesus in every matter and have slandered our Lord and Master, the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him. It is deplorable that they believe with respect to the Messiah that the Holy Spirit never departed from him and that he was free from the touch of Satan, and that these two characteristics were unique to him; however, with regard to our Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, they believe that the Holy Spirit did not remain with him always and at every moment, nor was he free from the touch of Satan—God forbid! Citing blasphemy does not amount to blasphemy. Despite such beliefs, they are called Muslims. In their estimation, our Lord and Master, **Muhammad, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him**, is dead, whereas Jesus is still alive and the Holy Spirit is a permanent companion of Jesus<sup>35</sup>; meanwhile, our Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be on him, is—God forbid—deprived of this bounty. Finally, Jesus is safeguarded from the touch of Satan, but our Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be on him, is not safeguarded.

Who can assess the harm that is being done to the religion of Islam in this age by the people who hold these beliefs? These people are hidden enemies of the Messenger of Allah, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, and every Muslim and true lover of the Messenger of Allah, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, should avoid them. These people want to maliciously associate the righteous predecessors with their abominable statements but due to their inner blindness, they cannot understand the sayings of the righteous predecessors, nor can they grasp the true essence of *ahādīth* of the Holy Prophet. They deceptively

claim: if this is our stand, then this is also the belief of the righteous predecessors.

O ignorant ones! This is absolutely not the way of the righteous predecessors. If the Companions of the Messenger of Allah, peace and the blessings of Allah be upon him, had believed that the Holy Spirit ever separated from him<sup>1</sup>, for short or long periods, they would certainly not have collected the sayings of the Holy Prophet, peace and the blessings of Allah be upon him, at all the different periods of his life and all times of day. The Companions had their eyes fixed on this verse:

#### AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE

The *Salaf Ṣāliḥ* [Pious Predecessors] had never held the belief that the present-day *maulawīs*—Miyān Nadhīr, Batālāwī, and such—hold in relation to the Holy Prophet<sup>ṣas</sup>, through which egregious insult is inevitably hurled upon the Holy Prophet, peace and blessings of Allah be upon him.

وَمَا يَنْطِقُ عَنِ الْهَوَىٰ ۝ إِنْ هُوَ إِلَّا وَحْيٌ يُوحَىٰ ۝<sup>1</sup>

If the Companions had believed, like you, O *maulawīs*, that the Holy Prophet, peace and the blessings of Allah be upon him, was not free from Satan's touch, why would they have declared him to be the **Chief of the Immaculate?**

Fear God Almighty! Why are you adamantly bent upon fabricating such blatant lies?

مصطفیٰ را چوں فروتر شد مقام از مسیح ناصری اے طفلِ غام

*How can the status of Muṣṭafā [the Chosen One<sup>ṣas</sup>] be lower*

*Than that of the Messiah of Nazareth, O immature child!*

آئکہ دستِ پاک او دستِ خداست یَا اللّٰهُ قُوِّیْ اٰیْدِیْہِہٖ  
یعنی از روح القدس چوں تو ایں گفتن کہ از روحش جداست

*He whose holy hand is the Hand of God—*

*How can you say that he is separated from the Holy Spirit?*

1. He does not speak out of *his own* desire; it is nothing but *pure* revelation that *has been* revealed by God (*Sūrah an-Najm*, 53:4–5). [Publisher]

آنکہ ہر کردار و قولش دینِ ماست یکدم از جبریل بحدش چوں رواست

*He whose every word and deed is our Faith—*

*How can he possibly part from Gabriel even for an instant?*

بر امامِ انبیاءِ ایں افترا چوں نے ترسید از قہرِ خدا

*This is such a slander against the Chief of the Prophets<sup>sas</sup>,*

*How do you avoid fearing the wrath of God!*

#### AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE

The Companions never held the belief that the Holy Spirit would ever be separated from the Holy Prophet, peace and blessings of Allah be upon him. Had the Companions held this belief, they would not have considered every single word and deed of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, to be a binding authority of the Faith

The Companions believed without any doubt that no action or statement of the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> was devoid of the influence of *wahy*, whether that *wahy* was abridged or detailed, hidden or apparent, clear or susceptible to interpretation. So much so that the details of the domestic life of the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>, even his personal dealings and private, secluded discussions with his wives, or details about what he ate and drank, how he dressed himself, and minor events of the daily routine of family life, have all been included in the *ahādīth* because of the belief that all such words or deeds were inspired by the light of the Holy Spirit.

This hadith may be found in Abū Dāwūd etc. Moreover, Imam Ahmad relates from Abdullah ibn Amr, through a chain of narrators, that Abdullah stated: ‘Whatever I used to hear from the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, I used to write down in order to commit it to memory. Some people asked me not to do so, arguing that the Messenger of Allah, peace and the blessings of Allah be upon him, is a human being and sometimes speaks in anger too. So, upon hearing this, I stopped writing down the words of the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> and reported the matter to the Messenger<sup>sas</sup> of Allah. Thereupon, he [the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>] said, ‘I

swear by the Being in Whose hand is my life that everything that emanates from me, whether it be a statement or an action, is from God Almighty.’

Should it be said that, ‘These very traditions also state that, in certain matters, the Holy Prophet, peace and the blessings of Allah be upon him, made errors in interpretation, yet if all the words and deeds of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, were based on *wahy*, then why were those mistakes made, even though the Holy Prophet was never allowed to persist in any such error?’ To this, the response is that even that *ijtihādī* [interpretive] error was not devoid of the light of *wahy*. The Holy Prophet, peace and the blessings of Allah be upon him, never separated from God Almighty’s control even for a moment. Thus, the examples of his mistakes are like the few occasions of forgetfulness of the Holy Prophet, peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, during Prayer, which resulted in the raising and clarifying of certain religious matters. Similarly, he was sometimes led to make

#### AUTHOR’S MARGIN NOTE

Even the *ijtihād*-based errors of the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> also bore the character of revelation—the special decree of God Almighty overpowered the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> at such times

errors of interpretation so that the law may be completed by means of some utterly fine points being raised as a result. Furthermore, the human forgetfulness [of the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>] was not like that experienced by all others. Rather, it truly bore the character of *wahy*. It was, in fact, a very special will of God Almighty that took hold of the entirety of the Prophet’s being and inclined him to do something in which there were many points of wisdom from God Almighty. Therefore, I do not regard even such errors of interpretation as being separate from *wahy* because it was not an ordinary matter; for, on such occasions, God Almighty took complete possession of the faculties of His Prophet and, for the benefit of the people, manifested a light in the form of a mistake or of a wrong judgement. A stream of *wahy* gushed forth simultaneously, just as the current of water in a canal may be deliberately blocked for some purpose and then released. No

intelligent person would say in such a case that the water in the canal had dried up or had been removed.

The same is the case with the errors of interpretation by the Prophets. The Holy Spirit never departs from them, but sometimes, for some purpose of His own, God Almighty takes possession of the understanding and perception of Prophets and in such a condition some word or action proceeds from them in forgetfulness or error and thereafter the wisdom that was intended becomes manifest. Then, the river of *wahy* begins to flow with force, and the intervening error is removed as if it never existed.

**The Messiah** ran towards a fig tree to eat its fruit and, although the Holy Spirit accompanied him, it failed to warn him that the tree bore no fruit at the time. Despite all this, everyone knows that the rare and exceptional lies in the category of the non-existent.

#### AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE

The Gospels substantiate the judgemental errors of the Messiah [Jesus] about whom the foolish *maulawīs* of this day hold the belief that Gabriel remained with him at every moment, but the splendour of God Himself is seen in every single word, deed, activity, and inactivity of our Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him. The ignorant *maulawīs* of today believe in the perpetual companionship of the Holy Spirit with the Messiah from the glance of just a single verse, whereas the following verse in relation to our Prophet<sup>sas</sup> is superior in clarity, detail, and evidence:  
 وَمَا يَنْطِيقُ عَنْ الْهَوَىٰ ۖ إِنَّ هُوَ إِلَّا وَحْيٌ يُوحَىٰ  
 What a pity that those blind of sight fail to look upon this clear and explicit verse!

So, when in nearly a million words and actions of our master and leader, **Muhammad Muṣṭafā [the Chosen One]**, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, **we witness the pure manifestation of divine presence**, and in every matter—whether in movements, stillness, words, or actions—the radiant lights of the Holy Spirit are visible, then what harm is there if, in one or two instances, a hint of human nature is also perceived? Indeed, it was necessary that this should happen occasionally so that his humanness might be confirmed and people might not become involved in making him an associate with God.

In concluding this discourse, I would like to reproduce a few sayings of the righteous



people of the past. From these, it can be learnt that they certainly did not believe that the Holy Spirit descended upon the Holy Prophet, may peace and the blessings of Allah be upon him, only at certain special and particular times, and that at other times the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, was—God forbid—totally deprived of his company.

One of these sayings is documented by **Shaikh ‘Abdul-Ḥaqq, the *Muḥaddith* of Delhi**, on page 42 of his book *Madārijun-Nubūwwat*. Its purport is that the angels of *wahy* are the constant friends and companions of the Holy Prophet, peace and the blessings of Allah be upon him. He quotes from *Jāmi‘ul-Usūl* and *Kitābul-Wafā* that, continuously, for three years from the

#### AUTHOR’S MARGIN NOTE

Shaikh ‘Abdul-Ḥaqq, the *Muḥaddith* of Delhi, cites *Kitābul-Wafā Shāḥādāt* and *Safrus-Sa‘adat* etc. to show that the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> was never separated from the angels of revelation and that Jibrā‘il, peace be upon him, was his permanent companion.

beginning of the Prophethood, Ḥaḍrat Isrāfil accompanied the Holy Prophet, may peace and the blessings of Allah be upon him, after that Ḥaḍrat Jibrā‘il came to provide permanent companionship. Again, quoting from *Safrus-Sa‘adat*, he says that Allah, His eminence be glorified, commanded Isrāfil to keep company with the Holy Prophet, peace and the blessings of Allah be upon him, when he was seven years of age. So, Isrāfil stayed with the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> every moment and always till he was 11 years of age; Isrāfil, however, did not suggest anything by way of *wahy* to the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, except for a word or two. Likewise, Mīkā‘il was also a companion of the Holy Prophet. Then, after that, Ḥaḍrat Jibrā‘il was commanded, and he remained continuously in the company of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, for twenty-nine years before the *wahy* began. Following this period, the *wahy* of Prophethood commenced.

From this statement, every intelligent person can understand that those

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**

The fact is well established and none of the Ummah's eminent scholars deny it that the period of revelation is verily the period of revelation, but even before that period, the angels of revelation were closely accompanying the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> at every moment and every time. Accordingly, Gabriel was a friend and companion for every moment up to twenty-nine years preceding the revelation of the Quran. Moreover, this scenario is completely contrary to reason that when the revelation of the Quran was not occurring, the angel Gabriel was present and remained a companion every moment and every minute during that period, but when the time for the revelation of the Quran came—additionally putting forth the need for a perpetual companion—then Gabriel abandons his earlier practice, ascends to the heavens, and leaves him all alone, sometimes disappearing for several months at a time.

earlier virtuous people—who have written that Ḥaḍrat Jibrā'il, for instance, was a constant companion of the Holy Prophet, may peace and the blessings of Allah be upon him, for 29 years leading up to the prophetic call—could never have held the belief that Jibrā'il also used to ascend to heaven sometimes; for, leaving and departing at any time is contrary to the idea of constant proximity and uninterrupted companionship. But when we examine the second belief of these gentlemen that heaven is the permanent abode of Jibrā'il, peace be on him, and he brings every *wahy* from heaven itself, the contradiction that arises from combining these two beliefs can only be resolved by holding the belief that Ḥaḍrat Jibrā'il's, peace be upon him, descent from the heavens is not to be understood literally, but symbolically. When the descent is understood symbolically, there is no issue with Jibrā'il, peace be upon him, being with the Prophets, peace be upon them, at all times in every moment, and at every blink of an eye, in his symbolic form, because in his true form he remains in the heavens.

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**

Shaikh 'Abdul-Haqq, the *Muḥaddith* of Delhi, has written in *Madārijun-Nubuwwat* that Jibrā'il did not descend physically with revelation; [rather] he remains in his abode in the heavens and his reflection appears with the prophetic revelation.

Shaikh 'Abdul-Haqq, the *Muḥaddith* of Delhi, has confirmed and approved the same view in his book *Madārijun-Nubuwwat*. On page 45 of his book, he states that some discerning individuals have regarded Jibrā'il's descent, which sometimes took place in the shape of

*Dihiyah Kalbi*, or some other person, as something difficult to comprehend which leads to the objection that if Jibrā'il, peace be on him, actually took on a new body resembling *Dihiyah Kalbi* and infused his spirit into it, then what would happen to his original body with three hundred wings? Would that body remain lifeless, and would Ḥaḍrat Jibrā'il 'die' and after suffering death, assume another body through a process of transmigration?

In answer to this objection, he [the Shaikh] states that according to scholars, this descent is symbolic, not literal, so it does not necessitate leaving one body and entering into another. Again, he states that Jibrā'il, peace be upon him, fully projected his attributes upon the personality of *Dihiyah Kalbi*—which Jibrā'il, peace be upon him, possessed complete power and will to do. Thus, he was able to appear, with his perfect attributes, in the likeness of *Dihiyah Kalbi*. In other words, having invested this abstract personality with his own attributes, he appeared before the Prophet, peace be upon him, in the likeness of *Dihiyah Kalbi*. Jibrā'il never descended bodily from heaven; rather, he remained firm and steadfast in his place in the heavens. Jibrā'il appearing upon earth is only a likeness of the real Jibrā'il in heaven—a reflection and not the real Jibrā'il himself; for Jibrā'il, with all his characteristic attributes, always remains in heaven and enjoys a unique nature and exalted status.

#### AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE

Shaikh 'Abdul-Ḥaqq believed that Jibrā'il did not descend physically with revelation. He affirms that all scholars believe that Jibrā'il remains permanently in heaven; moreover, it is his metaphysical descent that is manifested upon the earth. The same example also explains the appearance of some great *Auliya'* in various places and in different forms. Not only Jibrā'il, but all angels make metaphysical appearances on earth and yet they do not leave their assigned station in heaven.

After making this statement, the above-mentioned Shaikh declares that just as Jibrā'il descended in a symbolic rather than a literal form, this is also an example of spiritual realities manifesting in physical forms. The same example would explain the appearance of God Almighty in the human form, which is experienced by those gifted with spiritual vision. The same example also explains the appearance of

some of the perfect *Auliya'* [saints], in various places and in different forms.

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**

The Companions agree that the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> physically saw Jibrā'il only twice in the heavens. His appearances on earth were always metaphorical.

May God Almighty reward respected Shaikh 'Abdul-Ḥaqq the *Muhaddith* for wholeheartedly accepting the view that Jibrā'il, peace be upon him, does not descend in person; rather, a symbolic form of him is seen by the Prophets, peace be upon them, while Jibrā'il remains firmly stationed in the heavens. This is the same belief of mine for which some blind-hearted ulema have issued an edict declaring me a disbeliever. Alas! They do not even consider that all commentators as well as the Companions agree that the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, saw Jibrā'il, peace be upon him, in his actual body on just two occasions.

Even a child can understand that Jibrā'il could not physically come to the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> in his true form since his true form extends from the East to the West—with his wings reaching the edges of the heavens—so how could he physically fit into locations such as Makkah or Madinah? If you maintain that Ḥaḍrat Jibrā'il's descent must be understood literally in terms of his true, actual existence, then you will be faced with the objection: How could his true form possibly fit into the chamber of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him? And if you say that it was not his true form, then, after abandoning the true form, could it be anything other than a symbolic representation?

The descent of the true form would only happen if there were no remaining trace of that form in the heavens. Once that form has descended from the heavens, it must be clearly demonstrated where it can find space to stay. In short, the notion that Jibrā'il would descend to earth with his actual being is clearly a false belief, especially because of the accompanying error—that such a belief means that the Prophets, peace be upon them, often remained without the blessings of *wahy*

[revelation]. Therefore, it would be extremely shameless to even entertain such a belief in your heart.

Shaikh ‘Abdul-Ḥaqq, the *Muḥaddith* of Delhi, says on page 83 of his book *Madārijun-Nubuwwat* that all the words and sayings of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, were

**AUTHOR’S MARGIN NOTE**

Pious ancestors believed that all sayings and deeds of the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> were revelational

[a form of] **subtle *wahy***, with only a few exceptions—for example: his treatment of the prisoners of war taken at the Battle of Badr, the narration concerning Mariyah and honey, and [the narration of] the cross-fertilization of the date trees—which are rare and insignificant. Then, in the same place, he states that Auzā’ī reports on the authority of Ḥassan bin ‘Aṭiyya that the descent of Jibrā’īl was not necessarily limited to the revelation of the Quran; rather, every sunnah [established practice of the Prophet<sup>sas</sup>] is based upon the descent of Jibrā’īl. Even the *ijtihād* [personal reasoning] of the Holy Prophet, peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, is a form of *wahy*.

Then, he writes on page 87 that the Companions of the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> **regarded** every one of his sayings and actions—regardless of whether they were few or many, minor or major—as *wahy* [**revelation**]. They did not hesitate to engage in any argument in acting upon them. They were eager to learn everything the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> did in privacy and in seclusion. There is, therefore, no doubt that anyone who were to reflect upon the life of the Companions—how they regarded everything, all the words and deeds of the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>, to be binding religious obligations, and who believed that every moment, every instant, and every breath of the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> was immersed in *wahy*—would feel ashamed before God and fear even entertaining the thought that Jibrā’īl could ever leave the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, and return to the heavens.

But alas, our ulema, who are also regarded as *muḥaddith* [scholars of Hadith], show no fear whatsoever. If abandoning their beliefs is

considered *kufr* [disbelief], then such disbelief would be a great blessing indeed! I am utterly repelled by their kind of faith, and I seek justice from God Almighty regarding these statements of theirs, due to which the opponents greatly undermine the status of the Messenger of Allah, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him. What should I say or write about these people, who have furnished the opponents with opportunities to laugh and ridicule, and who have so lowered the grand status of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, in comparison with Ḥaḍrat 'Īsā that one shudders to think of it?

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**

Remaining part of the study into the essence of Islam

Reverting now to the **study of the essence of Islam**, as taught by the Noble Quran, is nothing new. Rather, all the Prophets, peace be upon them, were sent to manifest the same fundamental truth. All heavenly Books also had the same objective; namely, to establish the children of Adam upon this straight path. But teachings of the Noble Quran have a perfect superiority over other teachings for two reasons:

**FIRST**—The earlier Prophets were not commissioned for the whole of mankind of their time. Rather, they were sent for their particular people, whose capacities were limited and in whose case only specific habits, conduct, beliefs, or moral qualities were in need of reformation. The scriptures of these Prophets were, therefore, like a law whose application is limited to a particular community. They only brought guidance to the extent that was appropriate for that particular people and aligned with the level of their capacity.

**SECONDLY**—The laws given to these Prophets, peace be upon them, were only meant for a limited period of time and God Almighty had not intended for the guidance in these Books to continue until the end of the world. Such Books, being limited in their application to

a particular time, furnished guidance for the time that Divine providence ordained for them.

The Noble Quran is entirely free from both the defects that I have mentioned because, God Almighty's purpose in revealing the Noble Quran was to reform, perfect, and educate all of humanity across all eras and capabilities, so that the **complete form** and full grandeur of **Islam** would become manifest to mankind. The time for such a glorious manifestation had also arrived. God Almighty, therefore, revealed the Holy Quran as a complete and comprehensive Law for all peoples and for all ages until the Day of Judgment. He thus opened the door for people of every level of aptitude to benefit and profit, as He Himself says:

ثُمَّ أَوْرَثْنَا الْكِتَابَ الَّذِينَ اصْطَفَيْنَا مِنْ عِبَادِنَا فَمِنْهُمْ ظَالِمٌ لِنَفْسِهِ وَمِنْهُمْ مُقْتَصِدٌ وَمِنْهُمْ سَابِقٌ  
بِالْخَيْرَاتِ يُؤْتِنُ اللَّهُ ذَلِكَ هُوَ الْفَضْلُ الْكَبِيرُ ١

Meaning that: then We made those people whom We chose from among Our servants as heirs to Our Book, and they are in three groups: (1) One group among them are *ẓālim* [harsh], who oppress themselves, meaning they force and coerce their *naḥs-e-ammārah* [the self that incites to evil] to follow the path of God Almighty. They engage in severe struggles by opposing their rebellious self.

(2) The second group consists of people who, in their moderate state, compel their rebellious selves to perform certain services in the path of God Almighty with force and coercion, while for other godly tasks, their souls willingly and eagerly follow, carrying out these tasks with pleasure, love, and devotion. In short, these people act on the commandments of God Almighty partly by way of perseverance and laborious effort and partly they obey their Glorious Lord due to a natural inclination and heartfelt zeal without any sense of burden whatsoever. That is to say, they have not yet fully conformed to the desires and

1. *Sūrah Fāṭir*, 35:33 [Publisher]



intentions of Allah, glorified be His eminence, nor have they, as yet, been completely freed from the battle and opposition of their selves, but rather, their self supports some paths leading to God and opposes other such paths.

(3) The third group is of سَابِقٌ بِالْخَيْرَاتِ [*sābiqum bil-khairāt*—those who excel in goodness] who constitute the highest rank. They have gained complete victory over their *nafs-e-ammārah* and have taken the lead in performing good works. In their case, the bitterness and rebelliousness of their egos has disappeared completely. They naturally love the commandments of God Almighty, all the paths of His law, all His decrees and predestinations, and everything related to His will and decree, without any pretence or affectation. They leave no stone unturned in their obedience and submission. Obedience to Allah, glorified be His eminence, becomes a part of their disposition and provides comfort to their souls, such that they absolutely cannot live without it. Their soul obeys God Almighty with a cheerfulness that is filled with perfect delight, yearning, relish, intense inclination, and joyous desire. At no time and under no circumstances do they need to force or compel themselves to act on any divine commandment or carry out the will of God. On the contrary, their soul becomes *nafs-e-muṭma'innah* [the soul at rest], and the intention and will of God Almighty becomes their intention and will; they love the commandments and the will of God Almighty in the same way as God Almighty loves His commandments and will. That is why they do not retreat in times of trials—rather, they advance a few steps forward.

Thereafter, Allah, His eminence be glorified, says that My grace is great upon all these three groups. That is, those who are *ẓālim* are also the recipients of God's grace and occupy an exalted station and are the beloveds of God Almighty; similarly, so are those of the middle group; and, of course, the case of those who excel in good deeds is self-evident.

It is clear that in this verse Allah the Exalted has also included the people who are *ẓālim* [harsh on their own selves] among his eminent servants and has declared them to be the recipients of His grace, beloveds, chosen ones, and the praised ones of God with whom He is very



much pleased. However, the Noble Quran is full of references which show that Allah, His eminence be glorified, does not love those who are *ẓālim* [unjust] and that those who forsake justice can never be the recipients of divine grace. Thus, based on this argument, it becomes patently clear that the group of *ẓālims* spoken of in the verse cited above does not refer to those who are rebellious and disobedient to God, or those who are polytheists, disbelievers, or who abandon the path of justice and righteousness and choose to oppose God; for, such people—according to the Noble Quran—are under the curse and wrath of God, and it clearly says that God befriends neither the unjust nor iniquitous people who abandon the ways of equity and justice. Then how can those people be considered recipients of grace and how can they be described as His chosen, elect, and eminent servants?

Thus, on the basis of these certain and decisive arguments, we have to accept that the word *ẓālim* is not used here in any derogatory sense. On the contrary, it has been employed in a laudable and praiseworthy sense to describe the people who merit being granted a share from the category of *سَابِقُونَ بِالْخَيْرَاتِ* [*sābiqum bil-khairāt*—those who excel in goodness] and who are, as it were, the younger brothers of this excellent grade [of people]. There can be no other meaning here of *ẓālim* except those who, for the sake of God Almighty, compel and force their own selves [to perform good works] and who are engaged, day and night, in curtailing their passions through hard strivings. The lexicons, too, explain that the word *ẓālim*, apart from its other uses, is also used to denote ‘reduction’, as, for example, Allah, glorified be His eminence, says at another place in the Noble Quran:

وَكَمْ تَظْلِمُ مِنْهُ شَيْئًا<sup>1</sup>

Meaning that: Nothing was reduced therefrom. To curb or kill one’s passions in order to gain the pleasure of God Almighty is undoubtedly a kind of *ẓulm* in this sense. Moreover, we cannot judge the Noble

1. *Sūrah al-Kahf*, 18:34 [Publisher]

Quran by the lexicons composed in accordance with the usage of their times, hundreds of years after the Holy Quran. The Noble Quran is self-sufficient for [conveying] the meaning of its expressions and some of its verses explain some others.

Clearly, the word *iṣṭifā'* [i.e. God's choosing of someone]—which bestows honour—has never been used by God Almighty in favour of the other [type of] *ẓālim* people. On the contrary, they have been described as rejected, accursed, and subject to the wrath of God. Here, however, God has declared these *ẓālim* people as His exalted ones who deserve His grace. It is clearly proven by this verse that just as the one in the middle group is an eminent servant of God because he is following the middle path, and just as the one who is سَابِقٌ بِالْخَيْرَاتِ [who excel in goodness] is spiritually eminent in the eyes of God because of being سَابِقٌ بِالْخَيْرَاتِ so must the *ẓālim* be an eminent person because he is harsh upon himself.

#### AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE

A companion of mine is interested in researching the praiseworthy aspects of the words ظُلُومًا جَهُولًا [harsh, unmindful] in the verse إِنَّكَ كَانْتَ ظُلُومًا جَهُولًا (Sūrah al-Aḥzab, 33:73)—the above-mentioned friend should read this discussion carefully

Now, is there any deficiency left in proving that, here, the word *ẓulm* refers to the harshness that is pleasing to God Almighty; namely, the force and compulsion upon one's self for the sake of God Almighty, and curbing and controlling one's passions for gaining the pleasure of Allah, His eminence be glorified? Elsewhere, the Noble

Quran also refers to this category of *ẓālim* people as *tawwābīn* [those who repent], whom Allah the Glorious loves.

In short, it would be a great blunder—God forbid—to take the word *ẓālim* here to mean those who are vehemently disobedient to God Almighty, are guilty of disbelief and polytheism, are transgressors and sinners, who approve of these sins, and are enemies of goodness and virtue; rather, the word *ẓālim* here means the people who, despite the storms of passions intensifying inside them, struggle to find some way of running towards Almighty God.

Another context of this is that Allah, glorified be His eminence, has declared the ultimate object of revealing the Noble Quran to be <sup>1</sup>هُدًى لِّلْمُتَّقِينَ [a guidance for the righteous], and has specifically designated the *muttaqīn* [righteous] as the ones who would attain rectitude, guidance, and grace from the Noble Quran, as He states:

الْعَمَّ ۝ ذَٰلِكَ الْكِتَابُ لَا رَيْبَ فِيهِ هُدًى لِّلْمُتَّقِينَ ۝<sup>2</sup>

Hence, keeping this ultimate objective in view, the point is firmly and decisively established that the word *zālim* in this verse can never be applied to any individual who is intentionally disobedient and rebellious, abandons the path of justice, and embraces *shirk* [polytheism] and faithlessness. For, such an individual is undoubtedly outside the pale of righteousness and is absolutely unworthy of being ranked even amongst the lowest of the righteous. However, in the verse under discussion, the *zālims* are not only included in the group of the righteous and believers, but they are also declared to be the leaders and elect of the righteous.

Hence, it is proven—as I have just explained—that such *zālims* are not those *zālims* who are entirely outside the pale of righteousness; rather, it refers to those people who are still somewhat involved in the darkness of sin but are not rebellious against God Almighty. They continue to wrestle with their rebellious self through formal actions and enforced struggle and, in whatever way they can, desire to withhold themselves from the promptings of their evil self. Evil desires overcome them at times and make them commit sin. But at other times, they overcome evil desires and wash that black stain with their tears. This quality of their eyes, crying and weeping [before God] is really not blameworthy; rather, it is praiseworthy and a vehicle for making infinite spiritual progress and a means for enabling the harshest of strivings. This very

1. *Sūrah al-Baqarah*, 2:3 [Publisher]

2. *Sūrah al-Baqarah*, 2:2–3 [Publisher]

quality of opposing one's self which, in other words, is called *ẓalūmiyyat* is really the most praiseworthy trait of human nature, which even the angels have not been bestowed. The following verse alludes to this very quality as Allah, glorified be His eminence, says:

وَحَمَلَهَا الْإِنْسَانُ إِنَّهُ كَانَ ظَلُومًا جَهُولًا<sup>1</sup>

Meaning that: This quality of *ẓalūmiyyat* [oppressiveness] and *jahūliyyat* [being neglectful] that is within humans is the reason that they came forward to assume the burden of carrying the trust that can be sustained only by those who possess the ability to oppose and compel their lower self. In short, this quality of being **harsh upon one's self** is a vehicle that man has been bestowed for attaining the grades of excellence and is a most eminent means for achieving the stations of nearness to God which, due to the strenuous spiritual strivings, manifests itself in the form of the fire of Hell in earlier stages, but which, in the end, ushers one to the bounties of Paradise.

In truth, the following verse at another place of the Noble Quran:

وَأَن مِّنكُمْ إِلَّا وَارِدُهَا كَانَ عَلَىٰ رَبِّكَ حَتْمًا مَّقْضِيًّا ۖ ثُمَّ نُنَجِّي الَّذِينَ اتَّقَوْا وَكَذَٰلِكَ ظَلِيلِينَ فِيهَا جَثِيًّا<sup>2</sup>

is also essentially alluding to the same praiseworthy quality of *ẓalūmiyyat*, and the translation of the verse is that 'There is not a single one of you who will not have to pass through the fire. This is a promise that your Lord has made incumbent and binding upon Himself. Then, after descending into the fire, We grant salvation to the *muttaqīn* [righteous], but We shall leave the *ẓālimīn*—meaning, those who are idolaters and rebellious—in Hell, down upon their knees.' Here the [definite] article 'al' [the] that appears at the head of *aẓ-ẓālimīn* serves

1. *Sūrah al-Aḥzāb*, 33:73 [Publisher]

2. *Sūrah Maryam*, 19:72–73 [Publisher]

to particularize it, and the purpose is to point out that the *zālim* are of two kinds:

(1) First, the righteous *zālim* for whom the promise of salvation is made and who are the beloveds of God Almighty, who have been included among the saved in the verse: *فِيهِمْ ظَالِمٌ* [among them are the *zālim*].

(2) **Second**, the idolater, *kāfir* [disbeliever], and rebellious *zālim* who will be hurled into Hell.

This verse states that even the righteous are not immune from the touch of this fire. This statement signifies that the righteous bravely cast themselves into this ‘fire’ in various ways in this very world, which is the abode of trials. For the sake of God Almighty, they hurl themselves into a raging fire. Various kinds of heavenly decrees and verdicts also fall upon them in the form of ‘fire’ and they are tormented, persecuted, and such severe upheavals befall them that no one apart from them has the strength to bear these tremors. Authentic *aḥādīth* also state that the fever from which a believer suffers is a type of Hell-fire.<sup>1</sup> A believer, therefore, receives their share of this fire in this very world in the shape of fever and other afflictions.

Another tradition says that, for a believer, Paradise assumes the form of Hell in this world;<sup>2</sup> i.e. the suffering undergone in the way of God Almighty appears to them like the hardships of Hell. So, they enter that Hell with a willing heart and instantly find themselves in Paradise. Similarly, there are many other traditions purporting that a believer takes his share of the fire of Hell in this very world. And the *kāfir* [disbeliever] is compelled and forced into Hell, whereas a believer enters the fire of their own will for the sake of God Almighty.<sup>3</sup> There is

1. *Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī, Kitābuṭ-Ṭibb*, Bāb al-Ḥumā min Faiḥi Jahannam, Hadith 5725 [Publisher]

2. *Al-Minhāj Sharḥ Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim, Kitābuz-Zuhd war-Raqā’iq*, p. 2035, Hadith 2956, published by Dār Ibn Ḥazm, Beirut, Lebanon [Publisher]

3. *Al-Minhāj Sharḥ Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim, Kitābuz-Zuhd war-Raqā’iq*, p. 2035, Hadith 2956, published by Dār Ibn Ḥazm, Beirut, Lebanon [Publisher]

**another hadith** to the same effect in which it is recorded that a portion of the fire is decreed for every human being—they may accept their share of this fire in the way of God Almighty in this world, or they may pass their life in ease and neglect and render the account for their comfortable living in the Hereafter.<sup>1</sup>

The verse <sup>2</sup>وَلَنْ يَرْضَىٰكَ اللَّهُ إِلَّا وَإِنْ قَسَيْتُمْ إِلَّا وَارِدُهَا<sup>2</sup> also has another meaning, which is that in the world of the Hereafter every fortunate person and every wretched person will be shown things in an embodied form so that he will realize whether he had walked on the path of peace and security in this world or had chosen the way of destruction, death, and Hell. In the next world, therefore, the path of peace and security, namely, *ṣirāṭ-e-mustaqīm* [the straight path]—a very narrow path upon which very few people walk and from which to stray to the right or left is really to fall into Hell—will materialize before their eyes. And the people who were unable to walk upon *ṣirāṭ-e-mustaqīm* in this world will be unable to walk upon it in the Hereafter also, because the *ṣirāṭ* [path] of the next world is in reality only a representation of the spiritual *ṣirāṭ* of this world.

With our spiritual eyes, we can see even now that there truly is Hell to the right and left of our *ṣirāṭ* [path]—such that if we leave the *ṣirāṭ* and walk even a little to the right, we fall into Hell; and if we falter a little to the left, even then we fall into Hell. Only if we keep walking upon *ṣirāṭ-e-mustaqīm* [the straight path] are we saved from Hell. In the next world, we shall see all this as a reality in physical form. We shall see with our own eyes that there really is a *ṣirāṭ* laid out above Hell in the form of a **bridge**, to the right and the left of which is Hell. Then, we shall be made to walk on the *ṣirāṭ*, and if we had been treading upon *ṣirāṭ-e-mustaqīm* in this world, and had not veered right or left, then we shall have no fear of the *ṣirāṭ* of the next world. The steam of Hell

1. *Al-Minhāj Sharḥ Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim ibn al-Ḥajjāj*, Imām Nawawī, *Kitābuz-Zuhd war-Raqā'iq*, p. 2035, Hadith 2956, published by Dār Ibn Ḥazm, Beirut, Lebanon [Publisher]

2. *Sūrah Maryam*, 19:72 [Publisher]

will not reach us and no anxiety or fear shall grip our hearts. Rather, with the power of the light of our faith, we shall pass over the *ṣirāṭ* like a flash of lightning because we had already passed over that bridge before. Allah, His eminence be glorified, alludes to this very fact in the following verse:

مَنْ جَاءَ بِالْحَسَنَةِ فَلَهُ خَيْرٌ مِّنْهَا وَهُمْ مِّنْ فَرَجٍ يَوْمَئِذٍ اٰمِنُونَ<sup>1</sup>

—Part Number 20, *Sūrah an-Naml*

Meaning that: On the Day of Judgment, those who did good will be recompensed in larger measure than the good they did, and they will be secure against fear of any kind on that day. Similarly, it is stated:

يُعَذِّبُكَ لَا خَوْفَ عَلَيْكَمُ الْيَوْمَ وَلَا أَنْتُمْ تَحْزَنُونَ<sup>2</sup>

—Part Number 25, *Sūrah az-Zukhruf*

Meaning that: O My servants! You need have no fear this day nor shall you grieve.

But the person who has not walked upon *ṣirāṭ-e-mustaqīm* in this world will not be able to walk upon it at that time. He will fall into Hell and will be consumed in its fire like fuel, as Allah, glorified be His eminence, says:

وَمَنْ جَاءَ بِالسَّيِّئَةِ فَلَبَّتْ وُجُوهُهُمْ فِي النَّارِ هَلْ تُجْزَوْنَ إِلَّا مَا كُنْتُمْ تَعْمَلُونَ<sup>3</sup>

—Part Number 20

Meaning that: The evildoers will be thrown into Hell on that day, and it will be said: ‘This recompense is in reality the very deeds which you were doing in the world.’ In other words, God Almighty will not be

1. *Sūrah an-Naml*, 27:90 [Publisher]

2. *Sūrah az-Zukhruf*, 43:69 [Publisher]

3. *Sūrah an-Naml*, 27:91 [Publisher]

unjust to anybody; it will only be that the good deeds will appear actualized as Paradise and the bad deeds as Hell.

Bear in mind that the world of the Hereafter is really a reflection of this world. Just as faith and its consequences, as well as disbelief and its consequences, are manifested in a spiritual form in this world, they will assume a physical form in the world of the Hereafter. Allah, His eminence be glorified, says:

مَنْ كَانَ فِي هَذِهِ أَعْمَىٰ فَهُوَ فِي الْآخِرَةِ أَعْمَىٰ<sup>1</sup>

Meaning that: The one who is blind in this world will also be blind in that world.

We should not be surprised by this personification or embodiment and should ponder how spiritual matters appear in the world of dreams in embodied forms. The world of visions is even more wonderful than this; for, despite retaining our normal senses and being awake, we see spiritual phenomena actualized as physical objects with our very eyes. For example, we frequently meet, in perfect wakefulness, the spirits of people who passed away long ago. They appear before us in their physical bodies, in the garments of this world, just as they appeared when they were alive in this world. They speak and with God's permission, the holier from among them often inform us about certain future events which are later manifested accordingly. Often, in perfect wakefulness, one has a vision of receiving a sweet drink or some type of fruit that is extremely delicious. My humble has personally experienced all these phenomena.

From among the higher types of visions, there is one that occurs when one is perfectly awake. I have seen so much in my personal experience that some delicious food or fruit or drink appears before me from the unseen, and it is placed into the mouth by an unseen hand. The sense of taste enjoys its wonderful flavour while discussion with

1. *Sūrah Banī Isrā'īl*, 17:73 [Publisher]



people also continues and the physical senses keep functioning as normal, but this fruit or drink is also simultaneously consumed, and its taste and sweetness continues to be enjoyed in full. Indeed, that taste is far superior.

It is certainly not some illusion or unfounded theory. Rather, God, who possesses the eminent quality of:

يَكُنْ خَلْقَ عَلَيْهِ ١

demonstrates the spectacle of a certain type of creation. Thus, when we have an illustration of this kind of creation in this very world, and when we have the continuous testimony of the enlightened individuals throughout the ages in support of these phenomena, why should an intelligent person be surprised that a similar new creation and birth will occur in the Hereafter, and that the scales upon which actions are to be weighed will be visible, and that the *pul-ṣirāṭ* [a bridge the righteous will traverse to Paradise while the wicked would stumble into Hell on the Day of Judgment] and many other spiritual matters will be seen as having assumed an embodied form? Is it beyond the ability of Him who has depicted allegorical illustrations of this kind of creation to the spiritually enlightened people in this world to also manifest such creation in the world of the Hereafter? In reality, such similitudes are most appropriate for the world of the Hereafter; for, when those who have attained purification can experience creation of this kind here in this world—which is not a place of perfect spiritual detachment—why should it not be possible to see such things in the world of the Hereafter, which is a place of complete and perfect detachment?

It should be fully borne in mind that all those wondrous matters are disclosed to an enlightened person through visions in this very world, which a person lacking insight reads as though they were mere stories in the verses of the Noble Quran that speak of life in the Hereafter. Such

1. He knows every kind of creation full well (*Sūrah Yā Sīn*, 36:80). [Publisher]

statements of the Holy Quran may surprise a person whose vision cannot discern the truth. They often give rise to objections in their mind, as, for instance, the sitting of God Almighty in Judgment on His Throne; the standing of the angels in rows; the weighing of actions on the scales; the people's crossing of the *pul-ṣirāt*; slaughtering death like a goat after the meting out of punishment and reward; good and bad actions appearing to people in the form of beautiful or ugly humans; the existence of flowing rivers of milk and honey in Paradise; and so on. These are all things that appear [to such people] as being remote from truth and reasonableness. This one explanation, however, resolves all such doubts—that the world of the Hereafter is a world of analogous creations.

A fine point from among the mysteries of God Almighty is that He creates certain things in analogous forms just as they used to be otherwise. For example, you see your reflection in a mirror, and you find an exact picture of yourself, with all your features correctly reproduced in the mirror. Why should it then be a cause for wonderment if God Almighty in actual fact takes a picture of the state of spiritual affairs and imbuing it with the spirit of truth, places it before your eyes? Allah, glorified be His eminence, reveals such truths to the seekers in this very world. There will be no experience in the Hereafter the nature of which cannot be discovered in this world.

The verse: <sup>1</sup> وَإِنْ مِنْكُمْ إِلَّا وَارِدُهَا is followed by the verse: ثُمَّ نُنَجِّي الَّذِينَ اتَّقَوْا <sup>2</sup> نَكُذِّرُ الْغَالِبِينَ فِيهَا جَذَابًا. Meaning that: After consigning the people to Hell, We shall save the righteous and leave the *zālim* [iniquitous ones] in it.

Some may be perturbed here, objecting that the word 'save' implies that the person is first subjected to some punishment or torment from which they are afterwards 'saved'; meaning that it is—God forbid—inevitable that the righteous people of God must be subjected, to some minor extent at least, to the punishment of Hell and would be saved thereafter. The reply to this misconception is that the word 'save' has

1. *Sūrah Maryam*, 19:72 [Publisher]

2. *Sūrah Maryam*, 19:73 [Publisher]

not been used here in its primary sense. Here, it only means that God will make it clear that the believers were ‘saved’ people and that they had reached their goal after having been safeguarded from a place of extreme pain and sorrow.

It is the practice of Allah in the Noble Quran to use certain words in a sense other than their primary meaning, such as in the verse:

وَأَقْرَضُوا اللَّهَ قَرْضًا حَسَنًا<sup>1</sup>

meaning that, ‘Lend to Allah a goodly loan.’ Obviously, the primary meaning of ‘loan’ is that someone asks another for something at a time of need or helplessness with a promise of returning it at a later time, but Allah, glorified be His eminence, is free from need. Hence, in this context there is only one sense intended to be taken from the wording of ‘loan’—namely, in the sense of taking something that one then holds himself responsible to return at another time. In the very same manner, this verse:

وَلَنَبْلُوَنَّكُمْ بِشَيْءٍ مِّنَ الْخَوْفِ وَالْجُوعِ<sup>2</sup>

strays from the true meaning because in common usage, one who ‘tries’ another is oblivious and unaware of the outcome which arises subsequent to the trial, but here this is not the intended meaning. On the contrary, the purpose behind God Almighty’s putting someone to trial is to expose the internal vice or internal virtue of the individual under trial. In much the same way the word ‘salvation’ has been used in a sense different from its primary meanings, and this explanation is established by another verse, which is:

1. *Sūrah al-Ḥadīd*, 57:19 [Publisher]

2. And We will try you with something of fear and hunger (*Sūrah al-Baqarah*, 2:156). [Publisher]

وَيَوْمَ الْقِيَامَةِ تَرَى الَّذِينَ كَذَبُوا عَلَى اللَّهِ وُجُوهُهُم مُّسْوَدَّةٌ أَلَيْسَ فِي جَهَنَّمَ مَثْوًى لِّلْمُتَكَبِّرِينَ ۝  
وَيُنَجِّي اللَّهُ الَّذِينَ اتَّقَوْا بِمِقَادَتِهِمْ لَا يَسُغُهُمُ الشُّوْءُ وَلَا هُمْ يَحْزَنُونَ<sup>1</sup>

—Part Number 24, *Sūrah az-Zumar*

Meaning that: On the Day of Judgment, you will see that those who lied about God will have their faces blackened. (And why should they not be blackened?) Is it not befitting that the arrogant be cast into Hell? And Allah the Exalted shall save the righteous in that He shall facilitate the attainment of their desires. Evil shall not touch them and they shall not grieve.

Now, this verse is—in a manner of speaking—a commentary on the earlier verse, for it discloses the essence of ‘giving salvation’: that they will attain their desires. It also reveals that they shall be totally safe from the touch of evil on that day—not even the slightest trouble shall touch them nor shall any grief come close to them.

And this verse:

وَأِنْ مِنْكُمْ إِلَّا وَارِدُهَا<sup>2</sup>

can also have another meaning: It may, in fact, be addressed only to those people who are suffering the punishment of Hell, some of whom—on account of possessing a share of righteousness—may be saved from the chastisement, while the others continue to abide in Hell. This meaning, however, would be applicable only if the righteous, the holy, and all those who have attained a station of nearness to God are excluded from the address. But the truth is that the meaning intended by the Word of Allah, glorified be His eminence, seems to be that which I have written earlier. وَاللَّهُ أَعْلَمُ بِالصَّوَابِ وَإِلَيْهِ الْمُرْجِعُ وَالْمَأْبُ [And Allah knows best what is right and everything must be rendered back to Him].

Returning to the discussion of *ẓalūmiyyat* [i.e. being harsh upon

1. *Sūrah az-Zumar*, 39:61–62 [Publisher]

2. *Sūrah Maryam*, 19:72 [Publisher]

one's self], I would like to note that it is this very quality which a believer possesses that endears him to God Almighty. Further, it is through the blessings which proceed from it that a believer can advance to higher stages in his spiritual journey, gladly suffering unbearable torment and the burning and fierceness of the 'hells' of different kinds. That is why, when God Almighty ascribes high praises to mankind and holds them even superior to the angels, He mentions this very quality of being *ẓalūm* and *jahūl*, as He says:

وَحَمَلَهَا الْإِنْسَانُ إِنَّهُ كَانَ ظَلُومًا جَهُولًا<sup>1</sup>

Meaning that: The trust that constitutes the ultimate test from *Rabūbiyyat* [the Providence of God], which can only be borne by the most perfect servitude, was accepted by mankind, for they were *ẓalūm* and *jahūl*—that is, they could be harsh upon themselves for the sake of God Almighty and could become so distant from everything besides Allah that their mind would become devoid even of their conceptual form.

Let it be clear that we would be committing a grievous mistake if we were to take the word *ẓalūm* here to refer to a *kāfir* [disbeliever], a rebel, a polytheist, or an unjust person; for, Allah, glorified be His eminence, has used the phrase *ẓalūm jahūl* in a praiseworthy sense here and not in a derogatory sense. If, God forbid, it had been used in a derogatory sense, the meaning would be that mankind was indeed the worst of all who took on the burden of the sacred trust of God Almighty and who obeyed His command. In fact, we will have to say, God forbid, that the Prophets and Messengers of God—who were the first to carry that trust—were the ones who were the most ignorant and the most unjust people, whereas Allah, glorified be His eminence, Himself says: 'We created him in the best make.' So, how could man be the worst of creation? And the Prophets have been described as the

1. *Sūrah al-Aḥzāb*, 33:73 [Publisher]

'leaders of the just', so how can they be called *ẓalūm jahūl* according to their other meanings [i.e. unjust and ignorant]?

Apart from this, such a view of the verse amounts to finding fault with Almighty God Himself; namely, that the trust which He desired to assign to people was not something beneficent, auspicious, or blessed, but a thing of evil and mischief, because the wicked and unjust accepted it while the good people did not accept it. However, is it permissible to even entertain such an ill notion, that a thing which springs forth from the fountain of God Almighty, which He calls His trust that merits being returned to Him, should—God forbid—really be an evil and unholy thing, which no one except such an unjust person who is truly rebellious and disobedient and utterly devoid of the quality of justice would accept?

Alas! Those who entertain such repulsive notions have no conception of the greatness of God Almighty. They do not even consider that if the trust is a blessing from beginning to end, then why should its acceptance be considered an injustice? Moreover, if the trust is itself a thing of evil and mischief, then why is it being ascribed to God Almighty? Is God Almighty the originator of mischief, God forbid? Should a thing emanating from that Holy Source be called mischief and evil? Darkness seeks darkness, and light seeks light. The trust was a light and—according to the sense given earlier to the words *ẓalūm* and *jahūl*—man is also a light. Light, therefore, accepted light.

That high degree of light which was granted to man—that is to say, upon the perfect man—was not within the angels, the stars, the moon, or the sun; neither was it in the oceans and the rivers of the earth, nor was it in rubies, emeralds, sapphires, diamonds, or pearls. In short, it was not in any earthly or heavenly object. It was only in man; that is, the perfect man, whose most complete, highest and loftiest, and most perfect example was our **Lord and Master, the Chief of the Prophets, the Chief of all living ones, Muhammad, the Chosen One, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him.** So that light was bestowed upon this [perfect] man and, according to their ranks, upon all those who bear some degree of the same nature and disposition.

The trust refers to all faculties, intellect, knowledge, mind, life, senses, fear, love, honour, grandeur, and all the physical and spiritual bounties that God Almighty grants to the perfect man. Then, in compliance with the following verse, the perfect man renders all these back to His Divine Majesty [Allah]:

إِنَّ اللَّهَ يَأْمُرُكُمْ أَنْ تُؤَدُّوا الْأَمَانَاتِ إِلَىٰ أَهْلِهَا<sup>1</sup>

That is to say, he annihilates his self completely in Allah and devotes it entirely in His path, as I have explained already in describing the subject of the **essence of Islam**.

And this grand stature was found in its highest, complete, and most perfect form in our Lord, Master, and Guide, the Immaculate Prophet, the Righteous One, testified to by the righteous, **Muhammad<sup>sas</sup> Muṣṭafā, [the Chosen One]**, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him. As God Almighty Himself says in the Noble Quran:

قُلْ إِن صَلَائِي وَنُفْسِي وَمَحْيَايَ وَمَمَاتِي لِلَّهِ رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ ۝ لَا شَرِيكَ لَهُ وَبِذَلِكَ أُمِرْتُ وَأَنَا أَوَّلُ

الْمُسْلِمِينَ<sup>2</sup>

وَأَنَّ هَذَا صِرَاطِي مُسْتَقِيمًا فَاتَّبِعُوهُ وَلَا تَتَّبِعُوا السُّبُلَ فَتَفَرَّقَ بِكُمْ عَنْ سَبِيلِهِ<sup>3</sup>

قُلْ إِنْ كُنْتُمْ تُحِبُّونَ اللَّهَ فَاتَّبِعُونِي يُحْبِبْكُمُ اللَّهُ وَيَغْفِرْ لَكُمْ ذُنُوبَكُمْ وَاللَّهُ غَفُورٌ رَحِيمٌ<sup>4</sup>

فَقُلْ أَسْلَمْتُ وَجْهِيَ لِلَّهِ<sup>5</sup>

وَأُمِرْتُ أَنْ أُسْلِمَ لِرَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ<sup>6</sup>

1. Verily, Allah commands you to make over the trusts to those entitled to them (*Sūrah an-Nisā'*, 4:59). [Publisher]
2. *Sūrah al-An'ām*, 6:163–164 [Publisher]
3. *Sūrah al-An'ām*, 6:154 [Publisher]
4. *Sūrah Āl-e-Imrān*: 3:32 [Publisher]
5. *Sūrah Āl-e-Imrān*, 3:21 [Publisher]
6. *Sūrah al-Mu'min*, 40:67 [Publisher]

Meaning that: Tell them that my prayer and my striving in worship, my sacrifices, my remaining alive, and my dying, are all for the sake of and in the way of God—that same God who is the Lord of all the worlds, who has no partner. And this is what I have been commanded to do. And I am the **Foremost of the Muslims**; that is, from the beginning of the world to its end, there is no other perfect man like me to attain such a lofty degree of self-annihilation in Allah and be able to return all the trusts of God Almighty to Him.

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**

Our Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> has complete superiority over all Prophets

This verse contains a refutation of those ignorant Unitarians who hold the belief that our Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, is not proven to have complete superiority over the other Prophets, and who say, on the basis of *ahādīth* of weak authenticity, that the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, has forbidden that he be given superiority even over Yūnus bin Mattā [Jonah son of Amittai].<sup>1</sup> These ignorant people do not realize that even if that hadith is authentic, it is only an expression of humility and modesty, which was ever the way of our Master, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him. There is a time and occasion for everything. How ignorant and mischievous it would be if a righteous man, who describes himself in a letter as 'the lowliest of all servants of Allah', were to truly be considered the worst of all people of the world, to the extent of being even worse than the idolaters and all transgressors, because he himself acknowledges that he is the lowliest of all servants of Allah!

Think it over carefully. Allah, glorified be His eminence, names the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, as

1. *Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī, Kitāb Aḥādīthul-Anbiyā'*, Bāb Qaulullāh Ta'ālā: Wa Inna Yūnusa Laminul-Mursalīn, Hadith 3412 [Publisher]



the first of the Muslims and He holds him to be the head of all who obey and submit and describes **the Holy Prophet to be the first to fulfil the *amānat*<sup>1</sup> given to him. Is there any room left after this for a believer in the Noble Quran** to raise any type of objection concerning the high spiritual station of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him? In the verse cited above, God Almighty, after setting forth the various stages in Islam, has determined the highest stage to be that which was imbued in the nature of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him. سُبْحَانَ اللَّهِ مَا أَكْظَمَ شَأْنَكَ يَا رَسُولَ اللَّهِ [Holy is Allah! How magnificent is your grandeur, O Messenger of Allah!]

مُوسَىٰ وَ عِيسَىٰ هُمَا خَلِيلِ تَوَانِدُ      جَمْلُهُ دَرِينِ رَاهِ طَفِيلِ تَوَانِدُ  
*Mūsā [Moses] and 'Isā [Jesus] are all among your tribe;*  
*They have all benefited from the same path of yours.*

Then the remaining translation [of the verses quoted earlier] is as follows. Allah, glorified be His eminence, addressing His Messenger, says: Tell them, my path alone is the path that is straight, so you should follow it and do not tread along other paths because they will lead you away from God Almighty. Tell them that if you love God Almighty, come and walk faithfully behind me—that is to say, tread upon my path, which is the lofty essence of Islam; then, God Almighty will also love you and will forgive your sins. Tell them that my path is that I have been commanded to devote my entire being to God Almighty and to sincerely and entirely belong to *Rabbul-'ālāmīn* [the Lord of all the worlds]; that is, by annihilating myself in Him, I should

1. *Amānat* (Trust) refers to the Divine Law of the Quran. Of all creation, only the Holy Prophet<sup>sa</sup>, *al-Insān*—the Perfect Man—was found worthy of receiving and fulfilling this Trust, owing to his unmatched spiritual perfection and capacity to discharge this final and most sacred responsibility. [Publisher]

make myself a servant of all the worlds, just as He is the Lord of all the worlds, and that I should become devoted completely to Him and to His path. So, I have turned over to God Almighty my entire being and all that belonged to me; now, nothing belongs to me—all that is mine is His.

#### AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE

Reply to the misgiving as to whether any earlier scholar ascribed such meanings to this verse

The misgiving as to who among the earlier scholars has ascribed such meaning to the verse containing the words *ẓalūm* and *jahūl*—or who from among the [Arabic] linguists gives this interpretation to the word *ẓulm*—may be answered as follows: We require no authority besides the Word of Allah. Certain passages of the Divine Word elucidate others. Thus, considering that Allah Almighty has referred to some of the righteous also as *ẓālim*, and has also identified the initial stage of the three levels of *taqwā* [piety] as *ẓulm*, we understand with absolute conviction and certainty that the term *ẓulm* here does not refer to the *ẓulm* that is far from *taqwā* and is the characteristic of disbelievers, polytheists, and the disobedient. Rather, the *ẓulm* referred to here is the necessary condition encountered by the righteous in the initial stages of the spiritual journey—namely, waging war against one's base desires and striving to diminish the darkness of human frailties within oneself. The meaning of diminishing is also ascribed to the word *ẓulm* in the verse: **وَلَمْ تَظْلِمْ** **وَلَمْ تَنْقُصْ** **مِنْهُ شَيْئًا**<sup>1</sup> —which means [and did not diminish anything therefrom]. See *Qāmūs*, *Ṣiḥāḥ*, and *Ṣarāḥ*, where *ẓulm* is also explained as 'to diminish,' and this verse has been interpreted accordingly. Meaning **وَلَمْ تَنْقُصْ**.

#### AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE

My humble self is not alone in adopting these meanings

Moreover, this humble one is not alone in positing this meaning. Eminent researchers and scholars who were native [Arabic]

1. *Sūrah al-Kahf*, 18:34 [Publisher]

speakers have given it the very same meaning. From among them is the author [i.e. Muḥy-ud-Dīn ibn al-‘Arabī<sup>rtta</sup>] of *Futūḥāt-e-Makkiyyah* who was also a native speaker. In one of his commentaries, which was printed and published in Egypt, he gives this very meaning to this verse. Hence, in explaining *ẓalūm* and *jahūl* in the verse:

وَحَبَّهَا الْإِنْسَانُ إِنَّهُ كَانَ ظَلُومًا جَهُولًا<sup>1</sup>

he has written that these words are used here in a commendatory sense. The meaning is that a believer, in fulfilling God’s commandments, exercises *ẓulm* upon his own self in such a way that he opposes the inclinations and desires of the lower self, thereby subduing and diminishing its impulses.

The author of *Tafsīr-e-Ḥusainī*, quoting from the commentary of Khwājah Muhammad Parsa, says that the meaning of the verse is that man bore this trust because he was *ẓalūm*—that is, he possessed the ability to rise above his own self and its desires. That is to say, he could diminish, or even eliminate, his base desires and become absorbed in the Absolute, and they were *jahūl* because they had the power of altogether forgetting and becoming totally unaware of everything besides God, and, in accordance with the words لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ [there is no one worthy of worship except Allah], negate the existence of everything besides God.

**Ibn Jarīr**, too, who is the Chief of Commentators, in commenting upon this verse, writes that the words *ẓalūm* and *jahūl* have been used in a praiseworthy sense and not in a derogatory one.

In short, the great scholars and researchers, whose eyes Allah Almighty had illumined with the light of understanding, have mostly inclined toward this interpretation: that the only possible meaning of this verse is that man, by taking on the trust of Allah Almighty, earned

1. *Sūrah al-Aḥzāb*, 33:73 [Publisher]

the titles *ẓalūm* and *jahūl* in a commendatory sense, not in a derogatory one. Ibn Kathīr has also given some citations in support of this view.

If we carefully reflect on this entire verse—

إِنَّا عَرَضْنَا الْأَمَانَةَ عَلَى السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَالْجِبَالِ فَأَبَيْنَ أَنْ يَحْمِلْنَهَا وَأَشْفَقْنَ مِنْهَا وَحَمَلَهَا  
الْإِنْسَانُ إِنَّهُ كَانَ ظَلُومًا جَهُولًا<sup>1</sup>

it becomes certain that the trust was offered to the angels, the earth, the mountains, and all the heavenly bodies and yet they refused to bear it. Then it was offered to human beings—undoubtedly it must have been offered to the souls of the Prophets and Messengers in the first instance, because they were the leaders of mankind and the first to deserve the appellation of humanity in its true sense. Therefore, if the meanings of *ẓalūm* and *jahūl* were to be taken in the sense in which they are used for a disbeliever, polytheist, or a confirmed rebel, then—God forbid—the first to deserve these epithets would be the Prophets. Hence, this point is extremely clear and self-evident that the terms *ẓalūm* and *jahūl* are used here in the sense of praise, and it is obvious that to accept the command of God Almighty and to turn away from it [i.e. contrary to its literal meaning] cannot be cause for disobedience to God. It is actually a source of blessing and prosperity. How, then, can the literal meanings of *ẓalūm* and *jahūl*, which inherently imply defiance and rebellion, be appropriate in this context?

Anyone well-versed in the modes of expression of the Noble Quran will not fail to recognize that, at times, the Most Gracious and Merciful, exalted be His Majesty, employs words for His chosen servants that may appear unflattering on the surface, but in meaning, they are highly

1. Verily We offered the trust to the heavens and the earth and the mountains, but they refused to bear it and were afraid of it. But the man bore it. Indeed, he was too cruel to *himself*, unmindful of the consequences (*Sūrah al-Aḥzāb*, 33:73). [Publisher]

praiseworthy and commendatory. For example, Allah, glorified be His eminence, said regarding His Noble Prophet:

وَجَدَكَ ضَالًّا فَهَدَىٰ ۝<sup>1</sup>

Obviously, the well-known and familiar meaning of the term ضَالٌّ—*dāll*, which the linguists are also fond to cite, is ‘astray’. According to this understanding, the verse would mean, ‘(O Messenger of Allah!) God Almighty found you misguided and guided you’, whereas the fact is that the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, was never misguided. Anyone who professes to be a Muslim yet believes that the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> engaged in an act of misguidance at any point in his life, is a *kāfir* [disbeliever], devoid of faith, and deserving of punishment under Islamic law.

Here the verse should be assigned a meaning consistent with the context, which is the following: Allah, glorified be His eminence, first stated about the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him:

أَلَمْ يَجِدَكَ يَتِيمًا فَآوَىٰ ۝ وَجَدَكَ ضَالًّا فَهَدَىٰ ۝ وَجَدَكَ عَائِلًا فَأَغْنَىٰ ۝<sup>2</sup>

Meaning that: God Almighty found you an orphan and helpless, and He gave you shelter with Himself and found you *dāll* (meaning that deeply in love with the Countenance of Allah) and therefore He drew you towards Himself and He found you indigent and enriched you.

The following verses, which occur after the above, support the validity of these meanings:

1. *Sūrah aḍ-Ḍuḥā*, 93:8 [Publisher]

2. *Sūrah aḍ-Ḍuḥā*, 93:7–9 [Publisher]

فَأَمَّا الْيَتِيمَ فَلَا تَقْهَرْ ۝ وَأَمَّا السَّائِلَ فَلَا تَنْهَرْ ۝ وَأَمَّا بِنِعْمَةِ رَبِّكَ فَحَدِّثْ ۝<sup>1</sup>

The reason is that all these verses are arranged in a coherent sequence, and the subsequent verses elaborate and clarify the implicit meanings contained in the earlier verses. For example, it is first stated: ۝ أَلَمْ يَجِدْكَ يَتِيمًا فَآوَى ۝ [Sūrah ad-Duḥā, 93:7]. Corresponding to this, it was [later] stated: ۝ فَأَمَّا الْيَتِيمَ فَلَا تَقْهَرْ ۝ [Sūrah ad-Duḥā, 93:10]; meaning that: 'Remember! You were also an orphan and We provided refuge for you. Similarly, you should also give refuge to orphans.' Then, after this verse, it was said: ۝ وَوَجَدَكَ ضَالًّا فَهَدَى ۝ [Sūrah ad-Duḥā, 93:8]. Corresponding to this, it was stated: ۝ وَأَمَّا السَّائِلَ فَلَا تَنْهَرْ ۝ . [Sūrah ad-Duḥā, 93:11]; meaning that: 'Remember that you, too, once pleaded for Our nearness and longed to behold Our beauty and were a seeker of Our truths and verities. Thus, just as We nurtured you physically like a father, so too did We, in place of a teacher, open all the doors of knowledge for you. We granted you the sweet drink of *liqā* [communion] more abundantly than any other. Whatever you asked for, We granted you. Therefore, do not turn away those who ask, nor rebuke them. Remember that you were عَائِلٌ—*ā'il* [indigent], and apparent means of livelihood were entirely cut off from you; and so God Himself became your Guardian and freed you from the need to turn to others for help. You had no need to depend on a father, nor a mother, nor a teacher, nor did you need to seek assistance from anyone else. Rather, all these matters were taken care of by Allah Almighty Himself, and from the moment of your birth, He took you under His care. [Sūrah ad-Duḥā, 93:8]. Therefore, be grateful to Him and treat the needy in like manner [Sūrah ad-Duḥā, 93:11].'

Comparing all these verses with one another, it becomes very clear that the word *dāll* here does not mean the one who has lost his way.

1. So the orphan, oppress not, And as for the beggar, chide him not, And as for the bounty of your Lord, do relate it to others (Sūrah ad-Duḥā, 93:10–12). [Publisher]

Rather, it is an indication of the highest degree of ardent love, as, for example, there is a similar verse about Ḥaḍrat Ya‘qūb [Jacob]:

إِنَّكَ لَفِي ضَلَالِكَ الْقَدِيرِ ١

Although the words ظلم [*ẓulm*] and ضلالت [*ḍalālat*] also refer to someone who abandons the path of moderation and justice and yields to the base or animalistic desires, the Noble Quran also employs them in reference to those ardent lovers of God Almighty who, intoxicated with divine love, crush their own selves and its passions under their feet. This couplet of Ḥāfiẓ of Shiraz addresses the same subject:

آسمان بارِ امانت نتوانست کشید      قرمه قال بنام من دیوانه زدند  
*The heavens could not bear the burden of the trust;*  
*It fell to the lot of a mad one like me.*

Ḥāfiẓ interprets ‘madness’ as a state of passionate love and intense eagerness for obedience.

In short, the real meaning of these verses is indeed that which God Almighty has disclosed to me, and I shall never ascribe a meaning which would dictate that, firstly, it was not a sacred trust from God Almighty, but was something to do with mischief, which was taken on by an unjust mischief-maker and not by the virtuous; and, secondly, that all the holy Messengers and Prophets, who are the first bearers of the trust, should be considered to be unjust.

I have already explained that the trust and the reality of Islam are in fact, one and the same thing, and both of these are praiseworthy and indicate that whatever is granted by God Almighty should be returned to Him alone, just as a trust is returned. Therefore, why should one who accepts a praiseworthy and desirable thing, does not turn away

1. You are assuredly in your old *ḍalālat* (*Sūrah Yūsuf*, 12:96). [Publisher]

from the command of Allah Almighty, and prioritizes His will over his own, be deemed worthy of blame?

It should also be remembered that after this verse God Almighty says:

لَيَعَذِّبَ اللَّهُ الْمُنَافِقِينَ وَالْمُنَافِقَاتِ وَالْمُشْرِكِينَ وَالْمُشْرِكَاتِ وَيَتُوبَ اللَّهُ عَلَى الْمُؤْمِنِينَ وَالْمُؤْمِنَاتِ وَكَانَ اللَّهُ غَفُورًا رَحِيمًا<sup>1</sup>

Meaning that: That is, when man accepted the trust from Allah, it necessitated that the hypocrite men and hypocrite women, and the polytheist men and polytheist women, who only accepted it verbally but did not adhere to it in practice, would be punished. On the other hand, the believing men and women, who accepted the trust and also adhered to it in practice, would become recipients of Allah's mercy.

This verse, too, speaks out clearly and unequivocally that *ḡalūm* and *jahūl* in the verse under discussion refer to the believers whose natures and capacities accepted the trust and then remained steadfast upon it; for, it is abundantly clear that the polytheists and hypocrites did not fully accept it. The addition of the [definite article] *alif lām* in the phrase *حَمَلَهَا الْإِنْسَانُ* is really for the purpose of particularizing. This proves Allah's intent that not all human beings fully accepted the trust—only the believers did. Though the hypocrites and polytheists possessed a slight capacity for it, they could not fully partake in this beloved title of *ḡalūm* and *jahūl* due to the deficiency of their capacity. But those who had been granted greater strength fully embraced this blessing. They did not merely acknowledge this trust with their tongues; they demonstrated it through their actions and deeds, and returned to Him the trust, which they had received, with the utmost integrity.

Lastly, it should also be clear that the word *jahūl*, like the word *ḡalūm*, has been used in the sense that is compatible with righteousness and holiness. For, if its true meaning were intended—namely,

1. *Sūrah al-Aḥzāb*, 33:74 [Publisher]



ignorance of religious sciences and of correct beliefs, and indulgence in falsehood and vain pursuits—it would clearly be contrary to the qualities of the righteous, since true *taqwā* [piety] cannot coexist with ignorance. True *taqwā* is accompanied by a light, as Allah, His eminence be glorified, has said:

يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا إِن تَتَّقُوا اللَّهَ يَجْعَلْ لَكُمْ فُرْقَانًا وَيُكَفِّرْ عَنْكُمْ سَيِّئَاتِكُمْ<sup>1</sup> وَيَجْعَلْ لَكُمْ نُورًا  
تَمْشُونَ بِهِ<sup>2</sup>

This means, ‘O you who believe, if you remain steadfast in piety and firmly establish the quality of *taqwā* for the sake of Allah, then Allah will place a distinction between you and others. This distinction is that you will be granted a light by which you will walk in all your paths—meaning, this light will permeate all your actions, words, faculties, and senses. Your intellect will be illuminated, and even your intuitive thoughts will be filled with radiance. There will be light in your eyes. In your ears, in your tongues, in your speech, and in your every movement and stillness, there will be light. The paths you tread will become illuminated. In short, all your paths—the paths of your faculties and senses—will be filled with light, and you will walk immersed in light from head to toe.

It is now clearly proven by this verse that righteousness cannot exist alongside ignorance. Yes, understanding and perception can vary in degree according to the levels of piety attained by a person. It is also clear in this context that the great and most excellent miracle granted to *Auliya’ullāh* [the Friends of Allah]—who have attained a place of eminence in the practice of virtue—is that in all their senses, their intellect, and their understanding and thoughts, there is placed a light. Through the waters of bright visions, their spiritual power attains a purity not granted to others; their senses become extremely perceptive,

1. *Sūrah al-Anfāl*, 8:30 [Publisher]

2. *Sūrah al-Ḥadīd*, 57:29 [Publisher]

the pure springs of knowledge and subtleties are opened to them, and the sweet blessings of the Almighty flow through their veins and fibres like blood.

Now, I turn once again to the main discussion concerning the nature of Islam. It has already been explained what Islam is and what its true essence entails. Following this, it is essential to discuss how this reality, which is called Islam, can be attained, and what means the Noble Quran has prescribed for its attainment.

First, it is essential to understand that the 'means of something' refers only to that which, when employed correctly and appropriately, inevitably leads to the desired outcome; whereas using its opposite results in deviation and failure.

After this, it should be understood that although the Noble Quran has described many means for attaining the reality of Islam, in truth, they all ultimately fall into just two categories: First, that a person should achieve full and complete faith in the existence of God Almighty, in His perfect Lordship, His absolute power and sovereignty; in His perfect knowledge, His judgment, and His being One without any partner; in the fact of His being حَيٌّ قَيُّوْمٌ [*Hayyun Qayyūmun*—Self-Existing and All-Sustaining]; in His being Omnipresent, All-Seeing, All-Powerful, Eternal, and Everlasting; and, in His being Peerless in all His powers, capabilities, and utmost glory and perfection; so much so that every particle of one's being, as well as of the entire universe, should be seen to be under His control and command; and a picture of هُوَ الْقَاهِرُ فَوْقَ عِبَادِهِ [God is supreme over His servants] should appear before one's eyes. Moreover, it should be inscribed upon the heart's tablet in clear and bold letters that, بِيَدِهِ مَلَكُوتُ السَّمٰوٰتِ وَالْاَرْضِ ['in God's hand are the kingdoms of the heavens and the earth'] so much so that the grandeur, awe, and greatness of God should overpower and replace all the passions of the self with the dazzling rays of their glory, cast an abiding influence over the heart. Moreover, by launching an overpowering attack upon the throne of carnal self, they cast it into the dust of disgrace and shatter it into pieces. With their awe-inspiring manifestations, they

demolish the walls of heedlessness, topple the towers of arrogance, and completely uproot the reigns of human darkness from the dominion of human existence and destroy, disgrace, and demonstrate the insignificance and worthlessness of the passions of *nafs-e-ammārah* [the self that incites to evil] that were hitherto ruling the human heart and were regarded as honourable.

Second, that one should develop a thorough acquaintance with the beauty and beneficence of Allah, glorified be His eminence; For, perfect love is born either through beauty or through benevolence. The beauty of Allah, glorified be His eminence, comprises the excellences of His being and attributes. These excellences are that He is pure goodness, the fountain of all grace, and the source of all bounties. He combines all perfections in Himself; He is the Refuge of everything; He is the Creator and Fashioner of all beings; He is the Ultimate Cause of all causes, and the effect or ineffectiveness of every cause is entirely within His control at every moment. He is One, without partner in His being, attributes, words, actions, and in all His perfections. He is Eternal and Everlasting, encompassing all perfect attributes. He is supremely Benevolent and exceedingly Merciful. Though He holds absolute power to punish, He forgives the transgressions of thousands of years in but a single moment of sincere repentance. He is very Gentle, Forbearing, and the Concealer of faults, who sees millions of hateful actions and despicable sins, yet does not hasten to punish. If His spiritual beauty were to appear in visible form, all hearts would fall down to Him like moths. However, He concealed His beauty from others and revealed it only to those who seek Him with sincerity.

He has cast a reflection of His beauty upon every beautiful object, whether it was the sun, moon, or stars, which appear so lovely in their glittering brightness; or the faces of beautiful human beings that look so attractive and charming; or the fresh, bedewed, and pretty flowers which, through their hues, fragrance, and brilliance, draw hearts towards themselves. In reality, all these partake, but as a mere speck, in the eternal and unfading beauty [of God], reflecting it in but a

shadowed form. This beauty is not mere assumption, nor an idle fancy, nor a fleeting thought; rather, it is a certainty—definitive and radiant—so resplendent that its very vision blinds the eyes of all, and pure hearts are ever drawn towards it.

The favours of this True Beloved upon man cannot be contained in tomes, for His favours are innumerable. He sees sin upon sin, yet He continues to bestow grace upon grace. Indeed, neither person X nor Y can do us any good, nor can the sun benefit us by its light, nor the moon, nor the stars, nor their influences; similarly, no friend can be of any use, nor son; in short, nothing can bring us comfort unless He so wills. This shows that the fulfilment of our needs through countless and innumerable means is, in truth, by the grace of the True Benefactor. So, who can count His blessings? If we speak justly, we must bear witness that no one has loved us as He has.

Both of these means, upon which depends the attainment of the perfect truth of Islam, are indicated in the following verse of the Noble Quran:

*Sūrah Fāṭir, Juzw<sup>2</sup> No. 22—*اِنَّكَ يَخْشَى اللّٰهَ مِنْ عِبَادٍ الْعُلَمَاءُ<sup>1</sup>

Meaning that: those who fear Allah, the Glorious, are the ones who have complete knowledge of His greatness, power, *ihsān* [benevolence], beauty, and majesty. In fact, based on the essence of their meanings, fear [of Allah] and Islam are, in reality, one and the same in their essence, because the concept of perfect fear [of Allah] is inherently encompassed in the concept of Islam. Therefore, the ultimate meaning and conclusion of this noble verse is that the primary means of attaining Islam is the knowledge of the greatness of Allah's essence and attributes, which I have already elaborated upon. Indeed, this is precisely what is alluded to in the verse:

1. *Sūrah Fāṭir*, 35:29 [Publisher]

2. A *juzw* comprises sixteen pages. [Publisher]

يُؤْتِي الْحِكْمَةَ مَنْ يَشَاءُ ۚ وَمَنْ يُؤْتَ الْحِكْمَةَ فَقَدْ أُوتِيَ خَيْرًا كَثِيرًا<sup>1</sup>

Meaning that: God Almighty bestows wisdom upon whomsoever He pleases, and he who is granted wisdom is given abundant good.

‘Wisdom’ refers to knowledge of the greatness of the Being and attributes of God, the Maker, and ‘abundant good’ refers to Islam, as is mentioned by Allah, glorified be His eminence, in the Noble Quran:

هُوَ خَيْرٌ مِمَّا يَجْمَعُونَ<sup>2</sup>

Then, in another verse He says:

قُلْ رَبِّ زِدْنِي عِلْمًا<sup>3</sup>

Meaning that: My Lord! Grant me perfect knowledge of Your greatness and cognition of Your ways and Your attributes.

And then at another place He said:

وَبِذَلِكَ أُمِرْتُ وَأَنَا أَوَّلُ الْمُسْلِمِينَ<sup>4</sup>

By combining these two verses, it becomes clear that our Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, was designated as the foremost among the Muslims because he possessed the greatest knowledge of divine understanding. In other words, his understanding of the divine realities surpassed that of all others. For this reason, his Islam is also the highest of all and he is the foremost of the Muslims. Another

1. *Sūrah al-Baqarah*, 2:270 [Publisher]

2. That is better than what they hoard (*Sūrah Yūnus*, 10:59). [Publisher]

3. *Sūrah Ṭā Hā*, 20:115 [Publisher]

4. And so am I commanded, and I am the first of those who submit (*Sūrah al-An‘ām*, 6:164). [Publisher]

verse also points to this vastness of his knowledge as Allah, glorified be His eminence, says:

<sup>1</sup>Part Number 5—وَعَلَّمَكَ مَا لَمْ تَكُنْ تَعْلَمُ وَكَانَ فَضْلُ اللَّهِ عَلَيْكَ عَظِيمًا

Meaning that: God Almighty granted you knowledge that you could not have attained on your own, and through divine grace, His blessings have been bestowed upon you in the greatest measure. In other words, you surpassed all others in the knowledge of divine realities, mysteries, and spiritual wisdom, and Allah has adorned you most abundantly with the fragrance of His divine understanding. Thus, God Almighty has appointed knowledge and understanding as the means of attaining the true essence of Islam.

There are other means for attaining the essence of Islam—like fasting, Prayer, supplication, and carrying out all the commandments of Allah—which exceed six hundred in number; however, knowledge of the greatness of God, the Oneness of His Being, and cognizance of His ways and attributes of glory and beauty of the Lord, the Maker, hallowed be His name, is the means of all means and everything else depends upon it. For, how can one who has a heedless heart and is utterly bereft of the cognition of God gain the ability to observe the Fast, perform Prayer, make supplication, or occupy himself with the doing of good works and charity? All these righteous actions are prompted by cognition of the Divine and all these other means are in reality born from it and are like its sons and daughters.

The beginning of this knowledge stems from the reflection of God's *Rahmānīyat* [Divine Graciousness] and is not the result of any action or prayer but is a gift of pure grace. يَهْدِي مَنْ يَشَاءُ وَيُضِلُّ مَنْ يَشَاءُ [He guides whom He wills and He adjudges astray whom He wills]. But then this cognition grows further through righteous deeds and the perfection of faith, until finally, taking the form of *ilhām* [divine revelation] and the

1. *Sūrah an-Nisā'*, 4:114 [Publisher]

descent of God's word, it illumines the entire expanse of the heart with the light that is known as Islam.

At this stage of perfect cognition, Islam ceases to be a mere word; rather, all its essential reality, that I have described, is attained. The human soul, in utmost humility, lays its head before the Divine Presence. Then, from both sides, are heard the words: 'Whatever is mine is yours.' That is, the soul of the servant declares and affirms: 'O my Lord, whatever belongs to me is Yours. And God Almighty responds, giving glad tidings: 'O My servant, all that is with Me—the heavens, the earth, and all else—is with you.' It is this exalted station that is indicated in the verse:

قُلْ يٰٓعِبَادِىَ الَّذِىْنَ اَسْرَفُوْا عَلٰۤى اَنْفُسِهِمْ لَا تَقْنَطُوْا مِنْ رَّحْمَةِ اللّٰهِ اِنَّ اللّٰهَ يَغْفِرُ الذُّنُوْبَ جَمِیْعًا<sup>1</sup>

*Part Number 24, Sūrah az-Zumar—*

Meaning that: 'Say: O My servants who have committed excesses against your own selves, you should not despair of the mercy of Allah, God Almighty will forgive all sins.'

In this verse, instead of قُلْ يٰٓعِبَادِ اللّٰهِ, which means, 'Say, O servants of God Almighty,' the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, was commanded to say قُلْ يٰٓعِبَادِىَ meaning, 'Say, O my servants.' The secret behind revealing this verse in this form is indeed that God Almighty wishes to convey the good news of His limitless mercies and thus comfort those who are broken-hearted because of their excess of sins. Thus, Allah, glorified be His eminence, intended in this verse to present an example of His mercies, and to show His servant the extent to which He honours His faithful servants with special favours. By adopting the form قُلْ يٰٓعِبَادِىَ [Say, O my servants], in effect, God said: 'Behold this beloved Messenger of mine! Observe the rank that this eminent servant has arrived at through his perfect obedience to Me, that now, all that is Mine is his; the person who desires salvation

1. Sūrah az-Zumar, 39:54 [Publisher]

should become his servant; he should obey him so perfectly as if he was his slave. Then, whatever sins he might have committed earlier will be forgiven.' Bear in mind that the word عَبْد [ʿabd] in Arabic idiom also means 'a slave', as Allah, glorified be His eminence, says:

وَعَبْدٌ مُّؤْمِنٌ خَيْرٌ مِّنْ مُّشْرِكٍ<sup>1</sup>

The verse [39:54] indicates that whoever seeks salvation must forge a bond of servitude with this Prophet—meaning, he must never step outside his commandments and must hold fast to his obedience, just as a devoted servant is bound to his master's will. Only then shall he attain salvation. In this regard, one pities the spiritually blind and so-called *Muwahhids* [upholders of the Oneness of Allah]: for, they harbour such deep enmity towards our Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, that they consider names like Ghulām Nabī, Ghulām Rasūl, Ghulām Muṣṭafā, Ghulām Aḥmad and Ghulām Muḥammad being tantamount to *shirk* [associating partners with God]; whereas the verse indicates that these names are the very means of salvation. Since the essence of عَبْد [ʿabd—slave] includes renouncing every kind of freedom and self-will and becoming completely obedient to one's master, seekers after truth are urged that, if they desire salvation, they should cultivate this state in themselves. And, in reality, this verse and the following verse:

قُلْ إِنْ كُنْتُمْ تُحِبُّونَ اللَّهَ فَاتَّبِعُونِي يُحْبِبْكُمُ اللَّهُ وَيَغْفِرْ لَكُمْ ذُنُوبَكُمْ<sup>2</sup>

both have the same connotation. Perfect devotion necessitates the kind of complete absorption and absolute obedience that is inherent in the

1. Even a believing slave is better than an idolater (*Sūrah al-Baqarah*, 2:222). [Publisher]

2. Say, 'If you love Allah, follow me: then will Allah love you and forgive you your faults (*Sūrah Āl-e-Imrān*, 3:32). [Publisher]



concept of عبد [*abd*—slave]. This is why the first verse contains not only the promise of forgiveness but also the glad tidings of becoming the beloved of Allah. Essentially, the verse, قُلْ يٰٓاِبَادِى [Say, ‘O my servants’], in effect means, قُلْ يٰٓاَتَّبِعِى; that is, ‘Say O my followers who are beset by numerous sins, despair not of the mercy of Allah’; for Allah, glorified be His eminence, through the blessing of your following me, will forgive all your sins. If عِبَادُ [*ibād*] is taken to mean only the creatures of Allah, the meaning becomes flawed; for, it is absolutely incorrect to say that God Almighty would just forgive all idol worshippers and disbelievers without the condition of faith being fulfilled and the requirement of obedience being met. Such an interpretation would be clearly contrary to the explicit text of the Holy Quran.

Remember here that the essence of this verse is that, ‘O Messenger of Allah, those who wholeheartedly become your servants shall be granted the light of faith, love, and devotion that will liberate them from all that is besides Allah.’ They will be freed from sins, and a pure life will be granted to them in this very world. They will be brought out of the dark and confining graves of carnal desires and passions. The same is indicated by the hadith: <sup>1</sup> اَنَا الْخَاشِعُ الَّذِي يُخَشِّرُ النَّاسَ عَلَى قَدَمِي. That is, I am that raiser of the dead at whose footsteps the dead are raised.

Let it be clear that the Noble Holy Quran is filled with the expression that the world had died, and Allah Almighty revived it anew by sending His Prophet, *Khātamul-Anbiyā*’ [the Seal of the Prophets], may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, as is said:

اعْلَمُوا أَنَّ اللَّهَ يُحْيِى الْأَرْضَ بَعْدَ مَوْتِهَا<sup>2</sup>

Meaning that: Take heed that Allah Almighty revives the earth after its death.

1. *Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī*, Kitābul-Manāqib, Bāb Mā Jā’a fī Asmā’ Rasūlullāh<sup>ṣas</sup>, Hadith 3532 [Publisher]

2. *Sūrah al-Ḥadīd*, 57:18 [Publisher]

Accordingly, He states in regard to the Companions—may Allah be pleased with them—of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him:

وَأَيَّدَهُم بِرُوحٍ مِنْهُ<sup>1</sup>

Meaning that: God helped them with the Holy Spirit and the help of the Holy Spirit is that it enlivens the hearts, delivers from spiritual death, bestows pure faculties, pure senses, and pure knowledge, and conveys to the station of nearness to God Almighty through certainty of knowledge and conclusive arguments. For, only those are close to Him who know for a certainty that He exists, and know with certainty that His powers, mercies, punishments, and judgments are all true, and that He is the Source of all graces, and the Fountainhead of the entire system of the universe, and the Ultimate Cause of the entire chain of causes and effects, and, moreover, that He is the Sovereign by will, in whose hands lies the entire dominion of the heavens and the earth.

This knowledge, which is the means of salvation, cannot be attained with certainty and definitiveness except through the life that is granted to man by the Holy Spirit. The Noble Quran claims loudly and emphatically that that spiritual life is obtained only through following this Noble Messenger and that all those people who repudiate obedience to this Noble Prophet are dead and lack the spirit of that life. Here, 'spiritual life' refers to those human faculties of knowledge and action that are brought to life by the assistance of the Holy Spirit.

It is proved from the Noble Quran that those commandments upon which Allah, glorified be His eminence, wishes humankind to become established are 600. In consonance with this, the wings of Jibrā'il, peace be upon him, are also 600. Till the egg of humanness bearing these 600 commandments upon its head comes to lie under the wings of Jibrā'il, the hatchling of being completely lost in Allah is

1. *Sūrah al-Mujādalah*, 58:23 [Publisher]

not born from it. Human nature has within it the capacity of 600 eggs. A person whose 600 eggs of capability are sheltered under the 600 wings of Jibrā'il is the perfect human whose spiritual birth is perfect and whose life is perfect.

Careful consideration reveals that the spiritual children of the egg of humanness—who were born through the Holy Spirit by the blessing of following the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him—are more perfect and complete than the spiritual children of all other Prophets, whether in their number or in their quality, appearance, nature, or condition. It is to this that Allah, glorified be His eminence, alludes when He says:

كُنْتُمْ خَيْرَ أُمَّةٍ أُخْرِجَتْ لِلنَّاسِ<sup>1</sup>

Meaning that: You are the best of people because you have been created for the reformation of mankind.

In reality, the extent of the special excellences of Quranic teachings bears witness to the excellent qualities of this blessed Ummah because the Books revealed by Allah, glorified be His eminence, inevitably descend only to the measure to which the people who are charged with carrying out the commandments possess the ability to do so. For example, all authorities agree that the teachings of the Gospel are not perfect; it continuously emphasises just one aspect, ignoring the other side altogether. In reality, this is the fault of the capacity of those for whom the Gospel was revealed. As God Almighty has advanced human faculties through a process of evolution, many of the people of earlier times were comparatively weaker in intelligence, sagacity, and understanding. They were frail-hearted, weak of resolve, poor of faith, and low in thinking. They were entangled in worldly greed. Their intellectual and mental powers were very weak. But then came the time of our Chief and Leader, the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of

1. *Sūrah Āl-e-Imrān*, 3:111 [Publisher]

Allah be upon him, when human capabilities had advanced gradually and over time. It was as if the world had assumed—from the point of view of human nature—a completely new appearance altogether. So, in accordance with their perfect capabilities, the perfect teaching was revealed.

## FOOTNOTE<sup>1</sup>

The translation of these verses<sup>2</sup> is:

I swear by the heaven and by that which comes in the night.  
And what knowledge have as to what it is that comes at night?  
It is a glittering star. And the statement is made under oath to  
affirm that there is not a single living thing that does not have a  
guardian over it; that is to say, over everything from among His  
created beings, there is an angel that has been appointed who  
protects it and constantly accompanies it.

God Almighty has stated this verse with an all comprehensive scope by  
qualifying it with the word **كُلُّ** [*kull*—meaning ‘all’]; thus, it is clearly  
proven that everything to which the word *nafs* [individual thing,  
body, soul] can be applied is safeguarded by angels. Hence, according  
to this verse, we must believe about the celestial bodies that **all stel-  
lar objects—the Sun, the Moon, Saturn, Jupiter**—are under the  
protection of angels. That is, for each of them—Sun and the Moon,  
etc.—an angel is appointed who safeguards it and runs its functions  
appropriately.<sup>3</sup> ☆

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1. **Footnote** is referenced from the main text on page 97. [Publisher]

2. The reference is to *Sūrah at-Ṭāriq*, 86:2–5: **وَالسَّمَاءِ وَالطَّارِقِ ۝ وَمَا أَدْرَاكَ مَا الطَّارِقُ ۝ النُّجُومِ الثَّاقِبُ ۝ إِنَّ كُلَّ نَفْسٍ لَّهَآ عَلَيْهَا حَافِظٌ ۝** [Publisher]

3. ☆ **Note:** This theme is further supported by this verse: **وَلَقَدْ زَيَّنَّا السَّمَاءَ الدُّنْيَا بِمَصَابِيحَ ۖ وَجَعَلْنَاهَا رُجُومًا لِّلشَّيَاطِينِ ۖ** [And verily, We have adorned the lowest heaven with lamps, and We have made them for driving away satans (*Sūrah al-Mulk*, 67:6)].

As the act of driving away is performed by the angels and not the stars, it  
is proven categorically that every star has a guardian angel appointed over it.  
As, due to the intensity of their relationship, the angels are like the life and  
soul of the stars, so in this verse the acts of the angels are attributed to the  
stars. **So reflect. Author**

At this juncture, various objections may arise, the rebuttal of which is my responsibility. One of them is that since the **Holy Spirit** is bestowed only upon the favoured ones who arrive at the stage of *baqā* [revival] and *liqā*,<sup>1</sup> how can it be the guardian of everyone? The answer is that the perfect descent of the Holy Spirit does indeed take place only upon the favoured ones, but others also enjoy its **general** support according to their degree of love and sincerity.

The statement of mine given earlier only indicates how the higher manifestation of the Holy Spirit takes place: When, at the stage *baqā* and *liqā*, the love of Allah descends upon human love, the meeting of the two loves produces the **higher manifestation** of the Holy Spirit, compared with which the other manifestations are insignificant. Nevertheless, this does not mean that the other manifestations do not exist. God Almighty does not let so much as a particle of sincere love go to waste. His love descends upon the love of human beings, and the splendour of the Holy Spirit arises to this very degree. It is an unvarying law of God Almighty that the divine love continues to descend in accord with the measure of every love, and when a river of human love begins to flow, a river of love descends from the other side as well; when those two rivers meet, a magnificent light is generated which, in our idiom, is called the Holy Spirit.

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**

Deficient descent of the Holy Spirit

However, just as you can see that if a trace amount of sugar is added to a large quantity of water, the taste of sugar will not be felt and the water will seem as bland as before. Nonetheless, we cannot say that sugar has not been added, but neither can we say that the water

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1. Islam recognizes three stages in man's spiritual journey towards God: The first stage is *fanā* (passing away), which is the total annihilation of one's ego for the sake of God; the second stage is *baqā* (subsistence), which denotes a new spiritual life; and the third stage is *liqā* (meeting), which is the state of achieving union with God. [Publisher]

is now sweet. The same is the case with the Holy Spirit that descends upon deficient people in a deficient way. Its descent cannot be doubted because the Holy Spirit generates the idea of doing good deeds in the mind of even the lowest of the low; and sometimes even a sinful and brazen evildoer also sees a true dream. All of this is the effect of the Holy Spirit, as the Noble Quran and the authentic *aḥādīth* of the Prophet<sup>sas</sup> prove; but in comparison with the magnificent relationship experienced by the holy and godly people, it amounts to nothing—as if it did not exist at all.

**ANOTHER** question is that given the case that the Holy Spirit is appointed to restrain man from evil conduct, then why do they commit sin and why does man still fall into *kufṛ* [disbelief], disobedience, and vice?

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**

Response to the Objection: If the Holy Spirit stays with every human, then why does the progeny of Adam commit evil deeds?

**ITS ANSWER** is that God Almighty has appointed **two spiritual callers** by way of trial for human beings: one is the **caller to good**, whose name is the Holy Spirit, and the other is the **caller to vice**, whose name is Iblīs and Satan. Both of these callers continue to call towards good or evil but exercise no compulsion as is indicated in the noble verse:

قَالَهُمَا فَجُورُهَا وَتَقْوَاهَا ۝<sup>1</sup>

Meaning that God reveals the evil as well as the good.

The medium for revealing evil is Satan, who casts mischievous ideas into hearts, and the means for revealing good is the Holy Spirit, who inspires pure thoughts within the heart. Since God Almighty is the **Cause of all causes**, He has attributed both these revelations to Himself because He alone has instituted this entire system. Otherwise,

1. *Sūrah ash-Shams*, 91:9 [Publisher]

what standing does Satan have to place mischievous thoughts in anyone's heart and what is the status of the Holy Spirit to guide anyone along the paths of *taqwā* [righteousness]?

#### AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE

It is not the teaching of the Noble Quran that Satan can compel anyone. Nor does it teach that only Satan is appointed as man's companion to instill evil thoughts in his heart. Rather, both a caller to good and a caller to evil have been assigned.

Our opponent Āryas, Brahmūs, and Christians—on account of their short-sightedness—criticize the teaching of the Noble Quran that this teaching proves that God Almighty has deliberately set Satan upon man as if He Himself desires to mislead His own creation. This is an error on the part of our hasty critics. They ought to realize that it is not the teaching of the Noble Quran that Satan can compel anyone to go astray, nor is it the teaching that only Satan is appointed for the purpose of calling to evil. Rather, the teaching is that, for the purpose of trying and testing,<sup>1 ☆</sup> mankind has been equally subjected to the **touch of angels and the touch of Iblīs**—that is, one calling to good and one calling to evil—so that man, being confronted with this trial, can be deemed worthy of reward or retribution. This is so because if only one means had been provided for man—for instance, if the causes of all external and internal emotions had only drawn someone towards good, or if his nature had been endowed with nothing except the doing of good, then there would be no reason for him to merit any rank of nearness to God on account of good deeds, inasmuch as

1. ☆ **Note:** By the term 'test' at this juncture, no one should be misled to ask what need there is for God, the Knower of the Unseen, to test or try; for, without a doubt, He has no need. However, as the essential purpose of a trial is to expose concealed truths, it is for this reason that this term is found in the Books of God Almighty. He does not subject [man] to trials for lack of knowledge, but for the reason that He might reveal to the individual under trial what his true nature is, and whether he possesses this vice or virtue and also to expose his secret nature to others as well. Author



all the means and emotions he possesses would be for doing only good and the desire of evil would be inherently absent from his nature. In such a case, by what virtue would he have the right to deserve reward for avoiding vice?

For instance, if a congenitally impotent man, who has no desire for women, were to claim before an audience that he passed a certain time in the company of young beautiful women, but being virtuous, he did not look upon them lustfully even once and feared God all the while, everyone would laugh at him for saying so and mockingly exclaim: ‘O fool! When did you ever have the capability, which you then restrained to justify boasting about or expecting any reward?’

It should be understood that, in his initial and intermediary phases, all hopes of reward for the seeker arise out of the rebel-

**AUTHOR’S MARGIN NOTE**

All hopes of reward arise out of rebellious desires

lious desires. If, in those stages, the circumstances of the seeker’s very nature are such that he is completely incapable of committing any kind of vice, then his actions cannot merit any reward. For instance, unlike scorpions and snakes, we do not possess any poison within our bodies through which we can inflict the kind of injury on anyone that snakes and scorpions cause. Therefore, in being precluded from inflicting this kind of harm, we are also not entitled to any reward according to Allah.

Thus it is evident that the rebellious desires arising within man that pull man towards vice, are, in fact, also the very means for man’s reward because when he eschews those rebellious desires out of the fear of God, then, without doubt, he becomes worthy of praise in the estimation of Allah and pleases his Lord. However, there are no rebellious desires left in the one who has attained the highest station, as if his *jinn* has become a Muslim. Nevertheless, he continues to deserve reward, for he has traversed the stages of trial with great courage just as a

righteous individual who has done great virtuous deeds in his youth receives reward for them even in his old age.

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**

Response to the Objection: Why does God, like human beings, require intermediaries—such as angels and the like?

**ANOTHER** objection that is raised is: Why does God Almighty need angels for putting His designs into effect? Does His kingdom depend upon His staff as worldly governments do, and does He need armies just as they do?

**THE ANSWER:** Let it be clear that God Almighty is not in need of anything—not angels, not the Sun, not the Moon nor the stars—but He willed it to be thus so that His powers be revealed through the mediation of means and so that wisdom and knowledge may spread amongst people in this manner. If there had been no mediation of means, there would have been no Astronomy, Physics, Medicine, or Botany in the world. These are the very means that gave rise to these sciences.

Reflect and observe: If there is an objection to the employment of angels, the same objection applies to putting the Sun, the Moon, the stars, the vegetables, the minerals and other elements into service. Anyone who holds any share of spiritual insight knows that every single particle is functioning in accordance with the will of God Almighty, and even a drop of water cannot produce any effect—favourable or unfavourable—in our body without the command of God. Thus, all particles, heavenly bodies, and so forth are actually a form of angels who are occupied in service day and night; some are occupied in serving the human body and some in the service of the soul. The All-Wise who chose the mediation of many means for the physical development of man and created many physical mediators to influence the human body in diverse ways—that very One without associate whose works have unity and symmetry—was also pleased to decide that man's spiritual development should follow

the system which had been adopted for his physical development so that both systems, the external and the internal, and the physical and the spiritual, through their balance and harmony, point to the **One Creator, who, by His will, regulates everything.**

This is verily the reason why angels were appointed as mediators for the spiritual and, indeed, for the physical development of man. However, all these mediators are under the control of God Almighty like a machine which is run by His holy hand. They have no will of their own, nor do they exercise any control. Just as air enters our body by the command of God Almighty and goes out of it by His command and exerts its influence by His command, the same is the case and the sum total of the situation with angels:

يَفْعَلُونَ مَا يُؤْمَرُونَ

[They do what they are commanded].

It is a pity that **Pandit Dayanand** has raised an objection against this system of angels. Alas! I wish that the revered Pandit had knowledge of God's physical and spiritual systems so that, instead of raising objections, he would have appreciated the excellences of the teaching of the Holy Quran—how true and accurate a picture of the law of nature is found in it!

#### AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE

This is a misunderstanding of Pandit Dayanand and the Aryas that this is a defect of the Quranic teaching that it has assumed the existence of Satan without proof and has declared him to be the one who beguiles man.

**ANOTHER** objection is that there are certain indications in the Noble Quran—and similarly indicated in some *ahādīth*—that there was a delay sometimes in the descent of [the angel] Gabriel [Jibrā'īl]; namely, that during the period of apostleship of the Holy Prophet, peace and the blessings of Allah be upon him, it also happened that Gabriel did not descend upon the Holy Prophet, peace and the blessings of Allah be upon him, for several days. If Ḥaḍrat Jibrā'īl [Gabriel] was a constant

and close companion of the Holy Prophet's, and the influence of the Holy Spirit upon the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> was flowing continuously, what does the delay in the descent mean?

**THE ANSWER:** Let it be clear that the notion that the Holy Spirit sometimes ascends into the heavens leaving the Prophets alone is only a misconception which has been caused by misunderstanding the terms 'descent' and 'ascent'. Let it remain **no secret** that 'descent' certainly does not mean that an angel leaves its assigned station and abode in the heavens and descends to the earth. Such an interpretation is opposed to the clear dicta of the Quran and Hadith.

For instance, the following tradition is reported by Ibn Jarīr in *Fath-ul-Bayān* on the authority of Ḥaḍrat Āyeshah, may Allah be pleased with her:

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**

Authentic *aḥādīth* of the Holy Prophet prove that the angels do not leave their heavenly station, because leaving would inevitably mean that their assigned station in the heavens would be emptied; and this is impossible.

قَالَتْ: قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ: مَا فِي السَّمَاءِ مَوْضِعٌ قَدِمَ إِلَّا عَلَيْهِ مَلَكٌ سَاجِدٌ أَوْ قَائِمٌ، وَذَلِكَ قَوْلُ الْمَلَائِكَةِ: وَمَا مِنَّا إِلَّا لَهُ مَقَامٌ مَعْلُومٌ.<sup>1</sup>

Meaning that Ḥaḍrat Āyeshah, may Allah be pleased with her, reports that the Messenger of Allah, peace and the blessings of Allah be upon him, said that there is not

a foot of space empty in the heavens which is not occupied by an angel in prostration or standing upright. The same is the interpretation of the [Quranic] verse;<sup>2</sup> that is, every one of us has a fixed and ascertained abode from which it is impossible to move even a single step, up or down.

Now observe how clearly this hadith proves that the angels do not

1. *Fathul-Bayān*, vol. II, *Tafsīr Sūrah aṣ-Ṣāffāt*, p. 432, published by al-Maktabah al-'Aṣriyyah, Beirut, 1996 [Publisher]

2. *Sūrah aṣ-Ṣāffāt*, 37:165 [Publisher]

leave their posts and it never happens in the heavens that even a foot of space be seen empty.

But, alas! Sadly, Batālawī and the Shaikh of Delhi even in this **scientific age** hold on to the belief that **there is nothing extraordinary about the heavens being empty to the extent of only a foot of space.** Sometimes, through the descent of huge angels, the heavens become a desolate wilderness for thousands of miles in which not even a single angel remains! Insofar as when the angel bearing six hundred (600) wings of pearls whose length runs from east to west—namely, Gabriel—descends upon the earth with his entire being, then you can imagine the thousands of miles of heaven, or short of that, that would be left empty from the descent of such a colossal angel. **To be styled *Shaikh-ul-Kull* [the Greatest Scholar]** yet fail to understand the Prophet’s *ahādīth* is cause for pity and shame!

#### AUTHOR’S MARGIN NOTE

The erroneous belief of Batālawī and the Shaikh of Delhi is that at times the heavens are completely without angels. In particular, during *Lailatul Qadr*, the heavens become like a house abandoned because all the angels and the *Rūḥul-Qudus*, descend upon the earth and remain upon the earth till the morning.

**In short**, as I have just explained, it should be borne in mind very carefully that it is not possible for the godly to be separated from the influences of the Holy Spirit even for a single moment, for the soul of their new life is the Holy Spirit itself; how, then, can they be separated from their soul? The separation which is found in the *ahādīth* and in some indications in the Holy Quran, refers only to a particular manifestation [of the Holy Spirit] which was delayed, on occasions, as deemed appropriate by the will of Allah. The word *nuzūl* [descent] in the terminology of the **Noble Quran**

#### AUTHOR’S MARGIN NOTE

The descent of angels refers to a form of divine manifestation, whose clear impact is felt upon the hearts of the recipients of revelation. Often, the angels even become visible at such times by assuming a tangible form. If there is a delay in such a manifestation, it is said that the descent has been delayed. The permanent nearness of the Holy Spirit is akin to the fire that ever resides within stone—its manifestation resembles the striking of the rock, from which a spark is produced.

mostly refers only to such manifestations. Otherwise, one should just reflect that the Sun of Truth [the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>] about whom the verse was revealed:

وَمَا يَنْطِقُ عَنِ الْهَوَىٰ ۝ إِنْ هُوَ إِلَّا وَحْيٌ يُوحَىٰ ۝<sup>1</sup>

Meaning that none of his words or discourses proceeds from his own desire; that it is *wahy* [revelation] in its entirety that descends upon his heart—how can we think **about him** that he remained altogether deprived of the light of *wahy* for lengthy durations of time? It is written, for example, that on some occasions, there was no *wahy* for twenty, sometimes forty, or even sixty days at times.

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**

If our Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> remained totally separated from the Holy Spirit for 40 days or more, then the words spoken during those days should not be a part of the *aḥādīth*, nor should they be said to be revealed.

If such an absence of *wahy* means that the Angel Gabriel totally left the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> for such periods of time, it would raise a serious objection: To the extent that the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, made statements during this period, were they not included in his Prophetic Hadith? Were they not **called *wahye ghair matlū* [non-recited revelation]**? Did the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, not have any dream during that time, which clearly is a form of *wahy*? And if **Respected Baṭālawī and Miyān Nadhīr Ḥusain of Delhi were right**, and if it were true that, for long periods of time, Gabriel parted from the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, and left him totally devoid of *wahy*, then undoubtedly the reports of the Prophet's *aḥādīth* during those days must not be reliable in the eyes of **these gentlemen**, for they would lack the light of *wahy*. And, according to

1. *Sūrah an-Najm*, 53:4–5 [Publisher]

their opinion, the dreams must have ceased altogether during those periods as well.

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**

Batālawī and Shaikh Dehlawī have committed great disrespect towards the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, by proposing that the Holy Spirit totally left the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> at times but have not made such a suggestion about Jesus. This is an example of the level of their knowledge and cognition.

**Now, O just people!** Think about it. Has the disrespect shown to the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, by these two **shaikhs** reached an extreme or not? They believe that that **Sun of Truthfulness** [the Holy Prophet Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>], no instinct of whose heart was without the impulse of *wahy*, is believed by them—God forbid—to have remained in darkness for long periods without any light.

My humble self knows **from my own personal experience** that the **holiness of the Holy Spirit** operates at all the times on every occasion and every moment without cessation in all the faculties of the recipient of revelation; and without the influence of the **holiness** of the Holy Spirit, he cannot safeguard himself against impurities for even a moment.

And he is also the source of perpetual lights, perpetual steadfastness, perpetual love, perpetual sinlessness, and perpetual blessings in that the Holy Spirit is with them always and every moment. Then, how can it be imagined with regard to the *Imām-ul-Maʿsūmīn* [Leader of the Sinless], *Imām-ul-Mutabārikīn* [Leader of the Blessed], and *Sayyidul-Muqarrabīn* [Chief of all the Elects] that—God forbid—he was left devoid of these blessings, purities, and lights at any time. How sad that these people believe regarding Jesus that the Holy Spirit did not separate himself from him for even a single moment for thirty-three years; but they deny such a distinction here [to the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him].

**ONE OF THE OTHER OBJECTIONS IS** why, in *Sūrah at-Ṭāriq*, did God Almighty take the oath of a thing other than Himself when He says Himself that oaths must not be

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**

Answer to the objection that God Almighty swore in the name of those beside Himself in the oaths in the Holy Quran.

taken of anything but Himself—neither of man, heavens, earth, stars, nor of anything else? So, what was the need for God Almighty to swear by anything other than Himself, in particular, the stars and the heavens in this context?

These are, in fact, two objections, connected with each other and, on account of their interrelationship, I consider it appropriate to respond to both of them together.

**So, firstly**, in regards an oath, it must be fully borne in mind that comparing the oaths taken by Allah, glorified be His eminence, with those taken by mere mortals amounts to comparing two incompatible entities. God Almighty has forbidden man to swear by anything besides Himself because a human oath is meant to call the thing of which the oath is taken as a substitute for an eyewitness to corroborate or contradict the matter on the basis of personal knowledge, since, if you reflect and observe, the essential significance of an oath is the testimony itself. When man is unable to produce ordinary witnesses, he relies upon the oath to derive the benefit that is to be derived from an eyewitness. But to propose or believe that there is someone besides God Almighty who is Omnipresent and Omniscient, and has complete control over the power to verify or contradict or punish or anything else, is a statement of utter disbelief. This is why all the scriptures forbid swearing by anyone other than Allah.

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**

Nature of the oaths taken by God Almighty and the secret of cognizance hidden in these oaths

Thus, it is clear that God Almighty's oaths cannot be viewed in the same light as man's oaths, for God Almighty has no such difficulty as a man has when taking an oath.

Rather, God's taking an oath is of a very different character which befits His majesty and is in accordance with His law; and the object of such an oath is to offer the patent facts of nature to serve as a witness to explain the delicate hidden verities of the Shariah. That is analogous to an oath. For example, when one swears by God Almighty, he means to call God Almighty as a Witness to the event under discussion. In the



same way, some clear and manifest acts of God Almighty are witnesses over His hidden acts.

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**

All the oaths taken by Allah in the Holy Quran are meant to cite things from His law of nature as witnesses in support of His commandments or to manifest the truthfulness of the abstract and obtuse verities by citing the manifest and universally accepted.

Therefore, in the Noble Quran, He has repeatedly presented His manifest acts to witness the hidden side of His actions in the form of an oath. We cannot say that God has taken an oath of something other than Himself, for He, in fact, swears by His own works and not by anything else—and His acts are nothing distinct and apart from Him. For example, His swearing by the heavens or the stars is not understood to be an oath of something other than Himself; rather, it is meant to point out that all the wisdom and workmanship of His hands found in the heavens and the stars is evidence to explain some of His other unseen acts. So, in fact, such oaths of Almighty God, which exist in the Quran as having been taken by God, are abounding with many deep spiritual secrets. And, as I have just explained, to give these explanations the form of an oath is to supply a type of witness which takes the place of an eyewitness.

Similarly, some works of God Almighty serve as evidence for some of His other works so that, in order to explain the deep secrets of His spiritual realm, God recites evidence of the obvious phenomena of nature in the garb of an oath to make the law of nature—namely, the Book of God's

Deeds—bear witness to His Book of Words, and, thus, to furnish the sincere seeker with additional certainty of knowledge and belief through the accord prevailing between His Word and Deed. And this is a common practice of the Glorious God in the Noble Quran, that He frequently cites evidence of natural phenomena prevailing firmly

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**

The oaths taken by God Almighty in the Holy Quran where some of His creations are cited, there also lies the wisdom of drawing to the attention of man that all these Words and deeds flow from the same fountain.

and systematically in His creation to explain the ordinances of His Shariah to make people recognize that this Shariah and this teaching emanate from the same God who is One without any partner, such Deeds of whose exist which maintain absolute harmony with these Words of His, since the harmony between words and deeds is a conclusive proof that the One who has done those Deeds is the very One who has revealed those Words.

I will now explain, by way of example, some of the oaths which appear in the Noble Quran. One of them is the following:

وَالسَّابِقِ وَالطَّارِقِ ۝ وَمَا أَدْرَاكَ مَا الطَّارِقُ ۝ النَّجْمُ الثَّاقِبُ ۝ إِنَّ كُلَّ نَفْسٍ لَّبِئَاءَ عَلَيْهَا حَافِظٌ ۝<sup>1</sup>

The real purport and objective of these verses is that angels have been appointed for the spiritual protection of every soul.<sup>2 ☆</sup> They constantly accompany them and protect whosoever needs protection. This, however, is a subtle and abstract statement, since angels themselves are an imperceptible creation. How, then, would it be possible to believe in their protective influence?

#### AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE

Whether the angels protect against physical calamities or spiritual ones, in both cases their safeguarding against these dangers is of a spiritual nature.

Hence, God, the Noble and Wise, has cited His law governing the heavenly bodies in the form of a witness here. In other words, we can see God's law of nature clearly and palpably that the heavens and stars, the Sun and the Moon, and whatever else exists in

1. *Sūrah at-Ṭāriq*, 86:2–5 [Publisher]

2. ☆ Note: Although angels also safeguard against physical calamities, their protecting is strictly in a spiritual manner. For instance, if someone is standing near a wall that is about to collapse, no angel will lift him up with his own hands and take him away. However, if that person is destined to be saved, an angel would reveal to his heart that he should move away quickly. Nevertheless, the protection of the stars, elements, etc., is physical. Author

the vast space like air etc., are all engaged in the physical service of man and safeguard him from many types of injury, mishap, loss, and trouble. They prepare everything needed for his physical body and physical powers. The bright stars that especially appear at night are a boon to the travellers who walk through a forest or wilderness at night or who travel through the seas. During a dark night, every single *najmuth-thāqib* [**glittering star**] safeguards life by providing guidance. If these protectors, who are performing their duties of protection at their appointed times, had not been there, man could not survive even for a twinkling of an eye.

You should respond upon reflection: Could we survive without all those guardians—one who readily provides us vital heat, another who ripens the grains and fruits, another who sends down rain to supply us with drinking water, another who gives us light, another who regulates our system of respiration, another who aids our faculty of hearing, and another who maintains our natural body heat to be healthy? Now, from all this, man can understand that the Noble and Wise Lord, who created these thousands of heavenly bodies, elements, and such for the safety and stability of our physical bodies, placing them in our service day and night—nay rather, *every second*—could He have been so negligent in the management of our spiritual welfare! How can we entertain the reservation against that Noble and Merciful One that He created such extensive provisions for our physical welfare to the point He made an entire world a servant for us, yet failed to make any arrangement for our spiritual welfare?

Now, if we are fair-minded thinkers, this alone provides a strong proof that the Omniscient God must have made a spiritual arrangement resembling the

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**

The physical system established by God Almighty necessitates the existence of a corresponding spiritual system, for the Source of both is One and the same.

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**

The physical and spiritual system created by God Almighty

physical system. That arrangement is the appointing of angels for protection. That is why God Almighty has sworn by the heavens and the stars—so that the issue of the protective influence of the angels, which is a hidden and abstract phenomenon, may be clearly explained through a reference to the arrangement of the protective influence of the stars and so forth, which is an obvious fact of nature, and also that for the benefit of those who contemplate, He may cite the recognizable arrangement of the physical world to prove the existence of angels in order for a rational mind to understand the existence of a spiritual arrangement on the model of the physical.

By way of example, I cite the **SECOND OATH** as follows:

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**

Commentary on some verses  
of *Sūrah an-Najm*

وَالنَّجْمِ إِذَا هَوَىٰ ۝ مَا ضَلَّ صَاحِبُكُمْ وَمَا  
غَوَىٰ ۝ وَمَا يَنْطِقُ عَنِ الْهَوَىٰ ۝ إِنْ هُوَ إِلَّا  
وَحْيٌ يُوحَىٰ ۝ عَلَيْهِ شَهِيدُ الْقَوَىٰ ۝ ذُو مِرْقٍ ۝ قَاسُوتَىٰ ۝ وَهُوَ بِالْأُفُقِ الْأَعْلَىٰ ۝

<sup>1</sup>*Sūrah an-Najm, Part Number 27—*

Meaning that: By the star when it rises or sets, your companion has not lost his way, nor has he erred. He does not speak out of his own desire; rather, every single word of his is *wahy* [revelation] descending which has been taught to him by the one with mighty power; namely, Gabriel. That powerful one was fully manifested to him as he appeared on the high horizon.

The purport of this oath is that the Messengership of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, which was an abstract concept for the disbelievers, might be proven to them with reference to the facts of nature which they accepted as fully established. Now, it must be borne in mind that as a result of the ideas which the soothsayers had spread among them, the Arabs had a staunch belief

1. *Sūrah an-Najm*, 53:2–8 [Publisher]

that an unusually magnificent man is born at the time when shooting stars fall in abundance. In particular, their soothsayers who had established some connection with the evil spirits and who foretold the unseen, had a strong and firm belief that an extraordinary falling of the stars connoted the impending appearance of a Prophet. And it so happened that the time of the advent of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, was marked by an excessive falling of stars, as Almighty God testifies in *Sūrah al-Jinn*, where the Jinn are quoted as saying:

وَأَنَّا لَبَسْنَا السَّمَاءَ فَوَجَدْنَا مُلْأَتْ حَرَسًا شَدِيدًا وَشُهُبًا ۝ وَأَنَّا كُنَّا  
نَقْعُدُ مِنْهَا مَقَاعِدَ لِلسَّمْعِ فَمَنْ يَسْتَمِعِ الْآنَ يَجِدْ لَهُ شَهَابًا مَرصَدًا ۝

<sup>1</sup> *Sūrah al-Jinn*, Part Number 29—

Meaning that, on searching through the heavens, we found them filled with guards; that is, the angels and flames. Before this, we used to sit in ambush in the heavens to pirate upon the news about the unseen. But if we wish to do so now, we find a flame striking us.

There are copious *ahādīth* supporting this verse—[*Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī*, [*Ṣaḥīḥ*] *Muslim*, *Abū Dāwūd*, *Tirmidhī*, *Ibn Mājah*, etc. All have reported *ahādīth* to the effect that the falling of stars is meant to drive away satans.

Imam Ahmad reports on the authority of Ibn ‘Abbas that stars used to fall in the Age of Ignorance [before Islam] as well, but it was at the advent [of the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>]

that they fell in abundance and profusion. Accordingly, it is recorded in *Tafsīr ibn Kathīr* [The (Quranic) Commentary of Ibn Kathīr] that when the stars fell in abundance at the time of the Holy Prophet, peace

#### AUTHOR’S MARGIN NOTE

Stars fell in abundance during the year of the advent of the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>

1. *Sūrah al-Jinn*, 72:9–10 [Publisher]

and the blessings of Allah be upon him, the people of Ṭā'if were extremely frightened and started saying that there was a disturbance among the dwellers of the heavens. Then, one of them proposed examining the stars to see if they had shifted from their places. If the stars, so he said, had changed their places, the dwellers of the heavens would be visited with some ruinous calamity; if not, then the falling of stars was because of Ibn Abī Kabsha (They mischievously applied the name Ibn Abī Kabsha to the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him).

#### AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE

It was firmly believed by the soothsayers of Arabia that some Prophet is born when the stars fall in abundance. It was their personal experience that they received fewer satanic intimations after the abundant falling of the stars.

Thus, it was rooted in the hearts of the Arabs that when any Prophet comes into the world, or another great man is born, there is an abundant falling of stars. This is the reason why, in keeping with the notions of the Arabs, God swore by the falling of stars. The purpose of the oath is to make them realize that they and the soothsayers themselves admitted that the phenomenon of falling stars heralded the appearance of a Prophet or of someone gifted with Divine revelation; hence, there was no reason for the denial [of the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>]. Since the soothsayers regarded the falling of the stars in great numbers as a clear proof of the impending appearance of a Prophet or of a godly person gifted with revelation and since the Arabs obeyed the soothsayers as a follower obeys his spiritual preceptor, God cited this apparent phenomenon in the form of an oath, so that people might pay heed that the whole enterprise emanates from God Almighty and is not the product of man's imagination.

#### AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE

The question that stars fall all the time, but the Prophets do not always appear at their falling

If someone raises the **question** that if the falling of stars is a proof of the appearance of a Prophet, or a *Mulham* or *Muhaddath*

[recipient of Divine discourse], then why is it that the stars fall at all times, yet there appears no Prophet or *Muḥaddath*? **The reply is that:** the falling of the stars must be in large numbers. And there is not the slightest doubt that at the time when such phenomenon is abundant, and their abundance is abnormal, some man of God is raised in the world for the reformation of Allah's servants. Sometimes such a phenomenon occurs some years before as a forerunner of the actual advent of such a personage, and sometimes it occurs right at the time of his appearance. And sometimes it also occurs to mark a magnificent triumph of his, when the heavens are illuminated to serve as Sign of joy over his success.

**Ibn Kathīr** has narrated on the authority of Sa'dī that the falling of stars in abundance indicates the appearance of a Prophet or it conveys the good news that faith will

triumph. But the references of the Holy Quran to this phenomenon are of a general character from which it can be clearly deduced that when a Prophet, or the successor of a Prophet, appears upon the earth or is about to appear after having been appointed [by God], or when the Signs of his impending advent are about to become manifest, or when a great victory is near at hand, then, in all such circumstances, Signs of this kind appear in the heavens, and denying this is foolishness, because not knowing something does not necessarily mean that such a thing does not, in fact, exist. Some *Muṣleḥ* [Reformers] and *Mujaddids* [Rejuvenators] of the Faith come into the world in a manner that people are generally not even aware of them.

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**

What is indicated by the Holy Quran about the falling of stars?

## An Episode

### AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE

An episode from my personal life

I recall that in the early days when I was Divinely appointed, I received this *ilhām* [revelation], which is recorded on page 238<sup>1</sup>

of *Barāhīn-e-Aḥmadiyya*:

يَا أَحْمَدُ بَارَكَ اللَّهُ فِيكَ. مَا رَمَيْتَ إِذْ رَمَيْتَ وَلَكِنَّ اللَّهَ رَمَى. أَلَرَّحْمَنُ عَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ لِتُنذِرَ قَوْمًا  
مَّا أُنْذِرَ آبَاءَهُمْ وَلَسْتَنَبِيْن سَبِيْلَ الْمُجْرِمِيْنَ. قُلْ إِنِّي أُمِرْتُ وَأَنَا أَوَّلُ الْمُؤْمِنِيْنَ.

Meaning that: Allah has placed blessing in you, O Ahmad. Whatever you did let loose, it was not you but it was Allah who let it loose. He [the Most Gracious God] has taught you the Quran so that you should warn the people whose forefathers have not been warned, and that the way of the guilty ones might become manifest; that is, so that the virtuous may be distinguished from the mischievous and the rebellious. And tell the people: 'I have been commissioned and I am the first of the believers'.

### AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE

About the pelting of stars on the night of 28 November 1885

Many types of Signs started appearing after these revelations. One of them is that on the night of **28 November 1885**, which is the night before the day of 28 November,

there was such a **display across the sky** of so many meteors, the like of which I had never seen in my entire life and so many thousands of brilliant flashes were moving in every direction across the expanse of the heavens that there is no other spectacle in the world which I can cite to describe it. I recall that at that time the following revelation was vouchsafed to me repeatedly:

1. See also English translation, *Barāhīn-e-Aḥmadiyya*, Part 3, Sub-Footnote Number One, p. 209, published in 2018. [Publisher]



مَا زَمَيْتَ إِذْ زَمَيْتَ وَلَكِنَّ اللَّهَ زَمَى.

[Whatever you did let loose, it was not you but it was Allah who let it loose.]

Hence, that *letting loose* was very appropriately the *let loosing* of stars. This spectacle of **brilliant shooting stars** that occurred on the night of 28 November 1885 was so vast that it was published in the popular newspapers of Europe, America, and Asia with great wonder. People might have been thinking that there was no purpose behind this, yet the Noble Lord knows that the one who was most diligently observing this spectacle—more than everyone—and then enjoying the greatest delight and pleasure from it was verily none other than myself. My eyes were fixed upon the sight of this spectacle for a very long time, and that progression of casting stars started early in the evening, which I was watching with great pleasure only on account of revealed glad tidings, for it had been inspirationally placed within my heart that this Sign was manifested for me.

Thereafter, the people of Europe **were shown that very comet which** had appeared during the time of the advent of [Jesus] **the Messiah** and it was placed within my heart that this comet was yet another Sign in support of my truth.

Here an objection is raised that in the new and old investigations of the scientists the falling of stars has been attributed to other causes that have no connection with the matters that have been related here.

#### AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE

Response to the objection that the researchers of philosophical science have ascribed other causes for the genesis of meteors and their kind

For instance, in *Sharah-e-Ishārāt*, which deals with the causes and processes of **an atmospheric nature**, it is recorded only this much regarding the cause of the falling

#### AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE

The nature of meteors according to the course of Greek research

of stars that when smoke reaches fiery regions while it is still somewhat

combustible and transparent, it catches fire instantly because of its fiery origin, and it appears as if it is extinguished as soon as it catches fire, but in reality it is not extinguished. What happens is that the extremity that is upward of the column of smoke gets ignited first, and then the flame travels to the other extremity, and the flame in motion appears to us as if it had travelled in a curve to which we give the name of a **shooting star**, which appears towards the lower regions of the curve. Then, when the earth's atmosphere goes up towards that fiery column of smoke, the fire is not visible because of its expansion and looks as if it has been extinguished, whereas it is not extinguished. This happens when the smoke is very thin and rare. But if it is thick or dense, the flames endure for many days or even for years.

The light of the flame, which then looks like a star, appears in space in different shapes. It sometimes appears like a **comet** which, at times, has a wavy sort of tail, sometimes the **fiery image** appears in the form of a spear, and sometimes in the form of an animal with a number of horns. The fiery image appears for a year or, for many years altogether, and sometimes it breaks into pieces and takes the form of shooting stars, and sometimes again those **shooting stars** assume the shape of this fiery image. When the fiery image appears on the northern horizon, it very often lasts for a long time as compared to its appearance in some other direction, and if it stays there for a very long time its heat causes many a great calamity.

History also records that after the arrest of the Messiah [Jesus], **shooting stars** appeared first, and then the stretch of fire was observed in the heavens for one full year, and the sky rained down an ash-like substance, and the day was totally darkened from nine in the morning until nightfall.

#### AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE

Philosophical opinions are severely unstable and without firm establishment

In short, these are the explanations of the Greeks regarding the **shooting stars** and comets, which have been adopted by the philosophers of Islam and to which the

latter have added the results of their own investigations. The investigations of our own times, however, differ from these explanations in many respects.

The most disheartening aspect of these speculations is that every now and then the old ideas are swept away by newer ideas. There was a time when the scientific and astronomical knowledge of the Greeks constituted the correct approach, but today many of their investigations are ridiculed and looked down upon. And there is no reason to doubt that after some time this very science and astronomy may be laughed at by people; for, although it is claimed that the present-day science and astronomy is based on actual experiments, this claim is highly exaggerated. In certain cases, the confirmed theoretical part of science has been arbitrarily mixed with a great number of doubtful and unproven hypotheses, which have certainly not been fully and completely confirmed by any scientist.

Modern researchers believe **shooting stars** to be made up of a substance like iron and coal, weighing at most a few pounds. These meteors travel in elliptical orbits like comets, in large numbers, and revolve in space around the sun. They are illuminated because of the heat generated in the course of their speedy movement through space. About comets, they state that some of them endure for thousands of years, breaking up at last into meteors. They also say that when the sun is in Leo or Virgo, during both these times the shooting stars may be expected in abundance. Such a phenomenon generally takes place after every 33 years, but this is not an absolute rule for such phenomena may also occur even before or after the lapse of this time. For example, the falling of stars witnessed in 1872, by the admission of

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**

This assertion is completely preposterous and without foundation—that all contemporary debates in natural science and astronomy, along with their every detail, have been proven conclusively and definitively through experimental means. Yes, it is true that some questions have been clarified to some degree through experimentation, but these bear the same relation to the remaining questions as the rare bears to the commonplace.

these scientists, was unexpected. However, the meteoric phenomenon that occurred on 14 November 1833, and 27 November 1885, corresponds with astronomical expectations.

Nevertheless, a search through the dates of the occurrence of such phenomena reveals that the same has been taking place on dates very much removed from those ascertained by astronomical calculations. For example, astronomers only observe silence in regard to the occurrence of frequent shooting stars on 10 March 1521 and 19 January 1135 and May 610. Though we cannot fix a date of the occurrence of the shooting stars which appeared after the arrest of Jesus<sup>as</sup> and which afterwards became a comet with a tail, it appears that it must have taken place in early June. Although the Christian scriptures do not help us in investigating this long-gone event because of their contradictory statements, we can say by way of inference that when Jesus<sup>as</sup> was arrested by the Jews, it must have been the time of an intensely hot summer. His being extremely thirsty when he was arrested clearly shows that the weather at that time caused the feelings of heat and thirst. That month must therefore be June, for there was also a great dust storm as a result of which it became very dark, and June is the month of frequent dust storms.

#### AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE

Regarding meteors and similar phenomena, Europe's recent investigations have by no means reached the pinnacle of complete research and are full of doubts.

All this discussion shows that astronomers and scientists have attained no definite and conclusive methodology about the heavenly bodies and especially about meteors and comets. Whenever there appears a phenomenon which does not agree with their calculations, they are thrown into disarray and surprise and raise a clamour in agitation. European astronomers, and the **scientists** and astrologers who boast about their knowledge, are prone to publish predictions about the heavenly bodies and their influence—at times, they frighten people with impending famines and storms, and at other times, give them hopes of prosperity by foretelling opportune rains and lower

prices. However, when Divine decree unfolds itself, these prophecies generally turn out to be false. Nevertheless, they keep on disturbing the minds of people for nothing. Generally speaking, pushing their worries aside, they seek to have a hand in the Divinity of the Lord of Honour and Glory, but God's eternal wisdom always puts them to shame.

Now, it is clear that regarding those people whose serious errors are constantly being exposed, how can we believe that everything they have discovered up to now regarding systems and science is infallible? We simply find it even embarrassing to accept the speculative basis of many of their scientific conclusions, because up till now, there is a large store of unfounded and unproven theories among their ideas. At this moment, the following comment of **Imām Rāzī**, may Allah shower His mercy upon him, seems very appealing: مَنْ أَرَادَ أَنْ يَكُنَالَ مُمْلَكَةً: الْبَارِي بِمَكْيَالِ الْعُقُلِ فَقَدْ ضَلَّ ضَلَالًا بَعِيدًا. Meaning, anyone who wishes to measure the kingdom of God with the scale of his own intellect has deviated far from truth, sincerity, and salvation.

Now, that which the Noble Lord has disclosed and revealed to this humble one is that even if the theories of astronomers and physicists regarding meteors and comets are accepted to any extent, there is no disruption nor dispute between what Allah—exalted be His Majesty and glorified be His name—has described in the **Noble Quran** regarding the spiritual designs of these celestial objects and the explanations of those foolish philosophers, since the objective of these people is only to discover the material causes and the customary behaviour of these bodies in order to establish the general rules that regulate the physical system. However, the Holy Quran is concerned with the **spiritual** system, and it is obvious that God's action in one cannot be in contradiction with His action in the other. Hence, can this be an occasion for surprise that the physical and the spiritual systems always run parallel to each other through the power of God Almighty?

Particularly given the fact that the *musleh* [reformers] of God keep coming in the world and great spiritual schemes continue being initiated by the will of God Almighty, and not a century passes without

there being some such event happening in some part of the world or other, it does not remain a far-fetched notion to believe that the abundance of meteoric phenomena points towards the renewal and existence of the spiritual arrangement devised from eternity for giving strength to the Divine Faith. It should also be borne in mind, in particular, that the **abundance of meteoric phenomena** are not necessarily associated only with the actual appearance of a Prophet or a successor of a Prophet for the reformation of the Faith. They are also associated with the happenings that constitute a prelude to the appearance of a Prophet or a successor of a Prophet. Indeed, it also occurs with their outstanding successes, for such success means the utter rout of the satanic forces at the hands of the Gracious God. When great happenings which are precursors to the advent of a Prophet or the successor of a Prophet, or which are the prime supporters of the activities of the Prophet, or which constitute the marks of his victory, an extraordinary meteoric phenomenon takes place near the time of the occurrence of such happenings. Even a fool would clearly understand that such meteoric phenomena have a spiritual significance and that it takes place at the beginning, end, or during the operation of a new spiritual dispensation.

This has always been happening and will continue to happen in the future. European scientists today lay great stress upon the meteoric phenomenon of 27 November 1885, and upon other such phenomena of the 19th century, thinking them perhaps to be the best examples in support of their theories. If they reflect a little they will realize that the frequent falling of meteors in the 19th century was due to the fact that in the latter years of this century great spiritual events were destined to take place. God Almighty had determined to rejuvenate His Faith through a humble servant of His, and, therefore, He demonstrated the spectacle of falling meteors in order to re-emphasize what He had most certainly ordained.

Here, a question may arise about what connection there is between falling meteors—all of whose causes seem to be material—and the

stoning of satanic spirits. And how can we know that this occurrence is really meant to dispel and drive away satanic spirits from the heavens?

The reply is that this objection arises only when people ignore the fact that there is a spiritual universe, or, when they do not believe in the existence of such a universe.

Otherwise, the one who keeps an eye on both universes can easily understand that whatever changes or new events that take place in the higher or lower echelons and in all heavenly bodies are actually due to two causes:

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**

The answer to the question: What is the connection between the falling of meteors and the stoning of devils?

**FIRSTLY**, the chain of cause and effect in the physical universe, which is the special field of investigation and interest for the scientists and the superficial philosophers and

which the superficial scholars believe to be structured and governed by the physical laws of cause and effects, and the stimuli and response.

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**

There are two causes for all the changes in the celestial bodies and the terrestrial bodies.

**SECONDLY**, the realm which is hidden from the short-sighted view of such superficial thinkers, and that is the realm of God Almighty's angels which supports the material realm behind the scenes and carries its enterprises to completion. People with a fully developed understanding are well aware that without the support of the spiritual universe the material universe can never function. Although, upon observing a set of circumstances, a superficial philosopher may assume that a particular result must follow a particular set of circumstances, these people are shamefully disappointed when, notwithstanding those circumstances, the result turns out to be contrary to their assumptions or when the supposed circumstances themselves get out of their control.

For example, a physician may carefully treat a king who is ill, or, even a party of physicians may engage themselves day and night diagnosing the disease from which he suffers and in prescribing medicines and regulating his diet in order to exhaust all their medical skills, yet

all such efforts fail to do any good if the king is not destined to survive. Death triumphs over the physicians after a struggle lasting several days. Such things are of a frequent occurrence. But alas! People do not carefully reflect upon them.

In short, it is established that the All-Powerful One has not confined and limited the events of the world to just the visible system, but there is also an invisible system which is in operation at all times. Although the Sun, the Moon, the Earth, and the vapours that become rain, and the winds that blow fiercely, and the hail that falls upon the earth and the shooting stars, all have physical causes for all their functions, changes, cycles, and occurrences which are extensively described in books on Astronomy and Physics, yet those who possess insight know that beneath these causes there are other causes which are consciously regulating them and who are called **angels** in other terms. Whatever they are connected with, they carry it to its goal; in their functions, they keep in mind the spiritual objectives that God Almighty has committed to their care. Their actions are not vain. On the contrary, they have great objectives in mind in all that they do.

**Considering** that it is an established verity which I have set out in some detail above and which I have discussed in great detail in my booklet *Taudīh-e-Mārām* [*Elucidation of Objectives*], that the All-Wise One has instituted two systems for the proper functioning of the universe. The invisible system is related to the angels and there is no branch of the visible system which does not have the invisible system behind it. **Thus in this case**, it can be easily understood by anyone with sound intellect that the causes upon which the visible system of the falling of shooting stars operates do not interfere with, nor stand in the way of, the causes and means of the spiritual system. The spiritual system is that an **angel is appointed** on every shooting star, who moves it in whatever direction it desires. The way of the movement of shooting stars bears witness to this. It is obvious that the function of the angel cannot be without a purpose. There must be some objective behind this which is of benefit for the religion and the world, but it is not possible



to apprehend the purpose of the function of angels without the mediation of angels. Thus, through the mediation of Gabriel, peace be on him, it was disclosed to the Final Messenger, may peace and blessings of Allah be on him, that the object of angels in the shooting of stars is **to drive satans away.**

Consideration upon the spiritual system suggests that satans are driven away by the shooting of stars because there is personal animosity between satans and angels. At the time of the release of these shooting stars, whom they also influence by the heat of the stars, the angels spread their bright power in the atmosphere and every shooting star that moves has an angelic life as it comes with the blessing of angels and it possesses a quality which consumes satans. It cannot, therefore, be objected that as *jinn*s are created from fire, they cannot be harmed by fire; for, the harm that is inflicted upon *jinn*s by shooting stars is not caused by fire but by the light which accompanies the shooting star which is lit by the angels and which **by its nature consumes satans.**

No one should be led to object that **this discourse of mine** consists only of a set of baseless ideas and mere rhetoric which has no rational proof to support it, because I have already proven amply that everything happening or moving in this universe is not independent nor is it without the will of the Master, nor is it vain and purposeless. On the other hand, God has appointed regulators for the working of the upper and lower worlds—otherwise called angels. So long as a person believes in the existence of God and is not an atheist, he would have to acknowledge that this entire system is not in vain and that everything that happens or appears, issues from the wisdom and appropriate will of God Almighty, and that will is manifested in accordance with the system through physical means. As God Almighty has not invested the physical bodies with knowledge and intelligence, the mediation of such things was needed which are invested with knowledge and intelligence for the fulfilment of things requiring knowledge and intelligence, and they are angels.

As is obvious, the dignity of the angels necessitates that they do not

operate in a vain and purposeless way, but have a purpose in all that they do. Thus, it would have to be acknowledged that they have a purpose in the release of shooting stars and, as reason is unable to perceive that purpose, it is useless to ask reason to solve this mystery. If at all reason has any relevance in resolving this mystery, it is only to the extent that sane reason cannot propose that the beings who possess will, understanding, and good sense, would act in a way that is futile, baseless, and without any appropriate and essential objectives. Thus, sane reason may fully comprehend that whatever diverse changes, disturbances, and manifestations are taking place in the heavenly and earthly bodies and the celestial world is not limited to observable causes, but rather, there are other factors—possessing awareness, will, understanding, plans, and wisdom—for these events. With such an insight, reason will acknowledge that all these earthly or heavenly changes and movements that we observe are not pointless, absurd, and vain. Rather, they contain hidden objectives and purposes regardless of whether they may be understandable to us or above and beyond our understanding.

In the context of this admission, sound intellect will be compelled to make the same admission about the falling of stars—that it is not a futile act—for, it is utterly impossible to believe that the beings who stick to understanding, planning, and wisdom would persist in an absurd act since eternity. So, even though reason may fail to comprehend it fully, yet, after agreeing with the existence of angels and their assigned functions, it will at least understand that none of their actions is vain and pointless.

With this admission, even though reason may fail to comprehend the detailed reasoning for the falling of stars that are in the will and minds of the angels, it would understand, in a general way, that without a doubt there are objectives behind this activity just like the other acts of angels. Since reason is incapable of comprehending its details, it would be dependent on some other means which is beyond the limits of reason. That means is revelation which is bestowed upon man for the purpose of carrying him to those insights and verities to which

reason alone has no access and so that it might disclose to him those fine mysteries which cannot be solved through reason. Here, by revelation, we mean the revelation of the Quran which has disclosed to us that the purpose of the angels in releasing shooting stars is to **drive away satans**. That is, it is the type of spreading of light by the angels, which combines in it a part of their light. It affects the darkness of the **jinn**s and reduces their characteristic activities. And if the **diffusion of this light** is in a high degree, then on account of its magnetic attraction perfect manifestations of light are created from among men. Otherwise, this diffusion of light on account of its angelic quality pulls hearts towards light and righteousness and this is a quality the proof of which has always been displayed **practically** in the world.

Thousands of things in this world possess qualities which are beyond human comprehension and man cannot offer a rational argument for their existence, but he cannot deny their existence either. Therefore, to deny this established fact solely on the basis that our intellects are unable to comprehend it, is foolishness and nothing else. **Has human reason comprehended** all the minute qualities which are found in the physical bodies and objects to justify the objection as to why the explanation given for the diffusion of spiritual 'light' as the result of the falling of stars, should have remained undiscovered by reason? As we have already stated, we do not need to constrain reason to accept this explanation. Indeed, human intellect, up to the extent of its power of comprehension, accepts and does not deny this explanation; for, after admitting the existence of angels and recognizing that they are appointed to discharge certain duties, human reason must also admit that the phenomena of falling stars take place through the agency of angels, and that angels carry out the command of the Beneficent Lord for the realization of some special object. To admit so much is to place sane reason on the ladder of progress. Doubtless, having admitted this much, sane reason will not—like the atheists and scientists—regard falling stars as useless phenomena. On the other hand, it will be inclined to the view with **perfect persuasion** that such

phenomena are based on wisdom and have great objectives underlying it. Possessed of this knowledge, sane reason will be eager to investigate these high purposes and its very eagerness and true zeal will attract it to that perfect guide, the *wahy* [revelation] of the Noble Quran.

If reason can at all controvert this position, it cannot, surely, do so at this stage of the discussion. Undoubtedly, however, before it accepts the explanation, it is perfectly entitled to question the idea of the existence of God whose kingdom can exist only when every particle of this universe is subservient to Him. Then, it is entitled to demand valid arguments for the existence of angels and their duties. That is, it should perfectly satisfy itself that whatever arrangement prevails, or is manifested occasionally, in the world of matter and physical and celestial bodies, is not random and pointless. Rather, the Wise and Powerful One has committed the direction of all these into the hands of the angels, who are occupied with various types of action every moment under the command of the All-Powerful One. They do not act in vain, but cause various types of movement in heaven and earth in an altogether wise way for the achievement of grand purposes. No action of theirs is useless or meaningless.

I have already given some arguments in this book about angels and their duties. To recap, the easiest way to accept the existence of angels is that we should direct our reason to the following. It is admitted that for the training and perfection of our bodies, and in order for the desired actions of our senses be carried into effect, God Almighty has promulgated the law of nature that the elements and the Sun and the Moon and all the stars have been pressed into service to help our bodies and faculties perform all their functions in the best possible manner. We cannot escape from the verities that our eyes cannot perform their function through their own light unless they are aided by the light of the Sun, and our ears cannot hear anything through their faculty of hearing unless they are aided by the air teeming with sound. Does this not prove that Divine law has ordained that the perfection of

our faculties should be achieved through external means and that our nature is not such that it can dispense with the help of external means? If we observe carefully, we will find that not only in one or two matters, but for the perfection of all our senses and faculties and powers, we are dependent upon external help. As this law and system of God—the One without associate, whose works display unity and appropriateness—operates firmly, consistently, and compulsorily with reference to our external faculties and senses and our material needs, then does it not follow necessarily that there should be the same arrangement for our spiritual perfection and spiritual objectives, so that the similarity of the two systems should prove the Oneness of the Creator? It is obvious that the All-Wise One who has instituted this external system and has chosen that our bodies and faculties and senses should be perfected through the effect of external means like heavenly bodies and elements, etc., the same All-Wise and All-Powerful One would have chosen the same arrangement for our spiritual perfection. This is so because He is One without associate and there is unity and consistency in all His wise designs and works; the same being indicated by logical arguments. Thus, we give the name *angel* to the external means which affect our spirituality and fulfil our spiritual needs, in the same way as the Sun and the Moon and the elements help us with regard to our physical needs.

The foregoing discussion amply proves the existence of angels. Though we may not be able to penetrate into their true nature, nor is this necessary, but observing the uniformity and harmony of the law of nature as a whole, we are compelled to acknowledge their existence. Therefore, when we have readily accepted the external law, there is no reason why in the same way we should not accept the internal law. No doubt we shall have to accept the internal law in the same way as we have accepted the external law. That is the reason why God Almighty in His **Magnificent Book**, at various points, has set forth these two laws in matching words, as He says:

وَالَّذِينَ ذُرُّوا ۝ فَالْحَبْلِ ۝ وَفَرَّ ۝ فَالْجُرَيْتِ يُسْرًا ۝ فَالْمَقْسَسِ أَمْرًا ۝<sup>1</sup>

Meaning, God puts forward the testimony of the winds that separate the water vapor from the oceans and other waters as they should be separated. Then there is the testimony of airs which absorbs them like pregnant women. Then there is the testimony of the winds that carry the clouds to their goal. Then there is the testimony of the angels who work behind the scenes to activate all these functions and see them to their conclusion. This indicates that the winds have no power in themselves to lift the vapours from the oceans and to convert them into clouds and to cause them to send down rain exactly where it is needed and thus administer matters. **Angels** function behind the scenes in this entire operation.

In these verses, God Almighty first indicated, like philosophers, the cause of rain descending from the clouds and sets out how water becomes vapour and then becomes clouds, then in the last verse disclosed the reality<sup>2</sup> فَالْمَقْسَسِ أَمْرًا so that no one should imagine that the system of material causes and effects is adequate for the dispensation of God. Rather, a system of spiritual causes is behind this physical system which supports this visible system. At another place it is said:

وَالْمُرْسَلِ عُرْفًا ۝ فَالْحَصِفِ عَصْفًا ۝ وَالذُّشْرِ نَشْرًا ۝ فَالْفِرْقِ  
فَرْقًا ۝ فَالْمُلْقِي ذِكْرًا ۝<sup>3</sup>

This means that God Almighty puts forth the testimony of the winds and angels which proceed slowly and then God Almighty puts forth the testimony of the winds and angels who proceed firmly and fast, and then God Almighty puts forth the testimony of the winds that raise the clouds, and the angels which are appointed over them, and the winds

1. *Sūrah adh-Dhāriyāt*, 51:2–5 [Publisher]

2. *Sūrah adh-Dhāriyāt*, 51:2–5 [Publisher]

3. *Sūrah al-Mursalāt*, 77:2–6 [Publisher]

that carry everything that is spoken to the ears, and the angels who carry the Divine Word to the hearts.

In this way, God Almighty has combined the angels and stars in one place in the verse:

فَالْمُدَبِّرَاتِ أَمْرًا<sup>1</sup>

That is, in this verse, the seven planets have been mentioned as arranging the affairs of whatever is in the earth externally and the angels are mentioned as arranging them internally. The commentary *Fath-ul-Bayān* sets forth both these views in two traditions on the authority of Mu‘adh bin Jabal and Qushairī. Ibn Kathīr has reported on the authority of Ḥasan in relation to angels that: تُدَبِّرُ الْأَمْرَ مِنَ السَّمَاءِ إِلَى الْأَرْضِ. Meaning that all arrangements that are carried out between heaven and earth are carried out through the **means of angels**.

Ibn Kathīr writes that this is an agreed doctrine the **مُدَبِّرَاتِ أَمْرٍ** refers to angels.

Ibn Jarīr has interpreted the verse فَالْمُدَبِّرَاتِ أَمْرًا to mean that it refers to the angels, who carry out the arrangements of the universe. That is to say, that although on the surface, stars, the Sun, the Moon, and the elements carry out their functions, yet in reality it is carried out by angels.

Now that it is clearly established that by the Divine law of nature for the spiritual system there are—like the physical system—external influences which are called *malā’ikah* [angels] in the Holy Quran, it remains to be proven that whatever is also happening in the physical system is not determined and managed without the mediation of angels. The scriptural proof of that is obvious, because God Almighty has given the names *mudabbirāt* and *muqassimāt* [regulators and distributors] to angels and they are the means of the emergence and maintenance of all substances and their essence, to the extent that the

1. *Sūrah an-Nāzi‘āt*, 79:6 [Publisher]

Throne of God Almighty is also borne aloft by them. The following verse proves the appointment of angels over everything:

إِنْ كُلُّ نَفْسٍ لَّنَا عَلَيْهَا حَافِظٌ ١

The following verse of the Noble Quran also indicates this:

وَأَنشَقَّتِ السَّمَاءُ فَهِيَ يَوْمَئِذٍ وَاهِيَةٌ ٢ وَاللَّهُ عَلَىٰ أَرْجَائِكُمْ عَرِشٌ رَّبَّكَ فَوْقَهُمْ يَوْمَئِذٍ

This means that on the Day of Judgment, heaven will be rent asunder, appearing loose and listless, and will lose its faculties,<sup>3☆</sup> because the angels who were like the soul of the heavens and heavenly bodies will give up all the connections and will retire to the edges and on that day, eight angels will bear aloft the Throne of God Almighty on their heads and shoulders.

In his commentary on this verse, Shah 'Abdul-'Azīz writes that the durability of the heavens is on account of the spirits; that is to say, the angels who are like the spirits for heaven and heavenly bodies. Just as the soul safeguards the body and maintains control over it, in the same way some angels maintain control over the heavens and celestial bodies, and all celestial bodies exist only in connection with them, and the emanating activities of the planets take place through their means. Then, when those angels will depart from that body as the soul departs from the physical body, the whole system of the heavens will be upset just as the physical system is upset by the departure of the soul. Another verse of the Noble Quran also alludes to this very topic:

1. *Sūrah at-Tāriq*, 86:5 [Publisher]

2. *Sūrah al-Hāqqah*, 69:17–18 [Publisher]

3. ☆ In the original Urdu, the sub-footnote is included here. See pages 221–241 for its translation. [Publisher]



وَلَقَدْ زَيَّنَّا السَّمَاءَ الدُّنْيَا بِمَصَافِيحَ وَجَعَلْنَهَا رُجُومًا لِلشَّيَاطِينِ

<sup>1</sup> *Sūrah al-Mulk, Part Number 29—*

Meaning that, We have adorned the lowest heaven with the stars and We have made the stars the means of driving away satans.

It has been established by the Quranic text quoted earlier that the regulators and distributors of all matters from the heaven to the earth are angels, and now, this statement of Allah—glorified be His eminence—stating that the bright shooting stars are thrown in motion by those stars which are in the lower heaven. This might superficially appear to contradict the verses relating to the angels, but if we take a deeper look, there is no contradiction, because, as I have already stated, it is proven from the teachings of the Noble Quran that **the angels are like the souls of heaven and celestial bodies, and it is obvious that the soul of anything is not apart from it.**

This is the very reason why God Almighty ascribes shooting stars to angels in some places of the Noble Quran, while in some other places He has attributed that act of throwing to the stars, inasmuch as angels influence the stars as the soul influences the body. Then that influence proceeds from the stars and affects the earthly vapours that have the capacity to become shooting stars and they are set aflame by the power of God Almighty. In another way, the angels establish a connection with the shooting stars and direct them to the right and left with their light. No philosopher would deny the fact that the initiating causes of whatever happens on the earth or in the atmosphere are the stars and heavenly influences. Of course, not everyone can fathom this other abstruse mystery that the forces of the stars are realized through the benefit of angels. This mystery was first disclosed by the Noble Quran and then those with divine insight developed an interest towards it.

1. *Sūrah al-Mulk*, 67:6 [Publisher]

In short, this verse also provides a scriptural proof that the angels are like the spirit of life for the stars and heavenly forces. This is the very reason why God Almighty has sometimes ascribed the operation of the stars to the angels in the Noble Quran, and sometimes the operation of the angels has been attributed to the stars. The fact is that since **the angels, according to the Holy Quran, are like the soul for the stars, the Sun, the Moon and the heavens;** and the stability and durability of all things depends upon their connection with the angels; and all the celestial bodies, the stars, the Sun, the Moon and the heavens would undergo a sort of death if the angels **step aside;** then, given this situation, are they not like the soul for them, or are they something else?

I sorely lament the deplorable state of these *maulawīs* who, seeing all these manifest and clear Quranic statements, are still reluctant to accept the fact that angels have such a strong connection with heavenly bodies—rather, earthly and heavenly bodies for some angels which are **earthly** in scope—just like souls have with hearts. It is absolutely true that it is also proven by the Noble Quran that the angels maintain a permanent presence in the heavens, but isn't this other fact also proven true according to the same Holy Book that angels have a protective connection with every single heavenly body, and every star is dependent upon the assistance of angels in its survival, stability, and ensuing activities?

What a pity that these people who refer to themselves as *maulawīs* are completely infatuated with **condemning Muslims as kāfirs** without any basis, yet they fail to look upon the sacred and wise teaching of the Noble Quran with a prudent and penetrating eye! So then how can they be successful in understanding truth? They do not appreciate the Noble Quran in the least, and dismiss it as—God forbid—a collection of superficial ideas, remaining completely oblivious to the supreme strength, wisdom, and profound mysteries of the Noble Quran.

I presented this evidence **merely on a scriptural basis**, but proof of this fact on a rational basis—that whatever beneficial activity is taking place in the visible realm, the manifestation and movement of all those activities are actually occurring through the hidden works of the angels—would be produced **through diligent research on those activities** [proving] that Allah, glorified be His eminence, takes service from every single thing that was endowed with the capabilities to deliver that service. Therefore, to now hold the view that every change taking place in heavenly bodies and the celestial universe is caused only by external physical factors, without the need of any spiritual cause, is completely irrational because, if it were truly so that these changes in heavenly bodies and occurrences in the celestial universe—which comprise of many great benefits, and aid and assist the survival, health, and social needs of humanity on the condition that there be no disorder found in them—came about on their own without the intervening steps of intelligent agencies which can safeguard the design, understanding, expediency, and equilibrium; and [if] all our life's labour, survival, and social needs were left entirely to such things which have no intelligence, no comprehension, no capacity to perceive **an opportune moment**, no ability to protect their efforts from chaos and confusion, and no capability to distinguish the righteous from the wicked so that each may be dealt with in the manner deserved; then darkness and disorder would spread throughout the entire world and there would be no recognition of the Wise Creator—the Powerful, the Just, the Merciful, and the Benevolent [Lord]—nay rather, the continuation of life for these rational beings dwelling upon this earth could not go on for another instant and the world along with all its inhabitants would suffer the shock of witnessing its own end. Hence, what other proof would be clearer, more evident, and more illuminating than not seeing chaos and confusion in the design

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**

Rational proof that all affairs in the universe manifest through angels, and not of their own accord

of this heavenly and celestial universe, which would have been the case had this entire system been predicated upon lifeless and unintelligent objects? Therefore, the clarity of this argument grants us such insight to believe in the existence and need of angels as if we are actually seeing angels with our own eyes.

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**

The answer to the question as to why it is not permissible for the tasks assigned to angels in the physical world to be carried out automatically by each created thing through its natural faculties.

Should someone, at this juncture, raise the doubt as to why this option would not be viable that there are no intervening angels and everything carries out—through the command, permission, and standing judgment of God Almighty—that particular duty which is the will of Allah, glorified be

His eminence, then such a doubt would actually arise on account of a misconception; for, as I have already written just before this, it is a proven fact that the spheres of the heavens, the elements, and the celestial universe—which support our survival, life, and social order—do not possess knowledge, intelligence, or intent. It is, therefore, clearly impossible that they should be able to carry out for us such actions which can be done only through wise discrimination, moderation, planning, and a sense of expediency.

When God Almighty wills something to serve a particular object, He first empowers it with appropriate properties. Rain, for example, is an act of God that we require for various types of needs. And in accordance with the actions of His creatures, God sometimes sends rain at the opportune time, thereby safeguarding our crops and our well-being from the dangers posed by excess or shortfall; and, sometimes, when He wills to issue a warning to the world, He stops the rain to enter a country He wills, or sends more rain than usual, or less. Sometimes, in order to punish some people, a country, a city, a village or a tract of land is totally deprived of the benefits of rain. God spreads the clouds in the sky only to the extent to which He wills such clouds to spread, so that one field gets rain while another field that is adjacent to it, does not

benefit from even a single drop of rain and remains dry and parched, scorched by the heat of the sun.

Likewise, the air sometimes becomes foul, and subjects a city, a country, or a locality to a severe epidemic while some other places are totally safeguarded from it. Similarly, we see thousands of such phenomena as the result of profound Divine wisdom, which we can never ascribe to lifeless elements and bodies. And we know for certain that such works permeated with appropriateness cannot be performed by lifeless, non-cognizant and non-planning heavenly bodies, elements, or by the material creations of space. No doubt, God Almighty was capable of acquiring these things to do all such work, but if He had done so, He would have first invested these things with the faculty of understanding, consciousness, and the power of using a thing in its proper place. However, when this is not proven to be the case, it means that they are associated with other beings who have been granted the faculty of discrimination between the uses of different things. And those are angels.

I know that if a man who believes in God Almighty and believes Him to be Merciful, Beneficent, the Best of planners and Just, will never entertain the idea that God has handed over the whole machinery of the universe to things which have not been endowed with the faculty of discriminating between good and bad; and which are not blessed with the power of planning, of maintaining a state of equilibrium, or of recognizing the exigencies of a situation. Yes, a naturalist or an atheist, not having a belief in God Almighty, will doubtless have such an idea; but, out of ignorance, will say at the same time, that whatever is happening in the heavenly bodies, the elements, and in the creation of space is not based on wisdom or expediency; that there is no God, and, therefore, a belief in His wisdom and appropriateness is out of question; that, rather, by mere chance, mankind meets with fortune or misfortune as the result of happenings and changes taking place in the heavenly spheres and the earth.

Hence, there is a different way to convince such a man, that is a

very clear and quick way to silence him. And that is, that the powerful works of God Almighty and mighty prophecies which are granted to those gifted with revelation or to the holy ones who have gained communion with their Lord, are a strong, conclusive, and certain proof of the existence and attributes of the Perfect, Loving, and Glorious Allah, glorified be His eminence. But alas! There are very few who seek God Almighty with a sincere heart, hungering and thirsting for the path leading to His cognition. The world is filled largely with people who pay no heed to the voice of the crier, and do not attend to the caller, and do not wake up from their sleep, in spite of the cries of one who tries to awaken them. Having been granted the grace and the ability, and having been permitted by God Almighty to do so, I called upon all my opponents to verify this matter, but not a single one of them responded to me with a sincere heart and an honest quest for truth. And, had anyone attended to it, or even if anyone were to attend to it now, I am sure that the Living God, whose powerful works have always been a wonder for the rationalists, that Powerful and Self-Existent [God], who, from eternity, has been putting to shame and dishonouring the philosophers of this world, will bring home to him the truth by the manifestation of a bright Sign from the heavens.

The greatest evil of the world, which is responsible for so many other evils, and which makes people forget the life of the Hereafter, is that most people do not have faith in God Almighty, as they should. Some people in this age openly deny the very existence of God. And some, although they verbally profess a faith in Him, do not really believe in Him, as is evident from their actions and thoughts—the evidence of their hands and feet. They are so deeply engrossed in worldly affairs that they never even think of death. This is also because darkness has enveloped the hearts of most people, and not a ray of the light of Divine knowledge remains in their hearts.

Now, let it be clear that I have given complete proof for the existence of angels, the sum and substance of which is that God Almighty who, in His transcendence and holiness, is better than all that is best,

employs appropriate means to demonstrate His Signs and manifestations. And since bodies and material things—being confined by their personal characteristics and the finite limitations of their existence; and in comparison with the existence and the Being of the Creator, calling themselves as existing and present, and being particularized by their own will or natural actions; and considering themselves to have permanent existence comprised of themselves and excluding others — have drawn far away from the Cause of all causes and the Absolutely Benevolent. And around their physical being is a very thick veil of personal identification, self-conceit, and [the wonder of their] creation. Therefore, they are no longer worthy of directly receiving such graces of the Unique Being as could descend only if the above-mentioned veil had not intervened and their existence was to resemble non-existence wholly. Since the existence of all these things does not resemble non-existence, everything of this kind of creation emphatically and loudly proclaims its existence by its actions.

The Sun proclaims that I am the body upon which all heat, cold and light depends and that affects the world in 365 ways through 365 forms. And it causes heat where its rays fall and causes cold where its rays do not fall and rules over bodies and their matter, and upon their shapes and senses. The Earth proclaims that it is a body upon which are populated a thousand countries, and that it produces a variety of vegetation, and develops various types of minerals, and that it accepts heavenly influences like a woman. Fire proclaims by its actions that it is something that burns, possesses the characteristic power of combustion and is a local substitute for the Sun in the dark.

In the same way, everything on Earth proclaims its own praise. For example, Senna<sup>1</sup> claims that in the last part of the second stage, I increase metabolism and induce dryness in the first stage. Moreover, I alleviate phlegm, black bile, bilious temperament, soreness, and calm the mind, and I am beneficial in epilepsy, fissures, insanity, chronic

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1. *Cassia Senna* is a plant with healing and medicinal uses. [Publisher]

vertigo, painful flanks, mental constraint, colic, menstrual disorders, gout, muscular spasms, am a reliever of aphorisms, and a remedy for itching and scorpion bites, scabbiness and chronic fatigue, rheumatism—phlegmatic, choleric, or both—and I am beneficial for all types of melancholy.

Rhubarb claims that it is a tonic for the organs and promotes metabolism and causes dryness in the first part of the second stage. And, because I am easily absorbed, I also promote coolness, and possess within me many beneficial juices; I am arid, cause constipation, cleanse the skin, am beneficial in removing viscous matter, and am a remedy for the poisonous organisms which spread in winter, especially for scorpions, and facilitate the excretion of thick and thin humours of the body, facilitate menstruation and bowel movements, and strengthen the liver, and open up obstructions of the spleen and intestine, and dissolve the passing of wind. I am beneficial for chronic cough, and beneficial for the constriction of the heart, ulcer of the lungs, wounds of lungs and intestine, all kinds of oedema, and ulcerous jaundice and loose bowels, and beneficial for the saliva of the mouth, dysentery, disturbance of breathing, and passing of wind, cold sores, cholera, colic, piles, running sores, and intermittent fever.

Zedoary [*Curcuma zedoaria*] claims that I promote warmth and dryness in the initial part of the third stage and am very beneficial for maintaining body temperature, to relax and strengthen the vital organs—heart, brain, and liver—and to strengthen the contents of the belly (bowels, intestines etc.) and am a panacea for all kinds of poisons. Consequently, by the grace of God, I assist greatly, during the epidemic of cholera—if used in combination with a small quantity of saffron, musk, and ginger—along with sulphuric acid and the liquid mixture of white cardamom, mint and anise. Moreover, I relieve pain and strengthen eyesight. I burn up the stones in the bladder and dispel the colic, facilitate bowel movements, and intermittent fever, and am very beneficial for minor snake bites and scorpion stings, so much so that I even dispel the poison of deadly scorpions. With musk and the



extract of water lily, I provide immediate relief in the weakness of the heart. I support the declining pulse. Used along with a rose, I am beneficial for rheumatism and kidney and bladder stones. For constipation, I provide speedy relief if used along with the extract of cucumber seeds. I am beneficial for the colic in passing air. Moreover, if difficulties are suffered in childbirth, I induce childbirth if used with two doses of the water extract of root orchis mascula or milk or syrup of triangular thorn. I am beneficial for epileptic fits, and several diseases of the brain and nervous system. I am beneficial for inflammation in the back, armpits, groin, throat and granular swelling, and all kinds of swelling of the neck. I am beneficial during a plague. Used with vinegar, I relieve the swelling of the eyelashes. If rubbed upon the teeth, I relieve dental pain. Because of my soothing properties, I relieve pain if rubbed on puss or piles. Used as eye drops, I remove ophthalmia. If applied locally, I benefit in the difficulty of urination. If used with musk or other suitable medication, I am very beneficial for sensual vigour. Moreover, I am beneficial in epilepsy, depression, stroke, facial paralysis, flaccidity, shaking tremor, numbness of limbs, and all such diseases. I am a tonic for the nervous system and brain. If I am not available, Zerumbet is my substitute in many cases.

In short, all these things proclaim their own praise by virtue of their features and are veiled in the screen of their specific qualities and have therefore drifted away from the Fountainhead of Grace. Without the intervention of such things which are free from these veils, no design of the Fountainhead of Grace can establish a relationship with them inasmuch as the veil prevents the grace from reaching them. The wisdom of God Almighty, therefore, required that the primary manifestation of His designs should be a form of creation which should be empty of being veiled by the self, and should possess a form which, contrary to other things, should by its nature, be free from the intervening self and should serve God Almighty as His limbs, and their number should correspond to the designs of God Almighty, which are related to creation and all its needs. Those beings of unusual creation should possess

a nature like a crystal clear mirror and should be ever present before God Almighty.

Their selves should have two directions. One direction should be that of uniqueness, transcendence, and being highly imperceptible and free from veils. They should be different from other forms of creation and should have a complete resemblance with the Being of God Almighty by way of reflection. They should not be veiled by themselves. The other direction should be that they should have a relationship with the rest of creation and should be able to approach them with their influence. Thus, through this design of God Almighty, a wonderful form of creation called *angels* came into being. These angels are so lost in obedience to God that they have no will or fashion or focus of their own, and have no personal faculties whereby they could be kind to anyone on their own, or could be angry with anyone on their own, or could desire something on their own, or could dislike something on their own.

They are wholly like the limbs of the Divine. All the designs of God Almighty are reflected in their crystal clear mirrors and through their mediation spread in the whole of creation. God Almighty, on account of His perfect holiness, is in extreme uniqueness and transcendence; therefore, those that are not free from ego and from the opaqueness of veiled existence and are veiled by their self-consciousness, have no relationship with that Fountainhead of Grace. Thus, the need arose for a form of creation which, on the one hand, should be related to God Almighty and, on the other hand, to His creation so that they should obtain grace from His side and convey it to the other.

It is evident that nothing in this world has permanent self-existence with respect to either its physical body or its maintenance, its states of movement or rest, its changes taking place within itself or without, or with respect to the manifestation of all its attributes and of the possession and relinquishment of all its properties. Rather, all these processes of the created universe are supported by the One *حَيٌّ وَقَيُّومٌ* [*Hayyun wa Qayyūmun*—the Living, the Self Subsisting and All Sustaining God].

And although it appears we are not dependent upon any unseen assistance since we can move at will, stop at will, speak at will, and observe silence at will, it will definitely become clear with an enlightened view of the matter that in all of our own states of movement and rest, and in all our works, we do need assistance from the unseen. And God Almighty's everlasting sustenance is at work with regard to the sperm, with the *'alaqah* [clot], with the *mudghah* [piece of flesh], with the foetus, and in our every movement and rest, and in our speech and action.

In short, God Almighty's everlasting sustenance is at work in all that is needed by us by virtue of us being created. However, that Permanent Being does not descend upon us directly on account of the covering of the self around us, for there exists no compatible relation between us and the Rarest of the rare, the Highest, the Self-Sufficient, the Light of all lights. Every object among us, whether living or lifeless, is under a covering of the self and is very far removed from the Presence of the Holy God. Therefore, as between Almighty God and us, the being of angels is just as necessary as the existence of feelings and spiritual faculties are between the soul and the human body. This is because the soul was in a station of being alone and subtle, while the human body was veiled by its self-awareness and thus steeped in crudeness and darkness. Therefore, between the two, Almighty God created the spiritual faculties and feelings with two directions so that they may absorb the graces from the soul and develop good manners and civilized behaviour in the whole body.

**Let it be known** that man is also a **miniature universe**, and all the qualities, attributes, characteristics, and conditions of the larger universe are placed in him, as is evident from his powers and abilities. He is able to manifest, as an example, the power and qualities of all things. Like the Sun he has a light, like the Moon a brilliance, like the night a darkness, and like the Earth, he can be a source of a thousand works of good and evil. He grows and flourishes like the trees and attracts everything towards himself through his power of attraction. Again, his being a universe in miniature is also established by the fact that in his

true visions and pure dreams he finds all things of the universe mirrored in himself. Sometimes he sees the Moon in his visions and dreams, sometimes the Sun, sometimes stars, sometimes a myriad of streams and gardens, and sometimes fire and air, etc., and what is even more wonderful is that sometimes, in his true visions and pure dreams, he finds that he has turned into the Sun, or has become the Moon, or has become the Earth upon which are thousands of inhabited countries.

Hence, these arguments point undoubtedly to man's being a miniature universe; he embodies in himself examples of all that takes place in the larger universe. And a very fine way of understanding some of the very delicate and wonderful phenomena of the larger universe is to compare them with the universe in miniature and to see what insight it provides. For, both these universes are as two mirrors placed opposite each other and we can take the universe that we have examined in detail, as a standard for the purpose of investigating the mysteries of the other. And there is no doubt that the evidence derived from it can satisfy us.

Now that this foundation has been well established, it would be perfectly appropriate to say that angels are actually in the same relation to celestial bodies and earthly objects as spiritual faculties and feelings are in relation to the human body. For, just as the soul of man ministers to his physical body through the spiritual faculties and feelings, so does the Sustainer of the Universe, who is the ministering Spirit for the preservation and maintenance of all existence, as indicated in the verse <sup>1</sup> *اللَّهُ نُورُ السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ*, who is the Light of their life, who regulates the bigger universe through the agency of angels. And we cannot but admit that whatever arrangement prevails in the 'universe in miniature', a similar arrangement prevails in the larger universe as well; for, both these universes have sprung from the same Source, and the Oneness of God who has no associate, should result in the similarity of both these

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1. Allah is the Light of the heavens and the earth (*Sūrah an-Nūr*, 24:36).  
[Publisher]

arrangements, so that both of them, combined, should point towards the existence of one and the same Creator. This would be so because identity of arrangement supports the Oneness of God. The reason is that, had there been many creators, there would have been much discord in the system of the world. Thus, it is extraordinarily straightforward and clear that angels are as necessary to the larger universe as are man's spiritual faculties and feelings for the development of man who is a universe in miniature.

Here, an objection may be presented that if angels, in fact, are present, why are they not visible, and why we do not feel any assistance from them in our affairs? We clearly see that everything acts out of the natural powers gifted to it. For example, the creation of a child within the womb or the bearing of fruit by the trees, and the production of many different kinds of gems in the mines: they are simply the result of a natural process determined for them for ages. The process of evolution supports the animals, plants, and minerals to reach their perfection. This is maintained by sages of ancient times and is also corroborated by experience. For, sometimes we can bring the processes of the animal, plant, and mineral kingdoms under our own control; that is, we can regulate them to bring about desired results.

Take, for example, the case of abortion before full term and the case of miscarriage in women. Both can be diagnosed by a talented physician as a weakness of the womb. Then, in the beginning of pregnancy, the physician prescribes, for instance, a mild laxative, and having cleared the system of impurities, prescribes tonics, as, for instance, *jāwarish-e-lu'lu* [pearl stomachic tonic] and *dawaul-misk* [musk cardiac and nervine tonic], etc., and prescribes abstinence in sexual relations. Then, the treatment proves manifestly beneficial and miscarriage is averted. Similarly, when a competent gardener finds a fruit-bearing tree which is now yielding less fruit, he then concentrates on the source, and then, according to its various causes, he sometimes clips its branches; sometimes, digging a pit around it, irrigates it with the requisite amount of water; and sometimes supplies manure and ground bones to its roots.

Similarly, mining experts adopt suitable measures within the scope of their own science.

Very often all these people succeed in their endeavours. If, therefore, this order is under the control of angels, why can the angels not stand up to our efforts? This shows that in the days when people were ignorant of the greater achievements of science, the idea of the existence of beings like the angels was manufactured, a sign of human weakness that for every effect man searches for a cause, and when the true cause is not ascertained, there is manufactured, in an ignorant age, the idea of the existence of angels in order to satisfy the imagination.

Such are the unfounded ideas which the new light (cursed be this light) is inculcating in the minds of the newly educated. And I have been rather restrained in what I have said. Otherwise, these people's views do not stop at that, but criticize even the idea of the existence of God Almighty and deny that there is a Being who is the true Creator of everything.

Response: Let it be clear that the question as to why angels are not visible is an absolutely useless speculation. The angels, like God Almighty, are extremely subtle beings. Then, how can they be visible to our physical eyes? Is God Almighty, whose existence is admitted by even these philosophers, visible to physical eyes? Besides, it is not true that angels cannot be seen in any way, since those who possess insight behold angels with their spiritual eyes in their visions which they experience very often in a state of wakefulness. They talk to them and acquire knowledge of many things from them. I call to witness that Being in whose hands my life is, and who does not leave a cunning liar without disgrace and punishment, that in this explanation I am truthful when I say that I have, on many occasions, seen angels in the realm of visions and have acquired knowledge from them and have been told of past or future events, which turned out to be facts. Then how can I say that angels cannot be seen by anyone? Without doubt they are visible, but with other eyes. Just as these people laugh at these things, the insightful weep at their condition. If they were to keep company

with me, they could be satisfied through visions, but the trouble is that such people suffer from a form of arrogance. That arrogance is such that it does not permit them to come over in meekness and humility as seekers after truth.

And to imagine why we cannot feel the intervention of angels is actually an offshoot of the objection dealt with herein. When man is surrounded only by the veils of his own thoughts, he cannot see angels and can have no idea of Almighty God because of this veil. His belief only results from his thoughts. Similarly, he cannot have any realization of the working of angels, who are beings of a spiritual nature. Here, the following is an apt parable: A blind man denied the existence of the Sun. He said he could not vouch for its existence as he could not feel the Sun with his hands. The Sun said to him, 'O blind one, I cannot be known by grasping me, for I am very far away from your hands. You should pray to Almighty God that He may give you eyes. Then, through those eyes you will be able to see me.'

Should it be asked, 'If angels are the regulators and distributors of matters, then how do our plans succeed and most matters conclude according to our will through our projects and plans?', the reply is that our projects and plans are not independent of the mediation of angels and their suggestions and *ilhām* [revelation]. The functions that the angels perform by the command of God Almighty is carried out through persons who are naturally inclined towards acceptance of the suggestions of angels. For instance, when the angels desire to bring down rain upon a field, or a village, or a country with God's command, they cannot themselves become water nor can they make fire to perform the function of water, but they guide the clouds to the goal and, becoming regulators, cause rain to descend in accord with the quantity and the limit that has been determined. The clouds possess all those faculties which are possible in a lifeless article, which has no will and no intelligence, and which are in accord with its condition and the character of its elements, while the function of the angels is distribution and regulation. That is why they are called distributors and regulators.

Even the inspiration and *ilhām* that the angels perform is also according to the nature of the person concerned. For example, the *ilhām* that they communicate to Almighty God's chosen, they cannot communicate to others. Rather, they pay no attention to them. In accordance with this principle, everyone receives grace from the inspiration of angels according to his capacity. The help of angels is received with respect to the art or science to which one is inclined. For instance, when it is the will of Almighty God, glorified be His eminence, that someone's constipation should be overcome by a medicine, an angel suggests to the physician that such-and-such type of laxative should be administered to him. Then the physician feeds the patient either some turbid or *khyār shambār* [*cassia fistula*, also known as purging cassia, Indian laburnum], or *khisht syrup* [*Manna of Atraphaxis spinosa*], or scammony, or senna, or castor oil, or something else according to the angel's suggestion. And then, with the help of the angels, the bodily system of the patient accepts it and does not throw it out and the angels influence the action of the medicine and create a reaction in the body, and the undesirable matter is expelled from the body by the command of God. Through His extreme wisdom and perfect power, God Almighty does not let the system of external arts and science go to waste, and does not suspend His own divine controls and perpetual possession. Had God Almighty not possessed this minute control over the conditions of His creation and its continuation and destruction, He would definitely not have been God, nor would His Oneness have been established. It is true, however, that God Almighty has not desired that all these mysteries should become obvious and visible to the eyes of the world; for, if they had been obvious there would have been no merit in believing in them.

For example, if people would see Almighty God with their own eyes and witnessed the angels physically, this knowledge of theirs would have become a part of the other knowledge which man has gained by his senses or by experiment. In this way, belief in them would not have been a means of salvation, just as belief in a hundred other facts is not a



means of salvation. For example, we believe that the Sun and the Moon actually exist, and the Earth contains hundreds of kinds of animal and plants, and there are hundreds of kinds of mines, rivers, and hills, but can this belief of ours entitle us to any reward, or can we advance in the nearness to Almighty God by accepting the fact that these things exist? Definitely not. If there is such a man who believes in the angels of Almighty God, has faith in the existence of Heaven and Hell, in the weighing of actions on the Day of Judgment, who places his conviction in the bridge leading to Heaven, who accepts the truth of the existence of the Books of Almighty God which have been sent down, and the existence of His Messengers who have been appearing in the world, who believes in the Resurrection which must take place one day, and who believes in the One God with whom none is associated—then how is it that such a man is taken to deserve salvation?

Dear ones! Know it for certain that the reason is that such a man puts his faith in Almighty God while God is hidden from view, and he believes in the truth of the news of the unseen in His Book. In the eyes of Almighty God, he becomes righteous and pious-thinking and pious-minded and obedient and a good man and gets his salvation because of this sincerity of his. Otherwise, what connection is there between mere knowledge of physical objects and salvation? Can anyone on the Day of Judgment, when all mysteries shall be unravelled, say that he now believes in this Heaven and this Hell lying before him, in these angels standing in rows, in the balance in which actions are being weighed, and in the Lord of all the worlds who is sitting on the Seat of Judgment? Will such faith allow him to go free? No, definitely not.

What is the reason that he will not go free? Is it not that at that time he will have seen all the things which were hidden from his eyes earlier? He loses the opportunity to earn reward, which can be earned by he alone who is unaware of such obvious proofs, and realizes the truth by inference only from delicate hints. Alas! The people who display an undue enthusiasm for philosophy, their intellect is blocked by a veil. They do not consider that if knowledge of the existence of God and angels, of the

manner of the Resurrection, and of Heaven and Hell and Prophethood and Messengership, have been made as patent and obvious and clear as is the science of mathematics and some sections of physical science, medicine, and astronomy, what connection could such manifestly clear information have with salvation?

When we know salvation to be the loving grace of the Glorious God which is granted to the righteous, truly sincere, and the truly faithful people who accept the Divine mysteries on trust, what truthfulness, sincerity and purity can be indicated by the knowledge of obvious facts? We clearly see that just as we are convinced that one half of four is two, so is a scoundrel of the first rank convinced in the same way. We accept conclusively the existence of thousands—nay, *millions*—of things in the world, and we do not have the slightest doubt regarding them, but can we receive any reward for this belief? Definitely not.

That is why Almighty God has not revealed His Signs through His Prophets in the manner demanded by ignorant people throughout the ages. Rather, those who lack the capacity to accept the Prophet's claim forthwith were made to pass through a trial. Just as the Holy Quran has recorded that the ignorant Makkans conditioned their belief [in the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>] upon his restoring life to all the dead of Arabia, or upon his climbing up a ladder to the sky and his climbing down in their presence, with a Divine Book which they might hold and read! Those unintelligent people did not understand that if the reality was disclosed to view like that, there would have been nothing to distinguish between this and the Day of Judgment, and after witnessing such obvious Signs, how could the word faith be applied to this belief? What person is there who denies the obvious truths?

In short, the very foundation of the opinions of those subscribing to philosophy is flawed. They seek to include all matters of faith in the observed palpable sciences, and to prove the existence of angels, Heaven, Hell, and Almighty God just like much of the inhabited earth and many plants and mines have come to be discovered through contemporary research. However, how can something that God Almighty has

encompassed within the matters of faith since day one as a means to achieve the salvation of man reach the point of that degree of guidance in opposition to the will of God? Indeed, when a man advances from the stage of faith to the stage of cognition, he is undoubtedly gifted with the ability to see these things as a matter of spiritual guidance. The evidence in their support is superior than in the case of mathematical sciences, for mathematical proof is based mostly on circular assumptions, but religious truth in its highest stage of knowledge is free from doubt or assumptions.

We can prove such truth in the same way as we do any other fact in the world, in the most potent and obvious manner; nay, in a manner whose light is not to be found elsewhere. But unfortunate man does not pay any attention to those ways. He tries to arrive at the stage of *Haqqul-Yaqīn* [true certainty] by paths which the eternal law of Almighty God has not appointed for this purpose. It is as if he wished to test the sweet or bitter taste of a thing by placing it on his eyes, or as if he wanted to make the ears see while closing his eyes.

It should be realized, however, that in the matter of faith, Almighty God does not expect man to make an effort of which he is not capable. Rather, He has furnished fine arguments which, if considered thoughtfully by a sane man, would produce strong conviction in him. For example, believing in Almighty God is an essential religious requirement of belief in the unseen; yet, see how the Noble Quran abounds in arguments and satisfying proofs for the existence of the Creator. In the same way, though we cannot deliver angels physically into the hands of a denier or cause them to be seen executing their duties, still for a seeker of truth it is enough if he is convinced of the need of angels by observation of the minutely fine planning of the universe. If, however, he is an atheist, we shall first prove for him the existence of God, and then, we shall say, that the Being whom we call God has to be such that not even a leaf can fall without His command or will. And then we shall give proof of the fine purposes which underlie the bestowal on man of the bounties of Almighty God through the agency of the Sun, the Moon, the stars,

the clouds and the wind, etc., which are neither recognizable by these objects, nor are these latter possessed of the power to bring their influence to bear on the proper occasion as I have already just proven.

I have also proven that Almighty God does not do any work without intermediate agencies, and whoever He appoints as such an agent, He first grants them the strength and capabilities applicable for these duties. For instance, works requiring the exercise of reason are entrusted to rational beings, and those requiring volition to one having volition. Man's work is entrusted to man; animal's to an animal: and that requiring fineness of perception to one having fine perception. Thus, after all these proofs, without doubt, the need for the existence of angels is proven. In matters of belief this kind of proof suffices, so that there might not be placed on the believers a burden which is beyond his strength to bear, and so that he may deserve reward for his faith. For, if the existence of angels would have been proven by, for instance, physically holding an angel and pointing him out as one, then faith would no longer remain faith, and salvation would have become illogical. فَافْهَمُوا وَتَذَكَّرُوا وَلَا تَكُنْ مِنَ الْمُسْتَعْجِلِينَ [So, ponder over these things and try to understand, and do not be in a hurry to controvert them]. Author

## SUB-FOOTNOTE<sup>1</sup>

The present-day scholars of Astronomy, who are the scientists of Europe, are not actually in conflict with the Noble Quran in the conception which they hold regarding the substance of the heavens, because although the Noble Quran does not regard the heavens to be merely an expanse of emptiness, it has also not declared the heavenly matter that fills that emptiness to be rigid and dense and impossible to be torn apart. Rather, it describes it as soft and dense like air or water, in which the stars glide. This is indicated in the Word of Allah, glorified be His eminence:

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**  
**The Nature of the Heavens**

كُلٌّ فِي فَلَكٍ يَسْبَحُونَ<sup>2</sup>

The Greeks have considered the heavens to be dense matter which is formed layer upon layer like the scales of an onion. The sky of the last layer that encompasses all the layers is declared to be the ultimate extent of all creation which they call the 'Sky of the Skies' and also the 'Upper Limit of the Universe'. According to their speculation the last layer, along with three other skies called **Madir, Jouzehr, and Ma'il**, rotate from east to west, while the

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**  
The interpretation offered by the Greeks concerning the heavens does not align with the interpretation given in the Noble Quran. The explanation set forth in the Noble Quran regarding the existence of the heavens is wholly correct and such a self-evident truth that no sound intellect can reject it.

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1. Please see **Footnote** on page 200. In the original Urdu edition of *Ā'ina-e-Kamālāt-e-Islām*, the Promised Messiah<sup>as</sup> presented this sub-footnote along with the main text and footnote. For the ease of English readers, it is being presented as its own section. [Publisher]

2. All of them float in an orbit (*Sūrah Yā Sīn*, 36:41). [Publisher]

other skies rotate from west to east. In their speculation, the sky known as the Upper Limit of the Universe is the end of the universe and there is no empty space or existence beyond it. It is as if God Almighty has put a wall around the creation under His control, beyond which nothing exists—neither emptiness nor something existing.

The objections which the views of the Greeks invite are no secret—they are falsified not only in theory but also by observation. When modern telescopes have brought the most distant stars to view and when it is possible with their help to see the Sun and the Moon as if these were only at a distance of a few miles, it is surprising that the heavens—which according to the Greeks is dense matter and so dense as to be impenetrable and which is so big as to make the Sun and the Moon look like mere specks in comparison—should not have been discovered by these telescopic instruments. Even if the distant heavens were not visible, the lowest heaven, which is nearest, must have been visible. There is no doubt, therefore, that the picture drawn by the Greeks of the high heavens is not at all true, and it invites a host of objections from which there is no escape.

However, the account of the heavens, as stated in the Noble Quran, is absolutely correct and valid, which we cannot but accept as true. To criticize it would be to expose one's own ignorance and a proof of one's own prejudiced mind. Contrary to the Greeks, the Noble Quran does not declare the heavens to be made up of a solid substance; nor does it—like some ignorant people—declare them to be mere empty space that contains nothing. The error of the first of these is obvious as has just now been stated on the basis of rational arguments; and the second, namely, that the heavens have no material existence whatsoever is proven to be wrong by experimental observation; for, our experiments and observation of the higher regions up to the bright stars, which we are able to see, show that the Divine law is that God Almighty has not left the atmosphere as mere empty space. For example, someone going through the higher regions of the atmosphere in a balloon can bear

witness that however high one may fly, one does not come across a mere vacuum.

Our observation, therefore, can help us a lot in holding the view that though it is wrong to circumscribe the heavens like the Greeks, it is equally wrong to say that the heavens are a mere vacuum devoid of any created material substance. As far as we have reached through experiments, we do not see any absolute vacuum. How, then, can we say—against the conclusions drawn subsequent to a lengthy course of observation—that farther away, above our own atmosphere, there is a total vacuum? Is there any proof of this conjecture which runs contrary to the proven facts of observation? None at all. How then can anyone accept an unfounded conjecture? In the absence of any contrary and weightier evidence, how can we ignore the evidence which is conclusive?

Apart from this it would be derogatory of Allah, glorified be His eminence, to hold this view; as if God was unable to fill all space with creation; therefore He left a vast space empty after creating a little. I cannot say what conclusive argument there is with those who believe in the possibility of an absolute vacuum against the statement that there is no space without matter of some kind, however rarefied it may be. The argument from observation falsifies the views of those who hold that beyond a few balls of matter there is an infinite vacuum.

It is evident that experience or observation furnishes the most frequent form of proof in this world. For example, the assertion that man has two eyes and one tongue; two ears; that he is born through the private part of woman; that he is first an infant, then, passing through adolescence, becomes old, and dies at a certain age; as also our assertion, that man sleeps, eats, sees with his eyes, smells with his nose, hears with his ears, walks with his feet, works with his hands, that he has his head between two ears, and many other things; and a variety of properties and qualities which we have discovered in minerals, and the vegetable or animal kingdoms—what is the basis of these except observation? If

the argument from observation was to be looked upon with suspicion, all such knowledge will be totally disrupted.

The objection that may assail some minds, that if the heavens have a material existence why are we not able to see it, may be answered by saying that it is not necessary that all things should be visible to our eyes. How can that which is so very fine and expansive be seen? How can any telescope discover it? God Almighty describes the heaven as a very refined substance, as pointed out by the verse:

كُلٌّ فِي فَلَكٍ يَسْبَحُونَ<sup>1</sup>

Meaning that every star [i.e. celestial body] is gliding in its own heaven which is its defined orbit.

God Almighty, indeed, does not declare His Throne to be like the circumscribing heaven of the Greeks, nor has He described it as limited. Rather, He has called it the highest region which no other region can surpass in its qualities or size. To be so is not forbidden and impossible for something that is created and present. Rather, it is more likely that a region which is called the 'Throne of Allah' should bear a similarity with the Infinite God in its expanse and be unlimited.

If the objection is raised that the Noble Quran also says that at some time the heavens will be cleft asunder, and there will be holes made in it, then what does it mean if the heaven is only a fine substance? The answer to this is that by the heavens the Noble Quran frequently means all that is in the heavens; that is, the Sun, the Moon and all stars. Apart from this, every material body, whether thick or thin, is capable of being cut asunder, the fine things being especially susceptible of being cut asunder. Would it be strange, therefore, if in accordance with the command of the Powerful and All-Wise God the heavens experience some kind of cutting asunder? وذلك على الله يسير. [And this is easy for God].

1. *Sūrah Yā Sīn*, 36:41 [Publisher]



Finally, it must also be remembered that it is a great mistake to ascribe a literal meaning to every word of the Noble Quran. This sacred Word of Allah, glorified be His eminence, on account of its great eloquence, is full of fine metaphors. Therefore, to try to ponder over how the heavens will be shaken and rent asunder is really an undue interference with the broad significance of these words. We can only say that all these and many other similar words point towards the ultimate annihilation of the material universe.

The Word of Allah means that this created universe will inevitably be followed by devastation—all that has been made will be broken up, all combinations will be shattered, all matter will disintegrate and break into pieces, and every material object shall be consumed in the process of a general destruction. A number of verses of the Noble Quran point out that the rending or tearing asunder of the heavens, mentioned in it, cannot be taken to denote what the rending or tearing asunder of a hard and solid object means. At another place Allah, glorified be His eminence, says:

وَالسَّمَوَاتُ مَطْوِيَّاتٌ بِيَمِينِهِ<sup>1</sup>

Meaning that, at the time of the destruction of the universe, God Almighty will wrap up the heavens with His right hand. Now consider: if the phrase ‘splitting of the heavens’ were to be taken literally, meaning that they will be torn asunder, then the word **مَطْوِيَّاتٌ** [*maṭwiyyāt—folding*] would be altogether incongruous and contradictory—for [in this verse] there is no mention of rending or tearing, only of folding. There is another verse found in *Sūrah al-Anbiyā*, Part 17, which is as follows:

1. *Sūrah az-Zumar*, 39:68 [Publisher]

يَوْمَ نَطْوِي السَّمَاءَ كَطَيِّ السِّجِلِّ لِلْكُتُبِ كَمَا بَدَأْنَا أَوَّلَ خَلْقٍ نُعِيدُهُ وَعَدَّا عَلَيْهَا وَإِنَّا لَنَّا  
فَاعِلِينَ<sup>1</sup>

Meaning that, 'On that Day We shall wrap up the heavens, as a letter has wrapped within it a number of different subjects. The process, through which this universe had passed before it had assumed its material existence, will be reversed, and it will be made to pass back to nothingness. This is a promise binding upon Us. We shall certainly perform it.'

[*Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī*] has also recorded a hadith on this subject, of which the following words are noteworthy:<sup>2</sup> وَ تَكُونُ السَّمَوَاتُ بِيَمِينِهِ<sup>2</sup>; that is, 'wrapping up' means that God Almighty will hold and conceal the heavens in His right hand, and just as now the handiwork of God is apparent but their Cause [namely God] is hidden, at that time, the Cause of all things will become apparent and all things brought into being by Him will become hidden from view in the hollow of nothingness. All things, turning to Him, will be consumed by a destructive manifestation of the Supreme Being; all things will abandon their abodes and centres, and will be replaced by a Manifestation of the Divine; and, after the destruction of the imperfect causes, the Real and Absolute Cause will make His Countenance manifest. This is indicated in the following:

كُلُّ مَنْ عَلَيْهَا فَإِنَّ وَ يَبْقَى وَجْهُ رَبِّكَ ذُو الْجَلَلِ وَالْإِكْرَامِ<sup>3</sup> لَيْسَ الْمَلِكُ الْيَوْمَ إِلَهُ الْوَاحِدِ  
الْقَهَّارِ<sup>4</sup>

Meaning that: Through His overpowering manifestation, God Almighty will obliterate everything and thus make manifest His

1. *Sūrah al-Anbiyā'*, 21:105 [Publisher]

2. *Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī*, Kitābut-Tauḥīd, Bāb Qaulullāh Ta'ālā: Limā Khalaqtu Biyadayya, Hadith 7412 [Publisheer]

3. *Sūrah ar-Raḥmān*, 55:27-28 [Publisher]

4. *Sūrah al-Mu'min*, 40:17 [Publisher]

Oneness and Uniqueness. God Almighty's promises are not like something uttered casually, which might later have to be fulfilled perfunctorily—such promises do not befit the Majesty of the All-Wise and All-Knowing God. It is the weak human, the fulfilment of whose promises cannot always remain free from the obstacles of affectation and weakness, or constraints and helplessness. Moreover, the fulfilment of human promises is subject to accidental circumstances—not on knowledge, certainty, and eternal wisdom. But the promises of God Almighty are manifested in accordance with His eternal attributes; His promises are one of the branches of His infinite wisdom.

And if someone raises the objection here as to why God Almighty has limited the number of heavens to seven, the reply is that this really refers to the different influences which the various celestial bodies absorb from the different heavenly regions, and which are then transmitted to the earth. This is elaborated in the following verse:

اللَّهُ الَّذِي خَلَقَ سَبْعَ سَمَاوَاتٍ وَمِنَ الْأَرْضِ مِثْلَهُنَّ يَتَنَزَّلُ الْأَمْرُ بَيْنَهُنَّ لِتَعْلَمُوا أَنَّ اللَّهَ عَلَى كُلِّ شَيْءٍ  
قَدِيرٌ وَأَنَّ اللَّهَ قَدْ أَحَاطَ بِكُلِّ شَيْءٍ عِلْمًا ○ — <sup>1</sup>Part Number 28

Meaning that: The heavens were created by God Almighty created the heavens to be seven in number, and so were seven earths brought into being. He projected the influences of the seven heavens, which has been placed in them by the command of Allah, on to the seven earths, so that man might know that God Almighty can create everything. And that He has the perfect power to create everything and to implement all His designs and all His works in a variety of ways. Thus you may expand your knowledge and develop the sciences, the arts, Astronomy, Medicine and Geography by which way man may realize the greatness of God—how His knowledge and perfect wisdom is enveloping everything, and by what perfect technique and by what solid arrangement the relationship is maintained between the heavens and what is

1. *Sūrah at-Ṭalāq*, 65:13 [Publisher]

in them on the one hand, and the earth on the other, and how the earth has been granted the capacity to accept influences, and how the heavens and the heavenly bodies have been granted the power to impart such influences.

And let it also be realized that just as the **descent**, both of spiritual and physical phenomena, takes place from the heavens, and the influences of the angels combining with those of the heavenly bodies descend upon the earth, so have the earth and the dwellers of the **earth** been given both the spiritual and the physical powers of accepting such influences, so that those who influence and those who accept the influence may be on a plane of complete equality.

And by the seven earths are meant the seven regions of the populated part of the earth which, in their relation to one another, lie one above the other. It would not be inappropriate if we call these seven regions the seven *aqālīm* [*climates* or *regions*], but the reader must not fall into the error of supposing that the division of the earth into seven *aqālīm* by the Greeks, which divisions were adopted by Muslim savants in the early days of Islam, is correct or perfect. What I mean by division here is a correct division from the purview of which nothing is excluded and every region of the earth is included in one such division or other. I am not concerned with establishing whether such a true and perfect division has ever been attempted or affected. What I mean to point out is only that the popular idea that the earth should be divided into seven parts was, as it were, divinely inspired, and bears witness to the heavenly division.

Again, if the objection is put forward that the Noble Quran in several places says that God made the heavens and the earth in six days is proof of His being subject to a disability, for no sooner does He intend to do a thing than such a thing must come to pass, as He Himself says:

إِنَّمَا أَمْرُهُ إِذَا أَرَادَ شَيْئًا أَنْ يَقُولَ لَهُ كُنْ فَيَكُونُ<sup>1</sup>

1. *Sūrah Yā Sīn*, 36:83 [Publisher]

Meaning that: When God Almighty intends to do something, His intention is charged with a force and a power by which the mere saying: ‘Be’—the visionary picture of the thing that does already exist in His knowledge—causes that thing to come into existence.

The answer to this objection is that the power and strength to do something does not necessarily imply that the thing be accomplished of itself forthwith. Nay, rather, the power and intention would be perfect only when they are executed so as to bring about the intended result, sooner or later, in accordance with the real intention of the doer. For example, we cannot call a man perfect in his walk who can walk fast but not slow; we shall call him perfect who is capable of walking both fast and slow. Again, a man who always keeps his arm extended and is incapable of withdrawing it to himself cannot be called physically fit, as is a man who always keeps standing and is unable to sit. Such a man is an invalid and would be described as a disabled person. Therefore, ‘power’ connotes the ability to do a thing both at once and after a time. If only one such ability was present it would not constitute ‘power’, but would be evidence of weakness and a lack of power.

It is surprising indeed that our opponents do not look even at the divine law of nature by which divine decrees are executed sometimes at once, and at times with some delay. There is, moreover, also reason to believe that the destructive attributes of God find their expression mostly at once, and the manifestation of the finer and gentle attributes is delayed and takes place slowly. For example, the child in the mother’s womb takes nine months to develop completely; but death does not necessarily need much time. A single evacuation or vomit in a case of cholera sometimes sends the patient to the next world in a single moment—the body which had attained its physical and mental perfection in number of years, leaves him in an instant.

What I have so far said in reply to this objection will, in my opinion, suffice for the present. I, therefore, wish to close the reply here. Nevertheless, it is necessary to clearly reiterate that the perfect intention—like the perfect power—connotes both the immediate and the

delayed execution of the intention. For example, we can just as well intend a thing to happen after, say, ten years, as we can intend it to happen at once. For example, the railway, the telegraph, and hundreds of other new inventions which are being made today, were undoubtedly within the intention and knowledge of God from the beginning, but for thousands of years they remained undiscovered. The intention existed from the very beginning, but it remained a secret, and manifested itself at its proper time. When the time for its fulfilment arrived, God Almighty made a people devote their thoughts and energies to these things and helped them, making them successful in their plans.

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**

Why did God Almighty create the heavens and the earth in six Days?

In this connection, there is another objection put forward by some ignorant Āryas. They say that Allah the Exalted says in the Holy Quran:

إِنَّ رَبَّكُمُ اللَّهُ الَّذِي خَلَقَ السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضَ فِي سِتَّةِ أَيَّامٍ ثُمَّ اسْتَوَىٰ عَلَى الْعَرْشِ<sup>1</sup>

Meaning that: God, who is your Lord, made the heavens and earth in six days and then settled Himself on His Throne.

It is asked: 'Why these six days? Granted that most of God's works are of an evolutionary character. Allah's attribute of creation manifests itself as a process of evolution in the world of minerals, vegetables, and animals by gradually bringing everything to its complete development—but this specification of six days is incomprehensible.

The answer is that the mention of six days alludes to the stages of creation; that is, that everything that has come into being as a creation, having a body and physical character—whether it is composite or single, whether it is the universe comprising the earth, the heavens and all that is in them, or whether it is a microcosm of the universe meaning thereby man—reaches its final and complete development after passing

1. *Sūrah Yūnus*, 10:4 [Publisher]

through six stages of coming into being, in accordance with the wisdom and power of Almighty God. This is a general law and is not limited to the initial creation. Thus Allah, glorified be His eminence, mentions the same six stages in relation to the creation of every human being, as is stated in the verse of *Sūrah al-Mu'minūn* in the 18th Part of the Holy Quran;

وَلَقَدْ خَلَقْنَا الْإِنْسَانَ مِنْ سُلَالَةٍ مِّنْ طِينٍ ۝ ثُمَّ جَعَلْنَاهُ نُطْفَةً ۝ فِي قَرَارٍ مَّكِينٍ ۝ ثُمَّ خَلَقْنَا النُّطْفَةَ عَلَقَةً ۝ فَخَلَقْنَا الْعَلَقَةَ مُضْغَةً ۝ فَخَلَقْنَا الْمُضْغَةَ عِظْمًا ۝ فَكَسَوْنَا الْعِظْمَ لَحْمًا ۝ ثُمَّ أَنشَأْنَاهُ خَلْقًا آخَرَ ۚ فَتَبَارَكَ اللَّهُ أَحْسَنُ الْخَالِقِينَ ۝<sup>1</sup>

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**

The reason and evidence behind the creation of the heavens and the earth in six days

Meaning that: We created man first from the clay which was the essence of the different kinds of earth and contained all the powers which the earth possessed so that in respect of the physical body too, he may become a miniature universe and may embody in himself the qualities and powers of all earthly objects, just as in a spiritual sense also he is a microcosm of the universe, according to the verse:

فَإِذَا سَوَّيْتُهُ وَنَفَخْتُ فِيهِ مِنْ رُّوحِي<sup>2</sup>

Moreover, by reason of the perfect human attributes and his being a perfect reflection of God, he is the perfect manifestation of the Divine Spirit. Next, We ordained another process for the birth of man, and that process was that We created in him the sperm and lodged it securely in a safe depository, which is created in the womb simultaneously. (The words قرار مكين [safe depository] were adopted in order that they may apply both to the womb and the placenta) and then We made the sperm into a clot, and the clot into a piece of flesh, and from this

1. *Sūrah al-Mu'minūn*, 23:13–15 [Publisher]

2. So when I have fashioned him in perfection and have breathed into him of My Spirit (*Sūrah al-Hijr*, 15:30). [Publisher]

flesh we made bones in some parts of the flesh and covered the bones with muscles and skin, and after that We made it into another creation; that is, We invested him with a soul. So, how Blessed is that God who, in His works of creation, excels all creators in the beauty and perfect wonder of His creation!

Observe that, even in this instance, God Almighty states His law of nature to be the same; meaning that man attains His full development after passing through six stages of creation. It is clear that there is a strong resemblance between the larger universe and the 'miniature universe'. The Quran affirms that man is indeed a 'miniature universe.' This verse alludes to that very truth:

لَقَدْ خَلَقْنَا الْإِنْسَانَ فِي أَحْسَنِ تَقْوِيمٍ<sup>1</sup>

Meaning that man has been called the best of creation because of having assimilated all the qualities and properties of the universe, having been endowed by God with a portion of each of such different qualities and beauties. Therefore, because of the resemblance between the two universes and because of the existence of a state of correspondence between the actions of the One and Only Creator, we are compelled to accept the position that the same stages of creation which are to be found in the 'miniature universe' are also to be found in the process of creating the larger universe. We clearly observe with our eyes that this 'miniature universe' which is called by the name of 'man', passes through six stages of development, and there is no doubt that this universe [i.e. man] is like a mirror for the identification of the hidden secrets of the larger universe. When, therefore, the former is proven to pass through six stages of the development, we can say with certainty that, in the process of its creation, the larger universe also passed through six stages—the result of the six causes or manifestations—evidence of which has been preserved in the six planets. Their lasting impact is thus proven

1. *Sūrah at-Tīn*, 95:5 [Publisher]



rationally. And it is believed in learned circles that the six planets have something to do with the development to completion of the human foetus. There is for instance, full discussion of this subject in *Sadīdī*.<sup>1</sup>

Some ignorant people put forward the objection with reference to this verse that the recent researches in medical science do not support this view of the development of the human foetus in the womb; that the modern view rather proves the opposite. This objection is based either on great ignorance or, uninhibited prejudice. No one skilled in medical science is needed to demonstrate this. Everyone can discover the truth himself devoting some time to the examination of children born after full development or incomplete development or those who are aborted or miscarried. And, as I know it from personal observation, it is undoubtedly a fact, that when God intends to make it to grow in the womb from a spermatozoa, the ovum and the spermatozoa mingling together are embedded in the wall of the uterus, and after some days are made into something like a clot wrapped within a membrane which increases in size with the growth of the child until it becomes a bag of earthen colour looking like a bundle within which the child attains its full development. We know from the Holy Quran, and recent investigations support the view, that the larger universe, till the time of its full and complete creation, was like a bundle, as Allah, glorified be His eminence, points out in the verse:

أَوَلَمْ يَرِ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا أَنَّ السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضَ كَانَتَا رَتْقًا فَفَتَقْنَاهُمَا وَجَعَلْنَا مِنَ الْمَاءِ كُلَّ شَيْءٍ حَيٍّ<sup>2</sup>

Part 7—

Meaning that: Allah says, have the disbelievers not seen that the heavens and the earth were tied together like a bundle and We opened them up? The disbelievers, of course, did not see the heaven and the earth

1. *Sadīdī* refers to *Kullīyyāt Sadīdī*. It is a collection of medical treatises, published by Namay Press, Lucknow, India, 1307 AH. [Publisher]

2. *Sūrah al-Anbiyā'*, 21:31 [Publisher]

being created nor did they see their bundle, but the reference here is to the heaven and earth of spirit, the bundle of which was opened to the view of all of Arab disbelievers and the bounties of heaven were made to spread upon the earth.

Reverting to the earlier subject, I wish to state that the mingling of the sperm and ovum is the first stage of development, and then, this composite having the requisite powers of binding and being bound, assumes a redness under the influence of an excitement. In other words, the semen which was a product of the blood returns to its original colour [of the blood]. This is the second stage. Then that clot of blood, which is called عَلَقَةٌ [*‘alaqah*—clot], turns into a مَضْغَةٌ [*mudghah*—piece of flesh], which bears a faint resemblance to the shape of a human form. This is the third stage. Close examination of the aborted foetus in this stage reveals some traces of the transformation of the foetus into the human form. Many an abortion takes place in this stage. Women who have suffered this abortion or work as midwives are very familiar with this matter.

The fourth stage is that in which bones are formed from the مَضْغَةٌ [*mudghah*—piece of flesh] as is pointed out in the verse:

فَخَلَقْنَا الْمَضْغَةَ عِظًا<sup>1</sup>

The definite article *al* on المَضْغَةُ [*al-mudghah*] is for the purpose of particularization, the object of which is to point out that the whole of the flesh does not turn into bones, but the flesh of those regions where bones are needed hardens and turns partly into bones by the command of God Almighty and partly remains as a soft piece of flesh as before. In this stage, the human form becomes manifestly apparent, to detect which one does not require any microscope. The true human form takes its shape in this stage, but it is still devoid of *lahm* [flesh]—that heavy, graceful, and sparkling clothing which brings to view all the

1. *Sūrah al-Mu'minūn*, 23:15 [Publisher]

features of the body, imparting a freshness, beauty, and proportion to the physical appearance of man.

Then there is the fifth stage in which the human frame is covered with *lahm* [flesh] in proportion to the needs of the particular part of the body. This is the flesh which is consumed as the result of starvation or disease, and many a time a man becomes so emaciated that he is nothing but skeleton—the same that was in the fifth stage—as is the case of those suffering from hectic fever, consumptives disease and diabetics in an advanced stage. And if the man is destined to live, God restores the flesh to him. In short, this is the same flesh which gives beauty and lustre and proportion to the body, and there is no doubt that this flesh keeps on depositing on the human outline in the foetus condition, and when the foetus has acquired sufficient growth, it is, with the command of God Almighty, quickened with life. It is then that from the condition of a vegetative growth it assumes an animal state and begins to make movements in the womb. In short, it is established that the child progresses to the animal from the vegetative state when thick muscle becomes distributed proportionally over the body. This has been proven by man's constant observation and experience. This is exactly the account mentioned by the Noble Quran and consistently borne out by observation. Who but an unwise person can find fault with it?

Reverting again to the earlier topic, I wish to state that as in the case of 'miniature universe', i.e. man, the law of God is that its development is completed after it has passed through six stages, the same law of nature guides us to the rational view that in the beginning of creation when the larger universe was brought into being, God must have kept in view these six stages in its creation, and every stage, with the object of differentiating one from the other, must have been assigned a day or certain length of time, just as the six stages of man's development correspond to six periods of time. That a week of seven days is agreed on by the whole world and that, deducting one free day, the remaining six are devoted to work, points out to us that the six days of the week are in

fact a memorial to the six days in which the earth and the heavens and what is between them was created.

If anyone still does not accept this position and persists in denial, I would say that so far as I am concerned, I have given proof of six stages of creation of the 'larger universe', corresponding to the six stages of the development of the 'miniature universe', and have also referred to the six working days which prevail throughout all the people of the world, and have also proved that all processes of God's creation are evolutionary. Therefore, if this argument does not suffice in the eyes of an objector, it is incumbent upon him to give some proof in support of the view that God created the physical universe in a single instant, and not as a result of an evolutionary process.

Everyone knows that the same God exists who was before, and the same creative process exists as was beforehand and we clearly see that God completes the development of all creation in an evolutionary process—no one can say that God was strong before and therefore quick, but that now He is weak and slow. We would rather say that such is His law of nature since eternity that He creates all of His creation through stages. The events of the present tell us that the same development by stages was adopted in the ancient and beginning of times.

It would be foolish on our part not to see a glimpse of the past in the mirror of the present. A glance at the present way of creation not only proves that God Almighty brings everything into perfection through stages, but also that there are six stages in the development of all creation. The wisdom of Allah has so ordained that the birth of every creation undergoes six stages, and comes to completion in six intervals. Look at any creation—the same six stages will be proven for it. In other words, it would be proven that the completion of all physical bodies culminates in six stages. This is not limited to humans. You will find the same six stages in the physical completion of thousands of animals that dwell upon the earth.

Another marvellous phenomenon is that these six stages are not limited to physical creation; rather, they are also found in the realm

of the spiritual world. For example, a little reflection would reveal that there are six stages in spiritual creation. In the beginning, akin to sperm, it only has a far-fetched capacity to absorb the influence of truthfulness. Thereafter, after that capacity is mingled with a drop of the mercy of God—just as the sperm of a man mingles with the ovum of a woman—then the spiritual condition of man moves from *nutfah* [sperm drop] to عَلَقَةٌ [*‘alaqah*—clot] and some relation with the Exalted Creator begins to emerge—just as the word عَلَقَةٌ [*‘alaqah*—clot] indicates a relationship. Then the عَلَقَةٌ [*‘alaqah*—clot] turns into مضغة [*mudghah*—piece of flesh] with the help of righteous deeds, just as the blood changes from عَلَقَةٌ [*‘alaqah*—clot] into مضغة [*mudghah*—piece of flesh] with its relationship with the menstrual blood. Yet its organs are uncompleted.

As is the case with مضغة [*mudghah*—piece of flesh], which lacks the organs containing the bones, it lacks ardour, perseverance, and steadfastness for the sake of Allah, though it does have humility and softness. Although it does not have full vigour and hardness at this stage, like the مضغة [*mudghah*—piece of flesh], it is capable of bearing the impact of Divine decrees and determination to some extent. In other words, it is capable of being ground down by destiny and withstanding its impact to some extent. This is because عَلَقَةٌ [*‘alaqah*—clot], being liquid, is incapable of withstanding the act of being ground down, but the مضغة [*mudghah*—piece of flesh] can withstand *mudgh* [being ground down]—that is why it is called مضغة [*mudghah*—piece of flesh].

The stage of مضغة [*mudghah*—piece of flesh] is thus when some taste of the sweetness of the love of God is experienced by the heart, and it invites the manifestation of the attribute of *jalāl* [grandeur]. He is then tested with calamities, and like the lump of flesh, he is ground down under the teeth of providence like ground meat. In short, the مضغة [*mudghah*—piece of flesh] is the third stage of the life of the spiritual pilgrim.

Then there is the fourth stage when, after steadfastly enduring the blessing of being tested with calamities, it earns the reward of the human shape—that is, he is granted a human form in terms of spirituality. Like

a human being, he is granted two eyes, two ears, a heart, a mind and all other essential faculties and organs. And, in accordance with the verse:

أَشَدَّ أَعْيُنًا عَلَى الْكُفَّارِ رَحْمَةً بَيْنَهُمْ<sup>1</sup>

he starts showing firmness or leniency as demanded by the occasion. That is, each moral quality is exhibited at its proper time and the manners of following the right path are safeguarded. Every deed and every statement is carried out according to its appropriateness—leniency when leniency is required, firmness at the time when firmness is required, and lowliness or standing upright as appropriate for the occasion. Similarly, he employs all limbs as appropriate for the occasions. This stage is similar to the stage of the foetus when it advances from the stage of مضغة [*mudghah*—piece of flesh] to assume a complete human shape—the bone appears where a bone is needed, and the flesh remains flesh where flesh is needed and does not turn into bone. All the organs develop their distinctive shape. But at this stage there is no beauty, freshness, or balance in the organs. It is just a skeleton, visible only with minute observation.

Thereafter, the favour of Allah raises him by making him used to repeated opportunities and purification of the self, to the ultimate point of annihilating the self for the sake of Allah—thereby covering the skeleton with the flesh of a wide variety of blessings, and making his face and the entire structure lustrous. Then his face shines with the light of the perfection of faith and his body shows the full lustre of having attained the perfection of faith. This stage resembles the stage of the foetus when its bones are covered with the skin and beauty and due proportions of the body parts are manifested.

Thereafter comes the sixth stage of spiritual development, which is exemplified by the verse:

1. Hard against the disbelievers, tender among themselves (*Sūrah al-Fath*, 48:30). [Publisher]

ثُمَّ أَنشَأْنَاهُ خَلْقًا آخَرَ<sup>1</sup>

This is the stage of *baqā* [revival], which is attained after the stage of *fanā* [annihilation]. At this stage, the Holy Spirit is bestowed fully and a spirit of spiritual life is breathed into the person.

Similarly, these six stages are comprehended in the Word of God Almighty. First is the stage of letters which are the bearers of the Word of God and are like seeds for the Book of Allah. They do not possess any part of the intended meanings, but they do have a distant capacity to express them. The second stage is that of words, which took a palpable shape with that seed. They do not have a close relation with the intended meaning, but are a closer means of expressing them. The third stage is that of incomplete sentences that had not attained the status of the complete message because the Word of God had not yet manifested its countenance fully. However, these sentences had an ample portion of the intended meanings; therefore, they were like limbs for the full Word of God. Depending upon whether they are short or long, they are called *āyāt* [verses] and *sūrahs* [chapters]. The fourth stage is that of the complete, elaborate, and discriminating Word which had been revealed completely and incorporates in it all the scholarly points of wisdom, episodes and news of the past, commandments, laws and ordinances, limits, promises, warnings and glad tidings, rigidity as well as leniency, harshness and compassion, and verities and subtle points. The fifth stage is that of fluency and eloquence which has been bestowed upon this Word for beautification and embellishment. The sixth stage is that of the blessings, holy impact, and spirit of attraction which is present in the Holy Word and illuminates the entire Word and proves that it is a living and enlightened discourse.

Similarly, these same six stages can be seen present in the writing of a wise and eloquent writer, although that writing may not reach

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1. Then We developed it into another creation (*Sūrah al-Mu'minūn*, 23:15).  
[Publisher]

the level of a miracle. The letters of which that writing is composed—whether they be Arabic, English, or Hindi—must have an a priori existence. So this is the first stage which is a distant means of expressing the intended subjects, but has no part in them. Then the second stage is that of words that will be formed from the determined letters. They still do not partake of the intended meanings and subject, but are a closer means of achieving them. Then the next stage is that of sentences, which do not yet fully convey the intended meanings, but do have some share in them. They are like limbs for the subject that the writer has in mind. Then the fourth stage is that of the completed essay which emanates from the heart of the writer and is recorded on a piece of paper in its entirety and encompasses all of the intended meanings and subject. Then the fifth stage is to amplify these plain words and expressions through the beauty of eloquence and to adorn them with the charm of eloquent rhetoric. The sixth stage which immediately follows the fifth stage is that the composition should possess a spirit of making an impact that attracts hearts and captivates minds.

Now ponder over this and see that these six stages bear similarity with, and are an example of, what have been named in the Noble Quran as *nutfah* [sperm drop], عَلَقَةٌ [*‘alaqah*—clot], مضغة [*mudghah*—piece of flesh], and then some مضغة [*mudghah*—piece of flesh] and some bones—that is to say a sketch of the human form, then a full form of the human being, and then a living human being.

I had also intended to respond to the questions: ‘Why was the earth made in four days, and the heavens in two?’ and ‘Why it is written that the Throne of Allah is borne aloft by four angels, and that eight of them would bear it on the Day of Judgment?’, and ‘What is the meaning of the saying that in the beginning, the Throne of God Almighty was upon the water?’ However, in view of the shortage of time and the subject getting long, and the responses to these questions being filled with points of wisdom and calling for a prolonged discussion, I will now close this footnote. God willing, I will address these issues in *Barāhīn-e-Aḥmadiyya* Part V. Thus, it will become clear to all that, in making



such objections, our hasty and senseless critics have only exposed their depravity of insight and understanding, and how distanced they and their doctrines are from the subtleties of truthfulness; as well as what excellences of verities, insights, and subtleties are embedded in the holy teachings of the Noble Quran and how it encompasses all spiritual virtues and beauties.

In the end, I pray:

O All-Powerful God! O Guide of Your Servants! Manifest the insights and verities of the Noble Quran upon these ignorant people, just as You have made the present age a manifestation of new inventions. Draw this age towards Yourself, towards Your Book, and towards Your *Tauḥīd* [Oneness of God].

*Kufr* [disbelief] and *shirk* [associating partners with God] have grown so very much while fidelity to Islam is waning. Now—O Noble Lord!—cause the breeze of Your *Tauḥīd* to blow in the East and in the West and manifest a Sign of attraction in the heavens.

O Merciful Lord! We are in desperate need of Your mercy.

O our Guide! We are in urgent need of Your guidance. Blessed is the day when Your light is manifested. How holy would that moment be wherein the trumpet of Your victory is blown!

تَوَكَّلْنَا عَلَيْكَ وَلَا حَوْلَ وَلَا قُوَّةَ إِلَّا بِكَ وَأَنْتَ الْعَلِيُّ الْعَظِيمُ.

[We place our trust in You, and there is no power and no strength except through You, and You are the High, the Great.]

—Author



## ADMONITION

### **For the Purpose of Removing a Misconception in the *Nūr Afshān* dated 13 October 1892 CE**

The Gospel of John, Chapter 11, Verse 25—This statement of Ḥaḍrat ‘Īsā [Jesus], peace be upon him, is written in the verse: ‘I am the resurrection, and the life: he that believeth in me, though he were dead, yet shall he live’; that is, gaining deliverance from a death of sinfulness, disobedience, heedlessness, and disbelief, he will attain a spiritual life of obedience to God. Commenting upon this sentence of the Gospel, the editor of *Nūr Afshān* in the 13 October 1892 issue exposes his ignorance when he says that:

Since the creation of Adam to this day, no one has made such a weighty claim, nor has used such words about himself [claiming] that he was the resurrection and the life; and that even if there had been such a person who had said such words about himself, it would have been utterly impossible to substantiate them in his case, but that the Lord Christ not only made the claim but also substantiated what he had said about himself.—  
End quote.

The extent to which this statement of the editor is far removed from honesty and truth cannot remain hidden from any knowledgeable person. The reality is that if Ḥaḍrat Masīḥ [the Messiah], peace be upon him, had claimed that he was the life and the resurrection, then, as he was a true Prophet, it was necessary that the truth of this claim should have become manifest. Furthermore, through him, spiritual life would have spread throughout the world in the lifetime of Ḥaḍrat Masīḥ and thereafter. However, an example of the egregious extent to which the Honourable Messiah<sup>as</sup> failed in spreading the truth about God and *Taūḥīd* [the Oneness of God] would be very difficult to find in the life and times of any other Prophet.

In this age of ours, even highly eminent priests have affirmed that the teaching of the Messiah was incapable of removing the petty-mindedness, want of understanding, and worldliness of his very own disciples. Moreover, the cowardice, faithlessness, and infidelity that they displayed at the time of the Messiah's arrest—and indeed the curses some of them uttered against the revered Messiah during that final moment—is a matter concerning which highly esteemed and learned Christians have declared that these inappropriate actions of the disciples are a cause of great shame for Christians. How far from the truth is it, then, to say that the revered Messiah was the spiritual resurrection, and that by entering into him, those who were spiritually dead gained life? The model that the Messiah's followers showed in his own life is such an embarrassing example of a lack of faith and steadfastness as it must have had a very detrimental effect on all those Christians who came after him from that time through today; for, everyone can understand that had the honourable Messiah actually manifested miracles or demonstrated a high calibre of wonderful works, then the end result of his disciples who believed in him would have never been so evil that some would have had him arrested in exchange for a bribe of a few coins, while others would run away upon seeing him being arrested, with others cursing him to his face.

Do those whose hearts permeate with faith and who have attained

a new life exhibit such behaviour? Is this the kind of 'loyalty' such people express towards their leader, master, and guide? The revered Messiah's own words, which are mentioned in the Gospels, also establish the point that his disciples, friends, and companions, who spent their days and nights with him and enjoyed the closest relationship with him, were entirely devoid of spirituality. Thus, the honourable Messiah, peace be upon him, describes some of them as weak of faith and another as 'Satan'. If we set aside the disciples and observe those Christians who have appeared after him from time to time up to this day, we do not see a single one of them who has risen out of the grave of worldliness and ego and awakened into the resurrection of a new life. On the contrary, all of them appear dead and putrefied in the dark and narrow graves of self-conceit. The breath of spiritual life has never blown upon them. They do not even know who God is, what His greatness and power are, and how He bestows a pure life on pure hearts and grants them His nearness. They revel in declaring a weak human being 'God' and placing the burden of others' sins upon him without any justification.

Bear in mind that death is of four kinds: the death of heedlessness, the death of sin, the death of *shirk* [associating partners with God], and the death of disbelief. Accordingly, this death—of all four kinds—is found in the religion of Christianity: The death of heedlessness, because all their energies are devoted to the gatherings and adornments of this world, and they are not the least concerned with removing the veils that separate them from God Almighty; then, if you wish to see the death of sin, you may witness it by visiting Europe and observing how little modesty, purity, and chastity remains in them; then, so far as the death of *shirk* is concerned, it is evident enough that you can see how they have turned a man into God and forgotten God Almighty; finally, there is the death of disbelief, because they have denied the true Messenger. It is clear from all these statements that to think of the revered Messiah as being the resurrection, through whom the spiritually dead are revived, is an absolutely absurd idea and a baseless claim.

However, a demonstration of such a resurrection—which definitely bestowed spiritual life to humanity—was manifested by the man endowed with perfect human attributes, whose exalted name is Muhammad, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him. The entire Quran, from beginning to end, bears witness that this Messenger was sent at a time when all nations were [spiritually] dead with materialism, and spiritual disorder had spread havoc over land and sea. It was then that this Messenger came and gave life to the world anew and set afloaf the sea of *Tauḥīd* [Oneness of God] upon the earth.

If an unbiased individual were to reflect upon what the people of the Arabian peninsula were before, and what they became after following this Messenger; and how their norm of savagery was transformed into the highest degree of civility; and how they proved the sincerity and truth of their faith by shedding their blood, sacrificing their lives, abandoning their loved ones, and dedicating their properties, honour, and comforts to the service of God Almighty; then, without any doubt, their steadfastness, sincerity, and readiness to sacrifice their lives in service of their beloved Messenger would be seen as a miracle of the highest order.

That holy countenance had made such an impact upon on their lives that they became completely divorced from their own selves, and undergoing *fanā fillāh* [self-annihilation in Allah], they performed such acts of sincerity and truthfulness whose parallel is hard to find in any nation. And what they acquired as religious beliefs was not a teaching to accept a helpless human as God or to presume the Almighty Lord in need of children. On the contrary, through their Noble Messenger, they came to know the True God of Glory, who is eternally Immutable, *حَيُّ قَيُّوْمٌ* [*Hayyūn Qayyūmun*—Everlasting and All-Sustaining]; exempt from the exigencies of being a son or a father; and immune to death and birth. These were the people who, having truly emerged from the pit of death, arose to stand atop the lofty tower of a life of purity. All of them had acquired a fresh life and were shining like stars in their faith.

Therefore, in reality, only one perfect man appeared in the world

and manifested such a complete and perfect spiritual resurrection that brought to life those who had been dead for ages and whose bones had been decaying for millennia. Through his advent graves were opened and decayed bones were restored to life, proving that he is verily the one who brings the dead back to life and that he is the spiritual resurrection upon whose footsteps an entire population had risen from its grave. Thus, the whole of the Arabian peninsula was blessed by the glad tidings:

وَرَأَيْتِ النَّاسَ يَدْخُلُونَ فِي دِينِ اللَّهِ أَفْوَاجًا ۝<sup>1</sup>

After that, the impact of this resurrection did not remain limited to the Companions. Rather, the All-Powerful and Omnipotent Lord who had raised this Bearer of Glad Tidings and Warner for every nation, time, and country, placed everlasting blessings in his true followers forever, promising that the light and the Holy Spirit that had been bestowed upon the Companions of this Perfect Man<sup>sas</sup>, would also be bestowed upon future followers and people who possess sincerity of faith, as He has said:

هُوَ الَّذِي بَعَثَ فِي الْأُمِّيِّينَ رَسُولًا مِنْهُمْ يَتْلُو عَلَيْهِمْ آيَاتِهِ وَيُزَكِّيهِمْ وَيُعَلِّمُهُمُ الْكِتَابَ وَالْحِكْمَةَ وَ  
إِنْ كَانُوا مِنْ قَبْلُ لَكِنْفَىٰ ضَلَّالٍ مُّبِينٍ ۝ وَأَخْرَجَ مِنْهُمْ لَبَأًا يَلْحَقُوا بِهِمْ وَهُوَ الْعَزِيزُ الْحَكِيمُ ۝<sup>2</sup>

Meaning that: The Merciful God is that God who has sent a Messenger unto the unlettered people from among themselves, who recites His Signs to them and purifies them and teaches them the Book and wisdom, even though they were utterly misguided before this. In the same way, the Messenger who is training them will also train another group who will come to join the ranks of these very people and would

1. And [when] you see men entering the religion of Allah in troops (*Sūrah an-Naṣr*, 110:3). [Publisher]

2. *Sūrah al-Jumu'ah*, 62:3-4 [Publisher]

cultivate the same excellences—but they have not yet joined them—and Allah is Supreme and All-Wise.

This point should be kept in mind that the word *اٰخَرِيْنَ* [*ākharīn*] in the verse *وَآخَرِيْنَ مِنْهُمْ* [and another group of them] is actually in the position of the object, as if to say the full verse, including the implied words, would be as follows:

هُوَ الَّذِي بَعَثَ فِي الْأُمِّيِّينَ رَسُولًا مِنْهُمْ يَتْلُو عَلَيْهِمْ آيَاتِهِ وَيُزَكِّيهِمْ وَيُعَلِّمُهُمُ الْكِتَابَ وَالْحِكْمَةَ وَيُعَلِّمُ الْآخَرِينَ مِنْهُمْ لَعَلَّ يُلْحَقُوا بِهِمْ

Meaning that: In addition to the Companions, may Allah be pleased with them, there are other sincere and perfect servants of Ours as well, whose large group will appear in the Latter Days. And just as the Noble Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, trained the Companions, may Allah be pleased with them, similarly the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, will spiritually train this latter group as well. In other words, these people would appear at a time when the apparent system of imparting and receiving spiritual beneficence would have ended, and the religion of Islam would be afflicted with many flaws and innovations, and even the hearts of those devoted to the Faith would be deprived of inner light. At that time, God Almighty would cause an auspicious soul to attain a perfect spiritual state only through the spiritual training of the Noble Messenger—without the intermediation of any prevailing schools of thought and practice—and He would make him into a group.

That group would develop a perfectly strong similarity with the Companions, because it would be entirely and perfectly the fruits of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, and the graces of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, would flow in them. They would join the Companions; that is to say, they would become like them by virtue of their excellence, and—through the grace and favour of God Almighty—they would be granted the very same opportunities to earn blessings as were granted



to the Companions. Despite being alone and friendless, due to their steadfastness, they would rank as Truthful just as the Companions were in the sight of God Almighty. This is because they would appear at a time of widespread trials, tribulations, and the spread of faithlessness, and the righteous would face the very same difficulties experienced by the Companions, may Allah be pleased with them. Therefore, upon displaying steadfastness, they would be counted to have the same status as the Companions.

However, the period in between the two is *Faij-e-A'waj*,<sup>1</sup> in which, on account of the awe and grandeur of Muslim kings and abundance of luxurious ways of life, there were very few who walked in the footsteps of the Companions and acquired their eminent status by way of reflection. However, the latter age would resemble the early age of Islam, for the people in this age would be stricken with poverty and would have nothing except the power of faith to combat the prevalent calamities. Their faith, therefore, would be so deep-rooted and proven in the eyes of God Almighty that even if faith had ascended into the skies, they would bring it back down to earth. This means that they would face calamities, and they would be severely tried and subjected to fearsome trials, but they would prove to be so steadfast that they would not abandon faith even if it was up in the heavens. The fact, therefore, that these people have been described as those who would bring back faith even from the heavens indicates that they would appear at a time when disbelief would have spread in all directions, and hearts would be devoid of the true love of God Almighty. But their faith would be present with great fervour in their hearts, and they would have abundant power to endure suffering for the sake of God Almighty, and they would have limitless stores of sincerity and perseverance. No fear would prove to

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1. *Faij-e-A'waj* (lit. the crooked group) refers to the corrupt masses who emerged after the first righteous generations of Muslims. They were characterized by religious fabrications, sectarian differences, and injustice, until the Promised Messiah<sup>as</sup> was Divinely sent to reform and reunite them. [Publisher]

be an impediment for them, and no worldly hope or desire would slow them down.

Verily, it is with such things that the strength of faith is tested so that it should emerge whole after passing through such trials in an age of faithlessness. This hadith, therefore, contains the indication that this group of people is destined to appear at that very time when all the means would be present for them to be put through such trials, and the world would be so far removed from true faith as to be virtually devoid of it.

In short, Allah, glorified be His eminence, states in regard to these people that they would appear in the Latter Days and would be His sincere and perfect servants who—on account of the perfection of their faith, sincerity, truthfulness, perseverance, steadfastness, knowledge, and cognition of God Almighty—would be the likes of the Companions. It should be clearly borne in mind that, in reality, this verse alludes to the spiritually perfect people of the Latter Days and not of any other period; for, the very words of the verse demonstrate that these righteous people would appear in the Latter Days. It is clearly indicated by the verse that:

وَالْآخِرِينَ مِنْهُمْ لَنَأْتِيَهُمْ<sup>1</sup>

There are only three periods of time: the first was the age of the Companions; the middle one was between the Companions and the Promised Messiah; and then there is the last period which is that of the Promised Messiah, connoted by the words: وَالْآخِرِينَ مِنْهُمْ [and others from among them]. This age is the one in which we live, as is stated on page 155 of his book, *Hijajul-Kirāmah*, by the late Maulawī Ṣiddiq Ḥasan of Qannauj and Bhopal, who, according to Shaikh Baṭālawī is the *Mujaddid* of the time. He writes:

1. And *among* others from among them who have not yet joined them (*Sūrah al-Jumu'ah*, 62:4). [Publisher]

آخریت این امت از بدایت الت ثانی شروع گردیده آثار تقوی از اوّل گم شده بودند و اکنون سطوت ظاهری اسلام هم منقوده شده. ثُمَّ کَلَامُهُ [The latter period of this Ummah started with the beginning of the second millennium. Virtue had disappeared from its very beginning, and now even the worldly dominion has been lost. End quote.]

It is clear that the Messenger of Allah, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, characterized only two ages as being good. One is the age of the Companions which extended to the time of the death of the last of the Companions. It turns out to be around the time of Imām-e-A‘zam [the Greatest Imam] Abū Ḥanīfah, may Allah be pleased with him. Then the second is the middle age which, on account of the prevalence of a host of innovations [i.e. deviations in the Faith], may be termed *ummul-khabā’ith* [‘the mother of evils’] and which the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, has called *Fajj-e-A’waj*. According to the *aḥādīth*, the state of things during the last years of this age, which borders the age of the coming of the Promised Messiah, is described as being extremely wicked.<sup>1</sup> Baihaqī mentions a hadith in

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## NOTE ABOUT A VISION

It was 17 October 1892 when, in response to *Nūr Afshān*, my humble self concluded setting forth my arguments in full that the spiritual judgment in truth was the advent of the Holy Prophet, may the peace and blessings of Allah be upon him. I had supplemented this with verses in praise of the Holy Prophet, may the peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, whose true praise is in fact beyond description, and added, by way of a sample, some praise of his Noble Companions, may Allah be pleased with them, to prove my point. When I went to sleep after writing the ode in praise of the Holy Prophet, may the peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, and narrating the qualities and virtues of his Companions, may Allah be pleased with them, I saw a blessed and holy dream. I found myself in the upper storey of a large mansion, the rooms of which were very spacious and wide and richly carpeted. I was addressing a large gathering and was setting forth to them divine truths and

higher knowledge. Among the audience was a *maulawī* whom I did not know and he did not believe in me. He was sitting among the gathering and did not belong to our Jamā'at. I took note of his features. He was slim and white bearded. He interrupted my discourse and said: 'These are matters relating to the nature of God's Being and any discussion of them is prohibited. I admonished him: Foolish one, this has nothing to do with the nature of God's Being. This is holy knowledge concerning Him. I was deeply distressed by his irrelevant interruption and tried to silence him, but he persisted in his mischief which made me angry and I said: 'The evil-minded divines of this age persist in their mischief, but God will expose them' and added some more phrases of the same type, which I do not now recall. Then I called out: 'Is there anyone who would expel this *maulawī* from this gathering?' Thereupon, I saw someone who looked like my servant Ḥāmid 'Alī who seized the *maulawī* and pushed him out down the stairs. Then I looked up and saw the Holy Prophet, on whom be the peace and blessings of Allah, standing on a large terrace near our gathering as if he had been strolling there and was quite close when the *maulawī* was expelled. I had not noticed him before but on looking closely now I saw that he was holding the book *Ā'ina-e-Kamālāt-e-Islām* in his hand. At the place that I have mentioned, which appears to have been printed already, he had placed one of his blessed fingers at the spot where his praise was mentioned and his pure, effective, and high teachings were set out, and another finger at the place where the qualities and the truth and loyalty of his Companions, may Allah be pleased with them, were set out. He was smiling and said:

هَذَا لِي وَ هَذَا لِأَصْحَابِي

**Meaning: This is in my praise and this is  
in praise of my Companions.**

Then my mind moved from the dream towards *ilhām* [revelation] and a state of vision was created. It was revealed to me in a vision that God Almighty expressed His pleasure over His own praise mentioned at that place and the *ilhām* about it came to me:

هَذَا الثَّنَاءُ لِي

**[This is My praise.]**

This was Tuesday night and the time was 3:15 a.m.

I saw another dream on 7 December 1892 that I had become Ḥaḍrat ‘Alī, may Allah honour and exalt him; meaning that in my dream I felt as if I was the very same as him. It is one of the wonders of a dream that sometimes a person feels that he is someone else and in that way I felt at the time that I was ‘Alī Murtaḍā and the situation was that a group of *Khawārij*\* was opposing my *Khilāfat*; that is to say, they wished to obstruct my becoming *Khalīfah* and were creating mischief for that purpose. Then I saw the Holy Prophet, on whom be the peace and blessings of Allah, close to me and he said with kindness and affection:

يا علي دعهم وانصارهم وزراعتهم

**Meaning that, O ‘Alī! Stay away from them, their helpers, and their harvest. Leave them and turn away from them.**

I found that the Holy Prophet, may the peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, advised me to be steadfast in the midst of that trial and to refrain from getting involved with those people. He told me that I was in the right, but that it would be better not to address them. By their harvest is meant the followers of the *maulawīs* who are influenced by their teachings and whom they have been preparing for a long time.\*\*

Then my mind moved towards the reception of *ilhām* and God disclosed to me that one of my opponents said:

ذروني اقتل موسى

**Meaning: Leave me free to kill Mūsā [Moses]; that is, my humble self.**

I saw this dream at about 2:40 a.m., and it was the morning of Wednesday. فالحمد لله على ذلك [So Allah be praised for all this].

\* A group that turned against Ḥaḍrat ‘Alī and removed themselves from his *Khilāfat*. [Publisher]

\*\* In this dream it was revealed to the Promised Messiah<sup>as</sup> that people will oppose his *Khilāfat* and will try to create disorder (*Barakāt-e-Khilāfat*, p. 29, *Anwārul ‘ulūm*, vol. 2, p. 176). [Publisher]

this connection, wherein the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, is reported to have said that the *maulawīs* and jurists of that age would be the worst of all people inhabiting the world at that time.<sup>1</sup> And it is written in *Hijajul-Kirāmah* that it would, in fact, be these very *maulawīs* and jurists who would pronounce an edict of *kufṛ* [disbelief] against the Mahdi of Allah (the Promised Messiah). Most Muslims are unaware that it is established on the basis of *ahādīth* that even the Promised Messiah would be subjected to an edict of *kufṛ*. This prophecy has, therefore, been fulfilled.

In short, the period between the early age and the age of the Promised Messiah is the period of great evils, about which the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, has said: خَيْرُ هَذِهِ الْأُمَّةِ أُولَئِهَا وَآخِرُهَا. أُولَئِهَا فِيهِمْ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ، وَآخِرُهَا فِيهِمْ عِيسَى ابْنُ مَرْيَمَ، وَبَيْنَ ذَلِكَ فِجْجٌ أَعْوَجُ لَيْسُوا مِنِّي وَلَسْتُ مِنْهُمْ . Meaning that, only two Ummahs are good—the first and the last. And the middle one is a Crooked Host. They are like an army in numbers but are spiritually dead. They are not of me and I am not of them.

An authentic hadith relates that at the time of the revelation of the following verse:

أَخْرَيْنَ مِنْهُمْ لَمَّا يَلْحَقُوا بِهِمْ<sup>2</sup>

The Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, placed his hand upon the shoulder of Salmān Farsi [Salmān the Persian] and said: لَوْ كَانَ الْإِيمَانُ عِنْدَ الثُّرَيَّا لَنَالَهُ رَجُلٌ مِنْ فَارِسٍ أَوْ رَجُلٌ مِنْ فَارِسٍ.<sup>3</sup>

1. *Al-Jāmi' li-Shu'abul-Īmān*, Juzw 3, p. 317–318, published by Maktabat ar-Rushd Nāshirūn, Beirut [Publisher]

2. And among others from among them who have not yet joined them (*Sūrah al-Jumu'ah*, 62:4). [Publisher]

3. *Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim*, Kitāb Faḍā'iluṣ-Ṣaḥābah, Bāb Faḍl Fāris, Hadith 2546 [Publisher]

[Even if faith had ascended to the Pleiades, a man of Persia—or some men of Persia—would bring it back.]

Thus, it is apparent from this hadith that in the Latter Days a man of Persian descent would be raised, who would be so strong of faith that even if faith were in the Pleiades, he would bring it back from there. In another hadith, this very man has been referred to by the word ‘*Mahdi*’, whose appearance is established to be in the Latter Days from the lands of the East. The appearance of the *Dajjāl* [Antichrist] is also established to be in the Latter Days from the lands of the East. Reconciling both of these hadith reports makes it evident that the individual who is to oppose the Antichrist is this very man. And the practice of Allah demands this very fact as well, that the country in which the *Dajjāl*’s calibre of evil arises, is the very country in which the Virtuous One should arise; for, when the healer appears, he directs himself to the sick. It would, therefore, be quite astonishing that while, according to authentic hadith, the *Dajjāl* were to appear in India, the Messiah were to descend upon the minarets of Damascus!

There is no doubt that in relation to Madinah, the Illuminated City, India lies in an easterly direction. The authentic hadith undoubtedly shows that the *Dajjāl* would appear in the East, and it would be from the East that the black banners of the Mahdi of Allah would come into view—as if to say it had been determined on the day of creation that the East would be the site of spiritual strife and the East would also be the site for the reformation of that strife.

And there is another point worthy of note here. Just as the words of Allah, glorified be His eminence, *وَآخَرِينَ مِنْهُمْ* [‘and others from among them’] point out that the people who would resemble the Companions in their spiritual eminence would appear in the Latter Days, the same is indicated by the numerical values of all the letters of the verse:

وَآخَرِينَ مِنْهُمْ لَبَّا يَلْعَقُوا بِهِمْ<sup>1</sup>

1. *Sūrah al-Jumu‘ah*, 62:4 [Publisher]

It is 1275, indicating that the man of Persian descent connoted by the words: **اٰخَرِيْنَ مِنْهُمْ** ['others from among them'] will, having arrived at his physical maturity in this year, develop a resemblance with the Companions. The year 1275 AH can be derived from the numerical values of the letters of the verse:

وَ اٰخَرِيْنَ مِنْهُمْ لَّيَّا يَلْحَقُوْا بِهِمْ<sup>1</sup>

It is the year of my physical maturity as well as of my second life and spiritual rebirth; 34 years have since passed.

And if the question is asked that as the words: **اٰخَرِيْنَ مِنْهُمْ** ['others from among them'] point to more persons than one, how can they refer to one man, the answer is that the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, has himself applied them to one man. In explanation of this verse, he placed his hand on the shoulder of Salmān the Persian, and said that from among the sons of Persia a man would arise who would take faith from the Pleiades and bring it back to Earth. That is, he would appear at a time when, on account of the spread of philosophic thinking and atheism, and the waning love of God, people would become extremely weak of faith and slothful. Then, God Almighty, through this man's hand and the blessings attached to his person, will, once again, develop true faith in the hearts of people. It would be as if the lost faith would descend again from heaven. The Noble Quran, too, has used plural words for singular. Abraham [Ḥaḍrat Ibrāhīm], peace be upon him, has been called an ummah, whereas he was a single individual. Apart from this, the word has been used to show that the man would not remain a solitary individual but that he would grow into a Jamā'at which would possess true faith in God Almighty and would be granted the qualities and excellences of the Faith of the Companions.

Reverting, once again, to the refutation of the unfounded assertion

1. *Sūrah al-Jumu'ah*, 62:4 [Publisher]



of *Nūr Afshān*, I wish to reiterate that even if we say nothing about the Gospel in the hands of the Christians—tampered with and interpolated as it is—and assume that the revered Messiah [Jesus] really did make the claim to be the resurrection and life, it would still amount to nothing; for, such a claim which cannot be substantiated with evidence, cannot establish anyone's superiority. If a man lays no claim, but nevertheless demonstrates his ability to accomplish something, such a one is far superior to the one who makes a claim but is unable to substantiate it. The Gospel itself bears witness that the claim of the Messiah is highly questionable in the eyes of a critic and even in the case of the Disciples, let alone that of others. And it establishes that the revered Messiah left even his Disciples in the graves of selfishness. And when we compare the claim of the revered Messiah with the claim of the *Hadrat Khātamul-Anbiyā'* [Seal of the Prophets], may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, we find the difference between the two claims to be like the difference between darkness and light. The claim of the revered Messiah lies in the dark and obscure pit of wanting evidence, and it has no light accompanying it, but the claim of our Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, shines forth like the sun.

Moreover, a weighty proof of the eternal life of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, is that the infinite grace of his Praised Being continues to flow. Even in this age, a person who obeys the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, is raised from the dead and is bestowed a spiritual life—and not so merely in an imaginary sense. Rather, its real and true indications are manifested, and heavenly help and blessings and the extraordinary support of the Holy Spirit accompany such a person. He becomes a unique person from among all the people of the world, to the point that God Almighty speaks with him, discloses His profound mysteries to him, manifests His verities and truths to him, demonstrates the bright Signs of His love and favour in him, causes His help to descend upon him, places His blessings in him, and makes him the mirror of

His *Rubūbiyyat* [Providence]. Wisdom flows from his tongue, and the fountains of fine verities issue forth from his heart. Hidden secrets are disclosed to him, and God Almighty manifests Himself upon him in a glorious manner and draws in close proximity to him. He ranks above all and prevails over all others in the acceptance of his prayers, in being granted approbations, in the opening of the doors of understanding, in the disclosure of hidden mysteries, and in the descent of blessings.

Thus, having been commissioned by God Almighty, my humble self despatched several thousand registered letters to the well-known opponents in Asia, Europe, and America about these very matters, by way of fully discharging the duty to convey the message to them. I stated that if anyone claimed that this spiritual life could be achieved by any other means without following *Khātām-ul-Anbiyā'* [the Seal of the Prophets], may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, such a one should come forth to compete with this humble one. If this is unacceptable, then such a one should come to me as a seeker of truth in order to witness the one-sided display of blessings and Signs. However, no one responded to this with sincerity and good faith, and by keeping aloof, they proved that they all wander in darkness. And as for some of our contemporary brethren in faith who call themselves Muslims, reject this light, neither accepting nor sincerely making an attempt to test the truth, and who are ready to call me a *kāfir*—the real cause of all these issues is blindness, narrow-mindedness, and extreme bigotry.

The presence of such people in Islam cannot be the cause for Islam to bear the blame, and the objection cannot be raised as to why these people were not freed from their spiritual ills or why they have not come out of the graves; for, if someone bolts the doors of their house, sitting in a dark corner, it would not be the fault of the sun that the light of the sun fails to reach them. It is, in fact, the fault of that person himself who has behaved in this manner. Apart from this, however uninformed and removed from the truth this group of people may be, they do still openly profess *Tauḥīd* [Oneness of God], they have not

made any man their God, and because of the blessings of *Tauḥīd*, they do have an inner light and possess, to some small measure, the warmth of life. We cannot, therefore, call them completely dead, though they are in a precarious situation. If a Hindu or a Christian ignores us and indulges in criticism of this sort, he is either very much prejudiced or extremely ignorant. It is necessary that there be thorns in a garden as well. Where there are flowers, there will be thorns as well. However, in the opposing religious groups, only a heap of thorns can be seen.

It is utterly absurd for Christians to say that the Messiah<sup>as</sup> was the spiritual resurrection and that they were brought to life through the Messiah. The Christians should remember that it is not at all established that the Messiah, peace be upon him, was the resurrection. Nor have the Christians been brought to life—they are dead and more so than all the dead lying in narrow and dark graves, having fallen into the pit of polytheism. They neither possess the spirit of faith nor the blessings of such spirit. They have not achieved even the lowest grade of faith in *Tauḥīd*, which is to abstain from the worship of creation. They deem someone as frail and feeble as themselves to be the Creator and worship him.

Bear in mind that *Tauḥīd* has three grades. The lowest grade is to abstain from the worship of any created thing like oneself—neither stone, nor fire, nor mortal, nor any star. The second grade is to refrain from being so devoted to material means as if they were a sort of permanent partner in the operation of the Divine enterprise of *Rubūbiyyat* [Providence]. On the contrary, one must concentrate on the Provider of means rather than the means itself. The third grade of *Tauḥīd* is that, after having witnessed perfect manifestations of Allah's glory, one should consider every other being as non-existent, including one's own self. Everything besides God Almighty, who possesses perfect attributes, should appear as mortal to one's eyes. This is what spiritual life means—that these three grades of faith in *Tauḥīd* are achieved.

Now upon reflection you may see that all eternal fountains

of spiritual life have come into the world only through Ḥaḍrat Muḥammad, Muṣṭafā [the Chosen One], may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him. It is only this Ummah [the followers of Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>], that while not being Prophets, they still experience converse with God Almighty like the Prophets, and although not Messengers, the bright Signs of God Almighty manifest at their hands like the Messengers, and rivers of spiritual life flow in them and no one can compare with them in this. **Is there anyone who would stand up and respond to this claim of mine and compete with me in the showing of blessings and Signs!!!**

ہر طرف فکر کو دوڑا کے تھکایا ہم نے      کوئی دیں۔ دین محمدؐ سنا نہ پایا ہم نے  
*I let my thoughts run in all directions till I became exhausted,  
 But I did not find a faith like the Faith of Muḥammad<sup>sas</sup>.*

کوئی مذہب نہیں ایسا کہ نشان دکھلاوے      یہ ثمر باغ محمدؐ سے ہی کھایا ہم نے  
*There is no religion which shows the Signs [of truth];  
 This fruit I tasted only in the garden of Muḥammad<sup>sas</sup>.*

ہم نے اسلام کو خود تجربہ کر کے دیکھا      نور ہے نور اٹھو دیکھو سنایا ہم نے  
*I tested Islam myself and saw that  
 It is light upon light—wake up and see, I am informing everyone.*

اور دینوں کو جو دیکھا تو کہیں نور نہ تھا      کوئی دکھلائے اگر حق کو چھپایا ہم نے  
*Observing other religions, I found no light anywhere;  
 Let anyone show me, if I have concealed the truth.*

تھک گئے ہم تو انہیں باتوں کو کہتے کہتے      ہر طرف دعوتوں کا تیر چلایا ہم نے  
*I have exhausted myself repeating these things time and time again;  
 I have sent off invitations [to these truths] in every direction!*

آزمائش کے لئے کوئی نہ آیا ہر چند ہر مخالف کو مقابل پہ بلایا ہم نے

*No one came to test me, even though*

*I challenged every opponent to compete.*

یونہی غفلت کے لحافوں میں پڑے سوتے ہیں وہ نہیں جاگتے سو بار جگایا ہم نے

*They are lying asleep under the coverings of negligence.*

*They do not wake up despite my repeated efforts to awaken.*

جل رہے ہیں یہ سبھی بغضوں میں اور کینوں میں باز آتے نہیں ہر چند ہٹایا ہم نے

*They are burning in bitterness and bigotry;*

*They do not desist despite my repeated efforts.*

آؤ لوگو کہ یہیں نور خدا پاؤ گے لو تمہیں طور تسلیٰ کا بتایا ہم نے

*Come, O people! Herein you will find the light of God;*

*Lo! I have told you the way of satisfaction.*

آج ان نوروں کا اک زور ہے اس عاجز میں دل کو ان نوروں کا ہر رنگ دلایا ہم نے

*Today those lights are surging in this humble one;*

*I have dyed my heart with every hue of those lights.*

جب سے یہ نور ملا نور پیہر سے ہمیں ذات سے حق کے وجود اپنا ملایا ہم نے

*Ever since I received this light from the light of the Prophet<sup>sas</sup>,*

*I have joined my being with the Being of the True One.*

مصطفیٰ پر ترابے حد ہو سلام اور رحمت اس سے یہ نور لیا بار خدایا ہم نے

*Show Your countless blessings and peace upon Muṣṭafā.*

*Allah is my Witness: from him I received this light.*

رابط ہے جانِ محمدؐ سے مری جاں کو مدام دل کو وہ جام لبالب ہے پلایا ہم نے

*My soul is forever wedded to the soul of Muḥammad<sup>sas</sup>;*

*I have filled my heart to the brim with this elixir.*

اُس سے بہتر نظر آیا نہ کوئی عالم میں      لاجرم غیروں سے دل اپنا چھڑایا ہم نے  
*I found no one better than him in the entire universe;*  
*No doubt, I have freed my heart from all else.*

موردِ قہر ہوئے آنکھ میں اغیار کے ہم      جب سے عشق اس کا تیرے دل میں بٹھایا ہم نے  
*I became the object of wrath for the others*  
*Ever since I placed his love in the depth of my heart.*

زعم میں ان کے مسیحائی کا دعویٰ میرا      افترا ہے جسے از خود ہی بنایا ہم نے  
*In their imagination, my claim of being the Messiah*  
*Is an imposture, coined by myself.*

کافر و ملحد و دجال ہمیں کہتے ہیں      نام کیا کیا غمِ ملت میں رکھایا ہم نے  
*They call me disbeliever, apostate, and deceiver—*  
*What epithets I have earned for my passionate devotion to the Ummah!*

گالیاں سن کے دعا دیتا ہوں ان لوگوں کو      رحم ہے جوش میں اور غیظ گھٹایا ہم نے  
*I hear the abuse, but pray for these people—*  
*My compassion is surging and I have subdued the anger.*

تیرے منہ کی ہی قسم میرے پیارے احمدؑ      تیری خاطر سے یہ سب بار اٹھایا ہم نے  
*I swear by your countenance, O my dear Ahmad<sup>sas</sup>!*  
*For your sake alone have I taken up all this burden.*

تیری اُلفت سے ہے معمور مرا ہر ذرہ      اپنے سینہ میں یہ اک شہر بسایا ہم نے  
*Every particle of my being is saturated with your love,*  
*It is a veritable city that I have populated in my heart.*

صفِ دشمن کو کیا ہم نے بہ حجتِ پامال      سیف کا کام قلم سے ہی دکھایا ہم نے  
*I have vanquished the ranks of the enemy with conclusive arguments;*  
*With the pen alone have I accomplished the task of the sword.*

نور دکھلا کے تیرا سب کو کیا ملزم و خوار      سب کا دل آتش سوزاں میں جلایا ہم نے  
*By demonstrating your light, I subjected all of them to ignominy and humiliation;*

*I incinerated the hearts of all in the burning flame.*

نقش ہستی تری الفت سے مٹایا ہم نے      اپنا ہر ذرہ تری راہ میں اڑایا ہم نے  
*I vanquished all traces of my own being with your love;*

*I dispersed every particle of my being in your path.*

تیرا میخانہ جو اک مرجع عالم دیکھا      خُم کا خُم منہ سے بصد حرص لگایا ہم نے  
*Finding your drinking place to be the centre for the entire world,*

*I drank of it in abundance with the utmost zeal.*

شانِ حق تیرے شائل میں نظر آتی ہے      تیرے پانے سے ہی اُس ذات کو پایا ہم نے  
*I find traces of the Being of Allah the True in your moral qualities—*

*By finding you, I have found that Holy Being.*

چھو کے دامن ترا ہر دام سے ملتی ہے نجات      لاجرم در پہ ترے سر کو جھکایا ہم نے  
*A touch of your cloak liberates from all traps;*

*No doubt, I have prostrated myself upon your threshold.*

دلبرا مجھ کو قسم ہے تری یکتائی کی      آپ کو تیری محبت میں بھلایا ہم نے  
*O my beloved! I swear by your uniqueness;*

*I have forgotten all about myself in your love.*

بخدا دل سے مرے مٹ گئے سب غیروں کے نقش      جب سے دل میں یہ تیرا نقش جمایا ہم نے  
*By God, all traces of others were wiped out of my heart;*

*Ever since I affixed this trace of you in my heart.*

دیکھ کر تجھ کو عجب نور کا جلوہ دیکھا      نور سے تیرے شیطاں کو جلایا ہم نے  
*Upon seeing you, I witnessed a wonderful manifestation of light;*

*By your light, I burned up the evil spirits.*

ہم ہوئے خیر امم تجھ سے ہی اے خیر رسل      تیرے بڑھنے سے قدم آگے بڑھایا ہم نے  
*O Best of Messengers! We became the Best of Ummahs because of you;*  
*By your advancing forward, we too stepped forward.*

آدمی زاد تو کیا چیز فرشتے بھی تمام      مدح میں تیری وہ گاتے ہیں جو گایا ہم نے  
*Not to mention humans, even all the angels*  
*Sing in your praise what we are singing.*

قوم کے ظلم سے تنگ آکے مرے پیارے آج      شور محشر ترے کوچہ میں مچایا ہم نے  
*O my dear! Being torn under the tyranny of my people,*  
*I have raised this tumultuous clamour in your alley.*

I now wish to give some elaboration upon the fruits of Islam.<sup>1</sup> So let it be clear that when a true seeker of his Lord becomes perfectly established upon Islam and devotes all his powers to this endeavour—not with any contrivance or artificiality, but with a natural inclination—then the ultimate result of this condition is that the highest manifestations of the guidance of God Almighty, free from all veils, turn towards him and all kinds of blessings descend upon him. The commandments and beliefs which had hitherto been accepted as a matter of faith or on hearsay are now openly realized and felt through true visions and through certain and explicit revelations. The intricacies of the Shariah and the Faith, and the sealed mysteries of *Millat-e-Hanifiyyah* [the Religion ever inclining towards God] are disclosed to him. He is walked through the Kingdoms of God so that he may attain the perfect stage

1. Please see Footnote entitled, 'An Essential Conclusive Argument for Sayyed Ahmad Khan C.S.I.', on pages 279–306. In the original Urdu edition of *Ā'ina-e-Kamālāt-e-Islām*, the Promised Messiah<sup>as</sup> presented this footnote along with the main text. For the ease of English readers, it is being presented as its own section after this section. [Publisher]



of certainty and spiritual insight. His tongue and speech, all his actions and words, and his states of movement and rest become blessed.

He is granted extraordinary courage, perseverance, and resolve. He is granted a position of great eminence in the realization of truth. He is freed from the narrow-mindedness, meanness, and stinginess caused by the veils of humanness. He is no longer prone to repeated stumbling, narrowness of vision, the bondage of lust, lowliness of morals, and removing all kinds of the darkness of spirit fully from him; he is filled, instead, with the light of godly moral qualities. Thus, he is completely transformed and is adorned with the garment of a new birth. He hears through God Almighty, sees through God Almighty, moves with God Almighty, and rests with God Almighty. His wrath becomes the wrath of God Almighty, and his mercy becomes the mercy of God Almighty. His prayers at this stage are chosen for acceptance and not by way of trial. He is the embodiment of Allah's manifest argument and protection on earth, and his very being is the cause for joy in heaven.

The loftiest of lofty gifts that are granted to him is conversation with Allah and the discourses from the Omnipotent God, which continue to descend upon his heart—pure like the light of the moon and free from the dust of doubt or misgiving. This experience is highly pleasurable, and gratifies, satisfies, and comforts the soul.

And the difference between this discourse and revelation is that the spring of revelation is, so to speak, constantly flowing among the Holy and Elect [of God]. They speak with the speaking of the Holy Spirit, they see with the sight of the Holy Spirit, and they hear with the hearing of the Holy Spirit, and all their desires arise out of the very breath of the Holy Spirit. The affirmation is true—and absolutely true!—that they are the figurative fulfilment validating the following verse:

وَمَا يَنْطِقُ عَنِ الْهَوَىٰ ۝ إِنْ هُوَ إِلَّا وَحْيٌ يُوحَىٰ ۝<sup>1</sup>

1. Nor does he speak out of *his own* desire; it is nothing but *pure* revelation *that has been revealed by God* (Sūrah an-Najm, 53:4–5). [Publisher]

Nevertheless, Divine dialogue is a separate phenomenon, which is that—akin to a verbal *wahy* [revelation]—the Word of God Almighty descends upon them, and they receive a response from God Almighty to their questions just as a friend responds to a friend. We can define this converse only as a particular manifestation of Allah, glorified be His eminence, which takes place through an angel of the higher order. Its object is to notify of the acceptance of prayer, or to give information regarding some new and hidden affair, or to supply knowledge of future events, or to inform regarding God's approval or disapproval of something, or to bestow certainty and cognition in some other types of affairs.

In short, this *wahy* is a Divine voice emanating from Allah in the form of converse and discourse with a view to permeating the addressee with the certainty of knowledge and satisfaction. It is impossible to describe its nature better than by saying that it is a Divine voice produced purely by the prompting of God and His inspiration and in which one's own ego, thought, or deliberation plays no part at all. It is a speech experienced as pleasant, blessed, and possessed of Godly glory and the awe of Divine force.

Here, every seeker after truth would naturally ask what he should do in order to attain this high spiritual station of discourse with God. The answer is that this stage is a new existence in which one is granted new faculties, new abilities, and a new life. This new existence cannot be acquired without the annihilation of the previous existence. When the previous existence is wholly discarded through a true and real sacrifice, which means the sacrifice of one's self, honour, wealth, and all other trappings of the ego, this second existence immediately takes its place.

If it is asked, what are the signs of the annihilation of the earlier self, the answer is that previous characteristics and emotions are replaced by new characteristics and new emotions, and a tremendous change is experienced in one's nature. All states of existence relating to morals, faith, and worship, appear as transformed as if they are donning a

new character altogether. In short, deliberating upon his own condition, one should find himself to be a new person and, similarly, God Almighty is seen in a new perspective as well. Such new delights should be experienced in gratitude, steadfastness, and remembrance of God that were completely unknown beforehand. One should feel clearly that he has full trust in his Lord and does not care at all for anything other than Him. The contemplation of the Being of the Holy Creator should dominate his heart to such a degree that every other being disappears altogether from his vision of things that exist, and all material means appear useless, contemptible, and of no value. Devotion and loyalty surge up to such a degree that the thought of suffering every type of pain seems easy to bear, and, not only in contemplation, but even the actual experience of calamities and misfortunes is perceived as a delight. When all these signs are present, it can then be understood that the previous existence has suffered total death.

The realization of this death brings about amazing strengths in the cause of God Almighty for the seeker. He is endowed the ability to perform those activities that others talk about but cannot perform, to tread upon the paths that others see but cannot traverse, and to carry the burdens that others only estimate but cannot lift. He is granted the ability to carry out all these arduous tasks, not of his own strength, but with the help and assistance of a great power granted by God, which renders him greater than the mountains in firmness and bestows a faithful heart upon him. Then, for the sake of the majesty of God Almighty, such deeds emanate from him, and such feats of sincerity are manifested, that [one realizes] what is the worth of a human being and what is the essence of a son of Adam, that he could accomplish them on his own.

He cuts asunder and frees himself from all besides Allah, and removes all intervening barriers and obstructions. He is tested and persecuted and encounters diverse types of trials, and is afflicted with such calamities and misfortunes that would have destroyed the mountains and darkened the sun and the moon, but he remains steadfast

and cheerfully endures all hardships. Even if the mortar and pestle of calamities were to grind and render him like dust, no sound would proceed from him except: **إِنِّي مَعَ اللَّهِ** 'I am with Allah.' When a person arrives at this stage, his affair rises above the conditions of this world, and he is granted, by way of reflection, all of the guidance and high status that were bestowed upon previous Prophets and Messengers, and he becomes their heir and deputy.

The reality that is called *mu'jizah* [miracle] in the case of Prophets appears as *karāmat* [miraculous excellence] in such a man's case, and what is called *'ishmat* [sinlessness] in the case of Prophets is called *mahfūziyyat* [protection] in his case, and what we call *Nubūwwat* [Prophethood] in the case of Prophets, manifests itself as *Muhaddathiyyat* [receiving Divine discourse] in his case. The substance is the same, but different names are applied because of their intensity or weakness. The blessed sayings of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, indicate that a *Muhaddath* is a Prophet in potential. If the door of Prophethood had not been closed, every *Muhaddath*, in his own being, had the capability and the potential to become a Prophet. From the perspective of this very capacity or ability, the conception of a *Muhaddath* is admissible as a Prophet. In other words, the *Muhaddath* is a Prophet. Just as we say that:

الْعَنْبُ خَمْرٌ نَظَرًا عَلَى الْقُوَّةِ وَالْإِسْتِعْدَادِ وَمِثْلُ هَذَا الْحَمَلِ شَائِعٌ مُتَعَارَفٌ فِي عِبَارَاتِ  
الْقَوْمِ وَقَدْ جَرَّبَتِ الْمُخَاوِرَاتُ عَلَى ذَلِكَ كَمَا لَا يَخْفَى عَلَى كُلِّ ذَكِيٍّ عَالِمٍ مُطَّلِعٍ عَلَى  
كُتُبِ الْأَدَبِ وَالْكَلَامِ وَالنُّصُوفِ.

[The grape is wine in view of its capacity and potential. Such expressions are common and frequently used by our people, and such metaphors are found that are not unknown to all wise and learned men well versed in literary books, scholarly expressions, and mystic lore.]

This very concept is indicated when Allah, glorified be His eminence,

deemed it enough to reveal an abbreviated version of the words وَمَا أَرْسَلْنَا <sup>1</sup> into the second reading:

وَمَا أَرْسَلْنَا مِنْ قَبْلِكَ مِنْ رَّسُولٍ وَلَا نَبِيٍّ <sup>2</sup>

And the answer to the question as to when and under what circumstances someone gifted with Divine discourse deserves to be blessed with a greater experience of the converse from Allah is that very often it is at a time of great affliction and calamity that the word of God descends upon Allah's saints to be a source of support and strength for them. When they are crushed under the pain and distress of calamities and unbearable events, and pain and grief reach their extreme, it is then that God Almighty directs His speech upon their hearts, and they are granted comfort and satisfaction with the sacred word of Allah.

The fact is that the humility of a recipient of revelation has a very close relationship with the fire of Divine revelation bursting into a flame. When someone who is honoured with the gift of Divine discourse is in extreme pain and distress, and his attention reaches the point of being like a wick dipped in feelings of pain and affliction, and with qualities of loyalty, humility, and sincerity, comes under the rays of *Rabūbiyyat* [Providence], then a ray with its light of *Rabūbiyyat*, falls on him and illumines him. The light of such illumination sometimes manifests itself in the form of Divine speech and sometimes in the form of visions. It illuminates the seeker's heart with a Divine light like a wick which creeps close to a fire. Do we not see that a wick saturated with clean combustible oil, when taken close to a fire, changes its character and, as it recedes from the fire, brings back a bright flame with it? In the same way, the enlightened and perfect man is most eminently fit to receive

1. The words مِنْ قَبْلِكَ have been inadvertently omitted. See the *Tafsīr Qurtabī* and *Rūḥul-Ma'ānī* with reference to *Sūrah al-Ḥajj*, 22:53. [Publisher]

2. Never sent We a Messenger or a Prophet before thee... (*Sūrah al-Ḥajj*, 22:53) [Publisher]

Divine revelation when he falls upon the threshold of God in a state of great distress; when, cutting himself away from everything, he gives a fresh and new stimulus to the spiritual aptitude and sincerity with which every nerve and fibre of his body is saturated, and implores the help of God Almighty with a heart full of pain. Then, God Almighty gives him a hearing, responds to him with love and affection, sends His mercy on him, and generally accepts all his prayers.

The ideas of some people of atheistic tendencies, who, under the influence of European philosophy and rationalism, deny the possibility of acceptance of prayer and allege that there is no such thing as acceptance of prayer and that praying or not praying for attaining one's desires is just the same, are totally invalid and unfounded. It should be borne in mind that from among the favours that God Almighty has bestowed upon a true believer, one great favour is that his prayers are accepted. No matter how difficult a matter may be, most of his entreaties are graced with acceptance. This, indeed, is the true essence of *Wilāyat* [Sainthood]; namely, the attainment of an honourable status and nearness to God, which renders a true believer's prayer more acceptable than the prayers of other people. A *Walī* is a friend of God, and the sign of genuine friendship is indeed that most of his requests are accepted.

Therefore, anyone who says that the acceptance of prayer means nothing more than his voice reaching God Almighty, and God Almighty becoming aware that he has prayed, such an individual is a jester, utterly ignorant of the Book of God Almighty and His religion. If the mere hearing of prayer equated to its acceptance, and there was nothing more to it, then everybody could say that their prayers were not rejected; for, if the acceptance of prayer merely refers to its knowledge, then is there anyone whose prayer remains unknown to God Almighty? Obviously, Allah, glorified be His eminence, being the Omniscient, All-Knowing and All-Hearing, hears everything, and the voice of everyone reaches Him. What, then, is the difference between the prayer of a believer and a disbeliever insofar as the mere hearing is

concerned? How can it be proven that He says ‘yes’ to the believer but not to others when they are both equally deprived of the real object of prayers?

A *kāfir* [disbeliever] may also say that his prayer has been answered with a ‘yes’. Who can contradict him, and what purpose would such a meaningless ‘yes’ serve? On the contrary, a believer’s prayer is certainly accepted; or, if acceptance is not in his best interest, he is at least informed about it with gentleness and affection through a loving communion. God Almighty, who is the Fountainhead of all mercies, is Merciful to the believer in a greater measure than He is to anybody else. He supports the believer in all difficulties, protects him, and even if the whole world opposes him, the believer is made victorious by Him. He gives him longer life and greater safety; his enemy wishes to see him annihilated and destroyed, yet He destroys the enemy and spurns back the curses of the enemy upon their own heads. Notwithstanding, the believer’s prayers are accepted, and, as a result of such acceptance, God manifests such miracles that the whole world is amazed.

What is *karāmat*? It is a believer’s prayer that is accepted and achieves a most difficult and unimaginable objective thereby making the entire world astounded. Therefore, how can it be said that prayer is not accepted? Ignorant is the man who thinks so, and foolish is the philosopher who entertains that view. This claim is not without proof. I possess bright and clear arguments in its support, but if a person puts on a blindfold to avoid seeing the sun, how can such an individual ever see light?

Now, let it also be borne in mind that Islam, whose beauties I have recounted, is not something whose excellences we may prove only by referring to the past and pointing out where they lie buried. Islam is not a dead faith that it might be said that all its blessings lie in its past and that there is nothing in its future. The great excellence of Islam is indeed that its blessings perpetually accompany it. It does not merely talk about the stories of its past but offers ever-present blessings.

The world is always in need of blessings and heavenly Signs. It is

not that they used to be there before but no longer exist. The frail and feeble mortal who is blind when he comes into this world is perpetually dependent upon being shown the existence of some of the Kingdom of Heaven and of witnessing some indications of the existence and power of God in whom he believes. The Signs manifested in an earlier age cannot suffice for a later age because receiving an account of something is not the same as seeing it for oneself, and with the lapse of time, accounts of the past take on the form of stories.

With every new century, there starts, as it were, a new world. Therefore, the God of Islam, who is the True God, manifests new Signs for every new world; and, at the head of every century—and especially in a century devoid of faith and sincerity and filled with darkness of diverse kinds—He raises a successor Prophet, in the mirror of whose nature the image of the Prophet<sup>[sas]</sup> is reflected. This successor Prophet manifests to the people, through his own person, the excellences of the Prophet<sup>[sas]</sup> whom he follows. He exposes the guilt of all his opponents through truth, disclosure of the hidden verities, and the exposure of their falsehood. He does so through truth because the people did not believe in the true Prophet<sup>sas</sup>, and he proclaims the truth of the Prophet<sup>sas</sup> and points out the heavenly Signs of his truthfulness. He does so through the disclosure of hidden verities, for he resolves all the sealed points of the religion of the Prophet<sup>sas</sup> whom he obeys, thereby uprooting all doubts and objections. He does so through exposure of their falsehood, for he tears up the veils behind which the opponents live and shows the world how foolish those people are who have no understanding of the fine points of spiritual knowledge and have thrown themselves into neglect, ignorance, and darkness and are deprived and destitute of the audience with the Almighty.

This man, having these excellences, is always clothed in the robe of Divine communion. He is virtuous and blessed; his prayers are accepted; he proves, with utmost clarity, that God exists and that He is Almighty, All-Seeing, All-Hearing, All-Knowing, and is the Executor of His will; that prayers are, in fact, accepted, and that miraculous Signs are shown



by godly people. It is not that he alone is gifted with the cognition of Allah. Nay, in his time, a general transformation is brought about in the faith of the people of the world. All those miraculous Signs that the worldly people denied and ridiculed and which they considered to be opposed to philosophy and nature or which, if they at all made any allowance, were regarded by them as mere legends, are accepted as true after the advent of such a person and after witnessing his wonderful Signs. Indeed, people express regret and cry over what they had been doing before, that it was a great folly which they had regarded as great wisdom and sheer nonsense which they had deemed to be learning, wisdom, and the law of nature.

In short, he strikes people like a flame and paints all of them with his own colour in proportion to their varying capacities. In the beginning, he is subjected to trials and struggles, is put through difficulties and is called names of many kinds by the people who persecute and humiliate him in diverse ways, but since he is accompanied by truthful arguments, he triumphs over all in the end, and the rays of his truth spread with great force all over the world. When Almighty God sees that the earth does not testify to his truth, He commands the heavenly creations to bear witness to him. So, there descends a bright piece of testimony for him from the heavens in the form of miraculous Signs, acceptance of prayers, and the gift of fine points of spiritual verities and insights. This testimony reaches the deaf, the dumb, and the blind, and many are drawn to the truth and righteousness at that time, but blessed are those who accept him early, for they get a share of the glory of the *Ṣiddiqs* [Truthful] because of their purity of heart and strength of their faith. And this is the grace of God, which He bestows on whomsoever He pleases.

Now, with a view to completing the argument, I would like to point out that, in accordance with what I have said above, Almighty God, finding this age immersed in darkness, neglect, *kufr* [disbelief] and *shirk* [polytheism]; and seeing the decline of faith, sincerity, truth, and righteousness, has sent me so that He may re-establish the truth in

the world—in knowledge, practice, morals, and creed. And so that He may safeguard Islam from the attacks of people who—under the cloaks of philosophy, naturalism, heresy, *shirk* and atheism—wish to inflict some harm upon this Divine garden.

O Seekers of truth! Ponder over this: Is this not the time when Islam was in need of heavenly assistance? Have you not yet realized that in the past century, which was the 13th century, how many blows Islam has suffered? What unbearable injuries have we suffered as a result of the spread of misguidance? Do you not yet know what calamities surround Islam? Are you still unaware of: the many who have abjured Islam and have become Christians, atheists, or naturalists; how *shirk* and innovation have taken the place of *Tauḥīd* and the Sunnah [practice of the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>]; and how many books have been written and published across the globe for the refutation of Islam? Just reflect upon it—whether it was not incumbent upon God Almighty to send such a man at the beginning of this century who could repel the external attacks? If the advent of such a man was inevitable, do not knowingly reject this favour of God. Do not turn against him whose coming at the beginning of this century was a necessity in view of the exigencies of the time, whose advent the Noble Prophet<sup>sas</sup> had prophesied from the beginning, and whom the holy people had mentioned in their writings on the basis of their revelations and visions.

Just look around and see the extent to which calamities to Islam have made it helpless—how arrows are being launched against Islam from all four sides by its enemies, and how this poison has infected millions of souls! Look at all these storms with eyes wide open and point out, if you can, a parallel to them in the past—the storm of modern knowledge, the storm of reason, the storm of philosophy, the storm of fraud and intrigue, the storm of sin and transgression, the storm of greed and temptation, the storm of libertarianism and atheism, and the storm of *shirk* and innovation [i.e. religious deviation]. Has anything similar befallen since the days of Adam to now? If there is no parallel, then fear God Almighty and ascribe such meanings to the *ahādīth*

as are appropriate. Do not ignore the circumstances of the present so that you might clearly realize that all the prevalent misguidance is that same *Dajjāliyyat*—corruption of the Antichrist—against which every Prophet had warned and the foundation of which Christianity and the Christian nations have laid in this world.

It was necessary, therefore, that the *Mujaddid* [Reformer] of the age to come as the Messiah because the followers of the [first] Messiah are the ones who have laid the foundation of this spiritual strife. And it has been disclosed to me through a vision that Ḥaḍrat ‘Īsā<sup>as</sup> [Jesus] was apprised of the poisonous doctrines which have spread throughout the world through the Christians. Thereby, his soul was moved to beg for a spiritual descent upon the earth, and—deeply affected by finding his people ruined by this corruption—he desired a substitute who should resemble him and should be possessed of the same nature as himself as if he was the same. Hence, God Almighty, according to His promise, bestowed upon him one who resembled him and bestowed upon this one the resolve, the character, and the spirituality of the Messiah<sup>as</sup>. He and the Messiah [Jesus] were firmly bonded together as if the two were fashioned out of the same essence and the concerns of the Messiah [Jesus] made the heart of the other [Messiah] their resting place so that he might fulfil his urge through him. In this manner, he took on the identity of the Messiah, and the fervent designs of the Messiah descended upon him by virtue of which his coming was metaphorically described in the revelations as the coming of the Messiah.

Let it be borne in mind that it is one of the mysteries of the spiritual world that some perfectly holy men of the past acquire such a relationship with some such who are living on the earth by casting their spiritual influence upon them, and effecting a spiritual union with them, that they regard the advent of the latter as their own advent. As the same wishes arise in the heart of the heavens, they arise in the mind of the one upon the earth by the will of Almighty Allah. Their spirit—the essence of which is united with that of the man on earth—possesses such power that its will is placed into the other heart by God Almighty.

In short, it is the way of Allah that sometimes Prophets and saints of the past descend upon the earth in this manner. **Elijah's** manifestation in the person of **John** [the Baptist] was of this kind. It has been disclosed to my humble self that the real truth about the second advent of the Messiah is of this same nature. If there should still be someone who persists in doubt, I am prepared for a *mubāhalah* [prayer duel].

I had earlier refrained from *mubāhalah* because, as I understood, cursing Muslims was impermissible. But now, I have been informed that he who calls another Muslim a *kāfir* [disbeliever] and—despite finding the other's adherence to the *Qiblah* [direction of Prayer], affirmation of the *Kalimah*,<sup>1</sup> and belief in the doctrines of Islam—does not desist from calling him a *kāfir*, is himself outside the pale of Islam. I have, therefore, been commissioned to enter into a *mubāhalah* [prayer duel] with those individuals who are the leaders in the campaign of declaring me a disbeliever and are called *muftī*, *maulawī* and *muḥaddith* and who also have wives and children. It would be necessary that in a public gathering, I should first set forth my reasoning in a detailed speech, and refute all their charges and doubts that agitate their minds. If, after this, they do not desist from calling me a *kāfir*, I should enter into a *mubāhalah* with them.

The basis for the *mubāhalah* will not be that they exclude me from their technical appellation of *Ahl-e-Sunnah wal Jamā'ah*. I do not mind it in the least; for, I find that a *ghair muqallid* [not a follower of one of the four Imams] who calls himself the *Ahl-e-Ḥadīth*, addresses the followers of the four Imams as *bid'atī* [innovators] or belonging to the *Faij-e-A'waj* and considers them as contradicting the practice of the holy Companions and as opponents of the earlier elders in the Faith. Similarly, a *Ḥanafī* [follower of Imām Abū Ḥanīfah], for example, believes that all those who subscribe to the Oneness of God but do

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1. The declaration of the Islamic faith: *Lā ilāha illallāh; Muḥammadur-Rasūlullāh*, meaning: There is none worthy of worship except Allah; Muhammad is the Messenger of Allah. [Publisher]

not follow any of the Imams, are faithless and outside the pale of the *Sunnah Jamā'at*. Why, then, should I be worried of being considered outside the community of the followers of the *Sunnah*? Nowadays, to call oneself *Ahl-e-Sunnah wal Jamā'ah* is not considered the exclusive right of any sect; everyone thinks of himself to be the *Ahl-e-Sunnah* and excludes others from its fold.

This, therefore, is not a weighty dispute in the view of God. But to hastily call anyone *kāfir* for a minor difference in opinion and to declare him to be deserving of everlasting Hell is not, in the view of God, to be taken lightly or as an ordinary offence; it is a grave affair. It is a matter of great surprise that a man who believes in the *Kalimah*, faces the *Qiblah*, believes in One God, and accepts Allah and the Messenger<sup>ṣas</sup>, and truly loves them, and has faith in the Quran, should, merely on account of some minor difference of view, be declared a *kāfir* like the Jews and Christians or even worse than them, and that Miya'n Nadhīr Ḥusain and Shaikh Baṭālawī should acquiesce in his being called not only a *kāfir*, but an *akfar* [the greatest of disbelievers]; that is, deserving of punishment even somewhat greater than everlasting Hell.

The learned know that the Companions, may Allah be pleased with them, held views that differed greatly from each other. None of them was above this conflict of views—neither Ṣiddīq [Abū Bakr] nor Fārūq [ʿUmar], nor any other Companion. Indeed, it is reported that Ḥaḍrat Ibn-e-ʿAbbās, may Allah be pleased with him, notwithstanding the great eminence all the ulema grant him, differed from the general body of the Companions on fifty questions of theology. This difference had reached such an extent that he regarded some such matters as being lawful which other Companions considered quite unlawful or clearly sinful. Similarly, Ḥaḍrat Āyeshah Ṣiddīqah [the Truthful] and Ḥaḍrat Muʿāwiyah, may Allah be pleased with them, along with their adherents, were entirely opposed to the other Companions in their views of the nature of the *Mi'rāj* [Spiritual Ascension] and perception of the person of the Almighty, but no one called anyone *kāfir*. But times have taken such a turn that the *maulawīs* consider it ever so

easy to pronounce a Muslim brother as a *kāfir* and deserving of everlasting Hell as if it was nothing more than taking a sip of water. They have declared me a *kāfir* under the influence of this same old habit.

Therefore, I am now commissioned to invite the people, the leaders of the heresy campaign—Nadhīr Ḥusain of Delhi and Shaikh Muḥammad Ḥusain Baṭālāwī, and their peers who are of the same line of thought—to a *mubāhalah*. In discharging this responsibility, I publish below the *mubāhalah* announcement addressed to these leaders of the heresy hunt.

AN ESSENTIAL  
CONCLUSIVE ARGUMENT FOR  
SAYYED AHMAD KHAN C.S.I.<sup>1</sup>

After seeing some of the writings of Sayyed Ahmad Khan C.S.I., the leader of a new sect of Muslims, particularly his commen-

tary [of the Holy Quran], it appears that his ideas are along the lines of denying that anyone can really be blessed with converse and discourse with Allah. As of now, what I believe to be his view is that he denies the *wahy* [revelation] which is granted to Prophets through Gabriel, peace be upon him, and comprises of Allah's power, unveiling of the unseen, and other supernatural phenomena, and which descends purely from the heavens, and is not any natural human faculty.

**AUTHOR'S MARGIN NOTE**  
An Essential Conclusive  
Argument for Sayyed Ahmad  
Khan C.S.I.

He seemingly professes faith in the existence of Gabriel, but his Gabriel is not the Gabriel who is unanimously believed by 200 million Muslims of the world. He also believes in the revealed Word of Allah, but not in the Word which is comprised of the light and power of God. Rather, he believes it to be only a natural capacity which, in accordance with its measure, accepts the grace of God—not the *wahy* which emanates from the spring of the Divine.

The surprising fact is that Sayyed Şāḥib believes as well that the Noble Quran is from God, and from what he has been doing, it appears

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1. **Footnote** is referenced from the main text on page 264. [Publisher]

that he also loves Islam, has concern for Muslims, and is also keen about the material welfare of the progeny of Muslims. It is utterly surprising why, despite all this, he would express senseless and unorthodox opinions against the authoritative dicta of the Noble Quran.

The reason seems to be an inadvertent trial in which he has become ensnared. Namely, that before he could devote his thoughts to the teachings of the Noble Quran and attain complete awareness of its convincing arguments, he was attracted, at an inauspicious time, towards the books written in this age by European philosophers, who are very close to being atheists. Moreover, it appears that he has also been listening to the ideas of the modern free thinkers who were entrapped by European science and philosophy. Consequently, he had to suffer the same fate which is the lot of those taking a one-sided view of a matter. Having been ignorant of the lofty verities of the Noble Quran, he was affected by the magic of the discourses of philosophers. Had he not been supported by the grace of God Almighty and the purity of his heart which is the outcome of that grace, no one can say where his wanderings would have landed him by now.

As a matter of fact, Sayyed Šāhib's honesty of purpose is praiseworthy because he has not forsaken the Holy Quran, though inadvertently he has cast himself so far away from its purport, teaching, and guidance as to cause him to suggest interpretations of the Noble Quran which were neither within the knowledge of God and His Messenger, nor the Companions, nor Saints, *Quṭbs*, *Ghauths*, or *Abdāl*<sup>1</sup> and in support of which there was no authority nor any indication in the text.

Even more pitiable is that Sayyed Šāhib, meaning to do a well-intentioned service, swept away the basic principles of Islam which are the essence of Divine *wahy* [revelation] or, in other words, which are Islam itself. In his commentary, he has given such interpretations of the explicit verses of the Noble Quran that are remote from the truth and

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1. *Quṭbs*, *Ghauths*, or *Abdāl* are different ranks and honorary titles for the Saints in Islam. [Publisher]



so unjust that we cannot call them interpretations at all, and which, in a way, constitute a refutation of the pure teaching of the Noble Quran. Each and every sentence of Sayyed Şāhib shows as if his heart trembles at the new ideas and philosophy of Europe before which his spirit seems to lie prostrate. Whichever reference in his commentary I have examined in detail, in which the Noble Quran seemed to him really, or as the result of a superficial glance, to be against the prevalent philosophy, I found Sayyed Şāhib falling at the feet of that philosophy, and, taking for granted the conclusions of that philosophy, seeking such a disgraceful reconciliation between them and the Noble Quran by the use of flimsy interpretations, as is sought by a weak and hard-pressed adversary having no way to escape, by putting up a few absurd excuses. I was hoping to see some writings in which Sayyed Şāhib might have wielded a sharp sword against the prevalent philosophy and where, in cases of disagreement, he might have taken the opportunity of establishing the victory of the Noble Quran instead of resorting to questionable interpretations. But, alas, my wish remained unfulfilled.

If Sayyed Şāhib had made an attempt to interpret only such *aḥādīth* as were in his view opposed to the clear authority of the Noble Quran and which were also worthy of criticism against the prevailing philosophy, I would not have been sorry, for I would have considered that the Noble Quran, the basis and support of faith, every letter of which is irrevocable, certain, and true, is on the side of Sayyed Şāhib. But how can I conceal the lapse which amounted to negation of the Noble Quran itself?

I can never admit that his conscience may have, at any time, borne witness that the far-fetched and extensive process of interpretation spread by him was right. Rather, his conscience must be holding him guilty, and must be crying, 'O man, all your interpretations are such that if the Noble Quran had been a living being, it would have disowned them a hundred times.' And, in fact, it has disowned them, for it declares that those who distort the meaning of its verses deserve the wrath of God. The example of the misdeeds of the Jews is before us:

what kind of reputation had they earned by the interpolation and distortion in the text of the Word of God?

Any verse of the Noble Quran should be given such meanings which agree with the meaning of hundreds of other verses which are available for their support, so that the heart may be completely satisfied and exclaim that such indeed is the sense that is clearly conveyed by the Sacred Word of Allah, glorified be His eminence. It is a great sin and depravity to impute to the Noble Quran such meanings that are remote from its true meaning, as if we were trying to conceal its supposed faults, or as if the Holy Quran required to be told what it did not know.

The egregious error which Sayyed Ṣāhib has committed is that he accepts modern philosophy to be so irrefutable and certain as if it is beyond any error, whereas this new philosophy and science is just as vulnerable as the errors which are being exposed of the former philosophy or science. Sayyed Ṣāhib has forgotten the well-known saying: پائی استدلالیاں چوبین بود [It is a wooden leg upon which an argumentative person takes his stand]. He accredited the new philosophy with an honour which solely belongs to the pure and certain Word of God.

A few months ago Sayyed Ṣāhib, writing to one of his friends in Sialkot, said that my writings cannot benefit anyone at all; that is, they were totally devoid of truth. And not only *this* much, but I also recall that once Sayyed Ṣāhib had even published in a newspaper that it is an impossibility for anyone to experience revealed prophecies or be blessed with Divine visions and manifestations, and if anyone makes such a claim, then he is one of those stricken by dementia and such thoughts are one of the precursors of insanity, and if these delusions are firmly rooted in the mind, then it is complete insanity. This is a brief summary of his statement although I cannot precisely recall his actual words.

In short, I was so very saddened to hear and read such statements. I was surprised that a man like Sayyed Ṣāhib, who claims to be a lover of Islam and a zealous commentator of the Noble Quran and even boasts

of his unwavering devotion, determination, and fine authorship, would be so quick to make such statements that are diametrically opposed to the teachings of *Furqān-e-Hamīd* [the Praiseworthy Discrimination; i.e. Quran]. I would have been so pleased if Sayyed Ṣāhib—instead of making adverse and unjustified remarks against me and keeping silent after declaring a claimant of Divine communion to be insane and irrational—had demanded the arguments in support of my claim, as is customary with truth-loving and fair-minded people. Then, if I was in error, a clear verdict should have been given upon that error, and if, his revered self was in error, then he would have had a blessed opportunity to correct himself. In any case, the public would have benefited from this affair, and the daily controversies on which so much is being written these days would have been settled. But I feel saddened again and again that Sayyed Ṣāhib did not give so much as the slightest consideration to this straight path. I have contemplated much over the reason for his omitting to do so. It does not seem to be the case that Sayyed Ṣāhib is averse to being thrown into controversy with all and sundry, for my claims are not ordinary claims. Rather, they are matters that are the subject of talk among hundreds of thousands, if not millions, of people.

Apart from this, Sayyed Ṣāhib makes a general denial of revealed prophecies and miracles, and as far as I can gather from his writings, even the Prophets are not outside the scope of his denial. It would have been much better, therefore, for him to get his doubts resolved on this occasion from me who not only believes in prophetic revelation as a matter of faith, but actually lays claim to have experienced it. In the event I was unable to substantiate my claim, I would have been ready to suffer whatever penalty Sayyed Ṣāhib prescribed, and, if on the other hand, I was right, Sayyed Ṣāhib, at the time when his star of life was about to set, should not only have conceded that I was right, but should have also recovered his faith in prophetic revelation which he had lost.

My dear sir, it is the path to ruin to ignore the voice of a crier who is inviting towards the truth, to look at him with contempt, to make

unfounded remarks against him, and to remain obstinate against the proven truth. I feel that your statements reek not only of believing this Ummah to be bereft of Divine communion, but also that you deny that any Prophet had the honour of ever receiving the living and powerful Word of God Almighty. If your doctrine is truly what I have understood it to be, and which has crossed my mind, then I fear that—God forbid—your faith is in a precarious situation indeed.

I would be very pleased if you would let me know through some newspaper that you do not deny that Prophets receive the living Word of God Almighty or that the Word of God does not consist of information about the unseen. If, however, you believe, God forbid, what I have so far understood to be your belief—that the Divine Scriptures are not in fact and in reality the Word of God Almighty, and that *wahy* [revelation] means only a natural capacity possessed by Prophets—that is, they have a natural capacity to speak of wisdom and truth—I wish to publicly refute this position and to carry this argument to its conclusion so that people are not misled to their destruction by following you.

If you agree to retract your present position and then ask me to prove how *wahy* is in reality the Word of God Almighty and how it consists of information about the unseen and of past and future events, I shall be much pleased to prove this by putting forth examples of revealed prophecies. And, perhaps, nothing else would delight me so much as the news that you are ready to try this test honestly; for, if you renounce your fatal views, it would, I believe, be nothing less than reforming a whole nation.

When I see that the Noble Quran is full of past and future prophecies, for example, all its stories constitute information about the unseen, not that they are set forth on hearsay, I wonder how you can maintain that the Noble Quran does not contain information about the unseen or about the past events and prophecies about the future. Should we take your doctrine to be that the story of Joseph, *Aṣḥāb-e-Kahf* [the People of the Cave], or Adam and Moses, etc. etc., are not

*wahy* [revelations] from God; that is, they have not descended from Him, but were incorporated in the Holy Quran by the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, on hearsay from the Jews and Christians? If this be the case, the greater part of the Noble Quran will have to be excluded from that Holy Word; for, what is recorded on hearsay from the Jews and Christians would actually be the words of such Jews and Christians and not the Word of God Almighty. There would be another serious dilemma. The Noble Quran, in the case of several accounts of the Torah, tells a different story, and, this being so, it would have to be admitted that the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, in his simplicity and ignorance, inserted in the Noble Quran whatever the mischievous Jews related to him by way of deceit.

Now, one should contemplate that if a man believes that the Noble Quran contains hearsay information from the Jews and Christians, how can he say that he considers the Noble Quran to be the Word of God Almighty? Notwithstanding, I think that you do not entertain this belief at heart. The star of Western philosophy may have appeared very glittering to you, but—God forbid—how could it be possible that you would ever uproot the deep and firm belief from your heart which permeates your very being—not only because you belong to Islam, but also because of your Sayyed lineage—which is that every word of the Noble Quran is verbally revealed? Could it be possible that you would alternatively allow yourself to hold the belief that the stories and accounts of past events found in the Noble Quran are not the unadulterated tidings of the unseen, but are taken from Jews and Christians?

The dilemma is that if you believe that all the stories from Ḥaḍrat Adam up to Ḥaḍrat Maṣīḥ, [Jesus], peace be upon him, presented in the Holy Quran by Allah, His eminence be glorified, are the unadulterated tidings of the unseen and are above and beyond human nature and capacity, your principle that *wahy* [revelation] is nothing but a natural human capability breaks down. For, human nature cannot develop Divine powers within itself. The natural capacity of everyone is limited

by virtue of his humanity, and, as you believe *wahy* to be nothing more than a natural capacity, you will be inviting the objection stated just now. Every knowledgeable person who has experienced the phenomenon of revelation will laugh at your conjecture that *wahy* is a mere natural capability.

You are right to the extent that natural fitness to receive the light of Divine *wahy* is an essential condition for one to be able to reflect the light which God Almighty may at a certain time send down by His special will, but it is patently false that that light is to be found entirely within human nature and that nothing, having within it the character of Divine powers, comes down from the Source of all Bounty by His will.

Dear Sayyed! The views you follow in regard to this are not truly the principles of Islam. Rather, they are the opinions of spiritually blind philosophers who do not believe the Holy Creator, gloried be His name, to be the Master of His will, but believe Him to be—like the sun and the moon—merely a cause among causes of certain occurrences. When you begin to believe that God is the Master of His will and is the Being who sends down *wahy* in accordance with His own will, and also understand *wahy* to be something which emanates from His very Being, descending upon hearts with Divine power, then under these circumstances, you will not be able to say that it is a natural proficiency, nor call it a natural capability. Rather, you will designate it the Light of God which is sent down by the hand of God through His will, and descends at the very time when He pleases. Certainly, the light which descends, however, only illumines the one whose nature is worthy of it and makes him aware of itself.

The answer to the objection that we cannot accept this view of *wahy* because it is beyond the comprehension of human intellect, is that if the intellect of man considers an established truth to be above and beyond its comprehension, it will not be permissible to reject that truth simply because human intellect cannot probe its reality. In the world, plants, minerals, and animals are found to have many properties

which experiments show as proven, but which are beyond the comprehension of human intellect; that is, the intellect cannot probe into and describe their reality. The same is the case of *wahy* which comes down from God Almighty and conveys to pure hearts the knowledge which is beyond human capacity to discover. Again, when we know that human reason by itself amounts to nothing—rather, it assumes an importance and status through proven and established verities—then we can very well assert that heavenly *wahy* is a proven true phenomenon, having in it a miraculous significance and power, and consisting of information about the unseen. I am ready to prove this claim. Could it befit those who are hungering and thirsting in the quest for genuine truth to ignore making a test?

If you turn towards me with a sincere heart, I promise, having been enabled to do so by God Almighty, that I will seek help from the Absolutely Powerful One for the purpose of satisfying you, and I am certain that He will hear my entreaties and will rescue you from the misconceptions on the account of which, not only you but a large number of men seem to be in a whirlpool of doubts. Trust me that—simply for the sake of God—I stand ready to prove to you that your views are erroneous. You will now be able to understand my wonder and surprise and regret which have been caused by your statements in which you have, without giving it a thought, taken up the position that neither angels, nor *wahy* through angels, is real; but, rather, they are the names given to the natural abilities of man.

My dear sir, human nature cannot manifest Divine powers, and whatever is given to man as a part of his nature does not go beyond the limits set upon his capabilities by virtue of his being a creation of God. For example, we can never say that the discoveries and inventions of man—however wonderful and unique they may be—can ever rival the works of God Almighty. But the *wahy* which I have myself witnessed with my eyes, and the blessed voice which I have heard with my own ears, is without the least doubt above the capacity of human nature and comprises Divine powers of great magnitude. For me, seeing them



is akin to witnessing the face of God Almighty Himself. This is the pure word of God, just as much as the earth, the sun, and the moon are purely the creations of God Almighty. And, undoubtedly, revelation transcends the nature of man in the same way as God transcends man.

If, setting aside the veil of your personal greatness, you take a little trouble and live in the company of this humble one for a few weeks, then I am hopeful that most of what you consider beyond reason will easily appear to you to be rational and possible. You may consider yourself very well equipped with the essence of philosophy and science, and you may have been enlightened with modern light, having traversed all the stages of naturalism, but, my dear sir! (please do not mind my saying so) heavenly light is altogether different from the light of Western sciences. Had you known the darkness and damage caused by this light, you would have preferred a thousand times to live like a simple Muslim in preference to this wretched light, and adopting the humble people's faith, fearing the tribulations of this age of the Antichrist, and making use of patience in matters of faith, you would always have prayed with humility:

رَبَّنَا أَفْرِغْ عَلَيْنَا صَبْرًا وَتَوَقَّنَا مُسْلِمِينَ<sup>1</sup>

Beware that the prevailing philosophy is powerless and lifeless before proven truths.

Any body of knowledge, whether old or new, cannot override the actual facts. When I say two and two makes four, need I fear that a great philosopher may contradict this assertion of mine? Or, if I understand the day to be a day, why should I be fearful if a band of philosophers in my presence is calling it night? No food gives that strength to the body as does a convincing argument and complete revelation to the heart. This revelation and this argument which are necessary for the cognition

1. Our Lord, pour forth upon us steadfastness and cause us to die resigned *unto Thee* (*Sūrah al-A'rāf*, 7:127). [Publisher]



of God and the belief in life after death—which indeed are the sources of salvation—can only be attained through the true knowledge given to a steadfast man of faith. They can never be attained through philosophy—old or new—but those who neither fully develop their faiths to realize the light attendant upon faith, nor make thorough progress in the study of philosophy to realize its toxic effect, remain in doubt.

The true significance of all things is disclosed when they are at their full. For example, if it is required to discover the real action of a poison or an antidote, the poison or antidote should be taken in full dose, and, if it is intended to find out completely the value of the teaching of a philosopher or a Prophet, one must become a fully devoted disciple or follower of such philosopher or Prophet. You must be aware that the limits to which philosophy at its height takes, and has been taking, man is the limit called atheism.

Do you believe that the people called philosophers are true heirs to the cognition of God? Have any of these philosophers ever attained true humility, *taqwā* [righteousness], fear of God, and the realization of the greatness of God—the qualities which are the result of true cognition of God? Is there any hope that a study of philosophical books gives us that true cognition of God, which liberates man from the bondage of selfish desires and fills the heart with Divine love? To my knowledge, definitely not.

The ultimate height that the knowledge of philosophy leads to is that such a man who relies solely on it takes complete leave of God, the Prophet, Heaven and Hell, and chooses to live in arrogance, pride, and conceit. According to the philosophers, belief in the existence of God, who is the Master of His will, is only a superstition; Prayer and fasting are a waste of time; and any thought of the life hereafter is sheer madness. They are infused with this spirit which, like a powerful engine, draws them every moment towards atheism.

The centre of Islamic spiritual wisdom and knowledge is the idea of the existence of God and His being the Master of His will and One without associates. And all the matters of our faith correspond to this

concept. But, the centre of philosophical wisdom and knowledge is atheism, and all the investigations of philosophy correspond to that view. There are, however, some among them who make a verbal confession of God Almighty being the Cause of all causes, but they do not believe Him to be the Master of His own will, or to exercise any choice or prerogative over His creation, or to possess any detailed knowledge of the universe. They do not believe that He has any control or power over the universe. Hence, they too, in reality, are the younger brothers of atheists.

It is true that we should accept the truth wherever we find it, but, we should never eat from a dish which is among a number of poisoned dishes, hoping that in all probability it would be free from poison. Surely, everyone argues according to his principles; details of all discussions and investigations are governed by principles. When, therefore, the real creed of philosophers is atheistic or very close to it, how can one hope that there should be anything good in their discussions which necessarily must be governed by their creed? In fact, in the presence of the Word of Almighty God, what need and necessity remains for such discussions, that we should knowingly adopt a dangerous course which has always been leading to destruction? Five times a day, every Muslim recites the prayer in his daily Prayer that:

إِهْدِنَا الصِّرَاطَ الْمُسْتَقِيمَ ۝ صِرَاطَ الَّذِينَ أَنْعَمْتَ عَلَيْهِمْ<sup>1</sup>

And, Almighty God has made it clear that the straight path is the path of the Prophets, the path of the Truthful, and the path of the Martyrs. Then we would be extremely foolish not to seek the ways which God has commanded us to seek, and to wander, instead, after the philosophers.

To say, moreover, that we should give rational proof of all our beliefs, with the exactness of mathematics or the preciseness of some of

1. Guide us in the right path—the path of those on whom You have bestowed Your blessings (*Sūrah al-Fātiḥah*, 1:6–7). [Publisher]

the conclusions of physical sciences because man is gifted with reason and that which is not consistent with reason is not something which is worthy of acceptance, is a dangerous and fatal misconception under which you belabour. That is why you do not keep religion and science apart as two separate entities; rather, you want to give the collection of religious issues and doctrines the character of a science like mathematics or like something even more. But, alas! You do not consider that if religious knowledge and doctrines had been the subject of such obvious proofs as the expression 'two and two makes four', then for what reason should we have been promised salvation for accepting and believing them?

I fail to see any relationship between salvation and the fact of one's accepting and following an obvious phenomenon. If I were to say, 'I admit that up to this day, the 30th of November 1892, Sayyed Şahib is alive and hale and hearty'; or, if I were to accept the fact that Sunday is followed by Monday; that one-half of twenty is, in fact, ten; should I expect any reward for putting my faith in, and following, these matters of fact? Again, for example, had the existence of angels been like tangible beings; had they been, for instance, believable such that Almighty God could have held them up physically to your view and you could have felt them with your hands and seen them with your eyes; and in similar fashion, the streams of Paradise, the fair maidens and young boys of Paradise had been seen by you while you were sitting in Aligarh; and you had also enjoyed a cup of the pure drink, and had seen Hell before your very eyes; then I cannot understand what merit it would have been to believe in all these things after witnessing such patent and obvious proofs of their existence?

My dear Sayyed, time is fleeting. Quickly realize the important and delicate issue that reward depends upon faith, and faith means acceptance of facts whose existence is possible on the basis of some evidence, but which nevertheless remain concealed and covered, because, by believing in such facts, a person becomes true in the eyes of Almighty God. The reason is that he has accepted the information of His Prophet

and Messenger, and realizes His Messenger to be a True Bearer of news. Therefore, he attains salvation by virtue of his sincerity and goodness. It is the duty of every intelligent person to reflect over the deep mystery as to why Almighty God kept matters which man is obliged to have faith in, so secret and hidden that they cannot be solved or explained by the knowledge, wisdom, and philosophy of this world.

For example, in matters pertaining to faith, the foremost fact is that one has to believe in the existence of Almighty God, in His attributes of Knowledge, of His being Wise and Almighty, of His being the Lord of His will, of His being One without a partner, Eternal and Everlasting, Lord of the Throne, and then of His being Omnipresent, but what discovery can the reason of man make regarding these matters except that it may indulge in mere speculations and self-made conjectures? Further, how can such a person who is hungry and thirsty to discover the true reality and who desires realization of the Living God, be satisfied with the one-sided and inadequate argumentation of reason?

Human intellect may indulge in a thousand thoughts, and it may think—ever so deeply as if a hundred-thousand times—over the wisely planned creation of the earth and other heavenly bodies, but it can never dare make the assertion that there is a Creator of this universe; for, such an assertion can only be made if He has been seen or discovered. If, however, human reason does not fall prey to deception and does not go astray, it can only say that there ought to be a Creator of this highly organized, superbly planned, and wisely designed enterprise. Nonetheless, the extent of the difference that separates 'is' from 'ought to be' is obvious.

What I have said is only by way of mild statement. Otherwise, whoever has taken reason alone as their guide to find the Person of Almighty God, has been carried along by reason to either atheism or to such a weak belief in God Almighty, which is tantamount to disbelief. When the rationalists flounder even at the stage of God-realization, and, make a wrong start, then what can we expect from human reason in other matters pertaining to the unseen?

The answer to the question as to why these matters pertaining to faith have been kept a secret, is the very same as I have just stated that, the mercy, forgiveness, and grace of Almighty God has made these mysteries the path of salvation for man; for, Almighty God who is the Cause of all causes, His angels who are the planners of things under the command of God, the Day of Reckoning which is the Day of the manifestation of supreme power, Heaven, Hell, and the true reality of Prophethood, Messengership, and *wahy* were concealed from the view of the intellectuals. He gave knowledge of these facts to His unlettered servants, on whom He bestowed the crown of Prophethood and the robe of Messengership, and sent to the world to convey the invitation of faith. Then, everyone who took such a servant of His as the true bearer of news, and believed in them, were called 'believers' and they attained salvation, but those who questioned, worshipping reason and logic, became dead, *kāfir* [disbelievers], and losers of both this world and the Hereafter, their abode being Hell.

But here, no one must deceive themselves into believing that this call to faith is based on compulsion, or that it places a burden on man which he is unable to bear, because—as I have already stated in this and in previous writings—these matters pertaining to faith are accompanied by such pointers that are a source of satisfaction for a seeker of truth, which are considered equivalent to arguments and proof by a reasonable man, and which kill and destroy superstition and philosophy. The call again, coming from the mouth of one who has with him heavenly light, blessings, and miracles, and who is supported by extraordinary events, undoubtedly gives to the Faith of a reasonable man a unique brilliance if he only but turns his attention to such blessings.

This is the philosophy of faith which I have presented. The Word of Almighty God teaches us to have faith so that we may deserve salvation. It does not guide us to demand philosophical arguments and proofs of a conclusive character in support of the doctrines that the Prophet, peace be upon him, taught regarding these matters. It does not tell us not to believe in these truths until and unless they are clear

to us like the conclusions of mathematics. It is obvious that if a Prophet is to be believed only after his claim has been weighed in the balance of science, it would not be rendering obedience to the Prophet; for, every truth when completely revealed stands self-accepted, whether the same is put forward by a Prophet or by a man who is not a Prophet; it has to be accepted even if it is put forward by a sinner.

The information we accept as true because of our faith in a Prophet or because of a presumption in his truth, must be such that while, rationally, it might be highly probable, the ignorant might still be disposed to believe it to be false, so that, by taking the Prophet to be true and by aligning ourselves on the side of the truth, we might become worthy of the reward that may follow from our goodwill, our refined judgement, our respectful attitude, and our faith. The same is the essence of the teachings of the Noble Quran that I have presented. However, the sages and philosophers have not even trodden this path. They have always been careless of faith, and have been searching for knowledge, the certainty of which, they wish, might be made openly manifest to them immediately.

Nevertheless, bear in mind that while God Almighty requires faith in the unseen from the believers, He has not desired that believers be deprived of certainty of knowledge. Rather, faith is a ladder for the acquisition of certainty of knowledge. It is a grave error to search for true knowledge without climbing this ladder, but those who do climb up this ladder most surely see the face of clear insight and satisfying explanations. When a man of faith, being a true believer, accepts the commandments and information from God simply because such commandments and information have been bestowed upon him by God Almighty, proceeded from God and have reached him through a truthful bearer of news, he becomes worthy of attaining the reward of cognition of God. That is why Almighty God has ordained that His servants should first have faith in the unseen and should join the party of the obedient ones, and only then should they be admitted to the stage of

cognition when all their spiritual difficulties are resolved. But—alas!—man is hasty and fails to adopt this course.

Almighty God has promised in the Noble Quran that if a man only believes the Noble Prophet to be true and if he then tries to discover the true reality of the unseen through spiritual effort, the same would be disclosed to him through visions and *ilhām* [inspiration], and the faith of such an individual would be raised up to the stage of *irfān* [divine cognition]. The truth of this promise has always been made manifest to the holy ones who seek Almighty God through spiritual effort. In short, what is above the ordinary understanding of believers should not be sought by begging at the door of the school of philosophers or by asking the way from one who has lost it himself. Rather, they are granted the stage of Divine cognition through sincerity and perseverance. That is the stage where all their spiritual difficulties are resolved.

Do not be disheartened by the furious struggle going on in this age between religion and science and the attack upon religion being made by science, wondering what to do. Be sure that in this struggle Islam has no need to sue for peace like a conquered and helpless adversary. Rather, this is the age of Islam's spiritual sword, just as there has been in the past an age of its temporal might. Bear in mind this prophecy that, in this battle too, the enemy would very soon be vanquished with disgrace and Islam would be triumphant. The new learning of this age may launch attacks ever so severe with ever so new weapons, but they are doomed to suffer defeat.

I say this in a spirit of gratitude of the blessed favour that I have been granted knowledge of the great powers of Islam, on the basis of which I can make the assertion that Islam will not only remain secure from the attacks of modern knowledge, but will, instead, prove the ignorance of all present knowledge which is against it. The Kingdom of Islam has nothing to fear from the invasion of philosophy and science. The days of its grandeur are at hand, and I can clearly see the heavenly Signs of its triumph. This glory is spiritual and the triumph is also spiritual, so

that the powers of a false philosophy opposed to it may be broken and reduced to nothing by the Divine power of Islam.

I wonder from whom and where you heard and how you came to believe that the principles put forth by the philosophy and science of this age are dominant over Islam. Thoroughly bear in mind, sir, that philosophy merely possesses an incomplete weapon in the shape of reason, whereas Islam not only wields this weapon in full, but also many other heavenly weapons. Why should Islam then fear the assault? Hence, I do not know to why you are so fearful of this philosophy? Why do you fall at its feet, and why do you struggle to give a far-fetched interpretation to the meaning of the verses of the Holy Quran? It is a pity that you have accepted a great hoard of those statements of which to believe even one of those statements makes it incumbent to deny all the tenets of Islam, and it is strange that in spite of denying miracles, denying angels, denying news of the unseen, denying revelation, denying acceptance of prayer, and other denials, you also accept everywhere that the Quran is true, the Messenger is true, Islam is true and everything opposed to it is false; then on account of the fusion of these diametrically opposed ideas, your writings have become likened to that bizarre beast that is forced together in such a way that its mouth is of a man, its tail of a monkey, hide of a goat, claws of a wolf, and the tusks of an elephant for show while the truth inside is altogether different.

Again, the extreme extent of pity of it is that like the Shiites, your writings contain examples of *taqiyyah*<sup>1</sup>—in stating some of your views you make them so ambiguous as not to be the least intelligible. Your words, like the ostrich, are capable of assuming both the forms of a camel as well as a bird.

You may perhaps repeat your assertion, which I have just refuted, and say that writings of this kind were the need of this age. You may be

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1. In *Malfūzāt*, vol. 10, dated 10 February 1908, the Promised Messiah<sup>as</sup> has described *taqiyyah* as to 'disavow one's faith wherever overpowered or when one sees his own interest being jeopardized'. [Publisher]



thinking that when the whole of one's property is at risk in some calamity, one should bear a small loss in order to avoid a greater loss; for, it is better to lose a little than to lose it all. However, all such ideas would result from lack of due deliberation. You should bear in mind that not a dot of the Holy Quran is in danger owing to any coordinated attack launched by the philosophies of those in the past or the present. The Holy Quran is the kind of stone that will crush whoever it falls upon, and whoever falls upon it shall himself be broken into pieces—so why should you be so anxious to sue for a humiliating peace?

What have you done for Islam outside of accepting many false ideas of contemporary philosophy? You have sought to subordinate the Book whose every letter wields Divine glory to the ideas of the philosophers, and have sued for a humiliating peace. In my opinion, such endeavours on your part cannot defend against the corruption of the Antichrist in this age. Rather, they are a branch of its many branches because from the inside you have opened the gate of the Citadel of Islam for its enemies, helping to tie the hands and feet of the Muslims so that the enemies may comfortably enter this City and plunder it as they please, while the Muslims remain utterly helpless.

I am, however, of the opinion that you have not done so knowingly. Undoubtedly your motives must be honest, for it can be gathered from your writings that there is no reason to doubt your goodwill for Islam. But your goodwill actually has resulted in evil consequences, and it is really the community's misfortune that the Muslims' cause has been harmed in a way that no declared mischief-maker could have done, by one who purports to be a reformer. You may perhaps put forward the excuse that this had a purpose, that you published these writings at a time when the evils of Western education were overtaking the world and when the storm of spiritual darkness was at its height; that you supplied this dirty food for those who would wish to have it, lest they might apostatize from Islam—they might eat dirt but they must not abjure Islam!

This assessment of your efforts formed by some people may perhaps be partially true, that if Sayyed Ṣāhib had not supplied this food for such people, then only God knows how they might have degraded themselves like animals. Had this been your motive, even then, in my opinion, it was not free from error, for you cannot prevent anyone's inherent evil from expressing itself. Allah, glorified be His eminence, says:

كُلُّ يَعْمَلُ عَلَى شَاكِلَتِهِ<sup>1</sup>

Meaning that everyone acts according to his nature.

One should only teach the truth regardless of whether anyone accepts it or not. This is the way of the Prophets, and not that one should destroy one's own eye upon seeing another blind person. There may be a hidden fear in your mind that the ship of Islam was in great danger amid the storm of this new philosophy, and although it was full of jewels and carried a fine cargo—as it had been overwhelmed by a violent storm—it was expedient at the time of such a sudden calamity when there was no other help, that some of those bundles of jewels and fine cargo be thrown into the sea and that having made the ship a little lighter, human lives might be saved. If this was your motive, it was an unwarranted disobedience, which was none of your business.

The Captain of this ship is God Almighty, not you. He has repeatedly affirmed His promise that this ship would never be in such dangers till the Day of Judgment, and that He would always save it from the ravages of storms and unfavourable winds, as is the promise:

إِنَّا نَحْنُ نَزَّلْنَا الذِّكْرَ وَإِنَّا لَهُ لَحَافِظُونَ<sup>2</sup>

Meaning that: 'We Ourselves have sent down this Word and We will always continue to protect it.'

1. *Sūrah Banī Isrā'īl*, 17:85 [Publisher]

2. *Sūrah al-Ḥijr*, 15:10 [Publisher]

You ought to have, therefore, waited for the guidance of this Captain from the unseen and should have remained firmly of the belief that as surely the storm is raging, the help of the Captain called God was also near, who is not only the Owner of the ship, but is also its Captain. Therefore, you should not have been so bold and merciless, being self-appointed, to throw overboard the boxes of invaluable jewels, bags of pure gold, and the bundles of fine and valuable dresses.

Well, what is past is past.

Now I convey the news to you, sending glad tidings that the Captain who is the God of heaven and earth has already heard the wailing of the dwellers of this earth, and just as He had promised in His Holy Word that at the time of the storm, He would rescue His ship, He has, by appointing a servant of His—that is, this humble one who speaks—and has instructed him in the methods which would weather the storm and which would dispense with the need of throwing the boxes of valuables into the sea. The time is near when the heavens will send forth the call:

قِيلَ يَا رِضْ أَبْلَعِي مَاءَكَ وَيَسَاءَ أَقْلِبِي وَغِيْضَ الْهَاءِ وَقُضِيَ الْأَمْرُ وَاسْتَوَتْ عَلَى الْجُودِيِّ<sup>1</sup>

But the storm is still raging. God Almighty appointed me at the time of this very storm and commanded me:

وَاصْنَعِ الْفُلْكَ بِأَعْيُنِنَا وَوَحْيِنَا.

Meaning that: 'Make the ark under Our command and before Our eyes. This ark shall be in no danger of the storm and shall have the hand of Almighty God over it.' Hence, that ark of pristine Islam is the very one [i.e. Jama'at] which I invite people to board. If you are awake, then

1. It was said, 'O earth, swallow thy water, and O sky, cease *rain*ing.' And the water was made to subside and the matter was ended. And *the Ark* came to rest on al-Jūdī (*Sūrah Hūd*, 11:45). [Publisher]

arise and board this ark quickly, for the storm is in the height of its fury on earth, and all lives are in danger.

If you are fair-minded, you will be the first to acknowledge the existence of this storm. Rather, you have already acknowledged in several places that the present is the age for the appearance of the storm, from the ravages of which a promise to save the ark of Islam is contained in the Holy Quran. The Ummah has never before passed through a storm of this kind such as now; the world has never before seen such a war between religion and science which is happening now. Never before had ancient science and philosophy tried to efface Islam as contemporary science is seeking to do.

Who can point out such intellectual and academic depredations in the past as we see perpetrated today with our own eyes? Who can point out in any past age the precedent of such a storm predicated upon rationality as we are now witnessing day and night? In which era gone by can these convoluted philosophies and atheistic attacks be seen? And where can we find these shrewdly serpentine uproars in previous ages? Where and in which previous age can these kinds of scientific and intellectual catastrophes be found, which Islam must now face? When and at which time have such difficulties presented themselves in any previous age, which are presenting themselves now?

Do you not admit that the troubles and hardships of such intense level of intellectual debates which have now befallen Islam have never descended in any previous age? We, too, cannot find any such scene since the time of Adam to this day. Do you not agree that the calamity arising from the science and philosophy of today is a thousand times more serious and formidable than that which took hold of Islamic countries, arising out of Greek sciences? Do you not accept the fact that the enemy who has come into being today is more powerful than all the enemies of past combined, who came forth at various times?

Again, how can you run away from admitting that the sacred promise given in the beautiful words is a promise for these very days:

١٠ اِنَّا نَحْنُ نَزَّلْنَا الذِّكْرَ وَاِنَّا لَكُلِّ لَحِظُوْنَ

It is forewarning us of an age of a severe calamity which will befall Islam, and a fierce enemy will stand up in opposition, and a fierce storm will come into being. At that time, God Almighty shall send forth the treatment of a cure. And He shall favour it with an ark for being saved from such a storm. That ark is the invitation of this humble one. If anyone can hear, then listen. You totally deny the *ahādīth* of the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>. There is no point in presenting to you the hadith about the advent of a *Mujaddid* [Reformer] for every century—why would you accept this? So we will leave that aside, but, I draw your attention to the above-mentioned verse, and similar other verses, which I have written for the opportunity of this discussion in this very book.

Sir, this is that age, and these are those calamities, for which it was necessary that the Eternal Grace may draw attention towards it. The Noble Quran, while indicating the troubles of this age, explains:

٢٠ اِنَّا نَحْنُ نَزَّلْنَا الذِّكْرَ وَاِنَّا لَكُلِّ لَحِظُوْنَ

Meaning that: ‘We have sent down this Word and it is We who shall safeguard its honour, its greatness and the teachings contained within it, from the attacks of the enemies.’

In past ages the material sword of Islam had dispensed with many superfluous debates, and there was ample defence against the mischievous and cruel opponents suited to their natures. Moreover, the prophetic age had passed only a short time ago, and Muslims were endowed with *taqwā* [righteousness], piety and a true sympathy for Islam. But today all this is missing. Today there is no poor man, orphan,

1. Verily, We Ourselves have sent down this Exhortation, and most surely We will be its Guardian (*Sūrah al-Hijr*, 15:10). [Publisher]

2. *Sūrah al-Hijr*, 15:10 [Publisher]

or destitute person who is as downtrodden as Islam. Most of the well-to-do people live a life of luxury. They have no time to spare from building their worldly mansions, from catering to their pleasure, and—to some extent—spending for earning a good name and reputation.

The *maulawī* class is entangled in their own selfish bickering. They neither have the ability nor the zeal for inviting towards Islam, nor do they have any concern or passion for it. All they can do is to declare their own people, their own brethren, their own fellow Muslims, and their own fellow reciters of the same *Kalimah*, facing the same *Qiblah* to be *kāfir* [disbelievers], to call them *dajjāl* [deceivers], to brand them faithless, to issue edicts banning social relations with them, and announcing that it is unlawful to perform their funeral prayers, and they deserve various adverse appellations. And the scions of saintly houses and hermits of today who are known as 'godly people' are just sitting with their ears stuffed with cotton. Islam is being beaten like an innocent child in front of their eyes. The enemy is about to strangle him but these hard-hearted so-called hermits couldn't care less.

From whom, then, should Islam look for help? To whom should it appeal for sympathy? Firstly, all of these sections of society are incapable of serving Islam in any way. And if ever any of them does an uncommon happy service to Islam, it is not free from ostentation or ulterior motives. Thus, if Islam is not destitute today, when would it be? If these are not the days of misery, when would they be?

I declare on the basis of certain and conclusive revelation from Almighty God that these are the very days of serious calamities and it is the age of the Antichrist which had been foretold by the Immaculate Prophet, peace be upon him. The present-day foolish *maulawīs* deny that it is the age of the great Antichrist or of the greater catastrophes, but this denial of theirs will be valid only if they can point to any parallel from the days of Adam to the present day, to the great catastrophes which are knocking at the very crux of Islam. And because this age is totally deprived of virtue, and because genuine *taqwā* has

disappeared, and in the hands of some there has remained only the shell and not the kernel of *taqwā* and good deeds, and some have lost even the shell with the exception of a few rare godly persons who lead a secluded life, the present age is not the age in which the leaven of goodness may ferment to produce other good people, or one candle may be lit by another candle.

When Almighty God saw that the earth had been corrupted and that there was none who could by himself reform this state of affairs—not a single one—and when He saw that man's works and words and motives and worship and thoughts had all become corrupt, and that actions had become crooked, then according to His promise, He sent down the like of that Holy Personage, whose professed followers are responsible for this spiritual corruption and for spreading the filth of *Dajjāliyyat* [the deception of the Antichrist], and who had corrupted their original faith and had become the greater *Dajjāl* [Antichrist]. And the one who came down had no occasion to imbibe any light from the people of the earth or to profit by the tutorship of anyone, or to benefit by the pledge of *bai'at* [pledge of allegiance] to anyone; rather, all he gained was gained from the God of heaven. For this reason, the prophecy of the Immaculate Prophet about him contained words to the effect that he would descend from heaven; that is, he would receive from heaven, and would obtain no share from this world.

The secret of this humble one's coming in the name of Ḥaḍrat 'Īsā [Jesus] is that Almighty God caused him Ḥaḍrat Maṣīḥ [Jesus] to see this chaos created by the Christians. Jesus, having been informed in the heavens that this chaos had been created by his people and ummah, and then finding his followers at the lowest depth of corruption, became restless to descend to earth; his spirit experienced a severe restlessness, and it yearned for the appearance on this earth of a person who should manifest his will. It was then that Almighty God, in accordance with the promise already made, caused the spirituality and fervour of the Messiah to descend upon a suitable person.

This is the meaning of his having 'descended' from heaven; that is, in the same manner in which the Prophet Elijah 'descended' in the likeness of John [the Baptist]. If the Muslims do not accept the story of the Bible, which is authenticated by Ḥaḍrat Maṣīḥ himself, they should at least act on the hadith:<sup>1</sup> حَدِّثُوا عَنْ بَنِي إِسْرَائِيلَ [Pass on the reports heard from the Israelites]. In any case they must not reject it, for every Muslim has been dissuaded from that course. The Noble Quran, moreover, has many other arguments in support of it, which I have mentioned in other writings of mine, and some have been mentioned in this book as well. However, I do not wish to prolong this discussion. I conclude this discussion by saying only that I have been sent by Almighty God to dispel the misconceptions of this age and thus save the people from floundering, and I have been enabled by Him to satisfy you if you are truly a seeker of truth. Now, therefore, I assure you that I call Almighty God to witness that I invited you to get your mistakes resolved. If you still choose to keep silent, the argument of God, glorified be His eminence, will be complete against you and you will be responsible for the guilt of your followers. Sir, I ask you in the name of God, in Whose control are all living beings, not to turn down carelessly this epistle of mine, but to publish a carefully considered reply.

In concluding this footnote, I wish, merely in the name of God, to advise all those who are enamoured by the writings of Sayyed Ṣāḥib, to contemplate on the topic of whether salvation is the result of faith or philosophy. I say it repeatedly and emphatically, that if religious doctrines had been amenable generally to philosophical reasoning or to mathematical calculation, they would never have been a means of salvation.

Brethren! Rest assured that salvation is dependent upon faith and faith partakes of the unseen. If the true reality of things had not been

1. *Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī*, Kitāb Aḥādīthul-Anbiyā', Bāb Mā Dhukira 'an Banī Isrā'īl, Hadīth 3461 [Publisher]



hidden, there would have been no faith, and had there been no faith, there would have been no means to salvation. It is faith which is the means of winning the pleasure of God, which is a ladder with which to scale positions of nearness to Him, and which is the spring with which to wash away the rust of the spirit. That we need God is proven through faith; for, we are dependent on God for our salvation and for getting relief from all pain and distress. This salvation can only be attained through faith. The punishment of this world or the chastisement of the Hereafter are both remedied by faith. When we find that through the power of faith it is not impossible to solve a difficulty, such difficulty is in fact solved for us. We attain impossible and inconceivable feats through the power of faith. It is the power of faith which brings about miracles, and makes possible extraordinary and impossible events.

Therefore, it is faith which proves that there is a God. God remained hidden from the view of the philosophers and they could not discover Him. But faith takes a humble man in rags to the presence of God Almighty and enables him to hold converse with Him. The power of faith is the intermediation between a believer and the Truly Loved God. This conviction takes humble, degraded, downtrodden men to the Holy Palace which is the Seat of God, and removing one veil after another, discloses the Face of the Giver of Eternal Comfort. So arise, therefore, and search for the Faith, and burn the dry and useless tomes of philosophy, for, you will be blessed by faith. A particle of faith is better than a thousand volumes of philosophy.

And faith is not just the means of salvation in the Hereafter only, rather it rids one of the punishment and curses of this world also. It is the blessing of faith which rescues us from the grief which melts our very spirit. That very thing is faith which keeps a true believer contented and happy amidst a storm of distress and sorrow, when all around failure looks him in the face and when the doors of the usual means of successes are closed against him. Perfect faith does away with the impossible. Nothing harms faith so much as the feeling that this

or that thing is impossible. There are no riches like faith. Everyone in this world is grief-stricken except the man full of faith. Everyone is in the midst of a fire except a believer. O Faith! How sweet are your fruits! How fragrant are your flowers! Glory be to God, for what wondrous are your blessings! What a happy light is sparkling in thee! No one can scale the heights of the Pleiades but he who is equipped with your powers. God Almighty is pleased that you should come, and that philosophy should depart. **And no one can oppose His Will and His Grace. —Author**

## ANNOUNCEMENT FOR THE MUBĀHALAH

To all those *maulawīs* and *muftīs* who, because of minor differences or because of their lack of understanding, consider this humble one to be a *kāfir* [disbeliever], it is submitted that God Almighty has now enjoined me to invite you to a *mubāhalah*. The procedure for this is that I will recount the arguments in support of my beliefs from the Quran and the Ḥadith in the presence of those assembled for the *mubāhalah*. If, after this, you still do not desist from calling me a *kāfir*, I will hold the *mubāhalah* in that very assembly. Accordingly, my first addressee is Miyañ Nadhīr Ḥusain Dehlawī, but if he refuses, then Shaikh Muḥammad Ḥusain Baṭālawī, but if he, too, refuses, then, after him, I address all those *maulawīs* who consider me to be a *kāfir* and who are looked upon as leaders of the Muslims. I allow all these gentlemen four months, reckoned from today, 10 December 1892. If within four months, they do not hold a *mubāhalah* on the basis of the afore-said conditions, nor desist from calling me a *kāfir*, the argument would be complete against them in the eyes of Allah the Exalted.

It was my intention to first publish in this booklet as a response to all the unfounded allegations against me which they have made to constitute the basis of the charge of *kufṛ* [disbelief] against me, but due to the illness of the scribe and the consequent interruption, this part of the booklet could not be published till now. Nevertheless, I shall

read out such replies before the *mubāhalah* assembly, whether they are published by that time or not.

It should, however, be borne in mind that from our side, it is necessary that I should expose the error of those who have issued the edict of *kufri*. That is, I should, on my part, try to bring home to them my position with satisfying arguments, and then, if they do not desist, I should hold a *mubāhalah* in that same gathering. The word of Almighty Allah that has descended upon me, granting permission for a *mubāhalah*, is as follows:

نَظَرَ اللَّهُ إِلَيْكَ مُعْطَرًا. وَقَالُوا أَتَجْعَلُ فِيهَا  
مَنْ يُفْسِدُ فِيهَا. قَالَ إِنِّي أَعْلَمُ مَا لَا تَعْلَمُونَ.  
قَالُوا كِتَابٌ مُمْتَلِئٌ مِّنَ الْكُفْرِ وَالْكَذِبِ قُلْ  
تَعَالَوْا نَدْعُ أَبْنَاءَنَا وَأَبْنَاءَكُمْ وَنِسَاءَنَا وَنِسَاءَكُمْ  
وَأَنْفُسَنَا وَأَنْفُسَكُمْ ثُمَّ نَبْتَهِلْ فَنَجْعَلْ لَّغْنَةً  
اللَّهُ عَلَى الْكَاذِبِينَ.

Meaning that, God Almighty has looked at you with a fragrant look. Some of the people said in their hearts: 'O Allah, will You appoint in the world one who will cause disorder in it?' God Almighty answered to them: I know that which you do not know. And these people said: 'This person's book is full of *kufri* [disbelief] and falsehood.' Say to them: Come, let both of us call our women, sons, and dear ones, then let us do *mubāhalah* and invoke the curse of Allah on those who lie.

This is the permission to enter into *mubāhalah* which has been granted to this humble one, but along with this, I also mention some of the other revelations I received as glad tidings. And these are:

يَوْمَ يَجْنِي الْحَقُّ وَيُكْشَفُ الصِّدْقُ وَيَخْسَرُ الْخَاسِرُونَ. أَنْتَ مَعِيَ وَأَنَا مَعَكَ وَلَا يَغْلِبُهَا إِلَّا الْمُسْتَرْشِدُونَ. نَرُدُّ إِلَيْكَ الْكَرَّةَ الثَّانِيَةَ وَنُبَدِّلُ لَكَ مِنْ بَعْدِ خَوْفِكَ أَمْنًا. يَأْتِيَنَّ قَمَرُ الْأَنْبِيَاءِ وَأَمْرُكَ يَتَأْتِي. يَسْأَلُ اللَّهُ وَجْهَكَ وَيُخَيِّرُ بَيْنَهُمَا. سَيُؤَدِّ لَكَ الْوَلَدَ وَيُدْنِي مِنْكَ الْفَضْلَ إِنَّ نُورِي قَرِيبٌ. وَقَالُوا أَتَى لَكَ هَذَا قُلْ هُوَ اللَّهُ عَجِيبٌ. وَلَا تَيْئَسَنَّ مِنْ رَوْحِ اللَّهِ. أَنْظِرْ إِلَى يُوسُفَ وَأَقْبَالِهِ. قَدْ جَاءَ وَفَتْ الْفَتْحُ وَالْفَتْحُ أَقْرَبُ. يَخْرُجُونَ عَلَى الْمَسَاجِدِ. رَبَّنَا اغْفِرْ لَنَا إِنَّا كُنَّا خَاطِئِينَ. لَا تَتْرِبَ عَلَيْكُمُ الْيَوْمَ يَغْفِرُ اللَّهُ لَكُمْ وَهُوَ أَرْحَمُ الرَّاحِمِينَ. أَرَدْتُ أَنْ أَسْتَخْلِفَ فَخَلَقْتُ آدَمَ نَجَى الْأَسْرَارِ. إِنَّا خَلَقْنَا الْإِنْسَانَ فِي يَوْمٍ مُوَعَّدٍ.

Meaning that: On that day truth will come and truthfulness will be laid open and the losers will suffer loss. You are with Me and I am with you and this is known only to those who possess good sense. We shall grant you success a second time and shall convert your fear into security. The moon of the Prophets will come and your affair will become manifest. Allah will make your countenance cheerful and will illumine your reasoning. Soon will a son be born to you and grace will come close to you. My light is near. They ask you: 'Whence have you obtained this?' Say: Allah is Wonderful. Such are His acts: He honours whomsoever He wishes. Despair not of the mercy of Allah. Look at Yūsuf [Joseph] and his glory. The time of victory has arrived and victory is close. The opponents, that is, who are destined to be forgiven, will fall into prostration and will supplicate: Our Lord forgive us our sins; we were in error. No blame shall lie upon you this day; Allah will forgive your sins and He is the *Arḥamur-Rāḥimīn* [Most Merciful of those who show

mercy]. I was determined to appoint a vicegerent on earth and so I created Adam, who comprises mysteries. We created him on the day of promise.

This means that the Promised One has appeared at a time which had been indicated through the Holy Prophet<sup>sa</sup>s. It is indicated that at the time of his appearance, such and such people will be dominant in their empire and strength, and such and such type of worship of creatures will be prevalent. The Promised One has come in the same age, which is the time of the Cross and the worship of 'Īsā [Jesus].

He who can realize should fully understand these things before death overtakes him. He should think over the prophecies. **يَكْسِرُ الصَّلِيبَ** [He will break the cross], **يَقْتُلُ الْخِنْزِيرَ** 'will kill the swine', and ponder over **يَضَعُ الْجِزْيَةَ** 'he will abolish the *Jizyah*.'<sup>1</sup> All these matters apply to the People of the Book, and to no one else. Thus, when it is admitted that in that age the Christian religion and the Christian states would be very powerful—the same being indicated in the Noble Quran as well—is it still necessary to associate with them another hypothetical and whimsical *dajjāl* of one's own imagination? These are indeed the people who have overrun the entire earth. If any other *dajjāl* were to make his appearance while they were in existence, how would this *dajjāl* spread in the world? You cannot place two swords in one sheath. When the whole world would be under the kingdom of the *Dajjāl*, where would Britain, Russia, Germany, France, and the European states be, because the Promised Messiah must appear at the time when Christian states are in existence? Therefore, when it is essential that the Promised Messiah should appear at the time of the dominance of the Christian states, find them to be the authors of all strife and spiritual disturbance, break their crosses, kill their swine and abolish *Jizyah* by

1. *Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī, Kitābul-Maḏālim*, Bāb Kasruṣ-Ṣalīb wa Qatlul-Khinzīr, Hadith 2476 [Publisher]

causing them to join Islam, then how can the rule of the imaginary *dajjāl* be possible while there already prevails Christian rule?

Nevertheless, it is wrong to suppose that the Promised Messiah will come with a literal sword. I am surprised why these ulema do not consider the words **يَضَعُ الْحَرْبَ** [‘he will end war’] and why do they not read the hadith **الْأئِمَّةُ مِنْ قُرَيْشٍ** [‘the Imams will be from among the Quraish’].<sup>1</sup> When worldly rule and worldly *khilāfat* or *imāmat* is not lawful for anyone but the Quraish, how can the Promised Messiah, who is not from the Quraish, be a worldly *khalīfah*? It is strangely absurd to say that he will pledge allegiance to the Mahdi; that he will be subject to his command and will wield the sword at his bidding like a servant.

Not so, gentlemen. May God Almighty guide you aright! The Promised Messiah’s *Khilāfat* is spiritual. He has nothing to do with worldly kingdoms; he has been given the Kingdom of Heaven. Moreover, today, it is impossible to make anyone believe truly at the point of the sword. Ignorant people find fault even with the sword that was wielded in the past, let alone that it should be used anew to kill people. The spiritual sword, however, is sorely needed and it shall be wielded; no one can prevent it from being used. I now close this introduction, but I wield a spiritual sword against the opponents which is the following.

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1. *Musnad Ahmad ibn Hanbal*, Juzw 8, p. 239, Musnad Anas ibn Mālik, Hadith 12247, published by Dārul-Hadith, Cairo, 2012 [Publisher]





بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ<sup>1</sup>  
نَحْمَدُهُ وَنُصَلِّى عَلَى رَسُولِهِ الْكَرِيمِ<sup>2</sup>  
(اللَّهُ أَكْبَرُ ضَرَبَتْ الدَّلَّةُ عَلَى كُلِّ مُخَالِفٍ)<sup>3</sup>

## ANNOUNCEMENT

*Addressed to All Clergymen, Hindus, Āryas,  
Brahmūs, Sikhs, Atheists, Naturalists, &  
Other Gentlemen*

الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ الَّذِي أَرْسَلَ رَسُولَهُ بِالْهُدَى وَدِينِ الْحَقِّ لِيُظْهِرَهُ عَلَى الدِّينِ كُلِّهِ وَلَوْ كَرِهَ الْمُشْرِكُونَ وَالصَّلَاةُ وَالسَّلَامُ عَلَى خَيْرِ رُسُلِهِ وَأَفْضَلِ أَنْبِيَائِهِ وَسَلَالَةٍ أَصْفِيَاءَ مُحَمَّدٍ الْمُصْطَفَى الَّذِي يُصَلَّى عَلَيْهِ اللَّهُ وَمَلَائِكَتُهُ. [All praise is due to Allah Who sent His Messenger with the guidance and the Religion of Truth, that He may make it prevail over every *other* religion, even though the idolaters may dislike *it*. And may blessings and peace be upon the Best of His Apostles and the most exalted among His Prophets, the holiest of the holy, Muhammad, the Chosen One, on whom Allah and His angels and the eminent believers send their blessings.]

Now, whereas in this age, the religions named above are vehemently opposed to the teachings of the Quran, and most of their members do not believe in the truth of our Lord and Master Ḥaḍrat Muḥammad, the Chosen Prophet of God, the Seal of the Prophets, may peace and

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1. In the name of Allah, the Gracious, the Merciful. [Publisher]
  2. We praise Him and invoke His blessings upon His Noble Messenger. [Publisher]
  3. Allah is the Greatest; may all the opponents be smitten with disgrace. [Publisher]

blessings of Allah be upon him, and do not acknowledge that the Holy Quran is the Word of God and declare our Noble Messenger<sup>sas</sup> to be a fabricator and our Holy Book to be a collection of fabrications; and whereas there have been ongoing debates between them and us for a lengthy period of time, and all their criticisms have been completely answered; and the objections which can be raised against their own religions and books have been pointed out to them repeatedly with promises of rewards, and it has been manifestly stated that the beliefs and the principles of their religions, which are opposed to Islam, are remote from truth and something to be ashamed of—nevertheless, they have not accepted the Truth, nor have they given up their haughtiness and abuse;

Therefore, to present my argument to them in its entirety and conclusively, I have written this announcement today, which, in brief, is as follows:

Friends! People of all religions who believe in reward and punishment, in the continued existence of the soul, and in the Day of Judgment, may disagree on hundreds of things, yet they all agree on the basic tenet that **God exists**. They all claim that the religion that they follow and the guidance that they bear is from the same God. They say that only they are the people who walk in the way of His will and whom He loves, and all the rest are victims of His wrath, fallen into the pit of ignorance, and with whom God Almighty is very much displeased.

Since everyone claims to walk in the path of the will of God Almighty, and believes that their own way, and no other way, is the basis of salvation and Divine acceptance; and holds that only by walking on their path can God Almighty be pleased; that He only loves people like them, and, frequently and predominantly, pays heed to them and grants acceptance to their prayers; it is easy to arrive at a decision.

So far as the basic tenet mentioned above is concerned [that God exists], I agree with everyone. I also believe it to be true that there should be something established by God Almighty in this very world

that manifestly distinguishes a true person from one who is false. As things stand, no one will say that his people are in any way inferior to the people of other nations in possessing the fear of God and righteousness, in their attachment to *Tauḥīd* [the Oneness of God], justice, and equity, and in the doing of other good deeds. Therefore, it is impossible to arrive at any decision in this way.

I assert that Islam possesses those praiseworthy features that establish the distinction of the Muslim faith to an incomparably perfect degree. Take, for example, the *Tauḥīd* that Islam teaches, the righteousness it inculcates, and Islam's laws for the safeguarding of chastity and protection of other rights which influence the beliefs and actions of millions upon millions of people. In contrast to this, the doctrinal and practical circumstances of our opponents is not something unknown to impartial people, but when prejudice obstructs reason, who is going to vouch for the existence of these praiseworthy features of Islam, and who is going to pay attention to them? This is, therefore, merely an academic exercise.

The most obvious and evident method fathomable by even a peasant tilling the land or a nomad of the desert, is that during a time when all religions are locked in war and disputation with one another—which at present is at its fiercest—one should beseech help from that very One for whom this war and disputation is being waged. Since God Almighty does exist, and as all these battles are all concerning Him, it would, indeed, be better if we were to seek a verdict from Him.

Now, let it be known that by the grace of God Almighty, I understand Islam alone to be the true religion, and consider all others to be untrue and entirely the embodiments of falsehood. By following Islam, I observe springs of light flowing through me, and merely due to the love I have for the Messenger of Allah, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, I have attained that lofty station of Divine communion and acceptance of prayer, which none but a follower of the true Prophet<sup>sas</sup> can attain. The Hindus, the Christians, and others can never attain that station even if, in addressing their false gods, they were to

pray themselves to death. And I [actually] hear the word of God which others dismiss as a mere hypothetical possibility. I have been shown, told, and made to fully comprehend that Islam alone is the true faith in the world and it has been revealed to me that whatever has been bestowed upon me is by way of blessing on account of following the *Khātām-ul-Anbiyā'* [Seal of the Prophets], may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, and that there is nothing the like of what has been bestowed upon me in the other faiths, for they are false.

Now, therefore, if there is any seeker of truth—whether Hindu or Christian or Ārya or Jew or Brahmū or anyone else—it is an appropriate occasion for him to contest my assertion. If he is able to successfully compete with me in the matter, showing some Sign of the unseen and of the acceptance of prayer, I swear by Allah, glorified be His eminence, that I shall hand over to him all my immovable property, the value of which must be about 10,000 rupees. I shall also satisfy him by paying a penalty in any manner which he may approve. The Lord God, who is One, witnesses that I shall never be amiss in this; I shall heartily yield to the penalty even if it be the forfeiture of life. I am sincere in my declaration, and Allah the Exalted knows that I speak the truth. If anyone has a doubt or mistrusts my proposal, I invite him to suggest some other wholesome way in which the penalty might be imposed. I shall agree to that. I shall put forward no excuses. If I am a liar, it would be better that some severe punishment should destroy me, but if I am true in my claim, my only desire is that someone in spiritual desolation might find salvation at my hand.

O Christian clerics who hold an honourable and eminent status among your people! I call upon you in the name of Allah, His eminence be glorified, to pay attention to this matter. If, in your hearts, you have even a particle of love for the man whose name is Jesus, the Messiah, I hereby adjure you to take up this invitation. I adjure you to come and compete with me in the name of God who caused the Messiah to be born of Mary the Truthful; who revealed the Gospel; who, having caused the Messiah to die, did not take him to the company of the dead

but made him enter the company of His living people, the Prophets Abraham and Moses and John, and, after giving him life, called him to the heavens to join those who had been given such a life before him. If you indeed possess the truth and Jesus is, in fact, really and truly God, victory will be yours. And if he is not God, but is instead a frail and feeble mortal, and the truth is in Islam, God Almighty will hear me and will manifest such matters at my hand as you shall not have the power to do. If, however, you say that you will not compete with me and that you do not have the hallmarks of faith, I invite you to come and, on the condition that you will accept Islam, witness the works of God Almighty at my hand from this side. Let anyone of you regarded as honourable, or who is a leader of the community, or is a prominent individual among you—all of them or any of them—come and compete with me. But if he be unable to compete, he might seek a Sign from me making only the promise, on his own behalf, that he would accept Islam and believe in it if he witnessed any Sign whose manifestation was beyond the ability of man.

Twelve witnesses—four each from the Christian, Muslim, and Hindu communities—should testify to this promise on oath, to be published as a notice. Let one of such notices be sent to me as well. If God Almighty then reveals some extraordinary Sign, which is beyond the power of man to reveal, they should accept Islam without delay. But if they do not accept Islam, the other Sign should be that I would beseech God to send, within one year, some severe calamity over such a person—for example, leprosy, blindness, or death. And if this prayer is not accepted, I shall be ready to pay any penalty as proposed.

I offer the same terms to the Ārya gentlemen. If they believe their Vedas to be the Word of God Almighty, but consider our Holy Book, the Word of Allah, to be a human fabrication, they may come forward and compete with me. They should remember that, as a consequence of this encounter, they would come to great disgrace. They have the greatest share of atheistic ideas and unbridled audacity, but God Almighty will prove to them that He does exist. If, however, they do not compete

with me, they might seek a Sign from me unilaterally, without imposing any frivolous conditions. In order that it might be proved that my Sign is from Allah, it is enough that in case any Ārya who has seen a Sign and who does not become a Muslim without delay, I should pray against him, and if, within the space of one year, he is not visited with a calamity of the nature of leprosy, or blindness or death, I shall be ready to bear all kinds of punishment.

The exact same terms are offered to the others. And if they do not attend to me even now, the argument of God Almighty has been fully completed against them.

*Announced by*  
Humbly, **Ghulam Ahmad** of Qadian, District Gurdaspur

## BLESSED ARE THE TRUTHFUL, FOR THEY SHALL TRIUMPH IN THE END

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Those who have seen the paper *Nūr Afshān* dated 10 May 1888 must be aware of the degree to which the editor of this paper, after publishing a letter of mine that contains a prophecy, had made use of abusive language, and used improper, indecent, and filthy words against me. We should not, as a rule, feel sorry for such conduct of the Christian preachers, because opposition, denial, and contempt for the truth are their long-established habits. Nevertheless, I wish to now show what the ultimate outcome was of the Divine prophecy which they have characterized as a selfish plan and a human fabrication, and against which—consistent with their habit—they have levied undue criticism. Did the prophecy prove to be only a lie, or did God Almighty, who supports the truth, manifest its truthfulness?

Let it be noted that the words of the prophecy relating to Mirza **Aḥmad Baig** of Hoshiarpur contained in the letter of mine which is published in the *Nūr Afshān* of 10 May 1888 and printed on pages 2 and 3 of the said newspaper, are as follows: ‘It has been made clear to me by God Almighty through His holy revelation that if you consent to give me the hand of your elder daughter in marriage, God will remove all your adversities due to this marriage, and, safeguarding you from calamities, will bestow blessing upon blessing on you; but, if this marriage does not take place, arranging a match for her anywhere else would certainly not be auspicious for you. It will result in pain, suffering, and death. Blessings on one side and death on the other will point to my truth or falsehood after a test has been made. (It is for you now

to make a test as you please). Members of my clan have not recognized me, and God Almighty desires to acquaint them with my works.'

This is the letter that was published in the *Nūr Afshān* of 10 May 1888, the purport of which was indeed that if the girl was married to someone else, the result would be death for you; while, in the other case, instead of such death, there would be blessings. Now, I hereby disclose that the girl was married to someone else on 7 April 1892, and the prophecy was fulfilled on 30 September 1892, when God Almighty caused Mirza Ahmad Baig of Hoshiarpur to depart from this mortal world. Now, let the editor of the *Nūr Afshān* patiently ponder over whether, in accordance with the teaching of the Torah<sup>1</sup>, the fulfilment of a prophecy is the Sign of a true or a false claimant. For a seeker after truth, a Divine Sign like this alone suffices, but a man who is devoted to falsehood will not benefit from any Sign until there appears the final Sign which is called Hell. It is incumbent upon every seeker after truth to study the *Nūr Afshān* of 10 May 1888 and indict the Christian pastors with this prophecy. For this reason, the Announcement of 10 July 1888 is appended to this statement. It is hoped that our suspicious brethren will also attend to this matter to find out whether all this is has come from man or from the Lord of Heaven. There is yet time to give up their obstinacy. The man who opposes a true claimant does not, in fact, oppose him but opposes God Almighty.

وَالسَّلَامُ عَلَى مَنِ اتَّبَعَ الْهُدَى. [And peace be upon those who follow the guidance].

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1. Deuteronomy 18:18—Author



بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ<sup>1</sup>  
نَحْمَدُهُ وَنُصَلِّي<sup>2</sup>  
يَا مُعِينُ بِرَحْمَتِكَ نَسْتَعِينُ<sup>3</sup>

## ANNOUNCEMENT OF A PROPHECY PRIOR TO ITS FULFILMENT

پیشگوئی کا جب انجام ہویدا ہوگا      قدرتِ حق کا عجب ایک تماشا ہوگا  
*When the outcome of the prophecy shall become manifest,  
It would be a wonderful spectacle of the power of Allah, the True.*

جھوٹ اور سچ میں جو ہے فرق وہ پیدا ہوگا      کوئی پا جائے گا عزت کوئی رسوا ہوگا  
*The distinction that exists between truth and falsehood shall come into  
being;  
Someone shall attain dignity and someone shall be disgraced.*

The newspaper *Nūr Afshān* of 10 May 1888, after publishing one of my letters containing a proposal for a *nikāḥ*, [marriage in Islam] has indulged its loose tongue in an extraordinary manner. An entire page of the paper has been completely wasted in harsh words and abuse. How unjust it is for a people whose pure and holy Prophets had hundreds

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1. In the name of Allah, the Gracious, the Merciful. [Publisher]
  2. We praise Him and invoke His blessings [upon His Noble Messenger].
  3. O Helper! We seek Your help with Your mercy.

of wives at the same time, to consider it a great sin to have 2 or 3 wives together! Indeed, they consider it adultery and fornication.

No family line can endure forever by confining itself to the principle of one wife for everyone. In fact, there is always someone in the family who encounters the difficulty that his wife turns out to be barren and unable to have children. This shows that humanity has attained sustenance and endurance with the principle of polygamy. Had it been forbidden to have more wives than one, humanity would have come close to extinction by now. Research would demonstrate the degree to which this useful and blessed principle has protected humanity and how it has restored fertility to dwindling families, and how strongly this principle supports and helps righteousness.

This blessed practice fully makes up for the deprivation of physical needs which man incurs as a result of the physiological limitations of women, like the periods of pregnancy, menstruation, and childbirth. It gives to the man his due right by reason of his nature. There are many other reasons which oblige a man to have more than one wife. For example, if the wife of a man becomes unpleasant to look at as the result of age or disease, the motivating power of the man, on which depends the activation of the woman's function, becomes inactive and suspended. But if the man is unattractive, the woman does not suffer, for the active power has been given to man and gratification of the woman rests in his hands.

If a man's potency is weak or at fault, the woman, according to the Quranic teaching, can get a divorce. But if the husband is able to provide full satisfaction, the woman cannot complain against his taking a second wife, for she is unable to meet the frequent needs of man, which establishes man's right to have a second wife. For those who are exceptionally potent and of a righteous and pure temperament, this practice is not only lawful but necessary. Some of the opponents of Islam, following their lustful inclinations, do all kinds of things, but they hate

this pure method, because the lack of self-restraint that is increasing among them, encourages them to have no regard or need for it.

The attitude of Christians towards this question is utterly regrettable, for they close their eyes to the examples of their Prophets, whose Prophethood is beyond question, and grind their teeth without justification against the Muslims. Christian people admit that the physical body of the **Messiah**, through his mother's side, was a product of the self-same principle of polygamy which in the case of **David** (forbear of the Messiah) was extended not merely to having two or three but over a hundred wives. But it is a shame that they consider polygamy no different than adultery, and care not in the least what this dirty principle of theirs would mean in relation to Ḥaḍrat **Maryam**, the Truthful. In spite of all this impertinence, they profess to be lovers of the Messiah. Let it be realized that, according to the **Bible**, polygamy is not merely proved by the text but is also vouched for as a lawful and a praiseworthy principle by the practice of most of the Israelite Prophets, among whom may be named the grandfather of the Messiah.

O you Christians who have no fear of God! If it is obligatory for a man gifted with revelation to have only one wife, will you reject a true Prophet like David? Or, will you exclude a person like **Solomon**, the Elect of God, from being a recipient of Divine revelation? Is not this, according to you, a constant sin for these Prophets, whose hearts were, as it were, in a constant telegraphic connection with the revelation from Allah, and who were recipients of the details of what constitutes Allah's pleasure or displeasure. Despite that, they were constantly indulging in this practice. Was it not a sin from which they did not desist till their end? Did they care in the least for God and His commandments?

The Jealous God who is Ever-Vigilant for protecting His honour destroyed Thamūd and 'Ād on account of their rebellious behaviour, rained stones on **Lot's** people, and drowned the **Pharaoh** along with all his mischievous people in a terrible deluge. Is it becoming of His

sense of honour and dignity not to have chastised **Abraham and Jacob and Moses and David and Solomon** and many other Prophets knowing them to be disobedient arch-rebels, for they had married many wives? Rather, He loved them more than the other people. Did your God not find anyone else on whom to bestow the gift of revelation? Did only those who had many wives catch His fancy?<sup>1</sup>

It may also be borne in mind that the Prophets and all eminent righteous persons, by contracting polygamous marriages, and yet surpassing all in spiritual powers and advancing in Divine favours, have proven to the world that the way to befriend God does not lie in living in this world like eunuchs and impotent persons. Rather, strong in faith is he who carries the largest burden of wives and children and, notwithstanding so many responsibilities, leads a life detached from this world.

Developing the bond of being the Beloved and the lover between God Almighty and His servant demands the existence a third element. What is it? The faithful spirit arising within the believer, which grants him new sensory perceptions. It is through this very spirit that the believer hears the word of God Almighty, and it is through this very means that he attains genuine and everlasting purity, and it is through this very means that the extraordinary capabilities of a new life are produced within him. I now ask, who from among the yogis or monks or *sannyasis* [Hindu ascetics] is gifted with this holy spirit? Does any Christian pastor possess this pure spirit or, as you may call it, this Holy Ghost?

I have exhausted myself in addressing challenges to clergymen all over the world; no one has responded to them, but some pastors published in the *Nūr Afshān* that they would present a sealed envelope in the presence of a gathering for me to reveal its contents through my

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1. There are indications in the Gospels which show that Jesus, too, was thinking of marrying; but he was taken away while he was still young, or else, he would have walked in the footsteps of his forbearer, David.—Author

inspirational powers, but when I accepted their offer on the condition that they would have to accept Islam, the pastors did not pursue the matter further. The Christian priests had long since put a seal on revelation. Now that the seal has been broken and the bounty of the Holy Spirit has been proven to be on the side of the Muslims, the fault of Christian preachers' belief has come to light. It was inevitable that the clergymen should have felt doubly pained due to my revelations—one being the pain due to the breaking of the seal, and the second being due to the shifting of revelation from one people to another. The harsh language of *Nūr Afshān* is really due to its chagrin at this affair, which, like a consuming atrophy, is incurable.

Now, let it be realized that the letter which the opposing party had published in the *Nūr Afshān* of 10 May 1888, was written [by me] solely upon Divine direction. For a long time, some of the more important and near relatives of the addressee, about whose real niece's hand this proposal had been made, had been seeking a Sign from me. They were violators of Islamic practices and were—and remain even now—enemies of the Islamic Sunnah. Their request for a Sign is contained even in the notice they published in the *Chashma-e-Nūr* of August 1885 printed in Amritsar. They are not only my enemies but also the enemies of God and His Messenger. The father of the girl, on account of the existence of a close relationship with them, is solicitous of their approval. He is devoted to them with all his heart and soul, and is unable to assert his powers; nay, he is totally subservient to them. He regards his own daughters as theirs, and they, too, look upon his daughters as theirs; they are his chief advisers in everything and act as his mouthpiece. That is why they themselves drummed and proclaimed the affair about his daughter, so much so that they filled even the Christian papers with this story. Bravo for such a piece of wisdom; you have acted as maternal uncles indeed with a vengeance! Ideal maternal uncles!

In short, as these people took me for an impostor and a liar, and as they found various faults with Islam and the Holy Quran, and asked

for a heavenly Sign, I prayed, and the prayer having been accepted, God Almighty brought about circumstances under which the father of the girl had to make a request to me regarding an important affair of his. The details of this affair are that a sister of the said father had been married to one Ghulām Ḥusain, a cousin of mine. This Ghulām Ḥusain has been an absentee for 25 years, and nothing is known of his whereabouts. His land, to which I am an heir, had been mutated in the Government revenue papers in the name of the said father's sister. In the course of the present settlement operations in the District of Gurdaspur, the said father, the addressee of my letter, expressed the desire with the concurrence of his sister, that the land which is valued at four or five thousand rupees be transferred by way of gift to his son Muḥammad Baig. The deed of gift, accordingly, was drawn up with his sister as the donor. However, as the gift was inoperative without my consent, the addressee approached me with all humility to request me to give my consent to the gift and sign the deed. I was about to sign it, but it occurred to me, as is my habit in all important affairs, to beg Allah for guidance by doing *Istikhārah*.<sup>1</sup> Accordingly, a reply in these terms was sent to the addressee. Then, after having been repeatedly importuned by him, the *Istikhārah* was undertaken, which turned out to be nothing but an indication that the time for the manifestation of a heavenly Sign in response to these people's request had drawn near. The result of the *Istikhārah* disclosed itself in this wise:

The Powerful and Wise God informed me that I should propose for the hand of the elder daughter of this man, and should tell them that all the kindness that may be done to them would depend on this condition; that the *nikāḥ* would be a source of blessing for them, and that they would share all the blessings enumerated in the notice published on 20 February 1888,<sup>2</sup> but if they rejected the proposal of *nikāḥ*,

1. A special prayer to seek Divine guidance in important affairs. [Publisher]

2. The year 1888 appears to be a scribal error. As referenced in *Tablīgh-e-Risālat*, vol. 1, p. 116, footnote, the correct year is 1886. [Publisher]

the girl would meet with an extremely bad end, that any other man whom she might marry shall die within two and a half years of *nikāḥ*. Similarly, her father shall die within three years,<sup>1,2</sup> that there would be discord, deprivation, and trouble in that family, and, in the intervening period, there would also be unpleasant incidents and sorrowful happenings for the girl.

Again, on repeatedly concentrating my attention for detailed knowledge, I came to know that God Almighty had ordained that eventually, after removing all obstacles, He would cause the elder daughter of the man addressed—for whose hand the proposal had been made—to marry this humble self; that He would cause the irreligious to become Muslims and would spread guidance among the misguided. Here is the Arabic revelation relating to this:

كَذَّبُوا بِآيَاتِنَا وَكَانُوا بِهَا يَسْتَهْزِءُونَ فَسَيَكْفِيكَهُمْ اللَّهُ وَيُرَدُّ. هَا إِلَيْكَ لَا تَبْدِيلَ لِكَلِمَاتِ اللَّهِ  
إِنَّ رَبَّكَ فَعَالٌ لِّمَا يُرِيدُ. أَنْتَ مَعِيَ وَأَنَا مَعَكَ. عَسَى أَنْ يَبْعَثَكَ رَبُّكَ مَقَامًا مَّحْمُودًا.

Meaning that: They have rejected Our Signs and they had already been mocking. To frustrate the activities of all those who are interfering in this matter, Allah will be your Helper. God will ultimately bring her back to you. No one can change the words of God. Your Lord is All-Powerful and does whatever He determines. You are with Me and I am with you. Soon you will be granted a praiseworthy station.

Meaning that though at first, the foolish and ignorant ones will say all sorts of disagreeable things out of their evil and suspicious minds, and

1. Three years are to be reckoned from the date of *nikāḥ*; but, it is never meant that there would be no incidents before this; some of the visions show that the time of the addressee's misfortune, the result of which is unknown, appears to be near at hand. وَاللَّهُ أَعْلَمُ [And Allah knows best].—Author
2. The father of the girl died in the fourth month after marriage in accordance with the prophecy; that is, the *nikāḥ* was performed on 7 April 1892, and he passed away on 30 September 1892 at Hoshiarpur.—Author

will utter worthless words, but in the end, observing the support of God, they will feel ashamed. And when the truth is established everyone will give expression to praise.

There is another objection of the *Nūr Afshān* which may be refuted, and that is that if this revelation was from Almighty God and if it was absolutely trustworthy, why was it kept secret and why was I particular in asking it to be kept secret<sup>1</sup>?

The response is that this was a private affair and it had been communicated to those for whom it was meant to be a Sign. It was also certain that the publication would offend the father of that girl. Therefore, I desisted because of the possibility of such heartache and pain; indeed, I did not like that even they—in case they refused to entertain the proposal—should publish it. And, though I would have been within my rights if I had published it, I thought it advisable to wait for another occasion, when Mirzā Nizām-ud-Dīn, the maternal uncle of the girl and a real brother of Mirzā Imām-ud Dīn, in a fit of rage and fury, himself published it and published it so widely that perhaps within one or two weeks, ten thousand men and women were informed of my proposal for marriage and of the revelation relating to it.

And then, not being content with just broadcasting it verbally, he had my letter published in the newspapers and with his parading it throughout the bazaars, that letter was read everywhere and the contents of the letter were trumpeted [before all,] even to women and children. Now that this letter of mine, as a result of Mirzā Nizām-ud-Dīn's efforts, has been published even in *Nūr Afshān*, and the Christians, as is their wont, have begun to utter falsehoods regarding it, it is my duty to reveal the facts with my own pen. People inclined to evil thinking

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1. I was disinclined to publishing this revelation which, subject to a condition related to the death of the addressee; indeed, I did not wish even to let the addressee know about it. As the result, however, of his persistently asking about it verbally and through several imploring letters, I—out of sheer kindness and honesty—disclosed this secret to him. He and his relation, Mirzā Nizām-ud-Dīn, then publicized the contents of this revelation.—Author



should know that, for the purpose of testing my truth or falsehood, there can be no better test than my prophecy. And this prophecy of mine is also not such as has only been made public by me just at this time. Rather, the fact is that Mirzā Imām-ud-Dīn and Nizām-ud-Dīn, all the local Āryas, as well as Lekh Rām of Peshawar and hundreds of other people, know well that many years ago I had made a prophecy in general terms about this matter, namely that a man from our clan named Ahmad Baig was about to die.

Now, an unprejudiced critic must realize that this was a part of the present prophecy or—as one might say—the latter constitutes the detail and the former the outline; the latter reveals the date and period of time, while the former contains no such mention; the latter contains conditions but the former was of a general character. The fact that the first prophecy was made at a time when the girl was a minor would suffice for an intelligent person. And when the present prophecy is about the same person about whom a prophecy was made five years ago—that is, at a time when his daughter was 8 or 9 years of age—to suppose it to be a fabrication emanating from one's lustful inclinations is nothing but foolish.

وَالسَّلَامُ عَلَى مَنِ اتَّبَعَ الْهُدَى. [And peace be upon those who follow the guidance].

(Humbly, **Ghulam Ahmad** of Qadian,  
District Gurdaspur, Punjab)  
10 July 1888



## A LETTER TO SHAIKH MUḤAMMAD ḤUSAIN BATĀLAWĪ

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ<sup>1</sup>  
نَحْمَدُهُ وَنُصَلِّي<sup>2</sup>

To Shaikh Muḥammad Ḥusain Abū Saʿīd Batālawī,

اَلْحَمْدُ لِلّٰهِ وَالسَّلَامُ عَلٰى عِبَادِهِ الَّذِيْنَ اصْطَفٰى —[All praise is due to Allah; and peace be on his chosen servants]. After this, I regret to write that on account of your edict alleging *kufṛ* [disbelief]—the inevitable consequence of which being that one of the two parties must be a *kāfir* [disbeliever]—I was unable to begin this letter with the customary salutation of peace; that is, *As-salamu ʿalaikum* [Peace be upon you]. However, upon receiving an admonitory revelation about you, and hearing similar dreams from fellow Muslims, I was overcome with fear for your terrifying fate. As a result, out of respect for the inherent rights of human beings bestowed upon them by virtue of their humanity and also due to our shared nationality and proximity as neighbours, my sympathy was deeply stirred by the condition I observed in you. And I declare in the name of Allah, glorified be His eminence, that I have been moved to sympathize with you on account of your condition greatly, and I

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1. In the name of Allah, the Gracious, the Merciful. [Publisher]

2. We praise Him and invoke His blessings [upon His Noble Messenger].  
[Publisher]

fear lest you face the consequences which have always been the lot of those who attribute lies to the truthful. It was precisely for this reason that last night while pondering deeply I was overwhelmed with anxiety regarding what to do by way of sympathy for you. Ultimately, the edict of my heart counselled me to write you again, inviting you to the truth. It may be that Almighty God may thereby admit you to His grace and deliver you from this perilous situation. So, my dear friend, do not despair of the mercy of Almighty God. He is the Great Lord of Power who does what He wills.

If you cast a glance upon my life with the mindset of a seeker after truth, you will find conclusive evidence that Almighty God has always safeguarded me from the filth of falsehood to the point that sometimes in the British courts my life and honour were subjected to such perilous risk, no lawyer gave me any advice except lying. But Allah, glorified be His eminence, granted me the ability to disregard my life and honour for the sake of truth. I often suffered hefty losses in pecuniary suits merely for the sake of truth. And many a time, I deposed against the interests of my father and brother, simply out of the fear of Almighty God, but I did not abandon the truth. I have lived a lifetime in this village and also in Batala, but who can prove that a lie was ever spoken out of my mouth? So, when I have refrained from lying about people since the very beginning merely for the sake of Allah, and I have repeatedly sacrificed my life and property for the sake of truth, then why would I lie about God Almighty?

If the thought occurs to you that my claim is against the Book of Allah and the Sunnah, I wish to very respectfully reply that this idea has arisen in your mind due to a lack of understanding. If you give up your priestly pretentious warring and disputing spirit and come to stay with me for a few days like a seeker after truth, I do hope that Almighty God will remove all your misconceptions and grant you satisfaction. But if you cannot bear [to do] even this, then you know that the last remedy is the heavenly verdict. Some knowledge about you has been

vouchsafed to me in general terms. If you so desire, upon focusing on the matter for a few days, I would seek further knowledge, and upon being apprized with details by the grace of God Almighty, I would publish them in some newspapers.

I would like to have your special written permission for such publication. I am writing this letter merely out of a feeling of sympathy for you and I am sending it to you after adding the signatures of a few witnesses. I close with the prayer: رَبَّنَا افْتَحْ بَيْنَنَا وَبَيْنَ قَوْمِنَا بِالْحَقِّ وَأَنْتَ خَيْرُ الْفَاتِحِينَ [O our Lord, decide Thou between us and between our people with truth, and Thou art the Best of those who decide.]

*Āmīn.*

The Humble Writer,  
**Ghulam Ahmad**

From Qadian, District Gurdaspur  
31 December 1892

### **Witnesses of this Note:**

(1) Khudā Bakhsh, Tutor with Nawwāb Ṣāhib, (2) ‘Abdul-Karīm of Sialkot, (3) Qāḍī Ḍiyā’-ud-Dīn, resident of Kot Qāḍī, Gujranwala District, (4) Maulawī Nūr-ud-Dīn, (5) Muḥammad Aḥsan of Amroha, (6) Shādī Khān, in the service of Sir Rājā Amar Singh Bahādur, (7) Zafar Aḥmad of Kapurthala, (8) ‘Abdullāh of Sanaur, (9) ‘Abdul-‘Azīz of Delhi, (10) ‘Alī Gauhar Khān of Jalandhar, (11) Faḍl-ud-Dīn Ḥakīm of Bhera, (12) Ḥafīz Muḥammad of Peshawar, (13) Ḥafīz Muḥammad Ashraf ‘Alī Hāshimī, preacher of Batala, (14) Abdur-Raḥmān, nephew of Maulawī Noor-ud-Deen (15) Muḥammad Akbar, resident of Batala, (16) Quṭb-ud-Dīn, resident of Baddomalhi.

The reply received from the Shaikh of Batala in answer to the letter of this humble one given above is set out below along with its rebuttal. However, as the rebuttal which has been sent from me to the gentleman from Batala does not contain a reply to all the absurdities and slanders that his letter contains, and as it is possible that the readers of his letter may not be aware of the fabrications that have been placed in his letter for the purposes of deception, I have deemed it appropriate to refute some of Shaikh Ṣāhib's fabrications, braggings, and slanders before I proceed to transcribe his letter. Therefore, I set out the response below in the form of 'His Statement' and 'My Statement':<sup>1</sup>

**His Statement:** I consider to be true and I believe in the truthfulness of the Quran and the former Scriptures, and the religion of Islam and former faiths, and the Prophet of the Last Age and the former Prophets; and it is the essential consequence and requirement of all this that I should regard you as a liar.

**My Statement:** Shaikh Ṣāhib! If you considered the Quran to be true and believed the Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, to be a true Prophet you would not have declared me a *kāfir* [disbeliever]. Does your belief in the truth of the Noble Quran and of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, mean that a man who believes in Allah and the Messenger—who faces towards the Qiblah in Prayer, who professes the Holy *Kalimah* [the declaration of faith in Islam], who considers salvation to be limited to Islam, and who is devoted with all his life and soul to the way of Allah and His Messenger—is to be declared by you not only a *kāfir* but the greatest *kāfir* and that you deem him to deserve everlasting Hell, you

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1. In the letter that was sent to the gentleman from Batala, no mention was made of his absurd statements in order not to prolong it. Now that he has ventured to publish that letter himself, the response has to be published perforce—**Author**

curse him, call him *dajjāl*, and hold it lawful to kill him and to rob him of his property? As for my statements which you characterize as being heretical, their reply is set out in this book for every impartial reader to read himself. Your scholarship, honesty, and understanding of the Quran and Hadith has been amply exposed thereby, so there is no need to separately write anything further.

**His Statement:** Apart from your false beliefs that are opposed to the religion of Islam and the former faiths, telling lies and deception has become such an integral part of your character as if it was ingrained in your very nature.

**My Statement:** Shaikh Ṣaḥīb! Anyone who is God-fearing and of pure birth would not, in the first place, dare accuse his brother of any transgression and disbelief without full investigation. But if he would make any such accusation, he would furnish such perfect proofs about it that would make the day dawn upon those looking on. So, if you possess both of these above-mentioned qualities, I adjure you in the name of the Powerful God who is the Lord of Glory—the invocation of whose oath elicited a considered reply even from the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him—to prove that I have these two types of evils in me that you think I possess; that firstly, I am hostile to the religion of Islam and am a *kāfir*, and secondly that I am given to lying.

The Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, has said that: Most truthful indeed are the dreams of the one who is most truthful in all that he says. In this hadith the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, has appointed this as a sign of the truthful; that truth should be dominant in their dreams.<sup>1</sup> You have just made the claim that you believe in the Holy Prophet,

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1. *Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim, Kitābur-Ru'yā*, Bāb fī Kaunur-Ru'yā minallāh wa'annahā Juzw minun-Nubuwwah, Hadith 5905 [Publisher]

may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him. Thus, if you have not said this by way of hypocrisy, and you really truly believe in the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, knowing that the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him is true in his sayings, then come, let us examine each other on the basis of this standard, and see who is proven to be truthful and who is innately given to lying. Similarly, Allah, glorified be His eminence, says in the Holy Quran:

لَهُمُ الْبُشْرَىٰ فِي الْحَيَاةِ الدُّنْيَا<sup>1</sup>

Meaning that, it is a special quality of the believers that, as compared with others, their dreams turn out to be true. You have also just claimed that you, too, believe in the Holy Quran. Very well! Let us also test from the perspective of the Noble Quran who possesses the sign of a believer.

Both these examinations can be conducted as follows: A gathering can be held at Batala, Lahore, or Amritsar, to be attended by witnesses of the dreams of both parties, and then whoever between the two of us is proven to be أَصْدَقُ [most true] in his dreams on the basis of conclusive and convincing evidence, his opponent shall right there and then be given to wear the 'medal' of the epithets كَذَّاب [kadh-dhāb—arch-liar], دَجَّال [dajjāl—deceiver], كَافِر [kāfir—disbeliever], أَكْفَر [akfar—the greatest of disbelievers], and مَلْعُون [mal'un—the accursed], or whatever names are deemed appropriate. And if you are unable to prove the truthfulness of your past [dreams], I agree and allow you up to six months to publish in a few papers such dreams of yours which may embody news of the unseen. As for myself, I shall not only furnish proof [from my dreams] of the past but shall also, God willing, publish present dreams of mine against yours.

And just as you profess to have faith in the Quran and the Prophet,

1. For them are glad tidings in the present life (Sūrah Yūnus, 10:65). [Publisher]



may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, so do I believe with all my heart and soul in that beloved Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, and in that beloved Book, the Noble Quran. Now these tests, therefore, would determine who is true and who is false in his claim.

In case I lose according to the test appointed by the Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him and the Noble Quran, you would be the truthful one; and I, according to you, would be considered to be a *kāfir* [disbeliever], a *dajjāl* [deceiver], infidel, satan, *kadh-dhāb* [the greatest liar], and a fabricator. Moreover, in that case all your mischievous doubts would become true and justified; namely, that I defrauded the people through *Barāhīn-e-Aḥmadiyya*, cheated them of their money by holding out promises of acceptance of prayers, and lived on ill-gotten wealth. However, if the munificence of God Almighty which accompanies the believers and the truly righteous, establishes my truthfulness, then tell me yourself whether all these epithets would apply to your claimed priestly pretentious stature, or whether there would still be a way of escape left for you?

You have caused me great pain and distress; I continued to exercise patience, but you did not show an iota of fear of that All-Powerful Being who is aware of your very essence. He has informed me by way of a prophecy regarding you and those of your bent of mind, that:

إِنِّي مُهَيِّنٌ مِّنْ أَرَادَ إِهَانَتَكَ.

Meaning: 'I shall humiliate him who designs to humiliate you.'

So rest fully assured that the time is now close at hand when Almighty God will prove that you have lied in making all these accusations. He will send down upon you all those humiliating punishments that slanderers and liars face by way of disgrace and shame. You claim to profess belief in the Quran and the Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him. Thus, if you are true in this claim of yours, come into the **battlefield** for a test, so that Almighty God may Himself judge

between you and me, and so that he who is a liar and a *dajjāl* may be disgraced.

At this moment, something in support of the **truth** arises from my heart. I cannot suppress it, for it does not proceed from myself. It is an overwhelming inspiration from my Lord. It is that as you consider me to be a *kāfir* and declare lying to be a special trait of my character, I adjure **you** in the name of Allah, glorified be His eminence, to immediately come and **compete** with me in the above-mentioned manner so that it be seen who is proven to be the liar, *dajjāl*, and *kāfir* according to the Noble Quran and the sayings of the Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him.

Following this elucidation, should either one of us hesitate—notwithstanding such intense passion, accusations of disbelief, and denunciations of lying and sinning—and refrain from entering the battlefield, skulking away like a **jackal** with its tail between its legs, then he merits the following prize:

1. **Curse**<sup>1</sup>.....
2. **Curse** .....
3. **Curse** .....
4. **Curse** .....
5. **Curse** .....
6. **Curse** .....
7. **Curse** .....
8. **Curse** .....
9. **Curse** .....
10. **Curse** .....

AND, THIS COMPLETES THE NUMBER UP TO TEN.

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1. The word *la'nāt* (curse) is short for the prayer, 'May the curse of Allah be on the liars.' [Publisher]

This is that verdict which God Almighty will deliver Himself; for, it is His promise that a believer will prevail in any case. As, He Himself says:

كُنْ يَجْعَلَ اللَّهُ لِلْكَافِرِينَ عَلَى الْمُؤْمِنِينَ سَبِيلًا ١

Meaning: It can never be that the *kāfir* should find a way to overpower the believer. He also says:

يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا إِن تَتَّقُوا اللَّهَ يَجْعَلْ لَكُمْ فُرْقَانًا ٢ وَيَجْعَلْ لَكُمْ نُورًا تَمْشُونَ بِهِ ٣

Meaning that: O believers! If you become righteous, God Almighty will place a distinction between you and the others. What is that distinction? It is that you will be granted a light which will not at all be found in the others—namely, the light of [Divine] revelation, the light of acceptance of prayer, and the light of miracles of the Chosen Ones.

Now, obviously, how can he who has not even abandoned falsehood, be considered a righteous person in the eyes of God Almighty, and how can he perform any marvels? In short, this method will expose the hidden reality of us both and people will see who enters the battlefield and who is proven to be true according to the verse لَهُمُ الْبُشْرَى [for them is good news] and the hadith أَصْدَقُكُمْ حَدِيثًا [Truest of you in his statements].<sup>4</sup>

There is another thing also with this by means of which the truthful ones can be tested, and which God Almighty Himself brings into existence. Namely, that sometimes a man is involved in such a calamity from which no way of escape or success can be seen by him except that he should tell a lie. It is at such a time that he is tested as to whether there is truth or falsehood in his nature, and whether at such a delicate time his tongue utters the word of truth or whether, fearing for his life, honour, and wealth, he starts uttering falsehood.

1. *Sūrah an-Nisā*, 4:142 [Publisher]

2. *Sūrah al-Anfāl*, 8:30 [Publisher]

3. *Sūrah al-Ḥadīd*, 57:29 [Publisher]

4. *Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim, Kitābur-Ru'yā*, Hadith 2263 [Publisher]

My humble self has had to face many such experiences, the details of which will only lengthen this account. However, I proceed to relate three such examples, and I do so with this objective: If you have ever had similar occasions to test your love of truth, I hereby adjure you in the name of Allah, His eminence be glorified, to publish them along with their proof, so that it might be known that you are not making an empty claim, and that even in the grip of trials and tribulations you have not violated the truth.

One of these is that after the death of my father my brother the late Mirza Ghulam Qādir and I were sued in the District Court by the joint proprietors of the Qadian estate at the instance of Mirza 'Āzam Baig of Lahore, for proprietary possession of the estate.

I knew that these co-proprietors had apparently nothing to do with the ownership of the estate, for it had been lost to the family and had ceased to exist in the time of the Sikhs. In an effort to retrieve it along with other estates, my father had alone borne an expense and loss of approximately 8,000 rupees in which these people had not shared so much as a single penny. In the course of this litigation, on praying for the success of the suit, I had the revelation:

أَجِيبُ كُلَّ دُعَائِكَ إِلَّا فِي شُرَكَائِكَ.

Meaning that: I shall accept all your prayers but not in the matter of your collaterals.

After this revelation I invited my brother along with all the men and women of the family, some of whom are still alive, to gather at a place, and I clearly explained to them not to defend the joint proprietors' suit as it was against God's will to do so, but they did not accept my suggestion and were ultimately unsuccessful. As for myself, I bore the loss of thousands of rupees with courage. All those who are now my enemies are witnesses to this. As all affairs of the estate were in the hands of my brother, I counselled him again and again, but he refused and ultimately bore the loss.

Another one of these incidents occurred as follows: Approximately fifteen or sixteen years ago, or perhaps a little more, my humble self dispatched an article for printing in a press owned by a Christian by the name of Rallia Rām, who was also a lawyer and lived in Amritsar. He was also the owner and editor of a newspaper. This article was in support of Islam and was a response to the Āryas. The article was sent in a postal packet open on both sides and I also placed a letter in the packet along with the article. Because this letter contained statements in support of Islam and in refutation of other faiths and insisted that the article might be printed, the Christian [editor] became upset on account of religious differences. And quite by chance he got this opportunity to make a hostile attack because the placing of such a separate letter in a postal packet was an offence under the law which my humble self was not aware of at all. And such a crime was punishable under the postal laws with a fine of up to 500 rupees or imprisonment up to six months. Accordingly, he became an informant and got the postal authorities to file a case against me.

Even before I received intimation of this case, Allah the Exalted showed me in a vision that Rallia Rām, the lawyer, had sent a serpent to me so that I might be bitten by it, but I fried the serpent as one fries a fish and sent it back to him. I know that this was an indication that the decision in that case by virtue of the way it came about, might set a precedent that would prove helpful to lawyers [in such cases].

In short, I was summoned to the headquarters of the District of Gurdaspur for this crime and all the lawyers with whom I consulted regarding the case, advised that there was no other way than to employ falsehood and counselled that I should make a statement to the effect that I had not put the letter in the packet and that Rallia Rām himself might have put the letter in the packet. Moreover, the lawyers said to me by way of assurance that by giving such a statement the case would be decided upon by witnesses and that I would be acquitted by producing two false witnesses. Other than this the case was very difficult and there was no hope of my deliverance, but I told all of them that I did

not want to abandon truth under any circumstances, so let whatever happens, happen.

Thus, that very day, or the next, I was made to appear in the court of an English magistrate, and the Superintendent of Post Offices appeared as the complainant on behalf of the Government against me. The magistrate of the court proceeded to record my statement with his own hand and, before anything else, asked me this very question: 'Did you put this letter in the packet and is this letter and this packet yours?'

I answered without any hesitation: 'This is indeed my letter, and this is indeed my packet and I had dispatched this letter by placing it in the packet, but I did not put the letter in the packet with any ill-intent to cause loss of revenue to the Government. I did not consider the letter as being distinct and separate from the article enclosed in the packet, nor did the letter contain any personal matter.' Immediately upon hearing this statement, Allah the Almighty inclined the heart of this magistrate in my favour.

My opponent, the Superintendent of Post Offices, created a great uproar and made very lengthy statements in English, which I could not follow except that each time the Superintendent made a point, the magistrate would reject it, saying: 'No, no.' Thus, finally, when the plaintiff Superintendent had concluded his submission and finished venting his anger, the magistrate wrote his order in a couple of lines and said to me: 'You may leave.' Upon hearing this, I came out of the courtroom deeply grateful to my Real Benevolent Lord, who had bestowed victory upon me even in opposition to a European officer. And I know full well that God Almighty delivered me at that time from that misfortune on account of my adhering to the truth.

Before this case, I had also seen a dream that a man had stretched forth his hand to take away my cap, whereupon I said: 'What are you up to?' On this, he left the cap on my head and said, 'That is all right, that is all right.'

Another one of these incidents transpired as follows: My son, Sultan Ahmad, brought an action against a Hindu for the demolition

of a building which the latter had built on land belonging to our family. In the plaint, a fact had been inaccurately stated, and the proof of this rendered the action liable to dismissal, in which case not only Sultan Ahmad, but I as well, would have to suffer the loss of proprietary rights. The defendant, seizing the opportunity, cited me as a witness.

I went to Batala and stayed at the residence of Babū Fateḥ Dīn, Sub-Postmaster, which was situated close to the Batala courts. The case was in the court of a Hindu judge whose name I no longer recall, but who was lame of one leg. Sultan Ahmad's lawyer came to me and said, 'The case is about to be called, what statement are you going to make?' I said my statement would be in accordance with the facts and the truth, whereupon he said 'Then there is no need for you to go; I will go myself to withdraw the case.' So, I ruined that case myself, with my own hands, merely for the sake of truth; I preferred truth to gain God's pleasure and did not mind the material loss at all.

These last two examples are not without proof either; witnesses to the first are Shaikh Ali Ahmad, Lawyer, Gurdaspur, and Sardār Muhammad Hayat Khan, C.S.I. Moreover, the file must be preserved in the Gurdaspur District records. Witnesses to the second incident are Babū Fateḥ Dīn and the lawyer himself, whose name I do not remember at this time, and also the judge whom I have already mentioned and who has now perhaps been transferred to Ludhiana. The suit was brought about seven years ago. Also, I recall that Nabī Bakhsh, Patwari [Village Land Revenue Accountant] at Batala, was also a witness to what happened in this case.

Now, Ḥaḍrat Shaikh Ṣāḥib! If you also have any instance of a trial of this degree of seriousness, in which you had seen your life, honour, and property at risk in the event that you had spoken the truth, yet you stuck to the truth caring not for your property or life, I would beseech you in the name of Allah to come forward with that incident along with the full proof thereof. It is, however, my belief that most of the mullahs or *maulawīs* of this age are just talk; they are ready to sell their faith for a single penny; for, our Noble Prophet, may peace and

blessings of Allah be upon him, had declared the *maulawīs* of this latter age as the worst of creation.

Moreover, the late Nawwāb **Ṣiddiq Ḥasan Khān**, whom even you believe to be a *Mujaddid* [Reformer], has acknowledged in *Ḥijaj-ul-Kirāmah* that that latter age is this very period of time. Thus, to acknowledge the piety and righteousness of such *maulawīs* without proof would mean falsifying the saying of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him. Therefore, let us have instances of your experience, but if you fail to present any, it will be established that you only possess a claim to piety, but no claim is worthy of acceptance without evaluation.

The state of your inner being is known only to God Almighty as to whether you ever soiled yourself with the filth of lies and fabrication, or it might be known to those who are acquainted with your affairs. The man who emerges as truthful at a time of trial and does not abandon the truth earns the seal of truthfulness. If you possess this seal, come forward and show it. Otherwise, fear God Almighty lest He may expose your flaws.

What harm can your nonsensical malicious talk do to me? You write that I have been working as a legal agent and have been involved with litigation. You should desist from making such fabrications. You know well that my humble self has never been involved in acting on behalf of others in courts. But yes, it is true that in my father's time, most of the cases in connection with the family were conducted through lawyers and sometimes, I too, had to go personally to the courts. But if you insinuate that those cases might be false, you only make an accusation filled with satanic stench. Are cases of all plaintiffs false? Do they all always tell lies?

O perverse-natured *shaikh*! Only Allah knows the state in which you shall die. Does a man who brings an action in court to protect or secure a due right always have to tell a lie? Certainly not. On the contrary, the man upon whom God Almighty has conferred the capability of truth and who loves truthfulness is by nature averse to telling a lie,



and if some worldly benefit is dependent only upon telling a lie, he forgoes it. It is regrettable, however, that a man who himself eats filth considers all people to be eaters of filth. The people given to falsehood always say that without falsehood recourse to a court of law is impossible. So, this statement of his would be true only under the circumstance when a party to a suit would never be prepared to bear any loss to himself and wants to win each and every case by all possible means. But why should a man who always gives precedence to truthfulness do so? Why would someone, who is prepared to suffer loss, place any reliance on falsehood?

Now, let it also be clear that it is true that in my late father's time I had to resort to the courts of law to get satisfaction of the family's legal rights in connection with the business of our estate. But my father's legal actions were either for the arrears of rent, or for compensation for cutting down a tree without permission, or for recovering the proprietary dues from village headmen. These were not complicated cases because of the administrative arrangement whereby the testimony of the Village Accountant—viz. the *Patwārī*—often sufficed for the decision. Falsehood had no place in such suits, for they were decided on the evidence of official records. And because land was not properly taken care of in those days, there was always loss incurred in agriculture and many times one had to take a loss oneself when dealing with cultivators having little income by treating them favourably.

Knowledgeable people are aware that a landlord who is honest can treat his tenants with the highest dictates of honesty and virtue. There is no inherent conflict between landlord-ism and goodness. Notwithstanding this, no one can prove that after my father's death I was concerned with any case except the one in connection with the letter which I have already mentioned. If I had not been temperamentally averse to litigation, I would have freely indulged in it throughout the fifteen years that have elapsed between my father's demise and now.

Again, it must also be noted that only innately evil people would compare these lawsuits with the litigation of the moneylenders. I

cannot conceal the fact that for many generations, we have been a family of landowners; we are even now, and a landowner does need to go to a court of law sometimes, but this cannot be anything objectionable in the eyes of a fair-minded person. Just look up the *ahādīth*: the man who is to come in the Latter Days—in the days when the Quraish would be deprived of temporal authority, when the followers of Muhammad, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, would be disunited and in a state of anxiety—would belong to the landed class, and God Almighty has informed me that **I am that person.**

*Ahādīth* of the Prophet clearly state that in the Latter Days a defender of the Faith and the Muslim community would be raised; and, he would be a landlord [*zamīndār*]. The Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, says in this context that every Muslim should accept him and help him.

Now, just reflect upon this. Being a landlord is a proof of my truth; it is not something to be criticized. And the Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, has commanded that he be accepted, not rejected.

چشم بد اندیش که برکنده باد عیب نماید بنز در نظر

*May the evil eye be destroyed;*

*It sees a virtue and considers it a fault!*

It would not be surprising, however, if litigation is a shortcoming of your father; for you know that under British rule he spent most of his lifetime as a litigant for the usurers. He employed whatever means he could to secure cases and to conduct them on payment, although he was not a legal agent nor a lawyer—not (even) a failed one. Nevertheless, he did everything to fill his belly.

However, this humble one had nothing to do with the cases of other people; I only attended cases connected with our own family estate, to conduct which I employed legal agents mostly like your father, but superior to your father in ability and respectable status. I had nothing to do with the cases of others at all. I remember—and you too must

recall—that your father once expressed a desire to my late father at Batala to be employed as an agent to attend some court cases, but as he was not competent to look after land cases, his request was denied.

**His Statement:** You prophesied the birth of a son based on a revelation and thus told a lie.

**My Statement:** You seem unable to give up your contemptible ways; God alone knows what your nature is made of. What falsehood is there in this prophecy? If you mean to say that a son was born after the prophecy and died, can you provide the proof that there is mention in any of my *ilhām* [revelations] that the promised son was that very boy? If you can, then present that *ilhām*. Bear in mind, however, that there is no such *ilhām*. Nevertheless, if—in my own judgement—I had called that boy to perhaps be the promised son, does it prove that the *ilhām* is untrue?

Do you not know that a *Mulham* [recipient of Divine revelations] sometimes uses his own judgement in interpreting his *ilhām* and sometimes this judgement proves wrong, although this does not detract in the least from the stature and grandeur of the *ilhām*? Everyone must have experienced, countless times, that a dream is true, but errors occur in its interpretation. This subtle point of spiritual knowledge and guidance has specifically been explained in the Noble Quran, but only for those who have eyes [to see].

I am afraid, having raised an objection against me today, tomorrow you might raise a similar objection against the Holy Prophet, peace and the blessings of Allah be upon him, and allege that he could not perform the circuits around the Ka'bah in that particular year in order to do which, in fulfilment of a revelation, he had undertaken a journey of 200 *kos*;<sup>1</sup> and this was proven to be an error of judgement. Alas, excessive prejudice has made you also forget the hadith فَذَّهَبَ وَهَلِي

1. A measure of length equal to about two English miles, varying in different parts of India See Platts, John T. (John Thompson). A dictionary of Urdu, classical Hindi, and English. London: W. H. Allen & Co., 1884. [Publisher]

[‘It occurred to me’].<sup>1,2</sup> I fear how all of this ends for you—let us wait and see how far things go.

And the prophecy about the son is indeed true; it will certainly be fulfilled, and deniers like you will be disgraced by God Almighty.

O enemy of truth! When the words of all the prophecies, taken together, mean that some of the sons will indeed die and one son will be blessed by God Almighty with perfect guidance, then your objection becomes clear proof of your innately perverted mentality. You have portrayed yourself in the very image of the Jewish scholars—let us see what happens next.

**His Statement:** From this, everyone can understand that someone with the audacity to lie about his fellow man cannot possibly hesitate from lying about God.

**My Statement:** From these statements, it becomes proven that you are not free from the faults which your father had himself publicized about you.<sup>3\*</sup> Some of his letters about your nature and attributes are also likely in my possession bundled up somewhere. O good man, you should have proven, first, whether I have ever told a lie in the presence of such and such a person. Further, you should at least present some

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1. This reference is to a dream of the Holy Prophet Muhammad<sup>ṣas</sup> in which he saw migration to a verdant city and it occurred to him that it was Yamamah or Hajar, but it turned out to be Madinah. [Publisher]
  2. *Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī*, Kitāb Manāqibul-Anṣār, Bāb Hijratun-Nabī<sup>ṣas</sup> wa Aṣḥābihi ilā al-Madīnah [Publisher]
  3. **\*Note:** You seem to have forgotten the favours that this humble one has done to you in asking your father not to expose your faults. You know well that I had never approved of the accusation concerning you which was true which your father wished to publish in the papers; I was always a supporter of concealing your faults as well as your goodness of nature, and had been pleading with your father on your behalf. But the recompense of my favour that you gave me is that whereas I shielded you from true charges, you, consistent with the requirements of the nature you are blessed, have accused me of falsehood. I am now convinced that your father was undoubtedly right.—**Author**

examples resembling those instances, which I have presented of my abiding by truth, so that you might be justified in criticising the man who in his moment of severest trial proved to be truthful and did not abandon the truth. I am perplexed as to what evil spirit has come to possess you and is causing you to expose yourself.

In the end, please remember that it is a total fabrication on your part to take the *ilhām* [revelation]:

كَلْبٌ يَمُوتُ عَلَى كَلْبٍ<sup>1</sup>

[He is a dog and he will die according to the value of the letters in the word *kalb* (dog), which amounts to fifty-two]

to refer to yourself. I have never mentioned to anybody that you are the person meant by the revelation. And as regards the severity of some language that you complain about, that is also misplaced. What error have I committed if in reply to your extremely foul language—declaring me a *kāfir*, calling me a *dajjāl*, and Satan, and the greatest liar—I have spoken the truth about you that befits your present condition? After all, there is a time for [the Quranic commandment] <sup>2</sup> *وَاعْلَظْ عَلَيْهِمْ* 'Be strict against them' [to be put into practice].

You seem to think as though by the sale of *Barāhīn-e-Aḥmadiyya* I have taken 10,000 rupees from people and misappropriated the amount. This is an idea taught to you by the Satan who always accompanies you. How have you come to know that I do not intend to publish *Barāhīn*? If *Barāhīn* does get printed and published, would a sense of shame not demand that you drown yourself? Every delay cannot be ascribed to ill intention. I had even published a notice that people who could not wait may get their money back, and a lot of money

1. The reference is to the prophecy in *Izala-e-Auhām*, p. 186–187, *Rūḥānī Khazā'in*, vol. 3, p. 190. See also *Tadhkirah*, Second English Edition p. 236. [Publisher]

2. *Sūrah at-Taḥrīm*, 66:10 [Publisher]

was in fact returned. The Noble Quran which was so urgently needed by the people of Allah, and all of which had already been there since time immemorial in *Laub-e-Mahfūz* [the Well-Guarded Tablet] was revealed over a period of 23 years, and men like you, afflicted with suspicions, continued to object:

لَوْلَا نُزِّلَ عَلَيْكَ الْقُرْآنُ جُمْلَةً وَاحِدَةً<sup>1</sup>

**His Statement:** Since the day you published the claim of being the Promised Messiah, no writing, speech, letter, or book of yours is free from lies.

**My Statement:** O Shaikh destined for evil! What should I say in reply to this disgraceful lie and what should I write? May God Almighty Himself give you the reply, because you have now gone beyond the limit. **O unfortunate man**, how long will you live with these false accusations? How long will you remain safe from death in this fight which you are waging with God Almighty? If you or anyone else considers me to be a liar due to their own blindness, it is nothing new. Abū Jahl and Abū Lahab who were inflicted with the same evil nature as yours, considered the true Prophet of God Almighty to be a great liar. When a man is blinded by extreme prejudice, every statement of a truthful person seems to be a lie to him, but God Almighty brings a truthful person to a good end and obliterates all traces of the liar's existence.

إِنَّ اللَّهَ مَعَ الَّذِينَ اتَّقَوْا وَالَّذِينَ هُمْ مُحْسِنُونَ<sup>2</sup>

**His Statement:** [You] avoided discussion and then issued a poster with various false allegations and lies.

1. 'Why was not the Quran revealed to him all at once?' (*Sūrah al-Furqān*, 25:33) [Publisher]
2. Verily, Allah is with those who are righteous and those who do good (*Sūrah an-Nahl*, 16:129). [Publisher]

**My Statement:** All these are your disgraceful lies which are emanating from your mouth uncontrollably because of your innate [evil] nature. Otherwise, those who carefully consider your writings and mine can decide for themselves whether making accusations, telling lies, or shirking discussion are a characteristic of my humble self or your own. Who would indulge in such crafty talk if not you as you are a Shaikh with some familiarity with the law, and are overly proud of your little learning? But take due note that the day is coming when God Almighty will Himself make manifest which of us two is the liar, the fabricator, and the disgraced and humiliated in the eyes of God Almighty, and whose honour is established by the Benevolent God with heavenly Signs. Be patient for a little while and witness the end.

**His Statement:** If you had even a trace of kindness and sympathy, you would have at once called me to your own place or paid me a visit when I opposed your claim of being the Promised Messiah.

**My Statement:** Dear Sir! Who had prevented you from coming to me? Were there guards at my door who stopped you? Were you used to asking permission before coming to see me in the past? Your father, even if ill and suffering from fever, used to come to me somehow from Batala; so, what new obstacle prevented you? And, since you were not going to abandon your innate meanness and jealousy, devilish nature, conceit, and pride in any circumstances, what sympathy or kindness could I show you by inviting you to my home? Moreover, I also thought it inadvisable to go to your home, for I had recognized the elements of pride and conceit in your nature. I thought it would be useful to first purge you entirely of these elements. There is, however, no improvement in your condition up till now. God knows what fury is filled within you.

Allah, glorified be His eminence, knows that I have endured your abuse with great patience. I was tormented [by you] vehemently and kept trying to stop you from this course. Even now, I can patiently

tolerate your criticisms and accusations of apostasy and sinfulness, but at times I deal with your abuse with some harshness, merely with the intent that the evil substance which lies deep within your heart, as the result of a wrong conception of your priestly position and which has possessed you like an evil spirit, may be completely expelled.

Verily I say, and God Almighty knows, that I am honestly convinced that you are simply a rogue—utterly devoid of knowledge, understanding, and deliberation—and are a foolish man of dull intellect who has never traversed the paths of verities and true divine knowledge. Additionally, you are afflicted with undue pride and conceit that has nearly killed you [spiritually]. Until you become cognizant of your state of ignorance, and the worm of conceit is expelled from your head, you cannot reap any worldly benefit or the benefit of faith. Your greatest friend would be the one who remains engaged in the effort of proving your ignorance and pride to you. I do not know what it is that you are so proud of. A shameful innate nature, a dull understanding, superficial thinking and then such pride and conceit! نَعُوذُ بِاللَّهِ مِنْ هَذَا الْجَهَالَةِ وَالْحُمْقِ وَتَرَكِ! —[We seek Allah's protection from this ignorance, stupidity, shamelessness, pettiness, and misguidance].

And this thought of yours, my dear man, that I have now sent the letter by way of mischief so that the Muslims of Batala may become divided is merely due to your innately suspicious nature. I had not sent the letter to create dissension but merely out of sympathy for your woe-ful condition, lest you fall into the pit of degradation, and so that you might recognize the truth before you pass away. Creating dissension and mischief among Muslims is indeed your habit and is, in fact, your creed and method due to which you declared a Muslim to be a *kāfir* [disbeliever], faithless, and *dajjāl* [deceiver]; and deceiving the ulema you got them to issue edicts of disbelief. You also did a disservice to your preceptor Nadhīr Ḥusain, when he was nearing his death, by persuading him to pronounce the formula by which I was declared a *kāfir*, thus casting the dust of disgrace on his piety in his old age.

You deserve 'applause' on this 'manly performance' of yours!



Nadhīr Ḥusain was advanced in years and was devoid of understanding like a child. It fell to you—to discharge the duties of being his disciple—by blackening his face in his old age when he was about to die, with such revolting black ink that he will probably take his blackened face with him to the grave. The court of God is not something to be taken lightly. He who calls a Muslim *kāfir* will have to bear all the consequences which have been promised for the pronouncers of wanton edicts of disbelief by that Noble Messenger<sup>sas</sup> who so loved justice that, on one occasion, when he was approached to deal leniently with a thief he said with great displeasure, 'By the Being who controls my life, even if **Fāṭimah**, daughter of **Muhammad**<sup>sas</sup> were to commit theft, her hand too would be cut off.'<sup>1</sup>

**His Statement:** (In such case, I can come to Qadian) to expose your lies and fraud to the Muslims, but I am afraid that you will try to cause physical harm to my life.

**My Statement:** You cannot flee now through the means of any excuse or ruse. You have been presented with 10 curses and have been adjured in the name of Allah, glorified be His eminence, to settle the question of my truth or falsehood in accordance with the heavenly principle. If you are right in considering me to be a liar, then you will make yourself ready to oppose me as soon as you hear this from me. Otherwise, you will swallow all these curses and will seek to avoid the issue with absurd and half-baked excuses. And I do not wish to destroy you; there is only One who will destroy you if you do not desist and will safeguard His religion from this mischief of yours. There is no need for you to come to Qadian. If you are prepared to hold a test in accordance with the standard set by Allah and the Messenger<sup>sas</sup>, I myself can come to Batala, Amritsar, or Lahore. تاسیہ روئے شود ہر کہ دروغش باشد [So that the face of the one who is a liar may be blackened].

1. *Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī, Kitāb Aḥādithul-Anbiyā'*, Hadith 3475 [Publisher]

I now proceed to set out the response given by Shaikh Batālawī below.

### And it is as follows:

Letter from  
Muhamamd  
Husain  
Batālawī

Batala, District Gurdaspur, (1 January 1893).

No.1

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ<sup>1</sup>

Mirza Ghulam Ahmad of Kadian<sup>2</sup>! May God guide you and bring you to the right path!

اَسْلَامٌ عَلَى مَنِ اتَّبَعَ الْهُدَى [Peace be on those who follow the guidance.] I read your letter dated 31 December 1892 in amazement. I am not afraid of your bluster and bravado; on the contrary, I consider such fear to amount to *shirk*, and in response, I present the following verse from the Quran:

اتحاجوني في الله وقد هدان ولا اخاف ما تشركون به الا ان يشاء ربى شيئا وسع ربى كل شىء علماء افلا تتذكرون وكيف اخاف ما اشركتم ولا تخافون انكم اشركتم بالله ما لم ينزل به عليكم سلطانا فإى الفريقين احق بالامن ان كنتم تعلمون الذين آمنوا ولم يلبسوا ايمانهم بظلم اولئك لهم الامن وهم مهتدون.

Kadiani Şāhib! I know that the Quran and the former Scriptures, the religion of Islam and the former faiths, and the Prophet of the Last Age and the former Prophets are true and believe in their truth; consequently, it is essential for me to consider you to be a liar and to reject you; for, your beliefs, your teachings,

1. In the name of Allah, the Gracious, the Merciful. [Publisher]
2. The correct spelling of the Urdu word is in fact Qadian. However, the writer of this letter has written it with a *kāf* (ك) instead of a *qāf* (ق), hence this spelling. [Publisher]

and your manners and morals are contrary and opposed to the former books, faiths, and Prophets. Thus, believing in these books, faiths, and Prophets can only be true and correct if I regard your beliefs and teachings to be false and you to be misguided. The following verses are proof of this:

*Letter from  
Muhamamd  
Husain  
Batālawī*

و من يكفر بالطاغوت ويؤمن بالله فقد استمسك بالعروة الوثقى. وقد امروا ان يكفروا به. قد كانت لكم اسوة حسنة فى ابراهيم والذين معه اذ قالوا لقومهم انا براؤ منكم ومما تعبدون من دون الله كفرنا بكم. وبدا بيننا وبينكم العداوة والبغضاء ابدأ حتى تؤمنوا بالله وحده.

Apart from your false beliefs that are opposed to the faith of Islam and the former faiths, speaking lies and deception have become such an essential characteristic of yours, as if they are part and parcel of your innate nature. I do not have detailed knowledge of your life before the compilation of *Barāhīn-e-Aḥmadiyya* but you have adopted lying and deceit since the time of the compilation of *Barāhīn-e-Aḥmadiyya*, especially since [18]86 when you prophesied about the birth of a son according to a revelation and publicized other similar prophecies and, more specifically, since [18]90 when you published your claim to being the Promised Messiah—no writing, speech, letter, or book of yours has remained free from it. From this it can be inferred that in your earlier life, especially when you failed in the examination of legal attorney and during the prolonged period of being involved in litigation, this same must have been your condition.

From this everyone can understand that a man who has the audacity to lie about his fellow man and to deceive them will not hesitate to fabricate lies about God, claiming that he is a recipient of Divine revelation, that it has been revealed to him that if a particular person does not give his daughter in

marriage to him, that person would die<sup>1</sup>, and that if such and such man does not accept him as the Messiah that man would incur [Divine] punishment. And thus, how can this claim of Divine revelation be considered truthful?

You are a claimant to the truth of three thousand such revelations of yours. I will accept you as a *Mulham* [recipient of Divine revelation] if only three from among these three thousand revelations are proven to be true, and I will, in that case, acknowledge that I made a mistake in regarding your beliefs and your teachings as being contrary to the truth, and you as being immoral and misguided. You may choose from these three thousand whichever three you consider to be manifestly true. The revelation concerning the death of Dayanand Sarsawati, for example, or the revelation regarding the release of Shaikh Mehr Ali, or the revelation about Dalip Singh returning unsuccessfully, or the revelation about the death of your supposed future father-in-law, and other examples like these. You may prove the truth of these [three revelations] and attain success easily in a gathering in which there should be present an equal number of persons from each side and three judges belonging to different faiths or who are free thinkers.

Leave aside three, let us take only one supposed revelation

1. This was a true prophecy which was fulfilled within its term, for it said that if Mirza Ahmad Baig of Hoshiarpur did not give his daughter in marriage, he would die within a period of three years from the date of the *nikāḥ* [Islamic marriage]. Thus, Mirza Ahmad Baig did not marry his elder daughter to anybody for five years after becoming aware of this revelation and thus continued to live. After five years he gave her in marriage to a certain man, and in the sixth month after marriage, within the term of the prophecy he died. If this is a man-made affair, I adjure Batālawī to give an example of such a prophecy the truth of which had been manifested by God Almighty, or he might himself make such a prophecy. Otherwise, he should fear the curse which descends swiftly on the enemies of truth, like a rock falling downhill from the peak of a mountain. **Author**

of yours—the last one—which you mentioned with so much enthusiasm at your *Jalsa*, the annual fair, to your followers and to those who are caught in your net, mostly illiterate common people, some selfish rationalists, and some mere spectators who had no interest in finding out the truth about you. You may prove that it was indeed a revelation.

Now, if you are a brave man, come into the battlefield; otherwise, be ashamed of such tall talk. You have spoken of your sea of ‘abundant mercy’, swelling and becoming agitated, there too, you have adopted your age-old habits of lies and deception. What do you have to do with mercy? Sympathy and kindness are entirely lacking in you. Your actions, behaviour, and words clearly bear witness that you are an extremely cruel and selfish, sinning and conceited man. Your tongue and the sword of Hajjaj bin Yusuf are twins.

You have called your opponents and objectors—whom you used to address as ‘my revered sirs or brothers’ and whose honesty of purpose you had acknowledged—by names such as ‘shameless’, ‘faithless’, ‘savage animals’, ‘mad with rage’, ‘dog’, ‘a dog who will die on the numerical value of dog [52]’, ‘mean’, ‘petty’, and ‘barbarous’, etc., etc. Is this indeed the meaning of mercy and human sympathy?

You have misappropriated more than 10,000 rupees from the Muslims by way of payment for the book *Barāhīn-e-Aḥmadiyya* and by tempting them with promises of acceptance of prayers while the book *Barāhīn* is still in your brain, and those who had put faith in your prayers are still looking up expectantly towards you. Is this indeed what is called sympathy and kindness?

When I had a good opinion of you, believing that you might possibly be a saint, I repeatedly requested you to let me stay with you and show me the Signs of [Divine] mercy and blessings. You never replied in the affirmative. Once, I had even

said to you that your opponents and rejecters were more fortunate in that you invited them to witness heavenly Signs, promising them rewards of money, but you did not invite us—your friends—even without any promise of rewards; whereupon you smiled and became quiet.

Then, when you made the claim to being the Promised Messiah I, having manifested my opposition, expressed a desire to come to you for a private friendly conversation but after coming close to promising to invite, you went away to Ludhiana to sit there majestically and having set up the arena for controversy took refuge behind unfair conditions designed to avoid discussions. Then, when I compelled you, by going to Ludhiana and arriving at your house to hold a conversation, you interrupted this peaceful conversation and tried again to prepare the arena for a controversy, unfurling the banner of controversial debates in Delhi, Patiala, Lahore, Sialkot, etc.

Thereafter, avoiding actual discussion, you issued an announcement containing all manner of allegations and lies. In the meantime, you wrote *Āsmānī Faiṣalah* [The Heavenly Verdict] sparing neither unkindness nor abuse in the least. This unkindness and conceit resulted in dissension among the Muslims community—brother leaving brother and friend leaving friend. Is this indeed the outcome of mercy and sympathy?

If there had been even a trace of mercy or sympathy in you, you should have immediately invited me to your place when I had manifested opposition to your claim to be the Messiah, or else you should have taken the trouble of coming to my humble abode (as it had been your practice before and you had taken the trouble of coming to my humble abode at least three times and expressed your sentiments of solidarity) and, in this manner, you could have had the opportunity to prove your new claim. Now, this letter that you have sent, is also not free from your selfishness and intent of creating mischief. It is selfish

because it is intended to make your followers think that you are well-intentioned and steadfastly established upon your claim, and ready to face your opponents. The intention to create mischief consists in wishing the other party to issue point-by-point rebuttals, thereby helping create dissension among the Muslims of Batala. The above is a rejoinder to your claims of revelation, righteousness, well-wishing, and mercy.

Now I proceed to reply to your request that: 'My humble self should come to you and submit to you fearing the revelations and dreams of yourself and your followers or that I should allow you to publish those revelations and dreams consisting of warnings.'

If you are inviting my humble self to visit you for the purpose that I should make enquiries from you regarding your false beliefs, then from this point of view my coming is useless. We Muslims now have no doubts concerning the falsity of your erroneous beliefs. Therefore, there remains absolutely no need or requirement to make any enquiry.

If, however, you have any doubt or misgiving, you can, as always, come to my humble abode at any time.

You will be treated just as you have been treated before, and God willing, I shall try to satisfy you.

And if you are inviting my humble self to visit you so that you may show me some heavenly Sign, then to come for this purpose would not only be of no benefit but would, in fact, be a sin and cause for harm. A believer can never hope for a Sign from a person whose beliefs contradict Islam and the former faiths. And even if he were to show something through his trickery, jugglery, or mesmerism, etc., it would be against Islam to put any faith in it. You, too, have admitted this in your own announcement.

Of course, my going there would not only be permissible but spiritually meritorious if upon arriving there I were to make

manifest to the people that you are incapable of showing any heavenly Sign and expose your falsehood and deception to the Muslims, for I believe you have nothing to do with mesmerism etc. and the weapon and device for deception that you possess is simply your clever speech and eloquence. However, if I were to go to Qadian for such purpose, I fear that you would try to end my life, thereby bringing about the fulfilment of your revelation that this person would die upon reaching the age of 52 years, which your disciples and friends, Miyān Chattu, the silk dealer, and Miyān Rajab-ud-Din, the rice thresher of Lahore, etc. are circulating among themselves. (Although in reality this could never be proven true, for I have already completed the age of 52; 17th of Muharram 1256 Hijri is my birthday, and now it is the year 1310 Hijri). Or you will at least plan to try to disgrace me. If, therefore, you wish to invite me to come to you keeping in mind this objective of mine, you should first remove this fear of mine by executing a written legal document which should be registered in court.

I shall send to you the draft of this document if you signify your agreement to bear this responsibility. Only then shall this humble one come to Qadian and perform the same service regarding you while residing there that I am performing here. If, however, you do not agree to the above condition, I cannot come to Qadian.

I was surprized at you asking for my permission to publish your and your followers' revelations and dreams about me and I became convinced from this that you are a great liar in your claim of being a recipient of revelation. Why would permission to publicize and convey a Divine revelation be needed at all?<sup>1</sup>

1. **Note:** This statement of Batālawī Ṣāhib exposes well his [lack of] knowledge of the Quran and Hadith. He should be aware that there are three kinds of revelation received by the *Mulham* [recipient of revelation] from Allah: (1)



In the first place, the revelation that is received by a Prophet or a saint by way of a warning for some person must necessarily be published and conveyed as this is precisely the requirement of that revelation. But if the one bestowing revelations upon you sends you such revelations with a stipulation not to publish until they are reviewed and reconfirmed by someone else, why do you not ask your bestower of revelations whether or not to publish this particular revelation, and whether, if you publish them, you would not be entangled in some legal complication.

It seems to me that, by asking such permission, you simply wish to abuse me and plan to write and publish such words as might defame me and hurt and cause grief to me and my relatives. You have published such revelations regarding me before, and, at the same time, you also fear the law and consider the Government to be more powerful than the one who is bestowing revelations upon you. I cannot, therefore, allow you to publish such revelations in general. Nevertheless, I cannot withhold permission for the publication of revelations that you and your followers received to the extent that the law permits. And thus, considering the one who bestows revelation upon you to be weak and cowardly (who is certainly not God Almighty, but is Satan) and whom you consider being overpowered by the Government, you must limit your obedience to this bestower of revelation to remain within the law of the Government. If

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The revelation that must be conveyed; (2) The revelation in regard to which the *Mulham* has an option to make known or not to make known—which he might publish if there is wisdom in doing so, or otherwise keep it secret; (3) The third type of revelation is that which the recipients of revelation are forbidden from disclosing. This very division [of the types of revelations] is present in the *ahādīth* of the Holy Prophet, peace and blessings of Allah be upon him. So this revelation was of the second kind which this humble one had been given the option to publicize or not to publicize, and the Prophets do not always get everything resolved by God; they also make use of their own judgement in this world of cause and effect. So ponder. **Author**

you act otherwise, you will be summoned to a court and then may have to visit some other resting place. I am also considering your past revelations, and I have not given up my intention of seeking redress regarding them.

I also do not think it improper to state that if you are gifted with communion with God and can ask God Almighty regarding the details of things needing explanation, and if, with all that, you have (as you claim in your letter) sympathy for mankind, then you should, instead of threatening and warning me, first make an enquiry regarding me from God Almighty; namely, whether the warning revelation you have received regarding me is irrevocable and bound to occur, or whether its occurrence is conditional, and the fear or punishment that is mentioned in it can be lifted from the person in the situation that he submits to it.

Thus, if God Almighty informs you that it is not irrevocable but that it is contingent, you should pray to God that He may enable me to recognize you and make me submissive to you,<sup>1</sup> and that He may ward off that punishment from me. You should, in this regard, cause the sea of your abundant mercy to swell and act upon the example of that merciful Prophet<sup>sas</sup> whose blood was shed by his own people and who, while he wiped off blood from his face said, اللهم اغفر لقومي فانهم لا يعلمون — [‘O our Allah! Forgive my people, for they do not know’].<sup>2</sup> You should moreover act upon this example of the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>, that when the ‘Angel of the Mountains’ came to him and said, ‘I have been sent by God Almighty to crush your rejecters and

1. **Footnote:** God guides only those as a result of the prayer of a *Mulham* whose hearts are not dominated by crookedness and perverseness. Otherwise, such a person, in accordance with the verse فَلَمَّا رَأَوْهُ زُلْفًا عَلَوْهُ مَا لَا صُلْبَ لِقَوْمِهِمْ [61:6] deprived of true guidance. **Author**

2. *Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī*, Kitāb Aḥādīthul-Anbiyā’, Bāb..., Hadith 3477 [Publisher]

opponents under the mountain if you so wish,' he replied that he did not desire this and that he entertained the hope that such people would come into being among their descendants who would proclaim the Oneness of God. If, however, God Almighty informs you that this revelation is irrevocable and bound to occur, then you should discharge your obligation, and prove your claim to Prophethood and Sainthood to your followers by reciting that revelation before them. Preaching to me in this case would be useless, for no Prophet ever persisted in preaching after receiving the promise of inevitable punishment.

If, however, you persist in thus threatening me, then the seekers after truth and the just people will come to know that your preaching and warnings are fraudulent and false.

In conclusion, I also wish to inform you that if I am well-intentioned and in the right in opposing you, and am supporting the Faith of Islam, and my ego has no part in the affair, then God Almighty will help me and by guiding you will make you submit to the truth and the Faith of Islam, or He will destroy you by involving you in a severe punishment. But if my intentions are mischievous, God will Himself punish me for it. Your warning and threatening me is vain and pointless, especially because I consider you to be a great liar, and I consider this belief to be part and parcel of Islam. It is better, therefore, for you to abandon this bluster and bravado and become submissive to the truth. It is up to you now as how to behave in the future.

I can do no more than to clearly convey these things.

The Writer,  
Abū Sa'īd Muhammad Ḥusain,  
may Allah have mercy on him.

The above letter was read out at a public meeting of the Muslims. Important persons present at the meeting approved of its contents and affixed their signatures thereupon. Some of the names are the following:

1. Muḥammad Faiḍ Muḥy-ud-Dīn Qādirī, may God forgive him
2. Aḥmad 'Alī, may God forgive him
3. Muḥammad 'Āzam, may God forgive him
4. Shaikh Amīr Bakhsh
5. Ḥafīẓ Ghulām Qādir
6. Nūr Muḥammad
7. Shaikh Amīr Bakhsh
8. Nabī Bakhsh, Zaildār, Batala
9. Barkat 'Alī
10. Muḥammad Ishāq s/o Qāḍī Nūr Aḥmad
11. Faqīr Shaikh Muḥammad, wā'iz Islām Naqshbandī Makhdūmī Aḥsanī
12. Muḥammad Ibrāhīm, Imām of the Jāmi' Mosque
13. Ḥakīm 'Aṭā Muḥammad
14. 'Alī Muḥammad
15. Miskīn Muḥammad Aḥmadullāh
16. Faqīr Shams-ud-Dīn
17. Muḥammad 'Alī, Thanadār, Pensioner
18. Ḥusain Bakhsh, Appeal Writer

And many others who number more than 100. And many others who number more than 100.

## REBUTTAL TO SHAIKH BATĀLAWĪ

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ<sup>1</sup>  
نَحْمَدُهُ وَنُصَلِّي<sup>2</sup>

اَلْحَمْدُ لِلّٰهِ وَالسَّلَامُ عَلٰى عِبَادِهِ الَّذِيْنَ اصْطَفٰى —[All praise is due to Allah and peace be on his chosen servants]. To proceed, I received your registered letter on 4 January 1893. This letter, which is full of lies, accusations, and false allegations, did not merit a reply, and I could have ignored it, but on pages 2 and 3 of your letter, you mentioned three prophecies of my humble self. You have offered to be bound by the last prophecy published in *Nūr Afshān* of 10 May 1888, and in my public announcement issued on 10 July 1888. You have declared that if this revelation proves to be true, you will accept me as a *Mulham* [recipient of Divine revelation] and will concede your error in regarding my beliefs and teachings to be opposed to truth and considering me immoral and misguided. I deemed it appropriate, therefore, to have compassion once again on your condition and draw your attention to the proof of this prophecy which is based on revelation.

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1. In the name of Allah, the Gracious, the Merciful. [Publisher]

2. We praise Him and invoke His blessings [upon His Noble Messenger].  
[Publisher]

The prophecy, as you state yourself in your letter, was indeed that if Mirza Ahmad Baig of Hoshiarpur does not give his daughter in marriage to my humble self, and marries her to someone else, then he would die within three years from the date of the marriage. The basis of this prophecy was not that I had asked for the hand of Mirza Ahmad Baig's daughter without any rhyme or reason; on the contrary, the basis of this was that this party of opponents, of whom Mirza Ahmad Baig was one, was composed of my near relatives who were inveterate enemies of the Faith, and one of them was so far advanced in his enmity as to openly revile Allah, glorified be His eminence, and the Messenger of Allah, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him. He called himself an **atheist** and had even published a public announcement asking for a Sign. All these people thought that I was an impostor. They demanded Signs and used to ridicule Fasting, Prayer, and the tenets of Islam. Hence, God Almighty desired to complete His argument against them and He chose a manner of showing a Sign which would affect all such faithless relatives.

A God-fearing man can appreciate that life and death are not in man's control, and it is not within the power of man to make a prophecy in which the death of a person is linked to that person marrying his daughter to some other person within a time limit set for that person's demise. The prophecy clearly pointed out that the death or survival of Mirza Ahmad Baig depends upon the *nikāh* [marriage] of his daughter. Accordingly, he continued to live for five years; that is, as long as he had not given his daughter in marriage elsewhere. Then, on 7 April 1892, Ahmad Baig gave his daughter away in marriage and, in accordance with the prophecy, died within three years, on 30 September 1892, in the sixth month counting from the date of the marriage.

It had been also stated in the same public announcement that although death was to take place within three years of the date of the *nikāh*, other visions indicated that it would not take very long. And thus did it occur; that is, there was only an interval of six months, and

indeed even less, between the *nikāḥ* and Mirza Ahmad Baig's death. As I have already stated, the *nikāḥ* was performed on 7 April 1892, and Mirza Ahmad Baig departed from this mortal world on 30 September 1892. Now have some fear of God Almighty and tell me whether this prophecy has been fulfilled or not.

If you are labouring under the misconception as to why it should be regarded as a Divine prophecy and why it should not be attributed to astrology or other sciences of divination, you should know that the prophecies of astrologers are not of this kind. They do not contain conditions of a personal character like, for instance, if so and so will give his daughter in marriage to so and so, he will continue to live, otherwise he will die within a period of three years or less after giving her in marriage to someone else. If any astrologer or other person versed in the science of divination has ever manifested such a prophecy, then come forth with its proof. Apart from this, the prophecy, as stated in the public announcement, included a claim; namely, that I have been commissioned by God Almighty, am gifted with Divine communion, being appointed by God to a spiritual office, and that this prophecy is a Sign of my truth.

Now, if you have the slightest fear of Allah, glorified be His eminence, you will understand that a prophecy which has been put forward as proof of my appointment by Allah could only be fulfilled under the circumstance that this humble one had, in reality, been appointed by Allah. God Almighty would never fulfil the prophecy of an impostor, which he had presented as proof in support of his false claim, the reason being that people would be deceived thereby. As Allah, glorified be His eminence, Himself has declared as a Sign of the truthful:

وَأِنْ يَّاتِكُمْ صَادِقًا يُبَيِّنْكُمْ بَعْضَ الَّذِي يَعِدُكُمْ<sup>1</sup>

1. But if he is truthful, then some of that which he threatens you with will surely befall you (*Sūrah al-Mu'min*, 40:29) [Publisher]

and that:

فَلَا يُظْهِرُ عَلَىٰ غَيْبِهِ أَحَدًا ۝ إِلَّا مَنِ ارْتَضَىٰ مِنْ رَسُولٍ<sup>1</sup>

The word *Rasūl* [Messenger] is a general word, and has a common application to a Messenger, a Prophet, and a *Muhaddath*. Therefore, for a Muslim to believe that this revelation is indeed from God, this argument should suffice that this prophecy has been presented by its recipient together with the claim of his being from Allah and that God Almighty manifested its truth. Notwithstanding, if in your estimation it is possible for a person who is, in fact, an impostor, and who claims by way of total fabrication that he is the Vicegerent of Allah, the Appointed One of Allah, the Reformer of the Age and the Promised Messiah, and declares it to be a Sign of his truth that if a particular man refrains from giving his daughter in marriage to him and marries her to someone else, then he would die within three years of the date of such marriage—and indeed within even a much shorter period—and then it should transpire exactly so; then I request you in the name of God to come forward with any example of such a prophecy. Otherwise, you must remember that you will be questioned after death about this denial and rejection and this allegation of *kufṛ* [disbelief]. God Almighty clearly states:

إِنَّ اللَّهَ لَا يَهْدِي مَنْ هُوَ مُسْرِفٌ كَذَّابٌ ۝<sup>2</sup>

Ponder over this and see that this clearly says that the prophecy of a person who is false in his claim is never fulfilled. Shaikh Ṣāḥib, it is

1. He reveals not His secrets to anyone. Except to him whom He chooses, namely a Messenger of His (*Sūrah al-Jinn*, 72:27–28). [Publisher]

2. Certainly, Allah guides not the one who is a transgressor, and a liar (*Sūrah al-Mu'min*, 40:29). [Publisher]



now time for you to understand this and fear the day when no talk would be of any avail.

If an astrologer, soothsayer, or a man versed in the science of divination can make a claim like mine and then manifest a prophecy, come forward and present such an example and get it published in some newspapers, but keep in mind that you will never be able to present such an example. Such an astrologer shall be destroyed. Almighty God says to His Prophet<sup>sas</sup> that if he had fabricated from himself even a single word or phrase, his life artery would have been severed. How then could it happen that as against my enemies, instead of cutting my life artery, Allah, glorified be His eminence, honoured my humble self who, in your eyes, is a disbeliever, an impostor, a deceiver, and a great liar, by fulfilling this prophecy in support of my claim? Has it ever happened in the world that God Almighty should so help a liar who has been repeating this lie against God Almighty for eleven years—that he is the recipient of such revelation as He bestows upon the saintly and those He converses with—yet God should not sever his life artery? In fact, on the contrary, God should fulfil his prophecies to bring shame, ignominy, and silence upon his enemies like you. Moreover, the result of your efforts should be that while only 75 people attended the *Salana Jalsa* [Annual Convention] before you issued the edict of *takfir* [alleging disbelief] and took so much trouble to discourage people, 327 sincere friends hastened to the next *Jalsa* held to propagate the truth.

What more should I say? I shall—God willing—print and publish this letter, and I have no need to hold any meeting in Batala to test this prophecy. It would be appropriate that you should also publish this letter of mine in *Isha'at-us-Sunnah* and should also state what prevents you now from accepting my claim. The fair-minded people will themselves judge whether your objections are valid or not.

**To reiterate**, Allah, glorified be His eminence, knows very well that I am truthful in my claim and I am neither an impostor, nor a *dajjal* [deceiver] nor an arch-liar.

There was already no shortage of arch-liars, *dajjāls*, and impostors during this era that God Almighty—instead of sending a *Mujaddid* [Reformer] ordained by Him at the beginning of the century—should have set up a *dajjāl* to add to the discord and corruption. Nevertheless, what remedy can I offer to those who fail to understand the truth and make no effort to discover the truth of the matter; instead, they hasten to make fatwas of *takfīr* [alleging disbelief].

I am in pain like one attending to a dear one who is sick, and deeply grieved for these unmindful people and pray that, 'O Lord of Power and Glory! O Guide who shows the right path! Open the eyes of these people; and bestow sight upon them Yourself and send down revelation of truth and righteousness upon their hearts Yourself.'

I am sure that my supplications will not be in vain, for I am from Him and call the people towards Him. It is true that if I am not from Him and I am an impostor, He will destroy me with a severe chastisement because He never bestows such honour upon an impostor as He bestows upon a truthful claimant. The one prophecy that I have put before you, which you have decided to rely upon to determine my truth or falsehood, is alone sufficient evidence for the recognition of my truth or falsehood, for it can never be that God Almighty should help a liar and an impostor. But together with this, I also affirm that in connection with this prophecy, there are two other prophecies that I have already published in the poster dated 10 July 1888. They state that God Almighty will make that woman a widow and will return her to me.

Now, just look at this with justice, for no man can be sure of his own life, nor can he make a claim regarding the life of another that that person would remain alive till such and such a time, or that that person would die by such and such a time. However, in this prophecy of mine there is not one, but six claims: **First**, my surviving until the time of *nikāh* [marriage]; **Second**, the certain survival of the father of the girl until the time of *nikāh*; **Third**, the passing away of the father

soon after the *nikāḥ*, not exceeding three years; **Fourth**, the passing away of her husband within two and a half years; **Fifth**, survival of the girl until the time of her *nikāḥ* with me; and lastly, **Sixth**, setting aside all the customs which she should otherwise have observed as a widow, her marrying me in spite of the opposition of her relatives. Now, can you say honestly that all these things are within the control of man? Think about it with due deliberation: Can such a prophecy, upon being fulfilled, be said to have been the work of man?

Again, if you are not satisfied with that part of the prophecy which relates to the father of the girl and which was fulfilled on 30 September 1892, you should, in accordance with your promise, publish a notice in *Isha'at-us-Sunnah* that, if the other prophecies are also fulfilled, you will repent of your false misgivings and will regard me as a true claimant. You should also, with all fear of God, declare that at least one of the prophecies has been fulfilled. But if the fulfilment of this prophecy does not have much impact upon your heart, you should at the very least adopt silence until the time when the prophecy runs through its final stage. When one part of the prophecy has been fulfilled, there should arise at least some fear in your heart. You are of course expecting my destruction and waiting for the days of my disgrace, but God Almighty is manifesting Signs in support of the truth of my claim. If you still do not accept, I cannot coerce you, but bear in mind that a man in the early stages of denial may be excused on the grounds of there being some doubt, but after he has seen the Signs, he can never be excused.

Was the prophecy which has been fulfilled such a coincidental event of which God Almighty was completely oblivious? Did this prophecy in support of the claim of a *dajjāl* come to be fulfilled in and of itself without the knowledge or will of God? Is it not true that the prophecy of a false claimant is never fulfilled? This is indeed what is taught by the Quran and the Torah. If you possess any sense of justice and even an atom's weight of righteousness, you should now hold your tongue;

the wrath of God Almighty is far more formidable than your wrath. —مَا يَفْعَلُ اللَّهُ بِعَذَابِكُمْ إِنْ شَكَرْتُمْ وَأَمِنْتُمْ. وَالسَّلَامُ عَلَى مَنْ اتَّبَعَ الْهُدَى وَمَا اسْتَكْبَرَ وَمَا أَلَى. [Why would Allah punish you if you are grateful and believe? And peace be upon him who follows the guidance and does not behave with pride and denial].

Humbly **Ghulam Ahmad**, may Allah grant him forgiveness.

*I reproduce below a letter from my dear Nawwāb Sardār  
**Muḥammad 'Alī Khān**. He wrote this letter at the suggestion of  
another seeker after truth.*

*Otherwise, the Nawwāb Ṣāhib himself entertains  
special love and sincerity towards my humble self and  
supports this Movement with his heart and soul.*

# LETTER FROM NAWWAB MUHAMMAD ALI KHAN

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ<sup>1</sup>

Honoured and Esteemed Spiritual Healer—may Allah protect you!

*Assalamu ‘alaikum* [Peace be upon you]. My indisposition prevented me from sending a reply. Allah be praised, I am well now, and I trust that you are also in good health. The money has been sent through Mirza Khuda Bakhsh. I hope that Mirza Şāhib would have informed you fully about everything.

Ever since the publication of your claim of being the **‘like of the Messiah’**, everyone is in a strange state of agitation. There may be some special people who have not experienced any doubt, but I have been in a state of vacillation ever since. At times your claim appears to be correct, while at other times, there is a state of perplexity, so my condition is as if I am vacillating between rejection and acceptance. Much dialogue has now taken place, but my mind finds no satisfaction through it. After listening to the pros and cons, the condition of my mind is indescribable. Rather, I sometimes begin to doubt even the truth of **Islam**. The reason is that while, on the one hand, God Almighty promises in the Holy Quran that He would show

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1. In the name of Allah, the Gracious, the Merciful. [Publisher]

His way to those who strive in His way, but on the other, it is surprising that the promise remains unfulfilled. They may not have performed *Istikhārah*,<sup>1</sup> but hundreds of people are striving with the utmost sincerity to find the straight path and to clearly see the truth.

The following seem to be the issues that will reveal the truth.

**First:** There is no excuse left now as to why the opponents should not be challenged to a *mubāhalah* [prayer duel] because as you have stated in reply to Maulawī ‘Abdul-Ḥaqq, a *mubāhalah* is not permissible until a discussion is held first, and a demand for a *mubāhalah* is made therein, because the difference has to do with a matter of interpretation. This is no longer the case. Opposition has intensified, and arguments have been thoroughly established. You should now challenge the opponents to a *mubāhalah*, and, with complete concentration, seek Divine permission for it. The *mubāhalah* should bring out a result in the near future within a period of not more than two months, for people become weary of a long period of waiting. If it is said that the deniers will continue to deny even after seeing the result of the *mubāhalah*, I would beg to state that the deniers may not believe, but those who are in a state of wavering would certainly come to believe. And a very great benefit would be that those who have already taken the Pledge of Allegiance will have their faith strengthened. In any case, a challenge to *mubāhalah* now seems essential.

**Second:** In *Nishān-e-Āsmānī* [*The Heavenly Sign*] you have stated that the *Istikhārah* should be free from sentiments of hostility or love; because, otherwise, Satan interferes, and one’s own thoughts determine the inspiration. Hence, it should be

1. A special prayer to seek Divine guidance in important affairs. [Publisher]

performed with perfect detachment from both of these matters. Now, this situation presents a great difficulty. Firstly, the person [doing *Istikhārah*] would either be an opponent or a friend. Thus, according to this statement, friends will have an inspiration of a friendly character, while opponents will receive a hostile response. Hence, the result would rest entirely on one's own thought process. Secondly, man is apt to incline towards that which he is asked to refrain from. Therefore, if you had not mentioned it, no one would have thought about it, but because you have mentioned it, some thoughts of one's imagination will play a part in the *Istikhārah*. Thirdly, the *Istikhārah* is really meant for the opponents, and, when an opponent, because of innate hostility, gets an inspiration hostile to you, how will the argument be brought home to him? In every case, therefore, there is the possibility of the intrusion by Satan. These three difficulties stand in the way of the *Istikhārah* being carried out, because in every case there is the possibility of Satan's inspiration. Moreover, it is difficult to free oneself from sentiments of love or hostility, which creates a helpless predicament.

Therefore, for God's sake, also pray that the *Istikhārah* should be free from Satan's inspiration that everyone who offers *Istikhārah*—whether friend or foe—should have the real truth disclosed to them, and that the interference of Satan may be eliminated from it. As the matter is important, it is essential that we pray to God against the interference of Satan. It is strange that Satan should dominate an affair which is essentially spiritual and divine. If God Almighty does not help us and does not save us from the inspiration of Satan, how shall we be able to find true guidance? Thus, nothing can happen without the support of the Gracious God. Therefore, I beseech you to pray that Satan may have nothing to do with the *Istikhārah*.

Let a public announcement be issued in connection with this matter; pray concentrate your spiritual powers and obtain

Divine permission within 10 or 15 days. I too am ready for *Istikhārah*; I shall perform it when, in respect of these three things, you have had a Divine inspiration that this *Istikhārah* will be free from Satan's interference and that, whether a friend or a foe performs it, the outcome in all cases would be the same. I shall perform the *Istikhārah*, and I shall wait for a month for a good and proper reply. By reply, I do not mean a reply to the letter of my humble self but rather, what guidance you receive about *Istikhārah* after you have prayed and concentrated your attention on this affair.

**Third:** There should be some extraordinary Sign so that truth may be brought home to the people.

I most respectfully beg, in the name of God, to give your attention to these three matters, for much dialogue has already taken place, and doubts are increasing day by day. The stage of argumentation is over, and we should now attend to the other side.

پائی استدلالیان چوبین بود پائی چوبین سخت بی تمکین بود

*The legs of logicians are legs of wood—*

*And wooden legs are exceedingly weak.*

گر باستدلال کار دین بدی فخر رازی راز دار دین بدی

*If Faith had rested on argumentation alone,*

*Fakhr[-ud-Dīn] Rāzī would have found the secret of Faith.*

And I adjure you most humbly, in the name of that One Supreme Being, who has brought you and me into being and who has created the whole universe, to kindly pray with concentration for all three of these matters mentioned above. In the prayer, please also beseech for a short span of time and not a longer term [in which the matter should be settled].



As the relation between the parties is delicate and the affair is of a spiritual character, please do not think that this letter of mine is impertinent, rather consider it as a request for beneficence. As I am pledged to you by *Bai'at*, I have given you this trouble for my own peace of mind.

One more issue comes to mind. Writings have now lost all credence. Those who believe in you will trust your writing, and the opponents will trust the writings of the opponents. Caught in between are those who wish to decide after due consideration of writings of both sides. These people do not trust either side, for they have no special connection with you nor the opponents. They will always be faced with a trial.



# [LETTER TO NAWWAB MUHAMMAD ALI KHAN]

Please read this letter carefully at least three times. Although this letter is addressed to you, many of its contents are meant to dispel the misgivings of others, even though you are the apparent addressee.

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ<sup>1</sup>  
نَحْمَدُهُ وَنُصَلِّي<sup>2</sup>

My dear brother Nawwāb Muhammad Ali Khan, may Allah protect you!

*As-salāmu ‘alaikum wa Raḥmatullāhe wa Barakātuhū* [Peace be upon you, and the mercy of Allah and His blessings]. More than a week ago—rather, more than ten days ago—I received the affectionate letter from your dear self. As it contained several matters calling for a detailed response, and as I had very little time due to the compilation of the book *Ā’ina-e-Kamālāt-e-Islām*—for which I am preparing my manuscripts daily—I was not able to write a response, nor were you pressing for a quick reply. Today it occurred to me that since you are a special loved one and your enquiries are based entirely upon sincere intentions and honesty of purpose, it is necessary that I

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1. In the name of Allah, the Gracious, the Merciful.

2. We praise Him and invoke His blessings [upon His Noble Messenger].  
[Publisher]

should inform you of certain matters and apprise you of what is good for you. Therefore, I write these few lines below for your information.

It is true that ever since this humble one made the claim to being the **Promised Messiah** by the command of Allah the Exalted, those people who lack a decision-making ability have been flung into an extraordinary confusion and perplexity. You also say that verbal arguments will not now help in reaching a decision; that it is now time to get ready for a *mubāhalah*. You also say that some Sign should be shown.

- I. Regarding the *mubāhalah*, Allah, glorified be His eminence, granted me His permission on His own a few days before your letter came. I consider this to be an agreement of your view with the will of God Almighty that you were moved to make such a proposal.

It seems to me that the wisdom in permitting the *mubāhalah* now is that a *mubāhalah* was not permissible earlier because the opponents had not yet been fully educated and were totally ignorant of the real situation. Moreover, they were not as vehement in declaring me to be a *kāfir* as they have been more recently. But now, after the compilation of *Ā'ina-e-Kamālāt-e-Islām*, the message has been fully conveyed, and after seeing this book, even a man of low understanding can realize that the opponents are absolutely wrong in their views. Therefore, I have been commanded to publish the request for the *mubāhalah* together with the book *Ā'ina-e-Kamālāt-e-Islām*. That request will, therefore, be published, if Allah the All-Powerful so wills, with the first part of the book.

Formerly, I was not sure whether a *mubāhalah* with the Muslims was at all permissible, because *mubāhalah* means pronouncing a curse against each other, and it is not lawful to curse a Muslim. However, these people now insist on declaring me a

*kāfir* [disbeliever], and the commandment of the Shariah is that whoever accuses a Muslim of being a *kāfir*, when that Muslim is not really a *kāfir*, the pronouncement of disbelief reverts to the accuser himself. This is why I have been commanded to invite those to a *mubāhalah* who call me a *kāfir*, have sons and female relations, and who are the leaders of the edict of disbelief.

2. What you write about the need for a Sign is also correct. In actual fact, there are two categories of people: those who are intelligent and virtuous and possess the quality of deciding for themselves. They can distinguish the speech which possesses the grandeur, the grace, and the light of truth, from the disputations of the opposing parties. Falsehood, which reeks of pretence and artificiality, also does not remain hidden from their view. Such people do not stand in need, for instance, of being shown the staff turning into a serpent in order to recognize Ḥaḍrat Mūsā [Moses], peace be upon him, nor is it necessary that they be shown lepers and paralytics being made whole and cured by the touch of Ḥaḍrat ‘Īsā [Jesus], peace be upon him, in order for them to recognize him. Similarly, in the time of our Lord and Master, Ḥaḍrat Khātamul-Anbiyā’ [the Seal of the Prophets], may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, such illustrious people never asked for a miracle. No one can prove that the great Companions, may Allah be pleased with them, came to believe in him after witnessing some Sign. On the contrary, they were virtuous and possessed enlightened hearts. They came to recognize him by merely casting a glance upon the face of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, as his was not the face of an impostor. Therefore, they were deemed to be the truthful and faithful in the eyes of God Almighty; they saw the truth and their hearts bore witness that he was from Allah.

The second kind of people are those who demand a miracle

and a marvel. God Almighty does not speak of them in the Noble Quran in praiseworthy terms; He holds them liable to punishment, as in one place, He says:

وَأَقْسَمُوا بِاللَّهِ جَهْدَ أَيْمَانِهِمْ لَئِنْ جَاءَتْهُمْ آيَةٌ كَيُؤْمِنُوا بِهَا قُلْ إِنَّمَا الْآيَاتُ عِنْدَ اللَّهِ وَمَا يُشْعُرُكُمْ  
أَنَّهَا إِذَا جَاءَتْ لَا يُؤْمِنُونَ<sup>1</sup>

Meaning: These people emphatically swear that if they see some Sign they would certainly come to believe. Tell them, the Signs are with God Almighty. And you do not know that they would never come to believe even if they were to see the Signs. Again, He says:

يَوْمَ يَأْتِي بَعْضُ آيَاتِ رَبِّكَ لَا يَنْفَعُ نَفْسًا إِيْمَانُهَا كَمْ تَكُنْ أَمِنْتَ مِنْ قَبْلُ<sup>2</sup>

Meaning: It would not be of any benefit to come to believe on the day when the Signs will be shown, and the one who comes to believe only after seeing a Sign, would not benefit from that belief.

Again, He says:

وَيَقُولُونَ مَتَى هَذَا الْوَعْدُ إِنْ كُنْتُمْ صَادِقِينَ ○ قُلْ لَا أَمْلِكُ لِنَفْسِي ضَرًّا وَلَا نَفْعًا إِلَّا مَا شَاءَ اللَّهُ  
لِكُلِّ أُمَّةٍ أَجَلٌ...<sup>3</sup>

Meaning: The disbelievers say, 'When will the Signs appear and when will the promise be fulfilled?' So, tell them that I have no power in this matter, neither for good nor for evil for my own self, except as God wills. There is an appointed time for every people which can never be averted.

1. *Sūrah al-An'ām*, 6:110 [Publisher]

2. *Sūrah al-An'ām*, 6:159 [Publisher]

3. *Sūrah Yūnus*, 10:49–50 [Publisher]

And then again, God says to His Messenger<sup>sas</sup>:

وَإِنْ كَانَ كِبَرَ عَلَيْكَ إِعْرَاضُهُمْ فَإِنْ اسْتَطَعْتَ أَنْ تَنْبَغِيَ نَفَقًا فِي الْأَرْضِ أَوْ سُلَيْمًا فِي السَّمَاءِ فَتَأْتِيَهُمْ  
بَيِّنَةٌ وَكُوشَاءَ اللَّهُ لَجَمْعِهِمْ عَلَى الْهُدَى فَلَا تَكُونَنَّ مِنَ الْجَاهِلِينَ<sup>1</sup>

Meaning: If (O Messenger, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him) the aversion of these disbelievers bears heavy on you, you might, if you have the power, dig a passage into the earth, or scale the very heavens with a ladder, and bring forth some Sign for them. Had God so willed, He would have guided all those who ask for a Sign. Therefore, be not of the ignorant people.

Now, all these verses show that in the time of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, the disbelievers used to demand Signs. Indeed, they would even swear oaths that they would come to believe; but, in the eyes of Allah, glorified be His eminence, they merited punishment, and their demands were absurd. Indeed, Allah, His eminence be glorified, says very clearly that the faith of someone who comes to believe after seeing a Sign is not acceptable [to God]. The verse:

لَا يَنْفَعُ نَفْسًا إِيْمَانُهَا<sup>2</sup>

[to believe in them shall not profit a soul which believed not before] bearing on this point, has already been quoted. Closely resembling it is another verse:

وَلَقَدْ جَاءَهُمْ رَسُولُهُمْ بِالْبَيِّنَاتِ مِمَّا كَانُوا لِيُؤْمِنُوا بِهَا كَذَّبُوا مِنْ قَبْلُ كَذَلِكَ يَطْبَعُ اللَّهُ عَلَى قُلُوبِ  
الْكَافِرِينَ<sup>3</sup>

1. *Sūrah al-An'ām*, 6:36 [Publisher]

2. *Sūrah al-An'ām*, 6:159 [Publisher]

3. *Sūrah al-A'rāf*, 7:102 [Publisher]

Meaning: In the earlier nations people did not believe in their Prophets even when they showed Signs, because they had rejected them before seeing the Sign. In this way, God places a seal on the hearts of such disbelievers who do not believe before seeing a Sign.

All these, and many other similar verses of the Noble Quran, to quote which would prolong this statement, indicate that those who demand a Sign become deserving of Divine punishment, and the faith of someone who comes to believe after seeing a Sign is not acceptable to God. Here, there may arise two objections: Firstly, why should someone asking for a Sign become deserving of Divine punishment? Someone who, for his own satisfaction, wishes to test whether a claimant is commissioned by Allah or not, apparently has a right to ask for a Sign lest he be deceived and take one rejected by Allah as an accepted servant of Allah.

The reply to this misconception is that all reward becomes established due to faith. And faith means acknowledging something that is yet behind the veil of the unseen based on the preponderant indicators. In other words, things should only be looked at to the degree of examining whether the reasons in favour of someone's truthfulness prevail over the reasons pointing to his falsehood and seeing to it that the existing indicators of his being truthful are amply greater than the evidence of his being a liar. This then is the limit of faith, but if someone goes beyond this limit and asks for a Sign, then he is a transgressor in the eyes of Allah. It is about such people that Allah, glorified be His eminence, says in the Noble Quran: After he has seen a Sign, his faith would not be of any benefit to him.

It can be readily understood with some reflection why one gains the pleasure of God Almighty as the result of faith. The reason is, that the things we accept with faith are not yet apparent to us in every way. For instance, a man comes to believe



in God Almighty though he has not seen Him; he believes in the angels though he has not seen them either; he believes in Heaven and Hell though they, too, are hidden from his view. He believes in them as a matter of goodly thinking and therefore becomes truthful in the eyes of God Almighty. This sincerity becomes a means for his salvation. Otherwise, Heaven, Hell, and angels are obviously the creations of God Almighty—what connection can there be between faith in them and salvation?

If we believe in the existence of something which, in fact, does exist, and the fact of its existence is manifestly obvious, why would we deserve any reward? For example, if we say that we believe in the existence of the sun, and in the existence of the earth, and the moon, and that donkeys and horses and mules and bullocks and birds of many kinds exist in the world, should we expect to be rewarded for this faith? Thus, why, for instance, when we believe in the existence of angels, are we held to be believers in the sight of God Almighty and become deserving of a reward for this? But if we believe in the existence of all the animals we see on this earth, we do not deserve the slightest reward for it, whereas the angels and all other objects are equally God Almighty's creations. The reason for this is indeed that the angels are behind a veil, but the other objects are definitely known to us. This is also the reason why declaring one's faith on the Day of Judgment will not be accepted. In other words, if someone says on that Day, after seeing God Almighty's manifestations and witnessing the angels, and Heaven and Hell, that he now believes in them, his belief would not be accepted. Why would it not be accepted? For the very same reason that, on that Day, there would be no intervening veil which might vouch for the sincerity of a believer's faith.

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Now, after pondering on this with some care, it should be understood what it is that is called *faith* and why upon attaining faith, one receives a spiritual reward. It is hoped that, with the grace of the Almighty, you will quickly come to understand with very little deliberation that attaining faith means accepting something while some aspects of it are still hidden and before it becomes apparent fully by thinking about it very carefully and keeping in view the preponderance of circumstances in its favour—this is faith upon which reward becomes merited. And although the venerated Messengers, Prophets, and saintly people, peace be upon them all, do, without any doubt, show Signs but the fortunate people, who are the beloveds of God Almighty, come to accept them through their sound judgement before they have seen such Signs. Those who accept them after witnessing the Signs are despised and worthless in the sight of God Almighty.

The Noble Quran emphatically proclaims that those who cannot accept the truth without seeing a Sign do not accept it even after seeing a Sign. Before a Sign is shown they openly declare their denial. They go about proclaiming publicly that this person [the claimant] is a great liar and an impostor because he has not shown any Sign. And what largely contributes to their misguidance is that God Almighty also deliberately delays and postpones the manifestation of a Sign to try His servants. And such people continue to advance in their rejection and denial to the extent that they become firmly entrenched in their opinions and start proclaiming that this person [the claimant] is in reality an arch-liar, impostor, deceiver, false in his claim, and not from Allah.

Thus, when they have become firmly entrenched in their opinion and have spread this firm assessment of theirs widely in the world through their speeches, writings, social conversations, and pronouncements from the pulpits—saying that this man is

truly an arch-liar—Divine Munificence attends to the matter at that moment to display a Sign to demonstrate the truth and honour of His humble servant. It is then that some Sign from the unseen is manifested, but only those benefit from it who have already believed and have joined the fold of the supporters of truth, or those who had safeguarded their tongues and pens—and even their thoughts—against expressing any hostile idea against the claimant. But those unfortunate people who had already expressed their hostilities cannot come to believe even after seeing the Sign, for they had already given open expression to their opinions. They had issued public announcements and put their seals on their declarations that this person is indeed a great liar. So, to go against their declared and well-known opinions becomes harder for them than death because that would constitute the height of disgrace for them, and their folly would become evident upon thousands of people who can say that: ‘These people proclaimed with great fervour that this man was definitely a liar, and there was no doubt about it. They had sworn and had pretended to be wise and learned, but now they support the same man.’

As I have stated earlier, coming to believe merits being rewarded for this very reason that the man of faith accepts the existence of such things which are yet hidden, on the authority of some valid circumstances which point to their existence. This is in fact how Allah, glorified be His eminence, has described the believers in the Noble Quran:

يُؤْمِنُونَ بِالْغَيْبِ<sup>1</sup>

Meaning that they believe in such things that are yet behind the veil of the unseen.

1. *Sūrah al-Baqarah*, 2:4 [Publisher]

For example, the Noble Companions believed in our Lord and Master, peace and the blessings of Allah be upon him, and none of them asked for a Sign or demanded any proof. And although Signs rained down at the proper time thereafter, and miracles were manifested, the Noble Companions were never in need of miracles to declare their faith. Had they made their faith dependent on seeing miracles, not even a grain of their distinction would have been established and they would have been counted among the common people, and would not have joined the ranks of those accepted as the beloved servants of God. Whoever demanded a Sign elicited the wrath of God Almighty. They did not truly enjoy a good end, and most of them died in a state of disbelief.

In short, all Scriptures of God Almighty point out that asking for a Sign never produced any blessings for a people and whoever demanded a Sign, that very individual faced destruction. Similarly, in the Gospel [Jesus] the Messiah says: An evil and adulterous generation seeketh after a Sign; and there shall no Sign be given to it.<sup>1</sup>

I have also written earlier that at this juncture the question naturally arises in the mind of every individual: 'How can a man differentiate between truth and falsehood without a Sign—if anyone is accepted as being from Allah without witnessing a Sign, there is a possibility of being deceived into acceptance?' The reply to this is precisely what I had previously written—that God Almighty has declared the reward of faith to be conditional upon the declaration of faith prior to witnessing a Sign, and to differentiate between truth and falsehood, it is sufficient to possess a few pointers that can form the basis to validate the claim, and the scale of attesting evidence should outweigh the scale alleging falsehood.

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1. See Matt 12:39 [Publisher]

For example, when the greatest among the Truthful, Ḥaḍrat Abū Bakr, may Allah be pleased with him, believed in the Holy Prophet, peace and the blessings of Allah be upon him, he did not demand a miracle. On being asked why he had believed in him, he replied that it had been proven to him that Muhammad, peace and the blessings of Allah be upon him, was *Amīn* [the Trustworthy] and that he firmly believed that he [the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>] had never spoken a lie about anyone, let alone that he should lie about God.

Similarly, each Companion—according to his personal inclinations—believed in the Holy Prophet, peace and the blessings of Allah be upon him, upon witnessing one or another of his moral excellences or teachings and taking that as a proof of his truth after minutely pondering over it. None of them had asked for a Sign. To make a distinction between truth and falsehood, it sufficed for them to know that the Holy Prophet, peace and the blessings of Allah be upon him, occupied the highest position in righteousness, was bold and steadfast in the proclamation of his mission, had brought a teaching that was clearer and purer than all other teachings, was a Light pure and simple, was incomparable in all praiseworthy morals, held the most glorious degree of God-given zeal, and the truth was manifestly evident upon his countenance. Thus, they were led to believe that he was truly commissioned by God Almighty.

It should not be taken to mean here that no miracles were manifested by the Holy Prophet, peace and the blessings of Allah be upon him. On the contrary, he showed more miracles than all the other Prophets, but the way of Allah has always been that, in the beginning, manifest miracles and Signs remain concealed, so that the sincerity of the believers and the denial of the deniers may be put to the test. This time [the beginning] is the time of trial, and no manifest Sign is shown in it. When, however, some pure-hearted people, through their profound vision,

come to believe [in the Prophet], and only the common people lag, Signs begin to appear so that arguments of the [Prophet's] truth may be brought home to them, and that, there may be a justification for the punishment to which they may be subjected. The only people who benefit from these Signs, however, are those who have already declared their beliefs, and there are very few who come to believe afterwards; for, they become hard-hearted by their persistent denial and cannot change their publicized opinions, and at long last, they go to Hell in the state of this very disbelief and denial.

It is my ardent heartfelt desire, and I pray, that you may come to understand the fact that the real meaning of faith requires the acceptance of the unseen. And that when a thing becomes completely manifest, or when a large part of it becomes manifest, acceptance of its existence does not constitute faith. For example, now that it is the time of day, if I were to say that I believe and declare my faith that it is now day and not night, what merit would there be in this faith of mine, and what superiority would I have over others by believing this? The first sign of a fortunate man is that he comes to understand this blessed concept of what it is that is called *faith*.

For all the people who went on opposing the Prophets ever since the beginning of the world, their failure to understand the real significance of faith was this very veil that was blinding their intellects. They thought that it was improper to accept a Prophet unless his Prophethood and teachings were manifested to them like other obvious and palpable phenomena. These foolish people did not stop to think how accepting what was already openly manifest could possibly constitute faith—such a thing would be like addition and subtraction, mathematics, a science and not faith. This indeed was the veil due to which Abū Jahl and Abū Lahab, etc., remained deprived of faith in the beginning. And then, when they became confirmed in their

rejection and stubbornly insisted upon their hostile opinions, it was at that time that openly clear Signs of the truth of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, were made manifest; so, at that time these people said it was now better for them to die than to believe.

In short, it is the people of good fortune who recognize the truthfulness of a true claimant through the use of their profound insight, and to demand a Sign is the most wretched habit of evil people, which has caused tens of millions of people—the deniers of Prophets—to be flung into the fire of Hell. God Almighty does not change His practice. As He has stated, in His view, only the faith of such is considered to be faith, who do not show much obstinacy, and who, upon seeing significant pointers and evidence of his truthfulness, accept the truthful one. For them, the speech of that truthful person, his righteousness, his perseverance, and his very countenance, testify to his truthfulness. Blessed are those who are gifted with the intellect to recognize the worth of men.

Moreover, testing a follower of the Principal Prophet—who believes in his commandments and the Book of Allah—in the manner of testing a Prophet, amounts to a lack of understanding. This is so because the Prophets come to make people leave one faith and enter another, to substitute a new *qiblah* for the old one, to abrogate some laws and replace them with others, but there is no such revolutionary claim here. Here it is the same Islam as there was before, the same Prayers, the same Beloved Messenger, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, and that same Noble Book that was there before. No such thing from the original faith has to be abandoned that could be a cause for great surprise.

The claim of being the **Promised Messiah** would have been greatly burdensome and would have required diligent investigation if, along with it, there had been some addition or

deletion—God forbid—in the religious commandments and if my practical condition had in any way differed from other Muslims, but there is nothing of this kind. The only controversy is the question of the life or death of the Messiah [Jesus]. The claim of being the Promised Messiah is, in reality, just an offshoot of this very issue. This claim does not imply any practical revolution, nor does it adversely affect Islamic beliefs. So, does accepting this claim require some great miracle or marvel, such as have always been demanded by people from the claimants of Prophethood? For an honest and God-fearing person, can there be any difficulty in accepting the claim of a man who is a Muslim, who has been sent by God Almighty to support Islam, whose objectives are to show people the beauties of Islam, to prove Islam to be free from the objections raised by modern day philosophies, etc., and to bring the Muslims back to the love of Allah and the love of the Messenger?

Had the claim of being the Promised Messiah been accompanied by anything that had adverse effects to the commandments and beliefs of the Shariah, it would have been something horrible without a doubt. Nevertheless, one should consider which Islamic principle I have perverted by making this claim, and to which Islamic commandments I have added or subtracted even an iota. Yes, of course, I have interpreted a prophecy in the light of the meanings which God Almighty has disclosed to me at its appointed time. The Holy Quran bears testimony to the authenticity of that interpretation, as do the authentic *ahādīth*. Therefore, I do not know why there is so much commotion and clamour!

A seeker after truth may, however, ask here: 'What indications are present for accepting the claim of the Promised Messiah; for, there should be some such indications present to accept the truth of a claimant, especially in the present age which is full of dishonesty, deceit, and fraud, and in which false



claims run rampant?’ In reply to this question, it is sufficient for me to say that the following matters should serve as signs and indicators to guide a seeker after truth:

1. **FIRST**, that prophecy of the Messenger of Allah, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, which has attained the status of *تَوَاتُرٌ مَعْنَوِيٌّ* [*tawātur ma‘nawī*], the meaning of which is that God Almighty has promised that He will raise a man at the head of every century who will rejuvenate the Faith and, removing its weaknesses, will restore it to its original strength and ability.<sup>1</sup> It was essential, therefore, that in accordance with this prophecy, a person would be raised by God Almighty in the beginning of this fourteenth century who would also come forward to rectify the prevailing evils. So, this humble one has been appointed exactly at the proper time. Hundreds of saintly people had testified beforehand based upon their revelations that the *Mujaddid* [Reformer] of the fourteenth century would be the Promised Messiah. And the authentic *ahādīth* of the Holy Prophet emphatically proclaim that the Messiah would appear after the thirteenth century. So, is this claim by my humble self not made exactly at the right time and appropriate occasion? Is it possible that the word of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, should fail to materialise? I have proven that if it is assumed that the Promised Messiah was not born at the head of the fourteenth century, several prophecies of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, would prove to be erroneous and hundreds of saintly ones possessed of revelation would turn out to be liars.
2. **[SECOND]** Let it be considered also that when the ulema are asked

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1. *Sunan Abī Dāwūd, Kitābul-Malāḥim, Bāb Mā Yudhkar fi Qarnil-Mi‘ah, Hadith 4291* [Publisher]

who, except my humble self, has claimed to be the *Mujaddid* of the fourteenth century, and who has informed the people of having come from Allah and made the claim of being the recipient of revelation, and of having been appointed [by God], they are completely silent in responding to this question. They cannot present anyone who has made such a claim. And it should be remembered that the claim of being the Promised Messiah is not greater than the claim of being the recipient of revelation from Allah or of being a *Mujaddid* deriving his authority from Him.

It is clear that for a man who is bestowed this rank of conversing with God Almighty—whether he is named by Allah as being ‘the like of the Messiah’ or ‘the like of Moses’—all these names would be permissible in his case. Being the like of another carries no real superiority. The true and real superiority lies in being the recipient of revelation from Allah, or in being one whom Allah blesses with converse. Therefore, Allah, His eminence be glorified, may bestow any name befitting the times upon a man who is granted the gift of Divine revelation and is appointed by Allah to serve the Faith. Assigning a name is no great matter. In Islam, names like **Mūsā [Moses]**, **‘Īsā [Jesus]**, **Dāwūd [David]**, **Sulaiman [Solomon]**, **Ya‘qūb [Jacob]** and others are often adopted by people since they are the names of the Prophets, with the intention that the bearers of those names may inherit the morals of these Prophets. There is nothing impossible, therefore, in Almighty God’s granting the gift of His communion to a person and giving him a name as appropriate under some prevailing circumstances.

That the *Mujaddid* of this age should be called the Promised Messiah appears to be based upon the understanding that the work of great importance that this *Mujaddid* had to accomplish is to break the prevalence of Christianity; repel its attacks; shatter their philosophy which is opposed to the Quran, with powerful arguments; and to fully convey the truth of Islam to

them; for, in this age, the greatest affliction for Islam—which cannot be repelled without Allah’s assistance—is the philosophic onslaught and religious criticism of the Christians. It was essential that God Almighty raise someone to repel these and, as it has been disclosed to me through visions, the soul of the Messiah [Jesus] was in a state of great zealous outpouring for the descent of his spiritual likeness on account of the falsehoods that had been attributed to him in this age, and it supplicated God Almighty that such a one should be sent down at this time. So, God Almighty responded to his zealous outpouring and sent his like into the world so that the promise, already made, should be fulfilled.

This is one secret from among the secrets of the Divine Being that when the shariah [spiritual law] brought by some Messenger or Prophet becomes corrupted after his death and his teachings and directions are perverted, and absurd and inappropriate things are ascribed to him, and when it is falsely alleged that that Prophet had indeed taught all those matters of disbelief and immorality, an ardent yearning and strong fervour for the removal of such corruption and false allegations is created in the heart of that Prophet. Then the soul of that Prophet demands that a substitute of itself should appear in the world.

Now, listen carefully to this subtle point of wisdom: The Messiah [Jesus], peace be upon him, had two occasions presented when his spirituality demanded a substitute representative. The first was 600 years after his death. This was when the Jews insisted more than ever that he was—God forbid—an impostor and a liar and that his birth was illegitimate and that that was why he died on the cross. Meanwhile, the Christians committed the excess of saying that he was God, and the son of God, and that he had laid down his life on the cross for the salvation of mankind. Thus, when the wicked Jews called the blessed status of the Messiah, peace be upon him, into question

in such indecent manner; and, quoting from Deuteronomy the verse that says that the man who is crucified is accursed; declared the Messiah, peace be upon him, to be—God forbid—accursed, an impostor, a liar, and of illegitimate birth; whereas, on the other hand, the Christians praised him with such exaggeration as to make him God and falsely ascribe this teaching to him—it was then that the soul of the Messiah was moved, in accordance with Allah's will, and demanded to be exonerated from all these charges and beseeched God for a substitute. Thereupon, our Holy Prophet, may the peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, was raised. Among the many objectives of his appearance, one was that he declare the Messiah free from all these unfounded allegations and give testimony in favour of his truth. This is indeed the reason why the Messiah himself says in John, chapter 16:

'Nevertheless, I tell you the truth; it is expedient for you that I go away, for if I go not away, the Comforter (that is, Muhammad, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him) will not come unto you; but if I depart, I will send him unto you.

And when he is come, he will reprove the world of sin, and of righteousness, and of judgment,

Of sin, because they believe not in me;

Of righteousness, because I go to my Father, and ye see me no more;

Of judgment, because the prince of this world is judged.

Howbeit when he, the spirit of truth, is come, he will guide you unto all truth;

He shall glorify me, for he shall receive of mine.'<sup>14</sup>

1. John 16:7–14 [Publisher]

‘The comforter whom the Father will send in my name he shall teach you all things’—14.<sup>1</sup>

‘Verily I say unto you, Ye shall not see me, until the time come when ye shall say, Blessed is he that cometh in the name of the Lord.’ (i.e. in the name of the Messiah, peace be upon him)—Luke 14.<sup>2</sup>

In these verses the words of the Messiah—namely, ‘I will send him unto you’—clearly indicate that the spirit of the Messiah would demand that such a person should be raised. Moreover, the sentence, ‘whom the Father will send in my name’ indicates that he who is to come, will have a complete share of Messiah’s spirituality and that in one aspect of his spiritual eminence he would be the Messiah just as, in another aspect, he is Moses.

The fact is that our Holy Prophet, peace and the blessings of Allah be upon him, combines in him the names of all the Prophets, because all the various spiritual excellences are concentrated in his holy personage. Hence, he is Moses, Jesus, Adam, Abraham, Joseph, and Jacob. This is what Allah, glorified be His eminence, has indicated in the verse:

فِيهِلَهُمُ اقْتِبَادٌ<sup>3</sup>

Meaning that: O Messenger of Allah! Combine all the various points of guidance in your own person, which each of the Prophets possessed as a special gift.

This shows that the spiritual merits of all the Prophets were to be found in the person of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him. And in reality, the very name

1. John 14:26 [Publisher]

2. According to KJV the reference is Luke 13:35 [Publisher]

3. *Sūrah al-An‘ām*, 6:91 [Publisher]

*Muhammad*, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, points precisely to this, for *Muhammad*<sup>sas</sup> means 'the most highly praised' and such praises can be conceived of only when all the different excellences of the Prophets and their distinctive qualities should be found in the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him. Many verses of the Holy Quran, the reproduction of which here would lengthen this statement, indicate—and indeed clearly point out—that the personality of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, was an amalgamation of the personalities of all the Prophets in spiritual merits and spiritual excellences. Every Prophet, finding that he bore a resemblance with him [the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>], anticipated that he would indeed come in his name. The Noble Quran says in one place that the Prophet who most resembles Abraham is this Prophet, and there is a hadith in *Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī* in which the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, says that he has such a striking resemblance to the Messiah as if his being and mine are joined together.

Hence, this hadith corroborates that sentence of the Messiah [Jesus<sup>as</sup>] where he says that that Prophet [i.e. Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>] would come in his name. And that is exactly what happened so that when our Messiah [the Holy Prophet], may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, came, he completed all the tasks that the Messiah of Nazareth had left incomplete. He bore witness to his truth and declared him innocent of the charges which the Jews and the Christians had heaped upon him and thus he became the cause for sending joy to the spirit of the Messiah. This was the first zealous outpouring of the soul of Jesus of Nazareth which achieved its purpose through the advent of our Lord and Master, our Messiah, the Seal of the Prophets, may the peace and blessings of Allah be upon him. So all praise belongs to Allah.

The soul of the Messiah had a second zealous outpouring at the time when the Christians completely and perfectly assumed the qualities of the *Dajjāl* [Antichrist]. Further, as it is written, the *Dajjāl* would also lay claim to Prophethood and Divinity, so they have done likewise. They have laid claim to Prophethood for they have tampered with the Word of God of their own accord making new regulations, amending, and abrogating, which is really the work of a Prophet. They have upheld the commandments which they wished to uphold and have fabricated a new creed and mode of worship and have freely interfered with the faith as if they have had a revelation from God to do so. This undue interference with the Divine Book is, in other words, laying a claim to Prophethood.

Additionally, they have claimed to be God in this way that their philosophers have made the intention of bringing all the works of God under their own control. Their thinking bears witness to their intent. They are engaged day and night in thinking how, for example, in some way they themselves could cause rain to fall, and how they could procreate children by placing the male sperm in the womb of the female by means of some instrument, and it is their belief that there is no such thing as the decree of God, and they say that failures are due to their own mistakes and are falsely attributed to Divine destiny. All that is ascribed to God in this world, they say, is only because the people of past ages were unaware of the physical causes of all phenomena and labelled all that was beyond the limit of their utmost and exhaustive efforts as 'God and destiny'. Now, when people come to fully recognize the chain of physical causes, these half-baked ideas will disappear on their own.

Thus, it should be considered whether these statements of European and American philosophers amount to a claim to 'Divinity' or something else? This is indeed why they are

preoccupied with the thought of somehow being able to bring even the dead back to life and a group of Christian philosophers is conducting experiments regarding these very initiatives. The enterprise for bringing down rain has already commenced, and it is their desire that instead of people praying to God Almighty for rain or offering the *Ṣalatul-Istisqā'* [Prayer for Rain], they should simply apply to the Government asking it to cause rain to fall on such and such a piece of farmland. Moreover, efforts are being made in Europe to invent some instrument to place the male semen in the womb of a woman, as well as to bring forth a male or female child at will and to induce pregnancy in a woman by injecting a quantity of semen into her womb. Now, it should be considered whether this amounts to an effort to usurp the power of God or is it something else?

As regards the words in the *aḥādīth* about the *Dajjāl* laying claim first to Prophethood and then to Divinity,<sup>1</sup> if this is taken to mean that the *Dajjāl* would first, for a few days, lay claim to Prophethood and then to Divinity, such a meaning would clearly be false. This is so because the person who makes a claim to Prophethood must necessarily affirm the existence of God Almighty and, moreover, make the statement that he receives revelation from God Almighty. Furthermore, he should recite to the people the words which have been revealed to him by God Almighty and bring into being a body of followers who consider him to be a Prophet and his book to be the Book of Allah.

Now, it needs to be understood how such a claimant could make a claim to be God before this very body of followers. These people would surely call him a great liar and say that he used to declare his belief in God Almighty and used to recite

1. *Fathul-Bārī Sharḥ Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī*, Juzw 13, p. 113, *Kitābul-Fitan*, Bāb Dhikr ad-Dajjāl, Hadith 7131 [Publisher]



the words of God to them but is now denying all of that and is making himself into God. They would say that his own declaration prove him to be a liar with regard to his very first claim, so how is it possible to believe in the truth of his second claim? How can he who has declared his faith in God Almighty, said that he is a servant of God, and has published a lot of his revelations among the people saying that this is the Word of God Almighty—how can such an individual be considered to be God after he disavows all these declarations? And who will accept such a patent liar? Consequently, these interpretations of our ulema are quite invalid.

The correct interpretation is that by the claim to Prophethood is meant interfering in the functions of Prophethood, and by the claim to Divinity is meant interference in the works of God. These are precisely the activities that the Christians are indulging in these days. A group of them is interfering with the Gospel as if they were charged with prophetic functions and revelation was being sent down to them. A group of them is interfering in the works of God to such a degree as if they are seeking to take control of the functions of Divinity.

In short, this Antichrist character of the Christians has reached its height in this age and they have spent their wealth without any regard in establishing it, and they have affected tens of millions of people badly by it. Through their speech and through their writing, through money, through women, through song, through music, through showing spectacles, through being called doctors—in short, they have cast their influence upon every country in every respect and in every way and by every means. Thus, some sixty million books have been composed to spread the unholy idea of the worship of Jesus throughout the world.

Thus, the soul of the Messiah experienced a zealous

outpouring a second time during this era and desired his descent again into the world through a substitute. And when this desire reached its climax, God Almighty, in accord with this desire of his, raised one who was his spiritual reflection to defeat the Antichrist of this age. This spiritual reflection, by coming in the likeness of the Messiah, peace be upon him, is called the Promised Messiah, for he has in him the substance and essence of the attributes of 'Īsā [Jesus]. This means that he has become one with the essence of 'Īsā, his birth being the consequence of the fervent demand of the spirit of the Messiah. Accordingly, the essence of the attributes of 'Īsā were reflected in him akin to the images of objects reflected in a mirror. And because that counterpart has come in response to the zealous outpouring of the spirituality of the Messiah, he has been so named after 'Īsā, for the spirituality of Ḥaḍrat 'Īsā, through its zealous outpouring, desired the All-Powerful God, glorified be His name, to make a likeness of him and requested Him to place in that likeness the substance of the qualities of 'Īsā so that his likeness may appear in the world. Accordingly, this is what transpired.

This discourse also answers the question as to why the Messiah was singled out for the descent; why was it not said that Moses or Abraham or David would descend? The reason, as has been clearly explained, is that on account of the current mischiefs, it was necessary that the Messiah should indeed be the one to descend. The people of the Messiah were the ones who had gone astray and the ones among whom the qualities of the Antichrist had spread. Therefore, it was only proper that the soul of the Messiah should have been moved.

This is the subtle spiritual insight that has been conferred upon this humble one through a vision. It has also been disclosed to me that, after a time of piety and purity and the supremacy of Divine *Tauḥīd* [the Oneness of God], the world will again return to mischief, *shirk* [polytheism], and transgression.

Some will devour others like insects, ignorance will prevail, the Messiah will be worshipped once again, and the error of creature-worship will again spread with great force. And all this mischief will spread in the world through the Christian faith in the last part of these Latter Days. Then again, the soul of the Messiah will be greatly troubled and will seek its descent in a majestic form. Then, with the advent of an awe-striking semblance of his, this age will come to an end. That will be the end and the expanse of the world will be rolled up. This shows that on account of the unworthy behaviour of the followers of the Messiah, it had been decreed that the spirituality of the Messiah should descend into the world three times.

In this context a point worth noting is that the spirituality of our Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, also keeps appearing in the world during the upsurge of internal mischiefs in Islam, and the essence of the spirituality of Muhammad<sup>sas</sup> manifests itself always in the person of one of his perfect followers. It is found in the *aḥādīth* that: 'A **Mahdi** would be born. His name would be the same as my name, and his character would be the same as my character.'<sup>1</sup> If these *aḥādīth* are true, then it is to this very spiritual descent that they allude.

This descent is, however, not limited to one specific individual. There have been hundreds of such people who possessed the spiritual essence of Muhammad<sup>sas</sup> and their name, by way of reflection, was **Muhammad** or **Ahmad** in the sight of God. But by the grace of the Exalted Being, the followers of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, who enjoy the mercy of Allah, have remained free from the mischiefs which were suffered by the followers of Ḥaḍrat 'Īsā. To

1. *Mishkātul-Maṣābīḥ*, vol. 2, p. 294, *Kitābur-Riqāq*, Bāb Ashrāṭus-Sā'ah, Hadith 5462, published by Dārul-Kutub al-'Ilmiyyah, Beirut [Publisher]

this day, thousands of good and righteous persons are to be found among the Muslims who have turned their back upon the wretched world; and five times a day, the *Adhān* of the *Tauḥīd* [Oneness] of God so reverberates from the mosques that the rays of the *Tauḥīd* of God as proclaimed by Muhammad reach up to the very heavens.

So what occasion was there for the spirit of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, to become so agitated, as there was for the spirit of the Messiah—occasion for which had been created by the offensive preaching of the Christians, their hateful deeds, their polytheistic teachings, their interference with the functions of Prophethood, and their setting up equals with God? In this age such agitation for his followers could also not have arisen in the spirit of Ḥaḍrat Mūsā [Moses], for they have become almost extinct, and today there are no more than a few hundred thousand of his followers upon the surface of the earth, and even they merit the description:

ضُرِبَتْ عَلَيْهِمُ الذَّلَالَةُ وَالْمَسْكَنَةُ<sup>1</sup>

[They were smitten with abasement and destitution], and they are immersed in worldliness and are despised in people's eyes.

But the Christians number more than four hundred million in this age and they are very aggressively spreading their corrupt beliefs, and are attempting hundreds of different ways for their devilish designs to find a home in the hearts of the people—some are roaming about as preachers, some are singers, some are poets publishing poems on the Christian creed of the Trinity, some have become Yogis to spread their beliefs, some have taken upon themselves the duty of translating their

1. *Sūrah al-Baqarah*, 2:62 [Publisher]

interpolated Gospels into all the languages of the world and compiling books against Islam in every language, and distributing them over the whole world, and some portray an unfavourable picture of Islam in peoples' mind through theatrical plays. Tens of millions of rupees are spent in such endeavours.

Some have formed an army which they call the Salvation Army; they go about in all countries. Similarly, there are many other ways whereby their men and their women have caused harm to tens of millions of people. The matter has now reached an extreme. It was necessary, therefore, that in this age, the spirit of the Messiah should have been moved and agitated and demanded the descent of a similitude having the closest affinity with itself. This is, therefore, a great Sign for recognizing the truth of my humble self, but only for those who understand.

The Sufis of Islam are accustomed to seeking spiritual benefit from the tombs of the dead, and also believe that it so happens sometimes that the spirituality of a deceased Prophet or saint is united with a living servant of God. They describe this phenomenon by saying that a particular saint has come in the footsteps of Moses or in the footsteps of Abraham. They also use the phrases 'of the disposition of Muhammad' or 'of the disposition of Abraham'. They should certainly attend to this profound insight of spiritual knowledge.

3. **THE THIRD SIGN** of this humble one's truth is that some men of God gave news of this humble one's appearance many years before my advent, to the extent that they have mentioned my name, place of residence, and age in detail. I have already written this in [my book] *Nishān-e-Āsmānī* [*The Heavenly Sign*].
4. **THE FOURTH SIGN** of this humble one's truth is that I dispatched about 12,000 letters and public announcement notices to members of other faiths to call them to a spiritual contest based on the gift

of revelation. In particular, from among the Christian clergy, it is likely that not a single notable clergyman of Europe or America or India was omitted from being sent a registered letter, but all were overawed by truth. For our mullahs and *maulawīs* to now criticize this challenge really amounts to lying and eating filth. I have been given a definite glad tiding that if any opponent of the Faith comes forward against me, I shall prevail against him and he will be humiliated. Why don't these people who call themselves Muslims and who look upon me with suspicion arrange a contest between me and some Christian clergyman of the time? They might tell some clergyman or some pundit that: 'this man is, in reality, an impostor and there is absolutely no likelihood of any harm in doing battle with him; we take the responsibility'. Then will God Almighty settle the affair Himself. I, for my part, agree that in the event I am proven to be a liar, I shall make over all my worldly possessions—namely, land etc., which have come into my possession through inheritance—to that clergyman or pundit; but, if it is the latter who is proven to be a liar, I shall not ask anything of him except that he embrace Islam. This is a determination I have made firmly in my mind, and I have stated it from the bottom of my heart. I declare in the name of Allah, glorified be His eminence, that I am fully prepared for this contest and ready to issue a public announcement in this connection. As a matter of fact, I have already issued 12,000 public announcement notices and have exhausted myself inviting people again and again, but no pundit or Christian clergyman has come forward with sincere intentions. What can be a greater proof of my truth than that I am ready to always engage in this contest? If a pundit or clergyman does not make any claim to being able to show any Sign against me, he can simply publish a one-sided declaration in a newspaper that he is ready to witness some extraordinary happening and if such extraordinary happening does take place, which he is unable to match, he would forthwith embrace Islam. I would be agreeable to accepting even such an arrangement. Let someone

from among the Muslims make the effort and put the one whom they call a faithless *kāfir* [disbeliever] and a *dajjāl* [deceiver] to a test against some Christian clergyman, while he himself would only have to watch the spectacle.

5. **THE FIFTH SIGN** of my truth is that I have been told that I shall also prevail over these Muslims in the sphere of my visions and revelations. Those from among them who claim to be recipients of revelation should, therefore, come forward in opposition to me. Then, if they prevail against me in Divine support, heavenly bounties, and heavenly Signs, I agree to being slaughtered with the knife of their choice. And if they do not possess the strength to compete with me, then I call upon those who have declared me a *kāfir* [disbeliever] and for challenging whom I have been granted permission through revelation, that they should agree in writing beforehand, which should be published, that if they witness a miraculous Sign they would accept my claim without any further ado. I am ready for this task also and my Noble God is with me but I have been commanded that I should enter into such a contest only with the leaders of those who have declared me a *kāfir*. I should hold the *mubāhalah* only with them, and if they so wish, I shall enter this contest with them alone. It must be noted, however, that they would never come forward for this contest, for truth has struck terror into their hearts, and they are well aware of their transgression and excess. They will also certainly not come forward for *mubāhalah*, but I shall, for my part, shortly issue public announcement notices to them in my book, *Dāfi'ul-Wasāwis* ['Remover of Misgivings']. As for the common people, who are not among the leaders or men of learning, nor have they issued any edict against me, the Divine commandment to me concerning them is that if they wish to see miraculous Signs, they should come and stay in my company. God Almighty is Self-Sufficient and Independent. He does not attend to anyone until He witnesses lowliness and humbleness of heart in

them, but He will not let this humble one go to waste and will fully establish His argument upon the world and will show His Signs before too long. Nonetheless, blessed are those who accept before the manifestation of Signs, for they are the beloved servants of God Almighty and they are the truthful without any imposture. Those who ask for Signs will bitterly regret their failure to attain the pleasure of God which was attained by those eminent people who accepted based on [preponderance of] indications and did not ask for any Sign.

Hence, it is worth remembering that Almighty God will not leave this, His Movement, without the support of proofs. He has Himself said, and it has been recorded in *Barāhīn-e-Aḥmadiyya* that:

دنیا میں ایک نذیر آیا پر دنیا نے اس کو قبول نہ کیا لیکن خدا اسے قبول کرے گا اور بڑے  
زور آور حملوں سے اس کی سچائی ظاہر کرے گا۔

[A Warner came unto the world but the world accepted him not; yet God shall accept him and demonstrate his truthfulness with mighty assaults.]

There is disgrace and abasement in store for those who have denied, and for those who are only too ready to deny. They did not even consider that if all this had been a man-made affair it would have been destroyed long ago; for, Almighty God is such an enemy of an impostor, that no one in the world has such an enemy. These foolish people do not even consider whether such perseverance and boldness can be found in an impostor. These ignorant people also do not know that only that person who speaks from a Divine sanctuary can have the distinction that there should be majesty and awe in his words, and only such a



one can have the courage and fortitude to be ready to oppose the whole world despite being a solitary individual.

Await, therefore, with certainty, for the days are coming—nay, they are close at hand—when the enemy shall be humiliated and friends shall be exceedingly happy. Who is a friend? The very one who accepted me before seeing a Sign and who dedicated his life, property, and honour as if he had seen thousands of Signs. So, this indeed is my Jamā'at and they belong to me for they found me alone and helped me, they saw me sorrowful and shared my sorrow, though unacquainted with me, they honoured me as an acquaintance—may God Almighty bestow His mercy upon them!

What shall it matter to me if someone accepts an open truth after seeing Signs and what reward will accrue to such a one and what honour can such a one have in the sight of the Lord of Honour? In essence, they alone have accepted me who have seen me through a keen vision, who weighed my claims in the balance of discernment, who studied my circumstances and listened to my words and pondered over them. And thus, God Almighty opened their breasts based only on such indications, and they joined me. Only he is with me who gives up his own desires for the sake of my wishes, who takes me for an arbiter regarding what his soul adopts or abandons, who treads upon my path, who annihilates himself in rendering obedience to me, and who divests himself of all self-conceit.

I have to say it with a deep sigh that those who demand manifest Signs cannot attain such praiseworthy titles and honourable ranks in the presence of my God which will be apportioned to those who were able to recognize a concealed secret and who were able to discern the fragrance of one who was hidden under the 'mantle' of Allah, glorified be His eminence. What excellence is there in a man who, for example, upon seeing a prince marching along with his army in great pomp and

splendour submits his greeting of peace to him? The man possessing excellence is the one who finds such a prince in the garb of a beggar yet recognizes him.

It is, however, not in my power to bestow such discernment upon anyone. There is only One who bestows; He gives understanding of faith to him whom He holds dear. Those who are guided aright are guided aright by precisely these kinds of realizations, but these very realizations make those who have a crookedness in their hearts to become even more crooked.

I believe I have now written a great deal on the question of Signs, and God Almighty knows that it is perfectly true and correct that up till now God has caused approximately 3,000 or more such phenomena to occur which are beyond human capability, and such phenomena will not cease to occur in the future. It is disrespectful to indulge in petty talk of time limits in connection with these Signs; Almighty God is Self-Sufficient and Independent. When the disbelievers of **Makkah** would ask the Holy Prophet, peace and the blessings of Allah be upon him, when the Signs would appear, Almighty God never replied that they would appear on such and such a date because this question was highly disrespectful and impertinent.

Man spends years waiting regarding petty and worthless affairs of this world. He prepares for years for an examination, he starts construction of those buildings that will take years to complete, he sows such plants in gardens to eat the fruits of which it is necessary to wait for years—so why does he show such haste in matters pertaining to God Almighty? The only reason for this is that religion is considered to be a plaything. Man demands a Sign from God Almighty but does not make up his mind as to what strenuous efforts he will undertake in His way after seeing a Sign: how much of worldliness he will relinquish, and how far will he walk in the footsteps of the one

appointed by God Almighty. On the contrary, the heedless man regards a Sign as some sort of a spectacle.

The Disciples of Jesus had asked him for a Sign, that food should descend for them from heaven so that some of the suspicions that they harboured against him might be removed. Accordingly, Allah, glorified be His eminence, narrates His response to Ḥaḍrat ‘Īsā in the Noble Quran: ‘Tell them that I will manifest this Sign but then if, after that, someone does not believe in Me as he should, I will inflict such chastisement upon them as was not inflicted upon anyone before.’ On hearing this, the Disciples repented of their demand for a Sign.

God Almighty says that whichever nation We have inflicted chastisement upon, We have done so only after the showing of a Sign. And He states in many places of the Noble Quran that the manifestation of a Sign is a prelude to punishment. The reason for this is that it becomes incumbent upon the one who asks for a Sign to renounce the love of the world forthwith after seeing it, and to don the clothes of a beggar, and after seeing the glory and majesty of God, render unto Him what is His due. But since a heedless man cannot render this measure of obedience, demanding a Sign as a condition for acceptance becomes a misfortune for him, because after seeing a Sign, God’s argument becomes established against him. That is indeed why, if he still falls short of rendering perfect obedience, the wrath of Allah overtakes him and destroys him.

Your third question relates to *Istikhārah* [Prayer seeking guidance and goodness], which, in reality, is *Istikhbārah* [Prayer seeking information]. Let it be clear, the difficulties which you have written about are not, in fact, encountered in *Istikhārah*. The meaning of what I wrote is only this much that *Istikhārah* should be performed under such conditions when the sentiments of love or hostility are not in a state of excitement due

to factors motivating such excitement. For instance, a man who is hostile to another man goes to sleep while excited with anger or feelings of enmity; then, perchance, his enemy may appear to him in a dream in the form of, say, a dog, a pig, or some other wild animal. He might surmise that his enemy is really a dog or a pig in the sight of God, but this idea of his would be wrong, for when feelings of enmity are prominent, the enemy very often appears in a dream in the shape of some wild animal or a snake. It is wrong to conclude therefrom that the man is really a bad man because he has appeared in that form. In fact, because in the estimation of the man who sees him in that form, he is like a wild animal, so he appears to him in the shape of a wild animal in his dream. So, what I mean is, that the man who sees a dream should be free from the promptings of his self and should go conduct the *Istikhārah* with a peaceful mind, with his heart turned entirely towards God, seeking only to find out the truth.

I cannot give the assurance that everyone will necessarily see a dream in whatever good or bad state he may be, but regarding you I can say that if you perform the *Istikhārah* for forty days with your mind turned to God in accordance with the conditions laid down in the [book] *Nishān-e-Āsmānī* [*The Heavenly Sign*], I will address a prayer in your behalf. It would be well and good if this *Istikhārah* was performed in my presence so that I should be able to pay more attention to you. For you, it is not at all difficult; people sometimes go to perform non-obligatory Hajj for minor reasons, but here the reward is greater than the reward for non-obligatory Hajj, and if one is careless, there is the danger of incurring loss and harm because this Movement is heavenly and the commandment is emanating from God.

A true dream demonstrates the signs of its own truth; it affects the heart as if a light has fallen upon it, and pierces

through it like an iron peg. The heart accepts it and its light and majesty permeate through one's whole being. I make the promise with you that if you go through this affair in my presence and under my instruction and advice, I will make strenuous efforts for you, because I entertain the very best sentiments regarding you, and desire from God Almighty that He may not let you go to waste, and that He may foster your righteousness and good fortune. I have taken much of your time, so now I close. وَالسَّلَامُ عَلَى مَنِ اتَّبَعَ الْهُدَى. [And peace be upon those who follow the guidance].

After reading your letter again, I noticed that there is one thing which appears in need of attention in greater detail; namely, your request for such prayer as may render everyone's *Istikhārah* free from the interference of Satan. My dear friend, such a thing is against the law of nature of God Almighty that He should remove Satans from their assigned stations. Allah, glorified be His eminence, says in the Noble Quran:

وَمَا أَرْسَلْنَا مِنْ قَبْلِكَ مِنْ رَّسُولٍ وَلَا نَبِيٍّ إِلَّا إِذَا تَمَنَّى أَلْقَى الشَّيْطَانُ فِي أُمُورِهِ فَیَسْخُ اللَّهُ مَا يُلْقِي الشَّيْطَانُ ثُمَّ یَحْكُمُ اللَّهُ أَلَيْسَ بِاللَّهِ عَلِيمٌ حَكِيمٌ<sup>1</sup>

Meaning: We have not sent any such Messenger or Prophet, whose condition should not have been such that when he wishes for something—meaning when he desired for something upon the prompting of his soul—that Satan would not mix something in it. In other words, when a Messenger or a Prophet seeks something by the promptings of his own soul, Satan mixes something in his desires as well, but then, *wahye-matlūw*—which possesses glory, majesty, and perfect light—removes that interference and makes the Divine will

1. *Sūrah al-Ḥajj*, 22:53 [Publisher]

manifest with full clarity. This is an indication to the fact that the thoughts that arise in the heart of a Prophet and whatever thinking develops in his mind are really all revelations, and the Noble Quran testifies to this:

وَمَا يَنْطِقُ عَنِ الْهَوَىٰ ۝ إِنْ هُوَ إِلَّا وَحْيٌ يُوحَىٰ ۝<sup>1</sup>

But the revelation of the Noble Quran is entirely distinguishable from the other revelations which are only of the nature of meanings revealed from Allah. All of the Prophet's own statements are included in *ghair matlūw wahy* [revelation which is not recited], for the blessing and brilliance of the Holy Spirit always encompass the circumstances of the Prophet and every word of his is filled with blessing, and that blessing is placed within that speech by the Holy Spirit. Hence, every word that issues forth from the mouth of a Prophet with his full attention and full application of mind is *wahy* [revelation] without a doubt. All the *ahādīth* are included in this very stage of *wahy*, which is called *wahye ghair matlū*.

Now, Allah the Glorious states in the verse pointed out earlier that in some ways even the influence of Satan occurs within this lower grade of *wahy*—which is called *hadith*—and when a Prophet desires anything from his own self, it is at that moment that his *ijtihād* [interpretive judgement] errs. And a Prophet's error of *ijtihād* is essentially an error of *wahy*, because a Prophet is never without *wahy*—he loses his self and becomes like an instrument in the hand of God Almighty. Therefore, since every word from his mouth is *wahy*, it is for this reason that

1. Nor does he speak out of *his own* desire. It is nothing but *pure* revelation *that has been* revealed by God (*Sūrah an-Najm*, 53:4–5). [Publisher]

if there is an error in his *ijtihād*, it would be called an error of *wahy*; not an error of *ijtihād*.

Now, God Almighty, in answer to this very question, says in the Noble Quran that sometimes this kind of *wahy* of the Prophet—which may otherwise be termed *ijtihād*—gets mixed up with the suggestion of Satan. And this happens at the time when a Prophet desires something to happen in a certain way, so then exactly such a thought passes through his heart, and he makes up his mind fully along those lines. It is then that the greater *Wahy*—which is the Word of God, *Wahye Matlū*, and is protected [from error]—immediately informs the Prophet of his mistake. *Wahye Matlū* is absolutely pure of Satan's interference because it holds within itself a striking awe, a majestic grandeur, and brilliance and is a burdensome word that descends with great intensity as well. Its overpowering rays scorch Satan, who, therefore, flees from its mere mention and cannot come near it. Moreover, angels protect it perfectly on all sides, but *wahye ghair matlū*, the non-verbal revelation, which also includes the Prophet's *ijtihād*, does not maintain such vigour. Therefore, when a desire arises in the mind of a Prophet or a Messenger, which sometimes accompanies the exercise of his judgement, there may be an interference by Satan, but then *Wahye Matlū* removes that interference. This is indeed why the Prophets made mistakes in their judgement on some occasions, which, however, was corrected afterwards.

Now, the gist of all this is that it is the law of nature of God Almighty, as is made clear by the Noble Quran, that an interference can also be caused by Satan in one type of revelation of a Prophet or indeed a Messenger, which is *wahye ghair matlū* [non-recited revelation]. This being the case, how then can it be permissible for anyone else to pray for a change in this law of God? Quite apart from all this, the clarity and truth of a dream depends upon one's own inner holiness, truthfulness,

and purity. This is indeed the eternal law of nature which has been handed down to us through His Noble Messenger, that for experiencing true dreams, it is essential for man, in his waking state, to always be truthful and virtuous for the sake of God Almighty. And there is no doubt that anyone who obeys this rule—completely and entirely adhering to righteousness of speech, conduct, and thinking—will experience true dreams. Allah, glorified be His eminence, says:

قَدْ أَفْلَحَ مَنْ زَكَّاهَا<sup>1</sup>

Meaning that the person who purifies himself from evil thoughts, evil intentions, evil actions, and evil beliefs, will be freed from the bond of Satan, and will be saved from punishment in the Hereafter and Satan will not be able to overpower him. Similarly, in another place He says:

إِنَّ عِبَادِي لَيْسَ لَكَ عَلَيْهِمْ سُلْطَانٌ<sup>2</sup>

Meaning that: 'O Satan, you cannot rule over My servants who tread upon the paths of My pleasure.' Therefore, until a man forsakes all crooked ways, unworthy thoughts, and absurd customs, and comes to prostrate himself only upon the threshold of God, there subsists a similarity between him and some habit of Satan. And because of this similarity, Satan turns to him and hastens towards him. So long as this is the condition, what action can I possibly take against this Divine law of nature to ensure that Satan should stay away from someone in his dream? Satan himself avoids the one who walks upon the path of the Gracious God.

1. *Sūrah ash-Shams*, 91:10 [Publisher]

2. *Sūrah al-Hijr*, 15:43 [Publisher]



Now, it may be asked that when there is no absolute security from the interference of Satan, how can we rely on our dreams being from the Gracious God? Is it not possible that we may perceive a dream to be from the Gracious God while it is actually from Satan, or we may think a dream to be from Satan while it was really from God? The answer to such a misgiving is that a dream from the Gracious God can be recognized by its own majesty, blessed influence, grandeur, and resplendence. Anything which issues forth from a holy spring possesses holiness and fragrance within it, and anything which originates from impure and filthy water, its filth and stench are discerned immediately.

True dreams which originate from God Almighty are like a sacred message. They are not accompanied by a bundle of scattered thoughts. They inherently possess the capability to impact; hearts are drawn to them and the soul bears witness that such a dream is from Allah because its greatness and glory pierces into the heart like an iron nail. And it often happens that someone sees a true dream, and God Almighty shows the same or a similar dream to one of his companions to make him a witness to it. Thus, the dream acquires added strength from the dream of the other person. Therefore, it would be better for you to make some friend of yours a 'dream companion'—someone who has the necessary aptitude and purity of heart—and tell him that if he sees any dream, he should write it down and show the writing to you, and you too should write down your dream and show it to him. Then, if your dream is true, hopefully the two dreams will have several common features which will have such a striking similarity that it will amaze you.

Alas, if you could have made such an intention in my presence I would have the strong hope that some extraordinary event would be manifested. I am going through a wonderful experience: some days Divine revelations rain down upon me

and some prophecies are such that they are fulfilled within a mere minute, while others come to fruition after a long duration. He who stays with me will not be deprived; he will surely witness some Signs of support from Allah, which would be enough for a man of penetrating vision. I now see continuously that some event is about to happen; I cannot say with certainty whether it would be soon or after some delay, but some preparation is afoot in heaven so that God Almighty may prove the guilt of the doubters and may disgrace them. There is hardly any day or night that I am not granted assurance. While I was writing this very letter, I received this revelation:

يَجِيئُ الْحَقُّ وَيُكْشَفُ الصَّدُّ وَيُخْسَرُ الْخَاسِرُونَ. يَأْتِي قَمَرُ الْأَنْبِيَاءِ وَأَمْرُكَ يَتَأْتِي. إِنَّ  
رَبَّكَ فَعَالٌ لِّمَا يُرِيدُ.

Meaning that: Truth will come and truthfulness will be laid open. Those who have suffered the loss due to ill-will, will also suffer the loss through humiliation and disrespect. The moon of the Prophets will come and your affair will become manifest. Your Lord does whatever He determines.

However, I cannot say when this will happen. Allah has no use for one who is in a hurry. He is Self-Sufficient and is not dependent upon anyone else. He does everything with wisdom and appropriateness. He tries a person and then displays His support. If Signs had been shown at the very beginning, what difference would there have been between the faith of the Great Companions and *Ahle-Bait* [the members of the household of the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>] on the one side, and the faith of the other people on the other? God Almighty delays the Signs for a while to manifest the honour of those who are dear and beloved to Him, so that people may realize that the elect of God are not in need of any Signs, and so that their sound judgement and far-sightedness may become manifest to all, and no one should doubt their high rank. In the early days of his preaching, seventy-two people left the Messiah

[Jesus], peace be upon him, and turned apostate, because they alleged that he had not shown any Sign. Twelve from among the early ones remained steadfast, but one of these also renounced him later. Those who remained steadfast saw many Signs later and were counted among the truthful ones in the sight of Allah.

I would like to say to you again that if you come and stay with me for forty days, I am sure that my company and nearness will impact you. Though I cannot hold out any promise, yet my heart testifies that something will certainly be manifested that will draw you towards certainty. I can see that something is about to happen, but, for now—in accordance with His eternal practice—God Almighty wills to bring into being two groups—first, those who are flocking to me on account of the blessing of virtuous thinking, and second, those who are drifting away from me as a consequence of the evil of suspicion.

And I was sorry to read your statement that mere dialogue will not result in anything decisive. Out of mere love, kindness, and sympathy, I wish to bring to your attention that most of the matters of this world are indeed decided through dialogue, so much so that on the strength of mere verbal proof—or lack of proof—a court of law can, in all serenity, pass the death sentence against one person while acquitting another of murder.

All legal cases are decided upon the proof or want of proof of facts; no party is asked to show a heavenly Sign before judgment is given in his favour, nor is a defendant asked to demonstrate a miracle before the case against him is dismissed. As a matter of fact, if a plaintiff, instead of proving his case, makes a serpent out of a needle or makes a pigeon out of a piece of paper and makes it fly in the air in the view of the court, no judge will give him a favourable decree merely on those grounds, unless the validity of the claim is proven and the facts are examined.

Thus, it is necessary to examine the facts. And my own statement is that all my claims are proven based on the Holy

Quran, *ahādīth* of the Holy Prophet, and the prophecies of the saints who have gone before. And all that my opponents wish to do by way of bringing the original Messiah [Jesus] back down into the world through unwarranted interpretations is not only stained by the lack of evidence, but this impossible thought is opposed to the manifest texts of the Noble Quran—and there is so much mischief and so much evil in every single aspect of it that it would be impossible for someone who keeps all this in view to say anything but that it is manifestly false. So, how can we call all these truths, subtle insights of knowledge, proofs, and arguments mere useless dialogue? The Noble Quran itself is apparently only a form of dialogue and yet it is a miracle of magnificent rank surpassing all other miracles. Rational proofs are indeed necessary in the first stage; for, without them, Signs are of no avail. It must be noted that the proofs upon the basis of which defendants are sentenced to death in the courts—those proofs are not stronger than these proofs which I have with me from the Quran, Hadith, and the sayings of the great holy guides and the noble saints, but it is necessary to ponder over them and to listen to what I say.

I have laid out these proofs clearly in my book *Ā'ina-e-Kamālāt-e-Islām*, and I have shown clearly and manifestly that those people who are wasting their time and life in the hopes that the Messiah will come again into this world with his earthly body, have indeed gone far away from the intent of the Word of God, and how they are surrounded by mischief and evil of every type. I have proven in this book that there is mention of the **Promised Messiah** in the Noble Quran and also of the *Dajjāl* [Antichrist], but the manner in which that mention is made in the Noble Quran will only be authentic and correct, if, by the Promised Messiah, is meant a like of the Messiah who should appear from this very Ummah, and if, moreover, the *Dajjāl* is taken to mean a group of people. The

word *Dajjāl* itself means a group of people. Without a doubt, our opponents have adopted for themselves an error that is the cause of great disgrace; they have, so to speak, set the Quran and the Hadith aside. Due to their extreme degree of foolishness they do not awaken from their error and take pride in their dense and superficial ideas. However, the time is drawing near when they will be put to shame.

I do not know what effect this letter will have upon your heart, but I have drawn a true picture before you. A personal meeting is extremely necessary. I would like you, in any way possible, to definitely come and attend the *Jalsa* of 27 December 1892. Allah the Almighty willing, it will greatly benefit you. The journey which is taken for the sake of Allah is a kind of worship in the sight of Allah. I close with the prayer:

—**أَيَّدْكُمُ اللَّهُ مِنْ عِنْدِهِ وَرَزَمَكُمُ فِي الدُّنْيَا وَالْآخِرَةِ.** [May Allah strengthen you from Himself and have mercy on you in this world and the Hereafter!]

With greetings of peace.

Humbly,

**Ghulam Ahmad**, from Qadian, District Gurdaspur  
(10 December 1892)

چون مرا نوری پئی قومی مسیحی داده اند  
مصلحت را ابن مریم نام من بنهاده اند

*Since I have been granted a light for the Christian nation,  
That is why I have been called Ibn-e-Maryam [Son of Mary].*

می در خشم چون قمر تابم چو قرص آفتاب  
کور چشم آنانکه در انکارها افتاده اند

*I am bright like the moon and am radiant like the sun—  
Those who are embroiled in rejecting me are blind.*

بشنوید ای طالبان کز غیب بکنند این ندا  
مصلحتی باید که در هر جا مفاسد زاده اند

*O seekers! Listen. A voice is proclaiming from the unseen:  
A Reformer is needed because there is corruption all  
around.*

صادقم و از طرف مولیٰ با نشاها آدم  
صد در علم و هدیٰ بر روی من بکشاده اند

*I am truthful and have been raised by the Lord with many Signs;  
Hundreds of doors of knowledge and guidance have been  
manifested to me.*

آسمان بارد نشان اَلوقت میگوید زمین  
این دو شاهد از پئی تصدیق من استاده اند

*The heaven is raining Signs and the earth is proclaiming that  
this is the time—*

*These two witnesses are standing upright to give testimony for  
me.*

# AT-TABLĪGH<sup>1</sup>

[*Conveying the Message*]

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ<sup>2</sup>  
نَحْمَدُهُ وَنُصَلِّي<sup>3</sup>

*To the descendants of pīrs, devotees engaged in prostrations,  
faqīrs involved in deviant practices, ascetics, sufis, and  
those secluding to take care of shrines in Punjab,  
India, Arabian countries, Persia,  
Egypt, Iran, Turkey and  
other countries.*

In a meeting on 11 January 1893, my sincere friend and my beloved for the sake of Allah, Maulawī ‘Abdul-Karīm of Sialkot suggested that a letter be included in this book *Dāfi‘ul-Wasāwis* to those ascetics and descendants of *pīrs* who are engaged day and night in deviant practices and act in complete opposition to the Book of Allah. Moreover, they are not informed of this Movement which has been established by God Almighty Himself.

I really liked this suggestion of Maulawī Ṣāhib. I have written something about the ascetics of the present times during the discussion

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1. The Promised Messiah<sup>as</sup> originally wrote this letter in Arabic; its translation is provided in this section. For the original Arabic text, see *Ā’ina-e-Kamālāt-e-Islām*, Rūḥānī Khazā’in, vol. 5, p. 359–363, Ed. 2021, published by Islam International Publications Ltd. [Publisher]

2. In the name of Allah, the Gracious, the Merciful. [Publisher]

3. We praise Him and invoke His blessings [upon His Noble Messenger]. [Publisher]

about the religious scholars of India and Punjab, but, in agreement with the advice of respected Maulawī Ṣāhib, I deemed it appropriate to write an independent letter to the ascetics who have drifted away from the Shariah and the mighty faith of Islam.

I had intended to compose this letter in **Urdu**, but was made to understand last night by some revelatory indications that I should write this letter in **Arabic**. I also received a revelation that it would have very little effect on my opponents, but the matter would be carried to its completion. It may be that the wisdom in writing in Arabic is that the people who make claims of **asceticism** and **Sufism** have not paid much attention to studying the Holy Quran and learning the Arabic language because of the extremity of their veils, carelessness, and lack of true love. They are liars in their claim because if they loved Allah, glorified be His eminence, and the Messenger, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, they would certainly have made efforts to learn the language in which this lovely and wisdom-filled Word was revealed. And if God Almighty had looked upon them with mercy, He would have granted them the ability to understand His Holy Word. If they had true love for the Holy Quran, they would have put their shrines to flames, and getting weary of those who pledge allegiance to them, they would have spent their time in perusing the knowledge of the Holy Quran and would have acquired proficiency in the language in which the Holy Quran was revealed.

A sufficient testimony to their being deficient in faith and being hypocrites is that they have not honoured the Holy Quran as it deserves to be honoured and have not loved the Holy Quran as it deserves to be loved. Thus, their hypocrisy is exposed.

It should be considered that there are many English **priests**, who have, in their zeal for opposition, learned the Arabic language upon reaching the age of 50 and have learned the meanings of the Holy Quran. Thus, if someone professes to love the Noble Quran, and indeed, styles himself as a *pīr* and *shaikh*, he would be proven a liar in



his claim of asceticism simply because he is lacking the signs of true lovers and is totally bereft of the meanings of the Holy Quran. Every true lover has a zeal to learn the language of the beloved. Therefore, someone who claims to love Allah, but is negligent in learning the Word of Allah, cannot be a true lover, or you may say that his condition is not free from one of the two aspects. [One], He has deliberately avoided learning the meanings and the language of the Holy Quran. If that is the case as I have said earlier, such indifference does not befit the men of God. The men of God have a passionate devotion to the Holy Quran, and the lover cannot bear being away from the beloved. Because of the blessings of the intensity of love, it becomes easy for him to learn the language of the Quran. The paths of acquiring knowledge, which bear hard on others, are easy for them. Since indifference has an element of hypocrisy, this hypocritical characteristic, lethargy and laziness cannot be their trait. The Holy Quran is their life; so how can they be separated from their lives? As a matter of fact, someone who styles himself in the mantle of the men of God, but does not understand the meanings of the Holy Quran, nor has an awareness of its verities and insights, is not a lover of the Holy Quran, but is a satanic jester. If the grace of the Eternal God had been with him, he would not have been deprived of this great wealth. Thus, there is no greater sign for a despised and rejected person than that, being called a Muslim, he is totally unaware of the meanings, necessary knowledge, and miraculous Signs of the Noble Quran.

[Two] The second aspect of such a one may be that he may be very dull, unintelligent, and close to the animals, possessing very little of the human faculties of intelligence and deliberation. As such he might be incapable of acquiring the knowledge of the language of the Holy Quran. Such a one can also not be graced with the noble status of being a *Walī* [i.e. Friend (of Allah)] or attaining the nearness of Allah. Those who consider such a one to be a *Walī* are also not any less than wild animals and donkeys. Because of their extreme dullness,

they fail to understand that someone who is deprived of a basic bounty, which is the pivot of faith, cannot possibly acquire other bounties. If any super-normal matter appears to be displayed by him, it would be a temporary and passing phenomenon not a miracle. There can in no way be such a calamity that somewhat claiming to be a *Walī* be bereft of simple human abilities because the established way of Allah is that those whom He blesses with His bounties also possess an ample share of the human excellences.

This seems to be the wisdom behind the indication given to me by Allah to write this letter in Arabic. Because in His view, people who are bereft of the language and verities of the Holy Quran due to their beliefs or negligence are not worthy of being considered honourable enough to be addressed. Indeed, by their perpetual negligence and love for ignorance, they have set a seal on their lack of love for the Holy Quran.

They actually do not tread the paths of Islam but are floundering on other paths. Even if they acquire some kind of relish, their souls cannot affirm that it is by the blessings of the Holy Quran, because they have no relationship with the Noble Quran, nor do they have any desire for it. Their souls also cannot affirm that they have acquired any status because of the love for the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him. Since they have not loved the Holy Quran perfectly, how can they have perfect love for the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him? The magnificence of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, is displayed by the Holy Quran. Someone who has not witnessed the Holy Quran cannot possibly witness the Holy Prophet. Such people were, therefore, not worthy of being loved and their hypocritical condition was quite obvious. Therefore, it had been considered needless to write them a letter to convey the message.

It is surprising that the followers of such people do not consider that the primary excellence and perfection of a *Walī* lies in being vouchsafed the knowledge of the Holy Quran because it is the commander,

leader, guide, and director of us Muslims. Anyone who is bereft of its knowledge faces death and destruction at every step. A person who has not been blessed and favoured by God with the knowledge of His Holy Word is a deprived being who cannot possibly be the recipient of any other blessing. Allah Himself says that whomsoever I grant true virtue, is granted the knowledge of the Quran, and whoever has been granted the knowledge of the Holy Quran has acquired something that cannot be matched by anything else.

I trust that every true Muslim will agree with this statement of mine. The exception of the one who has a hidden idol under his sleeve and is deprived of true love and devotion for the Holy Quran. Now I start the Arabic letter at the next page.



And it is the following:<sup>1</sup>

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ<sup>2</sup>

## **To the Eminent Leaders and Scholars of India & Mystics of Afghanistan and Egypt & Other Nations!**

All praise belongs to Allah whose mercy overwhelms His wrath in every act and decree of His, and His light triumphs over every dark and desolate night. Allah is the One from whom descends a host of comforts in every adversity that befalls. Every leaf that clings upon trees, every lightning that flashes amidst mountains, the alternation of days and nights that you observe—everything found upon the earth [below] and the heavens [above] beckons His mercy. Among the Signs of His mercy is that He has sent Messengers and raised Warners, and He has laid the foundations of the edifices of guidance. Among the Signs of His great mercy is the Full Moon [i.e. the Holy Prophet<sup>as</sup>] who rose from *Ummul-Qurā* [i.e. Makkah] during a night whose long locks had turned blacker. He effaced all darkness and placed a bright lamp in front of every perceiving eye. We suffer a loss of words in expressing our gratitude to Him for His immense blessings. He [the Holy Prophet<sup>as</sup>] awakened all the worlds and removed the slumber from the dozing ones and wholeheartedly embraced every distress and sorrow in the name of religion whenever they occurred and set an example of striving

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1. The Promised Messiah<sup>as</sup> originally wrote this letter in Arabic; its translation is provided in this section. For the original Arabic text, see *Ā'ina-e-Kamālāt-e-Islām*, Rūḥānī Khazā'in, vol. 5, p. 364–419, Ed. 2021, published by Islam International Publications Ltd. [Publisher]

2. In the name of Allah, the Gracious, the Merciful. [Publisher]

in the name of Allah for everyone who seeks the Lord. He lost himself in Allah and strove for Him and called towards Him and purified the earth as much it ought to be. How wonderful is this vibrant one!

O my Lord! Reward him with the best of rewards which You will have ever conferred upon anyone throughout creation; cause us to die in a state of being in his community and resurrect us among his followers and make us drink from his fountain and make it a source for our rejuvenation and make him our intercessor, whose intercession is granted in this world and the Hereafter.

O my Lord! Accept my prayers and shelter me in this heaven.

My Lord! O my Lord! Send down your blessings, peace, and favours upon this compassionate and merciful Prophet and upon all those who love him, obey his command, and follow the guidance.

O the ascetics, the pious and elders of India and other countries, who have indulged in innovative deviations and disorder! Surely, I have been appointed to convey the commandments of the Faith and to remind you of what you have forgotten from the secrets of the Eternal Divine Law. My Lord has revealed to me your affair, saying,

انهم ينادون من مكان بعيد

[They are being called from a place far away, that is, have drifted too far.]

My Lord does what He pleases and He is the Subjugator above all those who subjugate.

O my people! Fear Allah and do not follow the vain desires of the deviating innovators and follow the unlettered Prophet and Messenger who is a mercy for all the worlds. O my brothers! Know for certain that I have been sent as a recipient of Divine revelation to you and to all those who are upon the earth. So fear Him and do not try to humiliate the Messengers, and refrain from the abomination of innovations and abstain from novelties [in the matter of religion], and remain the righteous servants of Allah.

O my people! I am but a servant of Allah who has been gracious unto me with His mercy and has granted me the knowledge of the earlier people. He has sent me at the turn of this century in order to warn those people whose forefathers had not been warned so that the conduct of the sinners be exposed. He called upon me, saying,

قل لعبادى: اننى امرت وأنا أَوَّلُ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ.

[Tell My servants: I have been commissioned and I am the first of the believers.]

He conferred upon me a title that befits the people to whom I have been sent in order to silence them and put them under some conviction. They are Christians who transgressed in the land and deemed the people of truth to be weak, embellishing falsehood so that they might rebut the truth thereby, and they are a people who verily exceed all bounds. They caused many people to perish by their wicked designs and exceeded in their acts of arrogance and devised vicious plots against Islam and attracted people towards their absurd fables as they appeared with manifest deception. Allah looked into their hearts and found them extravagant and deceiving—themselves misled and misleading others. Verily they corrupted all of their ways and rebelled against their Lord and were bent on corrupting other peoples as well. They devour religions as a bullock devours the grass of a field.

They seek self-exaltation and disorder and indeed they are not humble. Their intelligence and intellect have subjected people to a trial and the substance of their deception has grown even bigger. They command deep insight over the sciences and affairs of the world. They ignited the fire of anarchy, causing streams of disorder to flow, and they devised a mighty plan to an extreme that was unprecedented in the machinations of the peoples of times gone by. They gathered their strength to uproot Islam and amassed the milk of she-camels [i.e. they spent their wealth generously] to lure the hearts of the mean, and to capture the hearts [and minds] of Muslims. Their (of Muslims) ulema

were like the destitute in the eyes of their (of Christians) leaders, or like a morsel [trapped] between their teeth, and our people became the object of ridicule for those who mock.

Thus, Allah desired to differentiate between light and darkness and to distinguish between abomination and holiness and to bestow favour upon the weak. He saw their mischief as a great trial for Islam and found their days like dark dreadful nights. He found them a people transgressed in anarchy. No greater mischief has befallen since the day of Adam's creation up to our day; nay, rather, even up to the very Day of Judgment! In spite of this, they became kings, behaved arrogantly in the land, flourished, grew in number, spread over the earth in numbers, and thrived in glory and grandeur. Allah increased them in their assets, offspring, knowledge, arts, and industries. He helped them in their thoughts and insights, and opened the gates of everything for them as a trial. So they turned blind and deaf and indeed they were among the arrogant.

Allah caused the hearts of our ulema and ascetics to deviate, and He extinguished the light of their hearts till they returned to the ignorance from which they were once liberated, for they were among those who create disorder in the earth and were not among the promoters of peace. They became totally absorbed into selfish desires, became weak in perception, slackened, and idle. The whirlwind of ignorance blew away their dust and they were deprived of their abilities, becoming as good as dead. When the Lord looked upon our affluent people, He found them extravagant, heedless, unmindful of righteousness and truth, cruel, and transgressing. Thus, He caused their carnal desires to remain unfulfilled and deprived them of their possessions with which their hearts were bonded. He let many of their possessions and their lands slip away from their hands and destroyed all on which they were relying.

Faces were afflicted with misery and the pangs of starvation, while the fire of the opulent was put out. Their bones were broken and their arrows were shattered to pieces so that their ignoble ones might know



that they were indeed rebellious. The bait of Christians and the net of their chiefs have ensnared them from the depths of the seas to the heights of the skies. Their ships sail through the seas of misguidance. Everything upon the earth trembled in fear of their majesty's splendour, so they fell prostrate before them. No dwelling, hut, or nest was spared from the hands of hunters. These Christians transgressed till they looked into the scriptures of Prophets and interpreted it according to their own views. They added and deleted things therefrom as if they themselves were Prophets and Messengers.

Then they turned towards the sovereignty of Allah and Divine acts. They meddled in such affairs which they had no right to interfere. They were exultant with their plots and believed themselves to be in full command over everything as if they were the God of the worlds. They became indifferent, brazenly transgressing the bounds, and far surpassed the atheists in their pride, disbelief, and narcissism. Indeed, this is what was meant by the proclamation of Prophethood and Divinity [by the Antichrist, mentioned in the Hadith]. Hence, a wise person should easily understand it. The earth became filled with disorder due to their deception and people hastened, save a few, towards their worldly embellishment, elegance, gloss of their fruits, their food, their gardens, and to their charming damsels with the exception of those who were safeguarded by Allah. Allah saves whom He pleases and He is the Best Saviour.

A great storm has swept over the acts of the people and their beliefs, piety, righteousness, intentions, perceptions, deeds, sayings, eyes, ears, religion, faith, morals, the manners of their favours, courtesies, affections, sons, brethren, daughters, women, virtue, insight, hands and their tongues. The wind of disorder blew upon them from every direction and darkness encompassed them from all sides. Creation was shaken with a violent shaking, and their senses were lost and they became like the bewildered. They did not know whether chastisement was intended for those who are in the earth or whether their Lord intends mercy for them. They were looking for the secret of the unseen to be revealed.

Their ark was rent asunder in the ocean of perversity, and the waves raged from all sides and they were well-nigh drowned.

Then, my Lord commanded me from heaven, saying:

إِصْنَعِ الْفُلْكَ بِأَعْيُنِنَا وَوَحْيِنَا وَفَمَّ وَانْذِرْ فَإِنَّكَ مِنَ الْمَأْمُورِينَ. لِيُنْذِرَ قَوْمًا مَّا أُنْذِرَ آبَاؤُهُمْ. وَ لَتَسْتَبِينَ سَبِيلَ الْمُجْرِمِينَ. إِنَّا جَعَلْنَاكَ الْمَسِيحَ ابْنَ مَرْيَمَ لَأَتِمَّ حُجَّتِي عَلَى قَوْمٍ مُتَنَصِّرِينَ. قُلْ هَذَا فَضْلُ رَبِّي. وَ إِنِّي أَجْرُدُ نَفْسِي مِنْ ضُرُوبِ الْخَطَابِ. وَ أَمَرْتُ مِنَ اللَّهِ وَ أَنَا أَوَّلُ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ. إِنَّهُ يَرَى الْأَوْقَاتَ وَ يَغْلَمُ مَصَالِحَهَا. وَ إِنْ مِنْ شَيْءٍ إِلَّا عِنْدَهُ خَزَائِنُهُ إِنَّمَا أَمْرُهُ إِذَا أَرَادَ شَيْئًا أَنْ يَقُولَ لَهُ كُنْ فَيَكُونُ. قُلْ أَتَعْبُدُونَ مِنْ فِعْلِ اللَّهِ. قُلْ هُوَ اللَّهُ أَعْجَبُ الْعَجَائِبِ. يَرْفَعُ مَنْ يَشَاءُ وَيَضَعُ مَنْ يَشَاءُ وَ يُعِزُّ مَنْ يَشَاءُ وَ يُذِلُّ مَنْ يَشَاءُ وَ يَجْتَبِي إِلَيْهِ مَنْ يَشَاءُ. لَا يُسْئَلُ عَمَّا يَفْعَلُ وَهُمْ مِنَ الْمَسْئُولِينَ. قُلِ الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ الَّذِي أَذْهَبَ عَنِّي الْحَزْنَ وَ أَغْطَانِي مَا لَمْ يَغْطِ أَحَدٌ مِنَ الْعَالَمِينَ. وَقَالُوا كِتَابٌ مُنْتَلَى مِنَ الْكُفْرِ وَ الْكَذِبِ. قُلْ تَعَالَوْا نَدْعُ أَبْنَاءَنَا وَ أَبْنَاءَكُمْ وَ نِسَاءَنَا وَ نِسَاءَكُمْ وَ أَنْفُسَنَا وَ أَنْفُسَكُمْ ثُمَّ نَبْتَهِلْ فَنَجْعَلْ لُغْنَةً اللَّهُ عَلَى الْكَافِرِينَ. وَادْعُ عِبَادِي إِلَى الْحَقِّ وَ بَشِّرْهُمْ بِآيَاتِ اللَّهِ وَ اذْعُهُمْ إِلَى كِتَابٍ مُبِينٍ. إِنَّ الَّذِينَ يُبَايِعُونَكَ إِنَّمَا يُبَايِعُونَ اللَّهَ يَدُ اللَّهِ فَوْقَ أَيْدِيهِمْ. وَ اللَّهُ مَعَهُمْ حَيْثُمَا كَانُوا إِنْ كَانُوا فِي بَيْعَتِهِمْ مِنَ الصَّادِقِينَ. قُلْ إِنْ كُنْتُمْ تُحِبُّونَ اللَّهَ فَاتَّبِعُونِي يُحْبِبْكُمُ اللَّهُ وَ يُجْعَلْ لَكُمْ نُورًا وَ يُجْعَلْ لَكُمْ فُرْقَانًا وَ يُجْعَلْكُمْ مِنَ الْمُنْصُورِينَ. إِنَّ اللَّهَ مَعَ الَّذِينَ اتَّقَوْا وَ إِنَّ اللَّهَ مَعَ الْمُحْسِنِينَ.

[Build the ark under Our supervision and Our direction. Stand up and warn (people about the impending calamities) for you have been commissioned to warn people whose forefathers were not warned and so that the way of the sinners becomes manifest. We have made you Masih Ibn-e-Maryam [Messiah, son of Mary], so as to perfect My warning for those who have adopted Christianity. Say: This is the grace of my Lord and I shun all kinds of titles. I have been commissioned by Allah and I am the first of the believers. He watches the times and knows well their requirements. He has large stores of everything with Him. When He determines upon a thing He directs it to 'Be'; and it is. Say: Do you wonder at what God does? Say: Allah is the Most Wonderful of all who are wonderful. He exalts whom He wills and abases whom He wills; He bestows honour

on whom He wills and humiliates whom He wills and chooses for Himself whom He wills. He is not questioned about that which He does and they will be called to account. Say: All praise belongs to Allah Who has removed from me all matter of grief and has bestowed upon me that which He has not bestowed upon anyone in the world. They have said: 'This is a book full of disbelief and falsehood.' Say: Come, let us call our sons and you call your sons, and we call our women and you call your women, and we call our people and you call your people and then let us pray fervently and call down the curse of Allah on the liars and call My servants to the truth and give them good tidings of the days of (the manifestation of the Glory of) Allah and call them to the clear book. Those who enter into a covenant with you enter into a covenant [not with you, but] with Allah. Allah's hand is above their hands. Allah will be with them wherever they might be, if they are faithful to their covenant. Say: If you love Allah, then come and follow me, so that Allah may also love you and will furnish you with [His special] light and will bestow upon you a distinction and will include you among those who are helped. Allah is with those who are righteous and Allah is with those who do good].

This is what my Lord has revealed to me at this time and before. He bestows His bounties upon those whom He wills and He is the Best Bestower. Verily, there are some of His close servants who are granted the title of 'Prophets' in the heavens because they resemble them in their essence and nature and because they acquire light from their lights and they have been shaped on [the basis of] their nature. Therefore, Allah makes them (their) inheritors and addresses them by the names of those whom they inherit from. He acts in this manner and He is the One who acts in the best manner.

Souls have such affinities with one another and their profound

mysteries cannot be fathomed. Thus, those who resemble each other are counted as one soul and the name of one is applied to the other. This has been the way of Allah and this matter is not unknown to the men of true knowledge. Allah is One and He loves oneness. Therefore, it has been His way that He sends some pious ones in the footsteps of the Prophets. Hence, he who is sent in the footsteps of the Prophet is named after the same trustworthy Prophet in the Exalted Assembly. Allah sends down upon him the secret of his [the said Prophet's] soul, the substance of his essence, the characteristics of his nature, and the grandeur of his attributes, and unites their essence, nature, name, and makes their wills consistent with each other and brings their attentions and objectives together, making them like two mirrors facing each other emitting and receiving light at once as if they are one and the same. This is the secret of oneness in the souls of the purified ones. It is the secret why Allah has given me the title 'Promised **Messiah**'. Ponder over this secret and do not be hasty.

Allah would not send a Prophet after our Holy Prophet, the **Seal of the Prophets**, nor would He create the chain of Prophethood anew after its end and abrogate some commandments of the Holy Quran or add to them, or go against His promise and forget the perfection of the Holy Quran and create any discord in the enduring Faith. Do you not read in the sayings of Muṣṭafā [the Chosen One], peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, that the Messiah would be one of his followers and will follow all the Islamic commandments and would offer Prayers as those who pray.

Indeed, the Holy Quran is replete with the verses which testify that Jesus son of Mary has passed away and joined his brothers Abraham and Moses. The Messenger of Allah, peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, has also conveyed the news of his death and he is the most truthful of those who impart information. Do you not read in the Holy Quran:

يُجِيسِي إِيَّايَ مُتَوَفِّيكَ<sup>1</sup> فَلَمَّا تَوَفَّيْتَنِي<sup>2</sup>

Do you not read:

وَمَا مُحَمَّدٌ إِلَّا رَسُولٌ قَدْ خَلَتْ مِنْ قَبْلِهِ الرُّسُلُ<sup>3</sup>

Do you not read in *Ṣaḥīḥ Bukhārī*:

مُتَوَفِّيكَ مُمِيتُكَ<sup>5,4</sup>

After these testimonies, no reason is left for any doubter to doubt. On which testimony will you believe after the verses revealed by the Lord of all the worlds? Do you not see that the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, prophesied about the Signs and time of the appearance of the Messiah that he would يَكْسِرُ الصَّلِيبَ وَيَقْتُلُ الْخَنزِيرَ [break the cross and kill the swine]?<sup>6</sup> Know that the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, indicated that he [the Promised Messiah] would come at the time when the cross would be worshipped and the flesh of swine would be eaten in abundance and the worshippers of the cross would be dominant throughout the world. So he would come and shatter their domination and break the cross

1. O Jesus, I will cause thee to die *a natural death* (*Sūrah Āl-e-Imrān*, 3:56). [Publisher]

2. But since Thou didst cause me to die (*Sūrah al-Ma'idah*, 5:118). [Publisher]

3. And Muhammad is only a Messenger. Verily, *all* Messengers have passed away before him (*Sūrah Āl-e-Imrān*, 3:145). [Publisher]

4. *Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī, Kitābut-Taḥṣīn*, Bāb Mā Ja'ala'llāhu min Baḥīrah walā-Ṣā'ibah walā-Waṣīlah walā-Ḥām [Publisher]

5. مُتَوَفِّيكَ means مُمِيتُكَ 'I will cause thee to die.' [Publisher]

6. *Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī, Kitābul-Maḥālim*, Bāb Kasruṣ-Ṣalīb wa Qatlul-Khinzīr, Hadith 2476 [Publisher]

into pieces and demolish their edifices, and he would demolish all of their sublime fabrications with arguments and proofs.

O people! Remember the lofty status of Muṣṭafā [the Chosen One], on whom be the peace from the Lord of the High Heavens. Read the books of the Christians and behold their attacks upon the honour of the Best of all Creation. Therefore—O progeny of Muslims!—do not exaggerate in praising the son of Mary and do not help the Christians. Is our Messenger dead and Jesus alive? That indeed is an unfair division. What has happened to you that you do not seek the honour of the Noblest of the Noble? Do you argue with me on the basis of *aḥādīth* describing that the Messiah will descend, while you overlook the other *aḥādīth*? You take one aspect but discard the other aspect. You abandon the method of research scholars. Let not the name 'son of Mary' mislead you in the sayings of the Best of Creation<sup>sas</sup>. That indeed is but a trial from Allah so that He may judge the right and the wrong among you and that He may reward the persevering who think good of themselves and that He may cause the filth to recoil upon the transgressors. This manner of Divine means have been in operation before as well, so let the seekers seek.

There is, in the episode of **Elijah** and the story of his descent, a clear precedent for those who seek. So read the Gospel and reflect upon its verses with an honest and penetrating eye. When the Jews said: 'O Jesus, how do you suppose that you are the Messiah whereas it is incumbent that Elijah appear before him as it is written in the scriptures of the Prophets?' He replied: 'Elijah has indeed come but you recognized him not.' He pointed towards Yaḥyā [John the Baptist] and said: 'This is Elijah, if you were to believe.' They said: 'You are a liar. Do you coin an odd meaning that we have not heard from our ancestors?' He said: 'O my people, I have not lied about Allah, but you do not understand the secrets of the Books of the Messengers.' This is the verdict issued by 'Īsā [Jesus], the Prophet of Allah, and in this is a lesson indeed for Muslims.

The descent of a human being from the sky is not the way of Allah.

If it is so, then bring forth a precedent from the past ages if you are the guided ones. No incident occurs before us, but there is a precedent for it in times past. This is what Allah referred to, and He is the Most Truthful:

وَكُنْ تَجْدِلُ اللَّهَ تَبْدِيلًا ١

And verily, the example of the former people has already gone. There are two parties that disagree in their opinions. One of them holds fast to the precedent but the other has no supporting precedent with them. So which of the parties is closer to truth? Look at it with the eyes of the just. O people! Fear Allah! Fear Allah! Desist! Desist! Do not follow the desires of the misguided lot and always remember what Muṣṭafā<sup>sa</sup> said.

I have come to you as an arbiter and judge to give verdict in the disputed matters. Therefore, accept my testimony. I have been blessed with a knowledge which neither you nor anyone else has been granted. If you are in doubt about my affair then come forward and let Allah judge between us and you. Indeed, He is the Most Powerful and Omnipotent Lord; He is with the truthful; He hears and sees. He has given me the glad tidings at this time and said:

يا عيسى سأريك آياتي الكبرى

[O 'Īsā (Jesus), I shall soon show you My great Signs.]

So what line of explanation would be more right than this if you are seeking guidance?

I have come at a time when darkness has spread and truth has vanished into the murk, and these have been the days of epidemics. Many peoples perished, and Islam was like an emaciated she-camel

1. And thou wilt never find a change in the way of Allah (*Sūrah al-Aḥzāb*, 33:63).  
[Publisher]

abandoned in a pitch dark night with no refuge or shelter for it. The seekers after truth were like a ravenous one whose bowels have swollen out of starvation. Thus, my Lord revealed unto me what He revealed and I rose up to the call. My Lord revealed to me concerning events in the future and the past; He purified me and delivered me from all worries and tribulations and gave me glad tidings of my dominance over all of my opponents and deniers. He has revealed to me that,

انى غالب على كل خصيم اعمى  
[I shall prevail over every blind opponent.]

And Allah has said:

اِنَّ مُّهِينٌ مِّنْ اَرَادَ اِهَانَتَكَ .  
[I shall humiliate him who designs to humiliate you.]

He favoured me with countless and innumerable bounties. He said::

انى معك حيث ما كنت و اني ناصرک و اني بذك الازم و عضدک الاقوى  
[I am with you wherever you might be and I am your Helper  
and I am your resource and your strong arm.]

He has commanded me that I should call people to the *Furqān* [the Discrimination—the Quran] and to the Faith of the Best of Mankind [the Holy Prophet Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>], who set the example of preaching and encouraged to strive and bear hardships. I am not a Prophet,<sup>1</sup> but a *Muḥaddathullāh* [recipient of Divine revelation] and *Kalīmullāh* [the one who converses with Allah] so that I may revive the Faith of Muṣṭafā [the Chosen One, i.e. the Holy Prophet]. Allah has commissioned me

1. A detailed discussion of this subject is included in *A Misunderstanding Removed* by the Promised Messiah<sup>as</sup>, Printed by Islam International Publications Ltd. 2007. [Publisher]



at the turn of the century and He Himself has taught me the knowledge of guidance. If you entertain doubts about my affair and believe that you are justified in my opposition and consider your nearness [to Allah] to be greater than that of mine, then I hereby stand in the battlefield against you to witness the signs of your truthfulness and to demonstrate my conclusive proof with utmost clarity. I call Allah as a Witness before you, who is the Creator of earth and heavens that you may not give me a respite for so much as the blink of an eye and strive with the best of your ability to vanquish me and pray to Allah for your victory.

Now it would be disgrace upon you if you slacken, delay, or fail to confront me in a neutral field. Therefore, be all of you united against me and shoot your arrows from the same bow and then you will soon come to know who gets annihilated and whom Allah the Almighty protects and safeguards. If you accept me, Allah will bless you and will make you prosper, blessed, and protected. He will restore the older days [of glory] to you. You will live under the protection of Allah. Your Lord will turn towards you and forgive you and will be pleased with you and all evils will be warded off and removed from you.

O my people! I am not a disbeliever as it is propagated and fabricated against me by the malicious ulema. I have neither forged anything against my Lord nor do I say anything to you from myself; surely he who forges a lie shall perish. I wholeheartedly believe that verily this world has an Eternal Creator who is One, Omnipotent, Generous, and has power over everything manifest and hidden. I also believe that verily Allah has angels near Him; each one of them has an appointed station; none of them descends or rises from his station. Their descent, as described in the Holy Quran, is not like human descent from above to below, nor is their ascent like human ascent from below to above. The reason is that human descent involves movement from one place to another with strenuous effort and exertion, but the angels do not suffer any weariness, exhaustion or change. So do not take their descent and ascent to be like that of others. Their descent and ascent is in the

manner of Allah's descent and ascent from the Throne to the lowest heaven. Allah has made it an article of faith to believe in their existence and He says:

مَا يَعْلَمُ جُنُودَ رَبِّكَ إِلَّا هُوَ<sup>1</sup>

Therefore, believe in their descent and ascent and do not intrude into their nature. This is the better way and closer to righteousness. Allah has described them as those who stand up, fall prostrate, line up, glorify, and remain firm at the appointed stations. He made these attributes eternal and indispensable to them and has distinguished them with these characteristics. So, how is it possible for angels to abandon their prostrations and standings, break their rows, and cease their glorification and adulations so as to descend to the earth by deserting their stations, leaving the heavens empty? Instead, they move around without leaving their station, like the King settled upon the Throne.

You know that Allah descends to our heaven in the latter part of every night, but it is not said that He leaves the Throne and then ascends to it at other times. The same is the case with the angels who adopt the character of the attributes of their Lord as a shadow mirrors its original. Although we do not grasp its true essence, we believe in it. How can we relate their characteristics to that of a man, for we know the essence of his characteristics and the scope of his qualities, actions, and movements? Allah has forbidden us to do so in relation to angels and has said:

وَمَا يَعْلَمُ جُنُودَ رَبِّكَ إِلَّا هُوَ<sup>2</sup>

1. None knows the hosts of thy Lord but He (*Sūrah al-Muddaththir*, 74:32).  
[Publisher]

2. And none knows the hosts of thy Lord but He (*Sūrah al-Muddaththir*, 74:32).  
[Publisher]

So fear Allah, O men endowed with reason!

We believe in what Allah has disclosed to us that ‘Īsā ibn Maryam [Jesus son of Mary] has passed away, joined his pious brethren Prophets, and has been raised to a place where Yaḥyā [John the Baptist] is. We also believe that our Messenger is *Khairur-Rusul* [the Best of all Messengers], *Afdalul-Mursalīn* [more exalted than all of them], and *Khātamun-Nabiyyīn* [the Seal of all the Prophets]—exalted above all who will ever come or who have passed away. He made me at one with his blessed being and nourished me with his holy and purified hand and showed me his glory and sovereignty and revealed unto me his sublime secrets. We also believe that every verse of the Quran is a surging sea filled with subtleties of guidance, and that anything that contradicts it and goes against its account of historical facts and the knowledge of this world and the Hereafter is absolutely false.

We believe that Heaven is real, Hell is real, the resurrection of bodies is real and the miracles of the Prophets are real, and we believe that salvation lies in Islam and following our Prophet<sup>sa</sup>, the chief of all Creation. We are absolved of everything that is against Islam. We believe in everything which our Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, has brought, even if we may not grasp its sublime essence. Whoever says anything contrary to this about us, merely lies and fabricates about us. So fear Allah and do not affirm the statements of an avaricious and mean one who charges at me like a serpent, indulges in accusing me with disbelief on account of his deficient judgement and follows his evil desires. Know for certain that Islam is my religion and in the Oneness of God lies my firm faith, and that my heart has neither erred nor gone astray.

He who has abandoned the Quran and follows erroneous speculations is like a person who has been savagely attacked and has been thrown into a deadly pit and destroyed. Allah knows that I love Islam and I am ready to sacrifice my life for the *Khairul-Anām* [Best of Mankind] and I am only a **servant of Ahmad, Muṣṭafā [the Chosen One]**, who was made dear to me ever since my boyhood and adolescence. Allah has

blessed me with the compilation of the book and enabled me to invite the opponents to Allah's manifest faith. So I sent a book to every opponent and I invited everyone—old and young—to Islam. I promised to show Signs for the seekers of truth and I promised them a great fortune if I failed to provide them a response. Their faces became grief-stricken with fury. None dared to come forward to accept the challenge. They did not answer my call and failed to utter any word, good or bad. None of them came out running to approach me. This is one of the Signs of my truth and honesty for those who ponder.

He who has recognized me has accepted me, and he who has not recognized me has not accepted me. Whosoever strives in a matter, Allah reveals the truth of that matter to him. Blessed are the hearts that strive. Fruits are not reaped by remaining idle. He who does not pursue a course of action, cannot possess so much as a whit. Those who seek, do ultimately find.

O my People! Do not reject me arbitrarily and do not reject me without evidence. Do not transgress in hurling abuses at me and do not deride me with rage. Do not interfere in the unseen of Allah and persist not about that which you know nothing. It may be that you declare someone a disbeliever while he is a believer before Allah, and it may be that you consider someone sinful while he is pious before Him. Allah sees the hearts of His servants while you do not.

O my people! If I were in the wrong, Allah is sufficient for my obliteration, but if I am in the right, I fear that you will be seized for your transgression.

O ye so-called mystics of India! Only a few of you are pious while most of you are innovators [of religious deviations]. Among you are those who have inclined towards monasticism and have abandoned what they had been enjoined to do. They neither fear nor pay heed to Allah. When they stand up for Prayer, they stand lazily, and yet they rush towards the meditations of Brahmans, causing the hoofs of their horses to bleed, gashing the foot soles of their camels, while believing that they are doing a virtuous deed. They say, 'We believe in the Quran'

while they do not believe in it; they say, 'We follow the examples of Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>' while they do not follow them. On the contrary, they veer to erroneous paths.

Those who discover truth sever all ties with worldly objects despite having a necessary connection with them, and they address themselves wholly towards Allah in such a way as if they have no spouse, offspring, camels, and horses. They all prefer Allah to their progeny, family, and wealth. They are the ones who are helped by God. They are the ones upon whom descend the blessings and mercy from their Lord, and they are the ones who are rightly guided.

There are some of you who were inclined towards immorality and followed your carnal passions, entering the desert of destruction and death. They squandered their enormous assets, provisions, and possessions. They forgot their camps and destinations and displeased their Lord. The wind shattered their sailboat and they were counted among the drowned. Does not such a man know that taking provisions is a fundamental principle for both lives—here and the Hereafter—and that one needs this in this very world as well? He does not grow weary of earning wealth and pursuing his objectives in this world. Thus, very soon, at the time of his departure from this world, he will come to know that he is departing empty-handed to the eternal abode.

Amongst them are some who have mixed good deeds with evil ones and confused disbelief with firm faith, and infused certainty with suspicion. They are resolutely inclined towards carnal desires and have plunged from the shore into the ocean of darkness and lustful desires. They drove themselves to the ways of destruction and the valleys of devastation and did with themselves what even the insane do not do. Alas! They concocted innovations in the Faith and everyone followed his own desire. Woe betides them and everything they concocted. They have fastened a number of innovations around their necks and are gladdened by their disordered state. They protect the innovations of Hindu Brahmans and the practice of the sinful disbelievers. They have adopted all their practices like mesmerism, casting attention to the heart, sitting

idle at shrines, circumambulating tombs, and prostrating before the dead of the graves. Moreover, they take pride in their actions. Their worship is nothing but the reverie of imagining their religious leaders at the time of prayers, as well as afterwards, and in this way they associate partners with Allah.

They prefer their ways and transgressions over the *Sunnah* [Practices] of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him. They say, 'We have not seen the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> nor do we understand the Quran. Our Prophet is none other than our Leader, and his sayings are the Quran to us, and surely we are rightly guided.' They would deceive Allah and those who believe, and they deceive none but themselves, only they perceive it not. In their hearts was a disease, and Allah has increased their disease to them, and for them is a grievous punishment because they lied. You see them completely stripped of the raiment of righteousness, of truthful course of action, and in absolute abandonment of the emblem of Islam.

In their life and on their faces, they carry a mark they try to conceal. Their aura is intensely cold, their gloominess is densely dark, their intellect is like that of animals, their piety is like the sparkling of a mirage, and they consider themselves to be men of knowledge. Destruction be upon their life! They are foxes in their dealings and wolves in disputes. They rejoice with the offerings of people and frown when service to them is denied and discontinued. They seek refuge in the opulent and flee from the poor, ever quick to complain. They consider themselves to be wise, while they, in fact, are nothing more than a vessel void of water. They rejoice upon the foolish babbling of an arrogant braggart, and are devoid of understanding. And the way to assess them—measuring the depth of their knowledge, experience, and the light within their hearts—is simple and easy: present the Noble Quran to them and question them. Verily, the Discriminator—the Holy Quran—is replete with wonderful mysteries, insights and subtleties, but no one comes even close to understanding it except those who are purified.

He alone who is endowed with divine character can apprehend

its verities and can be apprised of its profound meanings, so glad tidings to those who are ordained in this manner. They are the people whose hearts are infatuated with Allah's love. He has purified their souls, cleansed them, glorified them, and exalted them to Himself. They are always engrossed in the remembrance of their Beloved. They are wholeheartedly drawn towards the Truth, are totally lost in their Beloved, have sacrificed their souls, have fulfilled their vows, and have completely submitted themselves to Allah. They have abandoned their selfish desires and nothing has remained under their covering except Allah.

You may perceive them to be present and extant while they have been lost. They brutally drew their swords against their selves and became detached from them as a snake sheds its skin. Allah sees their sincerity and loyalty while they are invisible to the eyes of the people. Angels marvel at their serenity, submission, steadfastness, and the bond of love with their Beloved, while the ignorant laugh at them. People hurt and harm them with false accusations and condemn them as disbelievers with fabrications, while none but Allah knows their inner truth, hidden as they are under His veil.

Those who prefer the life of this world—resting content with it, sinning, spilling the blood of the righteous, and standing firm upon that of which they have no knowledge whatsoever—will soon know come to know the place they shall return. They fear people and do not fear Allah, while they are witnesses against themselves. Their ego, pride, and glory have restrained them from embracing the truth. So, they knowingly turned away from the Caller to Allah. Every one of them disregards the Sunnah of the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>, tampers with it, and invites and welcomes innovations to them. They say, 'Look at my piety and asceticism.' They are bereft of knowledge but consider themselves to be the men close to God.

They look towards people but they do not look towards Allah. They fail to see the assault of tribulations against Islam and they sit prostrating before their selfish desires as pagans sit before their idols, and they

remain heedless. The abode of Islam was destroyed yet they were heedless to it, the milk of Islam dried up yet they remained in deep asleep, the splendour of the Shariah lost its glory yet they were gleeful. They take the fire of love and the warmth of remembrance and the spark of knowledge as nothing more than a source of mere sunbathing, of warming by flames, and they love to be praised for what they have not done. They pretend that they have become thin due to ascetic exercises, while in reality they are naked, deprived of the garment of piety.

They boast about their *Tahajjud* Prayers [supererogatory Prayers offered in the latter part of the night] while they abandon the obligatory Prayers. They have gained nothing from the Word of the Compassionate Lord and from the recorded sayings, but rather they indulge in the poetry of the poets. Afflictions and calamities have befallen Islam, while they remain heedless. They sympathize not a whit, all the while steeped in their carnal desires. I see them as I see the one who despises the illumined Shariah and mocks the sayings of the Chief<sup>sas</sup> of all Creation. They prefer the couplets of poets over the verses of the Word of Allah and cheer and dance with joy. They listen to the Quran and do not cry and do not supplicate humbly.

They are the people who deviated from the path of guidance and preferred darkness over light. They grope in a gloomy night like a blind she-camel without any protector or guardian. By Allah I find their souls to be corrupted and they have become like a barren land full of foul weeds. They crawl like animals and do not stand straight. Excess is their habit and compulsion is their conduct. The ultimate reach of their cognizance is to follow the footsteps of the misguided Brahmans. The poetry of the poets is the fuel of their meditation and the food for their hearts. They have abandoned their Lord and clung to the world.

Allah put veils on their hearts, so they fail to understand. They have made the dead as their source of help and succour, and wasted away the blessings of the refuge from the Compassionate Lord. They behave sinfully and do not refrain. They have abandoned the King (Allah) who dominates all the lands and have followed every mean and worthless



one who is bereft of any providence. They wronged not Allah, but it was themselves whom they wronged. They were put into trial by the exaggeration of admirers, and were destroyed by the leniency of acquitters. They did not take light from the Holy Quran and wandered distracted in the valley of poets. They want to absolve their followers from the filth of sins, while they themselves indulge in all sorts of vices while they perceive not.

O ye foolish and ignorant! First stand up to cleanse your own heart, then rise with purified hands to cleanse your brother. Do not say to people what you do not do, lest you be mocked. How can you cleanse the body of your brothers while your own body is dirty and covered with filth? You yourself do not tread on the path of guidance, so how will they follow it? If you are in doubt about that which I have been commanded, then arise for a fight and prepare yourselves to demonstrate whether you are granted any Signs of splendour and truthfulness by Allah the Glorious. Indeed, we are ready to demonstrate these.

Know that being the Elect of God is nothing but the acceptance of one's prayers by God, and there is no other meaning of being a man of God but his acceptance in the court of the Mighty. So come to the battlefield! If you prefer to flee then you are liars. Come so Allah may make you enter the gardens of peace and do not be pleased knowingly with the greenery of a dunghill. Allah calls you towards good. What happened to you as you do not respond? A Warner from among you is waking you up, so why do you not come out of your slumber? The hand of the unseen is pulling you forward, so why—O people!—do you step back? The tidings from Allah have come to you, so why do you deliberately try to overlook them?

Verily, truth has come and falsehood has vanished, while you still doubt. The Signs have surely been manifested for you, while you deliberately act blindly. Do you not see that the earth has shaken violently, that it is encompassed with disorders, and that the hearts have become dead? Islam has been inflicted with every kind of affliction and has been hit and overcome by every kind of calamity. The enemies have awakened,

while you remain sleeping. I see innovations in all of your words, deeds, and conduct—in the shrines that you erect, in the clothes that you dye, in the verses that you sing aloud, in the gait with which you walk, in the narrations that you relate proudly and thereby behave arrogantly, in your long or trimmed beards, and in the birds with which you prey.

What has happened to you, for you neither shed tears upon your negligence nor do you regret it? What has happened to you that you do not fear Allah, are not awed by His glory, and your hearts do not burn for His love? You have forgotten the day when you shall be returned to Allah. I see depravity in the eyes that you stretch towards the world. You, with stiff necks and eyes wide open, set your sights like a hawk ready to pounce on carrion. I also see wickedness in the tongues that you sharpen, raising them against brothers, swiftly flicking them like a venomous snake. I also find your opinions to be faulty and full of errors, and—being confused—you fail to differentiate between the wise and the foolish. You abuse and speak ill of people on mere assumptions. You brag of your piety but at the moment of confrontation, you turn your backs defeated, without feeling any humiliation; rather you arrogantly compete with each other about your proclaimed blessings.

I know for certain that you are merely a lifeless entity and the divine spirit has never come even close to you, and that you are a dead people. If you stand on something true as you claim, then what has held you back from coming forth and marching with armies to defeat me in the battlefield, to contest me for a horse race in the arena, to challenge me to steed-mounted combat? Then, if you come forth, you will find my action against you faster than even a blink of an eye. Allah shall humiliate you with a painful humiliation and you shall be defeated.

Surely, I have come to glorify the message of Islam while you oppose it; I desire to revive the religion of Allah, while you resist it. Do you not see that Islam has become weak and helpless again, that what has befallen it is something that no observer has ever observed, nor any narrator has ever narrated? What has happened to you that you neither tremble on account of it nor feel its pain? What has happened to you that you neither get jealous for your honour nor become impassioned?

O ye ignorant ones! Are you men or eunuchs? Do you not see that discord is rife, that thick darkness has spread around and encompassed you? The earth has cast out that which was in her and has become empty. Innovations have multiplied; the teachings of the Holy Quran have disappeared; the people have inclined to the earth and turned to worldliness. The teachings have been overcome by baseless innovations and selfish desires have exceeded all bounds. Every people have corrupted its path and have gone astray. Thus, what is left for the spectators to expect?

Verily, I swear by Allah that I am from Him, and only under His command do I call people, so the seekers should investigate. I put both curse and blessing before the ulema and religious chiefs—now it is up to them for what they choose and incline towards. As far as curse is concerned, it is only for those who declare me a liar by following a mere conjecture, and who declare me a disbeliever by surmise. They neither know the truth nor reflect upon it. They do not ask me for what may heal their bosoms and they do not come to me so that they may witness Signs and thus receive deliverance from doubts as the righteous people do. Beware! It is surely they who have become evil in this world and the Hereafter, and the curse of Allah be upon them because they declare Muslims to be disbelievers without any knowledge, and because they are quick to conceive an evil thought.

As far as blessings are concerned, they are indeed for those who listen to my words carefully, observe my Signs, and think well themselves. They accept the truth and show no arrogance. It is only they who have been prosperous in this world and the Hereafter. They stood up to find the truth and that alone do they passionately seek. They do not walk grovelling upon their faces; rather, they ask about every arising doubt in order to dispose it off. They do not insist upon falsehood, nor are they neglectful. Upon them are the favours, mercy, and blessings of Allah, and these are they who have been shown mercy.

O ye people! Ask me if you harbour any doubt, and call upon Allah—in humility and in secret—imploping Him to reveal the truth to you; and lo, upon you will it surely be revealed! Do not sit with

those who indulge in their own evil—those who follow not the right path nor seek the truth—indeed, such are the arrogant ones.

O ye people! Verily, the descent of the Messiah is a matter of the unseen, so Allah has disclosed His secret in the manner that He willed. Argue not about His secrets and do not transgress your limits knowingly. If you are in doubt about my word and my claim, then come to my town and spend some days in my company. Allah will reveal upon you my inner state and will judge concerning that about which you differ. Should you wield the power, then venture forth to prove the signs of your truth and to witness my truth—assemble your infantry, your cavalymen, your brothers involved in innovation and worship of the graves, then pray against me and grant me no respite. If you prevail over me then slaughter me with any blade of your choice. Know for certain that Allah will surely humiliate you! He supports none but His servant and elevates naught but His religion.

O creators of disorder! He will certainly destroy you. Verily, Allah is not pleased with infidelity, idolatry, and innovation in His servants. It is only His enemies who are to be slaughtered. Verily, He is with me and He has revealed to me the mystery of the Messiah's descent, which has been rendered obscure to you. It is a trial from Allah; He conceals and reveals whatsoever He wills. Such has been His way regarding the secrets of the unseen. So, woe betide those who dispute in the secrets of Allah as if they have fathomed them, and have come to comprehend all their hidden mysteries, and they are not fearful!

O people! A tree is known by its fruits, and soon you will recognize me by my fruits—thus, why do you dispute? Hold your tongues from declaring anyone a disbeliever and restrain your hands from harming anyone. Fear the wrath of Allah, the Most Supreme. Pray to Allah for the disclosure of these secrets and soon you shall be informed. Verily, I call you towards a matter in which there is a spring for your welfare and a remedy for your doubt. It is that every one of you should strive hard and beg Allah Almighty to show you a vision disclosing the reality of the matter at hand, or to grant to you a revelation that harmonizes with

reason. Allah is All-Powerful, so He shall grant you such if you request this of Him wholeheartedly.

Stand up in the wee hours of the night and perform ablutions. Then offer prayers tearfully, and humbly supplicate, sending blessings and salutations upon the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>. Then seek forgiveness for yourselves and beg that the matter be disclosed to you. Do this consistently for forty days and despair not. Then you shall find guidance from Allah that will lead you towards the truth and you shall be delivered from the doubts as the righteous are delivered. What is the matter with you that you neither follow the way of the pious nor tread the path of the righteous? You love to disobey and ignorantly declare your brethren disbelievers. For this you will be seized and held accountable. Do you consider declaring someone a disbeliever to be a trivial affair, while in the sight of Allah it is grievous? What is the matter with you that you do not fear Allah and ponder not?

O ye people—Repent! Repent!—lest the doors of repentance be closed and you be left waiting.

O ye people! Refrain from the company of the so-called mystics who claim, 'Surely, we are Chishtīs and we are Qādirīs.'<sup>1</sup> They come to you in the garb of sheep while they are actually ravening wolves. They are extremely fond of singing and music, yet turn away from the practices of the peerless Prophet, and most of them are disobedient. They yearn for lithe girls and repel the illuminating Shariah. They have freed themselves from self-restraint and pursue their evil desires, grovelling upon their faces. They are completely devoid of the true knowledge of the Holy Quran, and their souls touch not its subtleties, yet they envision themselves as comprehending the deepest meanings of the Holy Quran. When it is said to them, 'Follow the Caller towards Allah', they say, 'We do not know who the Caller is and we, surely, are well-guided and can even lead others to guidance.' When they are called towards

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1. The Chishtī and Qādirī are orders within the mystic Sufi tradition of Islam. [Publisher]

Allah and the ways of His Messenger<sup>sas</sup>, they turn their heads away arrogantly, make a jest of the Warners of Allah and mock them.

They say: 'Surely, things such as sainthood, the grace of Divine converse and discourse, and Messengership are worthless. If we desire, even the lowest of our followers can attain that status, but we abhor these kinds of matters.' Allah has set a seal on their hearts so they see not the truth, never seek it, nor even respect it. They disdain him whom Allah has sent to His servants, and they claim that Allah has informed them that such a one is a disbeliever and the most egregious liar. They persist in their claim and continue lying. They say: 'All the blessings are associated with the vow of allegiance, while this man does not have the honour to be associated with the allegiance of any spiritual master.'

Hearken! To be in their allegiance is nothing but a futile bargain. Their claim is nothing but a downright lie fabricated by deceivers. Alas for them! Do they not know that the Messiah shall descend with all the wealth of his knowledge from the heavens and shall take nothing from this world? Why do they fail to understand? Do they not realize that those who are sent from their Lord do not need to be in anyone's allegiance? They are taught by their Lord and they receive every variety of knowledge from Him; they see, listen, and speak through Him alone. The spirit of Allah lives in them—they speak with it, illuminate there-with every person whose nature is pure, bestow favours with it, and through it are they apprised of the treasures of knowledge. They conclusively establish the argument of Allah against everyone who persists in rejecting and denying the truth. They are helped only by Allah and He fills their hearts with the insights of the Holy Quran. He reveals in advance very rare and unique developments of the age to them. He bestows upon them what others are denied, and they thus stand distinguished. He grants to them such a kingdom that does not suit others, and they are exclusively chosen for His favours.

O ye rebellious—ye deniers! How can this grace be granted to you?

O ye liars! Show me the fruitful impact of your pledge of allegiance with your spiritual masters if it exists. If there is blessing in your

company and their company then why can I not see it? Can you prove it?

O liars! You have ruined yourselves and many others. What happened to you? Your pledge of allegiance did not benefit the people nor yourselves. Your assembly is but a pliant mob and an audience of spectators. The Holy Quran is not recited in your gatherings, rather you amuse yourselves with reciting poetry. In those who pledge allegiance to you, I find no love for Allah and His Messenger<sup>ṣas</sup>, as I do not see them refraining from arrogance and transgression; rather, they race and vie with one another in committing vice. They incline towards the weak and the baseless instead of Allah. They worship graves and seek help from the helpless. They fall avariciously on the carcass of this world and with it do they fill their bellies. They have fallen in love with it on account of their stupidity and they crave it like dogs on account of their wretchedness, transgressing within it. They are not acquainted with so much as a single verity of the Holy Quran, nor do they simply read it. They do not take any provision for the Hereafter but keep on toiling after this world.

O ye people—Repent! Repent!—for the days have passed and the hour of Allah has drawn nigh. So blessed is the eye that looks deep and beholds. Blessed are the ears that listen attentively and blessed are the feet that tread and hasten unto the path of truth. Blessed are the people who accept the truth and do not turn away.

O ye Muslims! May Allah make you true Muslims. Know for certain that I am from Allah and He is sufficient as a Witness. Know, surely, He helps me and strengthens me and teaches me and reveals unto me. He has bestowed upon me such verities as none can know without His instruction. What is the matter with you that you neither accept me nor investigate my true claim?

O ye people! Come close to me and do not turn away; open your eyes and shut them not; enter the refuge of Allah and do not distance yourselves from Him; cleanse yourselves from malice and enmity and do not immerse yourselves in filth; hasten towards repentance and



slacken not; do not transgress in evil suspicions and fear. Refrain and seek help with patience and Prayer; strive hard and be not impatient!

Hearken! Do not delay. Humbly call upon Allah and cast yourselves before your Lord, asking Him about my truth and the true state of my affairs with your utmost sincerity, concentration, determination, and firm resolution. Thus, the matter shall be disclosed to you and you shall be granted your request.

Be kind—O people!—be kind! Exceed not in your abuse and do not transgress. Refrain from the denial of such Divine wonders that have been concealed from your eyes and be not audacious.

O ye impetuous ones! Have mercy on your souls and wrong not yourselves.

O ye so-called mystics of India! If you consider yourselves to be something, then why won't you dare confront me on the battlefield? I see that you have become impudent in your fervour and behave arrogantly, donning the robe of self-conceit and vanity. The sycophants and flatterers have destroyed you. Come, let us call our Glorious Lord, refrain from idle talk, seek manifest proof and evidence from Allah—implore Allah to judge between us both so that the truth be exposed and the spiritually dead may expire. Verily, by Allah, I am certain that you are foxes who pretend to be lions, and vultures who dissemble as hawks. You think no differently of me, so come, let us make Allah the Judge between you and me that He may honour the truthful and establish the liars as losers. So, if you boast any share of the favour which Allah has bestowed upon me, then come forth to respond to my challenge, march towards me, move fast, and grant me no respite.

By Allah! I do not see any righteous soul among you except as a single white strand in a lock of black hair. Indeed, I see that you have misled the servants of Allah and have cut the hamstrings of the she-camel of Islam and continue to do so. Verily, my Lord has sent me to disclose unto you the paths to tread upon, the deeds to perform, and the morals to adopt, that you might become civilized.

Respond to me: Will you accept my message or reject it? What is



the matter with you that you neither look towards Islam and its misfortunes—its unique and variegated present-day calamities—nor do you sympathize, O heedless ones! This age has accumulated terror of every desert's wilderness, terrors of each fearful place, and has brought forth shocking disorders and awe-striking sciences. This age is notorious for its signs of indecency like that of a woman of loose morals with whom the young kiss and flirt.

O ye people! I have come to you in a time when the sun is about to set and disappear, and the radiance of Islam is to be hidden and veiled. What is the matter with you that you do not perceive the age, nor do you embrace the light that has descended at its hour, even doubting the tidings of the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>? What is the matter with you that you have stagnated, that your she-camel has collapsed and dropped down its ears out of fatigue, and that your souls have wearied and crumbled helplessly? No sense or vigour remains in you, and your breathing has extinguished. Are you in a slumber or already dead?

What is the matter with you that you neither listen nor reply? Do you love the present life, while forgetting the demise of your ancestors and fearing nothing? Alas for your weakness in faith, for decorating your bodies with bulges, and for your being completely devoid of sympathy for Islam, as well as the knowledge and conviction which you falsely claim to have! Do you not see the wind that sweeps away from the right path, and the trials that eliminate men of understanding? Do you not see the turn of the century for which you were anxiously awaiting? Do you not see the shades of darkness and the marching army of the depraved? Why, then, do you not wake up? Do you not see that Islam has become like a grief-stricken orphan and the courage of Muslims is now like a feeble she-camel; that true righteousness has become a lost virtue, and the knowledge of Quran has become like a person buried alive? You clearly see this yet you pretend to be ignorant.

O ye people! Cultivate wisdom in your thoughts and pure honesty in your views, and do not turn away from the Gracious Lord, and do not reject the timely blessings of Allah nor turn away in aversion. If

you listen to my word carefully and pay heed to the advice and instruction that I will render unto you today, Allah will be pleased with you and will cause you to prosper and thrive. He will cause His blessings to descend upon you and will bless your progenies, posterity, crops, trades, buildings, and kingdoms. He will bless you with a pure life. Thus, you will enter into the protection of Allah and there shall you reside under His shelter. If you do not desist from your evils and fail to put on the yoke of Divine commandment around your necks, then you will surely be seized by your sins. The fire of your vices will consume you and Allah will render you as mere tales for future generations—a lesson for those who witness. He will disperse and uproot you; thus, you will perish leaving nothing behind but your remains. Allah will brandish His unsheathed sword at you and unleash tormentors upon you. He will smite you with disgrace and oust you from every place.

Verily, Allah wills to strengthen His religion and help His servant. Is this your Islam that you stand in its opposition! Do you wield the power to uproot the tree planted by the Gracious Lord Himself? Will you fight with Allah?

O my Lord! How magnificent this feat of Yours when You descend to help some people and they then stand victorious!

O my Lord! How sharp Your sword is when you draw it against a group; then, surely, they are doomed to be cut asunder! Surely, Allah has manifested Himself in a new fashion.

O ye heedless ones! Stand up for Him! If you deliberately behave heedlessly and turn away, soon you shall recollect and regret. Look at the people before you! They disobeyed Allah, so He slapped them on their faces and afflicted them with poverty and adversity, and destroyed them with calamities and varied afflictions. You are not the least bit better than any of them, nor has Allah weakened, fatigued, or slackened. What is the matter with you that you fear not the wrath of Allah and tremble not? We have not said much about you and have overlooked many of your disgraceful acts. We have preferred forgiveness over reproach so that you might be grateful in your hearts and repent.

## TO THE NOBLE AND PIOUS OF THE ARABS<sup>1</sup>

*Assalāmu Alaikum* [Peace be upon you]! O righteous and sincere friends from the true Arabian land! *Assalāmu Alaikum* [Peace be upon you]! O people of the land of Prophethood and the neighbours of the Great House of Allah!

You are the best party of Islam and the best group of Allah the Exalted. It is not for any people to surpass your glory. You have, indeed, exceeded in nobility, dignity, and stature. It is enough for your honour that Allah started His revelation with Adam and culminated it with the Prophet who was among you, and your land was his country, abode, and birthplace.

What should make you know who that Prophet Muhammad is—Muṣṭafā [the Chosen One], Chief of the Pious, the Pride of the Prophets, the Seal of the Messengers, and the Guide of Creation! His benevolence is established on every being who walks on two legs. His revelation contains all of the lost fine points, insights, and sublime verities. His religion revived all the dead verities of truth and paths of guidance.

O Allah! Send Your blessings, peace, and bounties upon him as much as all that is found in this world—droplets and particles, the living and the dead, and as many as everything found in the heavens and as many as all the conspicuous and concealed things that exist. Convey

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1. The Promised Messiah<sup>as</sup> originally wrote this letter in Arabic; its translation is provided in this section. For the original Arabic text, see *Ā'ina-e-Kamālāt-e-Islām*, Rūḥānī Khazā'in, vol. 5, p. 419–497, published by Islam International Publications Ltd. Ed. 2021. [Publisher]

to him as many blessings from us as fill the horizons of the sky. Blessed are the people who have committed themselves to obey Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>. Blessed is the heart that is inclined towards him, merges with him, and is lost in his love.

O inhabitants of the land upon which the feet of Muṣṭafā [the Chosen One] had trod! May Allah have mercy upon you and be pleased with you and gratify you.

O servants of God! Surely, I hold you in great regard and my soul suffers an exceptional thirst to meet you. I passionately desire to see your land and witness the favours upon your masses, so that I might behold the land trodden under the feet of the Best of Creation, and apply its dust as kohl for my eyes; and that I may visit its sacred places and meet its pious people, its savants, and scholars; and that I may soothe my eyes with the glimpse of its sages and magnificent sights. So I humbly pray to Allah the Exalted to grant me the honour to see your land and the pleasure of meeting you through His great bounty.

O my brethren! I love you and your land and the dirt of your paths and even the pebbles of your streets, and I prefer you to whatsoever is in this world.

O valiant ones of the Arabs! Surely Allah has chosen you with pure blessings, innumerable favours, and magnificent bounties. You live around the House of Allah, owing to which the Mother of Towns [i.e. Makkah] is blessed. In your land is the tomb of the blessed Prophet who spread *Tauḥīd* [the Oneness of God] to the corners of the world and manifested and illuminated the grandeur of Allah. Among you were the people who served Allah and His Messenger with the entirety of heart, soul and intellect. They sacrificed their possessions and lives for the propagation of the religion of Allah and His Sacred Book. It is only you who are exclusively identified with these characteristics. Those who failed to show you respect have indeed committed injustice and transgressed. O my brethren! Verily I am writing this letter to you

with a broken heart and flowing tears. Hearken to my word! May Allah grant you the best reward.

I am the man whom Allah nourished with mercy from Himself. He bestowed upon me His perfect bounty. He never allowed me to face scarcity of anything. He blessed me with His converse and revelation, granted me true knowledge from His Holiness, guided me towards the paths of His pleasure and piety, and revealed His sublime hidden verities to me. Many a time He strengthened me with discourses that were clear, without anything doubtful or hidden. At times, He enlightened me with the light of visions as clear as broad daylight.

Among the greatest of His bounties is that He raised me as the *Imām* and *Khalīfah* [Vicegerent] for this day and age. He has sent me as the *Mujaddid* [Reformer] at the head of this century so that I might lead the people from darkness to light and take them away from the paths of evil and disorder to the ways of *taqwā* [righteousness]. He has granted me what cures souls, dispels prevailing doubts, and removes the gloom from creation. He [Allah] has surely found this age imprisoned in hardships, strangled in adversities, and afflicted with annihilating innovations, vices, and darknesses. He willed to redeem its people from these calamities and various kinds of afflictions.

Verily, Allah saw that the evil of Christian priests and philosophers had spread from cities to wilderness, had turned from mere intentions to wicked works, and had reached from the surface of the earth to the lofty mountains. He saw that they had greatly exceeded the bounds and had escalated their pattern of offence to the extreme. The Glorious Lord saw that they had subjected a great deal of people to trial through their devilish obscure points, intricate philosophy, peculiar illusions, the magic of their knowledge, the spell of their arts, and their great deception. He found them plundering the religion and faith of the people, enchanting the hearts of people and their eyes and their ears, treading on beaten as well as unexplored paths to misguide creation,

making the darkness appear as light through the potency of their [deceptive] sorcery.

Being inspired by their actions, a group of Hindus has emerged who call themselves '*Ārya*'. They claim that, 'We do not believe in any book except our Vedas, which were revealed in the beginning of the world.' In reality their Vedas teach nothing except worshipping the sun, moon, stars, fire, water, and air. Moreover, if sons are not born to their wives, their Vedas enjoins them to let their wives commit adultery and by these means produce a male issue for them, and they should persist with this manner forever for their salvation. In their religious terminology, this act is called *Niyog* and they believe it to be a pious act. Such is their religious code and such are the injunctions of their holy book.

Despite all this evil, they stop their people from embracing Islam and, out of their evil and wickedness, they abuse the Best of Creation and persist in revilement, vituperation, and blasphemy, and produce books in refutation of Islam. Their refutation is nothing but a pile of fabrications. All these evils were initiated by the Christian priests and the earth has been shaken with a violent shaking. Allah is the Best Guardian and Refuge. One of the great and blessed Signs is that when He found the depravity of the Christians and saw them vigorously hindering people from religion and saw them maligning the Messenger of Allah and being contemptuous unto him, while on their other hand extravagantly exaggerating the status of Ibn-e-Maryam [the son of Mary], then His wrath was aroused with His honour and He addressed me, saying:

انى جاعلك عيسى ابن مريم و كان الله على كل شيء مقتدرا.

[I have made you 'Īsā ibn-e-Maryam (Jesus, son of Mary)  
and Allah has power to do all that He wills.]

Accordingly, I am the **honour of Allah** which appeared at its time so that the people who exaggerated in the matter of 'Īsā [Jesus], should

realize that ʿĪsā is not peerless as Allah is. Rather, Allah has the power to appoint someone from the followers of His Prophet as ʿĪsā and it was indeed a promise bound to be fulfilled.

O brethren! This was the matter which Allah kept concealed from the eyes of the earlier centuries and He revealed its details in this age of ours. He conceals whatsoever He pleases and reveals whatsoever He pleases and the example of this practice has appeared in the past. In adopting this manner of concealment, there are two matters of great wisdom which Allah deemed desirable and appropriate for His servants. The first of them is that indeed this great event is from the prophecies of the unseen and the time of its fulfilment was far away. Allah knew that it would not come to fulfilment except after a long period of time and demise of many generations from this world. He knew that the disclosure of this concise prophecy and its lengthy details would be of no avail to the earlier people.

He also knew that before this great event came to pass all of these people would be dead and its details would be of no avail to them. He wanted to grant them the blessings of faith in place of what they had lost and to endow them with the best reward for their faith. Therefore, He left out the details of this great event in his revelation and chose to keep it as a brief, subtle and abstruse event like a mystery. Then He also embellished this brief account with metaphors and imbued it with similes and allegories and kept it far away from intellects, speculations, and conjectures, so that He may try as to who from among them follows the injunction. When they came to believe, Allah was pleased with them and rewarded them with the best reward because they had put good faith in Allah and His Prophet by believing a thing, the true reality and essence of which they could not fully grasp.

As far as the second aspect of wisdom is concerned, Allah—glorified be His name—has willed to try the latter generations as He had tried the earlier ones so that He might forgive their sins and pave the way for them to guidance on account of their faith. They committed

vices and wasted centuries and ages in it. Their passions had governed them till they were no longer in control of their selves. They squandered their harvest in their selfish desires and became like unto barren soil. Thus, Allah manifested that succinct and concealed prophecy of great importance against their understanding so that He may try their knowledge, intellect, and cognition, and grant the believers a twofold reward out of His mercy, and pave a way for them to win His pleasure. All of this was nothing but a trial from Him, so that He might distinguish between the sincere believers and others, and turn towards them with compassion and mercy, and bring disgrace to the intellects of those who acted arrogantly and made the Servant of Allah and his teaching the object of ridicule and mockery.

It is a Divine practice that when God desires to subject a sinful people to a trial, then at times He makes the promised prophecy ambiguous to them, and twists their intellects and apprehensions such that they do not grasp the secret of Allah's promise nor its appointed time, so as to make them taste the evil of their past deeds and make them among those who became the enemies of a truthful servant and exceeded in tyranny and bigotry. Consequently, He makes the true interpretation of the prophecy unrecognizable in their eyes; thus, they consider it to be a pack of many fabricated lies. They cannot fly as high as the wise men do, nor see the veiled Signs in this hidden prophecy, nor do they fear the trial from Allah which particularly befalls the evil ones; rather, they quarrel like the blind. Do people think that they will be left alone because they say, 'We believe', and that they will not be tested with various kinds of trials, while similar practices of Allah have already manifested? In it lies a lesson for every heart that fears and trembles.

So beware, O ye who have eyes! Ask those who possess knowledge should the matter be dubious to you. Do you wonder that the ways of the earlier people have been disclosed to you? Do you wonder that Allah has sent down to you an Arbiter revealing the secret of this prophecy and he has unveiled the face of this prophecy? Is it an



unacceptable matter in your eyes? You have forgotten what was told to you that indeed the Messiah would descend unto you as Hakam [Arbiter] and Adl [Judge].

What is wrong with you that you refuse to accept the decree of your Arbiter? Have you forgotten what the Holy Prophet said and advised? If you believe yourself to be right and true, why don't you present a precedent from the past? Whereas Allah has indeed said that surely the examples of His ways are found in earlier peoples. Do you know of any person who ascended to heaven and then descended after centuries as you think of 'Īsā [Jesus]? God is my Witness, this indeed is contrary to the ways of Allah and you will never find its precedent in Divine scriptures.

You have read in the authentic books of Hadith that the Messiah joined his deceased brothers and took a place near his brother Yaḥyā [John the Baptist]. Indeed, Allah has promised those who die in a state of submission that they would not be returned to the world and would abide in the blessed abode forever. The Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, said, 'I have been apprised that I will live up to half the age of Jesus' life.'<sup>1</sup> This hadith serves as evidence for anyone who has a heart or for one who perceives with deep insight. So the Ahl-e-Hadith should judge by the *aḥādīth* of the Holy Prophet<sup>sa</sup>s recorded in the authentic books of Hadith; moreover, they should refrain from indulging in the debate regarding his descent without first proving his bodily ascent to the lofty heavens. Had Allah willed He would have granted hearing to their ears, insight to their eyes, and wisdom to their hearts, but He willed to try them with what He had provided them, and that He may humiliate him whom He desired to be humiliated in this world and the Hereafter.

If the Ahl-e-Hadith had believed and practised righteousness, Allah would have removed their sins and counted them among the

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1. *Kanzul-'Ummāl, Kitābul-Faḍā'il*, Faḍā'il Ahlul-Bait, Hadith 37731, published by Dārul-Kutub al-'Ilmiyyah, Beirut, Lebanon, 2004 [Publisher]

truthful, but they behaved niggardly and hastily and chose the crooked path. They followed the footsteps of the foolish who had passed before them and forgot everything they were advised, preferring the easy way for their world. They cannot harm Allah with their malicious schemes even if they were capable of moving mountains with their plot. Never consider them safe from the grasp of Allah and do not mistake the enmity of truth as a trivial offence. Allah will surely fulfil His promise and help His servant. If they incline towards peace, it is better for them, but if they transgress, Allah will soon disgrace and humiliate them.

I have indeed perfected my argument incontrovertibly against them and have read out the conclusive proofs of my truthfulness but they did not cast so much as even a mere glance at it. Do they not see that Allah has pronounced the death of the Messiah [Jesus] at several places? The entire Quran is filled with it, whereas you cannot find a single word or phrase to prove he is alive. The statement of the Messiah [Jesus] in the Quran is sufficient for you:

وَكُنْتُ عَلَيْهِمْ شَهِيدًا مَّا دُمْتُ فِيهِمْ فَلَمَّا تَوَفَّيْتَنِي كُنْتُ أَنتَ الرَّقِيبَ عَلَيْهِمْ<sup>1</sup>

Look how conclusively this proves that the Messiah had died and passed away! If the descent and second coming of the Messiah was predestined, he would have invariably mentioned two added testimonies in his statement, saying, 'I was a witness over them and was a witness over them again for a second time' and would not have remained restricted to the first testimony alone.

Allah the Exalted says:

فِيهَا تَحْيَوْنَ<sup>2</sup>

1. And I was a witness over them as long as I remained among them, but since Thou didst cause me to die, Thou has been the Watcher over them (*Al-Maidah*, 5:118). [Publisher]
2. Therein shall you live...(*Sūrah al-A'rāf*, 7:26). [Publisher]

Thus, He has limited the life of people to this earth just as He has restricted their deaths to its dust. Do you forsake the Word of Allah and the testimony of His Prophet<sup>sas</sup> and follow other sayings? An evil abode is for the wrongdoers.

O ye people! Allah has revealed this secret to me and taught me what you did not know, and He has sent me to you as *Hakam* [Arbiter] and *Adl* [Judge], so that I might manifest unto you what was concealed from you. Hence, you should not entertain any doubt nor indulge in disputes; rather, ponder upon His Words:

يُعِيسَىٰ إِنِّي مُتَوَفِّيكَ<sup>1</sup>

and read this verse up to the words <sup>2</sup>يَوْمَ الْقِيَامَةِ [the Day of Resurrection]. Think deeply and see how Allah began with the death of the Messiah and related the entire episode of ‘Isā in chronological order, ending it with the words يَوْمَ الْقِيَامَةِ [the Day of Resurrection], but in this entire sequence—reading this verse up to the words *Day of Resurrection*—He never mentioned the descent of the Messiah [Jesus] anywhere.

He did not mention anything new in this sequence of events because in Allah’s knowledge, his descent was nothing but the descent of his aims and objectives on the manifestation of his Second Coming who would come close and draw near to him in his faculties. He dyed his second appearance in his hue and made him a replica of himself in a manner till, by way of unification, he was lost in him and enveloped him and he resembled his original figure in faculties. His intellect grew close to his, his morals to that of his morals, his potential to that of his potential, and his nature to that of his nature till they became one with each other, and till they both were given the same name in Heaven.

If you are eager to delve deep into the depth of this mystery and

1. O Jesus, I will cause you to die *a natural death* (*Sūrah Āl-e-‘Imrān*, 3:56). [Publisher]

2. *Sūrah Āl-e-‘Imrān*, 3:56 [Publisher]

discover its sources in the clearest and most evident manner, then listen heedfully! I will reveal to you what my Lord has taught me about this matter from the secrets of guidance. It is that verily Allah saw in this age the complete dominance of the Christians and their fallacious dogmas. He saw that not only were they themselves misled, but they were misleading a great number of people as well. They have soiled the earth with the impurity of their polytheism and apostasy; wrought much corruption therein; disseminated their falsehood, fabrications and concocted lies; and opened the floodgates of sin and evil tendencies. Eventually, the wrath of Allah Almighty was enraged by seeing this great disorder and the Jealous [in point of love and honour] Lord revealed to His Word and Prophet [i.e. Jesus] about the trials of his followers, their mischief throughout the world, and their evil deeds. This is the way in which God reveals tidings, and you will never find any change or alteration in the ways of Allah.

When the Messiah [Jesus] heard that his followers have ruined the people of the earth and determined to waylay all of them, and rebelled a great rebellion against their Lord, then his pain and worry grew, he swelled with pity for his people, and he was overcome by sorrow and grief like the one who would try hard to help out the devastated, or like him upon whom it was quite obligatory to help the oppressed, and so he besought a Vicegerent from Allah. He desired his Vicegerent to be in unity with his true nature, to bear resemblance to his essence, to work as his limbs in order to fulfil his objectives, and to be a manifestation of his goals. Therefore, in order to fulfil his desire he turned his focus to this earthly world and besought the Divine decree to grant him a Vicegerent who would display his true image as a pond reflects the clear images of stars in the high heavens.

I am that very Vicegerent whom—in honour to His glory—Allah has sent during the age of the predominance of Christianity in order to console the soul of the Messiah [Jesus] and as a mercy to the whole world and as compassion upon the condition of creation. I have come

from Allah to break the cross that has been glorified, and to slaughter the swine such that it may never be revived again. My Lord has chosen me for His appointed time. Verily Allah never breaks His promise or covenant.

O men of reason! His promise was indeed to raise the Messiah [Jesus] during the very time of the attack from the mischief of the Cross and Christian vice. If you are in doubt about what we have said, then—O wise ones!—ponder over the saying of His Prophet; that is, يَكْسِرُ الصَّلِيبَ [*yaksiruş-şalīb*—‘He will break the cross’]. Open your eyes and cast a deep look into this era of yours, and note the people who have instigated the greatest turmoil; hence, bear witness on oath: ‘Has the time not come for the advent of the Breaker of Cross?’

By Allah, I have been sent by my Lord. The spirit of the Messiah has been breathed into my heart and I have been made a vessel for his intentions and inclinations until I was filled—body and soul—with it, and until my being was strung into his to the extent that his spiritual body can be seen in my being. His essence was absorbed into my heart and a light of his soul sparked which was perfectly accepted by my soul. I was so closely attached to him that I imagined that I was him. Accordingly, my being disappeared, and the Messiah was reflected within my mirror of being, manifesting himself. I imagined that my heart, liver, veins, and the fabric of my whole being was filled with his being and this particular being of mine is nothing but a part of the essence of his being. This was all done by my Glorious and Exalted Lord.

In the beginning of my mission he was as close to me as a sea is to a boat, then he drew nearer and came down. Then he became to me as water in a waterskin, so much so that his soul began to ripple in my body, then I became a non-existent entity. I found him as sugar dissolved in water, incapable of one being separated from the other. I have found through my spiritual sense that he has become one with my

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1. *Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī, Kitābul-Maḏālim*, Bāb Kasruş-Şalīb wa Qatlul-Khinzīr, Hadith 2476 [Publisher]

being, and my being has been immersed into his, and my nature has been lost into his sublime nature; thus, we have become one entity entitled with one and the same name. This is the truth that we have learned from our Lord, so decree what you wish to decree, but fear Allah and do not incline towards worldly desires.

Here, the crux of the matter is that the Prophets, who have departed and entered Paradise, focus their energies towards the earth through such occasions as Allah provides the opportunities for their manifestations. When the time of such manifestations arrives, Allah turns their eyes towards the earth and they find disorder and injustice in it, and they see that the earth is filled with evil, falsehood, polytheism, and apostasy. So, when it becomes evident for one of them that these evils and disorders are due to the rebellion of his followers, his soul is deeply disturbed and he prays to Allah that He may send him to the earth to guide them to the right path. Thus, Allah raises a Vicegerent for him who resembles him in his nature and He sends down his soul, by way of reflection, on the being of that Vicegerent.

That Vicegerent then becomes an heir to his name and knowledge and acts in accordance with his objectives. This is the true nature of the descent of Elijah mentioned in the old scriptures; the descent of 'Īsā [Jesus], peace be upon him; and the advent of our Prophet Muhammad, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, in terms of morals and character, in the person of the Mahdi. Every saintly Reformer enjoys—to a lesser or greater extent—a kind of proximity to the Prophets. He who had cleansed himself from the filth of prejudices would not harbour any doubt about it and would find the Holy Quran and the traditions in support of it.

O ye honourable ones! Verily the Being of God is a wonderful Being and His actions exemplify such rare mysteries that their true nature cannot be fathomed by the human mind. Among these secrets is the personification of angels and jinns. Among these secrets is the mystery regarding the true nature of the descent of the Messiah [Jesus] that is difficult to understand. Most people fail to fathom the depth of

its essence. I do not see anything in their nature except anger. It is only the Holy Quran that unveils its true essence. See how the Holy Quran elucidates the true meaning of نَزُول [nuzūl—‘descent’] in its sublime verses. Ponder over the Word of Allah Almighty:

وَأَنْزَلْنَا الْحَدِيدَ<sup>1</sup>

And in His Word, glorified be His eminence:

قَدْ أَنْزَلْنَا عَلَيْكُمْ لِبَاسًا<sup>2</sup> وَأَنْزَلَ لَكُمْ مِنَ الْأَنْعَامِ<sup>3</sup>

and in many other of His Words and in many other verses.

وَمَا نُنَزِّلُهُ إِلَّا بِقَدَرٍ مَعْلُومٍ<sup>4</sup>

You know only too well that these objects do not plop down from heaven; rather, they come into existence and develop upon the earth or beneath its surface. If you perceive deeply into the Book of Allah Almighty, it will be clearly revealed to you that the nature of the Messiah’s descent is like the case of the descent just mentioned. So ponder over our word and examine it deeply; for, it is not befitting that the Word of God bear any internal contradiction, nor shall you encounter any discrepancy in His verities. The comprehensive and commanding Word that guides towards the truth and judges between us and our people is the glorious verse of *Sūrah at-Tāriq* which reminds one of the secret overlooked by the slaves of desires; namely, the Word of the Almighty:

1. And We sent down iron... (*Sūrah al-Ḥadīd*, 57:26). [Publisher]

2. We have indeed sent down to you raiment (*Sūrah al-A‘rāf*, 7:27). [Publisher]

3. And He has sent down for you....cattle... (*Sūrah az-Zumar*, 39:7). [Publisher]

4. And We send it not down except in a known measure (*Sūrah al-Ḥijr*, 15:22). [Publisher]

وَالسَّمَاءِ ذَاتِ الرَّجْعِ ۝ وَالْأَرْضِ ذَاتِ الصَّدْعِ ۝ إِنَّهُ لَقَوْلُ فَصْلٍ ۝ وَمَا هُوَ إِلَّا هَزْلٌ ۝ اِنَّهُمْ يَكِيدُونَ  
كَيْدًا ۝ وَآكِيْدٌ كَيْدًا<sup>1</sup>

Know—O dear ones!—that this verse is such a surging ocean of secrets that no mind had ever encompassed it and no intellect amongst creation had ever touched upon it. My Lord has disclosed to me the secrets of this verse, exclusively choosing me for this. Its detail is that Allah Almighty has surely pointed out in this particular verse that heaven contains influencing elements and the earth consists of influenced elements. So, the decree descends from heaven to earth, and the earth gleefully receives it without rejection. This indicates that all that is in the heavens, such as the sun, moon, stars, angels, the souls of the sacred—from the Messengers, Prophets, Truthful and other believers—exert their influences upon all that is on the earth to the extent required by the wisdom of the Holy Lord. Hence, the heaven turns towards the earth with innumerable kinds of descent and passages and the earth welcomes them via expansion and contraction by countless and immeasurable means.

The outcome of this رُجُوعٌ [*rujū'*—‘return of rain’] and الصَّدْعِ [*aṣ-ṣad'i*—opening of earth *with herbage*] produces things under the strata of the earth like silver, gold, iron, precious gems, and the like; as well as crops, trees, plants, fruits, springs, rivers, and everything that sprouts out of the earth; and camels, mules, horses, and every insect that crawls on the earth and every bird that flies in the air. Man is also the product of this process, and has been created in the best make, and has been granted superiority over every walking and crawling creature. This process also creates *wahy* [revelation], Prophethood, Messengership, reason, wisdom, decency, nobility, stupidity, ignorance, foolishness, meanness, and lack of modesty. One kind of this رُجُوعٌ وَصَّدْعٌ is the descent of the

1. By the cloud which gives rain after rain, and by the earth which opens out *with herbage*, it is surely a decisive word, and it is not a useless talk. Surely, they plan a plan, and I also plan a plan (*Sūrah at-Ṭāriq*, 86:12–17). [Publisher]



souls of Prophets and Messengers by way of reflection to all those who conform to them in nature, and resemble them by their disposition and character in truthfulness, loyalty, and piety.

Hence, it is evidently clear that the influence of stars is an established and well-known fact—one that can only be denied by an ignorant, idiotic, and foolish one who does not reflect on the Quran and goes on quarrelling like a blind man. This phenomenon of returning rain and bursting forth continues in the heavens and the earth since the very day God created them. He said:

اَتَيْنَا طُوعًا اَوْ كَرْهًا ۚ قَالَتَا أَتَيْنَا طَائِعِينَ ۝<sup>1</sup>

So, the heaven turns towards the earth as a man towards a woman. This is why the Merciful Lord chose the word الرَّجْعُ for heaven and الصُّدُوعُ for earth indicating that these two have a lasting bond as a male and female always meet and neither of them refuses or rebels. So, the heavenly effects continue to descend and the earth unceasingly accepts them, and this cycle does not halt for the blink of an eye, and had it not been like this the earth and all in it would have been corrupted. Allah said before these verses:

اِنَّكَ عَلَىٰ رَجْعِهِ لَقَادِرٌ ۝<sup>2</sup>

followed by:

وَالسَّيِّئَاتِ ذَاتِ الرَّجْعِ ۝<sup>3</sup>

1. 'Come ye both of you, willingly or unwillingly.' They said, 'We come willingly' (*Sūrah Hā Mim as-Sajdah*, 41:12). [Publisher]
2. Surely, He has the power to bring him back to life (*Sūrah at-Tāriq*, 86:9). [Publisher]
3. By the cloud which gives rain after rain (*Sūrah at-Tāriq*, 86:12). [Publisher]

What should make thee know to what this mentioning together of two kinds of الرجعين points out? Know for certain, Allah, indeed, points out that sending down the souls of the holy ones, repeatedly—by way of reflection—from heaven (that being the source of returning rain) to the earth is within Allah's omnipotence just as it is His power to raise the dead on the Day of Resurrection.

This indeed is a great and sublime point of wisdom. Hold it fast and grasp it with all your strength, and may Allah bestow upon you the best guidance. This is the secret of descent about which they differ. This, in fact, is a command from Him decreed and bound to occur. Know that Allah has different ways of disclosing the tidings of the unseen. At times, He discloses the desired facts in clear words, watches over them, and manifests what He wills and desires. Sometimes He speaks in allegories and metaphors in order to keep the matter concealed and try people with it. This, in fact, is the Divine way and practice that He keeps those happenings in secret and under a veil as per the demands of His wisdom, and He allows misconceived desires to arise. Consequently, the contrary views continue to develop.

When He wills to conceal the true nature of an event, He, sometimes, on those occasions makes great incidents appear small and insignificant, while a small event appears great and unique; and a blessed event to be fearful, while a frightening one heralds glad tidings. These are the four old practices of Allah as mentioned above. As far as an example of a great and magnificent event which Allah desired to appear small and trivial is the event of Badr, mentioned in the Quran for those who ponder and reflect. Verily, Allah made the enemies of Islam to appear small in numbers in the dream of His Prophet<sup>sas</sup> so that He might remove the fear from the hearts of the Muslims and let happen what He had decreed.

As far as examples of the magnification of a small event to appear great and unique is concerned, we have the glad tiding of the contemporaneous support of angels mentioned in the Holy Quran, so as to

soothe the hearts of the believers, ensuring they are not overcome by any fear in the battle. Verily, He gave His promise and glad tidings in the Quran that He would help them with five thousand angels. He mentioned this great number only as a glad tiding for them. While under the command of the Lord, even a single angel has power enough to turn the whole world upside down. Hence, there was no need to mention five thousand, or even five, but Allah desired to manifest a great help to them, so He chose such a number that clearly indicates the great number of helpers, thus conveying His intended message. Then He informed the believers after the victory of Badr that the number of angels was not meant literally, rather, it had an interpretation known only to Allah the Great and Exalted. He did this so that their hearts might be at rest with this glad tiding, and it might reassure them and increase their hopes.

As regards an example of how an event of glad tidings was desired by Allah to appear as fearful, one mentioned in the Holy Quran is the incident of the vision of Abraham, may Allah send peace and blessings upon him. When the Almighty willed to turn to him with compassion and exalt his rank in Divine nearness, making him His chosen friend, he was shown in a vision—by way of metaphor—that he was sacrificing his beloved son, for the sake of Allah the Exalted. Its true interpretation was to slaughter a sheep, and not his son, but Abraham was afraid not to follow it literally. Hence, he hastened to obey the command and attempted to slaughter his son. However, the event he saw in his vision was never meant to be executed in a literal sense. If it were so, he would have been compelled to slaughter his son as he had seen in the vision, but he was powerless to do so. Hence, it is proven that this event had a different interpretation which Abraham could not apprehend.

How can a person comprehend something which Allah did not allow to be comprehended, but rather He desired to put a veil on it? You are well aware that a false vision is never revealed to the Prophets. Know for sure that Abraham's dream of slaughtering his son was in a figurative and metaphorical garb so that Allah may warn him out of

His mercy, yet expose to the world his sincerity and submission for his Lord, and that He may try Abraham in his truthfulness, loyalty, and submission to his Lord. So, Abraham immediately threw his beloved son down on his forehead to slaughter him.

O my Lord! Have mercy on us through Your Prophet<sup>sas</sup> and Abraham who remained loyal, saw Your blessings, and achieved goodness and prosperity. This affair resembles that of the *Dajjāl* [the Antichrist] because it has been made frightening, fearsome, intense, and awe-striking, and its matter has been described at length. Indeed, that affair is nothing but a well-connected sequence of the evil intentions of the *Dajjāl* that is completely devoid of the fragrance of Divinity and the attributes of Allah. It is nothing but an invitation towards mischief, malicious designs, and misguided temptations; indeed, it is a trial from Allah, the Self-Sufficient.

How can there be an equal to the Creator who holds sway over the Kingdom of the heavens and the earth, and who carries Heaven, Hell, and all the treasures of the earth with Him? The clouds of the sky, the water of the ocean, and the sun of the sky obey His command, and He gives life and causes death. Holy is He who is without blemish and has no equal. He is Glorious and Exalted. Nay, but it is rather a subtle metaphor pointing towards a people who shall behave arrogantly in the earth and shall hasten forth from every height. These are the Christian people who are far advanced in deceit and fabrication, and they have populated the earth more than it had ever been populated. You see extraordinary qualities in their accomplishments, which captivate us. The whole world is awestruck by their inventions and unique artifice, and they have caused many people to go astray through their innovations and deceit. Their deceptive fabrications have encompassed the whole earth, made its face filthy, and confused falsehood with the truth. They call people towards polytheism, impertinence, and atheism—this is how they entice. How could it be possible for the *Dajjāl* to appear from the Jewish people, for they were smitten with abasement and wretchedness till the Day of Resurrection, and would never have

the power to rule, nor would they emerge victorious? Do you not see the promise of Allah; that is, His Words:

وَجَاعِلُ الَّذِينَ اتَّبَعُوكَ فَوْقَ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا إِلَى يَوْمِ الْقِيَمَةِ<sup>1</sup>

Do you not reflect? Do you not ponder over the Quran as to how it has placed everything other than God beneath our feet and has given us the glad tidings of the glory of the *Kalimah* [declaration of faith in Islam] of Oneness till Doomsday? How is it that your hearts have become perverse and you believe in what contradicts the Quran, and have become heretical? Would Allah take someone as His equal in the Latter Days, even if it were only for a few days? Beware! Evil it is what you determine.

As far as an example of a traditionally well-known incident which Allah desired to appear as wonderful and noble, such is the incident of Pharaoh's dream mentioned in the Quran. He said:

إِنِّي أَرَى سَبْعَ بَقَرَاتٍ سَاهَنَ يَأْكُلُهُنَّ سَبْعٌ عَجَافٌ وَسَبْعُ سُنبُلَاتٍ خُضِرَ وَأُخْرٍ يُسَبِّتُ يَأْكُلُهَا الْمَلَأُ  
أَفْتُونِي فِي رَأْيَايَ إِن كُنْتُمْ لِلرَّءْيَاءِ تَعْبُرُونَ<sup>2</sup>

Likewise was the dream of Yūsuf [Joseph], peace be upon him:

إِذْ قَالَ يُوسُفُ لِأَبِيهِ يَا أَبَتِ إِنِّي رَأَيْتُ أَحَدَ عَشَرَ كَوْكَبًا وَالشَّمْسَ وَالْقَمَرَ رَأَيْتُهُمْ لِي سَاجِدِينَ<sup>3</sup>

Hence, these examples are decisive between us and our people and are

1. And will place those who follow thee above those who disbelieve, until the Day of Resurrection (*Sūrah Āl-e-Imrān*, 3:56). [Publisher]
2. I see in a dream seven fat cows whom seven lean cows are eating, and seven green ears of corn and seven others dried up. O ye chiefs, explain to me the meaning of my dream if you can interpret a dream (*Sūrah Yūsuf*, 12:44). [Publisher]
3. Remember the time when Joseph said to his father, 'O my father, I saw in a dream eleven stars and the sun and the moon, I saw them making obeisance to me' (*Sūrah Yūsuf*, 12:5). [Publisher]

a sufficient statement regarding that in which they used to differ. The event of the Messiah's descent bears a resemblance to what has been mentioned above. Allah has concealed it as He has concealed these events in metaphors. Grasp it if ye be wise. It is against Divine practice to completely manifest His tidings in every time and age; rather, He—at times—tries His servants by concealing His prophecies and subtly mentioning their secrets while they perceive it not.

As far as the incident that was rare and unique is concerned, one which Allah desired its true meaning to be known, its example in the Quran is what Allah Almighty has revealed about the bounties of the Paradise: its rivers, milk, trees, fruits, and the meat of the known and admired birds. He conceals and reveals whatsoever He pleases. All His acts carry much wisdom, expedience, and bear trials, but most of the people do not know. They know only the obvious and literal commands of the Shariah and its shell, being completely unaware of its essence. When a secret is revealed unto them, their eyes look down upon it, and they think an evil thought and repudiate it. They contend, 'How did the whole Ummah develop a consensus on error and how should we assume that all of them erred and only you are right?' Woe be upon them!

Do they not know that Allah has the absolute power over His decree? When He desires to conceal a matter then even the wise cannot perceive it. They recite the ways of Allah in the Quran but remain heedless of it. Do they not see that at times, Allah keeps a matter concealed even from His chosen Prophets, and they are consequently put to trial by its concealment? It is not for a people to surpass the Prophet in its understanding, nor is it the way of Allah to leave them alone without any trial:

أَحْسِبَ النَّاسُ أَنْ يُتْرَكُوا أَنْ يَقُولُوا آمَنَّا وَهُمْ لَا يُفْتَنُونَ<sup>1</sup>

1. Do men think that they will be left alone because they say, 'We believe,' and that they will not be put to trial? (*Sūrah al-Ankabūt*, 29:3) [Publisher]

Verily Allah tries all peoples with His tidings of the unseen and He tried even Ḥaḍrat Fārūq and others like him.

Are you superior to them? What is the matter with you that you do not fear the trial of Allah? It is possible that the prophecy about the descent of the Messiah is a trial for you. What is the matter with you that you do not practice righteousness? Are you wiser than those who have passed before you, or have you been exempted from the trials of Allah? What is the matter with you that you do not reflect? Indeed, many trials have passed before so blessed are those who open their eyes and take heed from them.

They contend, 'How can they come to believe in this Messiah while we have been informed that he would descend near a minaret in Damascus,<sup>1</sup> would slay the *Dajjāl*, and would fight and defeat the enemies?' They present this kind of flawed argumentation. They have lost their understanding and have erred. Do they not know that the Promised Messiah would put an end to war?<sup>2</sup> Do they not read *Ṣaḥīḥ Bukhārī* or have they forgotten it? From where have they been apprised of, and by which piece of evidence have they come to believe, that the Messiah would descend in Damascus,<sup>3</sup> the capital of Syria? Did the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, accompany them to Damascus and show them the minaret and his place of descent or display its picture on a piece of paper that they so recognize it and could not deny it? Or is this a city holier than Makkah, or does it hold superiority over all other cities, there living only the pure?

They are misled merely by the word 'Damascus' used in the sayings of our Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him. In fact, it has a general meaning, and it also carries various connotations as is known to the men of knowledge. Among these meanings are, 'a town',

1. *Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim, Kitābul-Fitan*, Bāb Dhikrud-Dajjāl, Hadith 7373 [Publisher]
2. *Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī*, Juzw 1, Kitābul-Anbiyā', Bāb Nuzūl 'Īsā ibn Maryam, published by Maktabah Raḥmāniyyah, Urdu Bazar, Lahore [Publisher]
3. *Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim, Kitābul-Fitan*, Bāb Dhikrud-Dajjāl, Hadith 7373 [Publisher]

‘the name of a chief from the progeny of Canaan’, ‘she-camel and camel’, ‘a skilled person who works deftly with his hands’, and many others. By what right do they insist on applying only a particular meaning to this word while rejecting the others? Likewise, the word ‘minaret’ used in the hadith also connotes ‘a place of light’ and, at times, it is also used to signify a guiding light. This indicates that the Promised Messiah will be known by the lights that appear before his advent. These lights serve as signposts that lead the travellers to the right path.

Its similitude is found in the Word of the Almighty in the Holy Quran:

وَدَاعِيًا إِلَى اللَّهِ بِأَذْنِهِ وَبِسِرَاجٍ مُنِيرٍ<sup>1</sup>

As a lamp is known by its light, so will the Messiah be known by his light.

During the time of Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>, the existence of any minaret to the east of Damascus was never proven nor did he ever allude to it. Had it been so, the liars would have created doubt in relation to it. These are well-known metaphors and the men of understanding know them too well; no one disputes them but the unjust. Do they not reflect on the ways of Allah, or is their denial a result of the advent of something which has never come before? If you follow the Divine secrets and do not deny them, then tell us what the secret was behind specifically mentioning the town of Damascus and its minaret? Do you wonder at this metaphor and do you not know that the discourse of Prophets and their speech is wrapped in the mantle of metaphors?

Remember the words of Abraham, peace be on him; that is, غَيْرَ عَتَبَةٍ <sup>2</sup> بَابِكَ [‘Change the threshold of your door’] then look how Ishmael,

1. And as a Summoner to Allah by His command, and as a radiant Lamp (*Sūrah al-Aḥzāb*, 33:47). [Publisher]

2. *Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī*, Kitāb Aḥādīthul-Anbiyā’, Bāb Yaziffūn..., Hadith 3364 [Publisher]



peace be on him, grasped the hidden message of his father. Did he take the threshold as literal, or did he take it to mean his wife? Look at how Umar, may Allah be pleased with him, took the breaking of a door as an omen of his death, rather than taking a literal meaning. Read the hadith related by Hudhaifah recorded in *Ṣaḥīḥ Bukhārī* for your guidance.

They say that the Promised Messiah will only appear during the time of the appearance of the *Dajjāl* and Gog and Magog, and they claim that since they have not yet witnessed any of them, how can they possibly follow the Messiah if he appears beforehand? The reply is: Know—may Allah guide you to the right path—that these two are the names of a people whose branches have spread all around in these Latter Days. They resemble each other in characteristics. Indeed, they are the people of Russia, Britain, and their brethren. The *Dajjāl* are the missionaries who invite to the message of the Gospel and confuse the truth with falsehood, and in this way they deceive. They have made Hindustan the centre of their activities. Thus, the word of our Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, has proved true that they will appear from the East. Accordingly, they have appeared from the eastern part of Hindustan.

If *Dajjāl* are other than what I say, or Gog and Magog are other than these nations, then it entails contradiction and conflict in the word of our Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him. I swear by God, the word of our Prophet<sup>sas</sup> is free of this blemish; rather, it is you who deviate from the truth. Do you not read in the most authentic book after the Book of Allah that the Messiah shall break the cross? It contains the clear indication that the Messiah will arrive at a time when people would be venerating the cross. Do you not understand? Surely, it has become manifest that they are the enemies of truth, and they wander blindly in their evil desires. In fact, they rule over the eastern parts of the land, and the western parts thereof, and hasten forth from every height. Indeed, their treachery in matters of faith and disorder in religious law and in everything they concoct have become manifest.

Do you find any space left for your imaginary *Dajjāl* to place his feet on the earth as long as they are there? Pity be upon your reason! How do you create a *Dajjāl* other than the clerics of this [Christian] nation? And on which part of the land will you make him rule over? Do you not know that the Promised Messiah will come only at the time of the domination of the people of the cross? How are you being turned away? Don't you see that Allah has established the power of these peoples over the greater part of the world and has sent down rain for them in abundance and has given them the means for everything and has supported them in everything they do? Now, how is it possible for anyone, as you presume, other than them to govern the whole world other than them?

I am surprised by your understanding! Are you awake or asleep? Have you forgotten that you believe that the Messiah shall come to break the cross? If the *Dajjāl* were to hold the power over the whole world, then how would the cross and its believers—the Christians—have an impact along with him? Do you not understand?

O ye ignorant ones! Do you not realize that these two things contradict each other and cannot coexist at the same time? When you believe that the *Dajjāl* will have supremacy over the whole world except two Holy Cities—Makkah and Madinah—then what space is left for the dominance of the cross and its believers? Can you establish its truthfulness and testify to it? What has happened to you that you do not realize this glaring contradiction? Some of your statements run contrary to your other statements, and you have deceived others regarding the sayings of the Prophet of Allah (peace and blessings of Allah be upon him), yet you declare yourselves to be true on oath.

You continue to deceive those who are weak at heart, in reason, and wisdom. You embellish your falsehood in their eyes and alter the word of Allah and His Messenger with addition or deletion. You cannot remove these contradictions or mend them or reconcile them however much you may desire, even if you were to help one another.

Do not completely incline towards falsehood knowingly. If you accept the truth and become righteous, Allah will surely turn to you in mercy and forgive you all that was in the past. Thus, the scholars of Hadith should ponder over it carefully and those who do not follow the guidance despite being provided with guidance are surely the transgressors.

O ye people! The Signs of the Latter Days have appeared, so why are you in doubt regarding the coming of the Messiah? Come ye that I may recount some of them for you, that you might follow the right way. Among them is that the fire of mischief and error has gathered the people from the east to the west. There is an exhortation in that for the righteous. Iblis has advanced upon the people from their fore, their rear, and their left, and they are consigned to perdition for what they have wrought. No one is saved from the trial of Allah except the one upon whom He has mercy. The waves of error came in between them and their faith and they were drowned. The majority of them increased in disbelief and enmity, and after becoming apostates, they transgressed in their fabrications. They strived their hardest to extinguish the light of Islam but failed to harm it and could not prevail over it. They touched the Book of Allah and found it filled with manifest proofs and light, and they returned frustrated.

This is something great in the eyes of those who dispute with you wrongfully and arrogantly, but the transgressors do not fear Allah, neither abandoning their worldly pursuits nor becoming righteous. Allah has taken away the light of their hearts and the sight of their eyes because they have disobeyed, and He left them in thick darkness so they do not see. Their hearts are wrapped in covers and their eyes are like opaque glasses. They know nothing except eating and drinking. They have abandoned Allah, the One, and bow down before their idols. Their mischief has increased, and their adversity against the Muslims has intensified. They thrive every passing day and their prosperity and progress are on the rise. You can see them from every peak, and they continue to grow in their worldly pursuits.

You see that Islam has become like a fruitless withered branch and its condition is akin to a hen that no longer lays eggs. It is high time for the mourners to weep. The trust it possessed and the station of honour it held have vanished. The vestiges of honesty have been obliterated and its burial has been performed. Knowledge has been buried alive, the scholars have passed away, and only those are left who are like pythons. They know neither religion nor honesty. They run after their worldly desires. Of those who call themselves Muslims, the majority of them disobey their Lord. They drink wine, fornicate, oppress people, and bear false witness. They do not obey and do not lend a generous hand to the needy, but extend their hands towards evil deeds.

All these calamities befell them when their hearts were occupied with Western knowledge and the Christian concept of freedom spread in their lands. Hence, they were pulled towards them. This is the great event that was clearly predicted by the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, and you read or hear it recorded in *Ṣaḥīḥ Bukhārī*. Thus, look at the alluring designs of the Western philosophies—how they have pulled the youth towards the West.

O ye believers! Look, how Allah has fulfilled the prophecy of His Messenger. Know that here the fire means the fire of mischief that has come from the West and has burned the robes of righteousness. At times the foolish are scared of its flames, but on other occasions the fire is mistaken for a light in their eyes—seducing them against their will—they being led astray by it. Do not take these prophecies in a literal sense and do not turn away from what you observe. Know for certain that the words of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, have such a lofty and elevated status that no one can grasp their true meanings except the one whom Allah has bestowed with an abundant provision of insight, and has granted him a wise heart, a penetrating eye, keen ears, and special knowledge from His Lord.

No one is granted this secret wisdom except the ones who no longer have their own eyes and personal opinions. They are lost in the Holy

Prophet (peace and blessings of Allah be upon him), totally alienating themselves from the orders of their selves and are fully imbued with the commandments issued from the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>. In short, their hearts are filled with the knowledge of the Prophet<sup>sas</sup> and they are granted a share from his lights, and it is from his spring that they drink. They are given a goodly share of purity and wisdom and drink from a cup that is tempered with the water of Tasnīm.<sup>1</sup> They are purified with the glory of Allah and His majesty and through His protection are they saved.

Then such a pious one becomes their heir who listens to their words with good intentions and humility, and follows them, remaining attached to them. He, overcoming his personal constraints, gives self-negating preference to their souls and fuses into them with his love. He then emerges as a hidden gem. Praise be to Allah who has made me one of them. Whoever wants to try me is free to do so.

In fact, I have come to them from my Lord with wisdom and insight to clarify to them their differences. They have split Islam into sects and made its followers split into many denominations. They attack each other and declare others disbelievers. Now, I call them to open ground for a battle. Is any one of them ready for combat? I called them to combat, but they turned away. Have they determined upon a course? Then surely, we too are determined. Do they think that Allah will not separate the bad from the good? What is the matter with them—how strangely do they think? Hence, I entrust my affairs to Allah and turn away from them; soon they will come to know.

From among the Signs of the Latter Days which have been revealed in the Holy Quran by Allah the Almighty are those rare events you observe and experience in this age. Indeed, He has manifested its Signs for us:

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1. تَسْنِيم (*Tasnīm*) is taken to be a fountain in Paradise. Figuratively, it means, the Word of God (See The Holy Quran with English Translation and Commentary, vol. 5, p. 3338, Note 4637, by Islam International Publications Limited, printed 2019). [Publisher]

وَإِذَا الْجِبَالُ سُيِّرَتْ ۝<sup>1</sup> وَإِذَا الْبِحَارُ فُجِّرَتْ ۝<sup>2</sup> وَإِذَا الْعِشَارُ عُطِّلَتْ ۝<sup>3</sup> وَإِذَا الْفُجُورُ  
 رُجِيَ ۝<sup>4</sup> وَإِذَا الصُّحُفُ نُشِرتْ ۝<sup>5</sup> إِذَا زُلْزِلَتِ الْأَرْضُ ۝<sup>6</sup> وَإِذَا الْأَرْضُ مُدَّتْ ۝<sup>7</sup> وَأَلْقَتْ مَا فِيهَا وَ  
 تَخَلَّتْ ۝<sup>8</sup> وَإِذَا الْكَوَاكِبُ انْتَثَرَتْ ۝<sup>9</sup> وَإِذَا الْوُحُوشُ حُشِرَتْ ۝<sup>9</sup>

He says:

There are Signs of the Latter Days in all these verses for a people who reflect. With your own eyes you have witnessed how the mountains have been made to move and were shaken from their stations—their pegs demolished, their summits flattened into depressions, and their ranges disappeared. You tread on their tracks and even run on them. Regarding the flowing forth of the rivers you have surely seen that Allah has raised a people who made the rivers to flow forth, diverted into canals. They continue to dig canals out of rivers. They have become the master of all the intricacies in the art of canalization, and have made the water flow into all barren valleys in order to populate the lands and protect their dwellers from the calamities of drought. This is how they work, that they may fully benefit from the land, and indeed they are the ones who benefit from it.

1. And when the mountains are made to move (*Sūrah at-Takwīr*, 81:4). [Publisher]
2. And when the rivers are made to flow forth *into canals* (*Sūrah al-Infīṭār*, 82:4). [Publisher]
3. And when the she-camels, ten month pregnant, are abandoned (*Sūrah at-Takwīr*, 81:5). [Publisher]
4. And when people are brought together (*Sūrah at-Takwīr*, 81:8). [Publisher]
5. And when books are spread abroad (*Sūrah at-Takwīr*, 81:11). [Publisher]
6. When the earth is shaken (*Sūrah az-Zilzāl*, 99:2). [Publisher]
7. And when the earth is spread out. And casts out *all* that is in her, and becomes empty (*Sūrah al-Inshiqāq*, 84:4–5). [Publisher]
8. And when the stars are scattered (*Sūrah al-Infīṭār*, 82:3). [Publisher]
9. And when the beasts are gathered together (*Sūrah at-Takwīr*, 81:6). [Publisher]

As far as abandoning the she-camel is concerned, it is indeed an indication towards the railway train that has rendered useless the ten-months pregnant and young she-camels, such that they are no longer used. Now the people travel by rail and put their goods and cargo on them. Therefore, they quickly go from one land to another. This indeed is out of the grace of Allah upon us and upon the people, but most of the people are ungrateful. Allah has put coverings over their hearts lest they should understand its secrets, and in their ears a deafness; thus, they listen not. They derive benefit from man-made inventions, even from those by disbelievers, but when they see a thing out of the mercy of Allah, they refuse to accept it.

As far as bringing people together is concerned it is, indeed, a multifaceted phenomenon. It alludes to the invention of the telegraph that helps people in every hour of distress, bringing them news about their beloved ones living in the far-off places of the world, and informing them about the state of affairs before the inquirer stands up from his seat. Through this device, the people of the East converse with the people of the West as if they are meeting in person. It communicates the conditions of the distressed in a very short time to those who are worried about their affairs. Undoubtedly, it brings two people together from two distant places so they may talk to one another as if there is no barrier between them and they are very close to each other.

Moreover, there is an indication in this to the prevailing peace along the sea and land routes and the removal of all hurdles. Therefore, in this day and age, people travel from one land to another without any fear. In fact, countries have strengthened ties with one another during this era, and their populations have developed a better acquaintance between them, so that they grow closer to one another with each passing day. Allah has brought the traders closer to traders, dwellers of both sides of the borders closer to each other, while uniting the craftsmen with their peers, such that they have begun to share in each other's profit and loss. They cooperate with each other in every comfort, delight,

clothing, food, and pleasure and things are transported from one part of the land to the other.

Look how people have been brought close together as if they are sitting on the same boat! Travel by land and sea has caused people to come together and through these voyages they get acquainted with one another. One of the means of such closeness is the letters that are sent swiftly through mail. Look how they are sent to the remote corners of the world! If you look deeply into the matter, the abundance of mail may cause you to wonder and you will not find the like of it in earlier times. Similarly, the abundance of travellers and traders may also cause you to wonder. In short, the means available today for bringing people close and for developing good acquaintance between them are unprecedented in history.

I beseech you by God! Have you ever seen or read in books anything the like thereof previously? As far as the spreading of books is concerned, it signifies their means of publication; that is, the invention of the printing press. As you see, Allah has raised a people who have invented the printing machines. Hence, you find plenty of printing presses established in Hindustan and other countries. This is an act of God in order to help us in our cause to spread our faith and books, and to convey our message to those who listen to it, that they might follow the right path.

As far as the shaking of the earth and its 'casting out' whatever is in her is concerned, it signifies the great revolution you are witnessing with your own eyes, a presage of the rise of many branches of worldly knowledge, new inventions, discoveries, innovations, evils, stratagems, deceptions, and all of their manufactures.

As far as the scattering of stars is concerned, it signifies the evils of the ulema and the departure of the righteous from the world. As you observe, the signs of true knowledge have become extinct and effaced, and some from the men of knowledge have passed away while others have become blind and deaf. Then Allah turned to them in mercy, yet



they remained blind and deaf and many of them were transgressors, indeed. Allah is Watchful of what they do.

As far as the gathering together of beasts is concerned, this signifies the abundance of the ignorant and the transgressors, as well as the disappearance of honesty and righteousness. You see with your own eyes that the water of the well of purity has dried up and its water has gradually become sunken. Most people are running towards evil, and in matters of faith they have become pliant. When they find evil, they quickly take it, and when they see good, they turn back on their heels. They look up to the inventions of the disbelievers with admiration but turn away from the creation of Allah.

O people! Look at the favours of Allah—how He has reformed your age and transformed the state of your times, and filled it with such wonders as your ancestors have never seen before, while you enjoy them! The Europeans have taught you the industry of train engines as a gift for you and your families, so be grateful. See how it runs in inhabited and uninhabited lands under your command, and you travel by them day and night, reaching your desired destinations without any fatigue. Likewise, the Europeans have instructed you in other industries such as the manufacture of agricultural machines, war weapons, construction devices, grinding devices, garment machines, and various kinds of vehicles for lifting and moving heavy objects.

Moreover, they also invented some devices for the decoration of cities and houses, as well as tools to facilitate arduous tasks. You constantly desire these things and utilize them. Every passing month and year, you see new, wonderful, and rare inventions the like of which you have never seen before. Some of them improve your living standards, and deliver you from hard labour, such as the matchbox by which you ignite, or the kerosene oil by which you kindle your lamps. There are then such products that decorate your houses and you happily purchase them.

Contemplate and reflect! Allah indeed is your Lord—the Glorious Lord who has granted you all the precious treasures of the world and

has filled your houses with them. Then, why do you wonder at the descent of heavenly treasures and distance yourselves from them? You become pleased with things of your temporal world and never look towards the provision of your Hereafter, never bothering about it. Why do you wonder at the descent of the Messiah and the days of spiritual blessings while you are witnessing the wonderful favours of Allah that have appeared, those which comfort your bodies in new fashion, as precious robes the likes of which were never found in the times of your ancestors? Do you believe in the wonders done by the disbelievers while you reject the act of God? You despair of Divine providence but do not despair of the power of the created.

What is the matter with you that you do not recognize the wondrous acts of Allah by His overt actions—ones which you can easily comprehend and manifestly observe? Did you ever know these wonders such as railways, telegraph, and other inventions before they appeared in your times? All of this was decreed in the Quran, but you could not understand it.

Likewise, you failed to understand the true nature of the descent of the Messiah because of your negligence, while it was so written in the Book of Allah. It is not for man to understand anything unless Allah makes him comprehend it, and here even the Prophets are no exception. Wonder upon wonder! You do not show any reluctance in using the new inventions which refresh your bodies, but when you are invited to the work of Allah who has made everything perfect, and you can use this work to be unique and wonderful, you show disgust and displeasure, deliberately refusing to accept it.

O ye people! I have not come to you with anything evil and surely Allah has borne witness to my truthfulness. You witness some of my Signs and find the description of my era written in the Book of Allah in which you believe. Allah has made the matter obscure in your eyes so that He may test your knowledge and righteousness. Thus, a trial suddenly befell you while you were heedless.

O my brethren! Hold fast to the Book of Allah and reflect upon it.

Has the time of Latter Days arrived, or are there still ages and centuries for it to come? You know that the Messiah will come in the Latter Days, and you have witnessed his Signs with your own eyes, and observed the extraordinary happenings in the world that the Holy Quran has foretold as the Signs of the Latter Days, and indeed you benefit from them.

What is wrong with you! You do not believe in the extraordinary heavenly phenomena that the holy verse speaks of; namely, Allah says:

إِذَا السَّمَاءُ كُشِطَتْ<sup>1</sup>

You incline to the earth and turn yourselves away from the heavenly favours. Surely, the Glorious Lord has given another glad tidings in this regard when He says: وَأَنَّا لَهُ لَحَافِظُونَ<sup>2</sup> but you forget the glad tidings of your Lord and renounce His Signs.

O dear ones! Know for a certainty that heaven and earth were closed up, then Allah opened them out, and the heaven was laid bare by His command, and split, and He let secrets descend from heaven and let the earth throw out its hidden treasures so that He might try His servant as to which way they turn. Wonders of the earth preceded over the wonders of heaven. So the people were beguiled by its inventions, wonderful sciences, and unique arts and were well-nigh ready to perish. But the Beneficent Lord beheld the earth and found it filled with perils and replete with so many disorders. He saw the people being allured by its inventions and found the Christians gone astray and misleading others. He found their philosophers deceiving people with their philosophies and rare arts, and these ideas took root into the hearts of the youth, thus creating a great chaos as if they were charmed and enticed to evil desires and pleasures, becoming like beasts and insects. They disobeyed their Lord, and their parents and noble elders. Their hearts became permeated with licentiousness and they were overcome

1. When the heaven is laid bare (*Sūrah at-Takwīr*, 81:12). [Publisher]

2. ...and most surely We will be its Guardian (*Sūrah al-Hijr*, 15:10). [Publisher]

by debauchery and impertinence. Thus, Allah willed to safeguard the honour of His Book and the followers of His religion against the evil consequences of these strange ideas, as He has promised in His Word:

إِنَّا نَحْنُ نَزَّلْنَا الذِّكْرَ وَإِنَّا لَهُ لَحَافِظُونَ<sup>1</sup>

So He fulfilled His promise and helped His servant with His grace and mercy and revealed to me that I might warn the people.

He has sent down many fine points of wisdom, knowledge, and manifestations of support from heaven to me so that He may rebut the peculiar arguments of the Christians and break their cross, prove their literature and scholars to be worthless, demolish their arguments, and render their old and new ones speechless. In fact, the manifestation of the abstruse phenomena of the world and its mischief is termed the Promised *Dajjāl* [Antichrist], and the manifestation of the heavenly miracles and its light is termed the Promised Messiah. These two are adversaries who face each other in the same era. The listeners should listen carefully!

The first of the many Signs of my truthfulness is that I have been sent at the time of the many disorders to which the Book of Allah has alluded. Thus, Allah has sent me down from heaven just as He has manifested disorders from the earth, and He spoke in metaphors and helped me as the truthful are helped. Look at the past ages since Allah created man. Have such immense upheavals ever spread and overcome the world, or have you ever heard about them or the like of their extraordinary phenomena in generations past?

What is the matter with you! You do not reflect. Don't you see how the Signs of Allah are being rejected by the discourses of the philosophers, and they are ridiculed and thousands of books have been written in their refutation?

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1. Verily, We Ourselves have sent down this Exhortation, and most surely We will be its Guardian (*Sūrah al-Hijr*, 15:10). [Publisher]

O ye historians! Have you ever heard such blasphemy against the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>, such vilification, and such attacks and mockery against his religion as you verily hear in this age? Have you ever heard such varieties of degradation perpetrated against the Book of Allah before, or such contempt for His Prophet<sup>sas</sup>, with abominable and tormenting discourse as your ears hear now? Then why are you surprised at the mercy of Allah amidst this turmoil?

O ye sleeping ones! Do you not see how they mock you and deride your religion? Allah punished their mockery and rendered them blind and deaf, and thus they possess no insight.

O my dear ones! Did an era dawn upon anyone the like of which has dawned upon you? You hear painful discourses from the People of the Book. They have transgressed in fabrication, accusation, and in inflicting pain. Islam has been subjected to such calamities as if donkeys are grazing upon the pastures of horses; as if dogs—out of intense eagerness—set their feasting eyes on the lion's den. After this, what greater misery are you waiting for?

Among the Signs of my truthfulness is that the Almighty has enabled me to follow His Messenger and obey His Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him. I did not encounter a saying of the Prophet<sup>sas</sup> but I followed it, nor a mountainous obstacle but I surmounted it. My Lord has joined me with those who are blessed.

Among the Signs of my truthfulness is that He reveals matters of the unseen to me in abundance. Surely, He reveals not His secrets to anyone except those who are sent [by Him].

Among the Signs of my truthfulness is that He accepts my prayers, takes care of my needs, blesses my deed and word, becomes the Friend of my friends and the Enemy of my enemies, and reveals to me what they try to conceal. Surely, He has listened to most of my sorrows and has elevated me when I prostrated before Him, and accepted such a great number of prayers that I cannot count them. He made my abode honourable and favoured me with such graces that I am short of words to describe them. He perfected His bounty on me in this world and in

the Hereafter, and made me among those who are helped. He addressed me and said:

يَا أَحْمَدِي أَنْتَ مُرَادِي وَمَعِي. أَنْتَ مِنِّي بِمَنْزِلَةِ تَوْجِيدِي وَتَقَرُّبِي. فَحَانَ أَنْ تُعَانَ  
وَتُعْرِفَ بَيْنَ النَّاسِ. أَنْتَ مِنِّي بِمَنْزِلَةٍ لَا يَعْلَمُهَا الْخَلْقُ.

O My Ahmad! You are My purpose and are with Me, you are to Me as My *Tauhid* [Oneness] and *Tafid* [Uniqueness]. The time has come that you should be helped and be made well known in the world. You are to Me in such an ultimate nearness of which the people cannot have any knowledge.

He addressed me with such words, that were I granted even the whole world it would not have pleased me as much as these affectionate words have pleased me. My soul is sacrificed in His way; He is my Guardian in this world and the Hereafter. I am never afflicted with any thirst, fatigue, or hunger, but He comes to my help. I see His bounties descending unceasingly upon me like those who tirelessly continue to perform their jobs.

Among the Signs of my truthfulness is that He has granted me the knowledge of the Quran and revealed to me the subtle points of the Furqān [Holy Quran]—those that none can touch except those who are purified.

Among the Signs of my truthfulness is that He has taught me good manners; refined my etiquette; and made patience, obedience, and compliance to my Lord, and following my Prophet as my disposition. He laid the treasures of true knowledge in my nature, revealed to me the true understanding of the good and evil aspects in different matters, and included me among those who are singularly unique in this regard.

O ye noble Arabs! The pious of the Two Holy Sanctuaries! These are the tidings and exhortations I have presented before the ulema of India. I warned them but they paid no heed; I admonished them but they did not learn their lesson; I awakened them but they did not rise.

They fell into the misconceptions of ignorance, and intended to declare me a disbeliever, and give me the lie. They tried to seize me by my collar and remained stubborn in their claims. I have perfected my argument against them, and the dawn of my truthfulness has shone upon them, but they refused to accept my message; their souls were convinced of it but their tongues continued to reject it. I find their hearts full of fear and their souls replete with agony and anguish.

The truth has been manifested to them but they feign ignorance. I see them splitting up and becoming divided into many groups about me. Some of them have testified to my truthfulness and they are among the humble and righteous; others have given the lie to me, have turned away and looked disdainfully upon me out of arrogance and hate, and it is none but they who are arrogant. I find the witnesses of my truthfulness to be on the rise while I see the deniers to be diminishing. My Lord is visiting the land, reducing it from its outlying borders. He keeps on making the hearts understand, opening the eyes and eliminating misconceptions.

Those who come to me with signs of righteousness eventually recognize me and swear allegiance to me, thus refining the insight of their righteousness, and they cease to doubt. My Lord has revealed to me that I am like the Ark of Noah for mankind, so whosoever comes to me and enters into allegiance with me shall be saved from being wasted. Blessed are those who are saved. I do not enjoin the people but with the Quran, and to the Quran and to the obedience of the Lord to whom shall they return. Indeed, Allah has found the people's hearts, limbs, eyes, ears, and desires filled with sin, offence, and filth. He found them smitten with various kinds of grave sins and wrongdoings. Thus, He raised a servant from His servants to call them to the essence of religion and the true nature of the Shariah, of which these people have never savoured and remain deprived.

O ye brethren from Arabia, Egypt, the lands of Levant, and others! When I found that this blessing is indeed a great favour, a provision descending from Heaven, and a great Sign from the Benevolent Lord,

then I desired not to eschew sharing it with you. I realized that conveying the message is an indispensable obligation, and such a mandatory debt that it is bound to be paid. Therefore, I have conveyed to you what has been revealed to me from my Lord and now I will await as to how you respond.

I swear by God! I am the one appointed by Allah who sent our Prophet and Lord Muhammad, the Chosen One, for the guidance of the whole world. I have knowledge from God that He will never let me fail. He has donned me with the mantle of friendship and has made me drink from His cup, and has granted me what only the beloved ones are granted. I see His blessings descending on my breath, my heart, my tongue, my intellect, my discourse, and on the walls and threshold of my house.

Now tell me—will you accept? It may be that you dislike a thing while it is good for you, and it may be that you like a thing while it is bad for you. Allah knows and you know not. Indeed, I put trust in my Lord, and I entrust my affair to Allah. I pray unto Allah that He may cleanse His creation of evil passions, and reveal unto them good acts, and enable them to accept the call of the Chosen Ones and deliver them—in this world and the Hereafter—from the chastisement of disgrace and the pain of affliction, and join them with those who are truthful.

I end this discourse with the prayer, 'All praise belongs to Allah who bestows faith, opens the ears, illumines the eyes, and removes all doubts.'



## ADDENDUM—

### *A Brief Account of My Life and the Blessings of the Gracious God*

O ye brethren! When I just finished writing my letter and completed my discourse it was revealed to my heart that I should unveil some account of my life and that of my forefathers, so that you may know the great grace that God has bestowed upon me, and how He has nourished me with bounties and favours. Thus, you may become fully aware of my particulars and objectives, and thus may my abode, dwelling, and standing become evident and manifest to you. It may be that thereafter Allah will sway your heart, and you may come to me seeking guidance and correspond with me asking queries.

Let it be known—may God be your help—that my ancestors were Persian in origin and were the nobles and chiefs of their people. Then, Divine will led them to the city of Samarqand where they lived for some time. Only Allah knows how long they remained there. I have no other source of knowledge about that period except what I inferred from their written records. Then, it became apparent to them that it was better for them to set out for Hindustan, so they departed from their land and settled in some parts of the Punjab. They found some fertile and green lands with clean air and sweet water, so they dropped their belongings and landed there, intending permanent residence. They were travelling along with a large company of their clan including nobles and servants.

Thus, Allah gave them a refuge in this land and caused them to dwell in an honourable abode, establishing them therein. Hence, they founded a town and named it Islāmpūr (now known as Qadian)

because they intended to inhabit it with the company of Muslims from their relatives, thereby being able to help one another and safeguarding themselves against enemies, and in case of any wrong done to them, they could defend themselves. They dwelled therein, became masters of the land, thrived greatly, and were blessed.

All of this transpired during the reign of the kings of the Mughal Empire who were of the same stock. At that time, the King named 'Babar' held the throne of authority. He was among those who would honour and respect the nobles. Accordingly, he honoured and respected them and granted them many towns, making them rulers, landowners, chief landlords, and leaders of this part of the territory, possessed of great wealth. Therefore, they continued to prosper gradually, and increased in possessions, lands, and ranks. Despite their glory and prosperity, they remained righteous and would tread in the ways of goodness. At the time of their glory, the face of Islam radiated brightly in their subjects and peoples. They were so pious that their subjects would humbly submit to them.

They would aspire to doing good deeds and acts of charity, would hold fast to the Book of Allah, would help the religion of Allah, and would aid those afflicted with hardship in the way of truth. But after this time, the state of the Islamic rule underwent a change. Disorder and decay penetrated into it so that the corrupt kings would be smitten with humiliation and severe punishment by Allah, on account of their negligence of the limits fixed by Allah, and their transgression. They were driven into different factions attacking each other, murdering one another, and breeding dissension. They completely abandoned virtue and morality, inclined towards what was against righteousness, and transgressed in their actions. There ceased to be anyone among them who behaved with goodness and compassion for the helpless. Rather, they began to punish each other with swords, and intended to decimate their rivals and destroy their brothers, elders, and ancestors, so that each would become the sole ruler over any competitor.

Most of them used to commit sins, satisfy evil desires, forsake

Divine obligations and limits, and relentlessly run to the snare of carnal desires. They were well pleased with their worldly possessions. They pursued the evil paths and followed misguided ways, rebelled, went astray, and ended up creating hostile disorder. Consequently, they fell from [the height of] their glory to the pit of disgrace. Hence, their era changed and their age passed, for Allah does not like the wrongdoers to inherit His land.

Some of them turned like those who turned back from the religion of Islam, casting off the robe of the epitome of purity of the Best of Creation [Muhammad]. They would neither recognize Allah's bounties, nor be grateful to Him. Consequently, Allah became wroth with them and tore their kingdom to pieces and fragmented it into segments. He raised some people who extended their hands to their estates, dividing it among themselves. It was a time of total chaos and disintegration, and every ruler was confined to his limited territory to rule over. My ancestors were also among those who would rule their estate and were like ruling monarchs in their towns. Their subjects would take their matters to them for judgment, and they would judge as they deemed right, fearing none except Allah, and seeking neither any approval nor permission from anyone.

Then my pious ancestors were taken into the mercy of Allah, but after them came descendants who neglected traditional virtues, and failed to observe them with due observance; instead, they indulged in evil innovations and rituals, deploring them not, while their hearts burned passionately for their worldly pursuits. The same current blew over all the leaders and chiefs of the Muslims in those days. They became unmindful of being submissive and humble to Allah and disobeyed the Quranic injunctions. When they would stand up for Prayer, they stood up lazily, and they would act pretentiously without sincerity.

Thus, when God looked upon them He found them to be like soulless bodies, and He saw them fallen greedily upon this world, averse to everything other than it. They would diligently follow their worldly pursuits but would remain heedless of their faith. They were stained

with the filth of this mundane existence and negligent of the afterlife, neither striving for it nor seeking it. Thus, Divine wisdom demanded they be warned. Accordingly, He willed to strip them of their sovereignty and grant it to a people—an offshoot from the idolaters [i.e. Hindus]—who called themselves *Khālṣah* [Sikh]. They were an illiterate, ignorant, and unwise people. Thereafter, Allah stirred up strange happenings for their succour and glory and for the annihilation and the uprooting of the tree of the Muslims, so that they might know that they had disobeyed their Lord and were transgressors.

Thus, Sikhs stood up with full effort and vigour in order to extirpate the Muslims and capture their kingdom. Allah helped them in strange ways, and thus they emerged victorious in every battle. In those times, my ancestors had also been victim to various calamities and afflictions. The Sikhs seized their lands and entered into their towns and usurped their properties and state, captured them by their hands, plundered their possessions, ruined their buildings, scattered their progeny, and burnt their libraries, including five hundred copies of the Holy Quran.

The Muslims helplessly looked on, crying as they turned their mosques into temples for their idols, slaughtered a great many of our people with their swords, and degraded our noblest into the lowest, to the extent that the agony reached a degree of extremity. My ancestors were overwhelmed with grief and sorrow, and the earth—with *all* its vastness—became too strait for them; they were expelled from their estates in troops along with their brothers, maids, and servants and they kept wandering about in the land. The disbelievers showcased the characteristics of their disbelief in their cities, eradicating all signs of Islam and rendering them as rubbish. All the pre-existent affairs were overturned, and this was their conduct.

In those times, the Muslims were inflicted with such a great calamity and widespread catastrophe that they were not allowed to raise the Call to Prayer in the mosques, nor to recite the Quran aloud, nor to bring any Hindu into the religion of Islam, nor to slaughter a cow. All these acts were punishable with death and plunder. If this [punishment]

was alleviated, then only the hands and legs were amputated, but if the culprit was shown mercy, he would be confined to harsh imprisonment until he would die of thirst and hunger before their very eyes.

During this entire period, the Muslims were oppressed, wounded, were the victims of wrath and were tortured; there was no escape, refuge, saviour, nor any compassionate one for them, for they were driven away from every door. They would build houses but could not dwell in them, and they would earn riches but could neither benefit from them nor enjoy prosperity on their account. They were invaded from all corners and were plundered. Sometimes they were taken captives, while at times they were murdered, with some being expelled from the land. They would till the land with the most gruelling toil, but could not eat out of what they sowed nor could they store its produce. The cities were devastated, roads became dangerous, crops were ruined, possessions were lost, mosques became empty, and knowledge disappeared.

In their eyes, Muslims were degraded to the level of locusts and they continued to increase in disgrace. Consequently, some of them [the Muslims] began to migrate to other lands. They departed their homes and dwellings and set out in haste. Most of them were like captives under the disbelievers, and the depraved would pounce upon the believers like serpents and devour them. Then, the Muslims turned to their Lord and threw themselves before their Compassionate Master. They fell prostrate in the mosques and kept on praying against them and implored earnestly for the removal of this chastisement from them. Thousands of them were put to death for raising the Call to Prayer, for praying, slaughtering a cow, or hamstringing it. They found no arbiter to whom they might take their pleas for judgment, nor any helper before whom they might cry. They, therefore, persistently turned towards their Lord.

They were afflicted and tortured and their souls were well-nigh on the cusp of departing them while they wailed and lamented. They were shaken violently, were ruthlessly killed, and were scattered, so much so that the wailing of the orphans, the lamentation of the widows and

cries of the weak ascended to the Divine Throne. Thus, the earth shook under the feet of the disbelievers, and the chosen ones held fast to the robe of Divine mercy in their intercession. When the supplications of the weak and the distressed accumulated in the presence of Almighty Allah, when they were coupled with the entreaties of the chosen ones, when all the difficult conditions arose from all around, and Almighty Allah found the possessions, lives, families, honour, treasures, beliefs, and actions of the Muslims in ruins, and finding that the calamity had reached its extreme, it was then that He looked towards the sinners with compassion and mercy.

Thus, He took into account that for His people—His chosen servants—when they penitently seek forgiveness, they are forgiven; when they tearfully entreat His mercy, they are shown it; and when they cry for help, they are helped. When they fall prostrate at the time of such calamities, God rushes to rescue them and they are helped. When they come towards Him in repentance, then their contrition is accepted. Their supplications were granted, and their wailing was heard. Consequently, the wrath of Allah fell hard upon the Sikhs and He willed to destroy them while they were heedless. So, when the time of their destruction came, Allah made mutual enmity and hatred their lot, and as such, they set about killing each other, and thus they turned to killing their honourable people and shedding blood like beasts.

Every one of them was bent on uprooting his brother and secretly desiring to kill his kin. They thought, 'If we killed them, we would certainly replace them as rulers.' So, they pulled out their swords against their ancestors, elders, brothers, and sons and the matter was settled in a few days. Allah made them taste of what they deemed lawful. They, in those days, split up and divided into sects; they began to create disorder in the land and became highwaymen and began to pounce upon travellers like beasts. They became boastfully hubristic with regards to their moribund state; they possessed neither knowledge to be civilized, nor heart by which to learn; they had neither ears to listen, nor eyes to see; indeed, they were like beasts in the jungle.

Thus, they abandoned the Hereafter and completely neglected it. They began to fall on this world as a dog falls on a carcass, or with even more avarice. They left no track nor valley but plundered it, and found no possession but robbed it. To them, shedding the blood of a Muslim was as trivial as killing a mosquito, and for such murder were they extremely keen. They turned into liars and traitors who would not observe any tie of relationship nor honour their solemn pledges; they would break their covenants and oaths and would not practice righteousness.

Thus, when Allah desired to heal the wounds of the Muslims and free their necks from the yoke of the oppressors, to deliver them from the captivity of tyrants and to be Gracious to the weak, He brought a people from the far corner of the world. They rushed into their devastated houses and reduced them from their outlying borders. They arrived with powerful armies heralding the glad tidings of deliverance and victory. They landed in the vast ground of a city—Firozpur—and the Muslims rejoiced at the fragrance of their arrival. It was quite impossible for the mean Sikhs to stand up to them or wage war against them. Allah cast cowardice into them as if the blood was squeezed out of their bodies, and they returned towards their homes defeated. Allah cast an extraordinary fear into their hearts and roused extreme anxieties in their bosoms. He ignited the ember of love for this life in their bellies; thus, they turned their backs, weeping like the impotent.

The youth of a people, being helped by God, punished them and fell upon their ugly darkened faces like meteors. Many of them were killed, many drowned in the river, and many of them resembled the dead in their fleeing. They lost their senses, as if all of their limbs were benumbed or paralyzed. Allah gladdened the eyes of the Muslims with the sight of the flags of their helpers. The Sikhs were ground into the earth such that they became like the slender veins woven on the skin of a mosquito. They looked like one fainting on account of their approaching death, and they became certain of their imminent destruction. The Muslims would pray for the conquerors of the Sikhs

saying: 'May you be granted the best reward and be saved from every affliction. You indeed have been gracious to us. If we remain ungrateful to you, we shall indeed be wrongdoers.'

Consequently, Allah abolished the name of the Sikhs through these people. He uprooted them from their land and rendered them incapable of inflicting any pain to His creatures. You see them then disappear without any trace as if the earth had swallowed them.

O ye witnesses! How astonishing does it appear to be? Now I briefly narrate unto you the traits of the people whom Allah has made the means for His mercy to the Muslims. He sent them as protective helpers in order to punish the tormentors and usurpers on account of their actions, and to provide peace to a threatened people. I deem it better to mention their accounts exclusively from that of the Sikhs. This is to honour Divine blessings, so that He may count us among those who honour His favours and who are always grateful, and to follow the path of our master (Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>) who has set the example of being grateful to the people, saying, *مَنْ لَمْ يَشْكُرِ النَّاسَ فَلَمْ يَشْكُرِ اللَّهَ* ['He who is not grateful to man is indeed not grateful to Allah,']<sup>1</sup> and so that we may be saved from the frailty of either exuberant praise or baseless criticism. We utter nothing but the truth, so the witnesses should bear witness.

1. *Sunan at-Tirmidhi*, Kitābul-Birr wa'ṣ-Ṣilah, Bāb Mā Jā'a fī as-Shukrliman Aḥsana'ilaik, Hadith 1955 [Publisher]



# AN ACCOUNT OF THE BRITISH EMPIRE & THE EMPRESS OF INDIA

*may Allah grant her the best of rewards  
on account of her treatment to us!*

O ye brethren! Remember that we have been delivered from the oppressors under the shadow of the government of this **Queen** whose title I have mentioned in the heading. We prospered under her rule as a land blooms with verdure in the rainy season. She is even more glorious and honourable in terms of her kingdom and dominion than that of the Queen Zenobia.

O Lord! Bless us with her person and generosity and save her Kingdom from the evil designs and conspiracies of the Russian Empire. Indeed, we have seen a great deal of beneficence and prosperity from her. If we neglect to appreciate her then, indeed, we are guilty of being remiss in our responsibility with respect of Allah. Surely, the worst of beasts in the sight of Allah are those who hurt the benevolent and desire to do evil to the comforters. Thus, Allah throws an axe on the trees of their life that they may be cut down.

O ye people! Before the reign of this honourable Queen we were left forsaken and forlorn from every quarter. We did not know any dwelling nor possessed any abode. The Sikhs would seize our possessions as the snatch of a hawk and would swiftly disappear like a shooting arrow, hastily running away. We had been left alone like those who were deserted in a vast barren wilderness and were being burnt in the fires of desolation. Allah delivered us from all these miseries and helped us with a people of faces shining like the full moon and with the colour

of bright pearl. Thus, the days of glory and prosperity returned to us with their arrival, and with their help we saw our lands and our brethren. They aided, helped, and stood by us in resettling us; thus, after a long time, we became a people living a life of ease and comfort.

We, by sighting their flags, came out of our imprisonment as the sun dawns upon the morning. We gained strength from their favours as bodies do from souls. Through their arrival, we were rid of our straitened circumstances, poverty, and destitution that had inflamed embers in our intestines, such that we turned into a people who lived a life of ease and comfort, and whose sleep was restful. The first and foremost benefit that we encountered through their favours and kind deeds was peace and deliverance from the insolence of the mean-spirited, and the oppression of the idol worshippers. They gave us security against every fear, made up for our desolation and removed our distress; consequently, we entered into a blissful paradise after having been tormented for a while.

In these blessed times [under the British], we became a people with land, business, and prosperity. As opposed to this, under the Sikh empire, our commerce was in jeopardy and our crops were easy prey for pillagers. Our sustenance was hardly enough to sustain life, and it was transient. Our admission into their helpers, officials, and employees was nothing but a prelude to punishment, and presaged various kinds of penalties and torments; we became like an object that was tossed up hundreds of times. We never knew whether we would be alive tomorrow or be like those who were assaulted violently and then killed.

All praise belongs to Allah who, in exchange for our fear, gave us peace and security, and granted us a **kind and compassionate Empress**. We do not experience a dreadful awe of the oppressors when we see her officials, nor do we see them rattle as do the snakes that bite and sting; rather, they are extremely kind towards the weak. We, under their shadow, plunge into ventures, and to fulfil our needs, we dare enter into deep waters. Besides, we became like those who have no fear or grief. If we happen to depart our homes bare and suddenly to

leave our land, we are not afraid of being ruined; instead, we feel secure from any thief and plunderer as if we never departed our homes or left our abode and neighbours to journey away.

Then—O ye heedless!—how can we remain ungrateful? They have granted us a complete freedom to preach our Faith, to write books, to establish arguments, to give advice, to call people to the message of Islam, to fast, to pray, to make the Pilgrimage and to pay the *Zakāt*. Mostly in Islamic disputes they revert to Islamic law, and in the matters of Muslims they seek guidance from the religious scholars of Islam, and transgress not. They search deeply before issuing any order, judgment, or decree, and are not hasty in implementation. When two groups of Muslims approach them for settling their dispute, they recommend them to present it before the consultative body of Muslims and advise them to appoint an arbiter from both sides, and when they accept it they rejoice.

In their reign, the Islamic sciences and the practices of the Best of Creation, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, became manifest—only the biased refuse to accept it. They built many an educational institute and spread various kinds of sciences, reviving all of what has been dead. In this regard, they laid out rules for examinations so that a student may succeed or fail. In fact, they set up a tremendous education system and perfected the methods of communication. In this process, they managed to overcome puzzling and insoluble problems that were like an invincible fort. Despite all these factors, expenses for education have been low, and the number of days involved are limited, while their benefits are immense and great. So they must be the envy of the enviers.

I swear by my life, they are such a people whom Allah has sent to us for our good. They have annihilated those who tried to destroy us and put the medal of bounties around our necks. It is incumbent upon us to express gratefulness to them in our hearts and on our tongues. Indeed, the reward of goodness is nothing but goodness. So, the Muslims should welcome them with honour and respect, and carry the yoke of their submission like the pious and noble. Whoever from us disobeys

them, revolts against them, or fights with them, they are the ones who transgress the limits prescribed by Allah and His Prophet<sup>sas</sup>, and it is they who are the ignorant. It is indeed wrong for the believers to be ungrateful to them unless they themselves change. It does not behove a male or female believer to disobey such a King who protects their honour and possessions, spreads goodness, removes pain, and promotes the welfare of the people.

O ye who seek guidance! Adhere to this advice. Pay heed to Allah's command, and do not incline towards selfish desires. Pay no attention to the views of the ulema who issue decrees without true knowledge. They have gone astray, and try to lead others astray as well. Indeed, as we have observed many a favour and great bounty from this Queen of India, how can we forget them and be ungrateful to her? In fact, Allah is not pleased with ingratitude in His servants while they have been blessed. Undoubtedly, this Queen is one of the two sheltering wings for the Muslims, the guardian of the Signs of Islam, and is from among those who are kind and generous. Her person is a kind of blessing for us, and her generosity to us is akin to the raining clouds. She is not pleased to inflict any pain on us and Allah has held her back from any oppression and negligence.

She brought many a people under her vast protection, each rejoicing at her kindness. She has nothing to do with the disorder, transgression, and toxic atmosphere of the priests, nor the prevalence of philosophical evils and their ideological spread; this Government is not guilty of supporting these, rather this is the result of the absolute freedom granted to every people. The law of the Queen gave no preferential right to the priests over the Muslims, instead they are being treated even handedly. Then why do the doubters doubt? He who considers that the priests are a part of the various branches of this Government, and that they preach under her command, has indeed strayed far away, and has come to be among the wrongdoers.

Does the Queen prevent you from preaching the religion of Islam? Many from among her people, and from various territories of

her kingdom, have embraced Islam. Mosques have been built in those areas and are correspondingly filled, so why you do not understand? Her favours are not reserved exclusively for any one people against the others. This is the assumption of those who remain content with shallow opinions and are unaware of the true reality of the situation. Look at the effects of her grace—how she has developed beneficial organizations such as literary societies and executive committees to run the affairs of cities, and how she embellished these societies with a consulting committee consisting of some wise and intellectual people. She has caused diverse rivers of knowledge to flow forth, opened many schools for students, granted financial support to the poor among them, and has helped them abundantly.

O ye Muslims! if she continues to follow this policy, you should always remain grateful to her. Pray to Allah that He may preserve the dignity of this honourable Queen, help her against the cursed Russia, bring her among those who believe in Allah and His Prophet<sup>sas</sup>, grant her the good of both the worlds, make her among those who are granted a share of both the worlds, for they are indeed blessed.

O ye Queen of India! May you be saved from being ruined, and may the memory of every past calamity be forgotten to you. You have tried to the best of your capabilities to restore peace; you have granted great freedom, and have delivered the Muslims from a tormenting pain, bringing forth for them oysters wherein precious pearls reside. We have found peace of mind through you, the delight of our eyes, and the removal of suffering. How blessed you are—if only you embrace Islam! May Allah grant you the best reward. May Allah grant you your heart's desires. The progeny of Muslims will never forget your favours, and your name will never be erased from Islamic literature. Time may pass, but the memory of your excellences will not cease.

Be thou blessed—O generous Queen!—this being a prayer from those who were oppressed.

O honourable Queen! I pondered deeply over your excellences and find you an exceptionally wise woman. Your opinion sails through

narrow reefs of subtle matters as swiftly as clouds, and your intellect and wisdom delves deep into abstruse matters as an eagle pounces on its prey. You wield a dexterous hand in sifting out the right conclusion from deep and delicate matters, and in seeking truth you have performed many a magnificent feat. By the grace of God you are from those who, after exploring the various ways of performing a task, come to the right decision and err not.

O Queen! You certainly recognize every pure gem, and through a profound intellect and a penetrating intelligence, you comprehend the subtleties of justice. With respect to this talent, you have an abundance of lofty examples which display your refined taste and good governance, even the nobility praising you. After considering your excellences and beautiful characteristics, the fragrance of which have spread all over the world, it was now revealed to my heart that I should apprise you of a great matter that your station may be elevated before the Gracious Lord. I do mention this with the force of pure sincerity, since my sincerity demands that I should call you to that which benefits you, and should not refrain from that by obligations of gratitude. Indeed, actions are judged by their intentions, and it is by the purity of intention that the sincere are recognized. It does not behove a truly loyal person to conceal a matter that contains good for his benefactor; rather, he should offer his possession to him and keep nothing secret from him.

O glorious and gracious Queen! It really surprises me that despite possessing such great grace, knowledge, and wisdom, you still do not believe in the religion of Islam, and you do not reflect into this as deeply as you do into other matters of great import. In fact, you can see through even the dark night, but now the sun is shining. Then what has come over you that you fail to see in broad daylight?

O glorious Queen! May Allah help you. Know for certain that Islam is a fusion of every light, the fountainhead of every stream, and that garden of fruit from which all other religions are merely offshoots. Look at its beauty, splendour, and heavenliness, and be of those who

enjoy its plentiful provision—those who live thereby in opulent comfort. Verily this religion—Islam—is a living religion, comprehending all blessings, manifesting numerous Signs, enjoining good, and forbidding evil. He who speaks against it, or expresses therewith dissent, certainly lies. We seek refuge with Allah from those who fabricate lies. Allah has cursed them on account of their concealing truth and protecting falsehood, and He has taken away the natural lights from their hearts; thus, have they forgotten their identity with them, and rejoice in their prejudices and vices.

O Queen! Verily this Quran purifies hearts, bestows lights within them, and induces spiritual bliss and contentment. He who follows it, in fact, finds the light given to the Prophets. It bestows its lights only to those who do not desire self-exaltation in the earth, nor disorder in the world, and who come to it passionately seeking its lights. It is they whose eyes are opened and whose souls are purified, and they suddenly begin to see.

Verily, I am among those whom Allah has granted the lights of the Furqān [Holy Quran], and who has been bestowed with the most profound knowledge of the Quran. Thus, He illumined my heart, and I discovered its guidance as do the men of God. Then, my Lord sent me to convey His message to humanity, and granted me manifest Signs so that I might call mankind towards His religion. Blessed are those who accept me, who remember death, seek Signs, and after their observation come to believe.

O gracious Queen! Undoubtedly, the immense favour of Allah was conferred upon you in terms of worldly bounties. Hence, you should also turn to the Heavenly Kingdom. Repent and bow before the One Lord who has not begotten a son—He with whom there is no partner in His Kingdom—and do glorify His name. Do you take beside Him gods who create nothing, but are themselves created? If you are in any doubt regarding Islam, here I stand to manifest Signs of its truth. He is with me in every moment. He grants me when I pray to Him and replies to my entreaties, and when I seek His help, He helps me. I know

He will help me in every conflict and will not let me go to waste. Are you—fearing the day of mutual crying—eager to see my Signs and to witness my truth and honesty?

O Queen! Repent! I repeat: Repent! Listen attentively! I repeat: Listen attentively! May Allah bless your provisions and everything you possess and may you be among those who are shown mercy. If, at the time of trial, I turn out to be a liar, then I am ready to be killed or hanged, or to have my hands and legs amputated and be among those who are slaughtered. But, if my truth becomes manifest, I ask nothing from you but to return to the One who has created, nourished, and honoured you—He who has granted you all of that which you sought.

Hence—O Queen of vast nations and Empress of India!—listen attentively to my message and be not like those whose hearts shrink with aversion and turn away at the mere mention of truth.

O gracious and glorious Queen! May Allah liberate you from all your worries, prolong your life and the lives of your beloved progeny, grant you safety, and protect you from the evil of enemies and enviers. I have written this advice with the utmost sincerity, being compassionate to you and your progeny. I pray seeking the blessings of night, day, governance, and battlefield for you.

O Queen of the land! Embrace Islam, the result of which you will be saved. Submit, so that Allah will provide for you till the Day of mutual calling, and you will be saved and protected from enemies—the guards appointed by God protecting you.

O gracious Queen! I am a man whom Almighty Allah has drawn to the Hereafter, detached from this world. I do not ask of Him from this world except two mere morsels of bread and a glass of water, and He has turned my heart away from selfish desires. I do not desire self-exaltation—the glory of this world and its adornment—rather, I seek to be among those for whom the couches shall be arranged in Paradise: those who shall be provided with its bounties and shall enjoy themselves in the garden of the holy court of God.

O Queen! I am a Muslim and Allah has bestowed upon me His true



knowledge and has granted me His light, splendour, and luminance. He has disclosed to me the Kingdom of the Heavens and ingrained its love into my heart. He has also shown me the kingdom of the earth and caused my heart loathe it, turning my mind away from it. Therefore, it is now like a corpse to me, or something of even greater stench. I hold the same view regarding the adornment of this world's life, such as wealth and sons.

O Queen! In the end of my discourse, I sincerely offer the humble advice to you that Muslims are indeed your special aide and they hold a distinct position in your Empire of which you are well aware, so you should look upon the Muslims with a unique perspective. Take special care of the Muslims and please them, uniting their hearts in love and bringing many of them close to you. Give preference to them over all other people and choose them exclusively. There are blessings and benefits in following this course. Please them because you have arrived in their territory and take care of them because you have landed in their homeland. God has granted you a land where they have governed for nearly a thousand years. Be grateful to your Lord and be kind to them, for Allah loves those who act compassionately. Sovereignty is for Allah alone, He gives it to whomsoever He wills and takes it away from whomsoever He wills, and prolongs the days of those who remain grateful.

O honourable Queen! Certainly, the hearts of Indian Muslims are with you and I do not smell any scent of rebellion in them nor do I see the fire of rancour in them. These are your infantries and cavalries who are ever ready to lay down their lives and to fulfil the conditions of loyalty. For you they endure all the adversities of mountainous peaks and valleys; indeed, they lead the vanguard and defend against the enemies, serving as your limbs for the implementation of your verdicts. Even your slightest gesture is their command, submission to you being nothing less than a prize for them. You will never see betrayal nor any excuse from them; rather—O Queen!—they hold a lofty station.

They possessed thrones and crowns and used to govern idol

worshippers as a shepherd holds sway over sheep and goats. Then, their days of glory were overturned due to their misdeeds and they were oppressed at the hands of their brethren—the Sikhs. They used to await your Government as those who fast eagerly search for the moon of Eid. They used to seek your benevolence as a pregnant woman anticipates the birth of a goodly child. They would seek victory with your arrival. Indeed, they had times when they donned the robes of governance and held the sceptre of authority; therefore, they are often agonized by the memory of those glorious times, for old habits die hard.

I have said all this as good counsel, the entire reward of deeds being dependant upon the intentions behind them. I swear by God, all good lies in honouring them and restoring their respect to them through offering some offices and gifts. I do not see any good in devising a plan for their destruction and slaughtering them like snakes. No soul can die or be expelled from a land except by the decree of the Lord of the Heavens.

O gracious and benevolent Queen! Be kind to them. Allah will grant you the best reward. Pardon me if you find some bitterness in my discourse for truth is never free of bitterness, and forgiveness is anticipated only from the noble. I see that poverty and destitution have befallen Muslims so severely that even the children of nobility have nothing but bricks and stones left in their houses. The turbans have fallen from their heads and nothing is left for them to give in pledge but kettles and glasses. There was a time when they had retinues, servants, wealth, and fine clothes, but now I find no servant for them but their own limbs, and due to the change of times, they appear to me as the drunken while they are sober, for they have been overwhelmed with grief as the people are overwhelmed by the severity of hardships and by the closure of all ways of deliverance.

Verily I have seen that you are, indeed, gracious and glorious and the like of you is not to be found in kings. God has endowed you with wisdom and vigour. You comfort your subjects with excruciating toil and take little rest. You spend most of your time in exploring

the welfare of your people and thinking about their interests, and you choose to work hard so that the people might live in comfort. I hope you must have advised your assistants in India to give precedence to the Muslim nobles over the rest, to look at them with special honour, and bring them exclusively to a position of nearness. But her representatives treated all alike in this regard, and did not give the warranted care to the honour of the Muslims; it did not even cross their minds to look at their miseries and help them.

This is a brief description of the state of the Muslims of India by myself, while the idol worshippers who call themselves Hindu or Āryah are such a people who have spent their lives like slaves and servants. Centuries elapsed while they remained anonymous, unknown, and insignificant.

O glorious Queen! You know well that they were devoid of power and were deserted in the wilderness over a long period of time; their skins were burned, their armies were severed; they were harshly reined in and the backbone of their courage was broken. Thus, they are easily driven to anywhere and offer no resistance. They do not seek honour and their hearts are filled with the cowardice of servitude; thus, they exhibit not courage. This is because they have remained humble servants for centuries on end and were not rulers. They were accustomed to poverty and begging, and were not men of honour and authority. The kings from other nations continued to rule over them and they grew accustomed to it.

The state of the Muslims resembles a stream that always flows swiftly to low land and depressions, while the idol worshippers are like the people of Lot, like a donkey for whom a whip or a strong rod is needed for driving. They are but rotten bones whereas the Muslims are those who have ascended to glory, and can be entrusted to regain it. This is my observation which I have presented before you with the utmost sincerity and loyalty. The decision rests with you; we are here to comply.



## AN ADDENDUM

*Regarding the Special Circumstances that will Benefit those  
Eager to Know Further Details about my Life and the Lives  
of my Ancestors and of some of my Brethren in Faith*

**All praise** belongs to Allah who made those pious scholars—honoured with Divine discourse—into the heirs of the Prophets. He taught them the highest morals, cleansed them of every filth, and shaped them like clear flowing water. He taught them and purified their knowledge, granted true Divine understanding to them, and perfected their insights, elevating them to the lofty minarets of perfect certainty [of faith]. He granted them prosperity and embedded the conditions of success in all their intentions, deeds, acts, and sayings, so much so that they were fully purified in their brilliance appearing like the bullion of pure gold. He opened their bosoms, perfected their light, made His countenance the centre of their bliss and delight, and detached them from everything other than Him. He raised their station, made their steps firm, enlightened their intellects, cleansed their insight and intuition, granted the power of the sword to their pens and the brightness of pearls to their discourse.

Allah, the Noblest of benefactors, is the Bestower of blessings. Peace and blessings be upon the noble master, the glorious, the gracious, the Seal of the Prophets and the Pride of the Messengers, who surpassed all the earlier and the later ones in guidance, purity, nearness [to God], and mercy to the faithful, so much so that he was bestowed the titles of some attributes of Allah, the Lord of all the worlds. He is the most honourable; every virtue is taught by him, and he is the source

of every guidance. He who seeks guidance from anyone other than him is bound to perish.

**Now**—O my brethren!—I deem it appropriate to briefly describe some significant accounts of my life and that of my ancestors so that you may grow in knowledge and insight. I have no power but from Allah who made me speak through His spirit. He is my Lord, Benefactor, and Teacher, and it is He who has illuminated me with the light of certainty.

O brethren! Know that my name is **Ghulām Aḥmad**, son of Ghulām Murtaḍā, son of 'Aṭā Muḥammad, son of Gul Muḥammad, son of Faīḍ Muḥammad, son of Muḥammad Qā'im, son of Muḥammad Aslam, son of Muḥammad Dilāwar, son of Ilāh-Dīn, son of Ja'far Baig, son of Muḥammad Baig, son of 'Abdul Bāqī, son of Muḥammad Sultān, son of Mirzā Ḥādī Baig, who is our common ancestor. This is my name and these are the names of my ancestors. May Allah forgive us and them, and He is Most Merciful.

If you are eager to know further details, you may write a letter posted to the following address: Qadian, District Gurdaspur, Tehsil Amritsar, Punjab, India and write my name 'Mirza Ghulam Ahmad of Qadian' at the head of envelope. If Allah wills the letter will reach me, and He is the Best of Providers. Now, I present to you some of those matters in whose description I see benefit and blessing, by which you may realize what you do not know with certainty.

O noble ones! Know for certain that my ancestors, as I have already mentioned, were prominent landowners who used to cultivate land. They were chieftains who ruled over many villages and vast lands. They, by origin, were of a noble and pure lineage, having grace, glory, lordship, nobility, honour, prestige, and being among those specially chosen. They were the hidden gems and the remaining pious chieftains of this land. Some of them were eminent spiritual masters and peerless in their time in their practice of the subtle paths of piety and varied virtues; they were men of that high spiritual station from whom wonders, Signs, and extraordinary phenomena were witnessed, and they

were estranged and detached from the world. They were dwelling in this land among the wicked disbelievers. Then, a calamitous wind blew over them—I have already mentioned it earlier for the readers—consequently their offspring were rendered weak and helpless. Then the Sikhs hatched malicious designs against us and expelled our ancestors from their land, with my grandfather dying in this exile. I have heard that he was poisoned to death.

Consequently, my father was left as an exiled, wandering orphan, empty-handed, deprived of his possessions, and smitten with calamities like one forlorn in a pitch-dark night. He would wander around in the streets of cities like a pitiable man never knowing his whereabouts. In those days my father was occupied with nothing but enduring the hardship of travel and reading books. I have heard from him (may Allah have mercy on him) many a time saying, ‘Whatever I have read, I have read in the days of adversity, homelessness, and estrangement. He would often say, ‘I have observed the common and the elite as one helpless and perplexed, and have witnessed many loathsome things I would try to avoid.’ He was a fearful soul. Many a time he wandered aimlessly as one who had no abode because he was expelled from his ancestral land, and was barred from returning to it. They were the target of assaults by the oppressors and afflictions by the hurtful; they were the target of assassins, victims of plunderers, mere fodder for the aggressors, and captives held in the hands of the oppressors.

Then, after spending a long period of time thus, and having endured severe sorrows, he betook himself to Kashmir to look for means of livelihood so that Allah might remove his difficulties, cure him of his afflictions, and enact His decree to restore the days of prosperity and flourishing. It so happened in those days that My Lord donned me with the robe of existence, and brought me out from the hidden realm to the manifest world, and into a pious family was I born. These were the days when Allah gave security to my father after his fear, and gave ease after his hardship, making him a sufficed man. The ruler gave him a safe haven and his heart softened in light of his suffering and difficulties.

When he had a conversation with him, and observed his God-given knowledge, wisdom, and profound disposition, then his deep insight bore witness that he indeed was a most precious pearl. Thus, he inclined to help him immediately, to bring him close to him, and admit him into his close and trusted circle.

He said, 'Fear not—you are this day one of our honourable helpers.' This is how Allah established my father and made him beloved in their eyes. He blessed him with honour, acceptance, and prosperity, and looked towards him with compassion and beneficence. This surely is the grace and mercy of Allah, and He is the Most Merciful. I have heard my mother repeatedly saying: 'Our days changed with your birth. Beforehand, we suffered through extreme adversity, trials, and were afflicted with various kinds of pain; then with your birth we were blessed with everything good—surely, you were a blessed soul.' My father began to grow in rank and status till it culminated in high esteem and prestige. Allah granted him the robe of honour and glory and did not let him suffer the lack of anything; he became abundantly prosperous.

Then he was overwhelmed with the memory of his homeland and a yearning to return to their abandoned lands and abodes. He, thereafter, struck the tents of exile and alienation, and saddled instead the steeds of homecoming to his fold and family. He returned to his stock safe and sound with freshness, verdure, wealth, and opulence, being well provided for and ever generous. This was purely an act of blessing from Allah who removed our grief and sorrow from us and conferred blessing upon us. He became our Protector and Guardian and showered His favours upon us, and He is the Best of Benefactors.

Afterwards, my father decided to try his fortune in agriculture in order to deliver himself from troublesome travel and separation that casts one away from one's fold, sons, and daughters. He deemed it beneficial to possess a piece of land and cultivate it. By the grace of Allah, he managed to produce a good and prosperous livelihood, and some villages were returned to him which had been snatched from his



forefathers in the past. Allah restored their might after severe weakness and put blessings in such things for him that were previously very useless and absurd to pursue. All this transpired solely out of the mere mercy and grace of Allah, but it is hidden from those marred with short-sightedness, so that the sayings of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, may be fulfilled, that the **Promised Messiah** would be from among the cultivators [of the land].

This is a brief account of my birth and youth. When I grew up and came of age, I studied Persian, some books of Arabic grammar, a few books of the subtle branches of knowledge (such as philosophy, logic, etc.), as well as medicine. My father was an expert physician, and he had a deep knowledge of this science, so he taught me some books of this field and continued to motivate me to acquire proficiency in it. Accordingly, I studied as much as God willed, but then my heart lost interest in it. Similarly, I did not long for a deep study of Hadith, essentials, and Islamic jurisprudence; rather, I acquired as much knowledge as a light rain in comparison to a heavy one. I did not find myself willing to gird up my loins for acquiring the deep knowledge of these sciences and their traditional degrees, nor for establishing the chain of narratives in the books of Hadith like the Hadith collectors.

I would love the men of God and would find my heart gravitating towards the **Quran** and its deep insights, its fine points, and verities. The love for the Holy Quran took root deep within my heart. My heart filled with the love of the Holy Quran. I observed it granting me various kinds of verities and fruits that were neither failing nor forbidden. I found that it strengthens faith and enhances certainty. I call Allah to witness that the Holy Quran is a **rare pearl**. Its outside is light, and its inside is light—it is light from above and it is light from below—and there is light in every word of it. It is a spiritual garden whose clustered fruits are within easy reach and through which streams flow. Every fruit of good fortune is found in it and every torch is lit from it.

Its light has penetrated my heart and I could not have acquired it by any other means. Allah is my Witness that if there had been no Quran,

I would not have found any delight in life. I find that its beauty exceeds that of a hundred thousand Josephs. I vigorously gravitate towards it, and drink it into my heart. It has nurtured me as an embryo is nurtured and it has a wonderful effect on my heart. My being is lost in its beauty.

I have perceived in a vision that *Hazīratul-Quds* [the Garden of Holiness] is irrigated with the water of the Quran, which is a raging ocean teeming with waves of life-giving water. Whoever drinks from it comes to life. Indeed, he becomes one of those who gives life to others.

I call Allah to witness that I find its countenance more beautiful than everything. Its countenance is made of beauty and it is donned with the robe of excellence. I find it akin to a charming man who is elegant and tall, and possessed of a soft and gentle cheek. He is blessed with a perfectly balanced physique—every kind of beauty, light, and brilliance has been poured forth upon him in full measure. He is a charming beauty as one who has been given a perfectly proportioned body, with attractive features that can be found in those who are beloved, such as wide eyes, broad eyebrows, red cheeks, a slim waist, soft and lustrous teeth, a straight nose, half-open eyes, soft and delicate joints, and long and shining hair. He has everything that can attract a heart and please the eyes, and everything deemed admirable in any beloved.

Every book besides the Holy Quran is a defective creation, a premature aborted embryo lacking either developed eyes or a developed nose, and you see their countenances as ugly and foul-smelling. Moreover, these books are like a woman who—as she lifts her *burqa'* and veil from her face, lo!—is an extremely loathsome spectacle: her eyes bleared, cheeks freckled, bald-headed with falling tresses, and with her teeth decayed; with the redness of her cheeks turned yellow, with her face like the once-full moon having lost its brightness in dark nights, with her moon split, and its luminosity darkened, while her vigour has been collapsed by the vicissitudes of age. Thus, she is like a rotten, stinking, and fetid carcass that stings the nose of people and destroys the pleasing vision of their eyes. Her family shamefully wails over their disgrace

and the clean-handed wish to bury her beneath the earth or cast her into the deepest abyss.

All praise belongs to Allah! I repeat: All praise belongs to Allah! Surely, it is He who has granted me a great share of its (i.e. Quran) lights, removed my poverty with its pearls, satiated me with its fruits, blessed me with its inner and outer blessings, and made me among those who are lost in God. I was young and I am now old, but every time I knocked on a door it was opened for me. Every blessing I sought was given to me, and every matter I wanted to know was disclosed to me, and whatever I prayed for earnestly and humbly was granted to me. It was all on account of my love for the Holy Quran and the Chief of the Prophets, my master and guide. May Allah send down as much peace and blessings upon him as there are stars in the sky and particles upon the earth!

It was purely out of this love within my nature that Allah was with me since my birth, since I was a baby in the lap of my mother, or was studying with fellow students. When I reached the age of 20 years, it was made dear to my heart that I should serve the Faith and enter into debate with Hindus and Christian priests. I wrote down many valuable treatises and books regarding these debates; one of them is *Barāhīn-e-Aḥmadiyya*—a unique book, the like of which had never been written. The one who doubts should peruse it. I have drawn out the swords of conclusive arguments against the views of the disbelievers, have thrown shooting stars on the devilish liars, and through this drawn sword have I lowered the head of every opponent. The disgracefulness of these opponents has been exposed squarely before the traditional and rational scholars. This book is replete with fine points and insights of deep knowledge, replete with true and pious revelations as well as great visions with their context. It is filled with everything that illumines the pearls of wisdom of the Mighty Faith [Islam].

There are some other books of mine that resemble it in excellence; namely, *Surmah Chashm-e-Āryah* [‘Guidance for the Aryas’], *Tauḍīḥ-e-Marām* [‘Elucidation of Objectives’], *Izāla-e-Auhām* [‘The Removal

of Misconceptions'], and *Fath-e-Islām* ['Victory of Islam']. There is another book—which I have written very recently—that has surpassed all these books. It is titled *Dāfi'ul-Wasāwis* ['Remover of Misgivings']. It is very useful for those who want to see the beauty of Islam and to silence its opponents. These are the books which are viewed by all the Muslims with the eye of love and compassion, from which they take benefit, and by which they accept me and testify to my claim; except for the progeny of the rebellious whose hearts have been sealed by Allah, and thus they do not accept it.

When I reached my age of strength at 40, the breeze of revelation blew over me, carrying the fragrance of favours of my Lord to increase me in knowledge and faith, to lift my veils, and to turn me into a firm believer. The very first thing the door of which was opened to me was true visions. I would not see a vision but it would be proved true like bright daylight. I saw nearly two thousand or more true dreams in those days. Some of them I remember to this day; many others I have forgotten. Perhaps Allah will reveal them again at another time, and I am indeed hopeful in this regard.

In my early youth, when one's natural bent is towards play and sport, I saw in my dream that I entered a house in which there were several people who were my servants and attendants. I said to them, 'Set up my house and tidy my bed, for my time has come.' Then I woke up in fear of my life, as the impression on my mind was that I was about to die.

In my early youth I saw one night that I was in a magnificent building which was very clean and neat, wherein people were talking about the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him. I enquired from the people where the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> was, and they pointed to a room in which I entered along with some others. When I presented myself before the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>, he was very pleased, and returned my greeting with a better greeting. I can still recall and can never forget his charm and beauty and the kind and affectionate look

that he directed towards me. He won my heart with his love and the beauty and glory of his countenance.

He asked me, 'O Ahmad! What are you holding in your right hand?' When I looked towards my right hand, I found that I had a book in my hand and I felt that I had written it myself.

I replied to him, 'O Messenger of Allah, this is something I have written.'

He enquired, 'What is the name of your book?'

I was surprised and looked at the book a second time and felt that it resembled a book in my library, which was called *Qutbī*, so I answered him, 'O Messenger of Allah, this book is called *Qutbī*.'

He said, 'Show me your book *Qutbī*.' When the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> took it, it turned into a delicate and attractive fruit as soon as his blessed hand touched it. When the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> cut it as fruit is cut, pure honey began to pour out of it like flowing water. I perceived the wetness of honey on the right arm of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, from his fingers to his elbow, which were dripping with honey. I also felt that the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, was showing me all this in order to enthrall me in wonder. Then it was conveyed to my heart that there was a dead body of someone lying outside the door who had been destined by Allah the Almighty to be brought to life through that fruit, and that the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, was to bestow life upon him. When this thought passed through my mind, I saw that the dead person had suddenly come to life and had come up to me running. He stood behind me, and was in a weak and starved condition.

Then the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, looked at me smiling, cut the fruit into several pieces and ate one of them himself and gave all the rest to me, while they were dripping with honey. He said to me, 'O Ahmad! Give one of the pieces to this person so that he might draw strength from it.' I gave him a piece and, like a greedy person, he started devouring it immediately. I then saw

that the chair in which the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, was sitting began to rise till it reached up to the ceiling and I noticed that the face of the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> began to shine as if reflecting the rays of the sun and the moon. I was watching his blessed countenance and my tears were flowing out of delight and ecstasy. Then I woke up and I was still weeping profusely. Allah the Almighty then put it in my mind that the dead person in my dream was Islam and that Allah the Almighty would revive it at my hands through the spiritual power of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him. You may be unaware that this time is fast approaching; so, await for it eagerly.

In this dream the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, nurtured me with his blessed hands, through his holy words and through his light and the gifted fruit. Therefore, I am his student without any intermediary between him and me, and indeed such is the state of the recipients of Divine revelations.

One day, when I had just finished the evening Prayer and was fully awake, overtaken by neither sleep nor slumber, I suddenly heard the knocking of the door. I saw the knockers hurriedly approaching me. When they came close to me, I recognized them to be five blessed persons; namely, Ali along with his two sons, his wife [Fāṭimah] az-Zahrā' [the Bright One], and the Chief of the Prophets, may Allah send blessings and peace upon him and his progeny until the Day of Judgment. I saw that az-Zahrā' put my head on her thigh and looked at me with love. I could recognize her by her face and I realized in my heart that I have an association with Ḥusain and resemble him in some of his characteristics and in the events of his life. Allah knows for verily He is the All-Knowing.

I saw that 'Ali, may Allah be pleased with him, showed me a book and said, 'This is a commentary of the Quran which I have compiled, and which God has commanded me to give to you.' I stretched my hand forth and took the book. The Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, was looking at me and heard what 'Ali<sup>ra</sup>

had said, but did not speak himself, as if he was saddened on account of some of my sorrows. When I saw him in my vision his countenance was the same as I had seen previously. The whole building was alight with his light. Holy is Allah who is the Creator of light and illumined personages.

One night I was occupied in writing something and then went to sleep and therein I saw the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, with his face bright like the full moon. He came close to me and I felt that he wished to embrace me. So, he embraced me and I saw that rays of light proceeded from his countenance and entered into me. I felt these rays were like a physical light, and I believed that I was seeing them not only through my spiritual sight but also with my physical eyes. Thereafter, I did not perceive that he had separated himself from me nor did I perceive that he had left me. After this, the doors of revelation were opened to me and God addressed me and said:

يَا أَحْمَدُ بَارَكَ اللَّهُ فِيكَ. أَلَوْحُنْ عَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ. لِتُنْذِرَ قَوْمًا مَّا أُنْذِرَ آبَاؤُهُمْ. وَلِتَسْتَبِينَ سَبِيلَ  
الْمُجْرِمِينَ. قُلْ إِنِّي أُمِرْتُ وَأَنَا أَوَّلُ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ. يَعِيسَى ابْنُ مَرْيَمَ وَرَافِعُكَ ابْنُ مَرْيَمَ وَمُطَهَّرُكَ  
مِنَ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا وَجَاعِلُ الَّذِينَ اتَّبَعُوكَ فَوْقَ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا إِلَى يَوْمِ الْقِيَمَةِ. إِنَّكَ الْيَوْمَ لَدَيْنَا  
مَكِينٌ أَمِينٌ. أَنْتَ مِنِّي بِمَنْزِلَةِ تَوْحِيدِي وَتَفْرِيدِي فَحَافِ أَنْ تُعَانَ وَتُعْرِفَ بَيْنَ النَّاسِ.  
وَيُعَلِّمَكَ اللَّهُ مِنْ عِنْدِهِ. تُقِيمُ الشَّرِيعَةَ وَتُخِي الدِّينَ. إِنَّا جَعَلْنَاكَ الْمَسِيحَ ابْنَ مَرْيَمَ. وَاللَّهُ  
يُعْصِمُكَ مِنْ عِنْدِهِ وَلَوْ لَمْ يُعْصِمَكَ النَّاسُ. وَاللَّهُ يُنْصِرُكَ وَلَوْ لَمْ يُنْصِرِكَ النَّاسُ. الْحَقُّ مِنْ  
رَبِّكَ فَلَا تَكُونَنَّ مِنَ الْمُمْتَرِينَ. يَا أَحْمَدُ أَنْتَ مُرَادِي وَمَعِينِي. أَنْتَ وَجِيهِي فِي حَضْرَتِي.  
اخْتَرْتُكَ لِنَفْسِي. قُلْ إِنْ كُنْتُمْ تُحِبُّونَ اللَّهَ فَاتَّبِعُونِي يُحْبِبْكُمُ اللَّهُ وَيَغْفِرْ لَكُمْ ذُنُوبَكُمْ وَيَرْحَمْ  
عَلَيْكُمْ وَهُوَ أَرْحَمُ الرَّاحِمِينَ.

[Allah has placed blessing in you, O Ahmad. The Most Gracious God has taught you the Quran so that you may warn those whose forefathers were not warned and so that the way of the sinners becomes manifest. Say: I have been commissioned and I am the first of the believers. O 'Isā

[Jesus], I shall give you full reward or cause you to die and shall raise you towards Me and shall clear you of all the accusations and calumnies of the disbelievers and I shall, grant predominance to your followers over those who disbelieve until the Day of Judgment. Today you have an established position of high rank, trustworthiness and strong intellect with us. You are to Me as My *Tauhīd* [Oneness] and My *Tafīd* [Uniqueness]. The time has come that you should be helped and be made well-known in the world. Allah will teach you from Himself. You will establish the Law and revive the Faith. We have made you Masīh ibn-e-Maryam [the Messiah, son of Mary]. Allah will Himself safeguard you from all calamities ,even though people do not wish to see you safeguarded from calamities. Allah will help you even if people do not help you. This is the truth from your Lord. Then be not one of the doubters. O My Ahmad, you are My purpose and are with Me. You have a high standing in My presence. I have chosen you for Myself. Say: If you love Allah, then come and follow me so that Allah may also love you and forgive you your sins and will have mercy on you. He is the Most Merciful of all those who show mercy.

This is a glimpse from my revelations. The following revelation is also a part of the main body of my revelations.

انا جعلناك المسيح بن مريم

[I have made you Masīh ibn-e-Maryam (the Messiah, son of Mary).]



**By God!** I knew it from a much earlier time that I had been made the Messiah, son of Mary, and that I had come in his place, but while interpreting it thus, I kept it secret. In spite of this, I did not change my doctrine, rather I held to the old doctrine firmly. I waited for ten long years to disclose this revelation and I did not make any haste in this matter, nor did I show any impatience. In addition to that, I never disclosed it to anybody—neither friend nor foe. Even then, if you are in any kind of doubt, either ask the scholars of India how much time has elapsed since the following revelation of mine was first revealed, *يَعِيسَى ابْنُ مَرْيَمَ* [O 'Īsā! I shall give you full reward or cause you to die] or go through *Barāhīn-e-Aḥmadiyya*.

I was waiting for Allah's permission, will, and order until this revelation was repeatedly revealed to me, and the darkness was removed, and the clear Divine Signs became recurrent. The above-mentioned revelation was revealed so many times that only God knows its real number. To make this Divine revelation public, the following revelation descended upon me, *فَاصْدَعْ بِمَا تُؤْمَرُ* [Proclaim widely that which you are commanded.] Signs manifested themselves which could only be felt by the senses of the pious and understood through the wisdom of the chosen ones. When the dawn's light spread amply across the sky and this matter was repeatedly emphasized, when my heart was opened and reached satisfaction, winning my heart's approval, it became evident that this is a revelation purely from Allah, and there is no sign of interpolation in it from Satan.

Even after that, I did not content myself with this; rather, I analyzed it according to the principles of the Holy Quran and the Sunnah. I also prayed to Allah to help me. Consequently, Allah gave me an understanding of the subtleties of both the Holy Quran as well as the Sunnah, and made me one of those who were succoured. It became clear to me through clear texts of the Holy Quran and Hadith that Jesus the Messiah, the son of Mary, had died and had joined his brothers, the Prophets. I knew it already that the death of Jesus is a proven fact through clear and incontrovertible texts of the Holy Quran and

Hadith. I also knew that my revelation was neither vague nor did it have an iota of doubt or any kind of impurity. Simultaneously, I believed that the doctrine of the Muslims about the second coming of Jesus Christ was true and there was no doubt in it. Due to this situation, it was very difficult for me to reconcile these two doctrines, so I was very much worried.

As a result, I did not content myself only with apparent texts of Hadith because when they were viewed apparently, I felt a subtle smoky smell of contradiction emitting from them. Although strong and incontrovertible arguments were in our favour—moreover, the Holy Quran completely corroborated our point of view—yet I wished to obtain such clear, illuminated, and absolute discernment which should be transparent from every aspect. In addition to that, it should have complete certainty. Therefore, I made humble entreaties to Allah and threw myself in front of God, hoping that He would disclose the secret of the descent of Jesus Christ upon me, and make me understand the true nature of the Antichrist so that I know it through certainty of inference and see it through an eye that has the certainty of sight.

Thereupon, Allah turned to me with mercy for my education and understanding. It was revealed to me from Him that in a real sense, this descent is a fact, but the Muslims did not understand this fact because Allah had purposefully kept it hidden. So, His decree, plan, and trial dominated the intellects. Consequently, he diverted their attention from spiritual reality to apparent form, and they contented themselves with it. The similitude of this news is like the similitude of a mustard seed which remained hidden and concealed in its ear for centuries, until my time approached. Islam became something alien, vice became prevalent, the religion of the followers of the cross became dominant and they attacked Muslims with false and defamatory statements.

They approved the bloodshed of those lovers [of faith] who were prohibited to be hunted in the same way as the animals living in the environs of the Haramain. Numerous misfortunes were inflicted upon us which we cannot even count. The earth became too strait for us

and our eyes became red and swollen, fixed for too long on the road of expected helpers. Then, Allah decided to cause the sun of truth to rise and to help the passionate as well as ordinary seekers of truth by unveiling the hidden meanings. He wanted to cure the hearts of the believers. In this respect we were most needy because we witnessed exaggeration in the praise of Jesus the Messiah, while seeing calumny against the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> with our own eyes. Likewise, we saw people being called to the 'Divinity' of Jesus and saw them abusing the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>, the Best of Creation. Moreover, we witnessed idolatry and heard lies and foul language. Thus, we were put to be burnt in two types of fire.

Thereafter, Allah disclosed the truth to us so that the fire became cold and peaceful, as it is Allah's duty to help the helpless. My Lord has revealed to me that the descent of Messiah is a spiritual matter and not a physical one, of which examples can be found in the history of ancient people. Allah never changes His ways and practices, nor does He put a responsibility on a person greater than their capacity. This is how He acts. He is the Best of planners. The secret which lies therein, is that whenever dangerous winds start blowing, and new inauthentic schools of thought are created, then—in a metaphorical way—descend the Prophets to this world.

In this respect, when a certain disorder takes root in this world and a certain Prophet suffers due to this disorder, the time of his metaphorical descent approaches near. At this point, that particular Prophet requests Allah, his Lord, for one who could become a recipient of his light, a manifestation of his plans, and an heir to his spirituality, such that this centre of manifestation wakes up people from their slumber and readies them. Thus, for the sake of His Prophet, Allah chooses a man from amongst His men, and pours all plans of that particular Prophet into the heart of this chosen one. As a result, this chosen one establishes a very close relation to that particular Prophet, and becomes almost identical to him in his essence.

As far as the circumstances of his descent are concerned, they are

so similar that it seems as if they were the same as the predecessor. And whatever impurities had crept into the helpless nation of that previous Prophet, this person eradicates them and fulfils the void. **This is one of the celestial mysteries which cannot be comprehended by shallow intellects. Its understanding is bestowed only upon those who have been given knowledge by Allah. It is impossible for an inflamed eye to see the new moon. So, blessed are those who have been given wisdom.**

It is an age-old practice of Allah that He unveils all aspects of a prophecy that pertains to the future only when the appointed time of its fulfilment approaches. Before this appointed time approaches, some sophisticated matters and hidden meanings remain veiled, which, later become a source of trial for those who happen to live in the prophesied time. During their age, Allah breaks that seal so that they are put into trial, whereby they are either honoured or disgraced. His practice of putting the Muslims to trial has already been established in the past.<sup>1</sup>

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1. The fundamental and supreme guardian in the paths of visions, which serves as a protecting law against misunderstanding in the interpretation of prophecies occurring in this physical world, is the knowledge of dream interpretation that is conferred upon the truthful ones.

It is not permissible to divert a matter of vision from the interpretations explicitly stated in this knowledge except when there exists strong evidence leading to certainty. Since this knowledge has been established as a revealing language for the secrets of visions, its rules have been perfected and following them has been made obligatory for believers.

Just as the commonly used languages that flow on tongues are decisive in resolving linguistic disputes in the lower world and serve as conclusive evidence for speakers, similarly the knowledge of dream interpretation and its rules, which have been arranged by the Eternal Tongue, are an accepted judgment for resolving disputes about visions, and whoever refuses this judgment has indeed committed a great injustice and is among the wrongdoers.

For example, if you wear shoes in your dream, it is not permissible for you in its interpretation to take the meaning of shoes as it is understood in the languages of this lower world. Rather, you must refer to the language that Allah has established for that spiritual knowledge, so you should interpret shoes as a wife or expansion in livelihood. Acknowledge this secret, for it will save you from the afflictions of those who err.—Author

By this trial the basic doctrine is not disturbed because its main idea, having a strong basis and being like clear running water, remains firm on its foundations; no impurities are allowed to pollute it, such that He sees who chooses to remain in that decrepit house in which his forefathers spent their lives, and who shows eagerness to depart from it. It is a reality that every baseless doctrine is born out of misunderstanding.

Behold! Allah always keeps His promise and never goes against it. There are many promises which He made to me, and all these promises were fulfilled the way He said, and He is the Best of those who keep promises. I swear by this era of mine that the ignorant have not considered the whole Book of God; hence, they believed in some verses and rejected others, trying to understand the Holy Quran and Hadith without their proper context. I see them chained by religious controversies and conflicts. If they had made correct analysis of those verses, surely Allah would have opened one of the doors of wisdom upon them, but instead they closed their eyes and left the Holy Quran like an abandoned object. Hence, Allah set a seal on their hearts, and they were left astray.

As to the *Dajjāl* [Antichrist], now listen, I will explain to you its true nature on the basis of the pure and clear revelation that I have received. This is an incontrovertible argument which has been well established for the opponents, in the same way as bamboo is straightened after much effort. Remember it well and do not discard it from memory.

O my dear ones! I have been given the understanding that the purpose behind the usage of the word *Dajjāl* in a singular form is not to indicate that it represents a single person; rather, it is to disclose its unity as a group. It means that those who belong to these people have a close similarity to each other in their antichrist-like nature and character, as the word *Dajjāl* delineates. There are many Signs in this term for those who ponder its meanings. Indeed, it should be clear to you that the word *Dajjāl* means a chain made of deceptive ideas which are interlinked in such a way that one strengthens the other. They support

a single frame of a great building, one made of bricks of the same colour, material, size, and strength, each plastered over with mud to add strength to their strength.

It resembles a group of travellers on camelback who follow one another, and the equal strength and speed of their camels make them appear as a single entity to onlookers. An example of it, by the name of *dukhān* [smoke] can be found in the Holy Quran; it represents the chain of scattered thoughts caused by severe hunger, while retaining a single name. Further it has been said:

يَوْمَ تَأْتِي السَّمَاءُ بِدُخَانٍ مُبِينٍ<sup>1</sup>

This mystery can only be comprehended by pious and wise people, and the intellect of dullards cannot come close to it.

It is a common habit among people—be they Arabs or non-Arabs—that when they notice a close similarity between disparate things or people, they consider them as part of a single entity. For example, there are various medicines, which when put together, when mixed and ground in unison, exhibit the same taste and enact the same effect. Thus, there is no harm if one says that it is a single entity while it has been created through the erstwhile mixture.

You know it quite well that when many people gather and begin to live in a certain place, a social system arises, and they become inter-linked through mutual ties of kinship and kindred—ties which become so well established as could never become undone or weakened; the residents collectively decide to settle in that place permanently, and show no intention of moving anywhere else. In this case, if one so wishes, one can call this group of people living in a particular place, a city. Although it is not a single entity, one can treat it as a single entity, and this is neither objectionable nor blameworthy. And if, by chance,

1. Watch thou for the day when the sky will bring forth a visible smoke (*Sūrah ad-Dukhān*, 44:11). [Publisher]

some of them come to meet you, you can say that the ‘city’ has come to me. You can make a mention of them as a single entity, and no one has the right to object over that, except the ignorant who wish to behave ignorantly.

In numerous cases a singular noun is used to denote something which is not literally a single entity. The pure of heart and those who have been gifted a deep understanding of Arabic grammar and its metaphors know well that these metaphors have deep and vast meanings, and are not limited by any one single rule. So ponder over this until you believe.

I am amazed by this nation who thinks that the *Dajjāl* is a single person. Moreover, they say that the *Dajjāl* was present at the time of the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> and remains alive. Their entire approach, and their baseless opinion about the *Dajjāl* is pitiable. Alas! How did they reach such a conclusion? Don’t they remember that the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> once said, أُقْسِمُ بِاللَّهِ مَا عَلَى الْأَرْضِ مِنْ نَفْسٍ مُنْقُوسَةٍ يَأْتِي عَلَيْهَا مَائَةٌ سَنَةٍ وَهِيَ حَيَّةٌ يُؤْمِنُ بِهَا ‘I swear by Allah that there is no living being that would remain alive after one hundred years from now.’<sup>1</sup> It can be deduced from this that all people living at that time would die within one hundred years and there would be nobody left alive. What has happened to them? They read Bukhārī and Muslim, yet they misguide the people.

O my dear ones! Holding to this doctrine entails two great calamities which have already led the vast majority of Muslims to the fire of disbelief, and have hindered them from tasting the fruits of Paradise. So, do not cross the limits and do not be of those who transgress. The first of these troubles which I have already mentioned forces one to deny the sayings of the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> in which he swore by Allah. Hence, stay away from such disrespect, and show deference and good manners. Dare not think yourself superior to the Prophet and to Allah,

1. *Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim*, Kitāb Faḍā’iluṣ-Ṣaḥābah, Bāb Qaulah<sup>sas</sup> Lā Ta’tī Mī’ah Sanah..., Hadith 2538, published by Maktabat Mu’assasatur-Risālah Nāshirūn; see also *Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī*, Kitābul-‘Ilm, Bābus-Samar fil-‘Ilm, Hadith 116 [Publisher]

and commit not disobedience after the matter has been made clear to you by the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>. He is truthful and veracious. He never says anything of his own accord, rather, whatever he says is revealed to him. So, if you consider yourself from amongst the righteous, then you should be humble and should never deny the sayings of the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>.

As far as the second calamity is concerned, it is quite evident, and there is no need to explain it further. Do you not reflect upon the Holy Quran and the teachings of the Gracious Allah? How He established firmly the great doctrine of the Oneness of Allah among people and prohibited them to act like the idolaters?! Therefore, you must peer into your hearts and consider how it could be possible that the *Dajjāl* [Antichrist] could appear the way you think he will appear; how he could give life to the dead, show miracles, and conquer the clouds, the sun, the moon, and the oceans. Moreover, his command would have to carry such weight that when he would determine something in his mind and say 'be', it will happen. Is this what you have understood from the Holy Quran? Was it for this that the chiefs of the Arabs and the leaders of the Quraish shed blood in the Battle of Badr among others? And was it for this that the Muslims as a whole defeated their enemies?

Therefore, bear witness and do not be of those who conceal true testimony. How is it possible that the teachings of the Holy Quran are abrogated and are shed like an outer skin? How is it possible that something is unravelled after being well coordinated, and that a *Dajjāl* suddenly appears to misguide humanity? Why do you tear apart the robe of truth, forget the Day of Resurrection, and seek to produce disorder in the world after it was established? Be righteous and be not of those who transgress. Can such a master who smashed the idols with his staff—who, when asked, 'Is there any Mighty Lord other than Allah?' instructed, 'No'—teach you something against the Holy Quran and the great doctrine of the Oneness of Allah? Never. Surely, he is the most jealous for Allah and His Oneness. So, do not defame and slander this master, falling prey to Satan.



These are the two great problems with your doctrine that are an obstacle in your faith, your doctrine of the Unity of Allah, the strength of your virtue, and your truthfulness. As far as the meaning explained by me—and for which I am well prepared—is concerned, it is wholesome in every aspect. In this, there is no doubt, nor any iota of idolatry or any denial of the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>. Rather, it is a source of solace for the eyes and it liberates us from these two burdens. Therefore, accept this and show gratitude. And that *Dajjāl*, which according to you is the offspring of a delicate woman, and has been fed milk by a weak and beautiful lady—not by the arrogant Satan—how can you imagine that it will become strong like satanic beings and will resemble them in its melodious voice? Maybe it would be stronger than this, and would be hard like iron, and span to 70 yards in length!

O ye progeny of the free and pious! Ponder over it. Is it possible that when it appears, the powers of Allah would be no longer functional, and that the *Dajjāl* will be all-powerful to do whatever he wants and to oppress whomsoever he desires? Will he take complete control of the sun, moon, fire, water, paradise, the treasures of the earth, and each particle of the clouds? Is it possible that he will go around the world in just one hour and gather the people of the east and the west under his flag, place hatchets on their heads, cut them into two pieces, and then bring them to life again, thereby disproving the following Quranic verse: *فَيَسِّكُ الرِّقَىٰ فَضَىٰ عَلَيْهَا الْمَوْتَ*<sup>1</sup>. Is it possible that he will put His plans into practice with all His energy, crush the doctrine of the Oneness of Allah under His feet, mocking at it? Our Lord is free from that which they ascribe to Him, and all praise belongs to Allah.

O people! Surely, there is a mystery concealed within this prophecy, and it is to your great benefit to develop an understanding of it. Thus, accept it with an open heart, and become one of the wise. May Allah be Merciful to you, and He is the Best among the merciful.

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1. And during their sleep of those *also* that are not yet dead (*Sūrah az-Zumar*, 39:43). [Publisher]

O my dear ones! This is the doctrine which has been taught to me by Allah Himself and which has deeply taken root in my heart, and yet there are some dull-minded people who consider it erroneous, not liking my words and wallowing in doubt. They deemed it bizarre and unusual and hastened to deny me, while they did not seek to enquire about my inner self, my outward reality, and the secrets which I possess. Further, they made slanderous statements against me, declared me a disbeliever, and devilishly concocted stories that sought to greatly defame me, tarnish my reputation, and to trick through sophistry the masses into considering me a disbeliever.

I pondered over their nature, and noticed a foul odour emanating from them, for they are rotten and have become infected. Due to their malice and ill-will, they emit a foul smell and have become of those arrogant ones who—on account of their pride—ridicule, create a cacophony, hurt people through their sophistry, and speak like snakes. They possess neither love nor wisdom. It seems as if they were put into a deep dark well and soon will they drown.

O my dear ones! I preached to my people day and night, but this preaching did not increase them in anything other than the speed of their fleeing. Then I tried to preach to them loudly. I preached to them publicly as well as secretly, and I advised that they should seek forgiveness from Allah and seek guidance in my regard, that they should search for the truth of the matter and pray—that it will be thus that He will help you through His revelations, and it will be thus that the reality will be disclosed to you. But they did not pay heed to my message. They displayed arrogance and turned away. They agreed on denying their own brothers while possessing no strong argument, except that they said that had I been truthful, then I should have brought a hadith to support my claim; this, while they read the Book of Allah and find every proof in it which I had presented to them!

In addition to that, they read the six authentic books of Hadith as well, and they find in them all that I had shown them. But Allah has set a seal on their hearts, and they have become blind. I am not

of the view that all traditions are—according to the research—concocted; rather, only some of them are. On top of that, they contain a lot of contradictions and great inconsistencies. That is why the Muslim nation was divided into sects and its unity could not be maintained. Therefore, although there is no doubt that originally there was one common teaching, due to sectarian differences, different schools of thought like Ḥanbalī, Shāfiʿī, Mālikī, Ḥanafī and Shīʿah came into existence. You can observe that every school of thought is happy with what it has, and every sect has made a castle for its doctrines, yet they do not want to come out of that even if they are presented with something better.

They have enclosed themselves in their strongholds so that they may wage a fierce war on their brothers. Therefore, Allah appointed me at this crucial time so that I might empty these forts, that those who have distanced themselves might be brought closer, that the sinful might be warned, that conflicts might be ended, and that the Holy Quran be established as the supreme authority and the lighthouse of the Faith. Nevertheless, when I came to them, they issued fatwas of *takfir* [alleging disbelief] upon me and denied me. Further, I was made victim of slanderous statements and open lies by them. I perceive their knowledge to be of no use. I perceive that they have put chains of slavery around their necks, and that their habit of making lame excuses serves them not. I perceive their faces as having been burnt.

And surely Allah has sent me to them as the Arbiter but they did not recognize me; rather, they deemed me one of the heretics. They hurt me with their bitter language and I saw grave injustice and fierce opposition on their part. They presented a distorted version of my arguments and made their minds to expel me from this land, but Allah protected me from all their evil designs as He is the Best of protectors. I have observed that every one of them is walking blindly and has abandoned the path and the teachings of the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>, so I said: ‘O ye jealous and ignorant ones! Truly evil is what you do, and what you devised is an act of transgression. Moreover, you seem to be in haste to

remove even my skin, but I am under the protection of Allah, who is the Guardian of His servants. Certainly, you wield no power to harm me even if your malice causes burns to your skin and your anger turns your faces black. Pity be upon you! I do not find even a single one of you fearful of Allah and humble. Your case is akin to a date palm whose dates have been harvested, leaving the tree fruitless. I see no sign of life in any of you; rather, you have become as lifeless as the dead. In addition to that, you are akin to the one who has been poisoned.'

By God! I repeatedly warned them not to fall victim to a frightening state of disbelief, for it is equivalent to taking great risks, and this habit of denial is akin to a wilderness that leads to destruction: 'Come to me so that I may purify you from the doubt that has arisen in you and remove every arrow which has penetrated deeply into your bodies'; however, they did not refrain from abusing with their language nor did they come to me like the righteous.

Thereupon I said: 'O ye religious scholars! Show me a clear text from the Book of Allah so that I also conform to you. Show me any hadith of the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> so that I become your companion. And surely I do not find in it—be it the Book of Allah or the Traditions of the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>—but the death of Jesus son of Mary. So if you consider me from amongst the liars, show me an argument contrary to that of mine. If you have an incontrovertible and thoroughly convincing argument from Allah, then why don't you bring it to me? And if you want to test me, then either witness the Signs of my verity or step forward to show yours. In case I am proven wrong, you are allowed to remove my skin and slaughter me. On the other hand, if I prevail and I am proven right, remember then, the proof of my verity would be established for you. Fear Allah and do not go beyond the limits of disobedience under the eyes of Allah. Surely, the eyes of Allah are fixed on every way taken by a man and He sees all your footsteps. Moreover, He knows well the minute detail of looming dangers for you. What happened to you? Why don't you fear Him? While He has descended in your courtyard, so stand in obedience to Him. The Faith is light for

humanity and the light of faith is in fact the discernment and who-soever lost them both, surely he is no more a human being; rather, he is like a worm. Whosoever understood this secret has comprehended the concept of virtue, so stand up and be ready to look for the essence which is deeper than the inner self, the meaning of the meaning, and the light of the light, so do not be jubilant over just outer layer. Come to life, and strive for wisdom and do not be like dead.

This is all that I told them. I now entrust my affair to Allah. It is He who is my Lord. I submit myself to Allah. I know that He will never let me fall in disgrace, nor will He waste me, nor will He make me one of those who have gone astray.

O my dear ones! Now I present some of my dreams and visions to you, in which **I saw the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>**. These visions and dreams of mine date back to my early days. These visions gave me the courage of a lion and prepared me to fight with oppressors and the pharaohs of the time.

O noble people!<sup>1</sup> I have seen the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> many times in my visions after which I received blessings and favours from him. Now I would like to present you some of these visions so that you may reflect upon my situation and consider me as a wise man. My people ran away from me the way a savage bull runs. They have abandoned the ways of humanity and have become like burning embers. Infuriated, they adopted the manner of bestial characteristics and the rigidity of their nature made them hard like rocks. I saw their angry and ominously changed faces. They agreed on harming and ridiculing me by committing transgression and disobedience. They surpassed each other in casting slurs upon me like galloping horses. None of them is ready to accept his defeat because none of them can see himself disgraced in front of his people. So when I saw their land barren and their sky cloudless, I came to you along with my pure water to speak to you.

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1. Members of the family of the Holy Prophet, peace and blessings of Allah be upon him. [Publisher]

O ye dear ones! O ye Sada'at! I have come to you for your well-being. I have brought to you such milk as a gift which flows from the breasts of spiritual mothers, so come forth to drink of it and be obedient to me. Now I would like to explain such a vision that brings solace to the listeners.

O ye honourable ones! I saw in a dream as if I were standing in the middle of a great crowd. There, I was explaining some wisdom to the audience in a very eloquent manner. Moreover, I saw that the building in which I was standing was exquisitely built and had been kept neat and clean. Sadness and gloom go away if one casts a glance on it and, in addition to that, its design pleases the onlookers. It was put into my mind as if this house belonged to me. What a beautiful house is the one in which the Chief of all Prophets, Ḥaḍrat Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>, is himself present. Furthermore, I see that one of the scholars—no, not of scholars, but *fools*!—was sitting on his knees and speaking against me. Owing to his dullness, he seemed ready to raise a fuss. He seemed to me as one of the jealous.

My anger increased so I said, 'Curse be upon these scholars who are actually enemies of the Faith (Islam)!' Then I said, 'Is there anyone who can expel this person from this house as evil and malicious people are expelled so that this house be purified from this manner of people?' At this moment a man from my followers stood up and decided to remove that individual from my sight and expel him from my place to protect me from that snake. I also saw that my follower seized him and tried to expel him, so he started punching him, grabbed him by his neck, and wanted to expel him from the house. Upon this, this man started yelling and crying and kept crying until he exited the house and disappeared.

When I raised my eyes I found the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> standing in front of me. I felt as if the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> had covertly witnessed the previous incident. Petrified, I stood up like one of his servants to find a place befitting to his high rank. When I drew nearer to him and beheld his holy face, I felt as if I had already seen this face. I had never seen such

a beautiful face in this world! The beauty and excellence reached their ultimate limits in his person in the same way that he is the Seal of all the Prophets (Prophethood reached its ultimate limits in his person).

I saw a book in his hand which was, in fact, my book entitled *Ā'ina* [*Kamālāt-e-Islām*], written by me after *Barāhin-e-Aḥmadiyya*. The Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> had placed one of his blessed fingers where he had been praised, whereas the other finger where his Companions had been praised and these two places were his main focus. Further, he said with a smile on his face, هَذَا لِي وَهَذَا لِأَصْحَابِي [‘This is in my praise and this is in praise of my Companions.’], while looking at these lines like a reader.

Then, my attention was driven to the revelation in which Allah indicated to different places of *Ā'ina* [*Kamālāt-e-Islām*] and said, هَذَا لِلَّهِ الشَّأْنُ لِي [‘This is My praise.’] On this point, I woke up and said, فالحمد لله رب العالمين. [‘So, all praise belongs to Allah, Lord of all the worlds!’]

**On another occasion, I saw in a vision as if I had been transformed into ‘Alī ibn Abī Ṭālib and people were fighting with me concerning my *Khilāfah*. It seemed I was among them like the one who had been oppressed and disrespected. Moreover, he had been a victim of people’s mistrust while he is completely innocent. At this moment, the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> looked at me, while I was thinking that he is like my respected father to me and I am like a son to him and he is one of my respected forefathers. He addressed me in a very compassionate way and said, يَا عَلِيٍّ دَعِهِمْ وَأَنْصَارَهُمْ وَزُرَاعَتَهُمْ [‘O ‘Alī! Stay away from them, their helpers, and their harvest. Leave them and turn away from them’].**

Thus, I deduced that it was advice from the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> for me to draw my attention away from these religious scholars and not to make a mention of them while turning my face away. That I should leave the idea and desire of reforming these anarchists for they will never accept the process of reformation. The time spent in advising them is tantamount to time wasted in vain. Hoping that they will accept the truth is like hoping to receive a gift from a miser.



**Furthermore, I saw** that the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> had affection for me so he approved of my thoughts and treated me with compassion. While gesturing to me he said, وَيُشِيرُ إِلَى أَنْ عُكَّازَتِهِ مَعِيَ وَهُوَ مِنَ النَّاصِرِينَ [‘His staff is placed alongside mine, and he is among my helpers’].

**In another vision,** I saw myself as God and I firmly believed that I was Him. Then, I did not have any will nor any thought, nor any action of my own accord. It seemed as if I was a broken pot; rather, I became like something which had been hidden underneath an armpit by something else and absorbed by it, to the point that the hidden thing possessed no characteristics nor smell of its own. It was completely lost in the other. What I meant by ‘as God’ is that the reflection returned to its Source and disappeared in It, as lovers of Allah often go through such experiences. The following is the detail of what has been said above.

When Allah made His mind to bestow something from His system of good, He made me the centre to manifest His will, knowledge, organs, Oneness, and Uniqueness so that His will and promises might be fulfilled as this practice of Allah always manifests itself concerning the righteous, virtuous, and the truthful. I saw that His soul had surrounded me and dominated my body and it absorbed me in Itself, to the point where not even an iota of me remained and my inner self completely disappeared. And when I looked towards my body, I found that my organs, eyes, ears, and my tongue had become His organs, His eyes, His ears, and His tongue.

Thus, my Lord took and absorbed me completely to the point where I became one with Him. I found His power and His will rush through my soul and His Divinity overflowing from my soul. Allah had overwhelmed my heart. The kingdom of this powerful God had deeply been ingrained in my heart. Not I nor my will, nor my desires—none of them—existed. The structure of my being had been completely abolished whereas only the structure of the Lord of the worlds was visible. The remains of my being disappeared and my ego was finished; moreover, not even an iota of my inner self remained. The Divine Essence dominated me; I conceived it to be a complete dominance. I was lost



in Him from head to toe. I became an essence without a peel and, in addition to that, I became an oil without any impurity or seed.

I was separated from my soul in such a way that I became something that was no longer visible, or I became like a drop of water which returned to the sea and the sea enclosed it and it became hidden under the waves of the ocean. So, in this condition, I did not know who I was before. The Divine Essence penetrated deep into the very roots of my being. I felt that my being had been made to disappear altogether and Allah put all my organs to His service and He became their Supreme Master. It had been done with such a power that is beyond imagination. And—after being caught like this—I felt that I no longer existed.

I started to believe that my organs were not actually mine, rather they were Allah's. Moreover, I started to believe that my being had been annihilated and had left my skeleton. At this point there was no one to quarrel, to be equal, or to resist like an occupant. My God has entered into my whole being. My entire anger, entire tolerance, entire sweetness, entire bitterness, entire activity or inactivity—all of them were devoted to Him, and I became empty of my being.

When I was in this state I was saying that I wanted to create a new heaven and a new earth. I wanted a whole new system. Thus, the sky and earth were created spiritually where there was yet no difference nor any order. So I separated them and rearranged them according to the will of Allah. It seemed as if I was capable of creating them. Furthermore, while I was in the same state, I created a sky for this world and I said that I would decorate it with stars. Then I said that I would create man from dust, after which my attention was driven to a revelation and the following words were put in my mouth:

أَرَدْتُ أَنْ أَسْتَخْلِفَ فَخَلَفْتُ أَدَمَ. إِنَّا خَلَقْنَا الْإِنْسَانَ فِي أَحْسَنِ تَقْوِيمٍ وَكُنَّا كَذَلِكَ خَالِقِينَ.  
I decided to appoint a *khalifah* [vicegerent] from Myself so I created this Adam. Then we created man in the best mould and in the same way We create.

It was revealed to me that when Allah desired that He should create Adam, He created the heavens and the earth in seven days and all that was needed in the heavens and the earth. At the end of the sixth day, he created Adam. This Divine practice kept repeating itself in people who preceded you and the ones who will succeed. Then, it was revealed to me that the creation which I witnessed in this vision is, in fact, an allusion to help from the heavens as well as the earth. Moreover, there was an allusion towards creating such circumstances which may help in getting this help. In the same manner, He creates such pious natures which are ever ready to join the company of righteous and pure souls.

Then, it was revealed upon me that Allah addresses every pure nature from the heavens and says, 'Prepare to help My servant and reach him in haste!' I saw this vision during the Islamic month of *Rabī'uth-Thānī*, 1309 AH. Blessed is Allah who is the Revealer of true revelation. By narrating this incident I do not mean what the followers of the unity of existence have written in their books, nor do I mean what the followers of human incarnation of the Divine believe in; rather, this incident is supported by a hadith of the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>. Here the allusion is being made to the hadith of Bukhārī about the high ranks of nearness to God attained by the righteous servants of God by offering *nawāfil* [voluntary Prayers].<sup>1</sup>

O my dear ones! Now I want to narrate such hidden incidents which were disclosed to me and which may serve as Signs for seekers of truth. One of them is as follows: Allah witnessed that sons of my uncle and some individuals from the family of my mother and father were indulging in destructive practices and vices. These vices included abominable traditions, false doctrines, and heresy. God the Lord saw that they had become enslaved to their desires and addicted to sexual pleasures. They denied the existence of Allah and were of those who created disorder. Allah found them ignorant of the morals which make a man civilized.

1. *Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī, Kitābur-Riqāq*, Bābut-Tawāḍu', Hadith 6502 [Publisher]

They were those who would fight for this base world. They never thought of life after death. They were completely neglectful of Allah's grandeur, His power, His fury, and of affairs related to the life after death. They prostrated in honour of satanic practices while being neglectful of the grandeur of Allah, the Self-Subsisting, the Self-Sufficient. Moreover, they do not believe in the verity of our beloved and innocent Prophet<sup>sas</sup> and considered him an impostor. God the Lord witnessed that they enjoined what is evil and forbade what is right. They uttered profanity to disrespect and mock the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>. They are ready for heresy and disbelief. God the Lord saw that they shift quickly from one sin to another and do not fear the wrath of Allah, the Supreme Sovereign, nor do they repent from abusing the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>; rather, they have adopted it as a habit. They do not guard their private parts nor do they abandon their drinking cup and usage of foul language. They insist on ridiculing Islam. They have a beast-like passion concerning the darkness of sin and injustice. Their case is like the case of a many-folded cloud which has thunder, noise, and electricity, but is empty of water droplets.

I seek refuge with Allah from these evil transgressors. They were in the same state as has been explained above, while Allah chose me to reform His religion, establish the grandeur of the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>, and to spread the fragrance of his teachings. Moreover, He commanded me to invite His creation to Islam and to the Ummah of the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>. Allah blessed me with revelations, communication, and visions. And it was done in a very good way; thus, I was made a *Muḥaddath* [recipient of Divine discourse]. So this news, this invitation, and this claim reached the sons of my uncle while they proved to be disbelievers in Allah and His Messenger. They did not believe in Divine decree; thus being atheists. Therefore, they became angry due to their inner jealousy. While transgressing, being rebellious, and ridiculing, they demanded Signs. They started saying that they did not believe in such a God who speaks to anybody or decides whatever He wills or sends revelation to anybody or gives any news to anyone. This is

nothing but illusion which, started from ancient people and gradually reached here. This is all nothing but tricks, lies, and sophistry. So show us some Signs if you are truthful.

They ridiculed Allah and His Messenger and said, 'The Holy Quran is nothing but the lies of the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>'; thus, being apostates. Moreover, the entire public stood with them and did not prohibit them from uttering such words, nor did they refrain from it. Day by day, they exceeded in their disbelief and transgression, and did not show any signs of refraining from it. Once upon a time, I was sitting in my house at the time of night when a person came to me weeping. I was terrified by his painful cry. I enquired him whether he had brought someone's death news. He replied that it was bigger than that. Further, he said: 'While I was sitting with those apostates, one of them started hurling abuses at the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> in such a manner which no one would have observed even from the early disbelievers.' He further added: 'I witnessed them putting the Holy Quran under their feet and uttering such words of which one's tongue trembles to quote. They were saying that the existence of God is nothing and there is none worthy of worship in this universe. This is nothing but the fabrication of liars.'

'Didn't I prohibit you from sitting in their company! Fear Allah and do not sit with them. Moreover, repent!' In this way, these relatives of mine became fearless in their exaggerations, and they transgressed out of their ignorance, showing arrogance. This conduct kept on increasing day by day. Afterwards, it came to their minds that they should publish this nonsense and should allure the simple people through their sophistry. Therefore, they wrote a book in which they hurled abuses at the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> and the Holy Quran. In addition to that, they denounced the existence of Allah Almighty. Besides, they demanded from me the Signs of my truthfulness as well as of the existence of God.

They spread this book far and wide. In doing so, they were assisted by the disbelievers of India too. They committed such gross and brazen transgressions of which we cannot find an example even in the dead Pharaohs. When this book, which was written by their leader, who was

not only in an advanced stage of life, but was also in an advanced stage of wickedness, reached me, I saw such abuses about the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> written in it which could break the hearts of Muslims and completely depress them. Therein I saw words usually uttered by depraves and fools. In addition to that, I discovered blasphemous content in the book about the Shariah of Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>, and mockery of the word of God.

I became very angry and upset. I saw that those words were such words that could cause even the skies to fall. Further, my eyes were filled with tears, I experienced shortness of breath, and I became emotional. At this point, I closed the door and prayed to Allah the Lord. Lying prostrate in front of Allah in complete humility I expressed my strong desire so that He helps me. I did with my tongue, with my eyes, with my heart what nobody could imagine except Allah the Lord of the worlds.

I prayed: ‘O my Lord! O my Lord! Help Your servant and bring disgrace to Your enemies. O my Lord! Accept my prayers, O my Lord, accept my prayers. Until when will You and Your Messenger be ridiculed? Until when will they continue to deny You and Your Book, and continue to hurl abuses at Your Messenger? O Eternal and Self-Subsisting God! O Helper! Bless me with Your help.’

Thereupon, my humility, my prayers, and my tears aroused Allah’s compassion. He called me and said: ‘I have seen their disobedience and their transgressions so I will put them in various kinds of troubles in the near future, and I will destroy them from under the skies. You will surely witness what I do with them. Surely I am capable of doing everything. I will make their women widows, and their children orphans and will make their homes abandoned so that they face the consequences of what they said and did. But I will not destroy them suddenly; rather, I will destroy them gradually in order for them to incline towards Me and repent. Likewise, My curse will descend upon them, upon the walls of their homes, upon their children, upon their elders, upon their women, upon their men and upon their guests who

come to them. All of them are cursed except those who believe and do good deeds. In addition to that, those who boycott them and stay away from their gatherings will receive mercy from Allah.' This is the summary of what Allah revealed to me.

Thus, I delivered the message of Allah to them but they did not show any fear nor did they accept them; rather, they exceeded in transgression and disbelief and started to mock like the enemies of the Faith. At this point, my Lord addressed me and said to me:

انا سنريهم آيات مبكية، و نزل عليهم هموماً عجيبة، و امراضاً غريبة، و نجعل لهم معيشة  
ضنكاً و نصب عليهم مصائب فلا يكون لهم أحد من الناصرين.

We shall show them Signs which will cause them to weep and shall send down upon them strange afflictions and extraordinary diseases and shall make their lives a misery and shall pile up afflictions upon them and no one will be able to help them.

So this is how Allah treated them. He broke their backbones with a load of debts and needs, and He caused various kinds of pain and suffering to befall them. The doors of death were opened upon them so that they incline towards Allah and be informed, but their hearts hardened. They did not understand nor did they show any sign of caution or fear. And when the appointed time of that particular Sign approached, it coincided with Ahmad Baig's desire, who is one of their elders, to transfer to his name the land of his sister whose husband had gone missing for a long time. This missing (husband) was the son of my uncle and the aforementioned land belonged to him. So Ahmad Baig showed his inclination towards taking this land from his sister and depriving her of her right in order to transfer this land to his name. In the same manner, his sister also made her mind to give this land, as an act of grace, to her brother as a gift, but in fact, we all were joint tenants of this land.

Moreover, the other sons of my uncle also agreed on this transfer as their sister was under the guardianship of Ahmad Baig and they were closer to him in relation. As my right was of superior degree than that

of theirs, they could not give that land as a gift to anybody unless and until I gave my consent. Therefore, the wife of Ahmad Baig came to me and pleaded that I forego my right and give my consent for this deed of gift without causing any problems. I was on the verge of pitying her and giving my consent for the gift deed, so that it might serve to reconcile their hearts and they might incline towards repentance and righteousness, but then I feared from this haste as it was the land of a missing person. The possible bad consequences and result of this haste cautioned me so I preferred to pray to God, the All-Wise, for a Sign and to wait for a piece of news from my Compassionate Lord so that I do not commit the crime of usurping the right of a missing person. Moreover, I wanted to be away from injustice like the chick who comes out of an egg. I also wanted to be away from those who do injustice to their land shareholders and deprive them of their rights and show an inclination towards usurping their rights.

These kinds of people do not fear being caught due to haste. Thus, due to this reason, I stopped myself from giving my consent for this gift deed. I closed this chapter as a book is closed and waited for guidance from Allah. I thought that this matter would be resolved, but I never thought that through this matter, Allah would try those who transgressed. These people were dominated by fearlessness, transgression, rebellion, and atheism. Likewise, they joined the disbelievers and surpassed them in disbelief. They were sinful people. So I said to Ahmad Baig's wife that I can make no decision until Allah guides me regarding this matter. Go back to your home and tell your husband what you have heard here. Surely, you will find me amongst the loyal ones.

When she went home her husband came to me running like a restless person and pleaded. His condition was as bad as a disaster victim's. His restlessness reached a point where it made him miserable. His peace of mind was taken away and he started trembling in humility. Due to his worry about this land, he started to experience mental agony and he was breathing like a person whose throat might have been cut. I observed that he was about to die due to his greed for this land. It

seemed as if grief had become an integral part of him and a deadly sorrow had attacked him. So, when I saw his inclination and grief which had reached its peak I felt pity for him due to his bad condition.

Moreover, as he wept and shed tears, I felt sympathy for him. So I made my mind to help him to such an extent where he should become needless. I consoled him quickly as it is done in such circumstances. I said to him: 'By God, I have not changed my mind. I am not from those who love wealth, rather I am from those who reflect on life after death and remember death. In addition to that, I am not greedy for worldly wealth like those who die for worldly wealth like animals. I will treat you with sympathy and will do a favour to you. I know it very well that the best of virtues is to relieve the one who is in pain. The best way of attaining salvation is to fulfil the needs of the needy. I am ready for your help. By God, I had promised to Allah that I would never involve myself in any doubtful matter, nor would I put my step where there is any risk of going astray. Likewise, I will never support a doubtful issue unless and until I consult my Allah. So now I am doing the same thing and I hope good from Allah. Therefore, do not be among those who lose hope. I think consultation is nearer to righteousness in this matter, as the legal owner is missing and we do not know for sure whether he has died or he is still alive. So it does not seem appropriate to handle this matter of inheritance in the same way as it is done when one dies. It would be better to avoid public opinion until my God shows me some Sign in this regard and I choose a way with a certitude of mind.'

Upon this, he said he had no objection to it. Further, he added, 'Do not go against your promise.'

I replied, 'My promise is completely conditioned by the commandment of Lord of all the worlds.' After hearing this he left while he looked like an ill person due to the grief which had overwhelmed him. I went to my room, sat in a corner and diverted my whole attention to Allah so that He may disclose His decree, unveil the reality regarding this matter, and separate illusion from truth. By God, it did not take more time than it normally takes to lace up shoes or put a saddle on a



horse that I felt sleepy and Allah sent a revelation to me. He gave me a piece of news which I never imagined, nor did I have any intentions to do so, ever. Allah commanded me to demand the hand of his elder daughter and to inform him that he should first accept me as his son-in-law in order to acquire my land.

Moreover, I was commanded that I should give him the land which he demands as a gift. Besides, I should add some more land and treat him graciously, but on the condition that he should give his elder daughter in marriage to me. On top of this, this whole matter should remain a secret between me and him: 'If you agree to this, surely you will find me among those who agree too. And if you do not agree to this, then let it be known to you that if this girl is given to somebody else in marriage, it will not be blissful for him nor for you. If you do so, great sufferings will befall you, the most grave of them being your death. Moreover, you will die after three years from her *nikāḥ* [marriage], rather your death is near and it is approaching you while you are neglectful of it. Likewise, the one who gets married to her will also die within two and a half years of his marriage. This has been decreed by Allah. So, do whatever you wish to do—I am just playing the role of an adviser for you.'

Upon this, he frowned, turned his face, and became one of those who reject the truth. Then I wrote to him a letter with the help of Allah, the Gracious, the Beneficent. I started this letter as follows, 'In the name of Allah, the Beneficent, the Merciful.' Further, I wrote: 'My dear! Listen! Why did you take my words lightly and deemed my truth to be false? By God! I did not want to be strict in your matter, rather you will find me among those who are kind. Pay heed! I am making a firm promise that if you accept my proposal and go against the will of your kin, I will give you a share from my own land as well as from the forest. In this way, the conflict between us will reach an end. Allah will purify the hearts of my clan as well as my close relatives, and all your desires will be fulfilled according to your wish. Your poverty will end. Thus, you will be one of those who prosper and not of those who are destroyed. The truth remains the truth. I am telling you the truth that

whatever I wrote in my letter, was written with utmost sincerity. So, if you accept my proposal and my words, surely it would be considered an act of kindness to me on your part. Moreover, I will consider it your goodness and favour to me. I will be grateful to you and will pray from Allah, the Gracious, for your longevity. I will keep all my promises and will give two-thirds of my land to your daughter; in addition to that, I will give her a share from what my hands possess. I will fulfil your needs. Surely, I am truthful. You will never find any giver of reward like me nor will you find anyone who loves his close relatives like me. Likewise, you will never find anyone who gives rights to his relatives like me. Moreover, you will find me your helper in your difficult times and the bearer of your burdens. Therefore, do not waste your time in denying and do not reject my affection. Furthermore, do not be of those who are in doubt. Certainly, I have written this letter by the commandment of my Lord. Preserve this letter in your box for this has been written by a truthful and honest person. The promise which I have made, is, in fact, from Allah. Whatever I said, was not said by my own accord, rather I was obliged by Allah's revelation to do so. This was my Lord's will which I have fulfilled. I am not in need of you nor your daughter. Allah never let me face scarcity—besides her are many other women (who could be taken as wives). Allah is the Guardian of the righteous. Therefore, do not doubt this letter of mine, as I have written it with a view to give pure advice. It has been written with the intention to spread the truth and with the hope of a reward from God. Leave this conflict and wait for the end. If the appointed time passes, and I am proven false, then tie a noose around my neck and put a chain upon my feet, giving me such punishment which has never been given to anyone in the whole world. You demand from me the Signs of my Lord. So, there is a Sign for you. He will seize you from your jugular vein. He will give them a rightful punishment. He is nearer to them than they think. This punishment will impact their honour as well as their bodies so that it may disclose the weakness of those who make excuses. Moreover, it will shatter the arrogance of the oppressors.'

This is what I wrote to Ahmad Baig in 1304 AH, but he turned his face from this, denied it, kept silent, and was left with no reply to give. He looked down upon my relation to him and my effort of establishing ties. He became worried after reading my letter and became my enemy. Along with him, his relatives as well as his friends, all of them became my enemies. They disliked the thought of giving their daughter to a close relative like me or to somebody who was already married. Their daughter for whom I sent a proposal for marriage was unmarried and young at that time whereas I was above 50. This kindled the fire of enmity and it flamed out. So their destiny decorated these obstacles in order to inflict pain and suffering on them. It is the same destiny that made it acceptable to their hearts to deny the truth. So they turned away.

He knew well my truthfulness, righteousness, and my relation to Allah but bad luck befell him. He overlooked the terrible consequences of my warning. So, he became of those who deny and turn their faces away. His denial did not make me sad; rather, I was very happy like a poor man who discovers the wealth of being released from the prison of this future marriage. I had written to him this letter by the commandment of Allah. I realized that Allah has proven His point very well for him and for his close relatives. Now they did not have any excuse.

I knew that He would make them regret their reaction to my words. Surely, they will weep remembering my words. Afterwards, his heart was overwhelmed by fear, restlessness, and sufferings due to my revelation. Therefore, due to his fear of Allah's warning, he did not give any of his daughters in marriage for five years and kept himself away from it. It did not take more than six months that he was seized by Allah when he gave his daughter in marriage to someone else. He was afflicted by such an illness which caused him to tremble. He gave in before this illness. Furthermore, he caught a fever which made him lose his senses. Thus, he reached his end.

The Divine decree manifested itself so he took off the robe of life and presented himself to death; thus, he died with great regret. The

agonizing fire enveloped his heart and he left this world with pain. With great regret, he took the reminiscence of past benedictions along with him to his grave. These are the Signs for those who deny. This news was a source of distress and pain for them. They started to slap their faces due to this incident. These are the same people who used to say that they did not know who Allah was. They would say there is no other life than that of this worldly life in which we live and die—we will never be raised again. His death became a source of great distress for them, as now they could not meet him. His time to profit from this world had reached its end. They have witnessed how my revelation was fulfilled with clear Signs and how its power showed itself in all its force. Its end was known from the very start. They were frightened due to their loss.

During these days, they could not sleep. Their night never turned into day, for the darkness of their gloom overwhelmed them. When people came to offer their condolences, they met them with broken hearts and their eyes were full of tears. When they learnt the news of his death, the wails of their mourning were heard and they started to beat their heads due to the departure of their beloved one from this world. So, they rushed towards the ruined houses. Thus, they wept, tore off their clothes, slapped their cheeks, and wounded their heads. As far as their women are concerned, they said while wailing, 'This is the day of our enemy, who had prophesied. Now he has been proven true!'

O seekers of truth! Reflect on this, whether it was a meaningless vision and a lie from a human being. Ask the grieving family who feels ashamed in their hearts today and are weeping over their dead and saying, 'Alas! It was we who were wrong!' My Lord has given me glad tidings that.

إِنَّا مُهْلِكُوا بَعْضَهَا كَمَا أَهْلَكْنَا آبَاهَا وَرَادُّوْهَا إِلَيْكَ. الْحَقُّ مِنْ رَبِّكَ فَلَا تَكُونَنَّ مِنَ الْمُمْتَرِينَ.  
وَمَا نُؤَخِّرُهُ إِلَّا لِأَجَلٍ مُّغْدُوْدٍ. قُلْ تَرَبَّصُوا الْأَجَلَ وَإِنِّي مَعَكُمْ مِنَ الْمُرْتَبِّصِينَ. وَإِذَا جَاءَ  
وَعْدُ الْحَقِّ أَهَذَا الَّذِي كَذَّبْتُمْ بِهِ أَمْ كُنْتُمْ عَمِيْنً.

We shall destroy her husband (also) as we have destroyed her father and will return her to you. This is the truth from your Lord. Then be not one of the doubters. We shall delay it only for a fixed period. Say: Wait till the end of the term and I am with you among those who wait. When the promise of God is fulfilled [it will be said]: Is this what you called false or were you blind?

These are the glad tidings which my Lord gave me. *فالحمد لله رب العالمين* [All praise belongs to Allah, Lord of all the worlds].

One night I saw in a dream that I am standing in a place and holding a naked sword. Its handle is in my hand while its other end is pointing to the sky. The lightning emanates from it and from time to time, the droplets of light fall from it. When I swing this sword from north to south, every time, thousands of enemies of religion are killed. In the same vision, I saw a very pious person by the name of Abdullah Ghaznavi, who had died long ago. I had asked him the interpretation of that vision.

He replied: 'This sword is, in fact, those arguments which Allah has conferred upon you. He has helped you with arguments and reasoning. Moreover, your swinging the sword from north to south signifies the spiritual as well as rational arguments which you will present to those who do not accept. Likewise, the killing of enemies means that you would silence them. This is the interpretation of your dream, and you are one of those who have been helped. As long as I was alive, I hoped and thought that there would be someone possessing these qualities, but I was not sure that it would be you as I did not pay much heed to your affair.'

Furthermore, through this vision, Allah has given me glad tidings and said that my entreaties and prayers have been heard and He will confer upon me what I desired. 'You are from amongst those who have been blessed. What can make you understand what you are being given? I will give you kindness, grace, nearness, victory, and prosperity. Peace be

upon you; you are from those who prosper. We give you glad tidings of a son whose name would be Emmanuel and Bashir. He will be handsome and sagacious. He will be one of those who are near to Allah. He will come from the sky and bring kindness along with him. He will be light, blessed, and from sacred people. He will spread blessings and provide clean and healthy food to people and help the Faith. He will flourish, prosper, and heal the sick. In addition to that, even his breath will possess healing powers.' He will be one of my Signs and an indication of the Divine favours done to me so that those who denied me might know that Allah is with me with all His grace. The truth will accompany him when he comes and along with his advent, falsehood will perish.

Through him, my power will shine brilliantly, and my grandeur will be manifested as well. He will establish the glory of the Faith. He will refine the arguments and save the seekers of truth through a life of faith and light from the claws of death. He will give life to the dead who sleep in graves so that those who denied the Prophets and His Book, know it well that they were wrong. Moreover, he will show it clearly which one is the way of criminals. Surely, we will give you an innocent boy from your progeny. He will be one of our elegant men. This handsome guest will come to you from us. He will be preserved from every kind of filth, weaknesses, defamation, evil, and disgrace, for he will be one of the righteous. He will be the word of Allah. He will be created by glorious words. He will be sagacious, intelligent, and handsome. His heart will be replete with knowledge, inner self with humility, and chest with peace. He will be given the breath of the Messiah and he will be blessed through the Holy Spirit on Monday.

'Behold! What a blessed day is the day of Monday in which the blessed souls will descend. Son, the delight of the heart, high ranking, noble; a manifestation of the First and the Last; a manifestation of the True and the High, as if Allah has descended from heaven. His advent will be greatly blessed and will be a source of the manifestation of Divine Majesty.

Behold! A light cometh—a light anointed by God with the

perfume of His pleasure. We shall pour Our spirit into him, and he will be sheltered under the shadow of God. He will grow rapidly in stature and will be the means of procuring the release of those held in bondage. His fame will spread to the ends of the earth and people will be blessed through him. He will then be raised to his spiritual station in heaven. This is a matter decreed. Blessed is Allah who is the Best Reckoner.<sup>1</sup>

I saw in a dream that I had saddled my horse for some particular purpose though I did not know whither I was bound and for what purpose. I had a feeling in my heart that I was preparing for something very

1. The Messenger of Allah, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, foretold\* that the Promised Messiah would marry and have children. In this is an indication that Allah would grant him a righteous son who would resemble his father, not reject him, and would be among the honored servants of Allah. The secret in this is that Allah does not give glad tidings to prophets and saints about progeny except when He has ordained the birth of righteous ones. And this is the glad tidings that I was given years ago, even before this claim, so that Allah might make me known through this sign in the eyes of those who are discerning and who eagerly awaited the Messiah. As for the burial of the Messiah in the grave of the Messenger of Allah, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, as mentioned in this hadith, this is a sealed secret and a concealed mystery that none knows except those who receive knowledge from their Lord among the honored recipients of divine revelation. The reality is that Allah the Exalted has made the grave of His Prophet connected to Paradise; they are two branches from the tree of the Light of Truth, neither separating from the other, and they are two means of attaining hidden radiance that reaches those who attain. It has been the practice of Allah the Exalted that He brings the grave of the Messenger of Allah, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, near to the deceased believer just as He brings Paradise near as a provision from Him, and He is the Best of Providers. So when a servant who has attained closeness and purity with Allah the Exalted dies, he is brought near to the grave of the Messenger of Allah, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, and to Paradise according to the measure of this closeness and purity in faith. Thus, he who is most intense in closeness and purity is nearest to the grave of the Messenger of Allah, as if he has entered it and is lying beside the Seal of Prophets. So take this date, and beware of the burning coal. And know that the Messiah has descended upon this earth just as the Dajjal has emerged in it, so do not be among those who bring ill fortune.—Author

\* *Mishkātul-Maṣābiḥ*, vol. 2, *Kitābul-Fitan*, Bāb Nuzūl ‘Īsā<sup>ra</sup>, Hadith 5508, published by Dār Arqam, Beirut, Lebanon [Publisher]



eagerly. I put on some arms and, following the way of the righteous, mounted my horse trusting in Allah. Then, I felt that I had received intelligence about some mounted people who were armed and had come to my home for the purpose of destroying me. I was alone and I had no helmet or other safeguarding armour except those arms which Allah had bestowed upon me for my defence. However, I disliked withdrawing from the contest and sitting inside in fear and so I started in one direction rapidly with full vigour and effort for the achievement of the purpose that I had in mind, which was to produce the best results from the point of view of the world and the Faith.

Suddenly, I saw thousands of people, all mounted on horses, advancing rapidly towards me. On seeing them, I felt as joyful as if I had won great spoils. I felt a great upsurge in my heart for opposing them and began to pursue them as a hunter stalks his quarry. Then, I galloped up to them to ascertain their condition and was certain in my mind that I would be victorious against them. As I came up to them, I discovered that their clothes were worn and torn. Their features were repulsive; they looked like pagans and were dressed like the rebellious. I noticed that they were manoeuvring their horses for the purpose of plunder and I was watching them carefully while I advanced rapidly towards them like a brave champion. My horse went forward so fast as if it was being urged by some invisible power, as camels are urged by the chanting of their drivers. I was also delighted by the charm and beauty of its paces.

Then they turned suddenly to obstruct my power and my plan, to destroy the fruits of my garden, to uproot my trees and to plunder them. They advanced towards my garden and entered into it, which made me anxious and much perturbed as I gathered that they wanted to destroy the fruit of my garden and to cut its branches. I advanced towards them rapidly and realized that it was a time of great danger and my enemies had made their homes in my land. I began to entertain fear in my heart like one weak and afraid, but I advanced towards my garden so that I could assess the situation. When I entered my garden and



looked carefully, I tried to discover the place where they had stationed themselves. I saw from a distance that they had all fallen down in the middle terrace of the garden, scattered like dead people. Thereupon, my anxiety departed, and I was reassured and advanced towards them rapidly and joyfully.

When I came close to them, I observed that they had all died suddenly, being abased and overcome by Divine wrath. Their skins had been stripped off, their heads had been smashed, their throats had been slashed, and their hands and feet had been chopped off and thrown away in bits. They had been destroyed suddenly as people are destroyed at one stroke of lightning and they were utterly consumed. Then I stood at the place where they had gathered to oppose me, which became the place of their destruction. My eyes were shedding copious tears and I supplicated: 'My Lord, may my life be laid down in Your cause. You have bestowed favour upon me and You have helped Your servant in a manner the like of which is not to be found among the annals of nations. Lord, You have destroyed them with Your hands even before the two sides had fought or two champions had battled or two knights had entered the arena. You do whatever You will. There is no helper like You. You have rescued me and delivered me. O Ye Most Merciful, if You had not taken pity upon me, it would not have been possible for me to escape all the calamities and afflictions.'

Then I woke up while I was still occupied with thanking God Almighty and my soul was still turned to Him. فالحمد لله رب العالمين [All praise belongs to Allah, Lord of all the worlds.] I interpreted this dream as meaning that God Almighty would send His help and success without the intervention of external means and human efforts. He desires to perfect His bounty upon me and to admit me to His grace.

I shall now interpret it to you in detail so that you might obtain true insight into it. Smashing the heads and cutting the throats of the enemy refers to shattering their arrogance and their boastful pride and humbling them. Cutting off their hands means destroying their opposing strength, frustrating them, stopping them from putting up

opposition and contest, depriving them of weapons and arms, and reducing them to helplessness. Cutting off their feet means repelling all their arguments, closing upon them all ways of escape, and convicting them and reducing them into the position of prisoners. This is all the grace of Allah, who has power over everything. He punishes whom He wills and has mercy on whom He wills. He vanquishes whom He wills and bestows victory upon whom He wills, and no one can frustrate Him. Surely, those who rejected His Prophets, tortured His chosen ones, denied the Signs of Allah and their encounter with Him, are the ones who have been left with no hope of receiving His kindness. It is this bad faith and their arrogance that have destroyed them. Thus, their efforts bore no fruits and they were destroyed.

O ye who believe! Fear Allah and do not fall behind when someone calls you to Allah. Join the truthful. Certainly, I have given you the message of my Lord and have advised you. I feel pity for those who do not like the advisers.

# AN ACCOUNT OF SOME OF MY HELPERS

*In order to express my gratitude to  
Allah, the Forgiving*

Since I have been commanded by my Lord and have been given the gift of life, I yearn towards the helpers of the Faith in the same way as a thirsty man seeks out clean water. I used to cry day and night and say, 'O Lord! Who are my helpers? O Lord! Who are my helpers?', for I am a weak and helpless person. So, when I invoked Allah repeatedly, and the heavens were teeming with my invocations, then my entreaties were accepted and the kindness of the Lord poured forth upon me. My Lord conferred upon me a true friend who is a feast for my eyes. He is the most sincere person and is the quintessence of my close friends<sup>1</sup> who

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1. And among the beloved ones in Allah are Munshī Zain-ud-Dīn Muḥammad Ibrāhīm of Bomba and Maulawī Ghulām Imām of Manipūr. And my beloved of Allah, Maulawī Ghulām Ḥasan of Peshawar, and Muḥy-ud-Dīn Idārah Sharīf of Tonk [Tuntī Kuran], and Sardār Muḥammad Wilāyat Khān of Madras, and my beloved of Allāh, Sayyid an-Najīb Maulawī Muḥammad Aḥsan, and my beloved of Allah, Maulawī 'Abdul-Karīm of Sialkot, may Allah protect him, who has supported me and assisted me in the translation of this letter of mine, and he is among the sincere lovers, and he is with me in these days. My delight was in meeting him and my appreciation of his stations. I desire to travel abroad and find the journey sweet, which is a piece of torment. So may Allah reward him and keep him steadfast on the path of truth and righteousness, and may He have mercy on him, and He is the Best of those who show mercy. And among them is Mirza Khudā Bakhsh, and he is with me these days, a righteous and sincere young man. May Allah expand his breast with love for me and fill his skirt with the fruits of sincerity, and keep

are the helpers of the Faith. His name, like his excellent qualities, is **Noor-ud-Deen** [the Light of the Faith] from Bhera. His lineage traces back to the Quraish and further to the family of 'Umar Fārūq<sup>ra</sup>. He is one of the great scholars of Islam and from the spiritual progeny of pious and righteous people. After meeting with him I regained the contentment of the past.

When I met him I experienced the same happiness which was felt by the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> of Arabia, on his encounter with Ḥaḍrat **Umar Fārūq<sup>ra</sup>**. When he came and met with me, I forgot all my sorrows. I found him like the ones who compete with each other in helping the Faith. No other financial help has been beneficial to me in a way as compared to that of his help, which he did purely for the cause of Allah. And he has been doing so for a long time. He surpassed his contemporaries in virtue and financial sacrifice. Besides, his humility is

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him steadfast among those who are steadfast. And among them is my beloved of Allah, Hakeem Faḍl-ud-Dīn of Bhera, and my beloved of Allah, Shaikh Raḥmatullāh of Gujarat. And my beloved of Allah, Sayyid Amīr 'Alī Shāh and Sayyid Ḥamid Shāh, and my beloved of Allah, Munshī Ghulām Qādir, known as al-Faṣīḥ [the Eloquent One of Sialkot]. And my beloved of Allah, Nawwāb Muḥammad 'Alī Khān, Chief of Malerkotla, and my beloved of Allah, Sayyid Muḥammad Tafaḍḍul Ḥusain of Otawah. And my beloved of Allah, Sayyid-ul-Ḥādī. And my beloved in Allah, Muḥammad Khān. And Munshī Muḥammad Arorā. And Munshī Zafar Aḥmad of Kapurthala, and my beloved of Allah, Maulawī Muḥammad Mardān 'Alī and Maulawī Muḥammad Maẓhar 'Alī of Hyderabad. And my beloved of Allah, al-Maulawī Burhān-ud-Dīn of Jhelum. And my beloved of Allah, Mīr Nāṣir Nawwāb of Delhi, and my beloved in Allah, al-Qāḍī Ḍiyā'-ud-Dīn of Qāḍī Kot. And my beloved in Allah, al-Maulawī Sayyid Muḥammad 'Askarī Khān, and my beloved in Allah, Qāḍī Ghulām Murtaḍā, and my beloved in Allah, 'Abdul-Ḥakīm Khān, and my beloved in Allah, Rashīd-ud-Dīn Khān, and my beloved in Allah, Sayyid Khaṣṣat 'Alī Shāh, and my beloved in Allah, Munshī Rustam 'Alī. And my beloved, Munshī 'Abdullāh of Sanur, and Mirzā Muḥammad Yūsuf Baig of Samana, and Munshī Muḥammad Ḥusain of Moradabad, and Qāḍī Khwājah 'Alī of Ludhiana. These are among my beloved ones; some of them we have mentioned, and some of them we have not mentioned, and all of them are among the sincere ones. Author

greater than Mount Radwa [a mountain near Madinah]. Only for the sake of Allah he abandoned all his relations and only in Allah's Word did he find his true happiness. I observed that generosity was his habit, knowledge was his primary objective, humility was an integral part of his character, and trust in God was his food.

I have never seen such a great scholar in the whole world, nor have I seen such a dervish among wealthy people. Moreover, I have never seen such a person who spends like him for the cause of Allah. When he came to see me and I cast the first look upon him I understood that he was one of the great Signs of my Lord. It was ascertained that this was the result of my repeated prayers over time. All my senses were dominated by this idea and my intelligence told me that he was one of the chosen ones. Often, I do not like praising people and expressing admiration for their qualities among people so that it may not cause harm to their personality, but I observed that his negative emotions had disappeared, and his carnal desires had gone extinct; thus, he had been protected from such things.

One of his excellent qualities was that when he saw the wounds of Islam, its state of a homeless wanderer, or saw it like a tree which had been uprooted from its place, he felt deep sadness and due to this sadness, his life became colourless, so having gone through this state of restlessness he stood up to help the Faith. Therefore, he wrote such books which were replete with facts and wisdom to such an extent that we cannot find an example of it in the books written by earlier people. His writings, though brief, are yet full of wisdom. As far as his diction is concerned, it is very attractive, beautiful, and refined which, upon reading, gives the taste of a pure beverage. The case of his books is like silk which is filled with different fragrances.

In addition to that, it seems as if a fair number of pearls, rubies, and musk was wrapped in them and on top of it, some ambergris was mixed in them and thus, this whole mixture turned into an electuary. There is no doubt that these books contain all those benefits in one place which are scattered in other books. Further, these books have

established their superiority over others on account of their containing rare explanations and unique knowledge. Moreover, they surpass other books for they—by force of arguments and reasoning—attract people towards them. Blessed is the one who acquires them, respects them, and diligently studies them; surely he will find them an exemplary helper. Whoever seeks to decipher the profound intricacies of the Holy Quran and fathom the mysteries of the Book of Allah, the Glorious, should indulge himself in the study of these books, for these books guarantee the knowledge which a wise seeker seeks out. The fragrance of these fragrant plants (books) attracts hearts. They bear a large number of fruits on their branches and without any doubt, they (books) have symbolically taken the form of a garden possessing clusters of hanging fruits, wherein no absurdity exists. These (books) are food for thought for the righteous.

One of these books is *Faṣlu'l-Khiṭāb Liqaḍāyā Ahlul-Kitāb* and the other prominent one is *Taṣḍīq Barāhīn-e-Aḥmadiyya*. These books contain excellent ideas which have been elaborated in a beautiful manner through precise words and subtle structures. Thus, these books have become a model for writers. Moreover, the academic philosophers dream of penning such books. Many prominent scholars have expressed nothing but praise for these books. The jewels contained in these books surpass the value of jewels worn around the neck, and the pearls found therein are superior to the pearls found in the sea. These books serve as a strong argument to prove that Ḥaḍrat Maulawī Ṣāhib attained perfection in this regard and as a concrete proof of fragrance, emitting from his personality. Certainly, you will know the worth of these books after a certain period.

The writer has endeavoured to interpret the difficult concepts of the Holy Quran in these books and while doing this research, he has taken into consideration both, the chain of narrators of hadith as well as logical reasoning. His courage as well as his brilliant ideas are praiseworthy. He is the pride of all Muslims. He possesses a remarkable ability to explore the deep meanings and to distribute the treasures of the Holy Quran. No doubt, he has been enlightened by the light of

Prophethood. In addition to that, so far as his outstanding courage and pure nature are concerned, these traits too, have been enlightened by the light of the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>. He has a rare, unparalleled, and matchless personality.

Multiple streams of light, replete with mysteries, originate from every look he casts and the fountains of thought flow from the nib of his pen. This is the sheer grace of Allah, which He bestows on whom He pleases, and He is the Best of providers. There is no doubt that he is one of the rare academic religious philosophers. He is the leader of religious writers. People drink from his fast-flowing clean water and buy his noble eloquence like cups of pure beverage, for he is the pride of the virtuous, the chosen ones, and the believers. His heart is illuminated with the light of delicate and subtle understanding. In addition to that, it is filled with profound knowledge, truth, and mysteries. Furthermore, his heart contains deep mysteries within mysteries, and it has been enlightened by the light of righteous people.

When he speaks extemporarily and uses well-chosen, fine words and rare eloquence, it appears as if he has won the hearts and minds through subtle songs and the touch of David's flute. In this manner, he presents extraordinary and lucid arguments. Whenever he initiates a conversation or indulges in dialogue, wisdom flows from his mouth like recurrent overwhelming tidal waves which reach the mouths of the audience. When I pondered over his excellence I found him a rare example of knowledge, actions, virtue, and financial sacrifice.

He is extremely genius, enlightened, and is the quintessence of the righteous and chosen ones. He has been bestowed with wealth and generosity, so a great deal is expected of him. He is the leader of those who strives to help the Faith; therefore, I am proud of him. People go to his home with expectations of hope, requesting his help for their needs. He never turns his face away from anyone who goes to his home to see him; rather, he provides financial help to those in need. He takes such delight, with all his heart, in meeting with me, as a wealthy person is delighted upon discovering gold. He, out of his love and faith, comes to meet me from a far-flung area.

He is a young man with a pure heart, who loves me, and I love him. He rushes to me with all his energy even on short notice. He received enormous rewards and repeated blessings from Allah the Almighty because of his virtues and his kindness towards his relatives. Allah has made his life a source of help for Islam as well as for Muslims. He has a rare bond with my heart. In my love, he faces different types of reproaches, endures hardships, and bears the separation of his homeland as well as his friends. It becomes easy for him to abandon his homeland in order to listen to my words. Out of his deference to my rank, he has abandoned his motherland to which his memories are closely connected.

He follows me in my every action the way the beating of a pulse follows the rhythm of respiration. He is wholeheartedly committed to fulfilling my wish, and whenever he is demanded of something, he gives and never lags behind. Moreover, whenever he is called for a purpose, he is always the first to say *labbaik* (I am present) among the people. He possesses a kind heart and excellent moral values. So far as his generosity is concerned, it is like a heavy rain. In addition to that, his company reforms the hearts of pretentious ascetics. He attacks the enemies of the Faith like a young and ferocious lion. He has stoned the disbelievers with his arguments and has performed a deep analysis of the doctrines of the followers of the Vedas. He invaded the territory of these fools, pursued them, and ultimately destroyed them.

He has written his books in refutation of liars with such superb expertise, which can be observed during the fascinating process of bamboo straightening to craft javelins. Through his hands has Allah put the followers of the Vedas to shame in such a way as if ash were smeared on their faces and their countenance turned sombre; thus, they became like dead bodies. They wished to retaliate, but how can the dead come back to life after their death? Consequently, they (the followers of the Vedas) retreated in failure. If they had any sense of honour, they would not have retaliated, but shamelessness is part and parcel of these people as they are attacking again like the ones who are ready to be slain.



This honourable scholar (Ḥaḍrat Maulawī Ṣāhib) is one of the near and dear friends of mine. He is one of those followers who took the Pledge of Allegiance at my hand and remained loyal to this Pledge with all his heart. He pledged allegiance to me that he would never give preference to anyone over Allah, the One and Only. I found him among the people who fulfil their promises and fear the Lord of the world. He, at the time when evil is in full swing, is like clear water descending from the skies. He is a gem of a person. I have never observed such love for the Holy Quran in anyone's heart as I have seen overflowing in his heart. Love of the Holy Quran has completely occupied his heart. His face is a reflection of his love for luminous Quranic verses.

The light of Allah, the Gracious, has been placed in his heart. Thus, through this light of guidance, he explains those subtleties of the Holy Quran which are very deep and hidden. Most of his qualities make me feel proud of him. It is a favour from Allah—He bestows it upon His servants in whatever way He wills, for He is the Best of providers. Allah has bestowed upon him excellent faculties and granted him great wisdom. He has been given the gift of sweet and exquisitely beautiful discourse which cannot be found in other books. So far as his nature is concerned, it has a close and perfect relation to the Word of the Glorious Lord.

This Holy Quran contains innumerable treasures of which this young nobleman has been given a deep understanding. This is by the sheer grace of Allah, and nobody can withhold the favours of Allah upon anyone's life. From among His (Allah's) men, some are given almost nothing, while others are abundantly blessed. But nobody has the right to argue with Allah over this matter. I swear by this era of mine, he (Maulawī Noor-ud-Deen of Bhera) is the champion of big arenas. The following proverb befits him very well, 'As there are great scholars for every branch of knowledge, in the same way, every arena has its champions.' Moreover, there is another proverb that suits him well, 'Surely, in some parts of the earth are hidden very precious treasures, as some men possess excellent abilities.'

May Allah keep him in good health and protect him from all harm. May He grant him longevity, spent according to His Divine will and make him one of the chosen ones. I see the wisdom flowing from his mouth. In the same way, the Divine light pours down wherever he is seated. I see this Divine light pouring down upon him incessantly in such a way as guests like to stay with a particular host with their heart's full content. Whenever he puts his heart into interpreting the Book of Allah, he discovers the mysteries and profound meanings contained therein, which flow like fountains. And he unveils the rare ideas of wisdom that remained hidden under layers. He treats the subtle topics in a very meticulous way and delves deep into the details of the facts, discovering the bright light.

When he delivers a speech, the intellectuals—while accepting the fact that his words carry astonishing and amazing effects—listen to him with undivided attention. He shows the truth like a pure gold ingot is shown and thoroughly refutes the objections of the opponents. This age has been hit by the storm of philosophy; rather, disorder and depravity are more prevalent than that. These incidents have made the youth restless and agitated. Furthermore, so far as religious scholars are concerned, they have become deprived of the wealth of spiritual knowledge, as well as the pearls of mysteries belonging to the Gracious Lord, as bones are left bare after the flesh has been removed.

In these terrible circumstances, this brave man stood up and retaliated against the enemies of the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> as meteorites strike the companions of Satan. So, he (Maulawī Šāhib) is as important among the scholars as a pupil in the eye and he is like a bright sun in the sky of wisdom. He fears no one but Allah and is not content with superficial and baseless opinions; rather, his profound understanding comprehends such subtle mysteries, hidden in the land of wisdom, of which the source is often deeply undiscoverable.

What a gem of a person he is! It is only Allah who can reward him. Allah has returned to him, his snatched away property and now he is of the people who have been bestowed with abilities. All praise

belongs to that God who has given me this dear friend on time and during the days when he was needed the most. Hence, we implore Allah that He may increase his age, health, and wealth. Moreover, I pray that He may grant me such opportunities that I may further supplicate for him as well as his family and these supplications may be accepted. My understanding bears witness that acceptance<sup>1</sup> of prayer

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1. Let it be known that acceptance of prayer is one of the mysteries of Divine wisdom. And for this only the spiritual people are chosen. This is a consistent practice of Allah that at the time of the prayers done by his chosen ones, He subdues this transitory world, the effects of celestial bodies, and the hearts of the people.

At times, due to the firm determination of these chosen ones, putrid air could be transformed into pure air. In the same way, the clean air could be turned into filthy air. By the will of Allah, who has absolute power over the heavens and the earth, a heart of stone could be turned into a heart of flesh. Similarly, a heart of flesh could be turned into a heart of stone. When some saint is in desperate need of something non-existent, and he diverts his whole attention with dedication for the manifestation of that particular thing, through his firm determination that non-existent thing is brought into existence. In the same way, if a saint diverts his full attention to make something existent disappear, it disappears suddenly. This is the reality of miracles.

Neither the intellect of shallow thinkers can comprehend these miracles, nor the reasoning of philosophers can enjoy its taste. Surely, the senses of the chosen ones are completely different which are bestowed upon them by the True God. So, when these saints receive a portion from these senses, thereupon, they are dressed in new robes and start listening to such new songs, the like of which no ear has ever heard in this world. Their intellect is refined to the highest point. They are given the knowledge of the sources of inference and deduction. Their intellect is amazed at the subtleties of these deep mysteries, whereas every dull-minded blockhead refuses them.

Allah helps them in all circumstances and His invisible hand works behind all their adventures and deeds. When they close a door on the earth, the same door is considered to be closed in the heavens as well. Similarly, when they open it on the earth, then it is also opened from the sky. The sky coincides in its movement, with the will of these chosen ones and the problems are resolved according to their will. Allah shows their respect and grandeur to His creation so that the wise and the fortunate may show an inclination towards them. Author

is a proven fact and is not just a presumption. We always place our hopes in the mercy of Allah.

By God! In his words, I see a new expression of glory. He has surpassed his contemporaries in exploring mysteries, understanding the themes, and the interpretation of the Holy Quran. I see his knowledge and his tolerance like two parallel mountains and it seems hard to make a decision which one of them is superior to the other. He is one of the gardens of the True Faith.

O my Lord! Send blessings upon him from the heavens and protect him from every evil design of his enemies. Furthermore, accompany him wherever he goes. Be merciful to him in this world as well as the Hereafter as You are the Best of the merciful. *Āmin*, and again *Āmin*.

All praise belongs to Allah who is the First and the Last, and the Manifest and the Hidden. He is the only Friend of mine in this world and the Hereafter. It is solely His Spirit that has conferred upon me the power of speech and it is solely His hand that has pushed me forward. Hence, this work of mine has been written by the grace, guidance, and revelation of Allah. The ability and the opportunity of completing a task, both come from Allah. It is only He who has command over the heavens and the earth.

O my Lord! I penned this composition through the sheer blessings of power, strength, and revelation granted by You. So—O Lord of all the worlds!—all praise belongs to You. It is only You who is my Benefactor, my Provider of reward, my Helper, my Revealer, the Sight for my eyes, the Joy of my heart, and the Strength for the steps taken by me. I will die in such a state that I will be proclaiming gratitude for Your blessings through my words and my deeds. My bones in my tomb, my dust in my grave, and my soul in the heavens—all will be showering gratitude upon You.

Your favours overwhelm my gratitude, and my eyes, my ears, my heart, my head, my other organs, my outward faculties, and my inner

self thrive under the great impact of Your blessings. You are an impregnable fortress for me. I seek refuge with You from the calamities of the earth and the sky, against every sharp-tongued jealous one, against every calumny, against furious rage, against every kind of darkness and obscurity, and against every person who becomes an obstacle in Your cause. And our final supplications will always be, 'All praise belongs to Allah.'



# AL-QAṢĪDAH

## [An Ode in Praise of the Holy Prophet<sup>ṣas</sup>]

This is a fine and elegant ode and it is filled with priceless pearls of the Arabic language. It is a eulogy for my beloved Master, the Sovereign of both worlds, the Seal of the Prophets, who has been praised by Allah the Exalted in His Eloquent Book [the Holy Quran]. O Allah! Bestow blessings and peace upon him until the Day of Judgment. This ode is not the product of my limited intellect, nor are my stultified wisdom and simple thoughts the heroes of this field, or the fountainhead of these mysteries. Rather, everything that I have said has come about through the succour of my Lord God, who is my Companion and Helper, who is with me at all times, who feeds me and gives me to drink, and guides me when I falter in my way and conveys me to the destination, and grants me health when I fall sick.

I have not acquired the fine and interesting expressions by dint of hard work; nevertheless, Allah has made me dominant over versatile linguists, and this is a magnificent Sign from my Lord for those who possess knowledge.

I have stated all this so that I may receive the reward of the grateful and not be deemed among those who are ungrateful.

يَا عَيْنَ فَيْضِ اللَّهِ وَالْعِزِّانِ يَسْعَى إِلَيْكَ الْخَلْقُ كَالطَّمَّانِ  
*O ye the fountain of Allah's grace and divine knowledge!*

*People throng towards you like the thirsty.*

يَا بَحْرَ فَضْلِ الْمُنْعِمِ الْمَنَّانِ تَهْوِي إِلَيْكَ الزُّمُرُ بِالْكَيْرَانِ  
*O ye the ocean of the grace of the Benefactor and Bountiful God!*

*People flock to you with empty cups.*

يَا شَمْسَ مُلْكِ الْحُسْنِ وَالْإِحْسَانِ نَوَّرْتَ وَجْهَ الْبَرِّ وَالْعُمُرَانِ  
*O ye the sun of the kingdom of beauty and grace!*

*You have illuminated the deserts as well as habitations.*

قَوْمٌ رَأَوْكَ وَأُمَّةٌ قَدْ أُخْبِرَتْ مِنْ ذَلِكَ الْبَدْرِ الَّذِي أَصْبَانِي  
*A people beheld you, and a nation was informed*

*of that full moon who has enchanted me.*

يَبْكُونَ مِنْ ذِكْرِ الْجَمَالِ صَبَابَةً وَتَأَلَّمَا مِنْ لَوْعَةِ الْهَجْرَانِ  
*They shed tears in passionate longing at the remembrance of your beauty;*

*And the pangs of separation from you make them cry.*

وَأَرَى الْقُلُوبَ لَدَى الْحَنَاجِرِ كُرْبَةً وَأَرَى الْغُرُوبَ تُسِيلُهَا الْعَيْنَانِ  
*I see their hearts in such anxiety as if they have reached their throats;*

*I see their eyes flowing with tears.*

يَا مَنْ غَدَا فِي نُورِهِ وَصَبَّاهِ كَالْبَيَّرَيْنِ وَنَوَّرَ الْمَلَوَانَ  
*O ye who art the sun and moon of light!*

*You have illuminated the day and the night.*

يَا بَدْرَنَا يَا آيَةَ الرَّحْمَنِ أَهْدَى الْهَدَاةِ وَأَشْجَعَ الشُّجْعَانِ  
*O ye our full moon! O ye Sign of ar-Rahmān [the Gracious]!*

*O ye the best guided of all guides and the bravest of the brave!*



إِنِّي أَرَىٰ فِي وَجْهِكَ الْمَهْلَلِ شَأْنَا يُغَوِّقُ شَمَائِلَ الْإِنْسَانِ  
*I find such glory in your radiant countenance  
 That surpasses all human excellence.*

وَقَدْ افْتَتَاكَ أُولُو التُّهَىٰ وَبَصِيقِهِمْ وَدَعَوْا تَذَكُّرَ مَعْهَدِ الْأَوْطَانِ  
*Verily, the wise have followed you, and—with their sincerity—  
 They abandoned the remembrance of their homelands.*

قَدْ أَتَرُوكَ وَفَارَقُوا أَحِبَّائِهِمْ وَتَبَاعَدُوا مِنْ حَلَقَةِ الْإِخْوَانِ  
*They preferred you, and abandoned their loved ones;  
 They distanced themselves from the circle of their brethren.*

قَدْ وَدَّعُوا أَهْوَاءَهُمْ وَنَفْسَهُمْ وَتَبَرَّءُوا مِنْ كُلِّ نَنْسَبٍ فَإِنْ  
*They bid farewell to their base desires and their selves;  
 They discarded all perishing belongings.*

ظَهَرَتْ عَلَيْهِمْ بَيِّنَاتُ رَسُولِهِمْ فَتَمَزَّقَ الْأَهْوَاءُ كَالْأَوْثَانِ  
*When the clear Signs of the truth of their Prophet became manifest upon  
 them,  
 Their base desires were shattered to pieces like smashed idols.*

فِي وَقْتِ تَزْوِيقِ اللَّيَالِي نُورُوا وَاللَّهُ نَجَّاهُمْ مِّنَ الطُّوفَانِ  
*They became enlightened in the pitch darkness of night,  
 And Allah saved them from the raging tempest.*

قَدْ هَاصَهُمْ ظُلُمُ الْإِنْسَانِ وَصَيِمُهُمْ فَتَنَّبَسُّوا بِعِنَايَةِ الْمَنَّانِ  
*The fury and wrath of the opponents attempted to grind them to dust,  
 But the mercy of their Beneficent Lord sustained them and they  
 remained steadfast.*

نَهَبَ اللَّثَامُ نُسُوبَهُمْ وَعَقَارَهُمْ فَتَهَلَّلُوا بِجَوَاهِرِ الْفُرْقَانِ

*The despicable looted their money and property;*

*So they enriched themselves with the pearls of the Furqān [i.e. Holy Quran].*

كَسَحُوا بُيُوتَ نَفُسِهِمْ وَتَبَادَرُوا لِتَمَتُّعِ الْإِيمَانِ وَالْإِيمَانِ

*They thoroughly cleansed their souls of all impurities,*

*And moved forward to gain the wealth of certainty and faith.*

قَامُوا بِإِقْدَامِ الرُّسُولِ بِغُرُوبِهِمْ كَالْعَاشِقِ الْمَشْغُوفِ فِي الْمَيْدَانِ

*In battle, they stood with the Messenger in ranks.*

*Intoxicated in love, they marched forward to the battlefield.*

فَدَمَ الرِّجَالِ لِصِدْقِهِمْ فِي حُبِّهِمْ تَحْتَ السُّيُوفِ أُرْيَقُ كَالْفُرْبَانِ

*For their sincere devotion, the blood of the brave was shed*

*Under swords, like sacrificial animals.*

جَاءُوكَ مَتَّهَوِينَ كَالْعُرْيَانِ فَسَتَرْتَهُمْ بِمَلْحَفِ الْإِيمَانِ

*They came to you looted and naked,*

*And you clothed them with the cloak of faith.*

صَادَفْتَهُمْ قَوْمًا كَرُوثٍ ذَلَّةً فَجَعَلْتَهُمْ كَسِينِكَةَ الْعِيقَانِ

*You found them dirty like a heap of dung,*

*And transformed them into a piece of pure gold.*

حَتَّى انْتَلَى بَرٌّ كَمَثَلِ حَيْقَةِ عَذْبِ الْمَوَارِدِ مُثْمِرِ الْأَغْصَانِ

*And the wilderness of Arabia was transformed into such a garden,*

*The streams of which are pleasant and sweet, and the trees of which are laden with fruits.*

عَادَتْ بِلَادُ الْعَرَبِ نَحْوَ نَصَارَةٍ بَعْدَ الْوَجَى وَالْمَحَلِّ وَالْخُسْرَانِ

*The towns of Arabia awoke to life once again,*

*Leaving the days of death and drought behind.*

كَانَ الْجَحَاؤُ مَعَازِلَ الْعِزْلَانِ فَجَعَلْتَهُمْ فَانِينَ فِي الرَّحْمَنِ  
*The people of Hijāz were entangled in flirtation with doe-eyed beauties;  
 You made them completely lost in the love of ar-Raḥmān [the  
 Gracious].*

شَيْئَانِ كَانَ الْقَوْمُ غُمِيًّا فِيهِمَا حَسُو الْعُقَارِ وَكَثُرَةُ النِّسْوَانِ  
*Two things had made the nation blind:  
 The zest for drinking and indulgence in women.*

أَمَّا النِّسَاءُ فَخُرِمَتْ إِنْكَاحُهَا زَوْجًا لَهُ التَّخْرِيمُ فِي الْقُرْآنِ  
*As for women, marriage was forbidden  
 To those who were sanctified in the Quran.*

وَجَعَلْتَ ذِكْرَةَ الْمُدَامِ مُحَرَّبًا وَأَزَلْتَ حَاشَتَهَا مِنَ الْبُلْدَانِ  
*And you laid waste the drinking places,  
 And you closed down the drinking of all the towns.*

كَمْ شَارِبٍ بِالرُّشْفِ دَنًا طَافِحًا فَجَعَلْتَهُ فِي الدِّينِ كَالنِّشْوَانِ  
*Many were those who were intoxicated with drink after drink,  
 But you made them drunk with the wine of the Faith.*

كَمْ مُخَدِّثٍ مُسْتَنْطِقِ الْعِيدَانِ قَدْ صَارَ مِنْكَ مُحَدِّثَ الرَّحْمَنِ  
*How many were addicted to playing music,  
 But you made them enjoy the bliss of converse with ar-Raḥmān [the  
 Gracious].*

كَمْ مُسْتَهَامٍ لِلرُّشُوفِ تَعَشُّقًا فَجَذَبْتَهُ جَذْبًا إِلَى الْفُرْقَانِ  
*How many were the wanderers lost in love of fragrant beauties,  
 But you drew them firmly toward the Furqān [i.e. the Holy Quran].*

أُحْيَيْتَ أَمْوَاتَ الْقُرُونِ بِحُلُوءِ مَاذَا يُمَاتِلُكَ بِهَذَا الشَّانِ  
*You raised the dead of centuries with a single manifestation—  
 Who can equal you in this majestic rank?*

تَرَكُوا الْعَبُوقَ وَبَدَلُوا مِنْ ذَوْقِهِ      ذَوْقَ الدُّعَاءِ بِلَيْلَةِ الْأَحْزَانِ  
*They abandoned the pleasures of the evening wine,  
 And embraced the joy of prayers during nights of grief.*

كَانُوا بِرَنَاتِ الْمَتَانِي قَبْلَهَا      قَدْ أُخْصِرُوا فِي سُحَّهَا كَالْعَانِي  
*They were previously bewitched by the charms of musical instruments;  
 They were held like captives who could not move.*

قَدْ كَانَ مَزْتَعُهُمْ أَغَانِي دَائِمًا      طُورًا بِغَيْدٍ تَارَةً بِدَنَانٍ  
*Their pleasure resorts were their music chambers;  
 At times they would flirt with women or indulge in heavy drinking.*

مَا كَانَ فِكْرٌ غَيْرَ فِكْرِ غَوَانِي      أَوْ شُرْبِ رَاحٍ أَوْ خِيَالِ جِفَانٍ  
*They had no worry but the thought of pretty, singing women,  
 Or of wine and wine pots.*

كَانُوا كَمَشْغُوفِ الْفَسَادِ بِجَهْلِهِمْ      رَاضِينَ بِالْأَوْسَاحِ وَالْأَذْرَانِ  
*They were eager to violate peace and order out of their ignorance;  
 And were quite pleased to live in dirt and filth.*

عَيَّيَانٍ كَانَ شَعَارُهُمْ مِنْ جَهْلِهِمْ      حُمُقُ الْجِمَارِ وَوُثْبَةُ السَّرْحَانِ  
*Their ignorance branded them with but two traits:  
 The obstinacy of a donkey and the ferocity of the wolf.*

فَطَلَعْتَ يَا شَمْسَ الْهَلْدَى نُضْحًا لَهُمْ      لِتُضِيَنَّهُمْ مِنْ وَجْهِكَ التُّورَانِي  
*It was then—O Sun of guidance!—that you arose on the horizon  
 To give them light and benevolence with your lustrous face.*

أُرْسِلْتَ مِنْ رَبِّ كَرِيمٍ مُحْسِنٍ      فِي الْفِتْنَةِ الصَّمَاءِ وَالطُّغْيَانِ  
*You were sent by the Benevolent and Gracious Lord  
 In the time of turmoil, storm, and rebellion.*

يَا لَلْفَتَى مَا حُسْنُهُ وَجَمَالُهُ رِيَّاهُ يُضَيِّبُ الْقُلُوبَ كَالزَّرِيحَانِ

*What a noble man! How wonderful his beauty and grace!*

*His fragrance captivates the heart like sweet basil.*

وَجْهَ الْمُهَنِّمِينَ طَاهِرٌ فِي وَجْهِهِ وَشُؤْنُهُ لَمَعَتْ بِهِذَا الشَّانِ

*The countenance of God the Protector is visible in his face,*

*And the attributes of the Divine have shone through his noble station.*

فَلِذَا يُحِبُّ وَيَسْتَجِقُّ جَمَالُهُ شَغَفًا بِهِ مِنْ زُمْرَةِ الْأَخْدَانِ

*That is why he is beloved. Indeed, his beautiful virtues demand*

*Passionate love for him spring forth from the circle of beloved companions.*

سُجِّحَ كَرِيمٌ بَاذِلٌ خِلَ التَّقَى خَزَقٌ وَفَاقَ طَوَائِفَ الْفُتَيَانِ

*He is gentle, noble, open-handed, a companion of the righteous,*

*Generous, and one who has excelled all the youth.*

فَاقَ الْوَرَى بِكَمَالِهِ وَجَمَالِهِ وَجَنَانِهِ الرَّيَّانِ

*In excellence and beauty, he surpasses all creation,*

*And in glory and cheerfulness of heart.*

لَا شَكَّ أَنَّ مُحَمَّدًا خَيْرُ الْوَرَى رَيْقُ الْكِرَامِ وَنُجْبَةُ الْأَعْيَانِ

*Without any doubt, Muhammad is the Best of all Creation—*

*A man of extreme generosity, the soul and strength of the nobles, the elect among the elite.*

تَمَّتْ عَلَيْهِ صِفَاتُ كُلِّ مَرِيَّةٍ خُتِمَتْ بِهِ نِعْمَاءُ كُلِّ زَمَانِ

*All noble virtues attained perfection in his person,*

*The blessings of all times reached their apex in him.*

وَاللّٰهُ اِنَّ مُحَمَّدًا كَرِْدَافَةً وَبِهِ الْوُصُولُ بِسُدَّةِ السُّلْطَانِ  
*By God, Muhammad is the vicegerent of God,*

*And through him alone can one reach the royal court of God.*

هُوَ فَخْرُ كُلِّ مُطَهَّرٍ وَمَقْدَسٍ وَبِهِ يَبْتَهِجُ الْعَسْكَرُ الرُّوحَانِي  
*He is the pride of the pious, the holiest;*

*He is the pride of the spiritual legions of men of virtue.*

هُوَ خَيْرُ كُلِّ مُقَرَّبٍ مُّتَقَدِّمٍ وَالْفَضْلُ بِالْخَيْرَاتِ لَا بِزَمَانٍ  
*He excels all those who are close to God,*

*Indeed the criterion of excellence is a matter of noble deeds, and not the time.*

وَالطَّلُّ قَدْ يَبْدُو أَمَامَ الْوَابِلِ فَالطَّلُّ طَلٌّ لَيْسَ كَالْتَهْتَانِ  
*Reflect! The drizzle precedes the heavy rain.*

*Yet drizzle is drizzle and rain is rain.*

بَطْلٌ وَجَيْدٌ لَا تَطِيْشُ سِهَامُهُ دُوْ مُضْمِيَّاتٍ مُّوْبِقُ الشَّيْطَانِ  
*He is the unchallenged archer. His arrows do not miss the target*

*They are dead set on killing Satan.*

هُوَ جَنَّةٌ اِنِّيْ اَرَى اَتْمَارَهُ وَقُطُوْفُهُ قَدْ ذُلَّلَتْ لِجَنَانِي  
*He is a garden and I see that his fruits*

*And clusters have been lowered towards my heart.*

اَلْفَيْئَةُ بَحْرُ الْحَقَائِقِ وَالْهُدَى وَرَأَيْتُهُ كَالدَّرِّ فِي الْمَعَانِ  
*I found him to be an ocean of truth and guidance;*

*I found him to be a pearl of lustre and light.*

قَدْ مَاتَ عَيْسَى مُطَرِّقًا وَنَبِيْنَا حَيٌّ وَرَبِّيْ اِيَّاهُ وَافَانِي  
*Jesus silently bowed his head and died. As for our Prophet,*

*He is alive, and by my Lord, he has met me.*

وَاللّٰهُ إِنِّي قَدْ رَأَيْتُ جَمَالَهٗ      بِعُيُونِ جَسْمِي قَاعِدًا بِمَكَانِي  
*I call Allah to witness that I have seen his beauty*  
*With my physical eyes, while sitting in my own home.*

هَآ إِن تَطْلَيْتَ ابْنَ مَرْيَمَ عَائِشًا      فَعَلَيْكَ إِثْبَاتًا مِنْ الْبُرْهَانِ  
*Look! If you think that the Son of Mary is alive,*  
*Then produce your proof with arguments.*

أَفَأَنْتَ لَا قَبِيْتَ الْمَسِيحَ بِمَقْظَةٍ      أَوْ جَاءَكَ الْأَنْبَاءُ مِنْ يَّقْظَانِ  
*Have you ever seen Jesus the Messiah while you were awake?*  
*Or has any living man given you the news that he has seen him?*

أَنْظُرْ إِلَى الْقُرْآنِ كَيْفَ يُبَيِّنُ      أَفَأَنْتَ تُعْرِضُ عَنْ هُدَى الرَّحْمَانِ  
*Look at the Quran how clearly it declares his death!*  
*Would you turn away from the guidance of ar-Raḥmān [the Gracious]?*

فَاعْلَمْ بِأَنَّ الْعَيْشَ لَيْسَ بِثَابِتٍ      بَلْ مَاتَ عَيْسَى مِثْلَ عَبْدٍ فَإِنْ  
*Know that there is no proof of his life.*  
*Indeed Jesus died as all mortal men die.*

وَبَيَّنَّا حَيِّ وَإِنِّي شَاهِدٌ      وَقَدْ اقْتَطَعْتُ قَطَائِفَ اللَّقْيَانِ  
*But our Prophet is alive, and I bear witness to his life;*  
*And I have tasted the sweetness of being in his audience many a time.*

وَرَأَيْتُ فِي رِيْعَانِ عُمْرِي وَجْهَهُ      ثُمَّ الْبَيِّ بِمَقْظَتِي لَا قَانِي  
*I saw his blessed face even when I was young,*  
*And he also met me when I was fully awake.*

إِنِّي لَقَدْ أُحْيِيتُ مِنْ إِحْيَائِهِ      وَهَآ لِإِعْجَازٍ فَمَا أُخْيَانِي  
*I am certainly among those whom he raised to life.*  
*What a miracle! How well he raised me to life!*

يَا رَبِّ صَلِّ عَلَى نَبِيِّكَ دَائِمًا      فِي هَذِهِ الدُّنْيَا وَبَعَثِ تَابٍ  
*O my Lord! Eternally shower blessings on Your Prophet—  
 In this world and the next.*

يَا سَيِّدِي قَدْ جِئْتُ بِابْنِكَ لَاهِفًا      وَالْقَوْمُ بِالْإِكْفَارِ قَدْ أَذَانِي  
*O my master, as I am oppressed, I have come to your door to seek redress;  
 These people slander and torment me by calling me kāfir [a  
 disbeliever].*

يُفْرِئِي سِهَامُكَ قَلْبَ كُلِّ مُحَارِبٍ      وَيَشْجُ عَزْمُكَ هَامَةَ الثُّعْبَانِ  
*Your arrows pierce the heart of all enemies,  
 And your firm resolve crushes the head of the serpent.*

لِلَّهِ دَرُكَ يَا إِمَامَ الْعَالَمِ      أَنْتَ السَّبُّوقُ وَسَيِّدُ الشُّجْعَانِ  
*Bravo! O leader of the world!  
 You rank above all—the bravest of the brave.*

أُنْظُرْ إِلَيَّ بِرَحْمَةٍ وَتَحَنُّنٍ      يَا سَيِّدِي أَنَا أَخْفَرُ الْعُلَمَانِ  
*Look at me with mercy and grace—  
 O my master!—I am your most humble servant.*

يَا حَبِّ إِنَّكَ قَدْ دَخَلْتَ مَحَبَّةً      فِي مُهَجَّتِي وَمَدَارِكِي وَجَنَانِي  
*O my beloved!—My adoration for you has penetrated  
 Into my blood, heart, soul and body.*

مَنْ ذَكَرَ وَجْهَكَ يَا حَدِيقَةَ بُهْجَتِي      لَمْ أَخُلْ فِي لَحْظٍ وَلَا فِي أَنْ  
*O ye my garden of delight! You live in my memory all the time—  
 I see your face every moment of my life.*

جِسْمِي يَطِيرُ إِلَيْكَ مِنْ شَوْقٍ غَلَا      يَا لَيْتَ كَانَتْ قُوَّةُ الطَّيْرَانِ  
*My body yearns to fly towards you out of love—  
 Would that I had the power to fly!*



**This unique and splendid Ode is a result of my deliberation. I have poured into this Ode such verses which will grant guidance to those who reflect and assuage the thirst of the thirsty:**

بِمُطَّلِعٍ عَلَى أَسْرَارِ بَالٍ      بِعَالِمٍ عَيْنِي فِي كُلِّ خَالٍ  
*I declare in the name of Him who is aware of my secrets of my heart  
 And by the Being who knows the mysteries of my bosom.*

بِوَجْهِ قَدْ رَأَى أَغْشَارَ قَلْبِي      بِمُسْتَمِعٍ لَصُرْحِي فِي اللَّيَالِي  
*By the Being who knows all the corners of my being  
 And by Him who hears my wailing and crying during the night.*

لَقَدْ أُرْسِلْتُ مِنْ رَبِّ كَرِيمٍ      رَحِيمٍ عِنْدَ طُوفَانِ الصَّلَالِ  
*I have been commissioned by the Benevolent and  
 The Merciful God at the time of a storm of misguidance.*

وَقَدْ أُعْطِيتُ بُرْهَانًا كَرَفَحٍ      وَتَقْفَنَاهُ تَقْنِيفِ الْعَوَالِي  
*I have been granted arguments as sharp as a spear,  
 And I have straightened those arguments as a spear is straightened.*

فَلَا تَقْفُ الظُّنُونُ بِغَيْرِ عِلْمٍ      وَخَفْ أَخَذَ الْمُحَاسِبِ ذِي الْجَلَالِ  
*So, do not foolishly follow conjectures  
 And fear the Glorious Lord, the Reckoner.*

تَرَى آيَاتِ صِدْقِي ثُمَّ تَنْسَى      لَحَاكَ اللَّهُ مَا لَكَ لَا تُبَالِي  
*You see the Signs of my truthfulness, and yet turn away!  
 May Allah destroy you; why do you not care?*

تَعَالَ إِلَى الْهُدَى دُلًّا خُضُوعًا      إِلَى مَا تَكْتَسِبُ ثَوْبَ الدَّلَالِ  
*Come towards guidance with humility and submissiveness—  
 How long will you don the robe of error?*

وَأَنْ نَّاصِلُتَيْنِ فَتَرَى سِهَامِيْنَ وَمِثْلِيْنَ لَا يَفْرُ مِنَ النَّصَالِ  
*If you confront me in releasing the arrows, you will witness the sharpness  
of my arrows*

*The one like me does not flee from the fray.*

سِهَامِيْ لَا تَطِيْشُ بِوَقْتِ حَزْبٍ وَسَيَفِيْ لِإِيْغَادُرٍ فِي الْقِتَالِ  
*My arrows do not miss in the battlefield*

*And my sword spares no one in battle.*

فَإِنْ قَاتَلْتَنِيْ فَأَرِيْكَ أَنِّيْ مُقِيْمٌ فِيْ مِيَادِنِيْ الْقِتَالِ  
*If you fight me, I will show you*

*That I am steadfast in the battlefield.*

أَبَالِيْذَاءٍ أَتْرُكُ أَمْرَ رَبِّيْ وَ مِثْلِيْ جِنِّ يُوْذِيْ لَا يُبَالِيْ  
*Will I abandon the commandment of my Lord due to persecution,*

*While those like me care not for the torments?*

وَكَيْفَ أَخَافُ تَهْدِيْدَ الْخُنَاثِيْ وَقَدْ أُعْطِيْتُ حَالَاتِ الرِّجَالِ  
*How can I be fearful of the threats of the coward,*

*While I have been granted faculties of a resolute stalwart?*

أَلَا إِنِّيْ أَقَاوِمُ كُلَّ سَهْمٍ وَأَقْلِيْ الْإِكْتِنَانَ عَنِ النَّبَالِ  
*Beware! I will confront every arrow*

*I do not approve of closing down the fortification for fear of arrows.*

فَإِنْ حَزْبًا فَحَزْبٌ مِثْلُ نَارٍ وَإِنْ سَلَمٌ فَسَلَمٌ كَالزَّلَالِ  
*If you want to fight, you will confront a fire from our side*

*But if you desire peace, we are for reconciliation like sweet water.*

وَحَزْبِيْ بِالذَّلَائِلِ لَا السَّهَامِ وَقَوْلِيْ لَهْدَمٍ شَاخُ الْقُدَالِ  
*My fight will be with arguments, not the arrows*

*And my speech is a sharp sword, which breaks the nape of the neck.*

وَفَاقَ السَّيْفَ نُطْقِي فِي الصَّالِ  
قَدْ اغْتَلْتُ الْمَكْفُرَ كَالْغَزَالِ  
*My words are more powerful than the sword in its lustre and sharpness.*

*Indeed, I have vanquished who issued edicts of disbelief as a deer is hunted down.*

وَلَمْ يَزَلِ اللَّئَامُ يُكْفَرُونِ إِلَى أَنْ جَاءَ نُصْرَةُ ذِي الْجَلَالِ  
*The wretched continued in takfir [accusation of disbelief]*

*Until the help of the God of Honour and Glory arrived.*

وَقَدْ جَادَلْتَنِي ظُلْمًا وَرُورًا وَجَاوَزْتَ الدِّيَانَةَ فِي الْجِدَالِ  
*You have argued with me with injustice and falsehood*

*And have exceeded the limits of honesty in your argumentation.*

وَلَوْ قَبْلَ الْجِدَالِ سَأَلْتُ مِنِّي جُذِبْتَ إِلَى الْهُدَى قَبْلَ الْوَبَالِ  
*If you had enquired from me, before entering into the squabble,*

*You would be drawn to guidance instead of being destroyed.*

لَنَا فِي نُصْرَةِ الدِّينِ الْمَتِينِ مَسَاعِنُ فِي التَّرْقَى وَالْكَمَالِ  
*In the service of the mighty Faith,*

*Ours is the struggle that is gaining progress and perfection.*

هَدَانِي خَالِقِي نَهْجًا قَوِيمًا وَرَبَّانِي بِأَنْوَاعِ النَّوَالِ  
*My Creator has established me on the right path*

*And has nourished me with diverse types of favours.*

لَقَدْ أُعْطِيتُ أَسْرَارَ السَّرَائِرِ فَسَلْ إِنْ شِئْتَ مِنْ نَوْعِ السُّؤَالِ  
*Deep secrets have been bestowed upon me—*

*If you like, ask me any type of question.*

وَقَدْ غَوَّصْتُ فِي بَحْرِ الْفَنَاءِ فَعُدْتُ وَفِي يَدَيَّ أَبْهَى اللَّالِئِ  
*I dove deep into the ocean of self-annihilation;*

*When I returned, I had precious pearls in my hand.*

رَأَيْتُ بِفَضْلِ رَبِّي سُبُلَ رَبِّي وَإِنْ كَانَتْ أَدَقَّ مِنْ الْهِلَالِ  
*I found the paths of the graces of the Lord through His grace,  
 Even though they were thinner and finer than the crescent moon.*

وَكَمْ سِرٍّ أَرَانِي نُورُ رَبِّي وَآيَاتٍ عَلَى صِدْقِ الْمَقَالِ  
*How many a mystery did my Lord's light reveal to me—  
 And how many a Sign confirmed the truth that I proclaimed!*

وَعَلِمَ يَهْرَنُ عُقُولَ نَاسٍ وَرَأَيْ قَدْ عَلَا قُنَّ الْجِبَالِ  
*He granted me knowledge that will overpower the intellect of the foes  
 And granted me ideas that are loftier than the mountains.*

سَعَيْتُ وَمَا وَنَيْتُ بِشَوْقِ رَبِّي إِلَى أَنْ جَاءَنِي رِيًّا الْوِصَالِ  
*I remained steadfast in my quest of nearness to my Lord  
 Until I smelled the fragrance of union with the Beloved.*

وَقَدْ أُشْرِبْتُ كَأْسًا بَعْدَ كَأْسٍ إِلَى أَنْ لَاحَ لِي نُورُ الْجَمَالِ  
*I was bestowed drink after drink  
 Until I was totally engulfed into the Light of Beauty.*

وَقَدْ أُعْطِيتُ ذَوْقًا بَعْدَ ذَوْقٍ وَنِعْمَاءَ الْمَجَبَّةِ وَالذَّلَالِ  
*I was granted zest after zest  
 And the blessings of love and playfulness.*

وَجَدْتُ حَيَاتٍ قَلْبِي بَعْدَ مَوْتِي وَعَادَتْ دَوْلَتِي بَعْدَ الزَّوَالِ  
*I found life after my annihilation—  
 My wealth returned to me after I gave it up.*

لُفَاطَاتُ الْمَوَائِدِ كَانَ أَكُلِي وَصِرْتُ الْيَوْمَ مِطْعَامَ الْأَهْلِي  
*There was a time when I was fed leftovers,  
 Yet today I feed the masses.*

أَزِيدُ بِفَضْلِهِ يَوْمًا فَيَوْمًا وَأُصْلِي قُلُوبَ مُنْتَظِرِ الْوَبَالِ  
*I am progressing day by day;*

*Thus burning the hearts of those who desire my destruction.*

أَلَا يَا حَاسِدِي خَفْ قَهْرَ رَبِّي وَمَا أَلُوكَ نُصْحًا فِي الْمَقَالِ  
*O my envious opponent! Fear you Lord.*

*I am not being negligent in giving you good advice.*

فَلَا تَسْتَكْبِرَنَّ بِغَوْرِ عُجْبٍ وَكَمْ مِنْ مُزْدَهِي صِنْدُ النَّكَالِ  
*Do not be arrogant out of self-conceit—*

*Many proud and haughty ones have tasted awe-striking punishment.*

أَلَا يَا خَاطِبَ الدُّنْيَا الدَّيَّيَّةُ تَذَكَّرْ يَوْمَ قُرْبِ الْإِزْتِحَالِ  
*O seeker of the mundane world!*

*Bear in mind the day of the departure.*

سِهَامُ الْمَوْتِ تَفْجَأُ يَا عَزِيزِي وَلَوْ طَالَ الْمُدَى فِي الْإِنْتِقَالِ  
*O my dear! The arrows of death strike unawares—*

*Even if the time of departure from the world is prolonged.*

هَذَاكَ اللَّهُ قَدْ جَادَلْتَ بَغْضًا وَمَا فَكَّرْتَ فِي قَوْلِي وَقَالِي  
*May Allah guide you. You opposed out of envy*

*And did not ponder over my words.*

وَكَمْ أَكْفَرْتَنِي كَذِبًا وَرُؤْرًا وَكَمْ كَذَّبْتَ مِنْ رَفِيعِ الْخَيَالِ  
*You have given falsehood to me by lying and deceit*

*And called me an infidel due to your perverted thinking.*

وَإِنِّي قَدْ أَرَى قَدْ ضَاعَ دِينُكَ فَقُمْ وَارْزَأْ بِهِ قَبْلَ الرَّحَالِ  
*And I see that your religions is being lost,*

*So arise and safeguard it before the day of departure.*

حَيَاتُكَ بِالتَّغَافُلِ نَوْمٌ وَأَيَّامُ الْمَعَاصِي كَاللَّيَالِي

*Your negligent life is a kind of slumber—*

*Your sinful days are like the nights.*

وَلَسْتُ بِطَالِبِ الدُّنْيَا كَزَعْمِكَ وَقَدْ طَلَّقْتُهَا بِالْإِعْتِرَالِ

*I do not seek the world as you allege—*

*I divorced worldliness by adopting a life of solitude.*

تَرَكْنَا هَذِهِ الدُّنْيَا لَوَجْهِهِ وَأَتَرْنَا الْجَمَالَ عَلَى الْجَمَالِ

*We have forsaken this world to seek His Face*

*And preferred His Grace over hordes of camels [i.e. material wealth].*

وَإِنَّكَ تَزْدِرِي نُطْقِي وَقَوْلِي وَلَوْ صَادَقْتُهُ بِمِثْلِ اللَّالِي

*You belittle my admonition and advice*

*Even though you find it to be like pearls.*

فَلَا تَنْظُرْ إِلَى زَحْفٍ فَإِنَّ

نَظْمْتُ قَصِيدَتِي بِالْإِزْتِجَالِ

*Do not seek any constrained statement in it*

*For, I have composed my ode extempore.*

## QAṢĪDAH<sup>1</sup>

أُمِرْتُ مِنَ اللَّهِ الْكَرِيمِ الْمُمَجِّدِ      فَقُمْتُ وَلَمْ أَكْسَلْ وَلَمْ أَتَبَلَّدِ  
*I have been commissioned by the Benevolent and Glorious God,  
So I arose, being neither lazy nor lethargic.*

وَهَذَا كِتَابِي قَدْ تَلَأْتُ وَجْهَهُ      تَلَأْتُ سَمَطِي لَوْلُو وَزَبْرَجِدِ  
*And my book, which is resplendent  
Like the splendour of pearls and emeralds*

تَرَى نُورَ الْعِزِّ فِيهِ كَأَنَّهُ      أَيَّاهُ دُكَايَ أَوْ بَرِيقُ الْعَسْجِدِ  
*You will find the light of Divine cognizance in it  
As if it is a ray of the sun or a bar of pure gold.*

وَأَنْتَ أَرَى فِيهِ الشِّفَاءَ لِطَالِبِ      وَيُشْفَى بِهِ قَلْبُ السَّعِيدِ وَيَهْتَدِي  
*And I see in it a remedy for the seeker after truth  
By which the fortunate find contentment of heart and are guided.*

وَأَوْدَعْتُهُ أَسْرَارَ عِلْمٍ وَحِكْمَةٍ      وَرَتَّبْتُه مِثْلَ التَّقْنِيفِ الْمُسْنَدِ  
*I have strung in it the pearls of knowledge and wisdom;  
I have organized it like a skilled writer.*

وَكَمْ مِنْ لَآئِنٍ فِيهِ مِنْ سِرِّ الْهُدَى      فَيَا صَاحِبَ قَسْطِهَا وَلَا تَتَجَلَّدِ  
*It contains many pearls of guidance;  
So—O my friend!—search for them and be not hasty.*

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1. This *Qaṣīdah* was not included in the Arabic section of the first edition of *Ā'ina-e-Kamālāt-e-Islām* but was later incorporated into the first edition of *At-Tablīgh*. [Publisher]

وَقَدْ بَانَ وَجْهُ الْحَقِّ فِيهِ وَصَاحَةً      كَحَدِّ نَقَى اللَّوْنِ لَمْ يَتَحَدَّدِ  
*The countenance of the Truth has been amply manifested in it*  
*Like a comely cheek that has no sign of sickness or weakness.*

وَإِنِّي مِنَ اللَّهِ الْكَرِيمِ مُجَدِّدٌ      وَمَنْهُ مُبَارَاتِنِ وَسَيْفِنِ وَأُجْرَدِي  
*I have been commissioned as a Mujaddid [Reformer];*  
*He has granted me the power to fight as well as the sword and speedy stallion.*

وَوَاللَّهِ إِنِّي مِنْ نَخِيلِ خَمِيلَةٍ      وَجَبْنِ بِبُسْتَانِ يَرُوحُ وَيُعْتَدِي  
*By God, I am a date palm tree yielding abundant fruit;*  
*My Beloved graced me with His presence day and night.*

وَقَدْ خَصَّنِي رَبِّي وَأَلْقَى رِدَاءَهُ      عَلَيَّ فَمَا تَذَرُونَ مَا تَحْتَ بُرْجَدِي  
*My Lord specified me and covered me with His mantle—*  
*How would you know what is behind this decorated mantle?*

وَقَدْ ذُلَّتْ نَفْسِي بِتَوْفِيقِ خَالِقِنِ      فَلَيْسَ كَمِثْلِي فَوْقَ مَوْرٍ مُعَبَّدِ  
*My self became obedient with the ability granted by the Creator;*  
*There is none like me in this trodden path.*

نَمَا كُلُّ عِلْمٍ صَالِحٍ فِي قَرِيحَتِي      كَأَشْجَارِ مَوْلَى الْأَسْرَةِ أَعْيَدِ  
*Every blessed knowledge is flourishing within my nature*  
*Like a tree with thick and multiple branches.*

فَجَدَّدْتُ تَوْحِيدًا عَفَثَ آثَارُهُ      وَطَهَّرْتُ أَرْضَ الدِّينِ مِنْ كُلِّ جَلْسِدِ  
*I have revived the belief in the Oneness of God which had virtually disappeared.*  
*I have cleansed the land of the Faith from all idols.*



وَقَوْمٍ يُعَادِيْنِي غُرُورًا وَنَحْوَةً  
مَنْى أَدْنُ رُحْمًا يَنْأَى عَنِّي وَيُتَعَدِّ  
*My people have opposed me out of pride and haughtiness.*

*I try to approach them mercifully, but they flee from me.*

يَسُبُّ وَمَا أَدْرِي عَلَى مَا يَسُبُّنِي  
أَيُّكَفَرُ مَنْ يُغَالِي لَوَاءَ مُحَمَّدٍ ﷺ  
*They abuse me for what reason I do not know—*

*Can someone be called a kāfir [disbeliever], while he raises the flag of Muhammad, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him?*

يُرَاجِمُنِي مِنْ كُلِّ بَابٍ فَتَحْتُهَا  
لِنَصْرِ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ حَبِيبِي وَسَيِّدِي  
*Whatever door I open for the succor of my Lord and Beloved Messenger of Allah,*

*They oppose me and obstruct my way.*

وَقَدْ أَكْفَرُونِي قَبْلَ كَشْفِ حِجَابِهِمْ  
وَيَعْلَمُ رَبِّي صِدْقَ قَوْلِي وَمَقْصِدِي  
*They called me a kāfir even before the truth was made known to them*  
*And my Lord is well aware of my truthfulness and objectives.*

وَرُبُّ وَلِيِّ اللَّهِ بَرٌّ مُقَرَّبٌ  
يُرَى فِي عُيُونِ الْخَاسِدِينَ كَمُلْجِدٍ  
*There are many friends of Allah who are pious and accepted by the Lord,*  
*But they are seen as heretics in the eyes of the envious.*

وَأَيْقَظُهُمْ رُحْمًا عَلَيْهِمْ وَشَفَقَةً  
وَلَكِنَّهُمْ أَعْدَاءُ كُلِّ مُسْهَدٍ  
*With mercy and kindness, I awakened them,*  
*But they are enemies of all who awaken them.*

وَلَسْتُ بِتَارِكٍ أَمْرَ رَبِّي مَخَافَةً  
وَلَوْ قَتَلُونِي بِالْخُسَامِ الْمَجْرَدِ  
*I would never relinquish the commandment of my Lord*  
*Even if they cut me to pieces with a sharp unsheathed sword.*

وَكَيْفَ أَخَافُ نَهَيْتِ قَوْمٌ مُعَنَّدٍ      مَثِيلَ عَوَاءِ الذَّنْبِ بَلْ صَوْتُ جُدْجِدٍ

*How can I fear the noises of a people*

*Whose voice is like a ram—not even a wolf.*

وَكَيْفَ يُؤَثِّرُ حُجَّتِي فِي نَفْسِهِمْ      وَلَا حِطَّ مِنْ سِرِّ الْهُدَى لِصَفْنَدٍ

*And how can my admonition make an impact upon them?*

*The ignorant have no share in the secret of divine guidance?*

تَبَيَّنَتِ الْآيَاتُ حَقًّا فَمَا رَأَوْا      وَصَالُوا وَخَالُونِي عَلَى غَيْرِ مَرْصَدٍ

*The Signs have been fully manifested, but they do not see.*

*They attacked and imagined that I am without a protecting fortress.*

وَإِنِّي أَبْنْتُ لَهُمْ دَلَائِلَ مُقْصِدِي      وَلَيْسَ لَهُمْ أَذْنَى الدَّلَائِلِ فِي الْاِيْدِ

*I have fully explained to them the arguments for my objectives,*

*But they do not possess even the most trivial of arguments.*

وَقَدْ اسْتَتَرُوا كَالطَّيْرِ فِي وَكَنَاتِهَا      لَمَّا عَجَزُوا مِنْ قِبَلِ عَضْبٍ مُخَدَّدٍ

*They hid themselves like birds in their nests*

*When they despaired of combating the sharp sword [of my arguments].*

فَمَا قَاوَمُونِي فِي مُصَافٍ وَمَا اهْتَدَوْا      فَقُلْنَا احْسَبُوا لَا خَوْفَ مِنْكُمْ لِمُهْتَدِي

*None of them confronted me steadfastly, nor accepted guidance;*

*So I said: Be gone! A guided one has no fear of you.*

وَكَيْفَ أَعَالِجُ قَلْبَ وَجْهِ مُسَوِّدٍ      غَبِيٌّ شَقِيٌّ فِي الْبَطَالَةِ<sup>☆</sup> مُفْسِدٍ

*How can I remedy the disease of the blackened face*

*Of the wretched and unfortunate resident of Batala.*

1. ☆ This word has a double meaning: the first meaning is quite obvious. The second meaning points to the city named Batala. In the city resides a pernicious trouble-maker named Shaikh Muhammad Husain. I have made

وَيَعْلُونَ دَغَصَ الرَّمْلِ هَزْبًا وَكُلُّهُمْ  
 كَرِبٍ ثَوْرٍ لَوْحَشٍ يَخْشَوْنَ جَدَّ جَدِي  
*They flee and run upon the sand dunes  
 As the wild ox fears the hard soil.*

وَقُلْتُ لَهُمْ يَا قَوْمَ خَفْ قَهْرَ قَادِرٍ  
 وَأَقْصِرْ وَمَهْلًا بَعْضَ هَذَا الشَّدِيدِ  
*I told them: O my people! Fear the wrath of the Omnipotent God  
 And be somewhat softer and milder in your extreme inflicting of  
 pain.*

فَمَا تَرَكُوا أَوْزَارَ شَرٍّ وَفْتَنَةٍ  
 وَمَا خَافُوا نِيرَانَ يَوْمٍ مُبَدَّدٍ  
*But they did not abandon the armour of wickedness and conflict  
 Nor feared the fire that cuts to pieces.*

وَقَدْ تَرَكُونِي نَحْوَةً وَتَبَاعَدُوا  
 وَلَيْسَ قُؤَادِي عَنْ هَوَاهُمْ بِمُبْعِدٍ  
*They abandoned me in their haughtiness and turned away,  
 Yet my heart has not become distant from its regard for them.*

references to him in these odes which I have composed and the booklet that I have written. This man is totally destitute [of learning]—he has not been fed anything of literary knowledge, nor granted anything of the elite sciences. He is among those who opt for the crumbs and reject the precious gems.

Moreover, he is an enemy of truth, wretched of character, utterly ill-fated, a veritable serpentine mocker, along with hissing and showing his canine teeth. He has firmly rooted his tongue in a bundle of hissing sounds of foul attacks with the hatchet. He has laid bare his canine teeth like a wolf in its rapacity. And verily he possesses absolutely nothing of the knowledge, and is a companion of the wavering people and the hordes of the sneaking whisperer. I invited him towards my book, but he rejected. I inclined towards him with compassion but he took shelter. Therefore, I have now made up my mind to totally expose his secret so that people know that the facts are clear and the Shaikh is of satanic nature. (Author)



## REPLY TO SHAIKH MUHAMMAD HUSAIN BATALAWĪ'S PAPER

*Which he had written on 9 January 1893 &  
published in his magazine—number 1, volume 15*

خدا چون به بندد دو چشم کسی      نه بیند و گر مهر تابد بسی

*When God closes both eyes of someone,*

*Nothing can be seen even if the sun shines brightly.*

Shaikh Batālawī has once again levelled the same accusation against my humble self on page 22 of this paper that none of my writings is free from falsehood. The truth is that when someone is blinded by the veils of arrogance and envy, all he can see is darkness. But keep in mind that these allegations are nothing new. They are the very allegations that the malicious have heaped upon all the righteous servants of God Almighty who appeared in the world—that they are false, they are *kadh-dhāb* [great liars], they are fabricators, they are licentious, and they are usurpers of people's wealth. Nevertheless, when the people could not decide between these two groups, then He whose sight penetrates into the deepest depths of the heart would ultimately manifest His heavenly verdict like a bright sunny day to expose who the *kadh-dhāb* is and who the truthful is. Hence, at this time I feel no obligation to repeatedly adduce the evidence of my truth. I know full well that He in whom I place my trust and who knows my inner conditions better than everybody will judge the matter Himself.

It should be noted what [insulting] variety of his names our Lord and Master, the Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, was forced to hear over so lengthy a period from the wicked disbelievers, and how many false accusations, slanders and such were flung

upon him. Nonetheless, since he was truthful and God was with him, he could not remain concealed forever, and when the heavens moved powerfully to manifest his splendour, all the accusers were vanquished and vanished as if a sheet of paper had been rolled up.

Keep in mind that such subtle mysteries have often been materializing through the Prophets in the shape of words and deeds, which are considered utterly absurd and disgraceful in the view of the ignorant. For example, **Moses**, peace be on him, borrowing the utensils and clothing of the Egyptians and putting them to personal use; [**Jesus**] **the Messiah** going into the home of an adulteress and using the perfume offered by her that she had not earned lawfully, without preventing her from applying it to him; and **Abraham**, peace be on him, speaking in such a manner three times that apparently was construed as lying. Then, if anyone alleges the fabricated premise by way of arrogance and ostentation about Moses, that he was—God forbid—a usurper, or utters words about [**Jesus**] the Messiah that he made personal use of the illegitimate earnings of a prostitute, or publishes a writing about Abraham expressing distrust in him on account of alleged falsehood, then what else could we say about such a wretch except that his nature is altogether different from the nature of these pure souls, and the material and make up of that filthy one conforms to the nature of Satan.

Therefore, let Mr Batālawī bear in mind that all the allegations of falsehood that he makes against my humble self out of his ignorance, are the same type of allegations which were previously levelled against the Prophets, peace be on them, by the wicked. But the objection against him is of arrogance, haughtiness, and self-righteousness, which is the distinctive characteristic of *Mu'allim-ul-Malakūt* [the Instructor of the Realm of Angels—a sarcastic title of *Iblīs*] who is his permanent companion. If I have truly uttered any falsehood, I will incur its punishment, but if—like the words of *Khalīlullāh* [the Friend of Allah—a title of Abraham]—any word of mine appears to resemble falsehood in the sight of any simpleton, then this would only be his ignorance which will surely disgrace him one day. May God Almighty protect us from such people who, wearing the mantle of *Iblīs* [Satan personified],

go around proclaiming out of self-conceit that 'there is no one like me' and criticize others out of the darkness of their own souls. Verily, verily I say that after *shirk* [polytheism], there will be no evil like arrogance on the Day of Judgment. It is the type of affliction that disgraces man in both worlds.

The mercy of God Almighty protects every monotheist from harm except for arrogance. Satan would also boast of being a monotheist, but since his head was filled with pride, he looked down upon and criticized Adam—who was beloved in the sight of God Almighty—he, therefore, was ruined and accursed. Hence, haughtiness was verily the first sin that eternally destroyed someone.

Now I affirm—swearing by Allah, glorified be His eminence, in whose hand my life is and who will never let a sinful liar go unpunished—that just as God Almighty has established me as Masīḥ Ibn-e-Maryam [the Messiah son of Mary], so has He established me as Adam, and He said:

أَرَدْتُ أَنْ أَسْتَخْلِفَ فَخَلَقْتُ آدَمَ.

Meaning: I decided to appoint a Khalifah [vicegerent] from Myself in the earth so I created Adam; that is, this humble one.

Since I have now been appointed as Adam, it was inevitable that I also have a critic, who—in the eyes of people—would initially be considered one of the angels, but then shall don the robe [of God's curse] إِلَى يَوْمِ الدِّينِ [until the Day of Judgment].<sup>1</sup> Hence, it is now evident that he is none other than you [Shaikh Batālawī].

I declare again on oath that the sentence that I have written above is the word of Allah, glorified be His eminence. If it is not the word of Allah, glorified be His eminence, I pray that God Almighty may not grant me respite even for one night and He may inflict such chastisement upon me that He has never been inflicted upon anyone: 'O my

1. This is in reference to verses 15:36 in the Holy Quran: وَإِنَّ عَلَيْكَ اللَّعْنَةَ إِلَى يَوْمِ الدِّينِ (And, surely, on thee shall be My curse till the Day of Judgment.) [Publisher]

God! O my Guide who shows the way! If this is not Your word, and if You have not appointed me as the Khalīfah [Vicegerent]; if You have not named me 'Īsā [Jesus], and if You have not named me Adam, then cut me off from among the living, but if I am from You and indeed belong to You, then help me as You help those who are raised by You.'

Finally, I cannot refrain from writing that it is not just my opinion that Batālawī Šāhib is the Chief of the Arrogant; rather, a large group of Muslims testifies to it. Moreover, people are surprised why he has such arrogance and what the basis for it is. For example, when Satan expressed his arrogance, it was on the premise that he considered himself an honourable creation. He boasted, <sup>1</sup> خَلَقْتَنِي مِنْ نَّارٍ **['You created me of fire']** and belittled Ḥaḍrat Šafiullāh [the Elect of Allah—a title of Adam] with, <sup>2</sup> خَلَقْتَهُ مِنْ طِينٍ **['You created him of clay']**. Thus, if Mr Batālawī considers himself to be endowed with an honourable descent from his parents, he should come forward with some proof of it and offer the testimony of some witnesses. If the reason for arrogance is some kind of knowledge which he has acquired from Miyān *Shaikhul-Kull* <sup>3</sup> or someone else, that also should be proven because we still do not know what kind of knowledge he possesses—is he a physician, a philosopher, an astronomer, a logician, or a man of letters? Or does he excel all others in understanding the verities and insights of the Holy Quran? Or does he have, like Imām Bukhārī, hundreds of thousands of *aḥādīth* [sayings of the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>] on the tip of his tongue? But if he does not have any of these, then what can be proven about him except his satanic pride?

Now remember that arrogance is invariably predicated upon falsehood. Indeed, the filthiest falsehood is that which is manifested in combination with arrogance. That is why Allah, glorified be His eminence, smashes the head of the arrogant before all others. He will do

1. *Sūrah al-A'rāf*, 7:13 [Publisher]

2. *Sūrah al-A'rāf*, 7:13 [Publisher]

3. 'The Greatest Scholar' is one of the titles of Maulawī Nadhīr Ḥusain of Delhi. [Publisher]



the same now. It has already been proven that Miyān Batālawī is wont to label himself specifically as *maulawī*, and he calls others as ignorant, stupid, and illiterate; and if he is very kindly disposed towards someone, he calls him a *munshī* [clerk], and he labels my Jamā'at as a band of ignorant fools.

Now Miyān Batālawī should tell whether he has spoken the truth or spoken a lie by calling himself a *maulawī* and labelling others as ignorant, foolish, and illiterate. Verily, verily I say that I see falsehood having penetrated into the very roots of Miyān Batālawī, and that the filth of arrogance has rendered his falsehood even more poisonous. Since satanic pride has placed the full weight of its burden upon him, the filth of falsehood spews from his mouth with great force. Moreover, he shamelessly labels others as liars. I can declare on oath that if my honoured and revered friend **Maulawī Hakeem Noor-ud-Deen**—  
[بَارَكَ اللَّهُ تَعَالَى فِي مَجْدِهِ وَعِلْمِهِ وَبِقَائِهِ وَزَرَقَ عِبَادَهُ مِنْ نَفَخَاتِ فُيُوضِهِ وَبَرَكَاتِ نُورِهِ وَضِيَائِهِ. may Allah the Exalted bless his grandeur, knowledge, and longevity, and may He enrich His servants with his grace and blessings of his light and illumination]—were to stand on one side to describe the insights of the Noble Quran, and Miyān Batālawī were to stand on the other side to describe some verities of *Furqān-e-Hamīd* [the Praiseworthy Discrimination—the Holy Quran], I am certain as if I am seeing it right now, that in comparison with the aforesaid gentleman, this helpless, half-schooled mullah from Batala imprisoned by pride and arrogance will be left so humbled and so far behind that every sensible individual will be laughing at him.

I have always wondered why this *ḥaṭīb-ul-lail*<sup>1</sup> does not look inward at himself in spite of such baseless arrogance and manifest lies and why he so wickedly refers to scholars and learned people with disdain. It is easy to decide about his status as a *maulawī* and his corrupt delusions. The time for it, by the grace of God Almighty, is nigh. I will,

1. Literally, 'wood-gatherer at night'—a metaphor for someone who acts without awareness or discernment, unaware of the consequences of their thoughts or actions. [Publisher]

*inshā'Allāh* [God willing], describe a complete set of criteria for settling this issue at the end of this discourse. I will now provide the necessary responses to several criticisms, and those are as follows:

**HIS STATEMENT**—Is it incumbent upon the prophecies of even Prophets to be true or not? Page 26.

**MY RESPONSE**—The intent of the foolish critic for raising this question seems to be as if some prophecy of my humble self came out contrary to the actual events. Let it be clear, therefore, that this is easy to decide. It is incumbent upon the critic to arrange a meeting to present the *ilhām* [revelation (i.e. prophecy)] of mine in which there is an error in the words of the *ilhām* itself, not in any suspected or supposed interpretation. However, there must be some punishment for such a person to prevent him from hastening towards the filth of lying again and again.

**HIS STATEMENT**—Can someone whose given prophecy comes true while another is false be a *Mulham* [recipient of Divine revelation] with respect to the truthful prophecy?

**MY RESPONSE**—O blind fool! By the grace of the Almighty, no prophecy of my humble self has turned out false to this day. On the contrary, nearly 3,000 have already come true, and they continue to come true. As for the error of interpretation, open [*Ṣaḥīḥ al-*] *Bukhārī* and ponder over the subject matter of ذَهَبَ وَهْلِي [‘it occurred to me’].<sup>1</sup> And be fearful of becoming like those who turned apostate by seeing the errors of the interpretation of some prophecies.

**HIS STATEMENT**—Can someone who tells lies, usurps the properties of others, etc., be called a *Mulham*, [recipient of Divine revelation],

1. See footnote 1 on p. 348. [Publisher]

*Walī* [Friend (of Allah)], *Muḥaddath* [recipient of Divine discourse], or the addressee of God, if any prophecy of his comes true?

**MY RESPONSE**—Ill-natured fabricators [of lies] like you levied the same objections against the Prophets. Abraham was accused of lying, Moses and Jesus were accused of misappropriation, and the innately blind Christians etc., of this age, make similar accusations against the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, alleging that the property of a certain caravan was looted without the state of war. Their books are filled with such accusations. If it is now asked that if someone shed the blood of thousands and looted wealth, how can he be a true Prophet? The answer to such a fool would be ‘because of his perfect [heavenly] refulgence which is not bestowed upon any except the righteous.’ A wise person would see the lustre of this refulgence and would understand the true import of these matters by his God-given wisdom. But the ignorant one will remain adamant upon his criticisms and will move straight towards Hell.

The essential truth is that the right of God Almighty supersedes all other rights. Every body, soul, and property belongs to Him alone. Thus, when a man becomes disobedient, his property reverts to the Real Owner. Then the Real Owner has the right to destroy the properties of the disobedient without the intermediation of the Messengers and convey their lives to utter nothingness or cause such awe-striking punishment to descend upon them through some Messenger. Both amount to the same thing. Similarly, there are thousands of matters like the acts of Khidr whose merit is revealed to the Prophets and the *Muḥaddathīn* [recipients of Divine discourse]. They are assigned to carry them out, and those who hasten to interfere in opposition to their tasks are the ones who are destroyed.

**HIS STATEMENT**—Have you made a prophecy of the death of my humble self upon reaching the age of 52 years or not?

**MY RESPONSE**—I have certainly not made this prophecy about you. If anyone has attributed it to me, he certainly lied. It is sheer dishonesty and deceit on your part that without asking me or finding any such statement in my writings, you have accused me without any reason.

**HIS STATEMENT**—Some of your followers drink alcohol. Has your chief helper and follower not consumed alcohol at your home?

**MY RESPONSE**—لَعْنَةُ اللَّهِ عَلَى الْكَافِرِينَ [May the curse of Allah be upon the liars]. Now prove who drank alcohol at my house and who drinks alcohol out of those who have taken my *Bai'at* [Pledge of Allegiance]. I observe that people suddenly manifest a holy transformation in their behaviour after taking the *Bai'at*. They are regular in Prayers, abstain from the forbidden, and give precedence to the Faith over worldly objects. The truly righteous are in no need of being called virtuous by anyone. God Almighty sees the hearts, and His seeing is sufficient.

Now, in accordance with my promise, I would like to lay down a criterion herewith that will amply demonstrate that my humble self enjoys the support of Allah and Mr Batālawī is a liar of the first degree, a *dajjāl* [deceiver], and the leader of the haughty. That statement is the following.

Readers are aware, based on the continuous writings of Mr Batālawī, that he has called my humble self ignorant, foolish, and illiterate. Moreover, he has claimed that my humble self is, in reality, not a *Mulham* and a *Muḥaddath*; but rather, is a rogue, a *kadhdhāb* [great liar], and a *dajjāl*. According to him, falsehood permeates me entirely. When some Signs were shown to him, he responded that sometimes God Almighty helps a false claimant as well, even though He knows that His help would become a testimony for the truthfulness of a false claimant. Nevertheless, He helps such a one, and enables such liars to use the arts of divination and foretelling to say something which is fulfilled. Thus, Mr Batālawī has rejected such Signs through his absurd

statements. However, there is another criterion here which I describe below.

*A spiritual Sign through which it will be proven whether or not my humble self is truthful and a recipient of help from God Almighty. And whether Shaikh Muhammad Husain Batalawī is true in declaring me a liar and dajjāl, or whether he himself is a liar and dajjāl*

The intelligent can understand that, along with other Signs, there are also Signs that are composed of verities, spiritual insights, and fine points of wisdom, which are especially bestowed upon those who possess virtuous souls and are the recipients of abundant [Divine] grace as is emphatically proclaimed by the verse:

لَا يَمَسُّهُ إِلَّا الْمُطَهَّرُونَ<sup>1</sup>

and the verse:

وَمَنْ يُؤْتَ الْحِكْمَةَ فَقَدْ أُوتِيَ خَيْرًا كَثِيرًا<sup>2</sup>

So this will be a manifestly clear Sign to judge my truth and falsehood against that of Miyān Muhammad Husain. To make this determination, an excellent arrangement would be to hold a brief meeting in which the appointed judges may select a few *sūrahs* of the Noble Quran—containing not less than 80 verses in number—for a commentary. Then

1. Which none shall touch except those who are purified (*Sūrah al-Wāqī'ah*, 56:80). [Publisher]

2. And whoever is granted wisdom has indeed been granted abundant good (*Sūrah al-Baqarah*, 2:270). [Publisher]

one *sūrah* may be selected out of those by drawing a lot, and the commentary of this selected *sūrah* be determined as the criterion for the decision.

It must be obligatory that the commentary be written in fluent, eloquent Arabic language with rhyming phrases, and not be less than 10 *juzw*<sup>1</sup> in length. All the verities and insights written in the commentary should not be plagiarized, but should be new insights and unique subtleties not found in any other book. Moreover, they should not contravene the original Quranic teachings, but should, instead, demonstrate their power and magnificence.<sup>2☆</sup> And at the end of the book, there should be a *qaṣīdah* [an ode] composed of 100 refined couplets in fluent and eloquent Arabic in exaltation and praise of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him. The meter that should be adopted for the ode may also be determined by lot in the same meeting. Both parties may be granted 40 days to complete the assignment. After 40 days, the parties should recite their commentary and their couplets in Arabic in a public meeting. Then, if my humble self is found incapable or deficient in stating the verities and insights [of the Holy Quran] and composing eloquent and fluent Arabic and vibrant and refreshing couplets in praise [of the Holy Prophet], or even if Muhammad Ḥusain is found to be at par with me, I would immediately admit to being in the wrong and would burn my books. And Shaikh Muhammad Ḥusain would have the right at that time to place a noose around my neck and

1. A *juzw* comprises sixteen pages. [Publisher]

2. ☆ If anyone entertains the fear in their hearts of how such verities and points of wisdom can be accepted that are not present in earlier commentaries, let him ponder over the following statement [in *Fuyūd-ul-Ḥaramain* by Ḥadrat Shāh Waliullāh<sup>ra</sup>]: ثم رأيت كل آية وكل حديث بحرًا موجًا فيه من أسرار ما لو كتبت شرح سِرِّ واحد منها في مجلدات لما احاطته ورئيت الأسرار الخفية متبذلة في إشارات القرآن والسنة فقضيت العجب 42 [Then I saw every verse and hadith as a raging sea of mysteries. Even if one of those mysteries were to be described, it would exceed several volumes. And I saw the pointers preserved in the Holy Quran and Sunnah and I was totally awe-struck—p. 42 (printed 1890)]—[Author]

say: 'O *kadhbhāb* [great liar]! O *dajjāl* [deceiver]! O fabricator! Your ignominy has been exposed today. Now where is He whom you claimed to be your Helper? Where is your *ilhām* [revelation] now, and where have your miraculous Signs disappeared?'

However, if my humble self is victorious, then Muhammad Ḥusain should stand up in that very meeting and repent by saying the following words: 'O members of the audience! Today my ignominy has been totally exposed akin to the dawning of the day with the rising of the sun. It has now been proven that this man is truthful, and I was indeed the *dajjāl* and I was indeed the great liar, and I was indeed the *kāfir* [disbeliever] and I was indeed the faithless one. I now repent—be ye all witnesses to it!' Thereafter, he should burn his books in that very meeting and follow me like humble servants.<sup>1☆</sup>

**Gentlemen!** This is a way to settle the matter which I have made public at this time. Miyān Muhammad Ḥusain adamantly persists that my humble self is absolutely ignorant of the Arabic sciences ❄<sup>2</sup>, dull, wanting, absolutely bereft, and that I am totally lacking in the knowledge of the Quran. Moreover, I am not even worthy of receiving the help of God Almighty since I am a great liar and a *dajjāl*. At the same time, he lays claim to excellence in knowledge and learning because in his view, the revered Ḥaḍrat Maulawī Noor-ud-Deen, who, in the sight of this humble one, is a scholar of the times and a compendium of knowledge, is only a physician, and Respected Brother Maulawī Sayyed Muhammad Ahsan, who is a veritable epitome of the knowledge of hadith, is just a clerk. Thus, his claims, along with his statements about my poor condition that he has published again and again, leave no doubt about the validity of this manner of deciding. And if he is not capable of participating in this competition and has uttered a lie about

1. ☆ Shaikh Batālāwī would be permitted to have Miyān *Shaikhul-Kull* [Nadhīr Ḥusain] and all other haughty *mullahs* to join him. Author

2. ☆ See his fatwa [in *Ishā'atus-Sunnah*], no. 4, vol. 13, p. 115. [Author]

himself as well as about me and my honoured and respected friends, then such a person is worthy of punishment to some degree that being himself a *kadhdhāb* and *dajjāl*, he blatantly publicizes others as being the liars.

It should also be remembered that my humble self is truly very weak and insignificant—as if nothing at all. Nonetheless, God Almighty has willed to smash the head of the haughty and to show him what heavenly support means. A few months ago—I do not recall the exact date—I saw an article by Miyañ Muhammad Ḥusain in which it was written about me that this person is a *kadhdhāb*, *dajjāl*, faithless, and together with this, extremely foolish and ignorant and lacks knowledge of the religious sciences. I then cried in the court of the Divine asking for His help. After the supplication, I received the *ilhām* [revelation]:

أَدْعُونِي أَجِبْ لَكُمْ

Meaning that: Pray unto Me, I shall answer your prayer.

However, I was naturally loath to praying for the punishment of anyone, but today—29 Sha‘bān 1310 AH—at the time of writing this essay, God Almighty unlocked my heart for supplication. So at that moment I prayed in this very condition with a weeping heart to gain victory in this competition. My heart was set free and I know that my prayer had been accepted. I also know that the *ilhām* which I had received concerning Miyañ [Muḥammad Ḥusain] Batālawī that:

إِنِّي مُهِنٌ مِّنْ أَرَادَ إِهَانَتَكَ.

[I shall humiliate him who designs to humiliate you.]

was with reference to this very situation. I have appointed a period of forty days for this competition in my supplication, and the same time frame flowed from my tongue.

Now, gentlemen, if I am proven false in this Sign or flee from the battlefield, or elude it through some flimsy excuses, then you all shall



bear witness that I am undoubtedly a *kadhhab* and *dajjal*. I will, then, be deserving of every punishment because, in that case, my falsehood would be established in every way, and the rejection of my prayer would also make the falsity of my *ilhām* manifestly clear to everyone. However, if Miyañ Batālāwī is defeated, his humiliation, ignominy, ignorance, and foolishness will become manifest like the brightness of a sunny day. Now, if he does not accept this manifestly clear decision and flees from it, nor admits his error, then know for certain that he has earned the following reward from the court of God Almighty:

1. Curse<sup>1</sup>.....
2. Curse .....
3. Curse .....
4. Curse .....
5. Curse .....
6. Curse .....
7. Curse .....
8. Curse .....
9. Curse .....
10. Curse .....

AND, THIS COMPLETES THE NUMBER UP TO TEN.

PRINTED IN RIYĀD-E-HIND PRESS, QADIAN  
 Announced by: Mirza **Ghulam Ahmad** of Qadian  
 (30 March 1893)

1. The word *la'nat* (curse) is short for the prayer, 'May the curse of Allah be on the liars.' [Publisher]

**Warning:** If no reply is received within two weeks from April 1, it will be deemed as your evasion. [Author]

**Note:** If Miyañ Batālāwī does not wish to accept this Sign, but wants a different Sign, I will pray accordingly, but he should first declare with an announcement that he is incapable and unworthy of this competition. [Author]



بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

نَحْمَدُهُ وَنُصَلِّي عَلَى رَسُولِهِ الْكَرِيمِ<sup>1</sup>

## SIGN OF THE DAY OF JUDGMENT

One of the major Signs of the nearness of the Day of Judgment which comes to be known from this hadith that Imām Bukhārī related in his *Ṣaḥīḥ* [*al-Bukhārī*] from ‘Abdullāh bin ‘Amr bin al-Ās, and it is as follows: يُقْبَضُ الْعِلْمُ بِقَبْضِ الْعُلَمَاءِ حَتَّى إِذَا لَمْ يَبْقَ عَالِمٌ اتَّخَذَ النَّاسُ رُؤُسًا جُهَالًا فَسُئِلُوا فَأَفْتَوْا بِغَيْرِ عِلْمٍ يُقْبَضُ الْعِلْمُ بِقَبْضِ الْعُلَمَاءِ حَتَّى إِذَا لَمْ يَبْقَ عَالِمٌ اتَّخَذَ النَّاسُ رُؤُسًا جُهَالًا فَسُئِلُوا فَأَفْتَوْا بِغَيْرِ عِلْمٍ فَضَلُّوا وَأَضَلُّوا.<sup>2</sup> Meaning that: ‘Knowledge will be lost through the death of scholars until the point when no scholar is found, the people will take the ignorant as their leaders and rulers and will go to them for inquiries about religious issues, upon which those people, on account of their ignorance and lack of proficiency, will draw conclusions that are opposed to the way of truth and upstanding fatwas. So they themselves will go astray and will lead others astray.’

Then, in another hadith is: ‘Those who will issue fatwas in this age’—namely the *maulawīs*, *muḥaddith* [scholars of Hadith], and jurists—‘will be the worst of all creation on the face of the earth.’<sup>3</sup> In another hadith, it is said: ‘They will recite the Quran, but the Quran will not go down their larynx’;<sup>4</sup> that is, they will not act upon it.

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1. In the name of Allah, the Gracious, the Merciful. We praise Him and invoke blessings on His Noble Messenger. [Publisher]
  2. *Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī*, *Kitābul-‘Ilm*, Bāb Kaifa Yuqbaḍul-‘Ilm, Hadith 100 [Publisher]
  3. *Mishkātul-Maṣābīḥ*, vol. 1, *Kitābul-‘Ilm*, p. 68, Hadith 276, published by Sharikat Dār Arqam ibn Abi Arqam, Beirut, Lebanon [Publisher]
  4. *Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī*, *Kitāb Istīṭābatul-Murtaddīn*, Bāb Man Taraka Qitālul-Khawārij..., Hadith 6934 [Publisher]

There are many other *ahādīth* about the *maulawīs* of this age, but I will provide, by way of a sample, proof of the hadith about the erroneous fatwas that I have cited above so that everyone should realize that if there is any benefit from these *maulawīs*, it is only that their degenerate behaviour is a reminder of the Day of Judgment and it is understood that it is near. Thus, we become eyewitnesses to the perfectly complete fulfilment of a prophecy of *Ḥaḍrat Khātamul-Anbiyā'* [the Seal of the Prophets], may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him.

To elaborate, since it was decided last year after consultation with most friends that the members of our Community should meet my humble self at least once a year with the intent of learning the essentials of the Faith and for consultations about propagating the Faith and the unshakeable Shariah. At the time of this consultation, it was also considered most expedient to appoint December 27 as the most appropriate and preferable date for coming to Qadian for this purpose because these are holidays and provide greater convenience and freedom to those serving employment. Moreover, because of the winter season, these days are convenient for travel. The friends and sincere members agreed happily with this advice and considered it appropriate. Therefore, based on this, my humble self sent an announcement to all members on 7 December 1892, and it was published in *Riyāḍ-e-Hind Press Qadian*. The gist of the announcement was that from among its objectives, the major purpose of this *Jalsa* [Annual Convention] is that all participants should get an opportunity to derive religious benefit from the face-to-face meeting and so that their religious knowledge and cognizance may be fostered.

It has now been heard that, in order to prove this activity to be an innovation, and indeed a sin, an older person has been bold enough to present a query to a *maulawī* by the name of Raḥīm Bakhsh—an imam in the Chiniyanwali mosque in Lahore. The import of the query was: What is the verdict about making a long journey for going to this conference on a specific date? And if a guest house is constructed specifically for accommodating the guests for such a conference, what is the

verdict about anyone who makes a financial contribution towards its construction? This last item was added to the query because the petitioner might have heard that my brother **Maulawī Hakeem Noor-ud-Deen**, whom I love for the sake of Allah, has constructed a house in Qadian for this gathering of Muslims at a personal cost of about 700 rupees or more and brother Hakeem Faḍl Din of Bhera has assisted in its construction by contributing 300–400 rupees.

In response to this query, Miyān Raḥīm Bakhsh has written a lengthy response quoting an irrelevant hadith with reference to شَدَّ رِحَال [shadd-e-riḥāl—setting out for a journey]. In brief, he says that going to such a gathering is an innovation; indeed, it is a sin. He adds that proposing such conferences is something novel which finds no support from the Holy Book or Sunnah [Practice of the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>]. Anyone who introduces such a matter in Islam stands condemned.

Now, let those people who possess honest dispositions declare faithfully whether the existence of such *maulawīs* and jurists in Islam is a Sign of the Day of Judgment or not. O naive man! Are you unaware that travelling for the sake of religious knowledge is not only permissible, but has been made obligatory by the Holy Quran and the Holy Law-giver, peace be upon him? Anyone who intentionally abandons it is guilty of a major sin, and deliberately insisting upon its denial under some situations amounts to *kufir* [disbelief]. Are you not aware that it has been commanded with great emphasis that: طَلَبُ الْعِلْمِ فَرِيضَةٌ عَلَى كُلِّ مُسْلِمٍ وَمُسْلِمَةٍ. Moreover, it has been commanded: اَطْلُبُوا الْعِلْمَ وَلَوْ كَانَ فِي الصَّيْنِ. Meaning: ‘Seeking knowledge is an obligation upon every Muslim man and woman’, and ‘Seek knowledge even if you have to travel to China for it.’

Now think about it. Considering that my humble self has announced in absolutely plain and clear words that the proposed journey for every sincere member would be solely with the intent of acquiring knowledge, how far removed from honesty, integrity, justice, *taqwā* [righteousness] and purity is it to give a fatwa that anyone who introduces such a matter in Islam stands condemned?

As for gathering all brethren together on a specific date is concerned, it is just a matter of making arrangements. It is not at all an objectionable innovation in Islam to do things by appropriate arrangements. <sup>1</sup> إِنَّمَا الْأَعْمَالُ بِالنِّيَّاتِ [Verily, deeds are (judged) by intentions]. Abandon the evil of ill thinking and reflect on what innovation there is in coming together on a specific date. Why is it unlawful to benefit from the convenience available for all friends to gather on a specific date, considering that on 27 December, every sincere friend can come over conveniently to meet me and in this context, their mutual meetings are also facilitated? Why is it unlawful to benefit from this convenience?

It is strange that the *maulawī* labelled me as condemned but did not recall the *aḥādīth* in which the Messenger of Allah, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, has encouraged travelling for the sake of acquiring knowledge and in which he has declared that travelling for the sake of meeting a Muslim brother is a means of earning the pleasure of the Lord of Honour and Glory, and in which it is written that travelling to meet the righteous is a means of attaining forgiveness and redemption of sins.

It should be borne in mind that it is utter ignorance to interpret the <sup>2</sup> شَدَّ رَحَالٍ [*shadd-e-riḥāl*—setting out for a journey] hadith as meaning that travelling anywhere except to the *Ka'bah* [in Makkah] or the Prophet's Mosque [in Madinah], or Baitul-Muqaddas [in Jerusalem] is prohibited. It is obvious that all Muslims have to travel for different purposes—sometimes the journey is indeed for the acquisition of knowledge, and sometimes it is to meet a relative, a brother or sister, or wife; or, for example, it may be a journey of the women for meeting

1. *Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī*, Kitāb Bad'ul-Waḥy, Bāb Kaifa Kāna Bad'ul-Waḥy ilā Rasūlullāh<sup>ṣas</sup>, Hadith 1 [Publisher]
2. *Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī*, Kitābuṣ-Ṣaum, Bābus-Ṣaum Yaumin-Naḥr, Hadith 1995 [Publisher]

their parents or of the parents to meet their daughters, or of men for their marriage or to search for a livelihood or delivering a message, or for meeting righteous people. For example, Ḥaḍrat **Umar**, may Allah be pleased with him, travelled to meet Ḥaḍrat **Awais** Qarni. And sometimes the journey is also for jihad, whether it be a jihad with the sword or for a religious debate [i.e. jihad with the pen]; and sometimes the journey is with the intent of engaging in a *mubāhalah* [prayer duel], as is proven from the life of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him. And sometimes, the journey is undertaken to meet one's religious guide, as has always been the case of the great *Auliya'* [i.e. Saints] amongst whom include Ḥaḍrat **Shaikh 'Abdul Qādir**, may Allah be pleased with him; Ḥaḍrat **Ba Yazīd Bistāmi**; Ḥaḍrat **Mu'in-ud-Dīn** Chishtī; and Ḥaḍrat **Mujaddid Alf Thānī**—all of whom have been travelling with such objectives and their handwritten travelogues are available to this day.

Sometimes, the travel is undertaken to obtain a fatwa as well. Its permission, indeed it being an obligation under certain circumstances, is proven from authentic *aḥādīth*. The journeys undertaken by Imām Bukhārī to seek the knowledge of hadith are well known. Perhaps Miyān Raḥīm Bakhsh is not aware of these. Sometimes travel is undertaken to see the wonders of the world, as is indicated by the verse:

قُلْ سِيرُوا فِي الْأَرْضِ<sup>1</sup>

Sometimes a journey is carried out to stay in the company of the righteous, as is enjoined by the noble verse:

يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا اتَّقُوا اللَّهَ وَكُونُوا مَعَ الصَّادِقِينَ<sup>2</sup>

1. Say, 'go about in the earth' (*Sūrah al-An'ām*, 6:12). [Publisher]

2. O ye who believe! fear Allah and be with the truthful (*Sūrah at-Taubah*, 9:119). [Publisher]

Sometimes travel is undertaken to visit the sick or attend a funeral. Sometimes, a sick person, or someone caring for him, travels for seeking treatment. Travel is also undertaken sometimes to attend a court hearing or for commerce etc. All these forms of travel are permissible according to the Noble Quran and the Hadith of the Holy Prophet. Indeed, there is great emphasis and encouragement in authentic *ahādith* for travelling to meet the righteous, to meet brethren, and to seek knowledge. If I were to write all these *ahādith* here, it would form a book in itself.

Those who issue such fatwas and who have them issued do not realize that they themselves are often faced with the need to undertake such travel. Therefore, if it is forbidden to travel anywhere except to the three Mosques [in Makkah, Madinah, and Jerusalem], then these people should give up all their relationships and relatives and sit idle and never undertake a journey to meet them, sympathize with them, or express their commiserations or care for their welfare. I do not think that anyone besides those totally blinded by prejudice and ignorance would hesitate to confirm the permissibility of all such travel. Open page 16 of *Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī* and see how much has been said by way of glad tidings for travelling to seek knowledge. It is said there that: مَنْ سَلَكَ طَرِيقًا يَطْلُبُ بِهِ عِلْمًا سَهَّلَ اللَّهُ لَهُ طَرِيقَ الْجَنَّةِ<sup>1</sup> Meaning that the person who travels to seek knowledge and treads a certain path, Allah will make the path to Paradise easy for him.

O unjust *maulawī*, now exercise some fairness. You condemned a brother who subscribes to the *Kalimah* like you, faces the *Qiblah*, and believes in Allah and His Messenger. You declared him to be totally deprived of the mercy of God Almighty and the intercession of the Messenger of Allah, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him. You also paid no attention to this authentic hadith in *Bukhārī*, which says: [‘أَشْعَدُ النَّاسِ بِشَفَاعَتِي يَوْمَ الْقِيَامَةِ مَنْ قَالَ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ خَالِصًا مِنْ قَلْبِهِ أَوْ نَفْسِهِ<sup>2</sup>’]

1. *Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī, Kitābul-‘Ilm*, Bābul-‘Ilm Qablul-Qaul wal-‘Amal [Publisher]

2. *Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī, Kitābul-‘Ilm*, Bābul-Ḥirṣ ‘alāul-Hadith, Hadith 99 [Publisher]



thiest of my intercession on the Day of Judgment will be the one who says, "There is no one worthy of worship except Allah" with purity of heart or mind']. The reason given in your fatwa for declaring me as condemned is that an announcement has been issued, and people have been invited to attend the *Jalsa*.

O ye deprived of any fear of God! Just open your eyes and read what the subject is from the announcement dated 7 December 1892. Have I invited the members of my Jamā'at for seeking knowledge, for resolving difficulties faced by the Faith, for showing goodwill for Islam, and promoting brotherly meetings, or does it mention some different kind of festival with singing and music?

O *maulawīs* of this age who bring disgrace upon Islam! Why do you not fear Allah, glorified be His eminence? Are you not going to die one day, or are you totally exempt from being called to account? You hear the word of truth and commandments of Allah and His Messenger, but do not think of reverting from your stubbornness. Instead, like chronic litigants, you try to find some way of making up a response and publicizing it so that the people do not think that their *maulawī* had no answer. How long will you persist in such audacity, dishonesty, jealousy, and malice? When writing your fatwa, you failed to recall the *aḥādīth* in which travelling for seeking knowledge of the Faith, removing misunderstandings, and meeting brethren in Faith and dear ones has been declared to be a source of great blessings and immense reward. As a matter of fact, it has been a well-established tradition among the pious predecessors to travel to meet the righteous.

It is narrated in a hadith that when a person will be liable for great punishment for his evil deeds on the Day of Judgment, Allah, glorified be His eminence, will ask him if he had ever gone to visit a certain righteous person. He will respond that he never did so intentionally, but by chance, he came across him during a journey. God Almighty will then say: 'Go and enter Paradise. I forgive you solely for that meeting.' Now, O short-sighted *maulawī*! Reflect a little: What does this hadith encourage?

If someone is troubled by the misconception as to why a specific date has been fixed for this religious *Jalsa* and how is such a practice proven from the actions of the Messenger of Allah, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, or the Companions, may Allah be pleased with them, the answer is: Open *Bukhārī* and *Muslim* and see that the Bedouins used to visit the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, to enquire about [religious] issues during the times when they were free. And some would present themselves in groups before the Messenger of Allah, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, during very specific months when they would have the time. *Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī* has recorded a hadith from Abī Jamrah that: قَالَ إِنَّ وَفْدَ عَبْدِ الْقَيْسِ أَتَوْا النَّبِيَّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ، قَالُوا: إِنَّا نَأْتِيكَ مِنْ شَقَةِ بَعِيدَةٍ وَلَا نَسْتَطِيعُ أَنْ نَأْتِيكَ إِلَّا فِي شَهْرِ حَرَامٍ.<sup>1</sup> Meaning that some representatives of the tribe 'Abdul Qais presented themselves to the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, and said: 'We travel a long distance to come here, and we cannot come except during the sacred months.' The Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, did not disapprove of their statement. It can be inferred from this hadith that the people who want to meet their spiritual leader to seek knowledge or serve a religious need can fix a date that suits them in terms of freedom from their activities when they can come without any inconvenience and harm. That, indeed, is the case for setting 27 December as the date because the employed people can conveniently come on those days due to the holidays.

God Almighty says in the Holy Quran that nothing inconvenient has been placed in this religion. This indicates that there is no harm in adopting the easier course in something that is legitimate and can be carried out with some convenience. To label such activities as innovations is the work of the blind who are deprived of the knowledge of both religion and world. Imām Bukhārī has devoted a special chapter

1. *Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī, Kitābul-'Ilm*, Bāb Taḥrīḍun-Nabī<sup>ṣas</sup> Wafid 'Abdul-Qais..., Hadith 87 [Publisher]

in his *Ṣaḥīḥ* about fixing a specific date for a gathering of seekers of religious knowledge. It is entitled *أَيَّامًا مَّغْلُومَةً* ; that is, fixing specific dates for the benefit of seekers of religious knowledge was the practice of some of the Companions. To prove this point, Imām Bukhārī narrates from Abī Wa'il in his *Ṣaḥīḥ*: *كَانَ عَبْدُ اللَّهِ يُذَكِّرُ النَّاسَ فِي كُلِّ خَمِيسٍ*<sup>1</sup>; meaning that Abdullah had fixed Thursday as the day for delivering his admonitions, and people used to gather for learning on that day.

It may also be borne in mind that Allah, glorified be His eminence, has commanded us in the Holy Quran to make use of planning and effective management. He has enjoined us to adopt what we consider to be the best plan and arrangement for serving the Faith and overpowering enemies, as He, hallowed be His name, says:

وَأَعِدُّوا لَهُمْ مَا اسْتَطَعْتُمْ مِنْ قُوَّةٍ<sup>2</sup>

Meaning that, make all needed preparations you can to counter the enemy and use all your power to propagate the message of Islam. See how vehemently this verse enjoins that all possible strategies that can prove successful to serve Islam be adopted and that all faculties of your mind and limbs, and all power of your wealth together with the best of planning and most appropriate tactics be employed so that you may be victorious.

The ignorant and blind *maulawīs* who are the enemies of the Faith now label this striving and planning as 'innovation'. These people of our times who are not even cognizant of the Holy Quran are called 'scholars'. *إِنَّا لِلَّهِ وَ إِنَّا إِلَيْهِ رَاجِعُونَ* [Surely, to Allah we belong and to Him shall we return].<sup>3</sup>

1. *Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī, Kitābul-'Ilm*, Bāb Man Ja'ala li-Ahliul-'Ilm Ayyāman Ma'lūmah, Hadith 70 [Publisher]

2. *Sūrah al-Anfāl*, 8:61 [Publisher]

3. A phrase from the Holy Quran which is recited by Muslims when one is afflicted with a misfortune. [Publisher]

Those who reflect upon the above-cited verse can understand that in line with the hadith of the Holy Prophet: <sup>1</sup> *إِنَّمَا الْأَعْمَالُ بِالنِّيَّاتِ* [Verily, deeds are (judged) by their intentions], no appropriate arrangement for serving Islam can be labelled as innovation or waywardness. As, with the changing times, new difficulties are arising for Islam, and new ways are being adopted to attack us, we have to make new plans to counter them. Therefore, if we think of a plan to counter and dispel the attacks prevailing at these times, it would be good planning and would have nothing to do with innovations.

It is also possible that because of the changing times, we may come across difficulties that were not faced by our Lord and Master the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him. For example, we cannot adopt the modes of fighting that were adopted by him, because the mode of fighting has been completely transformed. The older types of weapons are of no use, and new weapons have been invented. If handling and using these weapons is now considered an innovation, and if listening to the *maulawīs* like Miyān Raḥīm Bakhsh, we consider it a sin and misguidance because neither the Holy Prophet nor his Companions nor those who came after them adopted those modes of fighting, what else would happen besides us suffering the humiliating loss of even the dilapidated kingdoms that we now possess and the enemy being victorious? No other result would be achieved. Thus, in this verse of the Holy Quran, namely:

وَأَعِدُّوا لَهُمْ مَا اسْتَطَعْتُمْ مِنْ قُوَّةٍ<sup>2</sup>

Allah, glorified be His eminence, provides us sufficient guidance in all matters of fighting—whether they relate to physical or intellectual

1. *Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī, Kitāb Bad'ul-Waḥī, Bāb Kaifa Kāna Bad'ul-Waḥī ilā Rasūl-illāhī, Hadith 1* [Publisher]

2. *Sūrah al-Anfāl, 8:61* [Publisher]

warfare and whether the fight is with the sword or the pen. And we are granted general permission to adopt the strategy best known to us and that appears most effective against the enemy. It is therefore obvious that to label such appropriate arrangements as innovation and sin and to consider the helpers of the Faith who occupy themselves day and night to spread the message of Islam, about whom the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, says: حُبُّ الْأَنْصَارِ مِنَ الْإِيمَانِ [‘Love for the *Anṣār* is a sign of faith’] to be worthy of condemnation is not something that any virtuous person would do. On the contrary, it is actually the conduct of those whose spirituality has been disfigured. If you say that the hadith: حُبُّ الْأَنْصَارِ مِنَ الْإِيمَانِ وَبُغْضُ الْأَنْصَارِ مِنَ النِّفَاقِ—meaning that the love for the *Anṣār* is a sign of faith and envy against them is a sign of hypocrisy—is applicable only to the *Anṣār* who lived in Madinah but not to the helpers of the Faith in general, then it would justify being envious of all helpers of the Faith who appeared thereafter. This is certainly not the case; rather, this hadith, which was uttered with reference to one specific group of people, has a general applicability as well. In the Holy Quran several verses were revealed with reference to specific groups of people, but are considered to be of general application. In short, these people who are called *maulawīs* are enemies of the helpers of the Faith and are following in the footsteps of the Jews.

This statement of mine does not apply to the righteous ulema. It has been written only about the deceitful *maulawīs*. Every Muslim should pray that God Almighty may soon liberate Islam from the presence of these deceitful *maulawīs* because Islam is now going through a very precarious period and these foolish friends want Islam to be mocked and laughed at. They make such statements that are deemed clearly contrary to truthfulness by the light of faith in everyone’s heart.

May Allah the Exalted have mercy on Imām Bukhārī, who has devoted one chapter in his book to this issue as well. He writes in this

chapter: قَالَ عَلِيٌّ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ حَدَّثُوا النَّاسَ بِمَا يَعْرِفُونَ أَتَجِبُونَ أَنْ يَكْذِبَ اللَّهُ وَرَسُولُهُ<sup>1</sup> [Ali, may Allah be pleased with him, said: 'Speak to the people according to their level of understanding. Would you like them to falsify Allah and His Messenger?'] In explaining this hadith, Imām Bukhārī says in the footnote: أَيُّ تَكَلَّمُوا النَّاسَ عَلَى قَدَرِ عَقُولِهِمْ ; meaning that: 'Convey to people those topics of the sayings of Allah and His Messenger<sup>sas</sup> that they understand and that appear intelligible to them. Otherwise, they may unwittingly give the lie to Allah and His Messenger.'

Now, obviously any opponent who hears that the *maulawīs* have issued a fatwa stating that it is forbidden to travel in any other direction outside of three mosques and one or two other destinations, would laugh at Islam and would find an opportunity to find fault with the teachings of the Holy Law-giver, peace be upon him. The opponent would be completely unaware that this was simply the mischief or stupidity of a *maulawī* that was based upon some narrow-mindedness. He would directly attack our Lord and Master, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him.

Likewise, many such mischievous writings of the *maulawīs* have given ample help to the Christians. For example, when the *maulawīs* openly declared that our Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, is—God forbid—dead, but Ḥaḍrat 'Īsā [Jesus] is alive till the Day of Judgment, these people mounted vigorous attacks upon *Ahl-e-Islām* [the Muslims]. They misled thousands of simple-minded people with these very statements. These unworthy people did not understand that, in fact, all Prophets are alive—not a single one of them is dead. During the night of *Mi'raj* [Spiritual Ascension], the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, did not see the dead body of any of them. They were all alive.

Take note that in the Noble Quran, Allah, glorified be His

1. *Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī, Kitābul-'Ilm*, Bāb Khuṣṣa' bil-'Ilm Qauma dūna Qaum Karāhiyatan an Lā Yafhamū [Publisher]

eminence, informs His Noble Prophet<sup>sas</sup> about the life of Moses, peace be upon him, and says:

فَلَا تَكُنْ فِي مِرْيَةٍ مِّنْ لِّقَائِهِ<sup>1</sup>

Further, the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, has himself spoken about his becoming alive after death, his being raised to Heaven and meeting the Most Exalted Companion. Then what is so unique in the life of the Messiah [Jesus] that is not found in others? During the night of *Mi'rāj*, the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, encountered all Prophets equally alive and saw Ḥaḍrat ʿĪsā [Jesus] sitting along with Ḥaḍrat Yaḥyā [John].

May Almighty Allah shower His mercy upon Maulawī ʿAbdul-Ḥaqq, the *Muḥaddith* of Dehli, who records the statement of another *muḥaddith* of his time that it is verily his belief that if anyone, being a Muslim, considers the life of any other Prophet to be more potent than the life of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, then that individual falls outside of the pale of Islam, or perhaps he had written that that individual is close to becoming a *kāfir* [disbeliever]. Nevertheless, these *maulawīs* do not desist from such mischievous acts and depart from the Faith merely to publicize their enmity towards my humble self. It would be better if God Almighty wiped them all off the face of the earth in order to protect the religion of Islam from their deliberate distortions.

It is an opportune moment to exercise a little justice in that hundreds of people travel to Delhi seeking the knowledge or audience of Nadhīr Ḥusain, the wanting teacher, but that journey is considered permissible [by those very *maulawīs*]. Moreover, in spite of his elderly

1. Be not therefore in doubt as to the meeting with Him (*Sūrah as-Sajdah*, 32:24). [Publisher]

age, Nadhīr Ḥusain himself undertook a two-hundred *kos*<sup>1</sup> journey, arriving in Batala to feast at the *walimah* [wedding reception] of [Maulawī Muhammad Ḥusain] Batālawī, and that journey is deemed absolutely legitimate. Similarly, the Shaikh of Batala runs off to Shimla year after year to meet the British, seeking worldly fame, and that journey is not considered forbidden and *ḥarām* [unlawful]. In the very same fashion, some *maulawīs* travel here and there to the east and the west in the name of giving sermons to earn their living and that journey is not considered objectionable, and no one issues fatwas of them being innovators or evil-doers, or being worthy of condemnation. However, when my humble self, being appointed under Divine guidance and command to call unto truth, invites the members of my Community to seek knowledge, then that journey is declared *ḥarām*, and I am called an apostate on account of that act. Is this the way of *taqwā* [righteousness] and God-fearing virtue?

It is a pity that these simpletons do not even realize that planning and management cannot be inserted under the heading of *bid'ah* [innovations in the Faith]. Every time and age calls for new arrangements. If new types of challenges arise, then what can we do outside of new types of plans? So, would these plans be categorized as innovations? When the original Sunnah is safeguarded, and for its [continued] safeguarding we are compelled to make various plans, would such plans be called innovation? God forbid—not at all.

An innovation is something which, in its essence, hinders or opposes the Sunnah of the Holy Prophet, or for which there is a warning or limitation attributable to the Holy Prophet. If you want to label any new arrangement or plan as innovation, then keep counting the innovations in Islam—there is no limit to them. Knowledge of grammatical conjugation and syntax would be counted as innovation, as would be the art of composition. Moreover, documenting the *aḥādīth*

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1. A *kos* is a measure of distance, the length of which is approximately two English miles. [Publisher]



and classifying and arranging them into chapters would all become innovations. Similarly, riding a train, wearing clothes manufactured in factories, posting letters, seeking information by telegram, and fighting with guns and cannons would all be included as innovations. Indeed, fighting with guns and cannons would not only be considered an innovation, but also a major sin because there is a *sahih* [authentic] hadith stating that killing someone with the torment of fire is strictly prohibited.<sup>1</sup>

Who could be a better follower of the Sunnah than the Companions? Notwithstanding, they also did not understand the Sunnah to mean what Miyān Raḥīm Bakhsh has understood. They performed such activities under new plans and arrangements which had not been enjoined by the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, nor were they revealed in the Holy Quran. Look at the novel initiatives carried out by Ḥaḍrat Umar, may Allah be pleased with him, which would fill a volume. He established the Hijri calendar in Islam. He appointed policemen for protecting the cities and established a regular office for the treasury. He established rules for vacation and holidays for the army and ordained the regulation for their fighting engagements. He issued guidelines for the settlement of monetary disputes. He formulated and promulgated many regulations of his own for the protection of citizens. During the reign of his *Khilāfat*, he took upon himself the personal responsibility of sometimes going about at night in a covert manner to assess the true circumstances of the public. However, my humble self has not undertaken any such new initiative. I simply proposed this *Jalsa* [Convention] for seeking knowledge, mutual consultation, support for Islam, and meeting with the brethren.

As for the construction of a house, if it is *ḥarām* [unlawful] to build a house for the hospitality and comfort of every guest and traveller,

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1. *Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī, Kitābul-Jihād was-Siyar*, Bāb Lā Yu‘adhdhab bi-‘adhābul-lāh, Hadith 3016 [Publisher]

you should present a hadith or verse to support that view. What sin did brother Hakeem Noor-ud-Deen commit by constructing a house solely for the sake of Allah for the members of this Jamā'at? What kind of sincerity is it to go on criticizing an individual who is serving the cause of the Faith with all his ability and hard-earned money?

Gentlemen! You will find out after your death. Just wait a little, for the time is coming that you will be questioned about all of these verbal abuses. You constantly recite the hadith that 'He who dies without recognizing the Imam of his time, dies a death of ignorance,'<sup>1</sup> but you have no regard for the fact that someone was raised exactly at the appointed time—namely, the head of the fourteenth century—and not only the fourteenth century, but he also appeared during the very time of misguidance and the dominance of Christianity and philosophy. He proclaimed to be the Imam of the Age, but you denied him and labelled him a *kāfir* and *dajjāl*, without the slightest fear for your evil end, preferring to die in ignorance.

Allah the Exalted had instructed you to recite the following prayer in your five daily Prayers:

إِهْدِنَا الصِّرَاطَ الْمُسْتَقِيمَ ۝ صِرَاطَ الَّذِينَ أَنْعَمْتَ عَلَيْهِمْ<sup>2</sup>

Meaning that: O our God! Inform us of the path of those of Your servants who have earned Your blessings. Who are they? The Prophets, the Truthful, the Martyrs, and the Righteous. The essential meaning of this prayer was verily that whichever of these four groups whose season you chance upon, come under the shelter of their company and attain grace from them. But the present-day *maulawīs* have done a splendid job acting upon this verse—Bravo! Bravo!—who can I compare them with? They are akin to a blind man who openly boasts and

1. *Musnad Ahmad ibn Hanbal*, Juzw 10, p. 209, Musnad Mu'āwiyah ibn Abī Sufyān, Hadith 16819, published by Dārul-Hadith, Cairo, 2012 [Publisher]

2. *Sūrah al-Fātiḥah*, 1:6–7 [Publisher]

brags about curing the sight of others, but is completely oblivious to his own inability to see.

In the end, I also affirm that if Maulawī Raḥīm Bakhsh still does not retract his fatwa, I call him in the name of Allah, blessed be His eminence, that if he is a seeker of truth, he should come and visit me in Qadian to settle this matter. I will pay the total expenses of his journey and will prove to him by showing him the books and citing the Quran and Hadith that this fatwa of his is totally false and a satanic misguidance. **وَالسَّلَامُ عَلَى مَنْ اتَّبَعَ الْهُدَى** [And peace be upon those who follow the guidance].

Humbly, **Ghulam Ahmad** of Qadian, District Gurdaspur  
(17 December 1892)



بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ. نَحْمَدُهُ وَنُصَلِّي<sup>1</sup>

## PROCEEDINGS OF THE JALSA OF 27 DECEMBER 1892

*In Qadian, District Gurdaspur*

Although nearly 500 people had gathered during this *Jalsa* [Convention], the number of the friends and sincere devotees who travelled long distances solely for attending the convention for the sake of Allah reached about 325.

I shall now describe the proceedings of the days of the convention. First, Ḥaḍrat Hakeem **Maulawī Noor-ud-Deen** presented a commentary on the noble verses of the Holy Quran which comprise the narrative of how virtuous and chaste **Mary** the Truthful was, and how God Almighty bestowed all kinds of favours upon her honoured son **Jesus**, peace be upon him, and how he, having passed away from this mortal world upon drinking from the cup of death according to the decree of Allah, reached God Almighty's Abode of Tranquillity in which John the Chaste and other hallowed Prophets had already arrived before him. In the course of this speech, the honourable Maulawī Ṣāhib presented many verities and points of deep understanding which made a profound impact upon the audience. Maulawī Ṣāhib clearly proved that the Messiah, peace be upon him, had departed from this world and the concept of his being physically alive is baseless, false, and entirely against the definite and clear dicta of the Holy Quran and authentic *aḥādīth*. Hence, the hope for his physical descent is a vain desire.

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1. In the name of Allah, the Gracious, the Merciful. We praise Him and invoke blessings [upon His Noble Messenger]. [Publisher]

He also explained that although the news of descent had been given in many of the *ahādīth*, that particular descent is of a different context—that is, as a figurative expression and metaphor; not an actual literal descent—because a literal descent runs contrary to the explicit and decisive dicta of the Noble Quran and the authentic *ahādīth*, taking a step towards which would be like doubting the news given by God Almighty. After Maulawī Şāhib's address, Sayyed Hāmid Shah of Sialkot recited an ode.

After this speech, there was the brief speech of His Holiness **Mirza Şāhib** in which he refuted some points of the present-day ulema which, in their view, are the basis of their edicts of disbelief. And along with that, he gave proof through heavenly Signs of his being the **Promised Messiah**. He also informed the audience of the fulfilment of the prophecy that was published in the *Nūr Afshān* issue of 10 May 1888. It had been explained on several occasions to complete the argument, that the fulfilment of this prophecy is actually a Sign of the truth of his claim because this prophecy was manifested solely for those gentlemen who doubt whether Ḥaḍrat **Mirza [Ghulam Ahmad] Şāhib** was commissioned by Allah. For them, this would be a proof established directly from Almighty Allah regarding his claim. This proof is decisive because, according to the teachings of the Noble Quran and Torah, the prophecy of a false claimant of being commissioned by Allah, cannot prove truthful. The reason is that if Almighty God causes any prophecy of a liar's false claim to be true, then his claim would stand proven and God's created servants would be misled.

Afterwards, the Promised Messiah, Ḥaḍrat Mirza [Ghulam Ahmad] Şāhib gave some advice appropriate to the time about mutual love, *taqwā* [righteousness], and piety among the members of his Community.

Afterwards, on 28 December 1892, the esteemed

participants presented their advice about promoting the cause of religion in Europe and America, and it was decided that a periodical, which would comprehend the most important essentials of Islam and the beautiful face of the doctrines of Islam, should be compiled, and many copies should be sent to Europe and America. Afterwards, proposals were presented for the establishment of our own printing press in Qadian, and a list was compiled of those gentlemen's donations which they will be sending for the assistance of the press. It was also decided that a newspaper for the support of Islam should be commenced. It was also proposed that Ḥaḍrat Maulawī Sayyed Muhammad Ahsan Amrohi should be chosen as the preacher for this Community and should tour Punjab and India. This was followed by prayers.

Going forward as well, these shall always remain the very aims of this *Jalsa Salana* [Annual Convention]: for the publications of Islam and the sympathy of the new Muslim converts of America and Europe, appropriate proposals shall be deliberated upon so that progress is made in the world towards pious conduct, benevolence, *taqwā* [righteousness] and piety, virtuous morals, and for the removal of contemptible practices and disgraceful customs, and efforts and policies be made to be truly grateful and appreciative of this **British Government**. To fulfil these aims, and for the purpose of other arrangements, a committee was also appointed for which the President is **Maulawī Noor-ud-Deen** of Bhera; the Secretary is Mirza Khuda Bakhsh, teacher in the service of Khan Ṣāḥib Muhammad Ali Khan, Chief of Malerkotla; Shaikh Raḥmatullāh, Municipal Commissioner of Gujrat; Munshi Ghulam Qādir Fasih, Vice President and Municipal Commissioner of Sialkot; and Maulawī 'Abdul-Karīm of Sialkot. The following are names of the friends who participated in this *Jalsa* [Convention]:

| <i>Nº</i> | <i>Name</i>                                                                 |                                                                                                                                 |
|-----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1         | Maulawī Hakeem Noor-ud-Deen, Bhera Dist. Shahpur                            | <br><i>nephews of Maulawī<br/>Noor-ud-Deen</i> |
| 2         | Hakeem Faḍl-ud-Dīn, Bhera, Dist. Shahpur                                    |                                                                                                                                 |
| 3         | Miyān Ḥāfiẓ Muḥammad, Bhera, Dist. Shahpur                                  |                                                                                                                                 |
| 4         | Miyān 'Abdur-Raḥmān, Bhera, Dist. Shahpur                                   |                                                                                                                                 |
| 5         | Miyān Najm-ud-Dīn                                                           |                                                                                                                                 |
| 6         | Sayyed Qāḍī Amīr Ḥusain, Professor of Arabic, Madrasah, Amritsar            |                                                                                                                                 |
| 7         | Miyān Ḥasan Muḥammad, Zamīndār, Amritsar                                    |                                                                                                                                 |
| 8         | Maulawī 'Abdul-Karīm, Sialkot                                               |                                                                                                                                 |
| 9         | Miyān Maula Bakhsh, Shoe Seller, Sialkot                                    |                                                                                                                                 |
| 10        | Miyān Faḍl Karīm, Sialkot                                                   |                                                                                                                                 |
| 11        | Master Allāh Ditta, a Teacher, Sialkot                                      |                                                                                                                                 |
| 12        | Miyān Shādī Khān, Employee of Raja Amar Singh Bahādur, Sialkot              |                                                                                                                                 |
| 13        | Sayyed Nawwāb Shāh, a Teacher in American Mission School, Sialkot           |                                                                                                                                 |
| 14        | Sayyed Amīr 'Alī Shāh, Teacher, Resident of Seyyedān Walī, Dist. Sialkot    |                                                                                                                                 |
| 15        | Munshī Ilah Dīn, Sialkot                                                    |                                                                                                                                 |
| 16        | Chaudhary Muḥammad Sultān, Municipal Commissioner, Sialkot                  |                                                                                                                                 |
| 17        | Maulawī Abū Yūsuf Muḥammad Mubarak 'Alī, Sialkot                            |                                                                                                                                 |
| 18        | Mīr Ḥāmid Shāh, Clerk Remission of Revenue, Sialkot                         |                                                                                                                                 |
| 19        | Munshī Ghulām Qādir Faṣīḥ, Vice President Municipal Committee, Sialkot      |                                                                                                                                 |
| 20        | Miyān Faḍl-ud-Dīn, Jeweller, Sialkot                                        |                                                                                                                                 |
| 21        | Sayyed Khaṣṣat 'Alī Shāh, Deputy Inspector Police, Kurianwala, Dist. Gujrat |                                                                                                                                 |
| 22        | Miyān Faṭḥ-ud-Dīn, Gujrat                                                   |                                                                                                                                 |
| 23        | Munshī Ghulām Muḥammad, Student of Training College Lahore (Sialkot)        |                                                                                                                                 |
| 24        | Munshī Gulāb Khān, Draftsman, Sialkot                                       |                                                                                                                                 |
| 25        | Miyān Nūr Dīn, a Student, Sialkot                                           |                                                                                                                                 |
| 26        | Maulawī Quṭb-ud-Dīn, Baddomalli                                             |                                                                                                                                 |



| <i>Nº</i> | <i>Name</i>                                                                                                 |
|-----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 27        | Chaudhary Sarfaraz Khān, Nambardār, Baddomalli, Dist. Sialkot                                               |
| 28        | Miyān Muḥammad Dīn, Policeman, Sialkot                                                                      |
| 29        | Sayyed Maḥmūd Shāh, Sialkot                                                                                 |
| 30        | Miyān Imām-ud-Dīn, Noshehra                                                                                 |
| 31        | Miyān Allāh Bakhsh, Butcher, Sialkot Cantonment                                                             |
| 32        | Sayyed Amīr ‘Alī Shāh, Sergeant Police, Sialkot                                                             |
| 33        | Ḥakīm Shaikh Qādir Bakhsh, Ahmadabad, Dist. Jhelum                                                          |
| 34        | Ḥāfiẓ Sirāj-ud-Dīn, Isawala, Dist. Jhelum                                                                   |
| 35        | Miyān Sharf-ud-Dīn, Zamīndār, Kotla Faqīr, Dist. Jhelum                                                     |
| 36        | Miyān ‘Īdā, Zamīndār, Kotla Faqīr, Dist. Jhelum                                                             |
| 37        | Miyān Quṭb-ud-Dīn, Kotla Faqīr, Dist. Jhelum                                                                |
| 38        | Miyān ‘Alī Muḥammad, Imām Mosque, Kotla Faqīr                                                               |
| 39        | Maulawī Burhān-ud-Dīn, Muhallah Nau, Dist. Jhelum                                                           |
| 40        | Miyān Nizām-ud-Dīn, Muhallah Khojiān, Dist. Jhelum                                                          |
| 41        | Miyān Muḥammad Amīn, Haberdasher, Chakwal (Rawalpind)                                                       |
| 42        | Munshī Gulāb Dīn, Rohtās, Dist. Jhelum                                                                      |
| 43        | Miyān Allāh Dittā, Rohtās, Dist. Jhelum                                                                     |
| 44        | Munshī Ghulām Ḥusain, Rohtas, Dist. Jhelum                                                                  |
| 45        | Munshī Muḥammad Ḥusain, Employee of the Patiala State, Moradabad                                            |
| 46        | Maulawī Muḥammad Aḥsan, Amroha, Dist. Moradabad                                                             |
| 47        | Miyān Rashīd Aḥmad, Medical Student, Amroha, Dist. Moradabad                                                |
| 48        | Mīr Rashīd Ḥusain, Amroha, Dist. Moradabad                                                                  |
| 49        | Shaikh Zain-ud-Dīn Muḥammad Ibrāhīm, Chach Pokli, Kali Chokay Bombay, Engineer, Cloth Manufacturing Factory |
| 50        | Miyān ‘Abdul-Gafūr s/o Shams-ud-Dīn, Amroha, Dist. Moradabad                                                |
| 51        | Pīr Manzūr Muḥammad, Ludhiana (Deputy Inspector, Council Office Jammu and Kashmir)                          |
| 52        | Pīr Iftikhār Aḥmad, Ludhiana, Muhallah Nau                                                                  |
| 53        | Pīr ‘Ināyat ‘Alī, Ludhiana, Muhallah Nau                                                                    |

| <i>Nº</i> | <i>Name</i>                                                                   |
|-----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 54        | Bābū Muḥammad Bakhsh, Employee in Canal Office Ambala, Ludhiana, Muhallah Nau |
| 55        | Miyān Maula Bakhsh, Clerk Exams Office Lahore, Ludhiana, Muhallah Nau         |
| 56        | Miyān Karam Ilāhī, Police Constable, Ludhiana                                 |
| 57        | Qāḍī Khwājah 'Alī, Ludhiana                                                   |
| 58        | Munshī 'Abdul-Ḥaqq, Khalīfah 'Abdus-Samī', Ludhiana                           |
| 59        | Ḥāfiẓ Nūr Aḥmad, and Co. Cloth Merchant, Ludhiana                             |
| 60        | Miyān Nizām-ud-Dīn, Bookbinder, Ludhiana                                      |
| 61        | Maulawī 'Abdul-Qādir, Jamalpur, Dist. Ludhiana. (a Teacher)                   |
| 62        | Shāhzādah 'Abdul-Majīd, Ludhiana                                              |
| 63        | Miyān Karīm Bakhsh, Jamalpur, Ludhiana                                        |
| 64        | Haji 'Abdur-Raḥmān, Ludhiana                                                  |
| 65        | Miyān 'Abdul-Qādir Jaigan, Dist. Ludhiana, Teacher in Madrasah Jamalpur       |
| 66        | Miyān Shahāb-ud-Dīn, Ludhiana                                                 |
| 67        | Sayyed 'Abdul-Hādī, Machipura, Dist. Ludhiana                                 |
| 68        | Miyān 'Abdur-Raḥīm, Ludhiana, Muhallah Mochpura                               |
| 69        | Miyān Allāh Bakhsh, Dist. Ludhiana                                            |
| 70        | Miyān 'Iṣmatullāh Mistrī, Ludhiana, Bazar Kharādiyān                          |
| 71        | Miyān Raḥmatullāh, Dist. Ludhiana                                             |
| 72        | Miyān Shahāb-ud-Dīn, Dist. Ludhiana                                           |
| 73        | Miyān Nizām-ud-Dīn, Ludhiana                                                  |
| 74        | Ḥakīm Maulawī Nizām-ud-Dīn, Rangpur, Dist. Muzaffargarh, presently in Bhera   |
| 75        | Miyān 'Abdul Ḥakīm Khān, Samana, Patiala State, (Medical Student, Lahore)     |
| 76        | Munshī Ghulām Qādir, Sanaur, Patiala State, Patwārī, <i>Tehsīl</i> Sirhind    |
| 77        | Munshī Muḥammad Ibrāhīm, Sanaur, Patiala State                                |
| 78        | Qāḍī Zain-ul-Ābidīn, Khanpur, Patiala State                                   |

| <i>Nº</i> | <i>Name</i>                                                                           |
|-----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 79        | Munshī ‘Abdullāh of Sanaur, Patwārī, Ghaus Garh, Patiala State, <i>Tehṣīl</i> Sirhind |
| 80        | Munshī Hāshim ‘Alī, Sanaur, Patiala State (Patwārī), <i>Tehṣīl</i> Barnala            |
| 81        | Maulawī ‘Abdus-Samad, a.k.a Shaikh ‘Alī Muḥammad Sanaur, Patiala State                |
| 82        | Miyān ‘Abdur-Raḥmān, Sanaur, Patiala State, Patwārī, <i>Tehṣīl</i> Sanām              |
| 83        | Munshī Muḥammad Ibrāhīm, Teacher, Sanaur, Patiala State                               |
| 84        | Maulawī Muḥammad Yūsuf, Sanaur, Patiala State (Teacher)                               |
| 85        | Miyān Pīr Bakhsh, Kahiro, Patiala State (Zamīndār)                                    |
| 86        | Miyān Amīr Bakhsh, Kahiro, Patiala                                                    |
| 87        | Miyān Allāh Baksh, Barber, Kahiro, Patiala                                            |
| 88        | Shaikh Jalāl-ud-Dīn, Patiala State                                                    |
| 89        | Miyān ‘Alī Nawāz, Village Chamaro, Patiala State                                      |
| 90        | Miyān ‘Abdul-Karīm, Nambardār, Patiala State                                          |
| 91        | Miyān Muḥammad Ismā‘īl, Patiala State                                                 |
| 92        | Muḥammad Akbar Khān, Sanaur, Patiala State                                            |
| 93        | Miyān Nūr Muḥammad, Zamīndār, Ghaus Garh, Patiala State                               |
| 94        | Miyān Māhiyā, Zamīndār, Ghaus Garh, Patiala State                                     |
| 95        | Miyān Begā, Kahrīspura, Dist. Ambala                                                  |
| 96        | Miyān ‘Aṭa Ilāhī, Ghaus Garh, Patiala State                                           |
| 97        | Miyān Hamīrā, Jassuwal, Patiala State                                                 |
| 98        | Munshī Muḥammadi, Ghaus Garh, Patiala State                                           |
| 99        | Miyān Ghulām Qādir, Patiala, Muhallah Puriān. (Zamīndār)                              |
| 100       | Miyān ‘Abdul-Majid Khān, Sambhar Rajputana Agency (Student)                           |
| 101       | Ḥājī Muḥammad s/o Aḥmad Makki (the Holy Makkah)                                       |
| 102       | Mirzā Khudā Bakhsh, Jhang (Mentor of Nawwāb Muḥammad ‘Alī Khān Bahādur, Malerkotla)   |
| 103       | Ḥāfiẓ Najm-ud-Dīn, Bhattiyān, Dist. Gujranwala                                        |
| 104       | Qāḍī Ḍiyā’-ud-Dīn, Kot Qāḍī (Dist. Gujranwala). Post Office Botala                    |
| 105       | Munshī Muḥammad Dīn, Patwārī, Dist. Gujranwala                                        |

| <i>Nº</i> | <i>Name</i>                                                             |
|-----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 106       | Munshī Aḥmad Dīn, Gujranwala                                            |
| 107       | Sayyed Ghulām Shāh, Naurang, Gujranwala                                 |
| 108       | Miyān Karam Dād, Tehang, Dist. Gujrat                                   |
| 109       | Maulawī Jalāl-ud-Dīn, Bulānī, Dist. Gujrat                              |
| 110       | Miyān Ṣāhib Dīn, Tehal, Dist. Gujrat                                    |
| 111       | Maulawī Faḍl-ud-Dīn, Khariān, Dist. Gujrat                              |
| 112       | Miyān Muḥammad 'Alī, Jalalpur, Dist. Gujrat. Clerk Exams Office, Lahore |
| 113       | Maulawī Sayyed Jamāl Shāh, Preacher, Nindowal, Dist. Gujrat             |
| 114       | Ḥāfiẓ Faḍl Aḥmad, Gujrat, Clerk Exams Office, Lahore                    |
| 115       | Shaikh Raḥmatullāh, Municipal Commissioner Gujrat                       |
| 116       | Ḥāfiẓ Muḥammad, Peshawar Kotla, Elephant Handler from Bānān             |
| 117       | Miyān 'Abdullāh, Peshawar //                                            |
| 118       | Maulawī Ghulām Ḥusain, Teacher of Board School, Peshawar, //            |
| 119       | Ḥāfiẓ Ḥāmid 'Alī, Qadian, Dist. Gurdaspur                               |
| 120       | Ḥāfiẓ Mu'īn-ud-Dīn, Qadian, Dist. Gurdaspur                             |
| 121       | Mirzā Ismā'īl Baig, Qadian, Dist. Gurdaspur                             |
| 122       | Miyān Jān Muḥammad, Imām Mosque, Qadian, Dist. Gurdaspur                |
| 123       | Shaikh Nūr Aḥmad, Zamīndār Khara, Dist. Gurdaspur                       |
| 124       | Shaikh 'Abdur-Raḥmān, Buttar Kalan, Dist. Gurdaspur (New Muslim)        |
| 125       | Ḥāfiẓ Imām-ud-Dīn, Nangal, Dist. Gurdaspur                              |
| 126       | Miyān Muḥammad Bakhsh, Kakazai, Batala, Dist. Gurdaspur                 |
| 127       | Ḥājī Ghulām Muḥammad, Batala, Dist. Gurdaspur                           |
| 128       | Shaikh Murād 'Alī, Kalanaur, Dist. Gurdaspur                            |
| 129       | Miyān Hāshim 'Alī, Jand Mājha                                           |
| 130       | Miyān Nathu, Zamīndār, Bazid Chak, Dist. Gurdaspur                      |
| 131       | Miyān Mehar Dīn Zamīndār, Bazid Chak, Dist. Gurdaspur                   |
| 132       | Maulawī Ilāhī Bakhsh, Resident of Leel, Dist. Gurdaspur                 |
| 133       | Miyān 'Abdullāh, Sohla, Dist. Gurdaspur                                 |

| <i>Nº</i> | <i>Name</i>                                                        |
|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 134       | Miyān ‘Alī Bakhsh, Tailor, Sohla, Dist. Gurdaspur                  |
| 135       | Munshī Hāshim ‘Alī, Sohla, Dis. Gurdaspur                          |
| 136       | Faqīr Mardan Shāh , Sohla, Dist. Gurdaspur                         |
| 137       | Miyān Charāgh ‘Alī , Theh Ghulām Nabī, Dist. Gurdaspur (Zamīndār)  |
| 138       | Miyān Nizām-ud-Dīn , Theh Ghulām Nabī, Dist. Gurdaspur             |
| 139       | Miyān Muḥammad Bakhsh , Zamīndār, Theh Gulam Nabī, Dist. Gurdaspur |
| 140       | Miyān Shahāb-ud-Dīn , Zamīndār, Theh Ghulām Nabī, Dist. Gurdaspur  |
| 141       | Miyān Sultān Bakhsh , Dist. Gurdaspur                              |
| 142       | Miyān Khuda Bakhsh , New Muslim, Dist. Gurdaspur                   |
| 143       | Miyān Mehar ‘Alī, Bahbal Chak, Dist. Gurdaspur                     |
| 144       | Ḥakīm Muḥammad Ashraf, Batala, Dist. Gurdaspur                     |
| 145       | Miyān Muḥammad Akbar, Wood Contractor, Batala, Dist. Gurdaspur     |
| 146       | Shaikh Nūr Aḥmad, Chieftain, Batala, Dist. Gurdaspur               |
| 147       | Miyān Faḍl Ḥaqq, Dist. Gurdaspur                                   |
| 148       | Munshī Dīn Muḥammad, Dist. Gurdaspur, Policeman, Jammu State       |
| 149       | Miyān Muḥammad Ibrāhīm, Dist. Gurdaspur, Medical Student, Lahore   |
| 150       | Miyān Nūr Māhī, Batala, Dist Gurdaspur                             |
| 151       | Ḥāfīz ‘Umar-ud-Dīn, Theh Ghulām Nabī, Dist. Gurdaspur              |
| 152       | Miyān Nathu, Dist, Gurdaspur                                       |
| 153       | Miyān Raḥmat ‘Alī, Dist. Gurdaspur                                 |
| 154       | Munshī Ghulām Qādir, Dist. Gurdaspur                               |
| 155       | Miyān ‘Abdullāh, Dist. Gurdaspur                                   |
| 156       | Miyān Faqīr ‘Alī, Dist. Gurdaspur                                  |
| 157       | Miyān Sher ‘Alī, Dist. Gurdaspur                                   |
| 158       | Chaudhary Sultān Bakhsh, Zamīndār, Dist. Gurdaspur                 |
| 159       | Chaudhary Muḥammada, Garayanwala, Dist. Gurdaspur                  |
| 160       | Chaudhary Sulṭānā, Dist. Gurdaspur                                 |
| 161       | Mehar ‘Abdullāh, Dist. Gurdaspur                                   |

| <i>Nº</i> | <i>Name</i>                                                                                       |
|-----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 162       | Miyān Muḥkam Dīn, Shopkeeper, Sri Hargobindpur, Dist. Gurdaspur                                   |
| 163       | Miyān Muḥammad Shāh, Patauli, Batala, Dist. Gurdaspur                                             |
| 164       | Sayyed Mehar Shāh, Batala, Dist. Gurdaspur                                                        |
| 165       | Sayyed Faqīr Ḥusain, Patauli, Batala, Dist. Gurdaspur                                             |
| 166       | Sayyed Ḥusain Shāh, Kathala, Dist. Gurdaspur                                                      |
| 167       | Sayyed 'Umar Shāh, Nawan Pind, Gurdaspur                                                          |
| 168       | Mehar Nabī Bakhsh, Nambardār, Member Committee and Municipal Commissioner Batala, Dist. Gurdaspur |
| 169       | Shaikh Fateḥ Muḥammad, Batala, Dist. Gurdaspur                                                    |
| 170       | Munshī Muḥkam-ud-Dīn, Stamp Seller, Sri Hargobindpur, Dist. Gurdaspur                             |
| 171       | Munshī Muḥammad 'Alī, Pensioner, Zilladar, Batala, Dist. Gurdaspur                                |
| 172       | Ḥājī Ghulām Muḥammad, Deputy Inspector, Batala, Dist. Gurdaspur                                   |
| 173       | Bābū 'Alī Muḥammad, Dist. Gurdaspur                                                               |
| 174       | Munshī Muḥammad 'Umar, Dist. Gurdaspur                                                            |
| 175       | Shaikh Jān Muḥammad, Dist. Gurdaspur                                                              |
| 176       | Miyān Nūr Muḥammad, Faizulla Chak, Dist. Gurdaspur                                                |
| 177       | Miyān 'Umar Shāh, Dist. Gurdaspur                                                                 |
| 178       | Miyān Allāh Bakhsh, Dist. Gurdaspur                                                               |
| 179       | Miyān Ghulām Nabī, Dist. Gurdaspur                                                                |
| 180       | Miyān Karam Ilāhī, Dist. Gurdaspur                                                                |
| 181       | Miyān 'Alī Bakhsh, Dist. Gurdaspur                                                                |
| 182       | Miyān Maula Dād, Theh Ghulām Nabī, Dist. Gurdaspur                                                |
| 183       | Chaudhary Ḥāmid 'Alī, Nambardār Wazir Chak, Dist. Gurdaspur                                       |
| 184       | Chaudhary Ghasita, Bahbal Chak, Dist. Gurdaspur                                                   |
| 185       | Miyān Allāh Ditta, Bahbal Chak, Dist. Gurdaspur                                                   |
| 186       | Miyān Walī Muḥammad, Bahbal Chak, Dist. Gurdaspur                                                 |
| 187       | Miyān Ghulām Farīd, Bahbal Chak, Dist. Gurdaspur                                                  |
| 188       | Miyān 'Ināyatullāh, Batala, Dist. Gurdaspur                                                       |

| <i>Nº</i> | <i>Name</i>                                                                  |
|-----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 189       | Maulawī Qudratullāh, Batala, Dist. Gurdaspur                                 |
| 190       | Miyān Muẓaffarullāh, Batala, Dist. Gurdaspur                                 |
| 191       | Miyān Qādir Bakhsh, Batala, Dist. Gurdaspur                                  |
| 192       | Miyān Muḥammad Dīn, Qadian, Dist. Gurdaspur                                  |
| 193       | Miyān Ḥākim ‘Alī, Theh Ghulām Nabī, Dist. Gurdaspur                          |
| 194       | Munshī Zain-ul-‘Ābidīn, Dist. Gurdaspur                                      |
| 195       | Munshī Jān Muḥammad, Patwārī, of Jhelum, Dist. Gurdaspur                     |
| 196       | Miyān Jamāl-ud-Dīn, Fine Wool Weaver, Sekhwan, Dist. Gurdaspur               |
| 197       | Miyān Imām-ud-Dīn, Sekhwan, Dist. Gurdaspur                                  |
| 198       | Miyān Khair-ud-Dīn, Sekhwan, Dist. Gurdaspur                                 |
| 199       | Miyān Muḥammad Šiddīque, Sekhwan, Dist. Gurdaspur                            |
| 200       | Miyān ‘Abdullāh, Tahirān, Dist. Gurdaspur                                    |
| 201       | Miyān Quṭb-ud-Dīn, Dafarwala, Dist. Gurdaspur                                |
| 202       | Chaudhary Dīnā, Qadirabad, Dist. Gurdaspur                                   |
| 203       | Miyān Sher ‘Alī, Qadian, Dist. Gurdaspur                                     |
| 204       | Miyān Ilāhiyā, Watchman, Sekhwan, Dist. Gurdaspur                            |
| 205       | Miyān Gohar Shāh, Bhoe, Dist. Gurdaspur                                      |
| 206       | Chaudhary Nawwāb, Zamīndār Malolpur [Behlolpur], Dist. Gurdaspur             |
| 207       | Miyān Nūr-ud-Dīn, Ajoī, Dist. Gurdaspur                                      |
| 208       | Miyān Kalu Shāh, Alampur, Dist. Gurdaspur                                    |
| 209       | Miyān Nūr Aḥmad, Zamīndār Kalvi, Dist. Gurdaspur                             |
| 210       | Chaudhary Imām-ud-Dīn, Kalvi, Dist. Gurdaspur                                |
| 211       | Chaudhary Nizām-ud-Dīn, Kalvi, Dist. Gurdaspur                               |
| 212       | Faqīr Mehar Shāh, Koliyan, Dist. Gurdaspur                                   |
| 213       | Maulawī Ḥāfiz ‘Azīm Bakhsh, Bahomga [Bhoma], Dist. Gurdaspur, now in Patiala |
| 214       | Maulawī Ghulām Jilānī, Nohaun, Dist. Ambala, Teacher at Madrasah Guhronun    |
| 215       | Maulawī ‘Abdullāh, Teacher at Hindu-Muḥammadan School, Batala                |

| <i>Nº</i> | <i>Name</i>                                                                                |
|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 216       | Bābū Allāh Bakhsh, Ambala Cantonment, Railway Train Clerk                                  |
| 217       | Munshi Muhammad Mazahir-ul-Haqq s/o Maulawi Muhammad Zahur 'Ali, Etawah, Mohalla Qazi Tola |
| 218       | Ḥakīm Maulawī Muḥammad Ishāq, Guhla, Dist. Karnal                                          |
| 219       | Mīr Muḥammad Sa'id, Delhi, Kuhrki, Storeroom, Delhi                                        |
| 220       | Munshī 'Abdul-'Azīz, Delhi, Gali Qasim Jān, Employee in Canal Office, Ambala               |
| 221       | Mīr Muḥammad Kabīr, Delhi, Kuhrki, Storeroom                                               |
| 222       | Mīr Nāṣir Nawwāb Delhi, Kuhrki Storeroom, Draftsman in Canal Office Patiala                |
| 223       | Maulawī Muḥammad Ḥusain, Zamīndār Bhago Arain, Kapurthala State, Dist. Jalandhar           |
| 224       | Munshī Arora, Kapurthala, Dist. Jalandhar                                                  |
| 225       | Munshī Muḥammad Jān, Kapurthala, Dist. Jalandhar                                           |
| 226       | Munshī Ṣafar Aḥmad, Kapurthala, Dist. Jalandhar                                            |
| 227       | Munshī Ḥabībūr-Raḥmān , Chief of Ḥājīpur, Kapurthala State                                 |
| 228       | Miyān Jī Roshan Dīn, Kapurthala State                                                      |
| 229       | Ḥāfiẓ Muḥammad 'Alī, Kapurthal State                                                       |
| 230       | Miyān 'Abdul-Majīd Khān s/o Muḥammad Khān, Kapurthala State                                |
| 231       | Ḥakīm Fateḥ Muḥammad, Kapurthala State                                                     |
| 232       | Ḥāfiẓ Bābā, Nābina, Kapurthala State                                                       |
| 233       | Munshī Fayyaz 'Alī, Kapurthala State                                                       |
| 234       | Munshī 'Abdur-Raḥmān, Kapurthala                                                           |
| 235       | Miyān Nizām-ud-Dīn, Kapurthala                                                             |
| 236       | Miyān 'Abdullāh, Kapurthala                                                                |
| 237       | Munshī Ḥasan Khān, Employee State Artillery, Kapurthala                                    |
| 238       | Chaudhary Jhandu, Kapurthala                                                               |
| 239       | Miyān Karīm Bakhsh, Employee in Platoon, Kapurthala                                        |
| 240       | Munshī Imdādullāh Khān, Clerk in the Department of Education, Kapurthala                   |



| <i>Nº</i> | <i>Name</i>                                                                    |
|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 241       | Mistrī Jān Muḥammad, Kapurthala                                                |
| 242       | Munshī Muḥammad Dīn, Lahore, Clerk District Traffic                            |
| 243       | Munshī Muḥammad Ḥusain, Lahore, Clerk Exams Office, Lahore                     |
| 244       | Munshī Muẓaffar-ud-Dīn, Lahore                                                 |
| 245       | Miyān ‘Ināyatullāh , Student, Lahore                                           |
| 246       | Munshī Muḥammad Bakhsh, Lahore, Mochi Darwaza, Clerk Exams Office, Lahore      |
| 247       | Khalīfah Rashīd-ud-Dīn, Lahore (Medical Student)                               |
| 248       | Miyān Nūr-ud-Dīn, Lahore                                                       |
| 249       | Maulawī Karam Ilāhī, Lahore, Takia Sadhuan                                     |
| 250       | Ḥakīm Muḥammad Ḥusain, Lahore, Langay Mandi                                    |
| 251       | Miyān ‘Abdul-‘Azīz, Lahore, Langay Mandi                                       |
| 252       | Miyān Raḥīmullāh, Lahore, Langay Mandi                                         |
| 253       | Munshī ‘Abdul-‘Azīz, Baghbanpura, Dist. Lahore (Ex-Forester)                   |
| 254       | Munshī Imām-ud-Dīn, Calligrapher, Amritsar, Kura Karam Singh                   |
| 255       | Munshī Tāj-ud-Dīn Lahore, Accountant Railway Office                            |
| 256       | Master Aḥmad, Lahore                                                           |
| 257       | Ḥājī Shahāb-ud-Dīn , Lahore                                                    |
| 258       | Munshī ‘Azīz-ud-Dīn, Lahore                                                    |
| 259       | Khalīfah Rajb-ud-Dīn, Lahore                                                   |
| 260       | Miyān ‘Azīz-ud-Dīn, Patti, Dist. Lahore (Teacher at Baghana)                   |
| 261       | Miyān ‘Abdul-Latīf, Baghbanpura, Dist. Lahore                                  |
| 262       | Ḥājī Munshī Shams-ud-Dīn , Lahore, Clerk Exams Office Lahore                   |
| 263       | Miyān Nabī Bakhsh, Rawalpindi, Mohallah Quṭb-ud-Dīn, Clerk Exams Office Lahore |
| 264       | Miyān Pīr Bakhsh, Khoja Mukhadd, Dist. Rawalpindi                              |
| 265       | Chaudhary Muḥammad Sa‘īd, Mukhadd, Dist. Rawalpindi                            |
| 266       | Munshī Muḥammad Maqbūl, Mīr Munshī, Platoon No. 30, Rawalpindi                 |
| 267       | Şāhibzādah Sirāj-ul-Ḥaqq Jamālī Nū‘mānī, Sarsawah, Dist. Saharanpur            |

| <i>Nº</i> | <i>Name</i>                                                                       |
|-----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 268       | Ḥāfiẓ Ghulām Rasūl, Trader, Wazirabad, Dist. Gujranwala                           |
| 269       | Miyān Muḥammad Jān, in the service of Raja Amar Singh Wazirabad, Dist. Gujranwala |
| 270       | Shaikh Nabī Bakhsh, Wazirabad, Dist. Gujranwala                                   |
| 271       | Khalifah Nūr-ud-Dīn, Jammu                                                        |
| 272       | Miyān Allāh Ditta, Jammu                                                          |
| 273       | Sayyed Muḥammad Shāh, Jammu                                                       |
| 274       | Maulawī Tāj Muḥammad Sarbandi, Jammu                                              |
| 275       | Munshī 'Abdur-Raḥīm, Sub-Overseer, Srinagar (Jammu)                               |
| 276       | Munshī 'Abdur-Raḥīm, Overseer, Kashmir (Jammu)                                    |
| 277       | Mistrī 'Umar (Jammu)                                                              |
| 278       | Munshī Nawwāb Khān (Jammu)                                                        |
| 279       | Munshī Muḥammad Sharīf Nagyal (Jammu State)                                       |
| 280       | Maulawī Anwār Ḥusain Khān, Shahabad, Dist. Hardoi                                 |
| 281       | Shaikh Nūr Aḥmad, Owner Riyāḍ-e-Hind, Amritsar                                    |
| 282       | Miyān Ṣaḥūr Aḥmad s/o Miyān Nūr Aḥmad, Amritsar                                   |
| 283       | Shaikh 'Abdul-Qayyūm, Lawyer, Amritsar                                            |
| 284       | Maulawī Karīm-ud-Dīn, New Muslim, Amritsar (Katra Ahluwalia)                      |
| 285       | Maulawī 'Ināyatullāh, Ḥakīm, Amritsar (Katra Ahluwalia)                           |
| 286       | Munshī 'Abdur-Raḥmān, Amritsar (Kura Karam Singh)                                 |
| 287       | Chaudhary Muḥammadi, Amritsar (Katra Ahluwalia)                                   |
| 288       | Miyān Ghulām Qādir, the maker of silk girdles, Amritsar                           |
| 289       | Miyān Imām-ud-Dīn, Amritsar, Guru Bazar                                           |
| 290       | Bābū Muḥkam-ud-Dīn, Attorney Court (Amritsar)                                     |
| 291       | Mistrī Quṭb-ud-Dīn Khān, Amritsar, Durhi Karmun                                   |
| 292       | Maulawī 'Abdul-Laṭīf, Madrasah Muḥammadi (Amritsar) Katra Moti Ram                |
| 293       | Miyān Muḥammad Ibrāhīm, Katra Moti Ram, Amritsar                                  |
| 294       | Chaudhary Shāh Muḥammad, Zamīndār Ram Devali (Dist. Amritsar)                     |

| <i>Nº</i> | <i>Name</i>                                                                                                   |
|-----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 295       | Miyān Dīn Muḥammad, Bhoewal, Dist. Amritsar                                                                   |
| 296       | Miyān Faṭḥ-ud-Dīn, Rām Devali (Dist. Amritsar)                                                                |
| 297       | Sayyed Sikandar Shāh, Imām Masjid, Ram Devali, Dist. Amritsar                                                 |
| 298       | Miyān Būtā, Aulawala [‘Alīwal], Dist. Amritsar                                                                |
| 299       | Shaikh ‘Abdullāh, Student, Aligarh                                                                            |
| 300       | Shaikh Ḥāmid ‘Alī Khān, Medical Student Aligarh                                                               |
| 301       | Janāb Khān Muḥammad ‘Alī Khān, the Chief of Malerkotla                                                        |
| 302       | Shaikh Walī Muḥammad, Shahabad, Employee of Khān listed above                                                 |
| 303       | Shaikh Faḍl Muḥammad, Malerkotla, in the service of Khān, Muḥammad Zulfīqar ‘Alī and Muḥammad Yūsuf ‘Alī Khān |
| 304       | Sayyed Sher Shāh, in the service of Khān, Malerkotla                                                          |
| 305       | Miyān Ṣafdar ‘Alī, Malerkotla                                                                                 |
| 306       | Miyān ‘Abdul-‘Azīz, Malerkotla                                                                                |
| 307       | Miyān Jīvā, Malerkotla                                                                                        |
| 308       | Miyān Qādir Bakhsh, Malerkotla                                                                                |
| 309       | Miyān Barkat Shāh, Malerkotla                                                                                 |
| 310       | Miyān Kammay Khān, Malerkotla                                                                                 |
| 311       | Miyān Fateḥ Muḥammad, Malerkotla                                                                              |
| 312       | Miyān ‘Abdul-Karīm, Barber, Malerkotla                                                                        |
| 313       | Miyān ‘Abdul Jalīl Khān, Shāh Jahanabad, Malerkotla                                                           |
| 314       | Miyān Ḥāmid ‘Alī, Bareli                                                                                      |
| 315       | Munshī ‘Alī Gohar Khān, Jalandhar                                                                             |
| 316       | Munshī Rustam ‘Alī Khān, Madaran, Dist. Jalandhar, Deputy Inspector Police, Railway                           |
| 317       | Maulawī Aḥmad Jān, Jalandhar City, Teacher, Dist. Gujranwala                                                  |
| 318       | Miyān Wazira, Contractor, Khero, Nabha State                                                                  |
| 319       | Maulawī Shaikh Aḥmad, Preacher, Sirhind, Patiala State, now in Batala                                         |
| 320       | Miyān Muḥammad s/o ‘Abdullāh, Sheirpur, Dist. Firozpur, now in Bhera                                          |
| 321       | Sayyed Mi’rāj-ud-Dīn, Batala                                                                                  |

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*Nº*    *Name*

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- 322    Miyān Jān Muḥammad, Student, Batala
- 323    Maulawī Wazīr-ud-Dīn, Mukerian, Dist. Hoshiarpur
- 324    Chaudhary Karīm Bakhsh, Mukerian, Dist. Hoshiarpur
- 325    Ghulām Ḥusain, Mukerian, Dist. Hoshiarpur
- 326    Miyān Mīrān Bakhsh, Mukerian, Dist. Hoshiarpur
- 327    Miyān Ghulām Rasūl, Mukerian, Dist. Hoshiarpur

## WORTHY OF THE ATTENTION OF THE READERS

To understand the fact that man cannot halt the work of God Almighty through his own contrivances, this case is amply satisfying in that during the previous year when the fatwa of disbelief from Miyān Batālawī was not yet ready nor had he made any great effort for declaring this humble one a *kāfir* [disbeliever], only 75 friends and sincere ones had come to attend the *Jalsa* [Convention] in Qadian. However, now that the fatwa has been prepared and Batālawī Ṣāhib has exerted himself to his utmost, traversing all around with tremendous effort and bearing the hardships of travel, and has gotten the seals affixed upon this fatwa from the ulema of his own ilk, and he and the ulema of his ilk have boasted with great pride and pleasure as if they have now placed insurmountable obstacles in the way of the progress of this Divine institution, during this *Jalsa Salana* [Annual Convention], **three hundred and twenty-seven** friends have joined the *Jalsa*, instead of 75. Such gentlemen also came and attended who, having repented, have performed the *Bai'at* [Pledge of Allegiance].

Now, one should reflect: Is this not one of the Signs of God Almighty's magnificent powers, that the outcome was the opposite of what all the efforts of Batālawī Ṣāhib and the ulema of his ilk had desired and all those efforts went to waste? Is this not the act of God Almighty that Miyān Batālawī Ṣāhib's roaming and travelling around in Punjab and India, was to an extent to literally wear down his feet and yet, in the end, Almighty God has shown him how *His* designs prevail over man's designs.

وَاللَّهُ غَالِبٌ عَلَىٰ أَمْرِهِ وَلَكِنَّ أَكْثَرَ النَّاسِ لَا يَعْلَمُونَ<sup>1</sup>

During this year, Almighty God has manifested two Signs. First, that Batālawī remained frustrated in his efforts. Second, the fulfilment of the prophecy which was printed in the 10 May 1888 issue of *Nūr Afshān*. Even now it would be better for Batālawī Ṣāhib and his ilk to desist, and to stop fighting with God Almighty.

وَالسَّلَامُ عَلَىٰ مَنِ اتَّبَعَ الْهُدَى

[And peace be upon those who follow the guidance].

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Printed by the Riyāḍ-e-Hind Press, Qadian

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1. And Allah has full power over His decree, but most men know *it* not (*Sūrah Yūsuf*, 12:22). [Publisher]

# AN IMPORTANT ANNOUNCEMENT

*[Regarding Printing Press]*

Respectfully submitted to all sincere devotees and well-wishers of Islam.

After the customary salutations of peace, be it known that at the time of the *Jalsa Salana* that took place in Qadian on December 27, 28 and 29, it was decided on the basis of the advice from some sincere friends that since there have been persistent complaints about the **printing press** it is necessary to make permanent arrangements about it. In addition to the books in support of Islam, a semi-monthly paper should also be published, which should include commentary on some verses of the Holy Quran, as well as responses to the critiques of the opponents of Islam. The friends who were present endorsed this idea with great sincerity and an estimate was made as desired by the attendees. The expenses are estimated to be about ۞ [Rs. 250] per month. All sincere friends made pledges according to their capacities, and a list thereof is attached herewith. Many friends had left before this plan was adopted and they could not participate in this noble scheme. It is hoped that all truthful devotees and selfless friends will participate in this scheme to earn the blessings of both worlds and will intimate their pledges for this scheme. However, it has been directed by His Holiness that no one should feel constrained to contribute; rather, they should offer as they please according to what they can afford.

**Announced by Mirza<sup>1☆</sup> Khuda Bakhsh,**  
Teacher in the service of Nawwāb Muhammad Ali Khan,  
Chief of Malerkotla District, Ludhiana—Secretary

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1. ☆ Note: Be it clear to all friends that all correspondence in this regard should be with my humble self. [Author]

### List of contributors written on 29 December 1892 during the Jalsa in Qadian

| <i>Nº</i> | <i>Name</i>                                              | <i>Monthly</i>                | <i>Annual</i> | <i>Received</i> |
|-----------|----------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|---------------|-----------------|
| (1)       | Ḥakīm Muḥammad Aḥsan                                     | 1 Rs                          | 12 Rs         |                 |
| (2)       | Khalīfah Noor-ud-Deen                                    | 4 Rupees<br>2 Annas 8<br>Pies | 50 Rs         |                 |
| (3)       | Pīr Sirāj-ul-Ḥaqq                                        | 1 Rs                          | 12 Rs         |                 |
| (4)       | Munshī Hāshim 'Alī, Patwārī, Sanaur                      | 4 annas                       | 3 Rs          | 3 Rs            |
| (5)       | Mīr Nāṣir Nawwāb                                         | 2 Rs                          | 24 Rs         | 2 Rs            |
| (6)       | Shaikh Raḥmatullāh of Gujrat                             | 10 Rs                         | 120 Rs        |                 |
| (7)       | Miyān 'Abdur-Raḥmān of Sanaur                            | 1 anna 4<br>paisas            | 1 Rs          | 1 Rs            |
| (8)       | Munshī Ibrāhīm of Sanaur, Teacher                        | 1 anna 4<br>paisas            | 1 Rs          | 1 Rs            |
| (9)       | Sayyed Muḥammad Shāh, Contractor, Jammu                  | 2 Rs                          | 24 Rs         |                 |
| (10)      | Sayyed Ḥāmid Shāh of Sialkot                             | 1 Rs                          | 12 Rs         |                 |
| (11)      | Ḥāfiẓ Muḥammad of Peshawar                               | 2 Rs                          | 24 Rs         | 2 Rs            |
| (12)      | Sayyed 'Abdul-Ḥādī, Overseer, Machhiwara                 | 2 Rs                          | 24 Rs         |                 |
| (13)      | Dr. 'Abdul-Ḥakīm Khān, Medical College<br>Lahore         | 2 Rs                          | 24 Rs         |                 |
| (14)      | Maulawī Nizām-ud-Dīn of Rangpur                          | 1 Rs                          | 12 Rs         |                 |
| (15)      | Miyān Shādī Khān, Employee of Raja Amar<br>Singh Bahādur | 8 annas                       | 6 Rs          |                 |
| (16)      | Mirzā Khudā Bakhsh, Malerkotla                           | 3 Rs                          | 36 Rs         |                 |
| (17)      | Maulawī Ghulām Ḥusain of Peshawar                        | 1 Rs                          | 12 Rs         |                 |
| (18)      | Sayyed Khasīlat 'Alī Shāh, Deputy Inspector<br>Police    | 3 Rs                          | 36 Rs         |                 |
| (19)      | Qāḍī Ḍiyā'-ud-Dīn, Qadi Kot                              | 1 anna 4<br>paisas            | 1 Rs          |                 |



| <i>Nº</i> | <i>Name</i>                                                     | <i>Monthly</i>            | <i>Annual</i> | <i>Received</i> |
|-----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|---------------|-----------------|
| (20)      | Maulawī Qutb-ud-Dīn of Baddomalhi                               | 2 annas 8<br>paisas       | 2 Rs          |                 |
| (21)      | Sayyed ‘Amīr ‘Alī Shāh, Police Sergeant                         | 4 Rs 5<br>annas 4<br>pies | 16 Rs         |                 |
| (22)      | Maulawī Muḥammad Yūsuf of Sanaur                                | 4 annas                   | 3 Rs          |                 |
| (23)      | Shaikh ‘Abdus-Samad of Sanaur                                   | 4 annas                   | 3 Rs          | sR 1            |
| (24)      | Munshī Aḥmad Bakhsh of Sanaur, Patwārī,<br><i>Tehsīl</i> Bangar | 1 anna 4<br>paisas        | 1 Rs          | 1 Rs            |
| (25)      | Ḥāfiẓ ‘Azīm Bakhsh, Region Patiala                              | 1 anna 4<br>paisas        | 1 Rs          | 1 Rs            |
| (26)      | Miyān ‘Abdul-Karīm, Region Patiala                              | 1 anna 4<br>paisas        | 1 Rs          | 1 Rs            |
| (27)      | Sarfaraz Khān, Nambardār Baddomalhi                             | 8 annas                   | 6 Rs          | 1 Rs            |
| (28)      | Miyān Allāh Ditta of Sialkot                                    | 4 annas                   | 3 Rs          |                 |
| (29)      | Shāhzādah ‘Abdul-Majīd of Ludhiana                              | 4 annas                   | 3 Rs          | 1 Rs            |
| (30)      | Ḥāfiẓ Nūr Aḥmad of Ludhiana, Trader                             | 8 annas                   | 6 Rs          | 3 Rs            |
| (31)      | Shaikh ‘Abdul-Ḥaqq of Ludhiana                                  | 1 Rs                      | 12 Rs         | 1 Rs            |
| (32)      | Munshī Nabī Bakhsh, Clerk Exams Office,<br>Lahore               | 8 annas                   | 6 Rs          |                 |
| (33)      | Munshī Tāj-ud-Dīn, Accountant Exams<br>Office, Lahore           | 1 Rs                      | 12 Rs         |                 |
| (34)      | Ḥāfiẓ Faql Aḥmad, Clerk Exams Office,<br>Lahore                 | 4 annas                   | 3 Rs          |                 |
| (35)      | Maulawī Muftī Ghulām Jilānī, Teacher,<br>Kahronoh               | 2 annas 8<br>paisas       | 2 Rs          | 1 Rs            |
| (36)      | Maulawī ‘Abdul-Qādir, Teacher, Jamalpur,<br>Dist. Ludhiana      | 1 anna 4<br>paisas        | 1 Rs          | 1 Rs            |
| (37)      | Maulawī Quḍratullāh of Batala                                   | 1 anna 4<br>paisas        | 1 Rs          | 1 Rs            |
| (38)      | Bābū Ghulām Muḥammad of Sialkot                                 | 8 annas                   | 6 Rs          |                 |

| <i>Nº</i> | <i>Name</i>                                                          | <i>Monthly</i>   | <i>Annual</i> | <i>Received</i> |
|-----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|---------------|-----------------|
| (39)      | Mehar 'Abdul-'Azīz, a.k.a. Mehar Nabī Bakhsh of Batala               | 1 Rs             | 12 Rs         |                 |
| (40)      | Munshī Nizām-ud-Dīn Khoja of Jhelum                                  | 1 anna 4 paisas  | 1 Rs          | 1 Rs            |
| (41)      | Munshī 'Abdul-Majīd, Student Veterinary School, Lahore               | 1 Rs             | 12 Rs         |                 |
| (42)      | Shaikh Charāgh-ud-Dīn, resident of Theh Ghulām Nabī, Dist. Gurdaspur | 2 annas          | 1 Rs 8 annas  | 6 annas         |
| (43)      | Munshī Karam Ilāhī, Police Constable, Ludhiana                       | 4 annas          | 3 Rs          |                 |
| (44)      | Munshī Karam Ilāhī, Teacher Madrasah Nusrat-ul-Islam                 | 1 anna 4 paisas  | 1 Rs          |                 |
| (45)      | Miyān 'Umrā, resident of Jamalpur, Dist. Ludhiana                    | 2 annas 8 pies   | 2 Rs          | 2 Rs            |
| (46)      | Miyān Khairā, Nambardār, Jamalpur, Dist. Ludhiana                    | 1 anna 4 pies    | 1 Rs          | 1 Rs            |
| (47)      | Maulawī Mubarak 'Alī of Sialkot                                      | 4 annas          | 3 Rs          |                 |
| (48)      | Munshī Fayyaz 'Alī of Kapurthala                                     | 4 annas          | 3 Rs          |                 |
| (49)      | Munshī Ḥabīb-ur-Raḥmān                                               | 2 Rs 8 annas     | 30 Rs         |                 |
| (50)      | Munshī Muḥammad Rora [Arora]                                         | 4 annas          | 3 Rs          | 3 Rs            |
| (51)      | Munshī 'Alī Gohar of Jalandhar                                       | 2 annas          | 1 Rs 8 annas  | 1 Rs 8 annas    |
| (52)      | Munshī 'Abdur-Raḥmān of Kapurthala                                   | 4 annas          | 3 Rs          | 3 Rs            |
| (53)      | Maulawī Muḥammad Ḥusain of Kapurthala                                | 2 annas 8 paisas | 2 Rs          | 1 Rs            |
| (54)      | Ḥakīm Fateḥ Muḥammad of Kapurthala                                   | 2 annas          | 1 Rs 8 annas  | 8 annas         |
| (55)      | Miyān Roshan Dīn of Kapurthala                                       | 2 annas          | 1 Rs 8 annas  | 1 Rs            |
| (56)      | Munshī Zafar Aḥmad of Kapurthala                                     | 4 annas          | 3 Rs          |                 |
| (57)      | Munshī Muḥammad Khān of Kapurthala                                   | 4 annas          | 3 Rs          |                 |

| <i>Nº</i> | <i>Name</i>                                                                                | <i>Monthly</i>   | <i>Annual</i> | <i>Received</i> |
|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|---------------|-----------------|
| (58)      | Mirza Safdar 'Alī, in the service of Nawwāb Muḥammad 'Alī Khān of Malerkotla               | 2 annas 8 paisas | 2 Rs          | 2 Rs            |
| (59)      | Mirza Ismā'il Baig, Qadian, Dist. Gurdaspur                                                | 1 anna 4 paisas  | 1 Rs          |                 |
| (60)      | Ḥāfiẓ Muḥammad 'Alī of Kapurthala                                                          | 2 annas          | 1 Rs 8 annas  | 1 Rs            |
| (61)      | Munshī Allāh Bakhsh of Sialkot                                                             | 4 annas          | 3 Rs          | 3 Rs            |
| (62)      | Munshī 'Abdul-'Azīz, Employee in Canal Office, Ambala, resident of Delhi, Qasim Jan Street | 1 Rs             | 12 Rs         | 1 Rs            |
| (63)      | Munshī Ibrāhīm, Patwārī, Sanaur                                                            | 2 annas 8 paisas | 2 Rs          | 1 Rs            |
| (64)      | Munshī Ghulām Qādir, Patwārī, Gehnawan[-Gandwan], <i>Tehsil</i> [Sub District] Sirhind     | 1 Anna 4 Pies    | 1 Rs          | 1 Rs            |
| (65)      | Miyān Jamal Dīn, resident of Sekhwan                                                       | 2 annas          | 1 Rs 8 annas  | 4 annas         |
| (66)      | Mistrī 'Umar Bakhsh, resident of Jalalpur Jattan, now in Jammu                             | 13 annas 4 pies  | 10 Rs         |                 |
| (67)      | Munshī Gulāb Dīn, Teacher Girl's Madrasah, Rohtas, Dist. Jhelum                            | 2 annas          | 1 Rs 8 annas  |                 |
| (68)      | Miyān Faḍl Karim, Perfumer, resident of Sialkot                                            | 1 anna 4 paisas  | 1 Rs          |                 |
| (69)      | Shaikh Imām-ud-Dīn, resident of Nowshehra, Dist. Sialkot                                   | 1 Rs             | 12 Rs         | 5 RS            |
| (70)      | Munshī Ghulām Qādir Fasiḥ of Sialkot                                                       | 2 Rs             | 24 Rs         |                 |
| (71)      | Miyān Allāh Dittā, resident of Rohtas Dist. Jhelum                                         | 1 anna 4 paisas  | 1 Rs          |                 |
| (72)      | Miyān Nūr Aḥmad, resident of Khārā, Dist. Gurdaspur                                        | 1 anna 4 pies    | 1 Rs          |                 |
| (73)      | Miyān Muḥammad Tapgar [Hood Maker], resident of Amritsar, Katra Ahluwalia                  | 4 annas          | 1 Rs          | 1 Rs            |
| (74)      | Miyān Ghulām Ḥusain, resident of Rohtas Dist. Jhelum                                       | 1 anna 4 paisas  | 1 Rs          |                 |

| <i>N<sup>o</sup></i> | <i>Name</i>                                                                                        | <i>Monthly</i>            | <i>Annual</i>     | <i>Received</i> |
|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|-------------------|-----------------|
| (75)                 | Miyān Ata Ilāhī, Zamīndār [Landlord]<br>Ghous Garh, Patiala State                                  | 1 anna 4<br>pies          | 1 Rs              |                 |
| (76)                 | Babu Muḥkam-ud-Dīn, Mukhtar [Lawyer],<br>Amritsar                                                  | 1 Rs                      | 12 Rs             |                 |
| (77)                 | Miyān Māḥiyā, Zamīndār [Landlord] Ghous<br>Garh, Patiala State                                     | 1 anna 4<br>pies          | 1 Rs              |                 |
| (78)                 | Munshī Abdullah, Patwārī, Ghous Garh                                                               | 4 annas                   | 3 Rs              |                 |
| (79)                 | Ḥakīm Muḥammad Ashraf, Preacher, Batala                                                            | 1 Rs                      | 12 Rs             |                 |
| (80)                 | Maulawī Tāj Muḥammad, Region Ludhiana                                                              | 1 anna 4<br>paisas        | 1 Rs              |                 |
| (81)                 | Miyān Amīr-ud-Dīn, resident of Jassowal,<br>Dist. Ludhiana                                         | 1 anna 4<br>Pies          | 1 Rs              |                 |
| (82)                 | Miyān Nūr Muḥammad, Zamīndār Ghous<br>Garh, Patiala State                                          | 1 anna 4<br>paisas        | 1 Rs              |                 |
| (83)                 | Miyān Muḥammadī, Zamīndār Ghous Garh,<br>Patiala State                                             | 8 pies                    | 8 annas           |                 |
| (84)                 | Miyān Shehzādah, Zamīndār Ghous Garh                                                               | 1 anna 4<br>pies          | 1 Rs              |                 |
| (85)                 | Miyān Karam Ilāhī s/o Mada, Ghous Garh                                                             | 1 anna 4<br>paisas        | 1 Rs              |                 |
| (86)                 | Miyān Shāh Muḥammad, resident of Ram<br>Jiwali [Dewali] Musalmanan, Police Station<br>Kathu Nangal | 1 anna 4<br>pies          | 1 Rs              |                 |
| (87)                 | Chaudhary Muḥammad Sultan, Member<br>Committee Sialkot                                             | 8 Rs 5<br>annas 4<br>pies | 3 Rs <sup>1</sup> |                 |
| (88)                 | Sayyed Muḥammad Saʿīd, resident of Dehli<br>Khirkī, Farash Khānah                                  | 4 annas                   | 3 Rs              |                 |
| (89)                 | Miyān Ismāʿīl, resident of Chamaru, Patiala<br>State                                               | 1 annas 4<br>paisas       | 1 Rs              |                 |

1. The annual contribution here should have been recorded as 100 Rs; the discrepancy appears to be a scribal error. [Publisher]

| <i>Nº</i> | <i>Name</i>                                          | <i>Monthly</i> | <i>Annual</i> | <i>Received</i> |
|-----------|------------------------------------------------------|----------------|---------------|-----------------|
| (90)      | Ḥakīm Muḥammad Shāh of Sialkot                       | 8 annas        | 6 Rs          | 1 Rs            |
| (91)      | Ḥāfiẓ ‘Abdur-Raḥmān of Amritsar, presently in Batala | 8 annas        | 6 Rs          |                 |
| (92)      | Ḥakīm Muḥammad Amīn of Batala                        | 8 annas        | 6 Rs          |                 |
| (93)      | Shaikh Nūr Aḥmad—Owner Riyāḍ-e-Hind Press            | 1 Rs           | 12 Rs         |                 |



## FOR THE ATTENTION OF FRIENDS

Although there was no need for another reminder, on account of the burning restlessness that dwells in my heart for serving the ultimate cause of the Faith, I am writing these few lines by way of a reminder.

O Jamā'at of sincere devotees, may God Almighty be with you. At this time, we are confronted with the opposition of all nations. We hope from God Almighty that if we do not give up and remain engaged in serving Islam with all our heart, all our effort, and all our attention, then victory will be ours. Therefore, strive for this task as much as possible. We urgently need to put together three things right now, and all our efforts to publish the verities and insights of the Faith revolve around them. First, we need to have at our disposal at least two printing presses; second, we need a scribe with good handwriting; and third, paper. An estimate of 250 rupees per month has been made to accomplish all these three tasks. All friends should join in this donation urgently and without hesitation in accordance with their resolve and capacity.

This donation should arrive without fail every month on a specified date. For now, it has been proposed to complete the remaining part of *Barāhīn[-e-Aḥmadiyya]*, and to start a **newspaper**. Other papers will be published as new needs arise from time to time. Since this entire enterprise is dependent on donations, please consider how much you can send monthly on a regular basis before making a pledge.

O soldiers of the Faith! Strive, for this is the time for striving. Rouse your hearts for the sympathy of the Faith; for, these are the days for displaying such zeal. Now you cannot please God Almighty through any other deed as much as showing sympathy for the Faith. Therefore, wake up, arise, and be alert, marching forward for serving the Faith with such vigour that even the angels in heaven exclaim: جَزَاهُمُ اللَّهُ [‘May

Allah reward you’]. Do not be concerned that people label you a *kāfir* [disbeliever]. Show your Islam to God Almighty and submit to the point of self-annihilation.

دوتان خود را نثار حضرت جانان کنید در ره آن یار جانی جان و دل قربان کنید  
*Friends! Sacrifice yourselves to the Real Beloved,*  
*And offer your heart and soul in the path of that Dear Beloved.*

آن دل خوش باش را اندر جهان جوید خوشی از پیتی دین محمد کلبه احوان کنید  
*Turn your comfort-loving heart which seeks the pleasures of this world,*  
*To pine for the Faith of Muhammad.*

از تعیش ها برون آید ای مردان حق خویشتن را از پیتی اسلام سرگردان کنید  
*O soldiers of God! Give up the life of luxury.*  
*Make yourselves restless for the sake of Islam.*



فَمَنْ تَابَ مِنْ بَعْدِ ظُلْمِهِ وَأَصْلَحَ فَإِنَّ اللَّهَ يَتُوبُ عَلَيْهِ إِنَّ اللَّهَ عَفُورٌ رَحِيمٌ<sup>1</sup>

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ<sup>2</sup>

Proceedings of *Jalsa Salana*, Qadian, District Gurdaspur, on 27 December 1892 at the home of the *Mujaddid* [Reformer] of the Time, Messiah of the Age, Mirza Ghulam Ahmad, may the Gracious protect him, and the view of my humble self about it that I formed after meeting the aforementioned Mirza Şāhib and viewing the *Jalsa* and the attendees of *Jalsa*.



Mirza [Ghulam Ahmad] Şāhib also invited me to the *Jalsa* in spite of being fully aware that I am his opponent. In fact, I not only opposed him, but also spoke ill of him two or three times. He sent me a few letters, including one by registered mail. Although I had not been inclined to go on account of my own ignorance and opposition, my heart was inspired by the repeated invitations of Mirza Şāhib. If Mirza Şāhib had not written to me with so much kindness, I would certainly not have gone and would have been deprived. But it was his resolute spirit. The present-day *maulawīs* do not treat even their real fathers with such kindness and respect.

I arrived in Qadian before noon on the 27th of December.

1. But whoso repents after his transgression and amends, then will Allah surely turn to him in mercy; verily, Allah is Most Forgiving, Merciful (*Sūrah al-Mā'idah*, 5:40). [Publisher]
2. In the name of Allah, the Gracious, the Merciful. [Publisher]

At that time, Maulawī Hakeem Noor-ud-Deen was speaking in support of Mirza Ṣāhib. His speech was about to end; I regret that I could not hear all of it. I did hear from other people that it was an excellent speech. Then Ḥāmid Shah recited his couplets on the truthfulness and appreciation of Mirza Ṣāhib. However, since I was still not favourably inclined and my heart was overcast with doubts, I did not listen to them with much interest and love. Nevertheless, the couplets were excellent. May Allah the Exalted reward the author.

When I met Mirza Ṣāhib and he greeted me with courtesy, my heart melted. It was as if the appearance of Mirza Ṣāhib eliminated the clouds of darkness from the eyes of my heart and the bitterness and anger began to dry up. I started seeing the truth faintly, and gradually the inner darkness was fully cured. There were many attendees of the *Jalsa* whom I used to see with hatred and enmity, but now I started viewing them with love and affection to the extent that those who were dearer to Mirza Ṣāhib, felt dearer to me.

After *ʿAsr* Mirza Ṣāhib made a brief statement. After listening to it, all my suspicions were dispelled, and my eyes were opened. Next morning a lawyer from Amritsar narrated his wonderful story, which proved to be a miracle of the highest degree of Mirza Ṣāhib. The substance of it is that the said lawyer used to be a Muslim of the Sunnah Jamāʿat. When he grew up and studied the traditional subjects, he started entertaining misgivings due to his lack of familiarity with religious studies and because the scholars of the time and the *pirs* [spiritual mentors] of the age did not abide by the teachings of the Faith in their actions. Not finding any satisfactory response to his queries from anyone, he changed his religion several times. He went from being a Sunni to a Shia, but there he did not see anything except *tabarra* [cursing some Companions<sup>ra</sup> as ‘enemies’] and *taʿzīah sāzī* [processions involving replica mausoleums to

mourn the martyrdom of Imam Ḥusain<sup>ra</sup>, the son of ‘Alī<sup>ra</sup>]. Then he became an Ārya and savoured their teachings for a few days, but attained no satisfaction. Then he became a Brahmū and adopted their ways but there too he did not find any satisfaction. Then he became a Naturalist, but did not find any inner purity or love of God, and attained no enlightenment anywhere.

Finally, he met Mirza Ṣāḥib and addressed him with great insolence, but Mirza Ṣāḥib spoke to him with great kindness and courtesy, and demonstrated such excellent moral behaviour, that he became firmly established upon Islam, started offering the five daily Prayers with regularity, and adopted obedience to Allah and His Messenger<sup>sas</sup>. He is now a zealous follower of Mirza Ṣāḥib.

In the evening Mirza Ṣāḥib delivered an excellent speech at the residence of Nawwāb Ṣāḥib<sup>1</sup> in which he narrated some of his dreams and *ilhām* [revelations]. Some people, in whose presence the *ilhām* were fulfilled, gave their testimony about the truthfulness of those *ilhām*. In the morning after the *Fajr* Prayer a gentleman narrated the dream of Abdullah Ghaznavi, may Allah shower His mercy on him, when Abdullah Ṣāḥib was residing in the village of Kherdi.

Abdullah Ṣāḥib said that he saw Muhammad Ḥusain Batālawī wearing a long shirt, and that long shirt became torn into pieces. Abdullah Ṣāḥib had also said that the shirt refers to knowledge. As for being torn into pieces, everyone with some intelligence can understand that it refers to the tearing apart of his reputation as a scholar, which is taking place these days, and we do not know how far that will continue. Whoever torments

1. The reference is to Nawwāb of Malerkotla who attended the *Jalsa* along with some of his friends.

a *Walī* [Friend (of Allah)], actually fights with Almighty Allah, and shall end up being vanquished.

It is now fully proven to me that those people are very unjust who, from a distance, declare Mirza Šāhib to be a lying *dajjāl* [deceiver] without meeting and talking to him. They concoct wrong meanings of his words or accept the interpretation of someone else without due investigation and without inquiring from Mirza Šāhib himself. The heavenly honey which Mirza Šāhib is dispensing is labelled by them as satanic poison, and because of their hard-heartedness and veil of enmity, they label from afar the rose as urine. The common people, in following their leaders, stay away from consuming his food and drink and harm themselves from head to toe as a result.

Maulawī Muhammad Ḥusain, my old-time friend and former leader, is foremost in diverting people from Mirza Šāhib and inciting hatred against him. I had earlier dissuaded him from Mirza Šāhib, and he, in turn, misled me and separated me from the right path. So we are even. However, Maulawī Šāhib is still adamant. Now, when Mirza Šāhib invited me to the *Jalsa*, some informant also told Maulawī [Muhammad Ḥusain] Šāhib about it. He wrote me a letter through his lawyer. Pretending to be a sympathetic advisor, he made such adversarial comments and used such inappropriate words about Mirza Šāhib, that I cannot bear to repeat them. Maulawī Šāhib did not consider that in addition to being a respected elder, Mirza Šāhib is a close relative of mine. Still he claims to love me. What a pity!

There were more than 300 gentle and pious people gathered in this *Jalsa*. Islamic light was radiating from their faces. There were all kinds of people—rich, poor, *nawwāb*, engineer, sub-inspector police, tehsildar, landowner, merchants, physicians. People of all kinds were present. Of course, there were also some *maulawīs*, but humble *maulawīs*. Adding the word humble and self effacing to the title of *maulawīs* is a miracle

of Mirza Şāhib. After meeting Mirza Şāhib, even the *maulawī* become humble. Otherwise, a humble *maulawī* and a sufi who eschews innovation is as rare these days as the philosopher's stone or a good luck potion.

Maulawī Muhammad Husain should himself reflect about the level of humbleness he possesses. Certainly none. If he possessed humility, why would there be such immense mischief? Why would matters deteriorate to the point that so many of his erstwhile followers would turn against him and hate him? Why would so many Ahl-e-Hadith become weary of him? If Maulawī Şāhib considers me wrong in this assertion, I leave the matter to him. Let him publish a list of the friends who love him as much as the followers of Mirza Şāhib love Mirza Şāhib. My judgement tells me that the time is nigh when the enlightened ones would treat the dust off the feet [of Mirza Şāhib] as treatment for their eyes, and consider it better than any other treatment and deem it holy. Mirza Şāhib has hundreds of sincere friends who are devoted to him with their heart and soul. Not to speak of disagreeing, they do not even utter a symbolic ugh in his presence, as has been said: سر تسلیم خم ہے جو مزاج یاد میں آئے۔ [‘We bow down in submission to whatever our friend thinks’]. Let Maulawī Şāhib name—not many—just four or five such students or friends who love him wholeheartedly (for the sake of Allah), are devoted to him heart and soul, who would sacrifice their properties for him, and are ready to sacrifice their honour for the honour of Maulawī Şāhib. If Maulawī Şāhib retorts that people do not love the truthful and the righteous, but the liars and deceivers are so loved by the people, I would ask him if the Companions and *Ahl-e-Bait* [members of the Prophet's household] of the Holy Prophet, had love for the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, or not? Did they follow the Holy Prophet completely or did they have any differences with him?

Let me mention something closer at hand. Maulawī Abdullah Ghaznavi, who is my *pir* [spiritual guide] and mentor, as also of Muhammad Ḥusain Ṣāhib, enjoyed the utmost love and fidelity from his followers. Once he said to one of his special followers: 'Go to Najd in Arabia and copy the pamphlets about *Tauḥīd* [Oneness of Allah], written by Muhammad bin Abdul-Wahhāb.' The disciple left immediately, not waiting even a moment even though he did not have the travel expenses or the mount for the journey. If Maulawī Muhammad Ḥusain were to give a single paisa [penny] to one of his followers and ask him to go to the market to get him some yogurt, he may perhaps refuse to do so, and even if he complies, he may be angry and complain to people behind his back. *بین تفاوت ره از کجا است تا کجا*. [Look what a difference there is between the two scenarios!]

I have mentioned this by way of example. There have been thousands of *Auliā'* (who incurred fatwas of disbelief in their own times) whose followers are obedient and devoted to them. This is the consequence of the heartfelt love of God among the righteous. Since Mirza Ṣāhib has true love for his Lord, acceptance for him is being inspired by the heavens, and despite the opposition of the *maulawīs*, the virtuous are advancing in their affection for him (even though Abu Saeed Ṣāhib [Muhammad Ḥusain Batālawī] may be angry).

In contrast the Maulawī [Batālawī] Ṣāhib, who *مَا شَاءَ اللَّهُ* [*māshā'Allāh*—as Allah has willed] pretends to be the Sun of Punjab, should reflect upon his own situation. How many true well-wishers does he have and what is the inner condition of his true friends? It is said that there was a time earlier when Maulawī Ṣāhib was a good man, but now the love for fame and pride in his learning has thrown him down from the seat of honour to the dust of degradation. *إِنَّا لِلَّهِ وَإِنَّا إِلَيْهِ رَاجِعُونَ*. [Surely, to Allah we belong and to Him shall we return].

Now let Maulawī Ṣāhib personally reflect what caused this

calamity. Why is there so much hatred against the *maulawīs* in general, and against Maulawī Muhammad Ḥusain, the head of Punjab's ulema (as he himself claims), that he had to flee from Lahore, and, on account of his stubbornness and shame, he cannot even enter the mosque of the *Muwahhidīn* [Unitarians] if he happens to be in Lahore? But as for Mirza Ṣāḥib (who, according to Maulawī Ṣāḥib, is a *kāfir* [disbeliever]; nay, rather, the greatest *kāfir* and *dajjāl*) people are packing their bags and gathering around him from places like Lahore, Amritsar, Peshawar, Kashmir, Jammu, Sialkot, Kapurthala, Ludhiana, Bombay, countries north and west, Owadh, Makkah the Honoured, and other cities while he is sitting in his hometown. Moreover, these visitors are not innovators, idolaters, ignorant, or destitute. Rather, they are believers in the Oneness of God, giving due honour to the Hadith, *maulawīs*, jurists, descendants of *pīrs*, gentlemen, the rich, *nawwāb*, and lawyers.

This is now a moment to simply reflect. In spite of Maulawī Muhammad Ḥusain's belittling, and in spite of him getting seals placed by many *maulawīs* on his fatwas of *kufr* [disbelief], Allah, glorified be His eminence, has exalted Mirza Ṣāḥib so much, and how much have God's people been attracted to him that they are leaving the comfort of their homes, spending their money to come to Qadian and sleep on the floors! In fact, many of them must have spent a sleepless night or two in the train. Many of them came on foot. I have not heard any complaint from anybody. They gather around Mirza Ṣāḥib as moths swarm around a lamp. When Mirza Ṣāḥib says something, they listen with undivided attention. About forty to fifty people accepted his claim during this *Jalsa*. Mirza Ṣāḥib also mentioned the fulfilment of the prophecy concerning the death of Ahmad Baig, which *Nūr Afshān* had criticized so much. Now *Nūr Afshān* should realize that this is how prophecies are fulfilled.

This is something that is not available to anybody except the

Muslims. Muslims, especially those who oppose [Mirza Ṣāḥib] should reflect that the prophecies of the one who is labelled as a staunch disbeliever, *dajjāl*, and deceiver are being fulfilled by Allah even though he is 'heaping lies' upon Allah the Exalted, while those who are 'following' the Holy Prophet<sup>ṣas</sup> are being totally deprived by Allah of any influence on anybody. Indeed, they are so humiliated that they have to flee from Lahore and take refuge in Batala. Pity—a *hundred* pities!—be upon the lack of insight of these *maulawīs* of this age who are buried under the ignominy of الْعِلْمُ حِجَابُ الْأَكْبَرِ [‘Knowledge is the greatest veil (obstacle)’]. And despite all this they give the labels of *dajjāl* and disbeliever to such an honourable servant of God, who loves Allah the Exalted so much that he is totally devoted to serving the Faith and is putting up a fight against the Āryas, Brahmūs, Christians, and Naturalists. None of the opponents can confront him, nor is any *maulawī* able to dissuade people from him, despite making him out to be a disbeliever, cursed, and a *dajjāl*, and alleging that—God forbid—he is defaming the rod of Moses and his bright hand.

Those who claim to be the Vicegerents of the Noble Prophet<sup>ṣas</sup> are utterly deprived of blessings and enlightenment. They do not even possess the ability to control their few followers and earn their devotion by adopting the character of the Holy Prophet<sup>ṣas</sup>. Not to speak of spreading the Faith in any country or vanquishing the opponents, they cannot reform a single city or even a small section of a city. On the contrary, Mirza Ṣāḥib has issued invitations to Islam for opponents of Islam in both East and West, and has vanquished them so thoroughly that no one can confront him anymore. He was instrumental in causing the repentance of many Naturalists who could not be influenced by the *maulawīs* in the least, thereby mitigating the influence of Naturalism in the Punjab. Now those very Naturalists, who did not even look like Muslims, have adopted the character of true



believers after meeting Mirza Šāhib. Government Officers and Inspectors of Police have stopped taking bribes. Those accustomed to taking intoxicants have given up their intoxication—many people have stopped smoking the hookah. The erstwhile Shias among the followers of Mirza Šāhib have stopped their *tabarra* and started loving the Companions<sup>ra</sup>, and stopped the practices of *ta'zīah* and chants of lamentation. Some descendants of *pīrs* who considered Maulawī Muhammad Husain and even Muhammad Isma'il Shahid to be disbelievers, have started respecting Maulana Isma'il Shahid as their honoured mentor.

If such is the influence of the alleged *dajjāls* and liars while the claimants of being the 'Vicegerents' of the Noble Messenger are deprived of them, then I am delighted to be amongst the *dajjāl*. A tree is known by its fruits. Even Allah the Exalted has been recognized by the people through His attributes; otherwise, no one can see His Being. If you [simply] call a perfectly healthy person sick, he doesn't actually become sick. Similarly, the one who is a truly righteous believer in the sight of Allah the Exalted, and whose heart is permeated with the love of Allah and His Apostle<sup>sas</sup> suffers no harm if anyone ascribes to him the titles of a hypocrite, disbeliever, or *dajjāl*, etc. The colour white cannot be black if someone [simply] starts to call it so, and the sun cannot be worthy of blame [simply] because the bats loathe it.

The tyrannical behaviour of Yazid can inflict pain on Husain, but cannot annihilate him. He will make progress steadily by continuing to suffer pain, and will continue to do so. In other words, the obstacles placed by the *maulawīs* cannot wipe out the group of Mirza Šāhib, just as the river cannot be stopped by a dam built upon it. It may be interrupted for a brief period, but the dam will break, and the river will start flowing forcefully and carry the surrounding habitations of the opponents with it. Storms and clouds cannot hide the

sun, but themselves disappear after a short while. Similarly, this mischievous commotion will come to an end in a few days and the sun of truthfulness of Mirza Šāhib will shine brightly. Then the lucky ones will repent and agree with Mirza Šāhib, regret their earlier mistakes, and board the ark of Mirza Šāhib, which is like the ark of Noah. Nonetheless, the unlucky will try to save themselves by mounting the tricks of their *maulawīs*, but they will be wiped out by a single deluge into the sea of misguidance.

O Allah keep us in Your protection and grant us perfect understanding. You are the Protector of *Ummat-e-Muḥammadiyyah* [the followers of the Muhammad<sup>śas</sup>]. Pray, remove all veils and reveal the truth. Turn the Muslims to the straight path instead of mutual differences. *Āmīn*, O *Rabbul-‘ālamīn* [Lord of all the worlds].

الْعِلْمُ حِجَابُ الْأَنْبِيَاءِ [‘Knowledge is the greatest veil’] is a well-known saying. Its validity is being demonstrated these days very well. I did not believe this saying before, but now I am fully convinced of it. Nobody is opposing Mirza Šāhib as much as the *maulawīs*; rather, the *maulawīs* are verily the ones who have misled the others. Otherwise, thousands of people would have taken *Bai‘at* [the Pledge of Allegiance] by now and a very large crowd would have followed him. The existence of opposition is not a surprise.

Had there not been an era with such widespread corruption that had never been seen in centuries heretofore, there would not have been a need for such a *Muṣleḥ* [Reformer]. Verily, ‘Īsā has descended to kill the *Dajjāl*. Had there been no *Dajjāl*, the coming of ‘Īsā would not have been possible. Had the world not been so misguided, there would not have been a need for the Mahdi [the Guided One]. Allah the Exalted does everything at its proper time.

O Allah! Grant us the love of Your Messenger<sup>śas</sup> and Your *Auliya’* [Friends (of Allah)] and safeguard us from doubts and

uncertainty. Grant us the love of the righteous and safeguard us from the liars. Remove all self-adoration, greed, and lust. *Āmin*, O *Rabbul-‘ālamīn* [Lord of all the worlds].

Written by: Nāsir Nawwāb

Dated: 2 January, 1893

**Couplets Written by  
Maulawī Muḥammad ‘Abdullāh Khān  
Arabic Teacher, Mahinder College, Patiala**

دل میں جس شخص کے کچھ نور صفا ہوتا ہے      حق کی وہ بات پہ سو جاں سے فدا ہوتا ہے  
*Anyone in whose heart dwells some light of purity  
Sacrifices a hundred lives for the Word of God.*

حق کی جانب جو وہ ہر وقت جھکا ہوتا ہے      لوم لائم سے نہ خوف اس کو ذرا ہوتا ہے  
*Since he is ever inclined towards God,  
He is absolutely fearless of the critique of the critic.*

دیکھنے والے یہ کہتے ہیں کہ کیا ہوتا ہے      ان کو کہہ دو کہ یونہی فضل خدا ہوتا ہے  
*The observers marvel, asking what is happening?  
Tell them that this how the grace of God comes about.*



SUPPLEMENT OF THE NEWSPAPER  
RIYĀD HIND AMRITSAR

*Published on 1 March 1886*

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ<sup>1</sup>  
نَحْمَدُهُ وَنُصَلِّي عَلَى رَسُولِهِ الْكَرِيمِ<sup>2</sup>

جان و دلم فدائے جمال محمدؐ است      خاکم نثار کوچه آل محمدؐ است  
*I am ready to offer my heart and soul  
For the beauty of Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>;  
My body is merely the dust, sacrificed in the lane  
Trodden by the progeny of Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>.*

دیدم بعین قلب و شنیدم بگوش هوش      در هر مکان ندائے جلال محمدؐ است  
*I have seen with my heart's eye  
And heard with perceptive ears—  
The trumpet of the grandeur of Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>  
Echoes everywhere.*

لَئِنْ چشمه روان که بیاقت خدا دهم      یک قطره ز بحر کمال محمدؐ است  
*This ever-flowing river of insights which I distribute  
Freely among God's creation  
Is but a drop from the ocean  
Of the excellences of Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>.*

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1. In the name of Allah, the Gracious, the Merciful. [Publisher]

2. We praise Him and invoke blessings on His Noble Messenger. [Publisher]

لَا اَتَشْمُ زَآتِشْ مِهْرِ مُحَمَّدِکِتْ      وَ اَيْنَ آبِ مِنْ زِ آبِ زَلَالِ مُحَمَّدِ اَسْتْ

*The fire of devotion that burns within me*

*Is from the fire of the love of Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>;*

*The water that I possess*

*Is from the sweet and pure water of Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>.*

## About the Treatise Sirāj-e-Munīr [The Bright Sun]—Consisting of the Signs of the All-Powerful Lord

My humble self (author of *Barāhīn-e-Aḥmadiyya*) has attempted to write the above-mentioned treatise with the objective of presenting before the eyes of the deniers of the Divine origin of Islam and those who reject the Prophethood of *Khairul-Anām* [the Best of Creation], millions of greetings of peace be upon him and his progeny, such a shining lamp whose light is resplendent on all sides like a brilliant pearl and includes magnificent prophecies that have not yet taken place. Accordingly, the Noble Lord of Honour and Glory, who is aware of the hidden secrets, enabled me to discharge this great responsibility by informing me of some hidden verities and news of the unseen. In truth, it is His grace and it is indeed His doing that He relieved me from the onslaughts of the opponents on all sides. As has been said: قصه کوتاه کرد ورنه درد سر بسیار بود [He made short work of the matter; otherwise, it would be a great headache].

This treatise that is now nearly completed, and—God willing—only a few weeks' work remains to be done.<sup>1☆</sup>

This treatise includes three kinds of prophecies. First, prophecies that relate to my own humble self, comprising of comfort or pain, life or death, ordained for me, or some graces and bounties promised to my humble self. Those prophecies shall be included in the treatise. Secondly, the prophecies that relate to some friends or in general relate to a particular person or to mankind at large. Some work on these remains to be completed and—God willing—that, too, would be taken care of. Thirdly, prophecies that relate to the leaders, priests, or members of other religions. In this category, I have taken up, by way of example, only a few of the Āryas and a few Hindus of Qadian about whom different types of prophecies have been made because great vehemence and strong denial is indeed found among them these days.

At this juncture, I am also inclined to wish that our beneficent English Government—under whose protective care we are spending our time in an absolutely care-free environment in freedom and availability of solitude, peace, and prosperity—may remain under His protection and support and may He grant victory to our Government by plunging the dismal Russia in its self-inflicted wanderings. Therefore, God willing, such glad tidings also (if they are granted) will be included as appropriate. However, prophecies are not in one's own control so that they should always contain only good news. Therefore, with all humility, I request all friends and foes that if they find anything in any prophecy concerning themselves that bears heavy on them (like news of death or some other calamity), they may consider me excusable. In particular, those who, on account of opposition, or difference of

1. ☆ Due to some reasons, this treatise has not yet been published as of 25 February 1893,\* but some of its prophecies have been published in different ways, and—God willing—shall continue to be published. (Author)

\* It was published in May 1897 and is now included in volume 12 of *Rūḥānī Khazā'in*.  
[Publisher]

religion, or being unaware of the verities, find it difficult to think well, for example Munshi Inderman of Moradabad or Pundit Lekh Rām of Peshawar, about whose destiny something will be mentioned in this booklet, with specific time and date.

I submit to all these gentlemen with a sincere heart that I truly have no ill-will against anyone. Indeed, our Noble God knows very well that I entertain good wishes for everyone and am ever-ready to do good in return for evil. My heart is filled and enlightened with the love for mankind and I pray for the comfort and security of everyone. But if any news about a friend or foe, and indeed, about myself, is painful, I am totally helpless and excusable about [publishing] it. However, if a news that hurts someone, proves false, I would deserve severe condemnation and even punishment.

I declare under oath, making the Knower of the Secrets as my Witness, that my bosom is filled entirely with good intentions, and I have no enmity against any human being. Even if someone is exerting himself with ill-will to make accusations and hurl abuse, and is inflicting pain upon me without fear of God, I still pray for him that: O my Powerful and Mighty God! Grant this person understanding. And I deem such a one excusable in his impure thoughts and unworthy talk because I realize that until now his nature, disposition, and insight is incapable of fathoming lofty verities. [As has been said]

زاهد ظاہر پرست از حال ما آگاہ نیست      در حق ما هر چه گوید جانی هیچ اکراہ نیست

*A hermit, devoted to superficialities is unaware of our condition.*

*Therefore, whatever he may say about us, is no reason to be offended.*

And despite the general sympathetic feeling that God the Venerable and Pre-Eminent has naturally placed in my disposition, if anything disagreeable, or a fearful prophecy is conveyed to me by revelation concerning someone, it is a situation in which I am helpless. I would describe such things in my treatise with a painful heart. To elaborate, Allah has conveyed to me some fearful news about myself, about my



collateral relatives, some friends, some brethren of philosophic disposition who are the stars of India, and a rich person of Punjabi origin, which portend some trial, death of a relative, or death of the person concerned. All of these will, God willing, be written after complete satisfaction.

I pray for everyone of them because I realize that if there is a suspended decree, it can be averted through prayers. That is the reason that, in times of tribulations, people turn to those who are the accepted ones of God for prayer and refrain from immodesty and waywardness. Nevertheless, if anyone is offended by such a prophecy, he has the right before 1 March 1886, or within two weeks from the date that this announcement is published in any newspaper, to let me know through a signed statement so that the prophecy, the publication of which they are fearful, may be excluded from the treatise, and no one should be informed of it to avoid hurting the feelings of someone, nor should anyone be informed of its actual fulfillment.

Of these three types of prophecies that will—God willing—be included in the treatise with their full details, the first prophecy is about my humble self. Today, 20 February 1886, corresponding to the 15th of Jamādi-ul-Awwal, this prophecy is written as an example here—under in some brevity by way of summary of the revealed wordings and will—God willing—be set out in detail in the treatise.

**First Prophecy** through revelation from Allah the Exalted, and proclamation of the Lord of Honour and Glory:

God, the Merciful and Noble, the Venerable and Pre-Eminent, who has power to do all that He wills (glory be to Him and exalted be His name) addressed me in a revelation and said:

میں تجھے ایک رحمت کا نشان دیتا ہوں اسی کے موافق جو تو نے مجھ سے مانگا۔ سو میں نے تیری تضرعات کو سنا اور تیری دعاؤں کو اپنی رحمت سے پہلیہ قبولیت جگہ دی اور تیرے سفر کو (جو ہوشیار پور اور لدھیانہ کا سفر ہے) تیرے لئے مبارک کر دیا سو قدرت اور رحمت اور قربت کا نشان تجھے دیا جاتا ہے۔ فضل اور احسان کا نشان تجھے عطا ہوتا ہے اور فتح اور ظفر کی کلید تجھے ملتی ہے۔ اے مظفر تجھ پر سلام۔ خدا نے یہ کہا۔ تا وہ جو زندگی کے خواہاں

ہیں موت کے پنجے سے نجات پائیں اور وہ جو قبروں میں دبے پڑے ہیں باہر آویں اور تا دین اسلام کا شرف اور کلام اللہ کا مرتبہ لوگوں پر ظاہر ہو اور تا حق اپنی تمام برکتوں کے ساتھ آجائے اور باطل اپنی تمام نحوستوں کے ساتھ بھاگ جائے اور تا لوگ سمجھیں کہ میں قادر ہوں جو چاہتا ہوں کرتا ہوں اور تا وہ یقین لائیں کہ میں تیرے ساتھ ہوں اور تا انہیں جو خدا کے وجود پر ایمان نہیں لاتے اور خدا اور خدا کے دین اور اس کی کتاب اور اس کے پاک رسول محمد مصطفیٰ کو انکار اور تمذیب کی نگاہ سے دیکھتے ہیں ایک کھلی نشانی ملے اور مجرموں کی راہ ظاہر ہو جائے۔ سو تجھے بشارت ہو کہ ایک وجیہ اور پاک لڑکا تجھے دیا جائے گا۔ ایک زکی غلام (لڑکا) تجھے ملے گا۔ وہ لڑکا تیرے ہی ختم سے تیری ہی ذریت و نسل ہو گا۔ خوبصورت پاک لڑکا تمہارا مہمان آتا ہے اس کا نام عنموایل اور بشیر بھی ہے اس کو مقدس روح دی گئی ہے اور وہ جس سے پاک ہے وہ نور اللہ ہے مبارک ہو جو آسمان سے آتا ہے اس کے ساتھ فضل ہے جو اس کے آنے کے ساتھ آئے گا وہ صاحب شکوہ اور عظمت اور دولت ہو گا۔ وہ دنیا میں آئے گا اور اپنے مسیحی نفس اور روح الحق کی برکت سے بہتوں کو پیاریوں سے صاف کرے گا۔ وہ کلمۃ اللہ ہے کیونکہ خدا کی رحمت و غیوری نے اسے اپنے کلمہ تمجید سے بھیجا ہے۔ وہ سخت ذہین و فہیم ہو گا اور دل کا حلیم اور علوم ظاہری و باطنی سے پُر کیا جائے گا اور وہ تین کو چار کرنے والا ہو گا (اس کے معنی سمجھ میں نہیں آئے) دو شنبہ ہی مبارک دو شنبہ۔ فرزند دلبند گرامی ارجمند مَظْهَرُ الْأَوَّلِ وَالْآخِرِ۔ مَظْهَرُ الْحَقِّ وَالْعَلَاءِ كَأَنَّ اللَّهَ نَزَلَ مِنَ السَّمَاءِ۔ جس کا نزول بہت مبارک اور جلال الہی کے ظہور کا موجب ہو گا۔ نور آتا ہے نور جس کو خدا نے اپنی رضامندی کے عطر سے مسح کیا ہم اس میں اپنی روح ڈالیں گے اور خدا کا سایہ اس کے سر پر ہو گا۔ وہ جلد جلد بڑھے گا اور اسیروں کی رہنمائی کا موجب ہو گا اور زمین کے کناروں تک شہرت پائے گا اور قومیں اس سے برکت پائیں گی تب اپنے نفسی نقطہ آسمان کی طرف اٹھایا جائے گا۔ وَكَانَ أَمْرًا مَقْضِيًّا۔

[I confer upon you a Sign of My mercy according to what you begged of me. So, I have heard your entreaties and have honoured your prayers with My acceptance through My mercy and made your journey (i.e. the journey to Hoshiarpur and Ludhiana) a source of blessings for you. Therefore, a Sign of power, mercy, nearness is bestowed on you, a Sign of grace and beneficence is awarded to you and you are granted the key of success and victory. Peace be upon you, O victorious one! Thus did God speak so that those who desire life may be rescued from the grip of death and those who are buried in the graves may come out of them and so that the superiority of Islam and the dignity of God's Word may be manifested unto the people

and so that truth may arrive with all its blessings and falsehood may flee with all its ills, and so that people may understand that I am the Lord of Power, I do whatever I will, and so that they may believe that I am with you, and so that those who do not believe in God and deny and reject His religion and His Book and His Holy Messenger Muhammad, Muṣṭafā<sup>sas</sup> [the Chosen One], may be confronted with a clear Sign and the way of the guilty ones may become manifest. Rejoice, therefore, that a handsome and pure boy will be bestowed on you; you will receive an unblemished youth who will be of your seed and will be of your progeny. A handsome and pure boy is coming as your guest. His name is **Emmanuel** and also Bashir. He has been invested with a spirit of holiness, and he is free from all impurity. He is the light of Allah. Blessed is he who comes from heaven. He will be accompanied by grace which shall arrive with him. He will be characterized with grandeur, greatness, and wealth. He will come into the world and will heal many of their disorders through his Messianic qualities and through the blessings of the Spirit of Holiness. He is the Word of Allah; for, Allah's mercy and honour have equipped him with the Word of Majesty. He will be extremely intelligent and perceptive and will be meek of heart and will be filled with secular and spiritual knowledge. He will convert three into four (of this the meaning is not clear). It is Monday a blessed Monday. [Persian] [*Son, delight of the heart, high ranking, noble.*] [Arabic] [*A manifestation of the First and the Last, a manifestation of the True and the High; as if Allah has descended from heaven.*] His advent will be greatly blessed and will be a source of the manifestation of Divine Majesty. Behold a light comes, anointed by God with the perfume of His pleasure. We shall pour Our Spirit into him and he will be sheltered under the shadow of God. He will grow rapidly in stature and will be the means of procuring the release of those held in bondage. His fame will spread to the ends of

the earth and nations will be blessed through him. He will then be raised to his spiritual station in heaven. [Arabic] [*This is a matter decreed.*]

God Almighty then gave me the good news saying:

تیرا گھر برکت سے بھرے گا اور میں اپنی نعمتیں تجھ پر پوری کروں گا اور خواتین مبارکہ سے جن میں سے تو بعض کو اس کے بعد پائے گا تیری نسل بہت ہوگی اور میں تیری ذریت کو بہت بڑھاؤں گا اور برکت دوں گا مگر بعض ان میں سے کم عمری میں فوت بھی ہوں گے اور تیری نسل کثرت سے ملکوں میں پھیل جائے گی اور ہر ایک شاخ تیرے جدی بھائیوں کی کافی جائے گی اور وہ جلد لاولد رہ کر ختم ہو جائے گی۔ اگر وہ توبہ نہ کریں گے تو خدا ان پر بلا پر بلا نازل کرے گا یہاں تک کہ وہ نابود ہو جائیں گے ان کے گھر بیواؤں سے بھر جائیں گے اور ان کی دیواروں پر غضب نازل ہوگا۔ لیکن اگر وہ رجوع کریں گے تو خدا رحم کے ساتھ رجوع کرے گا۔ خدا تیری برکتیں ارد گرد پھیلائے گا اور ایک اجڑا ہوا گھر تجھ سے آباد کرے گا۔ اور ایک ڈراؤنا گھر برکتوں سے بھر دے گا۔<sup>\*</sup> تیری ذریت منقطع نہیں ہوگی اور آخری دنوں تک سرسبز رہے گی۔ خدا تیرے نام کو اس روز تک جو دنیا منقطع ہو جائے۔ عزت کے ساتھ قائم رکھے گا اور تیری دعوت کو دنیا کے کناروں تک پہنچا دے گا۔ میں تجھے اٹھاؤں گا اور اپنی طرف بلا لوں گا۔ پر تیرا نام صفحہ زمین سے کبھی نہیں اٹھے گا اور ایسا ہوگا کہ سب وہ لوگ جو تیری ذلت کی فکر میں لگے ہوئے ہیں اور تیرے ناکام رہنے کے درپے اور تیرے نابود کرنے کے خیال میں ہیں وہ خود ناکام رہیں گے اور ناکامی اور نامرادی میں مریں گے لیکن خدا تجھے بالکل کامیاب کرے گا اور تیری ساری مرادیں تجھے دے گا۔ میں تیرے خالص اور دلی محبوبوں کا گروہ بھی بڑھاؤں گا اور ان کے نفوس و اموال میں برکت ڈوں گا اور اُن میں کثرت بخشوں گا اور وہ مسلمانوں کے اس دوسرے گروہ پر تابروز قیامت غالب رہیں گے جو حاسدوں اور معاندوں کا گروہ ہے۔ خدا انہیں نہیں بھولے گا اور فراموش نہیں کرے گا اور وہ علیٰ حسب الاخلاص اپنا اپنا اجر پائیں گے۔ تُو مجھ سے ایسا ہے جیسے انبیاء بنی اسرائیل (یعنی ظلی طور پر اُن سے مشابہت رکھتا ہے) تُو مجھ سے ایسا ہے جیسی میری توحید۔ تُو مجھ سے اور میں تجھ سے ہوں۔ اور وہ وقت آتا ہے بلکہ قریب ہے کہ خدا بادشاہوں اور امیروں کے دلوں میں تیری محبت ڈالے گا یہاں تک کہ وہ تیرے کپڑوں سے برکت ڈھونڈیں گے۔ اے منکرو اور حق کے مخالفو! اگر تم میرے بندہ کی نسبت شک میں ہو۔ اگر تمہیں اُس فضل و احسان سے کچھ انکار ہے جو ہم نے اپنے بندہ پر کیا تو اس نشانِ رحمت کی مانند تم بھی اپنی نسبت کوئی سچا نشان پیش کرو اگر تم سچے ہو اور اگر تم پیش نہ کر سکو اور یاد رکھو کہ ہرگز پیش نہ کر سکو گے تو اُس آگ سے ڈرو کہ جو نافرمانوں اور جھوٹوں اور حد سے بڑھنے والوں کے لئے تیار ہے۔ فقط۔

[Your house will be filled with blessings and I shall perfect My favours upon you and you will have a large progeny from blessed women, some of whom you will find hereafter, and I will cause a great increase in your progeny and will bless it; but some of them will die in early age and your progeny will spread greatly in different lands. Every branch of your collaterals will be cut off and will come to an end soon through childlessness. If they do not repent, God will send chastisement after chastisement upon them, until they are completely wiped out. Their houses will be filled with widows and God's wrath will descend upon their walls. But if they turn to God, He will turn to them with mercy. God will spread your blessings about and will revive a ruined house through you and will fill a fearful house with blessings.<sup>1☆</sup> Your progeny will not be cut off and will flourish until the end of days. God will maintain your name with honour until the day when the world comes to an end and will convey your message to the ends of the earth. I shall exalt you and shall call you to Myself but your name will never be erased from the face of the earth. It will so happen that all those who seek to humiliate you and are determined to cause you to fail and wish to ruin you will themselves be frustrated and will die in failure and frustration. But God will grant you complete success and will grant you all that you desire. I will cause an increase of your true and sincere friends and shall bless their lives and their properties and they will grow in number and they will

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1. ☆ Note: The reference is to a prophecy published in the Announcement of 10 July 1888, the gist of which is that God Almighty has revealed this prophecy as a Sign for my opposing and denying relatives that one of them, named Ahmad Baig will die within a period of three years, or even less, if he does not give his daughter to me in marriage. And he who marries her will die within two and a half years from the date of the *nikāḥ* [Islamic marriage] and that woman will finally be among my wives. So, the words 'ruined house' refer to that ruined house. (Author)

prevail over the other Muslims—who are jealous of you and are hostile to you—till the Day of Judgment. God will not forget your supporters and will not lose sight of them and they will have their reward according to the degree of their devotion. You are to me as the Prophets of Banī Isrā'il [Israelites] (that is: You resemble them as a reflection<sup>1☆</sup>). You are to Me as My *Tauḥīd* [Oneness]. You are of Me and I am of you. The time is approaching—indeed, it is near—when God will put your love in the hearts of kings and nobles until they will seek blessings from your garments.

O you who deny and who oppose the truth! If you are in doubt concerning My servant, if you deny the grace and bounty that I have bestowed upon My servant, then produce some true sign concerning yourselves like this Sign of mercy, if you are truthful. If you are unable to produce it—and be sure you will never be able to produce it—then be mindful of the Fire which has been prepared for the disobedient, the liars, and the transgressors. (The end)]

Written by,  
Humbly,

Ghulam Ahmad, author of *Barāhīn-e-Aḥmadiyya*

From: Hoshiarpur, house of Shaikh Mehr Ali, the Chief

20 February 1886\*

Printed at Riyāḍ-e-Hind Press Qadian

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1. ☆ Footnote: The perfection of a 'follower' of a Prophet is that he may inculcate a complete resemblance with the Prophet whom he follows, indeed with all the Prophets, peace be upon them. This is the truth and ultimate objective of following, which has been enjoined upon us in *Sūrah Fātiḥah*. Indeed, that is the what the human nature demands. For the same reason, Muslims give the names of Prophets to their children—for example 'Īsā, Dāwūd [David], Musā [Moses], Ya'qūb [Jacob], Muḥammad, may peace be upon all of them—as a good omen. The idea is that they may be endowed with the same morals and blessings by way of reflection. Think about it. (Author)

# [MAGNIFICENT LIGHT OF MUHAMMAD]

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ<sup>1</sup>

(Footnote pertaining to page 2 of the Announcement dated  
20 February 1886, published in *Ā'ina-e-Kamālāt-e-Islām*)

عجب نورست در جان محمدؐ      عجب لعلست در کان محمدؐ  
*How wonderful is the light in the person of Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>!*  
*And marvellous indeed is the ruby in the mine of Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>.*

ز ظلمت‌ها دلی آنکه شود صاف      که گردد از محبان محمدؐ  
*The heart is cleansed of all darkness*  
*When it joins the lovers of Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>.*

عجب دارم دل آن ناکسان را      که رو تابند از خوان محمدؐ  
*Alas for the hearts of those unworthy ones,*  
*Who turn their backs upon the hospitality of Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>!*

ندانم هیچ نفسی در دو عالم      که دارد شوکت و شان محمدؐ  
*I know of no one in both the worlds*  
*Who has an exalted station equal to Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>.*

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1. In the name of Allah, the Gracious, the Merciful. [Publisher]

خدا زان سینه بیزارست صدبار      که هست از کینه داران محمدؐ  
*God is most displeased with the person  
 Who bears a grudge against Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>.*

خدا خود سوزد آن کرم دنی را      که باشد از عدوان محمدؐ  
*God Himself burns that worthless worm,  
 Which is among the enemies of Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>.*

اگر خواهی نجات از مستی نفس      بیا در ذیلِ متانِ محمدؐ  
*If you wish to be delivered from the stupor of the lower self,  
 Come and join the ranks of the lovers of Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>.*

اگر خواهی که حق گوید ثنایت      بشو از دل ثناخوانِ محمدؐ  
*If you desire that God should praise you,  
 Become a true admirer of Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>.*

اگر خواهی دلیلی عاشقش باش      محمدؐ هست برهانِ محمدؐ  
*If you desire a proof [of his truthfulness], be his lover;  
 For Muhammad himself is the proof of Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>.*

سری دارم فدای خاک احمد      دلم هر وقت قربانِ محمدؐ  
*My body craves to be sacrificed for the dust of Ahmad's feet;  
 My heart is ever eager to die for Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>.*

به گیسوی رسول الله که هستم      نثار روی تابانِ محمدؐ  
*By the tresses of the Prophet of God,  
 I would die for the illumined countenance of Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>.*



دین ره گر کشندم ور بوزند      نتابم رو ز ایوان محمدؐ  
*Cut me to pieces or burn me to death,*  
*I will not turn away from the court of Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>.*

به کار دین نترسم از جهانی      که دارم رنگ ایمان محمدؐ  
*In matters of faith, I fear no one in the world;*  
*For I have acquired the colour of the faith of Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>.*

بسی سهل ست از دنیا بریدن      بیاد حسن و احسان محمدؐ  
*How easy it is to renounce the world*  
*When one contemplates the beauty and grace of Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>!*

فدا شد در رهش هر ذره‌ی من      که دیدم حسن پنهان محمدؐ  
*Every particle of my being has been sacrificed in his path;*  
*For, I have witnessed the latent beauty of Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>.*

دگر استاد را نامی ندانم      که خواندم در دبستان محمدؐ  
*I know not the name of any other teacher;*  
*I have studied at the school of Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>.*

به دیگر دلبری کاری ندارم      که هستم کشته‌ی آن محمدؐ  
*I have no affiliation with any other beloved;*  
*I have fallen prey to the loving ways of Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>.*

مرا آن گوشه چشمی نباید      نخواهم جز گلستان محمدؐ  
*I crave but just a single glance;*  
*I need nothing but the garden of Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>.*

دل زارم به پهلویم مجوسید که بستیش به دامنِ محمدؐ  
*Search not for my anguished heart in my bosom,*  
*For I have surrendered it to the lap of Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>.*

من آن خوش مرغ از مرغانِ قدسم که دارد جا به بتانِ محمدؐ  
*I am the merriest among the birds of Paradise,*  
*Who have built their nests in the garden of Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>.*

تو جان ما متور کردی از عشق فدایت جانم ای جانِ محمدؐ  
*You have illumined my heart and soul with love;*  
*My life is an offering to you, O Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>.*

دریغا گر دهم صد جان دینِ راه نباشد نیز شایانِ محمدؐ  
*Were I to sacrifice my life for him a hundred times—*  
*Alas! It would still be unworthy of the high station of Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>.*

چه هیبت‌ها بدادند این جوان را که ناید کس به میدانِ محمدؐ  
*So awe-inspiring is the station granted to this champion;*  
*No one can even dare to compete with Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>.*

الا ای دشمن نادان و بی‌راه بترس از تیغِ بزبانِ محمدؐ  
*Beware—O foolish and misguided enemy—*  
*Beware of the sharp sword of Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>!*

ره مولی که گم کردند مردم بگو در آل و اغوانِ محمدؐ  
*The path to God—which mankind has lost—*  
*Search for it in the progeny and helpers of Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>.*

الا ای منکر از شأنِ محمدؐ      هم از نورِ نمایانِ محمدؐ

*Beware—O denier—of the status of Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>*

*And of the manifest light of Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>!*

کرامتِ گرچه بی نام و نشان است      بیا بنگر ز غلمانِ محمدؐ

*Even though miracles  
are nowhere to be seen,*

*Come and witness them  
among the devotees of  
Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>.*



### A Prophecy regarding Lekh Rām of Peshawar

On 20 February 1886, this humble one published an announcement wherein I proposed to Indarman and to Lekh Rām of Peshawar that should they so wish, I could publish some prophecies regarding their future destiny. Indarman avoided my proposal and died soon thereafter. Lekh Rām, on the other hand, accepted the proposal with immense audacity and wrote me a letter stating that I had his permission to go ahead and publish any prophecy regarding him.

Thus, in answer to my supplications, I received the following *ilhām* [revelation] from Allah, the Lord of Glory:

عَجَلْ جَسَدٌ لَهُ خُورٌ. لَهُ نَصَبٌ وَعَذَابٌ

**Meaning:** This is just a lifeless calf from which a mournful bleating emanates [this refers to Lekh Rām]. For him, on account of his blasphemy and foul language, grief

**and severe chastisement have been ordained which will definitely be meted out to him.**

Today, Monday, 20 February 1893, when I prayed to be informed about the time of this impending punishment, it was revealed to me that within six years from today—20 February 1893—this person would suffer dreadful chastisement by way of punishment for his foul and abusive language; that is to say, by way of **punishment for those insolences** which this person has shown against the **Messenger of Allah**, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him.

Therefore, I now publish this prophecy for all Muslims, Christians, Āryas, and people of other faiths. If this person is not visited by some Divine punishment<sup>1☆</sup>—which is miraculous in nature, and is distinct from everyday afflictions, and is far beyond ordinary suffering, and is accompanied by Divine awe—within these six years, then let it be known that I have not been commissioned by God, and these words are not from Him. And if I prove to be false in my prophecy, I shall be ready to face any punishment and shall be quite willing to be hanged. Notwithstanding this willingness on my part, a man cannot face a greater humiliation than to be proven false in his prophecy. What more can I say?

Be it clear that this man is guilty of showing such rank disrespect to the Messenger of Allah, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, that one shudders at the thought of it. His books are filled with a shocking variety of insult, sacrilege, and abuse. Who among the Muslims can listen to anything from these books without his heart being torn to pieces?

Besides being insolent and spiteful, he is grossly ignorant. He does not even have a nodding acquaintance with Arabic, nor the potential for writing refined Urdu. This prophecy is not a matter of chance. On

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1. ☆ Now the Āryas should all gather together and pray that this wrath may be averted from this representative of theirs. [Author]

the contrary, I prayed specifically for this purpose and received the foregoing answer. This prophecy is a Sign for the Muslims as well. Would but they realize the truth and their hearts soften!

I now conclude in the name of the Glorious God in whose name I had begun. وَالْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ وَالصَّلَاةُ وَالسَّلَامُ عَلَى رَسُولِهِ مُحَمَّدٍ الْمُصْطَفَى أَفْضَلِ الرُّسُلِ وَخَيْرِ الْوُزَرَى سَيِّدِنَا وَسَيِّدِ كُلِّ مَا فِي الْأَرْضِ وَالسَّمَاءِ [All praise belongs to Allah, and peace and blessings be upon His Messenger, Muhammad, the Chosen One, the Best of all the Messengers, and indeed the Best of all Creations, our master and the chief of all that is in the heavens and the earth].

The humble one,  
Mirza **Ghulam Ahmad** of Qadian,  
District Gurdaspur  
(20 February 1893 CE)



ANNOUNCEMENT ABOUT THE BOOK—  
THE MIRROR OF  
THE EXCELLENCES OF ISLAM

يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا إِن تَنْصُرُوا اللَّهَ يَنْصُرْكُمْ<sup>1</sup>

ای عزیزان! مدد دین متین آن کاری ست  
که بسد زهد میسر نه شود انسان را  
*O my dear ones! Helping the Mighty Faith is such a magnificent task  
That one cannot achieve its like even by hundred-fold acts of  
abstinence.*

Let it be known that these days I have written a book whose name is mentioned above with the intent that people of the world may learn about the excellences of the Holy Quran, and be educated about the magnificent teachings of Islam.

I feel embarrassed about saying that I have written it because I see that God Almighty has granted me diverse types of wonderful help in writing it from beginning to end, and has filled it with such wonderful points of wisdom and insight as are beyond the ordinary ken of man. I realize that He has manifested a Sign to show how He helps Islam with His special assistance in the times of its sorry state and how He sends His manifestation upon the heart of a humble man and thereby frustrates the plans of hundreds of thousands of people and utterly demolishes their attacks.

It is my heartfelt desire that the children of the Muslims and the progeny of the noble Muslims, who are increasingly being subjected to distraction caused by the ever-new branches of knowledge, should read this book. If I had the resources, I would have made a free distribution of all its volumes for the sake of Allah's blessings.

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1. O ye who believe! if you help the cause of Allah, He will help you (*Sūrah Muḥammad*, 47:8). [Publisher]

My dear ones! This book is an example of the power of the Almighty. Ordinary efforts of man cannot put together such a great treasure of insights on their own. It is about 600 pages in length and has been printed on fine paper with beautiful handwriting. The price is two rupees plus postage. This is only one part. The second part will be published and priced separately.

In addition to the verities and insights of the Holy Quran and the fine points of the Book of the Powerful Lord, there is also a large portion of the prophecies that I had intended at first to publish in *Sirāj-e-Munir*.

I am agreeable that if the readers find the book contrary to the way I have described it, they may return it to me. I will return their money without any delay. But the essential condition is that the book must be returned within two weeks and it should not be soiled or damaged.

Finally, I also wish to record that during the period of writing this book, I was twice honoured with beholding the visage of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, and he expressed great pleasure over the compilation of this book. I also saw one night that an angel was calling people towards this book with a loud voice and was saying:

هَذَا كِتَابٌ مُبَارَكٌ فَقُومُوا لِلْإِجْلَالِ وَالْإِكْرَامِ

Meaning, 'This is a blessed book, so arise in deference to its glory and grandeur.' Now I wish to request that whoever wants to buy it, should inform me without delay of their firm intent so that the book may be sent to them by value payable parcel.

وَالسَّلَامُ عَلَى مَنْ اتَّبَعَ الْهُدَى [And peace be upon those who follow the guidance].

Humbly, **Ghulam Ahmad**

From Qadian, District Gurdaspur, Punjab

(Published in Riyāḍ-e-Hind Qadian)



## SHAIKH MEHR ALI, CHIEF OF HOSHIARPUR

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ<sup>1</sup>  
نَحْمَدُهُ وَنُصَلِّي<sup>2</sup>

تا دلِ مردِ خدا نامد بدرد      هیچ قومی را خدا رسوا نه کرد  
*Until the heart of a man of God is tormented,  
God does not disgrace any nation.*

كَلَّا إِنَّ الْإِنْسَانَ لِرَبِّهِ لَكَنَافٍ ۝ أَن زَاهُ اسْتَغْنَى ۝<sup>3</sup>

Despite being utterly insignificant and a particle of dust, how quickly does man forget his helplessness! If his pain is somewhat relieved and he is able to turn from one side to the other in comfort, he immediately changes his tone of humility.

Almost everyone in the Punjab must be familiar with Shaikh Mehr Ali, Chief of Hoshiarpur. I think that due to some of his hidden errors, which are best known to God Almighty, he was apprehended in an unjustified case. That incident must be known even to the children and women of our country. At this time, I am not at all concerned with raising the annulled event. I only wish to point out that six months before the event,

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1. In the name of Allah, the Gracious, the Merciful. [Publisher]
  2. We praise Him, and invoke blessings [upon His Noble Messenger]. [Publisher]
  3. Nay, man indeed transgresses, because he thinks himself to be independent (*Sûrah al-'Alaq*, 96:7–8). [Publisher]

I was informed in a dream that the seat of Shaikh Ṣāhib is on fire, and my humble self has put out the fire by repeatedly pouring water over it.

God Almighty instantly conveyed its interpretation to me with firm conviction that Shaikh [Mehr 'Alī] Ṣāhib and his honour would be afflicted with a great misfortune and my pouring water on it meant that the misfortune would be finally repelled by my prayer and not through any other means. After this dream, I informed Shaikh Ṣāhib about it by a detailed letter, and exhorted him to repent and seek forgiveness of Allah, but he did not write anything in reply to that letter.

After about six months it happened accordingly. I was in Ambala Cantonment when a person by the name of Muhammad Bakhsh came to me on behalf of Jan Muhammad, son of Shaikh Ṣāhib, and told me that Shaikh Ṣāhib had been arrested in connection with such a case. I enquired from him about the letter that I had written six months earlier warning him of such a misfortune, but Muhammad Bakhsh denied any knowledge about the arrival of that letter. However, Shaikh Ṣāhib himself—after his release—often stated that the letter had been found in one of his boxes. While Shaikh Ṣāhib was in custody, I received several letters on behalf of his son Jan Muhammad, possibly written by Muhammad Bakhsh, who was a connection of theirs, requesting me for prayers. Allah, glorified be His eminence, knows that I prayed for him fervently for several nights. At first, the situation destined for him appeared very involved and fearful but at last God Almighty accepted my supplications and granted me the good news of his deliverance. This good news was conveyed in brief words to his son.

These are the real facts regarding the matter, but it has been heard subsequently that Shaikh Ṣāhib denies receiving the letter about acquittal, making people conclude as if my humble self told a lie. To put an end to this mischief, I asked Shaikh

Şāhib to return my letter in which the news about the acquittal had been conveyed, but he did not return my letter and in his letter of 19 June 1892, he stated that the letter had been lost. However, at the same time he quoted his son as saying that: ‘We do not recall the news about acquittal.’ But the wording of the letter was either these words or something close to it that the grace of God would descend; prayer is being made. ♦<sup>1</sup>

That is where things stood and I still have that letter of Shaikh Şāhib. But I have now learned from the letters and statements of some friends that Shaikh Şāhib is claiming that he was not at all informed of the acquittal. Moreover, he is raising a clamour that I knew that I had not written a letter, so then I asked Shaikh Şāhib to tell a lie and make a false statement that I had given him information about his acquittal. This is tantamount to saying that I wrote him a letter saying that although it is not true that I had informed you of an acquittal, but please do me a favour and say so, to show my miraculous Sign.

I was intensely grieved to learn about this attitude of Shaikh Şāhib. **إِنَّا لِلّٰهِ وَإِنَّا إِلَيْهِ رَاجِعُونَ** [Surely, to Allah we belong and surely to Him do we return]. God Almighty knows that Shaikh Şāhib was certainly informed about the initial and final events about him, and both these prophecies are true and a letter was sent to Shaikh Şāhib about both of them, and the same letter or confirmation of its contents was asked to be returned.

- 
1. ☆ My humble self did not use the words: prayer is being made. Rather, I said that I prayed for him a lot. At the end, reassurance of Divine grace and deliverance was conveyed in a few words which were quite definitive. God Almighty does not depend upon anybody and is not like the flatterers. Most of His glad tidings are conveyed in indications. His saying ‘yes’ or ‘no’ is more reliable than hundreds of tomes written by others, but the ignorant and proud materialists wish that God Almighty would make long speeches like obedient servants so that they may believe and consider the matter to be definitive. (Author)

If Shaikh Ṣāhib has indeed given such a statement, what answer can I give to his fabrication. The readers should ask him to produce my letters and carefully read them together.<sup>1☆</sup> If Shaikh Ṣāhib had any intelligence, he could have understood from my very first letter regarding the prophecy that I was informing him about acquittal because it clearly conveyed that I would cause his release. The reason is that I had told him that it was I indeed who had poured water to extinguish the fire.

Does Shaikh Ṣāhib not remember that when he visited me for a meal in Ludhiana, he recalled this letter and started crying? Perhaps some drops of his tears also fell upon the bread. So why does he not recall the pouring of water on the fire? And if I had not announced the news of his release, how did it get well known to hundreds of people even before the acquittal? And why did some of his relatives, some of whom are still alive, hasten<sup>2☆</sup> to object to the truthfulness of that prophecy? And

1. ☆ It would be appropriate for the readers to avail from Shaikh Ṣāhib and read all my letters written to Shaikh Ṣāhib around those days. None of my letters suggests that Shaikh Ṣāhib should write something contrary to the facts of the matter. I had only reminded him of the contents of the earlier letter, and it was hoped that the reminder would refresh his recollection. For this reason, the request was made to him, namely, that such is the subject of my earlier letter, I am asking you only to confirm the same. But it is a pity that Shaikh Ṣāhib unreasonably withheld the letter and fabricated a lie against me that I asked him to tell a lie. God Almighty knows that I only sought a confirmation of the contents of my earlier letter. If I am not right, Shaikh Ṣāhib should produce my letter under dispute, which he confirms to have received. Moreover, he also confirms that it was written that the grace of God will be bestowed. (Author)
2. ☆ Your relative, probably your nephew Shaikh Miran Bakhsh, resident of Dasoha, had argued in his shop in the presence of Shaikh Sindhi resident of Khanpur while being in a state of hopelessness of acquittal, with my servant Hamid Ali and said: Mirza Ghulam Ahmad had said that Shaikh Ṣāhib would be released, but now he is doomed to hanging. Hamid Ali says that I responded: 'Make your objection after seeing the final outcome.' (Author)

why did he write a summary of my letter implying that I had only written that grace would descend.

How far removed from the fear of God it is that that the charge of falsehood is being made in gatherings to cause my heart such pain. Well, I will make it easy by suggesting a convenient method to decide my truthfulness or falsehood as follows.

## Verdict

Last night, the 25th of February 1893, being greatly pained by the attitude of Shaikh Ṣāhib, I supplicated for a heavenly decision. I was shown in a dream that I had sent some money to a shopkeeper as the price of something good and fragrant. He took the money but sent an evil-smelling substance. When I saw it, I became angry and told my messenger: Go back to the shopkeeper and tell him to send me what I had asked for; otherwise, I would file a complaint against him for cheating and he will be sent to jail for at least six months and probably longer. Thereupon, the shopkeeper perhaps sent back word that he had not done this, or that it was not in his power to do and, together with this, sent word that there is a madman going around who had influenced him and made him forgetful, but he was now ready to send back what I had asked.

I interpreted this to mean that the Shaikh [Mehr 'Alī] would be afflicted with such humiliation and eventually would be remorseful and that for the moment he was acting under someone else's influence.

I then turned my attention again to the matter and I received this revelation:

إِنَّا نَرَى تَقَلُّبَ وَجْهِكَ فِي السَّمَاءِ. نُقَلِّبُ  
فِي السَّمَاءِ مَا قَلَّبْتَ فِي الْأَرْضِ إِنَّا مَعَكَ  
نَرْفَعُكَ دَرَجَاتٍ.

Meaning that, We are watching from heaven that your heart has turned from the well-wishing of Shaikh Mehr 'Alī towards supplicating for his chastisement. We shall turn the matter in heaven as you make it turn upon the earth. We are with you, and shall raise your ranks.

I am, therefore, sending this letter to Shaikh Ṣāhib through registered mail. If within the period of one week, he does not send a letter for publication in order to apologize for the unjustified mischief, the case between me and him would be registered in the heavens. I shall, in that case, withdraw the prayers I had made earlier for his life and restoration of honour and comfort. I have been granted this glad tiding in detail from Allah, glorified be His eminence. Thus, if Shaikh Ṣāhib does not publish a letter about his false charges against me, then the Sign of my truthfulness and veracity is that my prayer against him will make its impact upon him as God Almighty has promised me.

I cannot announce a specific date about it at this time because God Almighty has not yet revealed a date to me. If my prayer against him does not show any result, I would be confirmed to be a liar and impostor just as Shaikh Ṣāhib considers me to be. I declare in the name of Allah, His eminence be glorified, that I had informed Shaikh Ṣāhib both before and after his tribulation. If I am a liar, Shaikh Ṣāhib would clearly escape my prayer against him and that would be a sufficient proof of my being false.

If this matter had been confined to myself, I would have shown patience, but it is a matter of faith and a source of misguidance for the common people. Therefore, I prayed solely for the support of the Faith

and God Almighty accepted my prayer. The worldly people are proud of their material world, and the mendicants become proud by their self-confidence, whereas the greatness of God is cultivated by trusting Him. Thus, it is a sufficient Sign of my truthfulness or falsehood that I claim that Shaikh Şāhib was released in consequence of my prayer, as I had poured water on the fire. If I am not truthful in this claim, my ignominy would be manifested.

وَالسَّلَامُ عَلَى مَنِ اتَّبَعَ الْهُدَى [And peace be upon those who follow the guidance].

Written by,  
Humbly,  
**Ghulam Ahmad**  
From Qadian, District Gurdaspur

(Published in Riyāḍ-e-Hind Qadian)





بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ<sup>1</sup>  
اللَّهُمَّ صَلِّ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَآلِ مُحَمَّدٍ أَفْضَلِ الرُّسُلِ وَخَاتِمِ النَّبِيِّينَ<sup>2</sup>

## ANNOUNCEMENT

[*About Barāhīn-e-Aḥmadiyya*]

Being inspired and commanded by God Almighty, I have undertaken the compilation of a book named *Barāhīn-e-Aḥmadiyya*, with the object of reforming and rejuvenating the religion, which is accompanied by a reward of Rs. 10,000. The gist of this book is to show that the only true and the only revealed religion by means of which one might know God to be free from blemish, and obtain a heartfelt conviction as to the perfection of His holy and perfect attributes is the religion of Islam, in which the blessings of truth shine forth like the sun, and the impress of veracity is as vividly bright as daylight. All other religions are so palpably and manifestly false that their principles cannot stand the test of reasoning nor can their followers experience any measure of spiritual enlightenment and edification by putting into practice these principles. On the contrary, following these principles makes one so innately blind and dark hearted that signs of future misery among the followers become apparent even in this world.

This book has established the truth of the religion of Islam in two ways:

- 
1. In the name of Allah, the Gracious, the Merciful. [Publisher]
  2. O Allah, shower blessings upon Muhammad and the family of Muhammad, the Best of the Messengers and the Seal of the Prophets. [Publisher]

(1) **FIRSTLY**, by means of 300 formidable and sound arguments based on reason. Their grandeur, majesty, power, and stature can be inferred from the fact that a reward of Rs. 10,000 has been offered by me to anyone refuting them, and from my further readiness to have this offer registered for the satisfaction of anyone who might ask for it.

(2) **SECONDLY**, from those heavenly Signs which are essential for the complete and satisfactory proof of a true religion. With a view to establish the truthfulness of the religion of Islam like the bright day sun, the author has adduced under this latter head three kinds of evidence. First, those Signs which the opponents of the **Holy Prophet**, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, themselves saw manifested during his lifetime at his hand or through his prayers and focused attention. The author—that is, my humble self—has inserted these in this book together with lofty historical proofs based on the best kind of evidence. Second, those Signs which are found in the blessed Holy Quran inseparably adherent to it, and are perpetual, everlasting, and matchless, the nature of which I have fully expounded for ease of comprehension for everyone, leaving no excuse whatsoever for any type of denial. Third, those Signs which, by way of inheritances, devolve on any believer in the Book of God and the follower of the True Prophet. As an illustration of this, I—a humble devotee of His Lordship—by the grace of God Almighty, the All-Powerful Lord, have clearly evinced myself to be possessed of such virtues by the truthful revelations, super-normal and miraculous events, foretelling future events and revealing hidden secrets, truthful visions, and by obtaining from God the objects of my prayers to persons of many different persuasions (like the Āryas, etc.) who have been eyewitnesses. A full description of these will be found in the said book.

The author has also been informed that he is the **Mujaddid** [**Reformer**] of this age, and that as regards spiritual excellence, my virtues bear a very close similarity and strict analogy to those of the **Messiah**, son of Mary. In the same way as the distinguished Chief of Prophets was assigned a higher rank than that of other Prophets, I

also, by virtue of being a follower of the *Ḥadrat Khairul-Bashar* [the Benefactor of Mankind], *Afdalur-Rusul* [the Best of Messengers], am favoured with a higher rank than that assigned to many of the saints and holy personages preceding me. To follow in my footsteps will be a blessing and the means of salvation, whereas any antagonism towards me will result in estrangement and disappointment. All these evidences will be found by perusal of the book which will consist of nearly 4,800 pages, of which about 592 pages have been published. I am always ready to satisfy and convince any seeker of truth.

وَذَلِكَ فَضْلُ اللَّهِ يُؤْتِيهِ مَنْ يَشَاءُ وَلَا فَخْرَ وَالسَّلَامُ عَلَى مَنْ اتَّبَعَ الْهُدَى  
*All this is a grace of God—He gives it to whomsoever He likes, and there is no bragging in this.*

*Peace be to all the followers of righteousness!*

If, after the publication of this **notice**, no one takes the trouble of becoming an earnest enquirer after the truth and does not come forward with an unbiased mind to seek it, then my challenging (discussion) with him ends here, and he shall be answerable to God.

Now, I conclude this notice with the following prayer: O Gracious God! Guide the pliable hearts of all the nations, so that they may have faith in Thy Beloved Prophet, *Afdalur-Rusul* [the Best of the Messengers], **Muḥammad Muṣṭafā [the Chosen One]**, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him and on Thy perfect and holy Word, the **Holy Quran**, and that they may follow the commandments contained therein, so **that they may thereby be benefited by the blessings, prosperity**, and the true happiness which the true Muslims especially enjoy in both worlds, and may obtain absolution and eternal life which is not only attainable in the next world, but is also enjoyed by the truthful and honest people in this world; especially the English nation who have not yet availed themselves of this Sun of truthfulness, and whose honourable, civilized, and merciful **Government** has, by obliging us with numerous acts of kindness and friendly treatment, greatly encouraged

us to try our utmost for their welfare and security, so that their fair faces, which look comely in this world, may also shine with heavenly effulgence in the next world.

فَنَسْأَلُ اللَّهَ تَعَالَى خَيْرَهُمْ فِي الدُّنْيَا وَالْآخِرَةِ، اللَّهُمَّ اهْدِهِمْ وَأَيِّدْهُمْ بِرُوحِ مِنْكَ، وَاجْعَلْ لَهُمْ حَظًّا كَثِيرًا فِي دِينِكَ، وَاجْذِبْهُمْ بِخَوْلِكَ وَقُوَّتِكَ لِيُؤْمِنُوا بِكِتَابِكَ وَرَسُولِكَ وَيَدْخُلُوا فِي دِينِ اللَّهِ أَفْوَاجًا. آمِينَ ثُمَّ آمِينَ، وَالْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ.

We beseech God for their well-being in this world and the next. O God! Guide them and help them with Thy grace, and instil in their minds the love for Thy religion, and attract them with Thy power, so that they may have faith in Thy Book and Prophet, and embrace Thy religion in groups. *Āmin*, and again, *Āmin*! All praise belongs to Allah, Lord of all the worlds.

A N N O U N C E D B Y ,

humbly

MIRZA GULAM AHMAD

from Qadian, District Gurdaspur, Punjab

(20,000 Announcements were published)

# Original Translation of the Barāhīn Announcement

## TRANSLATION OF THE VERNACULAR NOTICE ON REVERSE.

*Being inspired and commanded by God, I have undertaken the compilation of a Book named "Barāhīn Ahmadiya," with the object of reforming and reclaiming the religion, and have offered a reward of Rs. 10,000 to any who could prove the arguments brought forward therein to be false. My object in this Book is to show that any true and the only revealed religion by means of which one might know God to be free from blemish, and of strong conviction as in the perfection of His attributes is the religion of Islam, in which the blessings of truth are as bright like the sun, and the impress of veracity is as vividly bright as the day-light. All other religions are so palpably and manifestly false that neither their principles can stand the test of reasoning nor their followers experience any spiritual edification. On the contrary those religions so obscure the mind and direct it to discernment of signs of future misery among the followers become apparent even to this world.*

That the Muhammadan religion is the only true religion, has been shown in this Book in two ways: (1st), By means of 300 very strong and sound arguments based on mental reasons, their cogency and sublimity being inferred from the fact that a reward of Rs. 10,000 has been offered by me to any one refuting them, and from my further readiness to have this offer registered for the satisfaction of any one who might ask for it; (2), From those Divine signs which are essential for the complete and satisfactory proof of a true religion. With a view to establish that Muhammadan religion is the only true religion in the world, I have adduced under this latter head 3 kinds of evidences: (1), The miracles performed by the Prophet during his lifetime, either by deeds or words which were witnessed by people of other persuasions and are inserted in this book in a chronological order (based on the best kind of evidences); (2), The marks which are inseparably adherent in the Alquran itself, and are perpetual and everlasting, the nature of which has been fully expounded for facility of comprehension; (3), The signs which by way of inheritances devolve on any believer in the Book of God and the follower of the true Prophet. As an illustration of this, I, the humble creature of God, by His help have clearly evinced myself to be possessed of such virtues by the achieving of many unusual and supernatural deeds, foretelling future events and secrets, and by obtaining from God the objects of my prayers, all of which many persons of different persuasions like the Aryas, &c., have been eye-witnesses (A full description of these will be found in the said book).

I am also inspired that I am the Reformer of my time; and that as regards spiritual excellence, my virtues bear a very close similarity and strict analogy to those of Jesus Christ, and in the same way as the distinguished chief of prophets were assigned a higher rank than that of other prophets, I also by virtue of being a follower of the August Person (the benefactor of mankind, the best of the messengers of God) am favored with a higher rank than that assigned to many of the Saints and Holy Personages preceding me. To follow my footsteps will be a blessing and the means of salvation, whereas any antagonism to me will result in estrangement and disappointment. All these evidences will be found by perusal of the Book which will consist of nearly 4800 pages of which about 592 pages have been published. I am always ready to satisfy and convince any seeker of truth. "All this is a Grace of God, He gives it to whomsoever He likes, and there is no bragging in this." "Peace be to all the lovers of righteousness!"

If after the publication of this notice any one does not take the trouble of becoming an earnest enquirer after the truth and does not come forward with an unbiassed mind to seek it, it is my challenging (discussion) with him ends here, and he shall be answerable to God.

Now I conclude this notice with the following prayer: (Oh Gracious God guide the pliant hearts of all the nations, so that they may have faith on thy chosen Prophet (Ahmad) and on thy holy Alquran, and that they may follow the commandments contained therein, so that they may thus be benefited by the peace and the true happiness which are really enjoyed by the true Muslims in both the worlds, and may obtain absolution and eternal life which is not only procurable in the next world, but is also enjoyed by the truthful and honest people even in this world. Especially the English nation who have not as yet availed themselves of the sunshine of truth, and whose civilized, prudent and merciful empire has, by obliging us by numerous acts of kindness and friendly treatments, exceedingly encouraged us to try our utmost for their welfare, so that their fair faces may shine with heavenly effulgence in the next world. We beseech God for their well being in this world and the next. Oh God guide them and help them with thy grace, and instil in their minds the love for thy religion, and attract them with thy power, so that they may have faith on thy Book and Prophet, and embrace thy religion in groups. Amen! Amen!

"Praise be to God the supporter of creation!"

(Sd.) MIRZA GULAM AHMAD,

Chief of Kadian, District Gurdaspur, Panjab, India.

Ripon Press, Lahore, Panjab.



## CONCLUDING COUPLETS

*About thankfulness and praise for  
the Glorious Lord & Sustainer, exalted be His glory &  
hallowed be His name with all the lights*

قربان تست جان من ای یار محسنم      با من کدام فرق تو کردی که من کنم

*O my Benevolent Friend, may my life be a sacrifice for You!*

*You have left no favour undone to me, so why should I remain deficient in Serving You?*

هر مطلب و مراد که می خواستم ز غیب      هر آرزو که بود بخاطر معینم

*All the objects and desires that I begged in secrecy*

*And every wish that was in my heart,*

از جود داده همه آں مدعائی من      و از لطف کرده گذر خود بمسکنم

*You satisfied all of them with Your kindness*

*And you graciously visited me in my home.*

هیچ آگهی نبود ز عشق و وفا مرا      خود ریختی متاع محبت بدامنم

*I had no awareness of love and fidelity.*

*You placed this love Yourself in my apron.*

این خاک تیره را تو خود اکسیر کرده      بود آن جمال تو سه نمودست احسنم

*You turned this dark soil into an elixir*

*And I was enamoured only by Your Beauty.*

ایں صیقل دلم نه بزه و تعبد است      خود کرده بلطف و عنایات روشنم

*The purity of my heart is not due to any abstinence or worship.*

*Indeed, You have illumined me with Your kindness and favours.*

صد منت تو هست برین مشّت خاک من      جانم رهینِ لطفِ عمیم تو هم تنم

*I am a particle of dust, carrying hundreds of Your favours.*

*Indeed, my body and soul are laden with Your acts of kindness.*

سحل است ترک هر دو جهان گر رضائی تو      آید بدست ای پند و کشف و مامنم

*It is easy to give up both the worlds, if Your favour*

*Is attained, O my Refuge, my Strong Protection, and my Abode of Peace!*

فصل بهار و موسم نگل نایم بکار      کاندل خیال روئی تو هر دم بگلشنم

*I have no use for the spring and the flowering season;*

*For, I am in a flower garden with the contemplation of Your Countenance.*

چون حاجتی بود بادیب دگر مرا      من تربیت پذیر ز رب همیمنم

*Why would I need another teacher?*

*I am being trained by my All-Powerful Lord.*

ز انساں عنایت ازلی شد قریب من      کاند ندائی یار زهر کوئی و برزغم

*His eternal favours have drawn so close to me*

*That I hear the voice of my Beloved in every street and alley.*

یا رب مرا بھر قدم استوار دار      وان روز خود مباد که عهد تو بکنم

*O my Lord! Grant me steadfastness at every step;*

*Let there not be a day when I break Your pledge.*

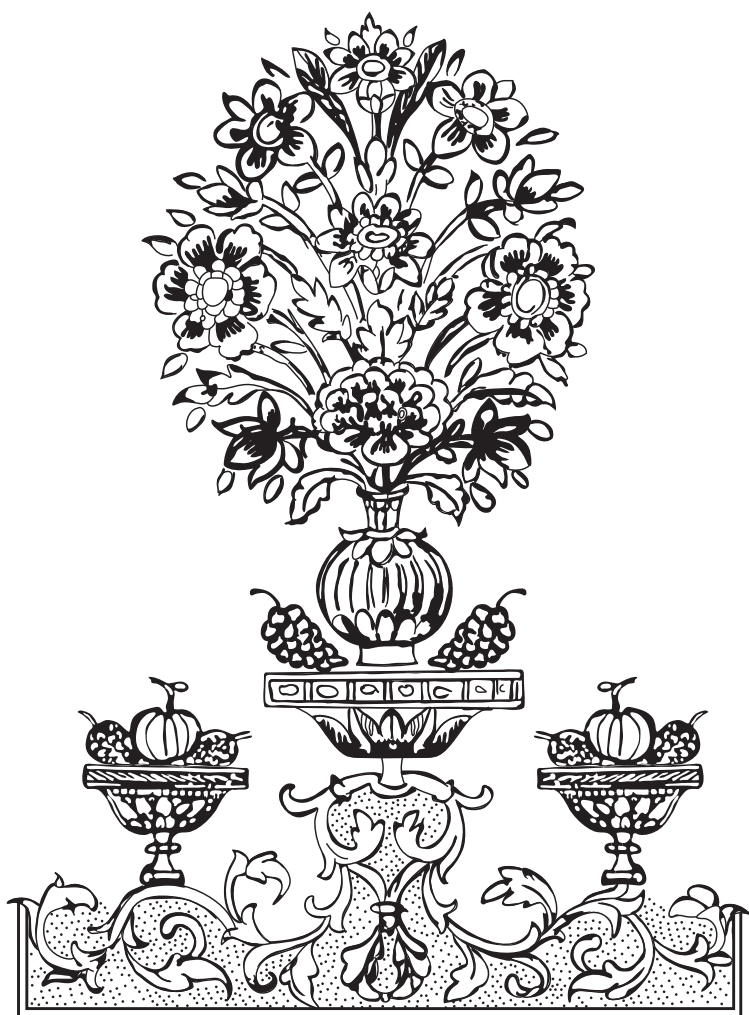
در کوئی تو اگر سر عشاق رازند

اول کسی که لافِ تعشّن زند منم

*If the lovers were to be beheaded in Your lane,*

*The first one to claim Your love would be myself.*







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**Nishān-e-Āsmānī** The Heavenly Sign

**Sirāj-e-Munīr** The Shining Lamp, or The Bright Sun

**Surmah Chashm-e-Āryah** Guidance for the Aryas

**Tauḍīḥ Marām** Elucidation of *Objectives*

*Lexicons, Encyclopaedias and Periodicals*

**Chashma-e-Nūr**, by Chashma-e-Nur Press, Amritsar, Punjab (British India)

**Faṣlul-Khiṭāb Liqadāyā Ahlul-Kitāb** by Ḥaḍrat Maulawī Hakeem Noor-ud-Deen

**Fuyūḍ-ul-Ḥaramayn** by Ḥaḍrat Shāh Waliullāh<sup>rta</sup>

**Madārijun-Nubūwwat** by Shaikh ‘Ābdul-Ḥaqq

**Qāmūs** by Shaikh Naṣr Abul Wafā

**Sihah** by Abu Naṣr Ismā’il Jauhari.

**Sharah-e-Ishārāt** by Nasir-ud-Din al-Tusi

**Taṣḍiq Barāhīn-e-Aḥmadiyya** by Ḥaḍrat Maulawī Hakeem Noor-ud-Deen

*Other*

**Sadīdī** by Shaikh Muḥammad Ḥusain



# NAMES OF PROPHETS IN THE BOOK

The following lists the names of Prophets who are mentioned in the this book, along with their transliteration (with and without diacritical marks) and their English equivalents where applicable:

| <b>Quranic—<br/>RAS with<br/>Diacritical<br/>Marks</b> | <b>Biblical<br/>Equivalent</b> | <b>Phonetic</b>  |
|--------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|------------------|
| Ādam                                                   | Adam                           | Aadam            |
| Ibrāhīm                                                | Abraham                        | Ibraaheem        |
| Dāwūd                                                  | David                          | Da'ood           |
| ‘Īsā                                                   | Jesus                          | Eesaa            |
| Yahyā                                                  | John the<br>Baptist            | Yahyaa           |
| Yūnus                                                  | Jonah                          | Yoonus           |
| Yūsuf                                                  | Joseph                         | Yoosuf           |
| Muḥammad                                               |                                | Muhammad         |
| Mūsā                                                   | Moses                          | Moosaa           |
| Masīḥ                                                  | Messiah                        | Maseeh           |
| Nūḥ                                                    | Noah                           | Nooh             |
| Ibn-e-<br>Maryam                                       | Son of Mary                    | Ibn-e-<br>Maryam |
| Sulaimān                                               | Solomon                        | Sulaimaan        |





## LIST OF PLACES

**Baitul-Muqaddas** Lit. the Sacred House. A title of the ancient Temple of Solomon which is the third holiest site in Islam—al-Aqsa Mosque.

**Firozpur** is a city in the Indian state of Punjab, known for its historical significance and proximity to the India-Pakistan border.

**Hijaz**, a historical region in western Arabia (now Saudi Arabia), was home to the descendants of Ishmael and Midian, a son of Abraham. It became the religious and political center of Islam. After the Fall of Mecca, the tribes of Hawazin and Thaqif attacked the Muslims at the Battle of Hunain, where despite an initial setback, the Muslim forces ultimately prevailed.

**Lahore** is a city the Pakistani province of Punjab.

**Makkah** The ancient Arabian city of the Holy Prophet Muḥammad<sup>sas</sup> birth, settled by Prophet Ibrāhīm<sup>as</sup>, and home to the Ka'bah, the holiest site in Islam.

**Madinah** The ancient Arabian city to which the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> emigrated from Makkah. Home to al-Masjid an-Nabawi and the tomb of the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>, the second holiest site in Islam.

**Mount Radwa** is a mountain near Madinah in the Hijaz region of present-day Saudi Arabia.

**Moradabad** is a city in the Indian state of Uttar Pradesh

**Peshawar** is a city in the north west of Pakistan in the province of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa.

**Qadian** is a town in the Gurdaspur district of Punjab, India, birthplace of Ḥaḍrat Mirza Ghulam Ahmad, the founder of the Ahmadiyya Muslim Community.

**Samarqand** (also Samarkand) is a city in present-day Uzbekistan, one of Central Asia's oldest cities. The Promised Messiah's family was of Persian origin and settled there before migrating to India. In the first half of the 16th century, his ancestor Mirza Hadi Baig moved from Samarqand to Eastern Punjab with several hundred followers, where he founded the settlement that would later become known as Qadian.

**Ta'if** is a small town about sixty miles southeast of Makkah, known for its agriculture and fruit production. When Prophet Muhammad<sup>sas</sup> sought refuge and support there in 619 CE after facing persecution in Makkah, the leaders of Ta'if rejected him and

incited the townspeople to drive him away by pelting him with stones, forcing his departure.

**Yamamah** was a historical region in central Arabia (now Saudi Arabia), notable in early Islamic history for the Battle of Yamamah (632–633 CE), where Muslim forces defeated the false prophet Musailimah, suffering significant losses among Quran memorizers.

**Yathrib** was the pre-Islamic name of the city that later became known as Medina (Al-Madinah Al-Munawwarah, “the enlightened city”). Located in western Arabia about 210 miles north of Mecca, it became the Prophet Muhammad’s place of refuge after the Hijra (migration) from Mecca in 622 CE. The people of Yathrib welcomed Muhammad and his followers, and the city became the first capital of the emerging Islamic state.

## GLOSSARY

**Adhan** The Islamic call to prayer.

**Aḥādīth** Sayings of the Holy Prophet Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>.

**Ahl-e-Bait** The members of the household of the Holy Prophet Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>.

**‘Alaqah** The three stages of development of the embryo, *nutfah* (sperm drop), *‘alaqah* (clot) and *mudghah* (lump of flesh) or to the three forms mentioned in 86:7, 8; 3:7 and 16:79, or to the three critical periods of pregnancy: (a) from the second to the third month of pregnancy; (b) from the third to the fifth month and (c) the beginning of the eighth month. During pregnancy there is danger of miscarriage at these three stages.

**Ākhirīn** Literally means ‘later ones’ and refers to the people in Latter days when the prophecy of the advent of Promised Messiah would be fulfilled.

**Amānat** The *amānat* (Trust) refers to the divine Law of the Quran. Of all creation, only the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> *al-Insān*—the Perfect Man—was found worthy of receiving and fulfilling this Trust, owing to his unmatched spiritual perfection and capacity to discharge this final and most sacred responsibility.

**Āmīn** Let it be so. Arabic equivalent to amen.

**Ānna** See **Currency values**.

**Annual Convention (Jalsa Salana)** A conference held annually and attended by Ahmadi and non-Ahmadi Muslims and other people throughout the world in large numbers. The annual conference was initiated by the Promised Messiah<sup>as</sup> in 1891. It is known by its original Urdu name, **Jalsa Salana**.

**Anṣār** *Anṣār* (Helpers) were the early Muslims of Madinah who provided shelter and support to the *Muhājirīn* (Refugees) who migrated from Makkah due to persecution. They are praised in the Quran as true believers for their sacrifices and commitment to Islam. Along with the *Muhājirīn*, they were promised forgiveness and an honourable provision by Allah.

**Aqṭāb** Plural of *qutb*, which means the polar star. Metaphorically applied to a saintly leader who guides people out of darkness.

**Āryah Samāj** A Hindu sect founded by Pandit Swamī Dayanand Saraswatī in 1875.

**Aṣḥāb-e-Kahf** The expression, *Aṣḥābul-Kahf*, has been variously interpreted as 'People of the Cave,' 'Men of the Cave;'

**ʿAṣr** Late afternoon. One of the five times of the daily obligatory Prayers [i.e. *Ṣalāt*] in Islam.

**Auliya'** Literally means 'Friends' and is the plural of *Walī*, which is generally used to refer to a saintly person. Shorter version of *Auliya'ullāh*.

**Awwalīn** Literally means 'the first ones' and refers of people during the time of the Holy Prophet Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>.

**Baqā** Islam recognizes three stages in man's spiritual journey towards God: The first stage is *fanā* (فناء—passing away), which is the total annihilation of one's ego for the sake of God; the second stage is *baqā* (بقاء—subsistence), which denotes a new spiritual life; and the third stage is *liqā* (لقاء—meeting), which is the state of achieving union with God.

**Bahādur** Literally, 'brave'. An honour conferred by the British Indian Empire on important Muslims and Parsis.

**Bai'at** Oath of allegiance to a religious leader.

**Baitul-Muqaddas** Lit. the Sacred House. It is a name for the Temple of Solomon, which is the third holiest site in Islam—al-Aqsa Mosque.

**Barāhīn** Convincing and conclusive arguments, evidence, and proof; the singular is *burhān*. Short name for *Barāhīn-e-Aḥmadiyya*, the

five-part magnum opus of the Promised Messiah<sup>as</sup>.

**Bid'atī** Refers to a person or practice associated with *Bid'ah*, meaning innovation or heresy in religious matters

**Brahmus** A Hindu revival movement that believes in the One God, but believes that reason alone is enough to guide mankind towards Him. They do not believe in divine revelation.

**Currency values** The book uses rupees, and paisa. **Rupee** was the main unit of currency in India, anna is 1/16 of a rupee and **paisa** is 1/4 of an anna.

**Dajjāl** An Arabic word literally meaning 'deceiver'. In Islamic terminology *Dajjāl* refers to those satanic forces which would be unleashed in the Latter Days, and would be opposed by the Promised Messiah and Imam Mahdi<sup>as</sup>.

**Dajjāliyyat** In Islamic eschatology, the sum total of the evils which the Holy Prophet Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>, prophesied would spread in the Latter Days, is *Dajjāliyyat*.

**Fajr** Dawn. One of the five times of the daily obligatory Prayers [i.e. *Ṣalāt*] in Islam.

**Faij-e-A'waj** (Lit. the crooked group) refers to the corrupt masses who emerged after the first righteous generations of Muslims. They were characterized by religious fabrications, sectarian differences, and injustice, until the Promised Messiah<sup>as</sup> was Divinely sent to reform and reunite them.

**Fanā** Lit., passing away. *See* **Baqā**.

**Fanā fillāh** A state of being lost in the love of Allah.

**Furqān** Literally, the 'Discrimination'. Another name for the Holy Quran, meaning the discrimination between right and wrong.

**Ghair Muqallid** Literally 'non-follower'. In Islamic terminology, it refers to individuals or groups who do not strictly adhere to the rulings and interpretations of a specific traditional school of Islamic jurisprudence.

**Ghauth / Ghauthiyyat** Ranks and honorary titles for the Saints in Islam.

**Gog and Magog** The words, *Ya'jūj* and *Ma'jūj* (Gog and Magog), are both derived from the root-word *Ajja* which means, he was quick in his pace; he or it became the flaming fire (Lane), and refer to the Scythians of the farthest East. Or, as some say, all nations inhabiting the north of Asia and Europe (Enc. Brit. & Jewish Enc. under 'Gog' and 'Magog,' and Historians' History of the World, vol. 2, p. 582 & Ezekiel, 38:2–6 & 39:6). The words may also apply to Christian nations of the West as they have made much use of burning fire and boiling water and because all their material progress and great discoveries and inventions are due to the right and very extensive use of these things. Or, the words may imply the restless behaviour of these nations as they are always on the lookout restlessly and impatiently to make new conquests.

**Hadith** A saying of the Holy Prophet Muḥammad<sup>sas</sup>. The plural is *aḥādīth*.

**Ḥaḍrat** A term of respect used to show honour and reverence for a person of established righteousness and piety. The literal meaning is: His/Her Holiness, Worship, Eminence, etc.

**Ḥarām** Unlawful

**Ḥārith** *Ḥārith* means a cultivator and *Ḥarrāth* means a big landlord. These characteristics are found in Promised Messiah<sup>as</sup>.

**Hijrah** Migration. Refers to the exodus from Makkah to Madinah by the Holy Prophet Muḥammad<sup>sas</sup> in the year 623 CE, which marks the beginning of the lunar calendar of Islam.

**Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup>** A title used exclusively for the Founder of Islam, Ḥaḍrat Muḥammad<sup>sas</sup>.

**Holy Quran** The final and perfect Scripture revealed by Allah for the guidance of mankind for all times to come. It was revealed word by word to the Holy Prophet Muḥammad<sup>sas</sup> over a period of twenty-three years.

**Ḥuḍur** *see* **Ḥaḍrat**

**Iblīs** An attributive name meaning 'he turned away'. The Holy Quran reports that Iblīs, inflamed by his own arrogance, refused to submit to Ḥaḍrat Adam<sup>as</sup>.

**Ilhām** Divine revelation from God, Islamic terminology. Also called *wahy*.

- Imāmūl-Ma'sūmīn** A title meaning 'Leader of the Sinless', referring to the Holy Prophet Muhammad. *See* **Holy Prophet**.
- Ijtihād** Interpretation of religious matters.
- Isrāfil** One of the angels in Islamic tradition who will sound the trumpet to announce the Day of Resurrection and the gathering of all beings for judgment.
- Istikhārah** A special prayer to seek divine guidance in important affairs.
- Jalsa Salana** Annual Convention, Conference, or gathering. *See* **Annual Convention**.
- Jamā'at** A Community. Although the word Jamā'at may refer to any community, in this book Jamā'at generally refers to the Worldwide Ahmadiyya Muslim Community.
- Jamādi-ul-Awwal** The fifth month of the Islamic lunar calendar.
- Jizyah** A tax paid by non-Muslims living in a Muslim State in lieu of military service.
- Juzw** A *juzw* comprises sixteen pages.
- Ka'bah** Also Baitullah The first house built for the worship of God, located in Makkah. Muslims face Ka'bah while performing their daily Prayers [i.e. *Ṣalāt*] and make circuits of it as a part of the pilgrimage and also as an act of devotion.
- Kadhhab** Great liar. A title of Muṣailimah, who claimed falsely to be a Prophet in Arabia in the 7th century CE.
- Kāfir** A person who is not a Muslim; disbeliever.
- Kalimah** The declaration of the Islamic faith: *Lā ilāha illallāh Muḥammadur-Rasūlullāh*, 'There is no one worthy of worship except Allah; Muḥammad is the Messenger of Allah.'
- Kalima-e-Tauḥīd** Islamic proclamation of the Oneness of Allah: *Lā ilāha illallāh*, 'There is no one worthy of worship except Allah.'
- Karamat** Miracles performed by saints.
- Khalifah** Caliph is derived from the Arabic word *khalīfah*, which herein means 'successor' or 'vicegerent'. *Khulafā'* is the plural of *Khalīfah*. In many divine revelations someone commissioned by God Almighty is referred to as His *Khalīfah*. In Islamic terminology, the title '*Khalīfa-e-Rāshid*' [righteous *Khalīfah*] is applied to each of the first four *Khulafā'* who continued the mission of the Holy Prophet Muḥammad<sup>as</sup> after he passed away. Ahmadi Muslims refer to each successor of the Promised Messiah<sup>as</sup> as Khalifatul-Masīḥ.
- Khalīlullah** Literally meaning 'Friend of God,' a special title bestowed upon Prophet Abraham<sup>as</sup> in Islam

**Khatm-e-Nubūwwat** Seal of Prophethood. Refers to the highest rank among Prophets, accorded to the Holy Prophet Muḥammad<sup>sas</sup>.

**Khātamun-Nabiyyīn** The Seal of the Prophets. A title accorded by God to the Holy Prophet Muḥammad<sup>sas</sup> in the Holy Quran. A variant is **Khātamul-Anbiyāʾ**.

**Khātamul-Anbiyāʾ** A title accorded to the Holy Prophet<sup>sas</sup> meaning, 'the Seal of the Prophets.' An alternate version of writing is **Khātam-e-Anbiyāʾ**.

**Kos** A *kos* is a measure of distance, the length of which is approximately two English miles.

**Kufr** Disbelief. Describes any belief or act that is so contrary to Islamic teachings that it can cause its doer to fall outside the pale of Islam. Often used by Muslims in the context of opining on the beliefs or actions of their co-religionists.

**Laʾnat** Curse. Literally means 'Absence of exaltation'.

**Lauḥ-e-Maḥfūz** Lit. 'the Preserved Tablet'. It is a term used in the Quran to represents the immutability of every decree by Allah for events and outcomes that have happened or will happen.

**Liqā** *see* **Baqā**.

**Mahjūb** literally means 'one behind a veil'; referring to someone who cannot understand owing to the obstacles hindering one's view and perception.

**Maḥfūziyyat** Divine protection.

**Malāʾikah** *Malāʾikah* which is the plural of *Malak* is derived from *Malaka* which means, he controlled, or from *Alaka* meaning, he sent. The angels are called *Malāʾikah* because they control the forces of nature or because they bring Divine revelations to Heavenly Messengers and Reformers.

**Manqūlī** Transmitted knowledge.

**Masīh** Messiah; a title for Jesus in Islam.

**Maulawī** A Muslim religious cleric.

**Maʾqūl** Knowledge that is corroborated by science, reason, and rationality.

**Millat-e-Ḥanīfiyyah** The monotheistic faith of Prophet Ibrahim (Abraham).

**Muʾjizah** Miracle performed by a Prophet.

**Mufti** An Islamic jurist who issues fatwas (legal opinions).

**Miʾrāj** The spiritual ascension of the Holy Prophet Muḥammad<sup>sas</sup> to Heavens, described in the Holy Quran and related in detail in hadith literature.

**Muʾallim-ul-Malakūt** Literally 'the Instructor of the Realm of Angels' used as a sarcastic title for Iblīs

**Mubāhalah** Prayer duel. As described in *Sūrah Āl-e-Imrān*, a contest between claimants to divine support wherein each party prays for God to curse the lying party.

**Mudabbirāt** Meaning, those beings or groups of people who plan, manage and conduct the affairs entrusted to them in an excellent manner.

**Mudghah** Lit. lump of flesh, *see* 'Alaqah.

**Muḥaddath** A recipient of Divine revelation. Plural is **Muḥaddathūn**.

**Muḥsin** *Muḥsin* signifies 'one who strives to be perfect in good deeds.' A famous saying of the Holy Prophet describes the *Muḥsin* as one who does a good deed as if he is actually seeing God or that at least God is seeing him (*Bukhārī & Muslim*).

**Mujaddid** Reformer. Holy personages within Islam who appeared at the head of every century.

**Mulham** Recipient of *ilhām*, or divine revelation.

**Mulḥid** An atheist; someone who denies the existence of God.

**Munshi** Meaning secretary or scribe. It is a title far below that of the *maulawī*, who is formally trained in Islamic studies.

**Muṣṭafā** The Chosen One, a title of honour used for the Holy Prophet Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>.

**Mutawātir ma'nawī** refers to narrations with essentially the same meaning transmitted through multiple and independent sources, making it impossible to be a fabrication.

**Muttaqī** A Muttaqi (righteous person), therefore, is one who is ever on his guard against sins and takes God for his shield or shelter. The plural is **Muttaqqīn**.

**Muwaḥḥid** Literally meaning a believer in the Oneness of God. All Muslims, by virtue of subscribing to the *Kalimah-e-Tauḥīd*, are *muwaḥḥidīn*. However, the term muwahhidin has been adopted by some Muslims who consider the Quran and hadith to be sufficient sources of guidance and do not follow any Imam.

**Muwaḥḥidīn** Plural of *muwaḥḥid*, literally meaning a believer in the Unity of God.

**Nubūwwat** Prophethood.

**Nafs-e-Ammārah** The self that incites to evil. The lowest of three spiritual states; also *an-nafsul-ammārah*.

**Nafs-e-Muṭma'innah** There are three stages of the *nafs* [self]: *Nafs-e-ammārah*, *lawwāmāh*, and *muṭma'innah*. In *Nafs-e-muṭma'innah*, the tranquil soul, achieved when all inner conflict ceases, leaving one in perfect harmony with the divine will. This state represents spiritual completion where the lower self has been fully subdued, establishing inner peace and eliminating all tendencies toward discord or moral corruption.

**Nawab** An honorific title ratified and bestowed by Mughal emperors to semi-autonomous Muslim rulers of princely states in South Asia. The female equivalent is 'Begum' or 'Nawab Begum'.



- Nikāh** The Islamic marriage contract.
- Nuṭfah** Lit. sperm drop; *see* 'Alaqah.
- Paisa** *See* Currency values.
- Patwārī** An accountant.
- Pīr** Spiritual mentor
- Qaṣīdah** An ode.
- Qassām-e-Azal** The Eternal Dispenser of all things; a Divine epithet denoting God as the primordial source from which all creation flows.
- Qiblah** Direction of the Ka'bah in Makkah, toward which Muslims face to offer formal prayers.
- Quraish** The leading tribe in Makkah during the time of the Holy Prophet Muhammad<sup>sa</sup>. He himself was from the Banū Hāshim clan of the Quraish tribe.
- Quran** *see* Holy Quran.
- Qutb** *see* Aqṭāb
- Rabb** Lord, Master, Creator; One who sustains and develops; One who brings to perfection by degrees.
- Rabbul-'ālamīn** An attribute of God as mentioned in *Sūrah al-Fātiḥah*. Meaning: 'Lord of all the worlds.'
- Rabī'uth-Thānī** Also known as Rabī' al-Ākhir, is the fourth month of the Islamic calendar.
- Rafa'** Arabic term meaning to physically raise or to spiritually exalt in rank. When the subject is Allah the Almighty, the term invariably refers to spiritual exaltation.
- Raḥīm** Merciful. An attribute of God as mentioned in *Sūrah al-Fātiḥah* and throughout the Holy Quran. The verbal noun of this attribute is *Raḥīmīyyat*.
- Raḥmān** Gracious. An attribute of God as mentioned in *Sūrah al-Fātiḥah* and throughout the Holy Quran. The verbal noun of this attribute is *Raḥmānīyyat*.
- Rak'at** A unit of formal prayer (*Ṣalāt*). Pl. *Rak'āt*.
- Rasūl** The terms *Rasūl* (Messenger) and *Nabī* (Prophet) are often misunderstood, with the misconception that a *Rasūl* brings a new law and scripture, while a *Nabī* only reforms his people; however, the two terms are interchangeable, representing different aspects of the same role. A *Rasūl* receives divine messages and, as a *Nabī*, conveys them. Thus, every *Rasūl* is a *Nabī*, and every *Nabī* is a *Rasūl*, with revelation preceding its delivery.
- Rubūbiyyat** Allah's attribute of sustaining or nurturing.
- Ṣiḥāḥ Sittah** The title given to the six authentic books of Hadith.
- Salat** The formal Muslim prayer offered five times daily.
- Sannyasis** Hindu ascetics.

- Sayyedul-Muqarrabīn** A title meaning 'Chief of all the Elects' (i.e. those who are close to God) referring to the Holy Prophet Muhammad. *See* **Holy Prophet**.
- Sha'bān** The eighth month in the lunar calendar.
- Shariah** Religious law of Islam. The term is also used in the general sense of any revealed law.
- Shaikhul-Kull** A title meaning 'the ultimate scholar' or 'master of everything'; also referred to as 'the *shaikh* of all things,' signifying the highest authority in knowledge or leadership.
- Shirk** Associating partners with Allah.
- Sufi** A Muslim focusing on mystical and ascetic aspects of religious worship.
- Sūrah** A chapter of the Holy Quran.
- Tahajjud** Early morning supererogatory prayers.
- Takfir** The practice of adjudging Muslims as non-Muslims, used chiefly by Muslims.
- Taqwā** Righteousness. Fear of God.
- Tauḥīd** The Oneness of God—the fundamental Islamic belief that there is none worthy of worship except Allah.
- Tehsīl** A sub-district administrative area in parts of India.
- Teḥsildār** A sub-collector of revenue.
- Tasnīm** *Tasnīm* is taken to be a fountain in Paradise; water coming from above: the knowledge of God. Figuratively, it means, the Word of God. *Also*, are revelations that are sent down to the Chosen Ones of God—the righteous followers of the Holy Prophet.
- Ummah** The community or followers of the Holy Prophet Muhammad<sup>sas</sup>.
- Ummul-Qurā** Lit. Mother of towns; it is an epithet for Makkah.
- Vedas** The most ancient Hindu scriptures, written in Sanskrit.
- Wahy** Divine revelation from God, used interchangeably with *ilhām* in Islamic terminology.
- Walī** Literally, 'friend'. In the terminology of Islamic mysticism, it refers to a very pious person or a friend of Allah. The singular form is *walī* [friend] or *Walīyyullāh* [Friend of Allah], the plural form is *Auliya'ullāh* which is sometimes abbreviated as *Auliya'*.
- Walimah** *Walimah* is, that the one who is having his *nikāḥ* [getting married], feeds his friends after the *nikāḥ*.
- Yathrib** or **Yathrab** This was the name of Madinah before the Hijrah.
- Zindīq** A heretic; someone accused of opposing or corrupting religious beliefs.

# INDEX



## *Index of the Verses of the Holy Quran*

### **Chapter 1, al-Fātiḥah**

|                  |     |
|------------------|-----|
| verse 6–7 .....  | 626 |
| verses 6–7 ..... | 290 |

### **Chapter 2, al-Baqarah**

|                  |                |
|------------------|----------------|
| verse 2–3 .....  | 131            |
| verse 3 .....    | 131            |
| verse 62 .....   | 404            |
| verse 88 .....   | 51, 95, 112    |
| verse 113 .....  | 77, 82, 83, 89 |
| verse 156 .....  | 139            |
| verse 201 .....  | 84             |
| verse 222 .....  | 160            |
| verse 270 .....  | 157, 605       |
| verses 2–3 ..... | 131            |
| verses 4 .....   | 387            |

### **Chapter 3, Āl-e-‘Imrān**

|                 |                       |
|-----------------|-----------------------|
| verse 32 .....  | 143, 160              |
| verse 56 .....  | 60, 63, 437, 467, 477 |
| verse 60 .....  | 143                   |
| verse 111 ..... | 163                   |
| verse 145 ..... | 437                   |

### **Chapter 4, an-Nisā’**

|                 |     |
|-----------------|-----|
| verse 59 .....  | 143 |
| verse 114 ..... | 158 |
| verse 160 ..... | 339 |

### **Chapter 5, al-Mā’idah**

|                 |             |
|-----------------|-------------|
| verse 40 .....  | 657         |
| verse 76 .....  | 63          |
| verse 118 ..... | 60, 63, 437 |

### **Chapter 6, al-An‘ām**

|                     |          |
|---------------------|----------|
| verse 12 .....      | 615      |
| verse 36 .....      | 383      |
| verse 62 .....      | 98       |
| verse 91 .....      | 397      |
| verse 110 .....     | 382      |
| verse 123 .....     | 109      |
| verse 154 .....     | 143      |
| verse 159 .....     | 382, 383 |
| verse 163–164 ..... | 143      |

|                 |     |
|-----------------|-----|
| verse 164 ..... | 157 |
|-----------------|-----|

### **Chapter 7, al-A‘rāf**

|                 |     |
|-----------------|-----|
| verse 13 .....  | 600 |
| verse 26 .....  | 466 |
| verse 102 ..... | 383 |
| verse 127 ..... | 288 |
| verse 173 ..... | 33  |

### **Chapter 8, al-Anfāl**

|                |               |
|----------------|---------------|
| verse 18 ..... | 85            |
| verse 30 ..... | 108, 153, 339 |
| verse 61 ..... | 619, 620      |

### **Chapter 9, at-Taubah**

|                 |     |
|-----------------|-----|
| verse 119 ..... | 615 |
|-----------------|-----|

### **Chapter 10, Yūnus**

|                   |     |
|-------------------|-----|
| verse 4 .....     | 230 |
| verse 49–50 ..... | 382 |
| verse 59 .....    | 157 |
| verse 65 .....    | 336 |

### **Chapter 11, Hūd**

|                |     |
|----------------|-----|
| verse 45 ..... | 299 |
|----------------|-----|

### **Chapter 12, Yūsuf**

|                |     |
|----------------|-----|
| verse 22 ..... | 646 |
| verse 44 ..... | 477 |
| verse 96 ..... | 151 |

### **Chapter 13, ar-Ra‘d**

|                |    |
|----------------|----|
| verse 12 ..... | 98 |
| verse 41 ..... | 60 |

### **Chapter 14, Ibrāhīm**

|                    |    |
|--------------------|----|
| verses 25–27 ..... | 13 |
|--------------------|----|

### **Chapter 15, al-Ḥijr**

|                |                    |
|----------------|--------------------|
| verse 10 ..... | 298, 301, 491, 492 |
| verse 30 ..... | 231                |
| verse 43 ..... | 97, 416            |

### **Chapter 16, an-Nahl**

|                 |     |
|-----------------|-----|
| verse 129 ..... | 350 |
|-----------------|-----|

### **Chapter 17, Banī Isrā’īl**

|                |     |
|----------------|-----|
| verse 73 ..... | 136 |
| verse 85 ..... | 298 |

|                                     |               |
|-------------------------------------|---------------|
| <b>Chapter 18, al-Kahf</b>          |               |
| verse 34.....                       | 129, 146      |
| <b>Chapter 19, Maryam</b>           |               |
| verse 72.....                       | 134, 140      |
| verse 73.....                       | 138           |
| verses 72.....                      | 138           |
| verses 72–73.....                   | 132           |
| <b>Chapter 20, Ṭā Hā</b>            |               |
| verse 115.....                      | 157           |
| <b>Chapter 21, al-Anbiyā'</b>       |               |
| verse 31.....                       | 233           |
| verse 105.....                      | 226           |
| <b>Chapter 22, al-Ḥajj</b>          |               |
| verse 53.....                       | 269, 413      |
| <b>Chapter 23, al-Mu'minūn</b>      |               |
| verse 15.....                       | 234, 239      |
| verses 13–15.....                   | 231           |
| <b>Chapter 24, an-Nūr</b>           |               |
| verse 36.....                       | 212           |
| <b>Chapter 25, al-Furqān</b>        |               |
| verse 33.....                       | 350           |
| <b>Chapter 27, an-Naml</b>          |               |
| verse 90.....                       | 135           |
| verse 91.....                       | 135           |
| <b>Chapter 29, al-'Ankabut</b>      |               |
| verse 3.....                        | 478           |
| <b>Chapter 32, as-Sajdah</b>        |               |
| verse 24.....                       | 623           |
| <b>Chapter 33, al-Aḥzāb</b>         |               |
| verse 47.....                       | 480           |
| verse 63.....                       | 439           |
| verse 73...130, 132, 141, 147, 148  |               |
| verse 74.....                       | 152           |
| <b>Chapter 35, Faṭir</b>            |               |
| verse 23.....                       | 109           |
| verse 29.....                       | 156           |
| verse 33.....                       | 108, 127      |
| <b>Chapter 36, Yā Sin</b>           |               |
| verse 41.....                       | 221, 224      |
| verse 80.....                       | 137           |
| verse 83.....                       | 228           |
| <b>Chapter 37, aṣ-Ṣāffāt</b>        |               |
| verse 165.....                      | 172           |
| verses 63–66.....                   | 13            |
| <b>Chapter 39, az-Zumar</b>         |               |
| verse 7.....                        | 471           |
| verse 43.....                       | 537           |
| verse 54.....                       | 159           |
| verse 68.....                       | 225           |
| verses 61–62.....                   | 140           |
| <b>Chapter 40, al-Mu'min</b>        |               |
| verse 17.....                       | 226           |
| verse 29.....                       | 367, 368      |
| verse 67.....                       | 143           |
| <b>Chapter 41, Ḥā Mīm as-Sajdah</b> |               |
| verse 12.....                       | 473           |
| verses 31–32.....                   | 109           |
| <b>Chapter 43, az-Zukhruf</b>       |               |
| verse 69.....                       | 135           |
| <b>Chapter 44, ad-Dukhān</b>        |               |
| verse 11.....                       | 534           |
| verses 44–47.....                   | 13            |
| <b>Chapter 47, Muḥammad</b>         |               |
| verse 8.....                        | 687           |
| <b>Chapter 48, al-Fat'h</b>         |               |
| verse 30.....                       | 238           |
| <b>Chapter 51, adh-Dhāriyāt</b>     |               |
| verses 2–5.....                     | 198           |
| <b>Chapter 53, an-Najm</b>          |               |
| verses 2–8.....                     | 180           |
| verses 4–5.....                     | 265           |
| verses 4–5.....                     | 117, 174, 414 |
| <b>Chapter 55, ar-Raḥmān</b>        |               |
| verses 27–28.....                   | 226           |
| <b>Chapter 56, al-Wāqī'ah</b>       |               |
| verse 80.....                       | 605           |
| <b>Chapter 57, al-Ḥadīd</b>         |               |
| verse 18.....                       | 161           |
| verse 19.....                       | 139           |
| verse 26.....                       | 471           |
| verse 29.....                       | 108, 153, 339 |
| <b>Chapter 58, al-Mujādalah</b>     |               |
| verse 22.....                       | 110           |
| verse 23.....                       | 112, 162      |
| <b>Chapter 61, aṣ-Ṣaff</b>          |               |
| verse 7.....                        | 59            |

**Chapter 62, al-Jumu‘ah**

verse 4 ..... 250, 254, 255, 256

verses 3–4 ..... 247

**Chapter 65, at-Ṭalāq**

verse 13 ..... 227

**Chapter 66, at-Taḥrīm**

verse 10 ..... 349

**Chapter 67, al-Mulk**

verse 6 ..... 165, 201

**Chapter 69, al-Ḥāqqah**

verses 17–18 ..... 200

**Chapter 72, al-Jinn**

verse 27–28 ..... 368

verses 9–10 ..... 181

**Chapter 74, al-Muddaththir**

verse 32 ..... 442

**Chapter 77, al-Mursalāt**

verses 2–6 ..... 198

**Chapter 79, an-Nāzi‘āt**

verse 6 ..... 199

**Chapter 81, at-Takwīr**

verse 4 ..... 486

verse 5 ..... 486

verse 6 ..... 486

verse 8 ..... 486

verse 11 ..... 486

verse 12 ..... 491

**Chapter 82, al-Infītār**

verse 3 ..... 486

verse 4 ..... 98, 486

**Chapter 84, al-Inshiqāq**

4–5 486

**Chapter 86, at-Ṭāriq**

verse 5 ..... 200

verse 9 ..... 473

verse 12 ..... 473

verses 2–5 ..... 97, 165, 178

verses 12–17 ..... 472

**Chapter 91, ash-Shams**

verse 9 ..... 167

verse 10 ..... 416

**Chapter 93, aḍ-Ḍuḥā**

verse 7 ..... 150

verse 7–9 ..... 149, 150

verse 8 ..... 149, 150

verse 10 ..... 150

verse 11 ..... 150

**Chapter 95, at-Tīn**

verse 5 ..... 232

**Chapter 99, az-Zilzāl**

verse 2 ..... 486

**Chapter 110, an-Naṣr**

verse 3 ..... 247

**Chapter 112, al-Ikhlāṣ**

verses 2 ..... 62





## *Index of Ahādīth*

**‘Abdullah** had fixed Thursday as day for delivering his admonitions, and people used to gather for learning on that day. 619

**‘Abdullah** ibn Amr stated: Whatever I used to hear from Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, I used to write down in order to commit it to memory. 118

**A** believer takes his share of fire of Hell in this very world. And *kāfir* (disbeliever) is compelled and forced into Hell, whereas a believer enters fire of their own will for sake of God Almighty. 133

**‘Alī**, may Allah be pleased with him, said: ‘Speak to people according to their level of understanding. Would you like them to falsify Allah and His Messenger? 621

**A** Mahdi would be born. His name would be same as my name, and his character would be same as my character. 403

**Angels** accompany man to protect him from every type of evil, but leave him when an irrevocable decree befalls him. 99

**A** portion of fire is decreed for every human being, they may accept their share of this fire in way of God Almighty in this world, or they may pass their life in ease and neglect and render account for their comfortable living in the Hereafter. 134

**A** sign of the truthful is that truth should be dominant in their dreams. 335

**Change** the threshold of your door. 480

**Even** if faith had ascended to the Pleiades, a man of Persia, or some men of Persia, would bring it back. 249, 255

**Even** if Fatimah, daughter of Muhammad were to commit theft, her hand too would be cut off. 353

**Fever** from which a believer suffers is a type of Hellfire. 133

**For** a believer, Paradise assumes the form of Hell in this world. 133

**For** every servant of Allah, an angel is appointed as a guardian, remaining with him and protecting him from satans and other evil enticements during his sleep and wakefulness. 99

**God** Almighty has promised that He will raise a man at the head of every century who will rejuvenate the Faith and, removing its weaknesses, will restore it to its original strength and ability. 393

**He** who dies without recognizing the Imam of his time dies a death of ignorance. 626

**He** who is not grateful to man is indeed not grateful to Allah. 504

**He** will break the cross, will kill the swine, and he will abolish the *Jizyah*. 310

**High** ranks of nearness to God are attained by the righteous servants of God by offering *nawāfil* (voluntary Prayers). 546

**Holy** Prophet says that he has such a striking resemblance to the Messiah as if his being and mine are joined together. 398

**I** am that raiser of the dead at whose footsteps the dead are raised. 161

**I** have been apprised that I will live up to half the age of Jesus' life. 465

**I** swear by Allah that there is no living being that would remain alive after one hundred years from now. 535

**It** occurred to me. 348, 602

**I** will cause thee to die. 437

**Killing** someone with the torment of fire is strictly prohibited. 625

**Knowledge** will be lost through the death of scholars until the point when no scholar is found, the people will take the ignorant as their leaders and rulers and will go to them for inquiries about religious issues, upon which those people, on account... 611

**Love** for *Anṣār* (Helpers of the Faith) is a sign of faith. 621

**Love** for *Anṣār* is a sign of faith and envy against them is a sign of hypocrisy 621

**Nawas** bin Sam'an, may Allah be pleased with him, relates that the Messenger of Allah, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, stated that when God Almighty desires to send down

a revelation from Himself, He speaks out the same. 115

**Not** a foot of heaven remains without angels even for a single moment. 113

(O Ḥassān!) Respond to the disbelievers on my behalf. O Allah! Strengthen him with the Holy Spirit. 111

**O** Ḥassān, return the disbelievers' sarcasm with sarcasm, and Gabriel is with you. 112

**Only** two Ummahs are good—the first and the last. And the middle one is a Crooked Host. They are like an army in numbers but are spiritually dead. They are not of me and I am not of them. 254

**O** our Allah! Forgive my people, for they do not know. 362

**Pass** on the reports heard from Israelites. 304

**Seeking** knowledge is an obligation upon every Muslim man and woman. 613

**Seek** knowledge even if you have to travel to China for it. 613

**Setting** out for a journey... 614

**Some** representatives of tribe 'Abdul Qais presented themselves to Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, and said: 'We travel a long distance to come here, and we cannot come except during sacred months.' 618

**The** *Dajjāl* would lay claim first to Prophethood and then to Divinity. 400

**The** *maulawīs* and jurists of that age would be the worst of all

people inhabiting the world at that time. 254

**The** Holy Prophet has forbidden that he be given superiority even over Yūnus bin Matta. 144

**The** Imams will be from among the Quraish. 311

**The** Messenger of Allah, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, placed a pulpit in the mosque for Ḥassān bin Thābit... 111

**The** Messiah would descend in Damascus. 479

**The** person who travels to seek knowledge and treads a certain path, Allah will make the path to Paradise easy for him. 616

**The** Promised Messiah will break the Cross. 469, 482

**The** Promised Messiah will end war. 311, 479

**The** Promised Messiah would break the cross and kill the swine. 437

**The** Promised Messiah would descend near a minaret in Damascus. 479

**There** are angels who never leave you except when you attend to the call of nature or are engaged in intimacy. Therefore, feel bashful in their presence and give them due respect. 99

**There** is no one from among you who is not accompanied by a companion of nature of *jinn* and a companion from among angels.' A Companion asked, 'And you, too, O Messenger of Allah<sup>ss</sup>?' He replied, 'Yes, I too, but God has placed my... 100

**There** is no such individual for whose protection an angel has not been permanently assigned. 99

**There** is not a foot of space empty in the heavens which is not occupied by an angel in prostration or standing upright. 172

**The** worthiest of my intercession on the Day of Judgment will be the one who says, 'There is no one worthy of worship except Allah' with purity of heart or mind. 616

**They** (the *maulawīs*) will recite the Quran, but the Quran will not go down their larynx. 611

**Those** who will issue fatwas in this age will be the worst of all creation on the face of the earth. 611

**Truest** of you in his statements. 339

**Twenty** angels accompany man to serve him in various ways, and lying in wait for every opportune moment are Iblīs during the day and Iblīs' children during the night with the intent of inflicting harm. 99

**Verily**, deeds are (judged) by intentions. 614, 620

**When** a person will be liable for great punishment for his evil deeds on the Day of Judgment, Allah, glorified be His eminence, will ask him if he had ever gone to visit a certain righteous person. He will respond that he never did so intentionally, but... 617

**'Wrapping up'** means that God Almighty will hold and conceal the heavens in His right hand... 226



## *Index of Revelations of the Promised Messiah<sup>as</sup> (Arabic)*

**Allah** has placed blessing in you,  
O Ahmad. 184, 527

**Allah** is with those who are righteous and Allah is with those who do good. 435

**Allah's** hand is above their hands. 435

**Allah** will be with them wherever they might be, if they are faithful to their covenant. 435

**Allah** will forgive your sins and He is the *Arḥāmur-Rāḥimīn* [Most Merciful of those who show mercy]. 309

**Allah** will help you even if people do not help you. 528

**Allah** will Himself safeguard you from all calamities, even though people do not wish to see you safeguarded from calamities. 528

**Allah** will make your countenance cheerful and will illumine your reasoning. 309

**Allah** will teach you from Himself. 528

**And** glad tidings to he who adopts this way and follows it 7

**And** tell the people: 'I have been commissioned'. 184

**And** that the way of the guilty ones might become manifest. 184

**And** these people said: 'This person's book is full of kufr [disbelief] and falsehood.' 308

**Be** not afraid, I am with you and walk along with you. 17

**Build** the ark under Our supervision and Our direction'. 434

**Call** My servants to the truth and give them good tidings of the days of [the manifestation of the Glory of] Allah and call them to the clear book. 435

**Despair** not of the mercy of Allah. 309

**God** Almighty answered to them: I know that which you do not know. 308

**God** Almighty has looked at you with a fragrant look. 308

**God** will ultimately bring her back to you. 327

**He** exalts whom He wills and abases whom He wills; He bestows honour on whom He wills and humiliates whom He wills and chooses for Himself whom He wills. 434

**He** has large stores of everything with Him. 434

**He** is a dog and he will die according to the value of the letters in the word *kalb* (dog), which amounts to fifty-two. 349

**He** is not questioned about that which He does and they will be called to account. 435

**He** (the Most Gracious God) has taught you the *Quran*. 184, 527

**He** watches the times and knows well their requirements. 434

**I** am the first of the believers. 184

**I** am with you wherever you might be and I am your Helper and I am your resource and your strong arm. 440

**I** decided to appoint a Khalifah [vicegerent] from Myself so I created this Adam. 545, 599

**I** have been commissioned by Allah and I am the first of the believers. 434

**I** have chosen you for Myself. 17, 528

**I** have found you that which I have found you. 17

**I** have made you 'Īsā Ibn-e-Maryam (Jesus, son of Mary) and Allah has power to do all that He wills. 462

**I** have made you Masīh ibn-e-Maryam (the Messiah, son of Mary). 528

**In** the same way We create. 545

**I** shall accept all your prayers but not in the matter of your collaterals. 340

**I** shall help him who designs to help you. 17

**I** shall humiliate him who designs to humiliate you. 17, 337, 440, 608

**I** shall prevail over every blind opponent. 440

**I** was determined to appoint a vicegerent on earth and so I created Adam. 310

**Look** at Yūsuf [Joseph] and his glory. 309

**My** light is near. 309

**No** blame shall lie upon you this day. 309

**No** one can change the words of God. 327

**O** 'Īsā, I shall give you full reward or cause you to die 529

**O** 'Īsā (Jesus), I shall give you full reward or cause you to die and shall raise you towards Me and

shall clear you of all accusations and calumnies of disbelievers and I shall, grant predominance to your followers over those who disbelieve until 527

**O** 'Īsā (Jesus), I shall soon show you My great Signs 439

**O** My Ahmad, you are My purpose and are with Me. 494, 528

**On** that day truth will come and truthfulness will be laid open and the losers will suffer loss. 309

**Pray** unto Me, I shall answer your prayer. 608

**Proclaim** widely that which you are commanded. 529

**Say:** Allah is the Most Wonderful of all who are wonderful. 434

**Say:** Allah is Wonderful. Such are His acts: He honours whomsoever He wishes. 309

**Say:** All praise belongs to Allah Who has removed from me all matter of grief and has bestowed upon me that which He has not bestowed upon anyone in the world. 435

**Say:** Come, let us call our sons and you call your sons, and we call our women and you call your women, and we call our people and you call your people and then let us pray fervently and call down the curse of Allah on the liars 435

**Say:** Do you wonder at what God does? 434

**Say:** If you love Allah, then come and follow me so that Allah may also love you and forgive you your sins. 528

**Say:** If you love Allah, then come and follow me, so that Allah may

also love you and will furnish you with [His special] light and will bestow upon you a distinction and will include you among those who are helped. 435

**Say:** I have been commissioned and I am the first of the believers. 527

**Say:** This is the grace of my Lord and I shun all kinds of titles. 434

**Say** to them: Come, let both of us call our women, sons, and dear ones, then let us do *mubālahah* and invoke the curse of Allah on those who lie. 308

**Say:** Wait till the end of the term and I am with you among those who wait. 557

**Some** of the people said in their hearts: 'O Allah, will You appoint in the world one who will cause disorder in it?' 308

**Soon** will a son be born to you and grace will come close to you. 309

**Soon** you will be granted a praiseworthy station. 327

**So** that you should warn the people whose ancestors have not been warned. 184

**Stand** up and warn (people about the impending calamities) for you have been commissioned to warn people whose forefathers were not warned and so that the way of the sinners becomes manifest. 434

**Tell** My servants: I have been commissioned and I am the first of the believers. 431

**The** moon of the Prophets will come and your affair will become manifest. 309, 418

**Then** be not one of the doubters. 528, 557

**Then** we created man in the best mould. 545

**The** opponents will fall into prostration and will supplicate: Our Lord forgive us our sins; we were in error. 309

**The** time has come that you should be helped and be made well known in the world. 494, 528

**The** time of victory has arrived and victory is close. 309

**They** are being called from a place far away, that is, have drifted too far. 430

**They** ask you: 'Whence have you obtained this?' 309

**They** have rejected Our Signs and they had already been mocking. 327

**They** have said: 'This is a book full of disbelief and falsehood.' 435

**This** is a blessed book, so arise in deference to its glory and grandeur. 688

**This** is in my praise and this is in praise of my Companions. xxii, 543

**This** is just a lifeless calf from which a mournful bleating emanates. 684

**This** is My praise. 543

**This** is the truth from your Lord. 528, 557

**Those** who enter into a covenant with you enter into a covenant [not with you, but] with Allah. 435

**Those** who have suffered the loss due to ill-will, will also suffer the loss through humiliation and disrespect. 418

**Today** you have an established position of high rank, trustworthiness and strong intellect with us. 528

**To** frustrate the activities of all those who are interfering in this matter, Allah will be your Helper. 327

**Truth** will come and truthfulness will be laid open. 418

**We** are watching from heaven that your heart has turned from the well-wishing of Shaikh Mehr 'Alī towards supplicating for his chastisement. 694

**We** are with you, and shall raise your ranks. 694

**We** created him on the day of promise. 310

**We** have made you Masīh Ibn-e-Maryam [Messiah, son of Mary], so as to perfect My warning for those who have adopted Christianity. 434

**We** shall delay it only for a fixed period. 557

**We** shall destroy her husband (also) as we have destroyed her father and will return her to you. 557

**We** shall grant you success a second time and shall convert your fear into security. 309

**We** shall show them Signs which will cause them to weep and shall send down upon them strange afflictions and extraordinary

diseases and shall make their lives a misery and shall pile up afflictions upon them and no one will be able to help them. 550

**We** shall turn the matter in heaven as you make it turn upon the earth. 694

**Whatever** you did let loose, it was not you but it was Allah who let it loose. 184, 185

**When** He determines upon a thing He directs it to 'Be'; and it is. 434

**When** the promise of God is fulfilled [it will be said]: Is this what you called false or were you blind? 557

**You** are from Me, your secret is My secret, you are My purpose and are with Me. 17

**You** are to Me as My *Tauḥīd* [Oneness] and *Tafrīd* [Uniqueness]. 494, 528

**You** are to Me in such an ultimate nearness of which the people cannot have any knowledge. 494

**You** are with Me and I am with you. 327

**You** are with Me and I am with you and this is known only to those who possess good sense. 309

**You** have a high standing in My presence. 17, 528

**You** have a standing with Me of which people have no notion. 17

**Your** Lord is All-Powerful and does whatever He determines 327, 418

**You** will establish the Law and revive the Faith. 528



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*Index of Revelations of the Promised Messiah (Persian)*

**A** pure drop is needed so that it may become a pearl; How can an impure heart be honoured with a sight of the countenance of the Holy One. 73

**If** you are seeking God, do not commit your heart to the luxuries of the world; For my Beloved loves only those who stay away from all luxury. 73

*Index of Revelations of the Promised Messiah (Urdu)*

**A** Warner came unto the world but the world accepted him not; yet God shall accept him and demonstrate his truthfulness with mighty assaults. 408

**I** confer upon you a Sign of My mercy... 674

**Your** house will be filled with blessings... 677



## *Index of Topics*

### **Abd**

meanings of, in Arabic 160  
'Abdul Ḥaqq Muḥaddith  
*Jāmi'ul-Uṣūl* and *Kitābul-Wafā*  
quoted in *Madārijun-Nubūw-*  
*wat* by, on companionship  
of angels with Holy Prophet  
121–123

### **'Abdullah Ghaznavi**

dream of, 659  
in dream of Promised Messiah  
557  
story of disciple of, 662

### **Abraham**

disposition of, 405  
had many wives 324  
Holy Prophet most resembles,  
398  
Jesus has joined with, 436  
Messiah joined in ranks of, 316  
misconstrued as lying by some  
people 598  
spoke in metaphors 480  
vision of sacrificing his son 475  
words 'change the threshold of  
your door' 480

### **Acceptance**

of prayer 571  
of prayers as method for settling  
religious controversy 316

### **Adam**

creation of, 546  
Promised Messiah appointed as,  
599

### **Agriculture**

by Promised Messiah's father 520

### **Ahl-e-Hadith**

advise of Promised Messiah to,  
about 'descent' of Jesus 465

### **Ahmad Baig**

denial of Promised Messiah's  
letter 555  
letter of Promised Messiah to,  
553  
restlessness of, 551  
seized by Allah 555

### **Ahmad Baig, Mirza**

death of, 320  
prophecy about, and its fulfill-  
ment 319–320, 329, 356,  
367–368

### **Ahmadiyya Muslim Community**

admonitions to, 1  
companions of Holy Prophet  
and, 1  
confronted with opposition of all  
nations 655  
divine favour and protection for,  
70

### **Ahmad, Mirza Ghulam. *see* Prom- ised Messiah**

### **Ā'ina-e-Kamālāt-e-Islām**

completion of argument in, 380  
dream about Holy Prophet hold-  
ing book, 252  
in vision 543  
permission for publishing of  
*mubāhalah* in, 380

### **'Alī ibn Abi Talib**

vision about, 543

### **Allah**

all particles and heavenly bodies  
in service of, 170  
all processes of creation of, are  
evolutionary 236  
always keeps His promise 533  
appointed Promised Messiah at  
crucial time 539

- assurance of, to Jesus about natural death and elevation 60  
 beauty and beneficence of, 153–154  
 beauty of, 155, 156  
 being elect of, means acceptance of one's prayers by God 449  
 benevolence and intervention for His helpers 3  
 brought people together through telegraph 487  
 chooses man from amongst His men 531  
 chose Promised Messiah to reform His religion 547  
 cognition of, only attainable through knowledge granted to steadfast 289  
 comfort attained by communion with, 41  
 commanded Promised Messiah to demand hand of Ahmad Baig's elder daughter 553  
 compassion of, upon Promised Messiah's prayer 549  
 conceals or reveals whatsoever is appropriate 463  
 conferred upon Promised Messiah true friend 563  
 confers mysteries upon virtuous 65  
 conversation with, 265, 269  
 couplets about thankfulness and praise for, 703  
 cured hearts of believers with truth 531  
 deliverance from all besides, 161  
 describes heaven as very refined substance 224  
 devoting one's life to cause of, 79  
 devotion to, 79  
 disclosed reality of descent of Messiah 531  
 discourse with, 266  
 divine decrees executed through law of nature 229  
 doctrine of Oneness of, 537  
 does He need angels 170  
 dream of Promised Messiah that, will send His help 561  
 endless excellences placed in Quran by, 57  
 exchanged fear with peace and security 506  
 experiences of conversation with, during afflictions 269  
 faith in, reliance on understanding of His Book 55  
 favours of, 489  
 favours of, upon Holy Prophet 31  
 forgiveness of, for followers of Holy Prophet 161  
 grandeur and greatness of, should permeate believers' hearts 153–154  
 granted treasures of world 489  
 has different ways of disclosing unseen 474  
 has facilitated invention of printing machines 488  
 has given Promised Messiah glad tidings 557  
 has granted us treasures of world 489  
 has increased disease in hearts of innovator mystics 446  
 has not left atmosphere as empty space 222  
 has singled out Promised Messiah to deduce verities of Noble Quran 104  
 hatred of people towards message of, 3  
 helped His Prophets according to needs of time 57

- human beings created for recognition and obedience of, 78
- in praise of Holy Prophet 149
- interference in His person, attributes, words, or works 61
- is enemy of impostor, 417
- light of, reflected in Holy Prophet 39
- love of,
  - requires staying away from all luxury 73
- love of, cannot be concealed 5
- love of, is panacea for thousand ailments 5
- love of, panacea for a thousand ailments 5
- love of, proud and haughty cannot attain 73
- love of, requires studying His Word 425
- made life of Noor-ud-Deen
  - source of help for Islam 568
- matchless wonders placed in
  - Quran by, 55
- men of, 89
- mercy of, 67, 159
- miracles of, 87
- Most Merciful of those who show mercy 70
- nearness to, attained by Holy Prophet 31
- need to be convinced of existence and wisdom of, 195
- non-acceptance of men of, in their time 51
- obedience of Muslims to, 78
- obedience to, in all due obligations 80
- Oneness of, 536
- Oneness of, emphasized in Quran 62
- one should belong solely to, 78
- only friend of Promised Messiah 572
- physical and spiritual systems are created by, for man's protection and welfare 180
- Promised Messiah appointed by, 496
- Promised Messiah has come from, with wisdom and insight 485
- Promised Messiah's love for, 5
- Promised Messiah's vision about, 544
- promises of, 226
- promises of, not uttered casually 227
- regulates everything 170
- relationship of Promised Messiah with, 52
- revival of dead world by, 161
- reward for spending in way of, 2
- right of, supersedes all other rights 603
- risks of admitting partner in attributes of, 62
- Seal of Prophets praised by, 575
- seals placed on hearts of heedless to, 65
- seek settlement from, 315
- sees hearts of His servants 444
- service to creatures of, 80
- showed number of enemies to be small in dream of His Prophet 474
- signs of, being rejected 492
- signs of latter days revealed by, in Holy Quran, 485
- some attributes of, 70
- sufficient as witness for Promised Messiah 455
- support for Promised Messiah 53
- supports only His servant 452

three categories of favoured servants of, 127  
 Throne of, 224  
 transgressors do not fear, 483  
 true seeker of, becomes perfectly established on Islam 264  
 true seekers of, have protection from darkness 55  
 understanding essence of individuality vs. uniqueness of, 62  
 unity and appropriateness between external and spiritual systems created by, 196  
 unity and symmetry in works of, 170  
 unveils all aspects of prophecy at appointed time 532  
 why does, employ angels to implement His designs 170  
 why, has limited number of heavens to seven 227  
 will disgrace and humiliate transgressors 466  
 will inevitably break up created universe 225  
 will of, 3  
 will of, to return Islam's power and glory 3  
 wills to support His religion 458  
 wisdom of, in entire physical system 193  
 wisdom of seeking refuge in, 5  
 wondrous acts of, 490  
 word of, affirms stars swim in heavenly spheres 221  
 would not forgive idol-worshippers without belief 161  
 would revive Islam 526  
 wrath of, fell upon Sikhs 502  
 wrath of, on depravity of Christians 462

### **America**

converts of, and Europe 631

### **Ancestors**

of Promised Messiah 497, 499, 518

### **Angels**

all heavenly bodies are under protection of, 165  
 are spirit of life for stars and heavenly faculties 202  
 are visible but with spiritual eyes 214  
 descent and ascent of, 441  
 Divine attributes imitated by, 442  
 do not leave their appointed station 172–174  
 do what they are commanded 171  
 easiest way to accept existence of, 195  
 everything denoted by *Nafs* has safeguarding angel 165  
 existence of, 103  
 faculties of stars derive grace from, 202  
 have same relation to bodies as spiritual faculties to human body 213  
 influences of, 228  
 meanings of ascent and descent of, 172  
 move around without leaving their station 442  
 moved by prayers of Holy Prophet 34  
 no space in heavens is empty of, in prostration 174  
 obtain grace from Allah's side and convey to His creation 210  
 personal animosity between, and Satan 193  
 phenomena of falling stars takes place through agency of, 195

- protect man from every type of evil 99  
 role of, in everything that happens 198
- Annihilation**  
 of previous existence 266
- Announcement**  
 of *mubāhalah* 307
- Annual Convention**  
 aims of this, 631
- Antichrist**  
 character of Christians as, 400  
 foundation of, laid by poisonous doctrines in Christianity 275  
 reality of, 533  
 time of, 302  
 true nature of, 530
- Apostasy**  
*maulawīs* would pronounce edicts of, against Mahdi 254  
 gravity of wanton edicts of, 353
- Arabia**  
 message to brethren of, 495
- Arabian Peninsula**  
 condition of people of, 246
- Arabic**  
 grammar and its metaphors 535  
 Holy Quran revealed in, 424  
 importance of learning, 424
- Arabs**  
 are best party of Islam 459
- Arbiter**  
 Allah has sent Promised Messiah as, 539  
 sent by Allah to reveal secret of prophecy 464
- Arguments**  
 300 formidable and sound, based on reason 698  
 Allah has helped Promised Messiah with, and reasoning 557
- Arrogance**  
 invariably predicated upon falsehood 600
- Aryah**  
 have spent their lives like slaves and servants 515  
 invitation to, 317  
 of India 515
- Ascetics**  
 resemblance to Hindu Yogis 65
- Astronomy**  
 not in conflict with Holy Quran 221
- Atheism**  
 spread of, in present age 69
- Attributes**  
 destructive and gentle, 229
- Auliya'**  
 incurred fatwas of disbelief but still had devoted followers 662  
 light placed on all senses of, 153
- Babar, Emperor**  
 among those who honoured and respected nobles 498  
 honoured ancestors of Promised Messiah 498  
 remained righteous despite glory and prosperity 498  
 tread in ways of goodness 498
- Bai'at (Pledge of Allegiance)**  
 people suddenly manifest holy transformation in their behaviour after taking, 604
- Baqā**  
 and liqā 166  
 condition of, 90  
 defined 82  
 stage of, 239
- Barāhīn-e-Aḥmadiyya 543**  
 compilation of book named, 697  
 delay in publication of, 349  
 prophecy of victory recorded in, 407

unique book of its kind 523  
will address further objections  
in, 240

### **Bashir**

glad tidings of son whose name  
would be, 558  
glad tidings of son whose name  
would be Emmanuel and, 675

### **Batālawī, Muhammad Ḥusain 105**

accusations of, against Promised  
Messiah 597  
and Dehlawī 107  
arrogance of, 600  
challenge to, to prove his truth-  
fulness 344  
contradictions in letter of, 334  
edict alleging disbelief by, 331  
fatwa of disbelief from, 645  
fight of, with God Almighty 350  
hastiness in using foul epithets  
49  
invitation to, for competition  
based on true dreams 336  
is liar 604  
mischievous propaganda of, 48  
objection against, 598  
pain to Promised Messiah caused  
by, 337  
patient endurance by Promised  
Messiah of, 351  
prophecy of humiliation for, 337  
revelations of Promised Messiah  
concerning, 608  
role in declaring Promised Messi-  
ah disbeliever 49  
sign of, being liar and *dajjāl* 605  
similarity of, with Abū Jahl and  
Abū Lahab 350  
sympathy of Promised Messiah  
for, 331, 353  
warring and disputing spirit of,  
332, 335

worst instigator of propaganda  
against Promised Messiah 49

### **Battle of Badr**

spiritual power of Holy Prophet  
shown during, 85

### **Beasts**

gathering together of, 489

### **Beliefs**

reality of heaven, hell, resurrec-  
tion, and miracles 443

### **Believers**

glad tidings for steadfast, 109  
if righteous, are granted distinc-  
tion over others 339  
tested during calamities 340–342

### **Bible**

disciples of Ḥaḍrat Masīḥ in, 245  
polygamy according to, 323

### **Birth**

blessings with, of Promised Mes-  
siah 520

### **Body**

dead, brought to life 525

### **Book(s)**

*Ā'īna-e-Kamālāt-e-Islām* in vision  
543  
every, besides Holy Qurān is  
defective creation 522  
of Ḥaḍrat Maulawī Noor-ud-  
Deen 565, 568  
of Promised Messiah called  
Qutbī 525  
written by opponents hurling  
abuses at Holy Prophet and  
Holy Qurān 548

### **Boy**

handsome and pure, will be  
bestowed 675

### **British**

blessed times under, 506

### **British Empire**

built educational institutes 507



- gave complete religious freedom 507
- gave freedom to preach Islam 507
- Promised Messiah's gratitude towards, 505, 507
- wish for our beneficent, 671
- Building**
- vision about, 542
- Calamity**
- couplets of prayer for aversion of, 3
- of conversion to Christianity by many Muslims 58
- of latter days prophesied 69
- truthfulness tested in, 340–342
- Captain**
- God is the, of Islam 299
- Chain**
- made of deceptive ideas 533
- Chieftains**
- ancestors of Promised Messiah were, 518
- Chosen People**
- three groups of, 127
- Christianity**
- enormous efforts to spread, in this age 404
- to break prevalence of, as task for Promised Messiah 395
- Christian(s)**
- absurd for, to say Messiah had spiritual resurrection 259
- aggressive spreading of corrupt beliefs by, 404
- antichrist character of, philosophers and scientists 400
- debate with Hindus and, 523
- deceptive fabrications of, have encompassed whole earth 476
- dominance and fallacious dogmas of, 468
- gone astray 491
- have fully assumed qualities of *Dajjāl* 398
- invitation and challenge to, clerics 316–317
- invitation to, clerics 316
- Salvation Army of, going about in all countries 404
- Clay**
- created man from, 231
- Clerics**
- evils of, prophesied in Holy Quran 488
- invitation to Christian, 316
- Promised Messiah's exhortations to, 494
- Comets and meteors**
- doubts in various theories regarding, 188
- Companions (of Holy Prophet)**
- believed that no word or action was devoid of element of revelation 118
- believed without demanding Sign 387–388
- best followers of sunnah 625
- group will develop similarity with, 248
- harmony and brotherhood attained by, 1
- held views that differed greatly from each other 276, 277
- included details of domestic life of Holy Prophet in *ahādīth* 118
- regarded all words and actions of the Holy Prophet as binding religious obligation 125
- Compassion**
- Allah's, aroused 549
- plea to cultivate, for plight of Islam 1

**Compulsion**

upon one's self for sake of God  
Almighty 130

**Convention**

proceedings of, 629

**Conversation**

with Allah 265, 269

**Converts**

of America and Europe 631

**Couplets**

eulogy in tribute of Holy Prophet  
679  
thankfulness and praise for Glori-  
ous Lord 703  
written by Maulawī Muhammad  
'Abdullah Khan 667

**Creation**

all processes of God's, are evolu-  
tionary 236  
six stages are not limited to phys-  
ical, 236  
six stages of, 232  
stages of, 230

**Creatures**

service to God's, is one aspect of  
devoting one's life to God 80

**Cross**

Promised Messiah shall break,  
310, 437, 469, 481

**Curse**

of Allah on disobedient and  
transgressors 549

**Dāfi'ul Wasāwis**

current book also named, xvii, 45  
issued public announcements to  
opponents inside, 407  
written to show beauty of Islam  
to opponents 524

**Dajjāl**

*Dajjāl*-like behaviour 69  
appearance of, 481, 536  
appearance of, in latter days 255

are Christian missionaries who  
confuse truth with falsehood  
481

baseless opinions about, 535  
correct interpretation of aḥādīth  
about claims of, 400  
evil intentions of, 476  
explanation of notion that, would  
first claim prophethood then  
Divinity 400–401  
false belief about, 536  
hypothetical and whimsical, 310  
influence of alleged, 665  
manifestation of abstruse phe-  
nomenon of world 492  
meanings of, 492, 533  
mention in Islamic eschatology  
69  
misconceptions about, 482, 535  
none else than powerful Chris-  
tian nations of latter days 311  
Promised Messiah will appear in  
time of, 481  
reality of, 533, 536  
spread and influence in present  
times 69  
term misapplied by critics 48  
usage of, in singular form 533  
word, means group of people 400

**Ḍāll**

meaning of, 149

**Damascus**

meaning of, 479  
minaret east of, 480

**Daughters**

Ahmad Baig did not give, in mar-  
riage for five years 555

**David**

polygamy of, 323

**Dayanand, Pundit**

response to his critique about  
angels 171

**Day of Judgment**

- behaviour of *maulawīs* reminder of, 612
- intercession by Holy Prophet on, 32
- major Signs of nearness of, 611
- message of Quran extends to, 57
- will reveal who is a Muslim or not 42

**Days**

- why six, 228, 230

**Death**

- four kinds of, 245
- of Ahmad Baig 553, 555
- of all kinds found in Christianity 245
- of Jesus 529

**Debate**

- with Hindus and Christian priests 523

**Decrees**

- Divine, 229

**Denial**

- habit of, akin to wilderness 540

**Descent**

- from heavens 228
- of Jesus 530
- of Messiah is spiritual matter 531
- secret of Jesus' 530

**Dihiyah Kalbi**

- appearance of Gabriel in form of, 123

**Disbelief**

- death of, 245

**Disciples of Jesus**

- asked for Sign but repented 410
- cowardice and infidelity in, 244

**Disgrace**

- for those who have denied, or are only ready to deny 409

**Disorder**

- when, takes root in world 531

**Divine Discourse 517**

- discourse 517
- loftiest gift from God 265
- objectives of, 266

**Divine Practice**

- consistency across history 56
- response to temporal needs 56

**Divine Punishment**

- prophecy published regarding, for Lekh Ram 684

**Divinity**

- people being called to, of Jesus 531

**Doctrine**

- baseless, is born out of misunderstanding 533
- taught to Promised Messiah by Allah 538

**Donation**

- appeal for, 655

**Dream(s)**

- element of subjective judgement in interpretations of, 347
- of 'Abdullah Ghaznavi 659
- of Promised Messiah 541, 542
- of Promised Messiah after writing ode in praise of Holy Prophet 251
- of Promised Messiah holding sword 557
- Promised Messiah interpreted, in detail 561
- Promised Messiah's, about Ḥaḍrat 'Alī 253
- that God Almighty would send His help 561
- that Holy Prophet nurtured Promised Messiah 526
- that Promised Messiah saddled his horse 559
- true, 524

**Dukhān**

- use of word, in Holy Quran 534

**Earth(s)**

- closed up then Allah opened, 491
- create new, 545
- heaven and, of spirit 234
- heavens and, in six days 230
- meaning of seven, 228
- multiplication of innovations in, 451
- seven, brought into being 227
- shaking of, 488
- wonders of, 491

**Edicts of Apostasy**

- gravity of, 276
- prevalence of, among *Ahl-e-Sunnah wal Jamā'ah* 276

**Edicts of disbelief**

- evil of ulema declaring a believer a *kāfir* 50

**Education**

- at time of British Empire 507
- promotion of, through educational institutes 507

**Efforts**

- baqā* and *liqā* not achieved through one's own, 91

**Egypt**

- message to brethren of, 495

**Emmanuel**

- glad tidings of son whose name would be, and Bashir 558, 675

**Empress of India**

- favours of, 508
- invitation to Islam by Promised Messiah 510, 512
- Muslims are special aide of, 513
- Promised Messiah's gratitude towards, 505
- Promised Messiah's high praise for, 509
- Promised Messiah's prayer for, 505, 509

**Enemy**

- Ahmad Baig became, of Promised Messiah 555

**Engines**

- industry of train, 489

**Europe**

- appropriate proposals shall be de-liberated upon for progress of converts of America and, 631

**Europeans**

- have taught industry of train engines 489

**Everlasting Life**

- is through service 2

**Evil**

- most people running towards, 489

**Evolution**

- all processes of God's creation are based upon, 236
- process of, 230

**Existence of God**

- inadequacy of intellectual arguments for, 292

**Experience**

- or observation furnishes most frequent form of proof in this world 223

**Eyes**

- not necessary that all things be visible to our, 224

**Faij-e-A'waj**

- characteristics of, 250
- defined 249
- hadith about, 254

**Faith**

- a ladder to attain cognition of God Almighty 294
- Allah always helps, in accordance with needs of time 56
- all reward established due to, 384
- consequences of not serving, 2

- difference between science and, 390  
 dignity and honour attained through sympathy of, 1  
 essence of, 77  
 establishment of, 55  
 fountain of life in darkness 3  
 freedom to preach, under British Empire 507  
 heedlessness and carelessness of people towards, 3  
 heightened challenges to, in these modern times 55  
 helpers of, 3  
 honour attained by sympathy for, 1  
 implications of uninformed beliefs 55  
 is accepting while some aspects are still hidden 386–389  
 Islam not dead, 271  
 light of, 541  
 limits of due inquiries of, 384  
 miracles brought forth by, 305  
 philosophy of, 293  
 pleasure of God Almighty as result of, 384  
 proves existence of God 305  
 real meaning of, 390  
 righteousness is necessity for understanding, 3  
 strengthening, through struggle 1  
 strength of, 250
- Family**  
 grieving, of Ahmad Baig feels ashamed 556  
 incidents from, of Promised Messiah 546
- Fanā (Self-Annihilation)**  
 defined 82  
 effort and struggle terminates at stage of, 91  
 stage of, 239
- Fath-e-Islām**  
 purpose and content of, 47  
 response to, 47  
 treatise in support of Islam 47  
 verities of Quran discussed in, 47
- Father**  
 of Promised Messiah 519, 521
- Fatwa(s)**  
 accusation against Promised Messiah by Miyān Nadhīr Ḥusain Dehlawī 48  
 against Promised Messiah 48  
 errors of judgement in, 49  
 misuse and errors in, 49  
 of *takfir* 539
- Foetus**  
 completion of human, 233
- Friendship**  
 characteristics of true, 5
- Fruit**  
 honey began to pour out of, in dream 525
- Furqān (The Holy Quran).** *see*
- Glad Tidings**  
 of son 558
- Glittering Star**  
 introduction to, 165
- God.** *see* **Allah**
- Gog and Magog**  
 appearance of, 481  
 Promised Messiah will appear in time of, 481
- Gospel**  
 claim of Jesus in, 243
- Government**  
 of Queen 505
- Grain of barley**  
 example of wonders of Allah's creation 56
- Grammar**  
 Arabic, and its metaphors 535

**Greeks**

theory of heavens falsified by  
observation 222  
what, considered heavens to be  
221

**Hadith**

books of, 538  
coming of Promised Messiah  
in, 4  
conflict of ulema with book of  
Allah and *ahādīth* 50  
death of Jesus in, 465  
Holy Prophet's life to be half of  
Jesus's life 465  
how righteous people attain high  
ranks 546  
Mahdi would be born, 403  
man of Persian descent in Latter  
Days 255  
on fixing date for religious knowl-  
edge 618  
on wrapping up of heavens 226  
reformer of Ummah to be raised  
at head of every century 4  
regarding knowledge 613  
regarding worst of all creation  
611  
tribulations in Islam 69  
ulema called scholars of, 125  
ultimate calamity mentioned in  
Quran and, 69

**Ḥaḍrat 'Alī**

dream about, 253

**Ḥaḍrat 'Īsā**

glad tiding of spiritual resurrec-  
tion and life 243  
promotion of truth about  
Oneness of God by, vs. other  
prophets 243

**Ḥaḍrat Khātāmūl Anbiyā'**

claim of, 257

**Ḥāfiẓ of Shiraz**

couplet on man's acceptance of  
trust 151  
on his intensity of love for Allah  
151

**Ḥassān bin Thābit**

Holy Prophet's prayer for, 111

**Haughtiness**

first sin that eternally destroyed  
someone 599

**Heart**

Holy Spirit in human, 92  
of stone could be turned into, of  
flesh 571

**Heaven**

starts in this very world 78

**Heavenly Decree**

certain to be fulfilled 2

**Heaven(s)**

according to Holy Quran, and all  
that is in, can be cut asunder  
224  
account of, in Holy Quran cor-  
rect and valid 222  
and earth made in six days 230  
and earth of spirit 234  
closed up then Allah opened 491  
create new, 545  
God Almighty describes, as very  
refined substance 224  
meaning of seven, 227  
soft and dense like air or water  
221  
substance of, 221  
tearing asunder of, 225  
why we cannot see 224  
words in Holy Quran point  
towards ultimate annihilation  
of material universe 225  
wrong to circumscribe, like  
Greeks 223  
wrong to say, are mere vacuum  
devoid of any substance 223

**Heedlessness**

death of, 245

**Hell**

fever suffered by believers is type of, 132

**Helpers of Faith**

aversion of calamities for those who are, helpers of God 3  
prayers for, 3  
Promised Messiah's prayer for, 3

**Help (to Promised Messiah)**

dream that God Almighty will send His, 561  
from heavens and earth 546

**Hereafter**

complete and perfect detachment in, 137

**Hijaj-ul-Kirāmah**

on edicts of apostasy by *maulawīs* of latter days 254  
three periods for Muslim ummah stated in, 250

**Hindu(s)**

debate with, and Christians 523  
have spent their lives like slaves and servants 515

**Hindu Yogis**

influence of, on Muslim ascetics 65

**Holy Men**

of past acquire relationship with those living at present 275

**Holy Spirit**

*ahādith* quoted by Ibn-e-Jarīr, 'Ikrimah, Mujahid, Uthman bin 'Affan, and Imam Ahmad 99  
always present for protection of man 97  
and Ḥaḍrat 'Īsā 113  
bounty of, proven on Muslims' side 324  
causes dissemination of light 96

constant companionship of, with

Holy Prophet 166

defined as magnificent light

descending upon meeting of human and divine love 166

departure of, breeds misguidance and evil thoughts 96–97

descends upon imperfect people in imperfect way 167

enlivens heart and delivers from spiritual death 163

functions of, 111

general support of, enjoyed by all according to degree of sincerity 166

granted to perfect believers for all time 108

never separated himself from Holy Prophet 96

not necessary to show, to every dark-hearted person 103

not possible for the godly to be separated from the influences of, 173

other name for Gabriel 104

outrageous belief of Christians about, 96

perfect and permanent companion of virtuous people 99

perfect descent of, at stages of *baqā* and *liqā* 166

permeation of, in men of God 265

prayer of Holy Prophet for

Ḥassān bin Thābit for, 112

prevents Satan from overpowering the elect 97

Promised Messiah's experience with, 175

puts holy thoughts in heart 167

reason for name of, 109

support of, 257

**Honey**

began to pour out of fruit 525

**Honour**

attained by sympathy for Faith 1

**Horse**

dream in which Promised Messiah saddled his, 559

**Human Beings**

completion of foetus of, 233  
six stages in relation to creation of every, 231

**Humanity**

Holy Prophet's pathos and prayers for, 34

**Human Rights**

emphasis in Quran for, 57  
universal application and guidance 57

**Humility**

of recipient of revelation 269  
relationship of one who has, with divine grace and converse and prayers 269

**Iblis and Satan**

appointed as part of entire spiritual system 167  
touch of, and of angels equally bestowed upon man as 'test' 168

**Idol worship**

prevailing darkness of, 39

**Imam Ḥusain**

continued pattern of conduct of ulema from time of, 51

**Imams**

acquittal of previous pious guides and, 51

**Incidents**

about family of Promised Messiah 546

**Indarman**

avoided proposal to publish prophecy against Promised Messiah 683

**Industry**

Europeans have taught, 489

**Infidelity**

act of hiding Divine love is, 5

**Innovation(s)**

explanation of, 620  
meaning of, 624  
planning and management cannot be inserted under, 624

**Insults**

inflicted upon Islam and Holy Prophet 68

**Intention**

power of, 229

**Inventions**

new, being made today 230

**‘Īsā, Ḥaḍrat**

advise of Promised Messiah to Ahl-e-Hadith about 'descent' of, 465  
birds of, 88  
claim of, in Gospel 243  
contrast between Holy Prophet's death and life of, 59  
death confirmed in Holy Quran 529  
death of, discussed in Jalsa 630  
exaggeration in praise of, 531  
gave glad tidings of Ahmad to, 59  
God's promise to, about natural death and elevating him 60  
hadith about death of, 465  
has died 58, 59, 443, 529  
historical records of shooting stars after arrest of Ḥaḍrat Masīḥ 186  
Holy Prophet's superiority over, 75  
Holy Prophet's twelve arguments about death of, 64  
implications of survival of, 59  
mystery regarding descent of, 470



- physical descent of, is vain desire 630
- power of spiritual healing of, 57
- predictions and prophecies about, 64
- Quran indicates death of, and the advent of Muhammad 61
- second coming of, 530
- status of his life according to Islam 64
- testimony of, in Holy Quran 59
- Islam**
- 3,000 objections against, 54
- age of victory of, 295
- Allah Almighty would revive, 526
- Allah commanded Promised Messiah to invite His creation to, 547
- Allah made life of Noor-ud-Deen source of help for, 568
- alone is the true faith 316
- as illumination of heart 159
- call of, 1
- challenges and tribulations falling upon, 274
- character of ulema of, foretold by the Holy Prophet Muhammad 51
- compassion for plight of, 1
- criticisms on, from everywhere 54
- current state of, 484, 493
- depth and richness of, 71
- difficulties of current age regarding, 64
- disputes concerning, should be settled according to Islamic law 507
- elaboration of fruits of, 264
- essence of, 79
- essence of, and its attainment 81
- following Holy Prophet to attain reality of, 145
- freedom to call people to, under British Empire 507
- grandeur and wealth of, by following Holy Prophet 72
- habit of ulema to expel people from the pale of, 51
- harm to, due to misconceptions of Jesus being alive 63
- has become like a fruitless dry branch 484
- help of Allah for, 64
- Holy Prophet is perfect model of, 143
- ignorance and obliviousness of present day ulema is challenge facing, 64
- ignorance of present day ulema to crisis in, 64
- implications for, and modern challenges 55
- invitation to Queen to, 510, 512
- kingdom of, has nothing to fear from assaults of philosophy and science 295
- large portion of teachings shifted away from, 58
- light of essence of, granted to true followers of Holy Prophet 159
- literal meanings of, 77
- magnificence of reality of, 80
- manifestations of divine guidance are fruits of, 264
- misuse and errors in fatwas regarding, 49
- no appropriate arrangement for serving, can be labelled as innovation 620
- Noor-ud-Deen one of great scholars of, 564
- not a dead faith 271

now going through precarious period 621  
 one should use all power to propagate message of, 619  
 opponents of, laden with criticisms and misgivings 54  
 people captivated by superficial looks cannot recognize, 71  
 plight of, in our times 301  
 possesses praiseworthy features with unmatched perfection 315  
 preaching of, under rule of Queen 508  
 present-day *maulawīs* belief of, not consistent with righteous elders of Islam 116  
 Promised Messiah issued invitations to, for opponents 664  
 Promised Messiah raised to show beauty of, 74  
 proposals for promoting, in Europe and America presented at Jalsa 631  
 reality of, 77  
 return of power and glory for, 3  
 revealed to Holy Prophet for people of perfect capabilities 164  
 sciences of, 507  
 some have maligned, through innovations 65  
 split into sects 485  
 state of rule of, 498  
 subjected to calamities by opponents 493  
 target of objections from all fields of life 54  
 technical meanings of, 77  
 time when, needs help from heavens 274  
 treatises in support of, 47  
 true visions and revelations are fruits of, 264

truth of religion of, in two ways 697

two ways to arrive at essence of, 154–156

victory of, requires sacrifices 2  
 violation of, principles through inappropriate fatwas 49

### **Islam, Opponents of**

laden with criticisms and misgivings 54

### **Islampur**

popularly known as Qadian 497

### **Israelite prophets**

practice of most, 323

### **Istikhārah**

should be conducted with a peaceful mind 412  
 should be free from sentiments of love or hostility 411  
 should be with peaceful mind with heart turned entirely towards God 412  
 suggestion of Nawwab Muhammad 'Ali Khan for, 375  
 undertaken by Promised Messiah 326

### **Izāla-e-Auhām**

purpose and content of, 47  
 response to, 47  
 treatise in support of Islam 47

### **Jalsa Salana**

75 friends attended first, 645  
 aims of, 631  
 invitations to Mir Nasir Nawwab to attend, 421  
 major purpose of, 612  
 of 1892 629  
 points of speech of Promised Messiah at, 630  
 proceedings of, 657  
 proposals for printing press presented at, 631

- proposals for promoting Islam in Europe and America presented at, 631
- reason why specific date has been fixed for, 618
- Jama'at**  
solitary individual would grow into, 256
- Jesus Christ.** *see* 'Īsā, Ḥaḍrat
- Jews**  
addressed in Holy Quran for their behaviour towards Messengers of Allah 51
- likeness between ulema and, 51
- Jibrā'il (Gabriel), Ḥaḍrat**  
belief that Holy Spirit is name of, 94
- constant and close companion of, with Holy Prophet 171
- descent of, is not physical, but metaphoric 122
- explanation of implications of 600 wings of, 162
- gave permanent companionship to Holy Prophet after Ḥaḍrat Isrāfil 121, 171
- seen in his real self on two occasions by Holy Prophet 124
- Shaikh 'Abdul Ḥaqq believed, did not descend physically 123
- six hundred wings of, 162
- views of Sayyed Ahmad Khan, about 279
- Jinn**  
proof of existence of, and angels 102
- Journey**  
many meritorious objectives for, 615
- Jouzehr**  
name of layer of sky according to Greeks 221
- Judgement**  
consequences of hasty, of ulema 50
- Kāfir (Disbeliever)**  
accusations and labels of being, 50
- declaration of, a serious issue 50
- definition of, 50
- he who gives name, to Muslim 276
- those who do not desist from calling Promised Messiah, 276
- Kalimah**  
ulema label one a disbeliever despite adherence to, 49
- Karamat 268**  
defined as acceptance of believer's prayer 271
- Kashmir**  
Promised Messiah's father betook himself to, 519
- Khālsah**  
an offshoot from idolaters 500
- Khilāfat**  
dream about group of Khawārij opposing, of Promised Messiah 253
- Kindness**  
Allah will give Promised Messiah, 557
- of Noor-ud-Deen 568
- Kingdom**  
prayer for, of Queen 505
- Kingdom of Heaven**  
granted to Promised Messiah 311
- sojourn in, through Islam 272
- Kings**  
God will put love of Promised Messiah in hearts of, 678

**Knowledge**

branches of, studied by Promised Messiah 521  
 God's, and perfect wisdom envelopes everything 227  
 granted through Holy Spirit 163–166  
 of greatness of God is greatest wisdom 162–164

**Kufr**

this age immersed in, 273

**Land**

Ahmad Baig's wife seeking consent of Promised Messiah for, 551

**Landowners**

ancestors of Promised Messiah were, 518

**Latter Days**

calamity of, 69  
 hadith about man of Persian descent in, 255  
 Messiah will come in, 491  
 signs of, in Holy Quran 485  
 sincere and perfect servants of God appearing in, 248, 250  
 vision of Promised Messiah about another period of Christians' mischief 396  
 would resemble early age of Islam 249

**Law**

just, of Queen 508  
 no variation in eternal, of nature 68

**Lekh Ram**

accepted proposal to publish prophecy against himself 683  
 books of, filled with shocking variety of insults 684  
 lack of qualifications of, 685  
 prophecy regarding, 683, 684

**Letter(s)**

of Promised Messiah to Ahmad Baig 553  
 published in Nūr Afshān 325  
 written to well-known opponents 258

**Life**

account of, of Promised Messiah 497  
 contrast between true pleasant, and punishment 53  
 dead body brought to, 525  
 definition of happy, 53  
 devoting one's, in cause of God 79  
 everlasting, attained through striving in service 2  
 of Promised Messiah 518  
 Promised Messiah given gift of, 563

**Light**

granted to righteous 153  
 of faith 541

**Linguists**

Allah has made Promised Messiah dominant over versatile, 575

**Liqā**

as ultimate stage of spiritual progress. 91  
 condition of, 90  
 defined 83  
 perfect attainment of grade of, 83  
 what is, 82

**Love**

nurturing of, 71  
 perfect degree of, generated by beauty and beneficence 155–156  
 Promised Messiah's, for Allah 5

**Love of Allah**

descends upon human love at stage of *baqā* and *liqā* 166

**Lūṭ, (Lot) Ḥaḍrat**

raining of stones upon people of, 323

**Ma'ālim**

on Holy Spirit 99

**Madārij-un-Nubūwwat**

by 'Abdul Ḥaqq Muhaddith, quoted, 121–123

**Madir**

name of layer of sky according to Greeks 221

**Mahdi**

*maualwīs* would pronounce edict of apostasy against, 254  
descent of, not limited to just one individual 403  
hadith about, 255, 403

**Mahjūb**

defined 105

**Mail**

abundance of, 488

**Makkan Disbelievers**

demands of, for Signs not accepted 410

**Man**

Allah chooses, for sake of His Prophet 531  
created, from clay 231  
created, from dust 545  
passes through six stages of development 232  
process for birth of, 231

**Marriage**

Promised Messiah's proposal for, to daughter of Ahmad Baig 553, 555  
prophecy about, 319

**Mary, Mother of Jesus**

death of, mentioned in Quran 63

**Masīḥ. see Messiah****Maulawī 'Abdul Karim**

proposal for writing letter in Arabic 423

**Maulawīs**

after meeting Promised Messiah even, become humble 661  
conflict of, with Book of Allah and *aḥādīth* 51  
degenerate behaviour of, is reminder of Day of Judgment 612  
disrespect of Holy Prophet by, 116  
hadith about, 611  
lack of insight of, 664  
many mischievous writings of, have given ample help to Christians 622  
obstacles placed by, 665  
of this age declared as worst of creation 344  
quick to pronounce edicts of disbelief 48  
role in opposition of Promised Messiah 48  
would be worst of all people 254

**Men of God**

characteristics of, at their loftiest level 265  
everything associated with, is blessed 89  
must have passionate devotion to Holy Quran 425  
transformation brought about by, 273

**Message**

Promised Messiah delivered, of Allah 550

**Messenger(s) of Allah**

high rank of, 159  
pride of, 517

**Messiah**

- descent of, 490
- descent of, is spiritual matter 531
- divine secret of descent of, 452
- falsehoods attributed to, in this age 395–396
- glad tidings of son who will be given breath of, 558
- indecent accusations of Jews upon, 396
- Jesus the, has died 529
- prophecy about descent of, may be trial 479
- prophecy of descent of, as Arbiter and Judge 465
- reason for giving name, to Reformer of this Age 275
- reason for spiritual descent of, in this age 275
- revelation about, son of Mary 528
- shall acquire knowledge from heavens 454
- signs of appearance of, have appeared 483
- spirituality of, to descend into the world three times 403
- teachings of, 244
- two occasions of outpouring of soul of, 395–396
- virtues of Promised, have close similarity and strict analogy to those of Jesus the, 698
- why was, singled out for descent vs. any other Prophet 402
- will come in Latter Days 491
- zealous outpouring of soul of, in this age 402

**Metaphors**

- Arabic grammar and its, 535
- discourse of Prophets wrapped in mantle of, 480
- Word of Allah is full of fine, 225

**Minaret**

- in east of Damascus mentioned in hadith 480
- meaning of, 480

**Miniature Universe**

- embody examples of all that takes place in larger universe 211
- Human beings are, 211

**Miracle(s)**

- endless excellencies of Holy Quran is, 57
- of God 87
- reality of, 571

**Mi'raj**

- Companions disagreed on nature of, 277
- during night of, Holy Prophet did not see dead body of any prophet 622

**Misfortunes**

- inflicted upon Muslims 530

**Misguidance**

- result of weak faith 55

**Moon**

- symbolic representation of illumination and guidance 71

**Morality and Virtues**

- importance of, 65
- loss of, in contemporary ulema 65

**Mubāhalah**

- announcement of, 307
- divine permission to enter into, 276, 309, 407
- Promised Messiah refrained from, earlier 276
- suggestion of Nawwab Muhammad 'Ali Khan for, 374
- text of announcement of, by Promised Messiah 307

**Mughal Empire 498**

kings of, were of same stock as  
ancestors of Promised Messiah  
498

**Muḥaddath**

has capacity of prophet 268  
Promised Messiah was made, 547

**Muhammad ‘Ali Khan, Nawwab**

agreement of, with will of God  
Almighty 380  
letter from, 372  
response to, 379  
suggestion of, to have *mubāhalah*  
374

**Muhammad, Holy Prophet**

3,000 objections against 54  
all words and acts of, emanated  
from revelation 119  
always accompanied by Holy  
Spirit 174–176  
and revival of dead world, 161  
angels moved by prayers of, 34  
a powerful Sign of existence of  
Allah the Creator 32  
appeared after death of Jesus as  
Ahmad 59  
as a criterion to judge truthfulness  
335–336  
attacks and mockery against  
religion of, 493  
blessings upon sincere servants  
of, 161  
bond with Allah preceded creation  
of Adam, 31  
characterized two ages as being  
good 251  
character of ulema of Islam fore-  
told by, 51  
Chief of Prophets, and most  
perfect example for all humans  
142  
combines all points of guidance  
of various Prophets 397

companionship of angels for, 121  
companions of, and Ahmadiyya  
Muslim Community 1  
companions of, believed without  
demanding a Sign 387  
complete superiority of, over  
other prophets 143–144  
death of, 59  
defeat and destruction of ene-  
mies of, 598  
dream of, holding book *Ā’ina-e-*  
*Kamālāt-e-Islām* 252  
dreams and visions of Promised  
Messiah in which he saw, 541  
eagerness and fire of devotion of  
Promised Messiah for, 37, 40  
element of revelation in the errors  
of interpretation of, 119  
everlasting blessings of 257  
every word of, reflects divine  
splendour 99 120  
exonerated Jesus of all false charges  
396  
face bright like full moon 527  
favours of Eternal Beloved upon,  
31  
forgiveness depends upon following,  
161  
glad tidings for those who travel to  
seek knowledge 616  
glad tidings for true monotheists  
617  
Grace of Allah greatest upon,  
157–161  
Grace of Allah to meet all his  
needs 150  
grandeur and wealth of Islam by  
following, 72  
grandeur of status of, 145  
harm done to Islam by erroneous  
beliefs of *maulawīs* about 116  
help of Holy Spirit to companions  
of, 162

- holiness of, 96
- Holy Quran on Holy Spirit abiding permanently with 96
- humility of, 144
- immense resolve of, 32
- in dream of Promised Messiah 524
- intercession by, on Day of Judgment 32
- Jesus' supposed ascension conflicts with death of, 58
- life of, to be half the age of Jesus's life 465
- light bestowed upon, and his true followers 142
- light of God reflected in, 39
- magnificence of, displayed by Holy Quran 426
- manifestation of Eternal Beauty of Allah 32
- most truthful in word and deed 335
- nearness to Allah attained by, 31
- ode in praise of, 251, 575
- on dreams of truthful 335
- opposition to, 493
- pathos and prayers for humanity of, 34
- perfect manifestation of glorious divine attributes 88
- perfect teaching revealed to, 163
- person who obeys, 257
- placed his hand on shoulder of Salman the Persian 256
- poem in praise of, and devotion to, 31
- powerful Sign of existence of Creator 32
- prayer of Promised Messiah for, 699
- Promised Messiah's burning passion to obey, 52
- Promised Messiah's dream about, 542
- Promised Messiah's dream of, 542
- Promised Messiah's pain from abuses against, 68
- prophecies of, 484
- prophecy about a rejuvenator in latter days 393–394
- Prophecy in Holy Quran about latter day group to join companions of, 247
- prophecy of, for reformer in every century 4
- Quran indicating advent of, after Jesus' death 61
- reason for being foremost of Muslims 157
- religion of, revived all dead 459
- sacrilegied in books of Lekh Ram 684
- saying of, that only two ummahs are good 254
- services of, to creation of Allah 32
- signs which opponents of, saw manifested during his lifetime 698
- similarity of his time to time of Noah 35
- so-called muwahhids harbour deep enmity of, 160
- source of light divine 261
- special will of God taking hold of, on certain occasions 120
- spirituality of, manifests itself in one of his perfect followers 403
- spiritual judgement in truth was advent of, 251
- spiritual life depends upon following, 162



- spiritual resurrection brought about by, 246
- stature and prestige of, 68
- superiority of, over Jesus 75
- surpasses all and every kind of excellence 32
- teachings of, extend to Day of Judgement 57
- trace of Divine qualities in 263–264
- truthfulness of, 535
- twelve arguments made by, about Jesus' death 64
- universality of teachings of, 57
- use of word *tawaffi* for, in Holy Quran 61
- was never misguided 149
- wonderful spiritual transformation in companions of, 245, 257
- Muhammad Holy Prophet,**  
**Prophecies of 484**  
 rejuvenator in latter days 393
- Muhammad Ḥusain Batālawī**  
 challenge to, 661
- failure of efforts of, 646
- foremost in diverting people from Promised Messiah 660
- has no true well-wishers 662
- love for fame and pride of, 662
- manifest Sign for, 606
- pretends to be Sun of Punjab 662
- satanic pride of, 600
- spiritual blindness of, 597
- Mujaddid**  
 no other claimant than Promised Messiah as, of fourteenth century, 393
- Promised Messiah informed that he is, 698
- reason for naming, of fourteenth century as Promised Messiah 393
- Mūsā (Moses), Ḥaḍrat**  
 confrontation with serpent 57
- rod of, 88
- Musleh**  
 need for, 666
- Muslim(s)**  
 Allah desired to heal wounds of, 503
- Allah made life of Noor-ud-Deen source of help for, 568
- and Queen 513
- and Sikhs 500
- are best of people because they have been created for reformation of mankind 163
- belief of, Jesus being alive helps Christians 438
- believing in teachings of Allah and His Messenger is sufficient for being a, 50
- children of, have vulnerability to external influences 58
- comparison with Jews during Jesus' time 64
- current challenges and adversities faced by, 64
- Day of Judgement will manifest who is, 42
- defined 78
- deserving title of, 80
- designation of *kāfir* to, 50
- deterioration of state of, 499
- do not understand descent of Jesus 530
- drifting away from Islamic tenets 58
- have shifted away from Islamic teachings 58
- Holy Prophet foremost of, 157
- lack of attention to warnings 3
- modern, have no interest in understanding Quran 56
- nation divided into sects 539

newly educated, are removed  
from Islam 58  
oppressed state of, 501  
person claiming to be, 79  
Promised Messiah calling atten-  
tion to, in regards to attacks of  
Christians in literature 438  
prophecy of Lekh Ram Sign for,  
as well 685  
putting, to trial 532  
Queen is sheltering wing for, 508  
reject this light 258  
should welcome British Empire  
507  
significance of trial for, 55  
state of, 484  
state of, at time of Sikh rule 500  
superficial understanding of  
Quran 56  
under reign of British as opposed  
to reign of Sikhs 506  
urgency for proactive engagement  
55  
why, were divided into sects 539

**Mysteries**  
of spiritual world 275

**Mystics**  
so-called, are fond of singing and  
music 453

**Nadhīr Ḥusain, Miyān**  
first to issue edict of apostasy 48,  
49

**Nafs-e-ammārah**  
status of, in three degrees of fa-  
voured ones of God 127–128

**Nafs-e-muṭma'innah**  
defined as soul at peace 128

**Naturalists**  
denial of miracles by, 86  
repentance of many, 664

**Newspaper**  
for support of Islam 631

## **Nishān-e-Āsmānī**

advise to do *Istikhārah* in accord-  
ance to condition laid down  
in, 412  
visions of saints about Promised  
Messiah mentioned in, 405

## **Niyog**

custom of, 462

## **Noor-ud-Deen, Ḥaḍrat Hakeem**

### **Maulawī**

books of, 565, 568  
chairman of committee at Jalsa of  
1892 631  
constructed house in Qadian for  
Jalsa 613, 625  
eloquence of, 567  
excellent qualities of, 564  
gave great financial help to Islam  
564  
generosity of, like heavy rain 568  
insight of Quran of, 601  
never seen such great scholar in  
whole world 565  
speech at Jalsa of 1892 630

## **Nūḥ (Noah), Ḥaḍrat**

similarity of his time to time of  
Holy Prophet 35

## **Numerical values**

of letters of verse 256  
significance of, in Holy Quran  
256

## **Nūr Afshān**

background and wording  
of prophecy critiqued by,  
325–326  
harsh words and abuse by, 321  
letter published in, 320  
mentioned in prophecy 325  
misconception in, 243  
no lustful element in prophecy  
critiqued by, 328  
response to, 251  
unjust comments of 321

**Nutfah (Sperm Drop)**

description of, 240

**Nuzûl**

true meaning of, 471

**Oath**

philosophy of, taken by God

Almighty 177

point to similarity between God's

Word and deeds 177

**Oaths in Holy Quran**

God Almighty has sworn by

heavens and stars to explain

protective influence of angels

177

of how heavens and stars serve

to explain other subtle acts of

Allah 177

point out that all these Words

and deeds flow from same

fountain. 177

point out wisdom and subtlety of

design in creation 177

**Obedience**

to Creator 80

**Objections**

against Islam 54

**Observation**

experience or, furnishes most

frequent form of proof in this

world 223

**Ode**

in praise of Holy Prophet 251,

575

**Oneness**

of Allah 213, 536

**Oppression**

of Muslims 501

**Ovum**

mingling of sperm and, is first

stage of development 234

**Passions**

one should control one's, for

pleasure of Allah 130

**Peace**

prevailing, along sea and land in

this age 487

**People**

state of, in time of Promised

Messiah 52

when, gather and begin to live

in certain place a social system

arises 534

**People of the Book**

different terms used for, in latter

day prophecies 311

**Permission**

given to Promised Messiah to

enter into *mubāhalah* 309

**Pharaoh**

drowning of, and his mischievous

people 323

**Philosophers**

denial of miracles by, 86

efforts of, amount to claim to

Prophethood and Divinity

398–399

**Philosophy**

and rationalism 270

leads to atheism 289

poison of modern, 58

**Physician**

Promised Messiah's father was

expert, 521

**Pleiades**

if Faith were in, 255

**Poetry**

addressed to Ahmadiyya Muslim

Community 1

praise of Holy Prophet 31

**Polygamy**

according to Bible 323

principle of, 322

wisdom of permission of, 322

**Poverty**

lavishly spending in God's way

prevents, 2

**Power**

of intention 229

**Praise**

couplets about thankfulness and,  
for God 703

ode in, of Holy Prophet 575

**Prayer(s)**

acceptance of, 270, 571

Allah accepts, of Promised Mes-  
siah 493

closing, of Promised Messiah in  
announcement regarding Lekh  
Ram 685

for helpers of Faith 3

for increase in knowledge 157

for Queen 509

of Promised Messiah 699

of Promised Messiah against  
enemies 549

of Promised Messiah for Allah's  
creation 496

of Promised Messiah for Ḥaḍrat  
Maulawī Noor-ud-Deen 571

Promised Messiah's plea for  
reflection and, 70

signs of acceptance of, 270

those who deny possibility of  
acceptance of, 270

**Preaching**

by Promised Messiah 538

**Prejudice**

spiritual blindness caused by, 351

**Printing Press**

complaints about, 647

invention of, 488

need for, 655

proposal for establishing, 647

proposals for, presented at Jalsa  
631

**Progeny**

increase in, of Promised Messiah  
677

Promised Messiah's, will flourish  
677

**Promise**

Allah always keeps His, 533

**Promised Messiah**

after meeting, even *maulawīs*  
become humble 661

Ahmad Baig's wife asked consent  
of, for release of land 551

Allah commanded, to demand  
hand of Ahmad Baig's elder  
daughter 553

announcement about *Ā'ina-e-*  
*Kamālāt-e-Islām* 687

announcement about  
*Barāhin-e-Aḥmadiyya* 697

announcement made for  
non-Musliim religious leaders  
313

appeal to Muslims on urgency of  
current situation 70

blessings for those who accept,  
458

blessings with birth of, 520  
challenge of, to his opponents  
261, 454

challenges to all with reward  
equalling all his immovable  
property 316–318

claim of, entails no change in  
tenets of Islam 391

Community of, 409

conclusive verdict about Sheikh  
Mehr 'Alī 693

declaration of victory over all  
false doctrines in *mubāhalah*  
407

deep pain of, from abuses against  
Holy Prophet 68

determination to enter into  
spiritual contest with non-Mus-  
lim leaders 407

doctrine taught to, by Allah 538

- eagerness and fire of devotion for Holy Prophet 37, 39, 40
- gratefulness to British Empire 507
- has come with wisdom and insight 485
- has deep rooted love for Holy Quran 521
- heart of, gravitates towards Quran 521
- high status of Companions of, 1
- holy change in followers of, 604
- Holy Quran delight of life for, 522
- humility of, 52, 608
- invitation to those who doubt him 452
- issued invitations to Islam for opponents 664
- khilāfat* of, is spiritual 311
- Kingdom of Heaven granted to, 311
- letter to Ahmad Baig 553
- life of, 518
- lights of *Furqān* granted to, 511
- love for Holy Prophet 523
- manifestation of heavenly miracles and its light 492
- message of, to different peoples 495
- misconceptions of Indian ulema about, 495
- morals and treasures of true understanding granted to, 494
- no ill-will against anyone 672
- no other claimant of *Mujaddid* after 14th Century 393
- notice for permission to publish some news about Batālāwī 333
- nourished with Allah's mercy 461
- pain caused by Batālāwī to, 337
- plea for reflection and supplication 70
- poem of, in praise of Holy Prophet 31
- points of speech of, at Jalsa 630
- praise for Noor-ud-Deen 563
- raised to show beauty of Allah 74
- readiness of, for spiritual contest 407
- recognition of, from amongst righteous 495
- regarding importance of meeting, 660
- responses to Batalwi's criticisms 602
- revelation of, about death of Jesus 529
- revelation of unseen matters as a Sign of truth, 493
- revelations of, concerning Batalawi 608
- revelations started at age of 40 524
- revelation upon being commissioned 184
- speech at Jalsa of 1892 630
- story of acceptance of, by lawyer from Amritsar 658
- sympathy for Batālāwī 331
- text of *Mubāhalah* challenge 307
- those who come with signs of righteousness recognize, 495
- truthfulness in perilous court cases 340–345
- waited before disclosing revelation 529
- widespread public announcement to other faiths' leaders for spiritual contest based on gift of revelation 405
- Promised Messiah, Advent of**
- appearance in latter days 248
- given divine mission 52, 71

happened at crucial time 539  
 has come to glorify message of  
     Islam 450  
 has substance and essence of  
     attributes of Jesus 402  
 Messenger named Ahmad proph-  
     esied by Jesus 59  
 news of appearance given by some  
     men of God before his advent  
     405  
 period of 250  
 sent at time of many disorders as  
     Sign of truth, 492  
 sent in likeness of Messiah 47  
 sent to pull people out of dark-  
     ness 52  
 shall break Cross 481  
 state of people in time of 52  
 will appear at time of Gog and  
     Magog 481  
 will be known by lights that ap-  
     pear before his advent 480  
 will come at time of domination  
     of people of Cross 482  
 will come when people will be  
     brought together 487  
 will happen in time of *Dajjāl* 481  
**Promised Messiah, Advice of**  
 exhortations to ulema 494  
 to extend forth hand of generosi-  
     ty for victory of Islam 2  
 to hold fast to book of Allah 490  
 to remove hypocrisy and discord  
     1  
 to turn away from obstinacy and  
     embrace righteousness 71  
 unheeded by Muslims 3  
 warning against opposing divine-  
     ly ordained initiative 70  
**Promised Messiah, Dreams &  
     Visions of**  
 about Ḥaḍrat 'Alī 253  
 about Holy Prophet 542

in early youth 524  
 interpreted dream as meaning  
     God Almighty would send his  
     help 561  
 saddling his horse 559  
 saw Holy Prophet 524, 527  
 saw Holy Prophet many times in  
     visions 541  
 vision about God Almighty 544  
 visions of Holy Prophet 40  
 visions of saints about, mentioned  
     in *Nishan-e-Aasmani* 405  
**Promised Messiah, Family &  
     Ancestry**  
 account of forefathers of, 497  
 account of his ancestors 518  
 ancestors were rulers 499  
 brief account of his life 497  
 grandfather was poisoned to  
     death 519  
 hardship faced by Promised Mes-  
     siah's father 519  
 his father 519  
 incidents about his family 546  
 Persian ancestry 497  
**Promised Messiah, High Rank of**  
 Allah appointed, as Maṣiḥ Ibn-e-  
     Maryam 528  
 Allah has sent, as Arbiter 539  
 appointed by Allah 496  
 appointed by God in this age to  
     safeguard Islam 299  
 exalted by God 663  
 has been appointed as Adam 599  
 Imam and vicegerent for this time  
     and age 461  
 informed that he is *Mujaddid*  
     698  
 was made *Muhaddath* 547  
**Promised Messiah, Love for Islam**  
 efforts made to convey message of  
     Islam 258

- lights of Islam surging in him 261
- losses borne by him only to uphold truth 331
- message about One Lord to Queen 511
- pain for Islam 43
- perfect belief in all Islamic teachings 443
- preaching by 538
- reconciled two doctrines about Jesus 530
- served Faith even while suffering 53
- served Islam at age of 20 523
- some books written by him 523
- wrote treatises in support of Islam 47
- zeal for Islam and obeying the Prophet 52
- Promised Messiah, Mission of**  
to pull people out of darkness 52
- Promised Messiah, Opposition to**  
accusations against, 48  
consequences of opposing divinely ordained mission of, 71  
edicts of disbelief against, 48  
false accusations towards him 3  
fate of opponents, 458  
gave Christians opportunity to attribute faulty thinking to Islam 105  
ill-will and prejudice of opponents 261–262  
opponents caught by unreasonable beliefs due to their enmity 105  
roles of mullahs in, 48  
subjected to edicts of apostasy 254
- Promised Messiah, Prayers of 699**  
against enemies 549  
for Allah's creation 496  
for creation of Allah 496  
for Hadrat Maulawi Noor-ud-Deen 571  
for power and intervention 3  
over the plight of Muslims 73  
prayer for spiritually sick 370
- Promised Messiah, Prophecies of**  
about collateral relations 677  
about Mirza Ahmad Baig 319, 367–368  
about Promised Son 676  
about scattering of stars 488  
about Sheikh Mehr 'Alī 690  
about victory and triumph 678  
are fulfilled 664  
birth of son 347  
fearful prophecy conveyed to Promised Messiah concerning someone 672  
have been fulfilled 664  
humiliation of Batālawī 417  
increase in progeny 677  
no prophecy of, has turned out false 602  
progeny will flourish 677
- Promised Messiah, Relationship with Allah**  
Allah taught perfect verities and sublime insights to, 52  
Allah taught subtleties of Holy Quran and Sunnah 529  
Allah will give grace to Promised Messiah 557  
Allah witness to his truthfulness 490  
experiences of divine converse 316

God conferred upon Promised  
 Messiah true friend 563  
 gratitude to Allah 52  
 help by Allah 492, 497  
 only friend is Allah 572  
 reliance on Allah alone 50  
 strength of faith despite tribula-  
 tions 248  
 support of Allah 604  
 trust in Allah 53

### **Promised Messiah, Signs of**

#### **Truthfulness of**

acceptance of prayers 493  
 Allah has borne witness to his  
 truthfulness 490  
 God has enabled him to follow  
 Holy Prophet 493  
 granted knowledge of Quran 494  
 has been sent at time of many  
 disorders 492  
 huge display of meteors in sky  
 upon his being commissioned  
 184  
 indicators to guide seekers  
 393–394  
 knowledge of Holy Quran 494  
 many men of God gave news of  
 his coming 405  
 obedience to Holy Prophet 493  
 sent at time of many disorders  
 492  
 spiritual Sign for his truthfulness  
 605  
 two Signs manifested in his  
 favour 646  
 will prevail in visions and revela-  
 tions 407

### **Promised One**

has appeared 310

### **Proof**

experience or observation fur-  
 nishes most frequent form of,  
 in this world 223

### **Prophecy**

Allah unveils, at appointed time  
 532  
 not been made public 329  
 not under one's control 671  
 of astrologers not comparable to  
 divine prophecies 367  
 treatise *Sirāj-e-Munīr* includes  
 three kinds of, 671

### **Prophet(s)**

adaptability of, 57  
 Allah chooses man for sake of  
 His, 531  
 believers as slaves of, 160  
 charges levied against all, 603  
 dangers of false, 71  
 descent of, to this world 531  
 discourse of, 480  
 Divine retribution for false, 71  
 Divine support in tune with  
 societal challenges 57  
 God Almighty helped His, ac-  
 cording to needs of time 57  
 heirs of, 517  
 man who stands in place of, 272  
*muḥaddath* has capacity of, 268  
 purpose served by errors of judge-  
 ment by, 120  
 saints of past, descend upon earth  
 276  
 Seal of, 517  
 speak in metaphors 480  
 statanic accusations against, 598

### **Prosperity**

Allah will give Promised Messiah,  
 557

### **Punishment**

contrast between pleasant life  
 and, 53

### **Punjab**

ancestors of Promised Messiah  
 settled in, 497



**Qadian**

- history of, 497
- popularly known as Islampur 497
- proposals for printing press in, presented at Jalsa 631

**Qiblah**

- declaring someone *kāfir* who faces, 50

**Queen. see also Empress of India**

- advice to repent 512
- and Muslims 513
- good governess of, 510
- government of, 505
- great bounty from, of India 508
- great freedom under rule of, 509
- invitation to Islam 510
- prayer for, 509

**Quraish**

- lineage of Noor-ud-Deen traces back to, 564

**Quran, Holy**

- 3,000 objections against, 54
- ability to obliterate darkness 57
- account of heavens absolutely correct in, 222
- adaptive nature against evolving challenges 57
- advice to Queen about, 511
- Allah granted knowledge of, to Promised Messiah 494
- all that is in heavens can be cut asunder according to, 224
- blessings of granting Holy Spirit to all elect people in, 96–98
- combination of wisdom, knowledge, and communication 57
- commandment in, to make use of planning and good management 619
- commentary on *Sūrah ad-Ḍuḥā* in, 149
- concealed mysteries and meanings in, 56

- conflict of ulema with, and *aḥādīth* 50
- critical need of learning, 426
- death of Jesus mentioned in, 529
- decreed all inventions before time 490
- disclosed mystery that faculties of stars derive grace from angels 202
- dispelling darkness in various eras 57
- Divine retribution for false prophet 71
- eloquence and lucidity of, 57
- endless excellences in, 57
- essence of teachings of, 294
- established as supreme authority 529
- eternal reformation through, 58
- every book besides, is defective creation 522
- exhorts believers to attain Holy Spirit 97
- far-fetched interpretations of, 296
- foretold Signs of Latter Days 491
- great mistake to ascribe literal meaning to every word in, 225
- has ability to obliterate darkness 57
- heart of Promised Messiah gravitating towards, 521
- importance of understanding teachings of, 61
- indicating Jesus' death and Muhammad's advent 61
- is a surging sea of guidance 443
- is delight in life 521
- is rare pearl 521
- is replete with wonderful secrets 446
- Jesus' continued life, a contradiction with prophecy of, 59

- limitless beauties of, 57  
 love of, in heart of Noor-ud-Deen 569  
 Mary the Truthful mentioned in, 63  
 matchless wonders placed in, 55  
 meaning of 'heavens will be cleft asunder' in, 224  
 mentions tribulations in Islam 69  
 message of, extends to Day of Judgement 57  
 metaphors in, 225  
 miracle of teachings of, 101  
 mission of, is eternal reformation 58  
 not learning of, is hypocrisy 424  
 number of commandments in, 162  
 on behaviour towards Messengers of Allah 51  
 on death of Jesus 529  
 Oneness of God emphasized in, 62  
 on nature of heavens 222  
 on punishment for hypocrites 152  
 on truthfulness of believers' dreams 335–336  
 on why has man been endowed with powerful emotions for good and evil 101  
 overcoming turmoil of *Dajjāl* 57  
 people ignorant of beauties of, 55  
 prayer of Promised Messiah that people follow, 699  
 promise of prevailing light over darkness 57  
 purifies hearts and bestows light into them 511  
 reformative role for humanity 57  
 remedying the mischief of every age 57  
 rich source of spiritual insights 47  
 scholars of astronomy not in conflict with Noble, 221  
 self-sufficient for meaning of its expressions 130  
 semi-monthly paper on commentary on verses of, 647  
 Signs of Latter Days in, 485  
 some parts of, explain others 146  
 some special features of usage in, 148  
 source of spiritual insights 47  
 superficial understanding among Muslims 56  
 target of objections from all fields of life 54  
 teachings of, relevant across different ages 61  
 testimony of Jesus in, 59  
 those who prefer couplets of poets over verses of, 448  
 timeless excellences 57  
 title of "Light" given to Holy Spirit in, 108  
 transformational impact on society 57  
 travelling for sake of religious knowledge made obligatory by, 613  
 two reasons for superiority of teachings of, 126  
 ultimate calamity mentioned in, and Hadith 69  
 ultimate object is to be guidance for righteous 131  
 verities of, 47  
 verse of, on meaning of Islam 77  
 verse of, referencing natural death of Jesus 60  
 verses showing that Holy Spirit is granted to, 107–109  
 wonders decreed in, 490

**Qutbī**

book of Promised Messiah 525

**Rafa‘**

God's promise of *tawaffī* and, 63

**Rahim Bakhsh, Maulawī**

fatwa of, 627

ignorant scholar of latter days,  
613

**Rahmāniyat**

beginning of understanding the  
Divine 158  
cognition of, gift of pure grace  
from God 158

**Rain**

case of spiritual, 67

**Rallia Ram**

case filed by, 341  
vision of Promised Messiah  
about, 341

**Rancour**

rise in contemporary times 54

**Rasūl**

common application of, to Mes-  
senger, Prophet, or Muḥaddath  
368

**Rationalism**

philosophy and, 270

**Reality of Islam**

first means of attaining, 154  
how can, be achieved 154  
knowledge and understanding  
means of attaining to, 158

**Reasoning**

Allah has helped Promised Messi-  
ah with arguments and, 557

**Reformer (Muṣleḥ, Mujaddid)**

need for, 666  
Promised Messiah informed that  
he is, 698  
reference to *ahādīth* about, of  
Ummah 4

**Religion**

Allah chose Promised Messiah to  
reform His, 547  
discrepancy between teaching  
and embodying teachings of,  
65  
misuse of, for personal motiva-  
tions 49

**Resurrection**

claim of Jesus regarding 243  
claim of Jesus regarding, 257  
which restored spiritual life to  
humanity 246

**Revelation. see also Vision(s)**

*ahādīth* about manner of, 114  
Arabic revelation regarding Lekh  
Ram 683  
difference between discourse and,  
265  
doors of, opened to Promised  
Messiah 527  
false claimants of, not granted  
long life 71  
God addressed Promised Messiah  
in, 673  
humility of recipient of, 269  
Promised Messiah given, to de-  
clare openly that which he has  
been commanded 529  
Promised Messiah's, fulfilled  
regarding Ahmad Baig 556  
received after supplicating to God  
about Lekh Ram 683  
role of Jibrā'il in, 115  
to Ḥaḍrat 'Īsā no different from  
other Prophets, 115  
transcends nature of man 288  
why was, kept secret 328

**Reward**

earned in earlier stages, by doing  
good under opposing emotions  
169  
philosophy of, 294  
spending in God's way 2

**Righteous**

Allah's support for, 351  
 departure of, from world prophe-  
 cised in Holy Quran 488  
 Holy Spirit remains with, 93  
 saving of, in Hereafter 139–140

**Righteousness**

cannot co-exist with ignorance  
 153  
 necessity for understanding Islam  
 3  
 those who came with signs of,  
 recognize Promised Messiah  
 495

**Sacrifice**

true and real, 266

**Sainthood**

true reality of, 270

**Saint(s)**

attention of, 571  
 prophets and, descend upon earth  
 276

**Salman the Persian**

Holy Prophet placed his hand on  
 shoulder of, 256

**Salvation**

and belief in unseen 291  
 is dependant on faith 304  
 real meaning of, 140

**Salvation Army**

going about in all countries 404

**Samarqand**

ancestors of Promised Messiah  
 lived in, 497

**Satan(s)**

appointed evil companion for  
 disbelievers 94  
 driven away by the shooting of  
 stars 193  
 influence of, vanishes in *baqā* and  
*liqā* 101  
 personal animosity between  
 angels and, 193

places mischievous thoughts in  
 hearts 167  
 possibility of influence of, in low-  
 er grade of *wahy* 415–416  
 protection from, with Holy Spirit  
 97

**Sayyed Ahmad Khan**

adverse comments made by, 282  
 contradictions and ambiguities in  
 writings of 296  
 denial of prophetic nature of  
 revelation by, 279  
 influence of free-thinkers on, 280  
 invitation to, to witness prophe-  
 cies 284  
 more appropriate course of  
 action for, 283  
 possible motivations of, 298  
 unorthodox and absurd opinions  
 about Holy Quran 280  
 views of, contrary to Islam 286

**Sayyed Muhammad Ahsan Am-  
rohi**

chosen as preacher for this Com-  
 munity at Jalsa 631

**Schools of Thought 539****Sciences**

Islamic, 507

**Sealed Mysteries**

of upright Faith disclosed to men  
 of God 264

**Seal of Prophethood. see *Khāta-  
mul-Anbiyā'*****Sects**

Muslim nation divided into, 539

**Seeker(s)**

of truth saved from terrible dark-  
 ness 55  
 true, of his Lord becomes perfect-  
 ly established upon Islam 264

**Self**

annihilation of older, 266

**Service**

reward for, 2  
serving Faith in one's life 2  
to God's creatures 80

**Seven**

meaning of, earths 228  
why God has limited number of  
heavens to, 227

**Shaikh 'Abdul Ḥaqq**

on metaphoric descent of Jibrā'il  
for revelation 122

**Shaikh Dehlawi**

ignorance of true knowledge of  
Aḥādīth 174

**Sharah-i-Ishārāt**

explanation of shooting stars in,  
185

**Shariah**

consistency with Quran 56  
innovations not rooted in, 65

**She-camel**

abandoning, 487

**Sheikh Mehr 'Alī**

Promised Messiah's prophecy  
about 690

**Shirk (Polytheism)**

after, there is no evil like arrogance 599  
considering a person uniquely  
exceptional to others is a type  
of, 62  
death of, 245  
definition and essence of, 61  
endorsement through altered  
meanings 61  
in Islam 62  
interference in God Almighty's  
attributes 61  
origins of, 61  
this age immersed in, 273

**Shooting Stars**

abundant falling of, upon Holy  
Prophet's advent 181–182  
belief of soothsayers about,  
183–184  
night before November 28 1885  
there was huge display of, in  
sky 184  
nothing conclusive in various  
explanations of, 186–189  
problem with Greek etc. explanation of, 186  
reference of, in Holy Quran  
points to appearance of prophet  
or his successor 183

**Siddiq Hassan Khan, Nawwab**

acknowledgement of, 344

**Signs**

appointed time for, which is  
never averted 382  
believe after seeing, is not beneficial 384  
blessed are those who accept  
before seeing, 407–408  
demands of Makkan disbelievers  
for, not accepted 410  
heavenly, for complete and satisfactory proof of true religion  
698  
in term *Dajjāl* 533  
manifested by the godly in every  
age 272  
miraculous, of Holy Prophet 84,  
85  
not needed by enlightened people  
382  
of Allah being rejected 492  
of Latter Days 483, 491  
of truthfulness of Promised Messiah 492, 493  
of verity of Promised Messiah  
540

those who deny truth without  
seeing, remain deniers after  
Sign 386  
two, in favour of Promised Mes-  
siah 646

### **Signs from Unseen**

as sure basis for judging truth  
316

### **Signs in Holy Quran**

abandoning she-camel 487  
abundance of mail 488  
communication among people  
487  
communication through tele-  
graph 487  
gathering together of beasts 489  
invention of printing press 488  
of prevailing peace 487  
of rare events 485  
scattering of stars 488  
shaking of earth 488  
travel by land and sea 488  
true nature of descent of Messiah  
one of, 490

### **Signs of Latter Days.** *see also* **Signs in Holy Quran**

### **Sikh(s)**

and Muslims 500  
empire compared to British 506  
extirpated Muslims and captured  
their kingdom 500  
malicious designs against ances-  
tors of Promised Messiah 519  
Muslims under reign of British as  
opposed to reign of, 506  
wrath of Allah fell upon, 502

### **Sin**

death of, 245  
true hatred for, 80  
why do humans commit, 168

### **Singular**

form of word *Dajjāl* 533

### **Sirāj-e-Munīr**

treatise of, 670

### **Sirāt-e-mustaqīm**

defined 134  
those who walked upon, here  
will be able to do in hereafter  
134–136

### **Six**

days 228  
days of week 235  
number of stages comprehended  
in Word of God 239  
stages of development 235, 236  
stages seen present in writing of  
wise and eloquent writer 239  
why, days 230

### **Social System**

arising of, 534  
creation of, 534

### **Son**

glad tidings of, 558

### **Son of Mary**

has died 529

### **Soothsayers**

*ahādīth* that falling of stars is  
meant to drive away satans  
181–182  
belief that shooting stars her-  
alded appearance of Prophet  
181–182  
fell in abundance at time of Holy  
Prophet 183  
may be prelude to appearance or  
victory of Prophet or khalifah,  
181–182

### **Soul**

God invested man with, 232

### **Space**

God has not left atmosphere as  
empty, 222

### **Speech**

of Noor-ud-Deen 567, 570

**Sperm**

mingling of, and ovum is first  
stage of development 234

**Spirit**

heaven and earth of, 234  
in human heart 92  
of faith needed for love between  
man and God 324  
of Holy Prophet 95

**Spiritual Faculties**

reason for creation of, 211

**Spiritual World**

mysteries of, 275  
mystery of past holy man acquiring perfect union with living spiritual man 275–276

**Stages of creation**

six, as called six days in Holy  
Quran 230

**Stages of development**

Six, in realms of spiritual world  
236

**Stars**

scattering of, 488

**Straight path**

is path of Prophets, Truthful, and  
Martyrs 290

**Striving**

favoured ones adopt opposition  
to their rebellious self and do  
hard, 127  
importance of personal contribution 2

**Suffering**

Divine mercy experienced amidst  
disappointments and, 2

**Sufis of Islam**

description of so-called, 450  
invitation to attend to issue of  
second coming 405  
use of phrases of ‘disposition of  
Muhammad or Abraham’ by,  
405

**Sūrah adh-Dhāriyāt**

commentary on, 197

**Sūrah al-Fātiḥah**

meaning of verse of, 626

**Sūrah al-Mu’minūn**

description of human foetus in  
womb, 231

**Sūrah al-Mursalāt**

commentary on, 198

**Sūrah an-Najm**

affirms Holy Prophet’s veracity by  
pointing to natural phenomenon 181  
commentary on some verses of,  
181–182

**Swine**

import of, in prophecies about  
latter days 311  
none else than powerful Christian  
nations of latter days 311

**Sword**

dream of Promised Messiah  
holding, 557

**Takfir**

fatwas of, 529, 539

**Tasnīm**

water of, 485

**Tauḍīḥ-e-Marām**

purpose and content of, 47  
response to, 47  
treatise in support of Islam 47  
verities of Quran discussed in 47

**Tauḥīd**

beauty and purity of, 47  
blessings of, 259  
doctrine of, 57  
no other religion shows Signs and  
light like 260  
prevalent thinking opposed to  
concept of, 70  
Quran established doctrine of,  
57  
role in defence of Islam 47

- three grades of, and their attainment 258
- Tawaffi**  
 difference in understanding, when related to Holy Prophet and Jesus in Noble Quran 61  
 endorsement of *shirk* by ulema through altered meanings of, 61  
 God's promise of rafa' and, 63  
 meaning of, 60  
 meanings and significance of word 60  
 word, used for Jesus 60
- Tawātur Ma'nawī**  
 defined 393  
 nature of *ahādīth* about a rejuvenator in latter days 393
- Tawwābīn**  
 Allah the Glorious loves, 130  
 defined 130
- Telegraph**  
 invention of, 487
- Telescopes**  
 modern, 222
- Test**  
 intended to reveal hidden potentialities 168
- Thamūd and 'Ād**  
 destruction of, 323
- Throne of Allah**  
 similarity of, to the infiniteness of Allah 224
- Time**  
 three periods of, 250
- Time of Promised Messiah**  
 criticisms of Islam in, 54  
 uproar of immorality, disbelief, and misguided intellect in, 57
- Traders**  
 abundance of, 488
- Train**  
 abandoning she-camel 487  
 industry of, engines 489
- Transgressors**  
 condition of, 483  
 do not fear Allah 483
- Travel**  
 by land and sea 488  
 fixing dates for, for religious knowledge 619
- Travellers**  
 abundance of, 488
- Travelling**  
 can be for different purposes 614
- Treasures**  
 heavenly, 490  
 of world 489
- Treatment**  
 of Allah towards disbelievers 550
- Trial(s)**  
 Divine mercy experienced through, 2  
 putting Muslims to, 532  
 significance for Muslims 55
- Tribulations**  
 present today 69
- True Believers**  
 blessings for, and qualities of, 451
- True Dreams**  
 from Gracious God recognized by majesty, blessed influence, grandeur, and resplendence 412–416
- Trust of Allah**  
 defined 143
- Two Companions**  
 influence of caller to evil virtually disappears in stages of *baqā* and *liqā* 100  
 miraculous nature of Quranic teachings about, 101  
 permanent appointment of caller to good and caller to evil 100



**Ulema**

- absence of good intentions of, 50
- characteristics of, resembling Jews as was foretold 51
- conflict with Book of Allah and Prophetic traditions 50
- decline in righteousness and integrity in, 64
- discrepancy between preaching and practicing of, 65
- errors and misconceptions of present day, 64
- evils of, 488
- exhortations to, 494
- failure of, to comprehend diverse truths 50
- habit of accusing others of disbelief 50, 51
- implicit support for polytheistic beliefs 59
- influence of Christian polytheistic notions on, 61
- issue decrees without true knowledge 508
- misinterpretation of meaning of *tawaffi* 61
- non-acceptance of men of God by, 51
- obliviousness of, to challenges facing Islam 64
- undue exaltation of Ḥaḍrat ‘Īsā by, 125
- unintended support of, for polytheistic teachings 58

**Umar Fārūq**

- breaking of door as omen of death of, 481
- carried out novel initiatives 625
- lineage of Noor-ud-Deen traces to family of, 564

**Ummahs**

- saying of Holy Prophet that only two, are good 254

**Universe**

- Greek view of, 222
- man is miniature, 232
- miniature, 231
- ultimate annihilation of material, 225

**Unseen**

- Allah reveals matters of, to Promised Messiah 493

**Vacuum**

- wrong to say heavens are mere, 223

**Vedas**

- polytheism and immoral teachings of *niyog* in, 462

**Verdict from God**

- needed to settle religious strife 315

**Verse**

- numerical values of letters of, 256

**Victory**

- Allah will give Promised Messiah, 557
- glad tidings of honour and, to Promised Messiah 310

**Virtue(s)**

- concept of, 541
- of Noor-ud-Deen 568

**Visible**

- not necessary that all things be, to our eyes 224

**Vision(s)**

- about ‘Alī ibn Abī Ṭālib 543
- establish status of man as miniature universe 212
- of five blessed persons 527
- of Promised Messiah 541
- Promised Messiah’s vision about God 544
- true, 524
- wonders of world of, 136–138

**Wahye Ghair Matlū**

- introduction to, 415–416

- why are prophetic Aḥādīth called, 175
- Wahye Matlū**  
is absolutely pure of Satan's interference 415  
is the Word of God 415
- Wahy (Revelation)**  
purifies hearts of internal impurities 65
- Wali**  
acquisition of noble status of, 425  
who is, 270
- Warning**  
call for careful consideration of current times 69
- War(s)**  
abolition of, by Promised Messiah 311  
he will abolish, 311
- Week**  
six days of, 235
- Wife**  
confining to principle of one, 322
- Wilāyat**  
true reality of, 270
- Wisdom**  
of Noor-ud-Deen 567
- seeking refuge in Allah is ultimate, 5
- Word of God.** *see*  
six stages comprehended in, 239
- World**  
darkness of, 39  
treasures of, 489  
when disorder takes root in, 531
- Worldly Sufis**  
description of, 447
- Worship of God**  
becomes intention and will of those with *Nafs-e-Muṭma'in-nah* 128
- Writer**  
six stages can be seen present in writing of wise and eloquent, 239
- Yogis**  
influence on Muslim ascetics 65
- Youth**  
dream in early, of Promised Messiah 524
- Zālim**  
defined as, 127–133  
linguistic discussion of word 130–134